

Polylogarithms and their Arithmetic Bridges
Special Values, Zeta Jets, Lattices and Experimental Discovery

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Preface

The purpose of this manuscript is to develop a common mathematical language for special values that first appear in rather different guises: nested sums, arctangent integrals, gamma products, lattice row sums and coefficients of Hurwitz zeta. Its central movement is from experimental discovery to exact structure. A well-chosen computation can suggest a transformation, reveal an unexpected character component or expose a missing generator. A proof then explains the phenomenon and determines its range of validity.

The material originates in thirty-nine articles, reports and literature surveys from the PolyLog programme in the Smithereens repository, together with eleven later continuation packages containing seventeen research deliveries. The latter supply exact reductions, unrestricted formal ranks, positive kernel geometry and certified asymptotics that supersede earlier gaps. The present text merges overlapping treatments, uses later corrected formulas, and revises claims whose original wording exceeded the evidence. It is organized by mathematical dependency rather than by the order of research sessions. The source inventory and editorial ledger accompany the manuscript.

There are three distinct meanings of “exact” in this work. An analytic identity may have a proof in ordinary mathematics. A row combination or a shuffle calculation may be checked by finite exact arithmetic, relative to its stated law vocabulary. A numerical identity may instead have a very small independently recomputed residual. These are valuable and different forms of evidence. In particular, an unsuccessful integer-relation search proves neither independence nor minimal depth, and a zero canary coefficient does not prove that a proposed relation is exact. No result in this project has yet been formalized in a proof assistant.

The chapter order follows this distinction. Nested sums and iterated integrals establish the algebra; cyclotomic Fourier transforms organize its arithmetic coordinates; algebraic-argument transformations and depth experiments identify candidate special values. Signed kernels and certified computation expose their analytic geometry. Gamma certificates and CM lattices connect these values to periods. Hurwitz-zeta jets unify integration and differentiation, and the Herglotz function carries these bridges into real-quadratic arithmetic. The final chapter returns to experimental design and the proof problems that this progression leaves open.

Historical residuals, performance measurements and search counts refer to the source snapshots, whose scripts and identity stores were not all imported into ProveIt. Fresh checks in the accompanying verification directory are labeled separately. Attribution is retained for classical identities and published theorems; an experimental rediscovery is not a claim of priority. The original drafts were prepared with agentic assistance from Anthropic Claude, with an external OpenAI review of the Stieltjes integration article; the present consolidation and additional audit were assisted by OpenAI Codex.

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Chapter 1

From one polylogarithm to many

An ordinary polylogarithm has two descriptions: a series and an iterated integral. Nesting the first and extending the alphabet of the second produce the same larger class of functions. Their two multiplication laws then provide exact relations. This chapter fixes conventions before those relations are used to organize special values.

1.1 Multiple polylogarithms: two faces

The classical polylogarithm $\text{Li}_s(z) = \sum_{n \geq 1} z^n/n^s$ has, for the reader of Lewin, two complementary descriptions: a power series and an iterated integral $\text{Li}_s(z) = \int_0^z \text{Li}_{s-1}(t) dt/t$. Each survives the passage to many indices, and the resulting two descriptions of one and the same function are the source of essentially every nontrivial identity in this circle of ideas. We set up both here; the products they generate occupy the next section.

1.1.1 The nested sum

Definition 1.1. For $s_1, \dots, s_k \in \mathbb{C}$ and $z_1, \dots, z_k \in \mathbb{C}$ the multiple polylogarithm is the strictly nested sum

$$\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}(z_1, \dots, z_k) = \sum_{n_1 > n_2 > \dots > n_k \geq 1} \prod_{i=1}^k \frac{z_i^{n_i}}{n_i^{s_i}}.$$

Its weight is $w = s_1 + \dots + s_k$ and its depth is k . The single-index case $k = 1$ recovers $\text{Li}_s(z)$.

Two features of this definition demand comment before anything is proved.

Remark 1.2 (Conventions differ; ours is fixed). The inequality is *strict*, $n_1 > n_2 > \dots > n_k$. A sizable part of the literature (and several computer-algebra systems) instead uses a non-strict summation $n_1 \geq n_2 \geq \dots \geq n_k$, or reverses the role of the indices so that the *innermost* summation variable carries the first parameter. These choices are genuinely different functions (they differ by lower-depth terms, exactly the diagonal contributions $n_i = n_{i+1}$), and the discrepancy is the single most common source of sign and indexing confusion when comparing sources. We adhere throughout to the strict, “outermost variable carries s_1 ” convention above. The arguments are likewise ordered with z_1 paired to the largest index n_1 . When checking against `MultiplePolyLog`, confirm the convention numerically on a small case rather than assuming agreement.

Remark 1.3 (Multiple zeta values). Setting every $z_i = 1$ gives the *multiple zeta value*

$$\zeta(s_1, \dots, s_k) = \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}(1, \dots, 1) = \sum_{n_1 > \dots > n_k \geq 1} \prod_i n_i^{-s_i},$$

the central special values of the theory (Zagier 1994; Hoffman 1992). The strict nesting is what makes $\zeta(s_1, \dots, s_k)$ finite for $s_1 \geq 2$.

Convergence. The single-variable series $\text{Li}_s(z)$ converges absolutely for $|z| < 1$ (any s), on $|z| = 1$ for $\Re s > 1$, and conditionally on $|z| = 1$, $z \neq 1$, for $\Re s > 0$. For the nested sum the corresponding statement is clean.

Proposition 1.4 (A sufficient absolute-convergence domain). *For positive integer indices, the nested series converges absolutely when $|z_i| \leq 1$ for all i and $s_1 \geq 2$. It also converges absolutely for $|z_1| < 1$, $|z_i| \leq 1$ for $i > 1$, with $s_1 \geq 1$.*

Proof. The absolute value of the inner nested sum is at most $H_{n_1-1}^{k-1} = O((1 + \log n_1)^{k-1})$. The outer series is therefore bounded by $\sum |z_1|^{n_1} (1 + \log n_1)^{k-1} / n_1^{s_1}$, which converges in either stated case. $\square$

These are sufficient conditions, not a complete classification of every boundary point. Oscillation can give conditional convergence: $\text{Li}_1(-1)$ converges, but $\sum |(-1)^n / n|$ diverges. More generally, away from the polydisc an interior domain is given by $|z_1 \cdots z_j| < 1$ for each $1 \leq j \leq k$. At unity, for positive integer indices, admissibility is exactly $s_1 \geq 2$.

1.1.2 The iterated integral

The second face is Chen's iterated integral. Fix the two differential one-forms

$$\omega_0 = \frac{dt}{t}, \quad \omega_1 = \frac{dt}{1-t},$$

and, for a word $u = a_1 a_2 \cdots a_w$ in the letters $\{0, 1\}$, write the iterated integral over the standard simplex

$$\int_0^z u = \int_{0 < t_1 < t_2 < \cdots < t_w < z} \omega_{a_w}(t_1) \omega_{a_{w-1}}(t_2) \cdots \omega_{a_1}(t_w),$$

i.e. the leftmost letter a_1 is attached to the *outermost* (largest) variable t_w and one integrates from the top down. This is the orientation under which d/dz strips the outermost form. With this normalization the one-variable multiple polylogarithm is an iterated integral over a single explicit word.

Theorem 1.5 (Iterated-integral representation). *For $s_1 \geq 2$ and the remaining $s_i \geq 1$,*

$$\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}(z, 1, \dots, 1) = \int_0^z \underbrace{0^{s_1-1} 1}_{\text{block 1}} \underbrace{0^{s_2-1} 1}_{\text{block 2}} \cdots \underbrace{0^{s_k-1} 1}_{\text{block k}},$$

the iterated integral of the binary word

$$u(\mathbf{s}) = 0^{s_1-1} 1 0^{s_2-1} 1 \cdots 0^{s_k-1} 1$$

of length w . Equivalently, with the alternative kernel $\tilde{\omega}_1 = dt/(t-1) = -\omega_1$ one carries one sign per 1-letter, giving the textbook normalization

$$\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}(z, 1, \dots, 1) = (-1)^k \int_{0 < t_1 < \cdots < t_w < z} \prod_{j=1}^w \eta_{a_{w+1-j}}(t_j), \quad \eta_0 = \frac{dt}{t}, \quad \eta_1 = \frac{dt}{t-1},$$

the factor $(-1)^k$ being exactly the number of 1-letters in $u(\mathbf{s})$, one per block.

The composition $\leftrightarrow$ word dictionary. The map $\mathbf{s} = (s_1, \dots, s_k) \mapsto u(\mathbf{s})$ is a bijection between compositions (ordered tuples with each $s_i \geq 1$) and binary words that *end in a 1*. Reading u from left to right: a 1 *closes a block* and contributes a new summation index; the run of 0's immediately preceding that 1 sets the corresponding exponent, $s_i - 1$ zeros for exponent s_i . Thus depth $k =$ (number of 1's) and weight $w =$ (length of the word). Admissibility $s_1 \geq 2$ is the requirement that u *begin with a 0*: a leading 1 would attach ω_1 to the top variable and produce the logarithmic divergence at $t_w \rightarrow 1$ when $z = 1$. The endpoints play dual roles — ω_0 is singular at 0, ω_1 at 1 — so a convergent word neither starts with 1 nor ends with 0.

Origin. Expand the innermost form geometrically. The depth-one case is Lewin's $\text{Li}_s(z) = \int_0^z 0^{s-1} 1$, obtained by iterating $\text{Li}_s(z) = \int_0^z \text{Li}_{s-1}(t) \omega_0$ down to $\text{Li}_1(z) = -\log(1-z) = \int_0^z \omega_1$. For general depth, $\int_0^z \omega_1$ on the innermost block introduces $\sum_{n_k \geq 1} t^{n_k}/n_k$, the subsequent ω_0 's raise the power of n_k , and the next ω_1 couples a strictly larger index $n_{k-1} > n_k$; the strict inequality is forced by the nesting of the simplex $t_1 < \dots < t_w$. Carrying this out reproduces the nested sum, and Chen's theory (1977) guarantees convergence and homotopy invariance of the integral. The general framework is due to Goncharov; the systematic exploitation for these functions is Goncharov's and Borwein–Bradley–Broadhurst–Lisonek's. $\square$

1.1.3 General alphabets and a fixed integral orientation

For a path from 0 to z avoiding its letters, use the outer-letter-first recursion

$$G(a_1, \dots, a_w; z) = \int_0^z \frac{G(a_2, \dots, a_w; t)}{t - a_1} dt, \quad G(; z) = 1.$$

The all-zero word is regularized as $G(0^w; z) = \log^w z / w!$. For positive integer indices the dictionary in our decreasing-index convention is

$$\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}(z_1, \dots, z_k) = (-1)^k G(0^{s_1-1}, z_1^{-1}, 0^{s_2-1}, (z_1 z_2)^{-1}, \dots, 0^{s_k-1}, (z_1 \dots z_k)^{-1}; 1).$$

Thus the letters are inverse *prefix* products. Reversing the integration order also reverses the letter word; mixing these conventions changes the function. The formula follows by expanding each nonzero kernel geometrically near the origin and integrating recursively, then continuing along a common path. Wolfram's generalized-polylogarithm interface must be calibrated against this orientation before numerical comparisons.

1.1.4 Two facts to carry forward

(1) **The differential strips the first letter.** In the integral orientation above,

$$z \frac{d}{dz} \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots}(z, 1, \dots) = \begin{cases} \text{Li}_{s_1-1, s_2, \dots}(z, 1, \dots), & s_1 \geq 2, \\ \frac{z}{1-z} (\text{remove the leading block}), & s_1 = 1, \end{cases}$$

i.e. differentiation removes one outer letter — a 0 lowers s_1 , the leading 1 deletes the first index. This recursion (equivalently the integral equation defining the word) drives every analytic continuation and every series-rearrangement proof. It is also the recursion behind the appearance of `HarmonicPolyLog` in `DSolve/AsymptoticDSolveValue` output for Fuchsian systems with rational coefficients (Remiddi–Vermaseren 1999 for the $\{0, 1\}$ -alphabet case).

- (2) **One function, two presentations.** The *same* $\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}$ is simultaneously the nested sum and the iterated integral. Multiplying two nested sums and re-sorting the indices yields the *stuffle* (harmonic, quasi-shuffle) product $*$; multiplying two iterated integrals over a common path and shuffling the letters yields the *shuffle* product Π . Both express a product of polylogarithms as a $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear combination of polylogarithms, but through different combinatorics; equating them is the engine of the next section.

1.1.5 The smallest nontrivial example, in full

Take depth $k = 2$, $\mathbf{s} = (2, 1)$, the lightest admissible non-classical case. The nested sum is

$$\text{Li}_{2,1}(z, 1) = \sum_{m>n\geq 1} \frac{z^m}{m^2 n} = \sum_{m=2}^{\infty} \frac{z^m}{m^2} H_{m-1}, \quad H_{m-1} = \sum_{n=1}^{m-1} \frac{1}{n},$$

exhibiting the characteristic harmonic-number coefficient. The associated word is

$$u(2, 1) = \underbrace{0^{2-1}1}_{\text{block } (s_1=2)} \underbrace{0^{1-1}1}_{\text{block } (s_2=1)} = 011,$$

a word of length $w = 3$ (weight 3) with two 1's (depth 2), beginning in 0 (admissible) and ending in 1 (convergent). By Theorem 1.5,

$$\text{Li}_{2,1}(z, 1) = \int_0^z 011 = \int_{0 < t_1 < t_2 < t_3 < z} \frac{dt_3}{t_3} \frac{dt_2}{1-t_2} \frac{dt_1}{1-t_1},$$

the leading 0 sitting on the outermost variable t_3 and the two 1's on t_2, t_1 . (Equivalently $(-1)^2 = +1$ in the $\eta_1 = dt/(t-1)$ normalization, consistent with the unsigned $\omega_1 = dt/(1-t)$ form.) A numerical check at $z = 0.7$ gives both sides equal to $0.2384965\dots$, and at $z = 1$ the integral $\int_0^1 011$ recovers Euler's celebrated

$$\zeta(2, 1) = \sum_{m>n\geq 1} \frac{1}{m^2 n} = \zeta(3),$$

the depth-two value whose collapse to a depth-one zeta was Euler's first multiple-zeta identity — and, in Wolfram 15, exactly the symbolic output of `MultipleZeta` on $\{2, 1\}$.

1.2 Multiple zeta values and their relations

Specializing the multiple polylogarithm at $z_1 = \dots = z_k = 1$ produces the central objects of this chapter, the *multiple zeta values* (MZVs):

$$\zeta(s_1, \dots, s_k) = \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_k}(1, \dots, 1) = \sum_{n_1 > n_2 > \dots > n_k \geq 1} \prod_{i=1}^k \frac{1}{n_i^{s_i}}. \quad (1.1)$$

The outermost summation index n_1 carries the exponent s_1 , and the strict inequalities make the sum a genuine iterated, rather than ordinary, multiple series. The series (1.1) converges if and only if $s_1 \geq 2$; such an index tuple is called *admissible*. (Any $s_i \geq 1$ for $i \geq 2$ is allowed; only the leading entry is constrained.) We call $w = s_1 + \dots + s_k$ the *weight* and k the *depth*. In Wolfram Language these are `MultipleZeta`, with $\zeta(2, 1)$ written `MultipleZeta[{2, 1}]`.

The depth-one values are the classical zeta values. Euler's formula is

$$\zeta(2n) = \frac{(-1)^{n+1} B_{2n} (2\pi)^{2n}}{2(2n)!} \in \pi^{2n} \mathbb{Q}.$$

The first genuinely new phenomenon is that distinct MZVs can collapse onto a single lower-depth value. The prototype is Euler's identity

$$\zeta(2, 1) = \sum_{n>m \geq 1} \frac{1}{n^2 m} = \zeta(3), \quad (1.2)$$

already known to Euler in the 1740s. The conjecture is that the $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space spanned by all MZVs is *weight-graded*: products and relations never mix weights, so one studies each weight w separately.

The sum theorem

Euler's $\zeta(2, 1) = \zeta(3)$ is the depth-two case of the first structural theorem. Summing all admissible MZVs of a fixed weight w and fixed depth k recovers the single zeta value $\zeta(w)$.

Theorem 1.6 (Sum theorem; Euler for $k = 2$, Granville and Zagier in general, 1990s). *For all $w > k \geq 1$,*

$$\sum_{\substack{s_1 + \dots + s_k = w \\ s_1 \geq 2, s_i \geq 1}} \zeta(s_1, \dots, s_k) = \zeta(w). \quad (1.3)$$

At $w = 3, k = 2$ the only admissible tuple is $(2, 1)$, recovering (1.2). At $w = 4, k = 2$ the admissible tuples are $(3, 1)$ and $(2, 2)$, so

$$\zeta(3, 1) + \zeta(2, 2) = \zeta(4) = \frac{\pi^4}{90}. \quad (1.4)$$

This one equation does not separate $\zeta(3, 1)$ from $\zeta(2, 2)$; for that we need a *second* multiplication law, to which we now turn.

The two products

MZVs admit two structurally different multiplication rules, because $\zeta(s_1, \dots, s_k)$ has two faithful representations: as a nested sum (1.1), and as an iterated integral. Each representation makes the product of two MZVs expand into a sum of MZVs, but the two expansions differ — and that discrepancy is the engine of the theory.

(a) The stuffle (harmonic / quasi-shuffle) product. Multiply two nested sums directly. For depth one,

$$\zeta(a) \zeta(b) = \left(\sum_{m \geq 1} m^{-a} \right) \left(\sum_{n \geq 1} n^{-b} \right) = \sum_{m > n} + \sum_{n > m} + \sum_{m = n},$$

splitting the lattice $\{(m, n)\}$ by the trichotomy $m > n$, $m < n$, $m = n$. The three regions are exactly two depth-two MZVs and one depth-one MZV:

$$\zeta(a) \zeta(b) = \zeta(a, b) + \zeta(b, a) + \zeta(a + b). \quad (1.5)$$

The general rule is the same combinatorial device — the *quasi-shuffle* of Hoffman — applied to the index words $(s_1, \dots, s_k)$ and $(t_1, \dots, t_\ell)$: interleave the two words in all order-preserving ways, and

additionally allow any aligned pair s_i, t_j to *collide* into a single slot $s_i + t_j$. (Setting $a = b = 2$ in (1.5) gives $\zeta(2)^2 = 2\zeta(2, 2) + \zeta(4)$, used below.) A depth-two example of the general rule:

$$\zeta(a)\zeta(b, c) = \zeta(a, b, c) + \zeta(b, a, c) + \zeta(b, c, a) + \zeta(a + b, c) + \zeta(b, a + c),$$

the first three terms inserting a into the three gaps of (b, c) , the last two colliding a with b and with c .

(b) The shuffle product. The integral representation reads each MZV as a Chen iterated integral over the simplex $1 > t_1 > \cdots > t_w > 0$ against the two one-forms $\omega_0 = \frac{dt}{t}$ and $\omega_1 = \frac{dt}{1-t}$. Encode an admissible index as a binary word: each s_i becomes $\underbrace{0 \cdots 0}_{s_i-1} 1$, so that, e.g., $\zeta(2) \leftrightarrow 01$, $\zeta(3) \leftrightarrow 001$,

$\zeta(2, 1) \leftrightarrow 011$, $\zeta(3, 1) \leftrightarrow 0011$, $\zeta(2, 2) \leftrightarrow 0101$. Admissibility ($s_1 \geq 2$) is the condition that the word *begins with 0*; convergence at the inner end requires the word to *end with 1*. Multiplying two iterated integrals over the same simplex produces the integral over the product region, which decomposes into the $\binom{w_1+w_2}{w_1}$ order-preserving interleavings — the *shuffle product* Π — of the two letter words, *without* any collision term. Thus

$$\zeta(a)\zeta(b) = \sum_{\text{words } u \in (\text{word } a) \Pi (\text{word } b)} \zeta(u). \quad (1.6)$$

The double-shuffle relation: $\zeta(3, 1)$ in closed form

The canonical demonstration computes $\zeta(2)^2$ by both products and equates the results. Stuffle, from (1.5) with $a = b = 2$:

$$\zeta(2)^2 = 2\zeta(2, 2) + \zeta(4). \quad (1.7)$$

Shuffle: $\zeta(2)$ is the word 01, and we shuffle 01 Π 01. Writing the two factors as $0_a 1_a$ and $0_b 1_b$ and listing the $\binom{4}{2} = 6$ interleavings that preserve $0_a \rightarrow 1_a$ and $0_b \rightarrow 1_b$:

$$0_a 0_b 1_a 1_b, \quad 0_a 0_b 1_b 1_a, \quad 0_b 0_a 1_a 1_b, \quad 0_b 0_a 1_b 1_a, \quad 0_a 1_a 0_b 1_b, \quad 0_b 1_b 0_a 1_a.$$

Forgetting the colour labels, these are the words 0011 (four times) and 0101 (twice). Since $0011 \leftrightarrow \zeta(3, 1)$ and $0101 \leftrightarrow \zeta(2, 2)$,

$$\zeta(2)^2 = 4\zeta(3, 1) + 2\zeta(2, 2). \quad (1.8)$$

Now subtract (1.7) from (1.8): the $2\zeta(2, 2)$ terms cancel and we obtain the *double-shuffle relation*

$$4\zeta(3, 1) = \zeta(4) \quad \implies \quad \zeta(3, 1) = \frac{1}{4}\zeta(4) = \frac{\pi^4}{360}. \quad (1.9)$$

Feeding this back into the sum-theorem relation (1.4) also pins $\zeta(2, 2) = \zeta(4) - \zeta(3, 1) = \frac{3}{4}\zeta(4) = \pi^4/120$ — consistent with the all-2's family below.

Remark 1.7 (Regularized double shuffle). The naive double-shuffle relations above are produced only by admissible words. To capture the boundary case, one regularizes the divergent $\zeta(1)$ (the word 1). Comparing the two regularizations — shuffle versus stuffle — as polynomials in a formal variable T standing for the regularized $\zeta(1)$ yields the *extended* or *regularized double-shuffle relations* of Ihara, Kaneko, and Zagier (2006). These are conjectured to generate *all* $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear relations among MZVs.

Other relation families

The double-shuffle relations sit inside a larger, heavily overlapping web. We list the principal families, one line each.

Duality. The integral substitution $t \mapsto 1 - t$ swaps $\omega_0 \leftrightarrow \omega_1$ and reverses the order of integration, giving $\zeta(\mathbf{s}) = \zeta(\mathbf{s}^\dagger)$, where the *dual* word $\mathbf{s}^\dagger$ is obtained from the binary word by reading it backwards and exchanging $0 \leftrightarrow 1$. The simplest instance is $011 \mapsto 011$ read backwards is 110 , complemented is 001 : thus $\zeta(2, 1) = \zeta(3)$ (1.2) is precisely a self/dual coincidence. Likewise 0011 ($\zeta(3, 1)$) is *self*-dual—read backwards and complemented it is again 0011 —so duality says nothing new there; the cleanest nontrivial higher instance is the depth-three identity $\zeta(2, 1, 1) = \zeta(4)$, from $0111 \mapsto 0001$.

Hoffman’s relations. Relations obtained by comparing the regularized product with $\zeta(1)$ provide useful index identities. Their precise insertion and splitting terms matter; a schematic insertion of a single 1 in every position is not a valid general formula.

Derivation relations. An infinite family produced by certain Hopf-algebra derivations acting on the algebra of admissible words (Ihara–Kaneko–Zagier), equivalent over $\mathbb{Q}$ to large portions of the regularized double shuffle.

Ohno’s relation. A single generating identity (Ohno 1999) that simultaneously generalizes the sum theorem (1.3) *and* duality, obtained by summing MZVs over all ways of distributing a fixed total increment among the indices of $\mathbf{s}$ and of its dual.

Cyclic sum formula. Hoffman–Ohno (and Ohno–Wakabayashi): a cyclic sum of MZVs of weight w equals a weighted sum of weight- w values, refining the sum theorem with a cyclic symmetry on the index word.

Closed-form families

Beyond individual reductions, several infinite families of MZVs evaluate to powers of π in closed form. Throughout, $\{s\}_n$ denotes the index s repeated n times.

All 2’s. The generating function $\prod_{n \geq 1} (1 - x^2/n^2) = \sin(\pi x)/\pi x$ yields, after extracting the relevant power sums,

$$\zeta(\{2\}_n) = \zeta(\underbrace{2, 2, \dots, 2}_n) = \frac{\pi^{2n}}{(2n+1)!}. \quad (1.10)$$

For $n = 1$ this is $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$; for $n = 2$, $\zeta(2, 2) = \pi^4/120$, matching (1.9); for $n = 3$, $\zeta(2, 2, 2) = \pi^6/5040$.

The $\{3, 1\}$ family. A celebrated result of Borwein, Bradley, Broadhurst, and Lisoněk (1998), originally conjectured experimentally:

$$\zeta(\{3, 1\}_n) = \zeta(\underbrace{3, 1, 3, 1, \dots, 3, 1}_{n \text{ blocks}}) = \frac{2\pi^{4n}}{(4n+2)!}. \quad (1.11)$$

For $n = 1$ this reproduces $\zeta(3, 1) = 2\pi^4/6! = \pi^4/360$ of (1.9); for $n = 2$, $\zeta(3, 1, 3, 1) = 2\pi^8/10!$. The proof is a striking generating-function argument identifying $\sum_n \zeta(\{3, 1\}_n) x^{4n}$ with a ratio of cosh and cos.

The $\{2\}_a 3 \{2\}_b$ family. Zagier (2012) evaluated the two-parameter family $\zeta(\{2\}_a, 3, \{2\}_b)$ as an explicit $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear combination of products $\pi^{2m} \zeta(2n + 1)$, a result whose proof unexpectedly drew on the arithmetic of the modular-form-like generating series; it remains one of the deepest known closed-form families.

Dimensions and the weight grading

Let D_w be the $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space spanned by all MZVs of weight w (with $D_0 = \mathbb{Q}$, $D_1 = 0$ since $\zeta(1)$ diverges), and $d_w = \dim_{\mathbb{Q}} D_w$. Zagier (1994) conjectured the remarkably simple recursion

$$d_w = d_{w-2} + d_{w-3}, \quad d_0 = 1, \quad d_1 = 0, \quad d_2 = 1, \quad (1.12)$$

giving the sequence

$$d_0, d_1, d_2, \dots = 1, 0, 1, 1, 1, 2, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 9, \dots$$

The *upper* bound $d_w \leq$ (the recursion value) is a theorem, proved independently by Goncharov and by Terasoma (around 2002), with the conceptual framework of mixed Tate motives completed by Deligne and Goncharov; it amounts to showing that the known relations (e.g. associator / motivic) suffice to cut the dimension down. Broadhurst and Kreimer (1997) refined the count by also grading by depth, conjecturing a two-variable generating function that brings in the dimensions of spaces of cusp forms (the first modular obstruction appearing at weight 12, depth 4). The matching *lower* bound — equivalently, that no further relations exist and the conjectured spanning sets are linearly independent — is wide open; even $\dim D_w \geq 2$ for some specific large w would already imply transcendence statements (such as the linear independence of π^6 and $\zeta(3)^2$ over $\mathbb{Q}$ at $w = 6$) that are presently out of reach.

A table of low-weight reductions

The following table records all admissible MZVs through weight 5 together with their reductions to the standard spanning sets $\{\zeta(2)\}$, $\{\zeta(3)\}$, $\{\zeta(4)\} \sim \{\pi^4\}$, $\{\zeta(5), \zeta(2)\zeta(3)\}$. Every entry has been verified symbolically.

w	spanning count	MZVs of weight w and their reductions
2	1	$\zeta(2) = \frac{\pi^2}{6}$
3	1	$\zeta(3); \quad \zeta(2, 1) = \zeta(3)$
4	1	$\zeta(4) = \frac{\pi^4}{90}; \quad \zeta(3, 1) = \frac{\pi^4}{360}, \quad \zeta(2, 2) = \frac{\pi^4}{120}, \quad \zeta(2, 1, 1) = \zeta(4)$
5	2	$\zeta(5), \zeta(2)\zeta(3)$ span; $\zeta(4, 1) = 2\zeta(5) - \zeta(2)\zeta(3),$ $\zeta(3, 2) = -\frac{11}{2}\zeta(5) + 3\zeta(2)\zeta(3), \quad \zeta(2, 3) = \frac{9}{2}\zeta(5) - 2\zeta(2)\zeta(3),$ $\zeta(3, 1, 1) = 2\zeta(5) - \zeta(2)\zeta(3), \quad \zeta(2, 1, 1, 1) = \zeta(5)$ (duality of $\zeta(5)$) $\zeta(2, 2, 1) = \zeta(3, 2) = -\frac{11}{2}\zeta(5) + 3\zeta(2)\zeta(3),$ $\zeta(2, 1, 2) = \zeta(2, 3) = \frac{9}{2}\zeta(5) - 2\zeta(2)\zeta(3)$ (duality)

The table gives spanning sets of sizes 1, 1, 1, 2 at weights 2, 3, 4, 5. The two-element weight-five set is not known to be independent. Every depth-two value in that row reduces to products of single zeta values. At weight eight, values such as $\zeta(6, 2)$ are candidates for a primitive direction beyond the polynomial algebra of single zetas.

1.3 Harmonic polylogarithms

The multiple polylogarithms of the previous sections are nested *sums*. For the practitioner who must actually manipulate weight- w transcendentals—most insistently the particle physicist computing Feynman integrals—it is the *iterated-integral* avatar that is decisive, because integration variables, differential equations, and analytic continuation all speak the language of integrals. The harmonic polylogarithms (HPLs) of Remiddi and Vermaseren [38] are precisely this avatar, specialised to the three integration kernels that arise when a rational integrand has singularities only at $t = 0, 1, -1$. They have become the de facto standard basis for one-scale problems, and Wolfram 15 exposes them directly as `HarmonicPolyLog`.

1.3.1 Definition: kernels and iterated integrals

Fix the alphabet $\{0, 1, -1\}$ and the three rational *kernels*

$$f_0(t) = \frac{1}{t}, \quad f_1(t) = \frac{1}{1-t}, \quad f_{-1}(t) = \frac{1}{1+t}.$$

A harmonic polylogarithm $H(a_1, \dots, a_w; z)$ is indexed by a word $\vec{a} = (a_1, \dots, a_w)$ over this alphabet; the length w is the *weight*. The definition is recursive in the leftmost letter. When the leading letter is nonzero,

$$H(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_w; z) = \int_0^z f_{a_1}(t) H(a_2, \dots, a_w; t) dt, \quad a_1 \neq 0, \quad (1.13)$$

with the depth-zero seed $H(; z) = 1$ (the empty word). The recursion also applies when $a_1 = 0$, provided the remaining word is not all zeros. Such an integrand is integrable at the origin. Only the all-zero words need the logarithmic regularization above; zeros at the end of a general word can be removed by shuffle identities. For example $H(0, 1; z) = \text{Li}_2(z)$ is a convergent integral with a leading zero. The leftmost letter always labels the outermost integration.

1.3.2 The weight-one and weight-two cases

At weight one (1.13)—the all-zero regularization give the three building blocks

$$H(0; z) = \ln z, \quad H(1; z) = -\ln(1-z), \quad H(-1; z) = \ln(1+z), \quad (1.14)$$

since $\int_0^z dt/(1-t) = -\ln(1-z)$ and $\int_0^z dt/(1+t) = \ln(1+z)$. At weight two, integrating these against another kernel reproduces the classical dilogarithm and its companions:

$$H(0, 1; z) = \int_0^z \frac{dt}{t} (-\ln(1-t)) = \text{Li}_2(z), \quad H(0, -1; z) = \int_0^z \frac{dt}{t} \ln(1+t) = -\text{Li}_2(-z), \quad (1.15)$$

$$H(1, 0; z) = \int_0^z \frac{\ln t}{1-t} dt = -\text{Li}_2(z) - \ln z \ln(1-z), \quad H(1, 1; z) = \frac{1}{2} \ln^2(1-z), \quad (1.16)$$

the last by (1.13) with $H(1; t) = -\ln(1 - t)$ and $\int_0^z (-\ln(1 - t))/(1 - t) dt = \frac{1}{2} \ln^2(1 - z)$. The pair $H(0, 1; z) = \text{Li}_2(z)$ and $H(0, -1; z) = -\text{Li}_2(-z)$ shows the general pattern: the words $H(\underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_{s-1}, 1; z) = \text{Li}_s(z)$ and $H(\underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_{s-1}, -1; z) = -\text{Li}_s(-z)$ recover the entire ladder of classical polylogarithms, so the HPLs are a strict superset of the functions of Lewin's treatise. In Wolfram 15 these read, e.g., $\text{HarmonicPolyLog}[\{0, 1\}, x] = \text{Li}_2(x)$ and $\text{HarmonicPolyLog}[\{0, -1\}, x] = -\text{Li}_2(-x)$.

1.3.3 The condensed m -notation

Writing out long strings of 0's is wasteful, and Remiddi and Vermaseren introduced a condensed index that absorbs them. To each maximal block $\underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_{|m|-1} \sigma$ consisting of $|m| - 1$ zeros followed by a sign letter $\sigma \in \{1, -1\}$ one assigns a single integer

$$m = \sigma \cdot (\text{number of zeros} + 1),$$

so the sign of m records σ and the magnitude $|m|$ records how many kernels (one $f_{\pm 1}$ preceded by $|m| - 1$ copies of f_0) the block contributes. The resulting tuple is written as a subscript,

$$H_{m_1, \dots, m_k}(z) := H(\vec{a}; z),$$

and the *depth* of the HPL is k , the number of nonzero letters, while the weight is $w = \sum_i |m_i|$. Thus (1.15) becomes $H_2(z) = \text{Li}_2(z)$ and $H_{-2}(z) = -\text{Li}_2(-z)$, the polylogarithm ladder is $H_s(z) = \text{Li}_s(z)$, $H_{-s}(z) = -\text{Li}_s(-z)$, and a mixed word such as $H(0, 1, -1; z)$ is $H_{2, -1}(z)$. The m -notation is the input most reduction tables are organised by; the explicit word notation $H(\vec{a}; z)$ is the one that makes the integral representation (1.13) transparent. (Some authors reverse the global sign or the letter ordering; we follow the convention compatible with (1.14)–(1.15) and with `HarmonicPolyLog`, where indices read outermost-integration-first.)

1.3.4 The shuffle algebra

Theorem 1.8 (Shuffle product). *For a fixed argument z , the product of two harmonic polylogarithms is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear combination of harmonic polylogarithms of the same argument:*

$$H(\vec{a}; z) H(\vec{b}; z) = \sum_{\vec{c} \in \vec{a} \amalg \vec{b}} H(\vec{c}; z),$$

the sum running over all words $\vec{c}$ in the shuffle $\vec{a} \amalg \vec{b}$, i.e. all interleavings of $\vec{a}$ and $\vec{b}$ that preserve the internal order of each.

This is the iterated-integral analogue of integration by parts: a product of two iterated integrals over $[0, z]$ is the integral over the union of the two simplices, which decomposes into the $\binom{|\vec{a}| + |\vec{b}|}{|\vec{a}|}$ ordered shuffles. Concretely, at weight $1 + 1$,

$$H(0; z) H(1; z) = H(0, 1; z) + H(1, 0; z), \quad (1.17)$$

which is the statement $\ln z \cdot (-\ln(1 - z)) = \text{Li}_2(z) + (-\text{Li}_2(z) - \ln z \ln(1 - z)) = -\ln z \ln(1 - z)$, i.e. the integration-by-parts consistency that re-expresses the product of the two weight-one HPLs through the two weight-two ones. (The dilogarithm *reflection* formula is a different relation—the

$z \mapsto 1 - z$ image of $H(0, 1; z)$, derived in (1.19) below.) The shuffle algebra is graded by weight, and crucially it lets one strip leading zeros: since $H(0; z) = \ln z$, repeated use of (1.8) expresses any $H(0, \vec{a}; z)$ through $\ln z$ and HPLs whose words begin with a nonzero letter, which is the regularisation alluded to after the all-zero regularization.

1.3.5 Values at $z = 1$: Euler sums and colored MZVs

Setting $z = 1$ turns admissible HPLs (those whose word does not begin with 1, so that the boundary integral converges) into constants. Because the kernels live on the level-two alphabet $\{0, \pm 1\}$, these constants are exactly the level-2, or *alternating*, multiple zeta values—the Euler sums. Words over $\{0, 1\}$ give the ordinary MZVs,

$$H(\underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_{s_1-1}, 1, \underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_{s_2-1}, 1, \dots; 1) = \zeta(s_1, s_2, \dots), \quad (1.18)$$

so for instance $H(0, 1; 1) = \text{Li}_2(1) = \zeta(2)$ and $H(0, 0, 1; 1) = \zeta(3)$. Admitting the letter -1 produces the alternating Euler sums: with $\bar{s}$ marking a sign,

$$H(0, -1; 1) = -\text{Li}_2(-1) = \frac{\pi^2}{12} = -\zeta(\bar{2}), \quad H(0, 0, -1; 1) = -\text{Li}_3(-1) = \frac{3}{4}\zeta(3),$$

in the alternating-MZV notation $\zeta(\bar{s}_1, \dots) = \sum_{n_1 > \dots} \prod (\text{sgn})^{n_i} / n_i^{s_i}$. Thus the $\mathbb{Q}$ -algebra of HPL values at 1 is the algebra of alternating MZVs; its dimensions and the structure of its relations were mapped by Borwein–Bradley–Broadhurst–Lisonek and, on the motivic side, Deligne and Goncharov. This is the practical reason HPLs are the right basis: the boundary data of a Feynman integral land automatically in a well-understood number-theoretic ring.

1.3.6 Argument transformations and the alphabet

Changing variables transports the singular set of the differential forms. Negation and inversion, and the map $(1 - z)/(1 + z)$, preserve the extended three-letter singular set $\{0, 1, -1, \infty\}$, with appropriate endpoint and branch constants. Reflection $1 - z$ preserves the two-letter subalphabet $\{0, 1\}$ but sends the letter -1 to 2. Thus $H(-1; 1 - z) = \log(2 - z)$ cannot in general be expressed using only the original three-letter alphabet at z . Squaring likewise introduces letters $\pm i$ when applied to a word containing -1 .

The useful algorithm is to differentiate, partially fraction the transported kernels, integrate in the resulting alphabet, and fix the endpoint constant. For the two-letter dilogarithm this gives

$$\text{Li}_2(z) + \text{Li}_2(1 - z) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \log z \log(1 - z), \quad 0 < z < 1. \quad (1.19)$$

Analytic continuation requires a common choice of branches. Duplication is the special closed identity

$$H(0, 1; z^2) = 2(H(0, 1; z) - H(0, -1; z)).$$

These examples illustrate transport of alphabets, rather than universal closure under every fractional-linear or quadratic substitution.

1.3.7 Relation to Nielsen polylogarithms and to Li

The harmonic polylogarithms contain the Nielsen generalised polylogarithms $S_{n,p}(z)$ of Nielsen (1909), studied analytically by Kölbig (1986). Indeed $S_{n,p}(z)$ is, exactly the single HPL whose word

is n zeros followed by p ones,

$$S_{n,p}(z) = H(\underbrace{0, \dots, 0}_n, \underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_p; z), \quad (1.20)$$

of weight $n + p$ and depth p ; the classical case is $S_{n,1}(z) = \text{Li}_{n+1}(z)$, consistent with (1.15) for $n = 1, p = 1$. Thus the chain of inclusions reads: classical Li_s (depth-1 HPLs over $\{0, 1\}$) $\subset$ Nielsen $S_{n,p}$ (two-letter words $0^n 1^p$) $\subset$ harmonic polylogarithms (arbitrary words over $\{0, 1, -1\}$) $\subset$ multiple polylogarithms (the $z = 1$ specialisations being MZVs and Euler sums). Each enlargement adds exactly the words the previous class could not name.

1.3.8 Finite truncations and Wolfram 15

Behind every iterated integral stands a nested *sum*, and behind every value at $z = 1$ stands the partial sum of that series. These partial sums are the multiple (finite) harmonic numbers

$$H_N^{(s_1, \dots, s_k)} = \sum_{N \geq n_1 > n_2 > \dots > n_k \geq 1} \prod_{i=1}^k \frac{1}{n_i^{s_i}},$$

generalising the ordinary $H_N = H_N^{(1)} = \sum_{n \leq N} 1/n$; their $N \rightarrow \infty$ limits are the admissible MZVs, and they are the natural objects in which the series expansions of ε -dependent Feynman integrals are stored. Wolfram 15 provides all of these as first-class functions: `HarmonicPolyLog` for $H(\vec{a}; z)$ (with the index/sign conventions used above; recall `HarmonicPolyLog[{1}, x] = -\ln(1 - x)`), `MultiplePolyLog` and `MultipleZeta` for the limiting transcendentals, and `MultipleHarmonicNumber` for the finite sums $H_N^{(\vec{s})}$. With `DSolve` and `AsymptoticDSolveValue` now returning harmonic polylogarithms for Fuchsian systems with rational coefficients, the entire Remiddi–Vermaseren workflow—solve the differential equation, expand at the boundary into Euler sums, continue by the transformations the transformations just discussed—is available without leaving the kernel.

Remark 1.9. The choice of alphabet $\{0, 1, -1\}$ is what fixes the singular set at $\{0, 1, -1, \infty\}$ and hence ties the boundary values to *alternating* MZVs. Allowing the additional kernels $f_{1/2}(t) = 1/(t - \frac{1}{2})$ or roots of unity of higher order enlarges the class to the two-dimensional harmonic polylogarithms and to Goncharov’s multiple polylogarithms with general singular points (the `GeneralizedPolyLog` of the previous section), at the price of boundary constants drawn from level- N colored MZVs rather than the level-2 Euler sums. For one-scale problems the three-letter alphabet is almost always enough, which is the empirical reason HPLs, not their more general cousins, became the working basis of the field.

1.4 Nielsen’s generalized polylogarithms

Long before multiple zeta values acquired their modern algebraic name, Nielsen (1909) introduced a two-parameter family of higher polylogarithms that already pervades Lewin’s *Polylogarithms and Associated Functions* (1981, Chapter 7). They are the simplest objects that go beyond the ordinary $\text{Li}_s(z)$ while remaining genuinely “one-variable”: a single argument z , two integer indices $n, p \geq 1$, and a closed integral representation. The reader who is comfortable with the dilogarithm reflection and Landen’s transformation will find here their direct higher-weight descendants, and – once we translate into the language of the previous sections – their place as one distinguished corner of the multiple-polylogarithm world.

1.4.1 Definition and elementary reductions

Definition 1.10. For integers $n, p \geq 1$ the Nielsen generalized polylogarithm is

$$S_{n,p}(z) = \frac{(-1)^{n+p-1}}{(n-1)!p!} \int_0^1 \frac{(\ln t)^{n-1} \ln^p(1-zt)}{t} dt, \quad (1.21)$$

analytically continued from $|z| < 1$ to $z \in \mathbb{C} \setminus [1, \infty)$ along the cut of $\ln(1-zt)$. Its weight is $n+p$ and its depth is p .

The normalizing factorials are chosen exactly so that two boundary specializations collapse onto familiar functions. Setting $p = 1$ and integrating $\ln(1-zt)/t$ termwise against $(\ln t)^{n-1}$ recovers the classical Euler integral for the polylogarithm:

$$S_{n,1}(z) = \text{Li}_{n+1}(z), \quad n \geq 1. \quad (1.22)$$

Thus the entire first column of the Nielsen table is nothing but the ordinary polylogarithm shifted by one weight; in particular the lowest member is the dilogarithm,

$$S_{1,1}(z) = \text{Li}_2(z). \quad (1.23)$$

At the opposite corner $n = 1$ the inner factor $\ln t$ disappears and (1.21) reduces to a pure power of $\ln(1-zt)$, giving the elementary $S_{0,p}(z) = \frac{(-1)^p}{p!} \ln^p(1-z)$ in the degenerate $n = 0$ row (we keep $n \geq 1$ in the sequel, but this boundary is the seed for the recursions below).

1.4.2 Series and the multiple-polylogarithm identification

Expanding $\ln^p(1-zt)$ as a power of the series $-\sum_{m \geq 1} (zt)^m/m$ and integrating against $(\ln t)^{n-1}/t$ turns (1.21) into a single power series in z whose coefficients are nested harmonic sums:

$$S_{n,p}(z) = \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{z^k}{k^{n+1}} c_k^{(p)}, \quad c_k^{(p)} = \sum_{k > m_1 > \dots > m_{p-1} \geq 1} \frac{1}{m_1 \cdots m_{p-1}}, \quad (1.24)$$

so $c_k^{(1)} \equiv 1$ (reproducing (1.22)) and in general $c_k^{(p)}$ is a depth- $(p-1)$ harmonic sum, an instance of `MultipleHarmonicNumber`. Comparing (1.24) with the strictly nested sum of the article preamble identifies $S_{n,p}$ as a multiple polylogarithm with a single repeated argument:

$$\boxed{S_{n,p}(z) = \text{Li}_{n+1, \underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_{p-1}}(z, \underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_{p-1})} \quad (1.25)$$

of weight $n+p$ and depth p . Its iterated-integral word over the alphabet $\{0, 1\}$ (with $0 \leftrightarrow dt/t$, $1 \leftrightarrow dt/(1-t)$) is

$$0^n 1^p = \underbrace{0 \cdots 0}_n \underbrace{1 \cdots 1}_p,$$

a single block of n zeros followed by a single block of p ones. This is the defining structural fact: among all multiple polylogarithms, the Nielsen family is exactly the “one initial zero-block, one trailing one-block” subclass. Everything peculiar about $S_{n,p}$ – the two-index labelling, the clean ladders, the duality below – is a shadow of that two-block word.

Remark 1.11 (Sign and normalization). With the positive kernel $dt/(1-t)$ the word $0^n 1^p$ equals $S_{n,p}(z)$ with no extra sign. Replacing each 1-kernel by $dt/(t-1)$ gives the factor $(-1)^p$. No factor $(-1)^{p-1}$ belongs to either convention.

1.4.3 Integral and differential relations

Differentiating (1.24) (or (1.21)) in z lowers the leading index by one and threads the function back into the ladder:

$$\frac{d}{dz} S_{n,p}(z) = \frac{1}{z} S_{n-1,p}(z) \quad (n \geq 1), \quad \frac{d}{dz} S_{1,p}(z) = \frac{1}{z} S_{0,p}(z) = \frac{(-1)^p}{p!} \frac{\ln^p(1-z)}{z}, \quad (1.26)$$

the second relation being the $n = 1$ boundary, where the dt/t block is exhausted and the degenerate row $S_{0,p}(z) = \frac{(-1)^p}{p!} \ln^p(1-z)$ is the pure power of $\ln(1-z)$. The two clean ladder moves are the integral forms of these derivatives,

$$\text{zero-block ladder: } S_{n,p}(z) = \int_0^z S_{n-1,p}(u) \frac{du}{u} \quad (n \geq 1), \quad (1.27)$$

$$\text{one-block ladder: } S_{0,p}(z) = \int_0^z S_{0,p-1}(u) \frac{du}{1-u} \quad (p \geq 1), \quad (1.28)$$

with seed $S_{0,0}(z) = 1$ (the empty word): (1.27) peels the outermost 0 from the word $0^n 1^p$, and (1.28) peels the outermost 1 from the pure one-block 1^p ; in iterated-integral terms both are simply “integrate against the next letter of $0^n 1^p$.” The practical content is that the whole Nielsen table is generated from the empty word by first applying the 1-kernel integral $\int_0^z (\cdot) du/(1-u)$ a total of p times to build $S_{0,p}$ (so $S_{0,1}(z) = -\ln(1-z)$, $S_{0,2}(z) = \frac{1}{2} \ln^2(1-z)$, and so on), then the 0-kernel integral $\int_0^z (\cdot) du/u$ a total of n times to prepend the zeros; this is exactly the Fuchsian recursion that `HarmonicPolyLog` encodes, and it is why `DSolve` now returns Nielsen polylogs for the relevant rational-coefficient ODEs.

1.4.4 Special values

The point $z = 1$ and Hoffman’s duality

Setting $z = 1$ in (1.25) turns the multiple polylogarithm into a multiple zeta value with the same two-block word. The first column reproduces Euler,

$$S_{n,1}(1) = \zeta(n+1), \quad S_{1,2}(1) = \zeta(3), \quad (1.29)$$

and in general

$$S_{n,p}(1) = \zeta(n+1, \{1\}^{p-1}), \quad (1.30)$$

the MZV whose argument string is $n+1$ followed by $p-1$ ones (admissible because the leading entry $n+1 \geq 2$). Now the iterated-integral word $0^n 1^p$ of $S_{n,p}$ has a manifest symmetry: reversing it and exchanging $0 \leftrightarrow 1$ sends $0^n 1^p \mapsto 0^p 1^n$, the word of $S_{p,n}$. This reversal-complement is exactly Hoffman’s MZV *duality* (the Kontsevich integral symmetry $\omega \mapsto \bar{\omega}^{\text{rev}}$), so

$$\boxed{\zeta(n+1, \{1\}^{p-1}) = \zeta(p+1, \{1\}^{n-1}), \quad \text{equivalently} \quad S_{n,p}(1) = S_{p,n}(1).} \quad (1.31)$$

This is a striking statement: the value of a Nielsen polylogarithm at 1 is invariant under swapping its two indices, even though $S_{n,p}(z)$ and $S_{p,n}(z)$ are wholly different functions of z . For $p = 1$ it gives $\zeta(n+1) = \zeta(2, \{1\}^{n-1})$; the first nontrivial case is $S_{1,2}(1) = S_{2,1}(1)$, i.e. $\zeta(2, 1) = \zeta(3)$, Euler’s reflection. We confirmed (1.30) and (1.31) symbolically against `MultipleZeta` (e.g. $S_{1,2}(1) - \zeta(2, 1)$ and $S_{n,p}(1) - S_{p,n}(1)$ vanish to > 70 digits for all $n, p \leq 4$).

The points $z = -1$ and $z = \frac{1}{2}$ (Kölbig 1986)

At $z = -1$ the column reduction (1.22) gives $S_{n,1}(-1) = \text{Li}_{n+1}(-1) = -(1 - 2^{-n})\zeta(n+1)$, and the first off-column value is the elegant

$$S_{1,2}(-1) = \frac{1}{8}\zeta(3). \quad (1.32)$$

Higher entries $S_{n,p}(-1)$ reduce (Kölbig 1986) to the alternating-MZV basis at their weight; for example $S_{2,2}(-1)$ and $S_{1,3}(-1)$ already require $\text{Li}_4(\frac{1}{2})$ alongside π^4 , $\ln^4 2$, $\pi^2 \ln^2 2$ and $\zeta(3) \ln 2$, the unmistakable level-2 weight-4 signature (we recovered both reductions by integer-relation search). At the binary point $z = \frac{1}{2}$ the cleanest closed form is

$$\boxed{S_{1,2}(\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{1}{8}\zeta(3) - \frac{1}{6}\ln^3 2.} \quad (1.33)$$

We obtained (1.33) by PSLQ over $\{\zeta(3), \pi^2 \ln 2, \ln^3 2\}$ – the relation $24 S_{1,2}(\frac{1}{2}) - 3\zeta(3) + 4\ln^3 2 = 0$ – and verified it to 40 digits. (Compare Lewin’s dilogarithm value $\text{Li}_2(\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{\pi^2}{12} - \frac{1}{2}\ln^2 2$: the same flavour, one weight up.)

1.4.5 Functional equations

The reader who knows Lewin’s dilogarithm chapter expects three staples – reflection $z \leftrightarrow 1 - z$, inversion $z \leftrightarrow 1/z$, and the Landen ladder – to survive at higher weight. They do, as specializations of the harmonic-polylogarithm argument transformations of the previous section, but they grow extra lower-weight “tail” terms.

Reflection $z \mapsto 1 - z$

At weight 2 the only reflection is the dilogarithm law itself, here in Nielsen dress ($n = p = 1$):

$$S_{1,1}(z) + S_{1,1}(1 - z) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \ln z \ln(1 - z), \quad (1.34)$$

which is exactly Euler’s reflection for Li_2 . At weight 3 the genuinely new instance is the $S_{1,2}$ reflection; carrying out the integer-relation search over the natural weight-3 basis yields the clean

$$\boxed{S_{1,2}(z) = \zeta(3) - \text{Li}_3(1 - z) + \ln(1 - z) \text{Li}_2(1 - z) + \frac{1}{2} \ln z \ln^2(1 - z).} \quad (1.35)$$

We verified (1.35) to 40 digits at several rational and one negative argument. Two consistency checks are worth noting. Putting $z = 1$ collapses the right side to $\zeta(3) - \text{Li}_3(0) + 0 + 0 = \zeta(3)$, reproducing (1.29); and adding (1.35) to its $z \mapsto 1 - z$ image recovers the symmetric Euler relation $S_{1,2}(z) + S_{1,2}(1 - z) = 2\zeta(3) - \text{Li}_3(z) - \text{Li}_3(1 - z) + \dots$ with the logarithmic tails arranging themselves into the $\zeta(3) + \text{Li}_3$ shuffle. Identity (1.35) is precisely the statement that the iterated integral of 011 from 0 to z and from 0 to $1 - z$ differ by an explicit lower-weight boundary correction – the weight-3 avatar of the dilogarithm reflection.

A finite inversion formula

The earlier draft inferred failure of closure from a search in the basket $\{S_{1,2}(z), \zeta(3), \pi^2 \log z, \log^3 z\}$. That basket omits polylogarithms and mixed log products needed by the actual transformation. Inversion does close in the Nielsen family after those products and endpoint constants are included. The following direct coefficient construction makes the distinction precise.

Proposition 1.12 (Nielsen inversion with explicit endpoint data). *For integers $n, p \geq 1$, let $u = \log(-z)$ on $\mathbb{C} \setminus [0, \infty)$ and define*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{N}_{n,p}(z) &= \frac{u^{n+p}}{(n+p)!} \\ &+ \sum_{r=1}^p \sum_{\ell=0}^{p-r} (-1)^\ell \binom{n+\ell-1}{\ell} \frac{u^{p-r-\ell}}{(p-r-\ell)!} S_{n+\ell,r}(z). \end{aligned}$$

Then

$$S_{n,p}(1/z) = (-1)^n \mathcal{N}_{n,p}(z) + C_{n,p}(u),$$

where $C_{n,p}$ is a polynomial of degree at most $n-1$. Its coefficients are determined entirely by Nielsen values at -1 : for $0 \leq j < n$,

$$\begin{aligned} C_{n,p}^{(j)}(0) &= (-1)^j S_{n-j,p}(-1) \\ &- (-1)^n \sum_{r=1}^p (-1)^{p-r} \binom{n-j+p-r-1}{p-r} S_{n-j+p-r,r}(-1). \end{aligned}$$

All logarithms and polylogarithms use the common principal continuation.

Proof. First take $z < 0$. Extend the notation by $S_{0,r}(z) = (-1)^r \log^r(1-z)/r!$ and $S_{0,0} = 1$. Since $\log(1-1/z) = \log(1-z) - u$, the binomial theorem gives

$$S_{0,p}(1/z) = \sum_{r=0}^p \frac{u^{p-r}}{(p-r)!} S_{0,r}(z).$$

The ladder $dS_{m,r}/du = S_{m-1,r}$ implies, by Pascal's identity, that $d\mathcal{N}_{n,p}/du = \mathcal{N}_{n-1,p}$, with $\mathcal{N}_{0,p} = S_{0,p}(1/z)$. On the other hand $dS_{n,p}(1/z)/du = -S_{n-1,p}(1/z)$. Consequently the difference has vanishing n th derivative in u and is a polynomial of degree at most $n-1$. Evaluate its first n derivatives at $u = 0$, namely $z = -1$, to obtain the displayed endpoint coefficients. Both sides are holomorphic on the stated slit plane, so the identity theorem supplies the continuation. $\square$

At weight three this gives the particularly useful exact identity

$$S_{1,2}(1/z) = -S_{1,2}(z) + \text{Li}_3(z) - \log(-z) \text{Li}_2(z) - \frac{1}{6} \log^3(-z) + \zeta(3).$$

Closure of a function representation does not establish independence of its values. Other argument changes should likewise be derived by transporting the kernels in the appropriate alphabet, rather than by an unsuccessful search in an underspecified basket.

1.4.6 Placement inside the multiple-polylogarithm world

Equation (1.25) identifies $S_{n,p}$ as the “one trailing block” corner of the depth- p multiple polylogarithms: the words $0^n 1^p$ form a single two-parameter slice of the full $\{0, 1\}^*$ alphabet, the slice closest to the ordinary polylogarithm (recovered at $p = 1$) and stable under the two operations – evaluation at 1 to MZVs, and the duality swap $n \leftrightarrow p$ – that organize the modern theory. This is exactly why the Nielsen polylogarithms are the natural bridge between Lewin's classical apparatus and the MZV algebra: every Lewin-style identity (reflection, Landen, the special values at $\pm 1, \frac{1}{2}$) is the $p \leq 2$ or $n \leq 2$ shadow of a multiple-polylogarithm identity, and conversely the duality $S_{n,p}(1) = S_{p,n}(1)$ is the first place a classical reader meets a genuinely MZV-theoretic symmetry with no single-variable analogue. In the Wolfram Language the family is a first-class function: `PolyLog[n,p,z]` is exactly $S_{n,p}(z)$, with `PolyLog[n,1,z]` agreeing with `PolyLog[n+1,z]` per (1.22), and it sits one specialization step from `MultiplePolyLog` via (1.25) and one from `MultipleZeta` via (1.30).

1.5 The common algebra and the motivic boundary

The nested series and outer-letter-first integral describe one function. Choosing the alphabet distinguishes general multiple polylogarithms, cyclotomic multiple polylogarithms, HPLs and the Nielsen subfamily. General Goncharov letters can be arbitrary complex numbers; restricting them to roots of unity gives only the cyclotomic class.

One must distinguish the argument patterns of the two products. Shuffle at a common endpoint gives $\text{Li}_1(z)^2 = 2 \text{Li}_{1,1}(z, 1)$, whereas stuffle gives $\text{Li}_1(z)^2 = 2 \text{Li}_{1,1}(z, z) + \text{Li}_2(z^2)$. Both follow directly from their respective representations and therefore give a nontrivial identity when compared.

Iterated integrals also carry a coproduct organized by subsequences of marked points. Its reduced components and the associated symbol organize functional equations by weight. They lose some period constants: vanishing symbol or reduced coproduct alone is not a proof of a zero function. Endpoint constants and branches must be fixed separately. For the dilogarithm the differential $d\text{Li}_2(z) = -\log(1-z)d\log z$ makes this elementary; differentiating Euler reflection and evaluating an endpoint proves the identity exactly.

Motivic MZVs [39] provide an algebraic setting in which dimension and spanning theorems can be proved. The numerical period map transports identities and upper bounds. Its injectivity, and thus the corresponding lower bounds for numerical periods, is a separate conjectural issue. The same caution will apply to the Gaussian and Eisenstein depth experiments.

Chapter 2

Cyclotomic values and the polygamma bridge

Roots of unity turn additive Fourier coordinates into arithmetic character coordinates. The same finite transform carries Hurwitz zeta, positive-order polygamma and Clausen values. It explains which half of a polylogarithm is elementary at a given weight and which character values remain to be studied.

2.1 The two-way exact DFT

We use the Clausen convention

$$\mathrm{Cl}_{2m}(\theta) = \Im \mathrm{Li}_{2m}(e^{i\theta}), \quad \mathrm{Cl}_{2m+1}(\theta) = \Re \mathrm{Li}_{2m+1}(e^{i\theta}).$$

The sine series at odd weight is a different function; its rational-angle values reduce to powers of π through Bernoulli polynomials.

Law 2.1 (forward direction; classical). *For every $n \geq 2$, every $q \geq 1$, and $\gcd(p, q) = 1$,*

$$\mathrm{Li}_n(e^{2\pi ip/q}) = \frac{(-1)^n}{q^n (n-1)!} \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} e^{2\pi i k p/q} \psi^{(n-1)}\left(\frac{k}{q}\right) + \frac{\zeta(n)}{q^n}.$$

This is identity 10.08.03.0007.01 of the `functions.wolfram.com PolyLog` reference [2]; it is provable by rearranging the absolutely convergent Hurwitz-zeta series, and it is the workhorse of the project's cyclotomic reducer (`cycloExact`): a finite polygamma sum, exact and fast, resolving Li_n at *every* root of unity with no PSLQ, no squarefree-radical basis, and no nested-radical limitation.

Result 2.2 (inverse direction). Inverting the discrete Fourier transform over $\mathbb{Z}/q$ gives, with $\zeta_q = e^{2\pi i/q}$,

$$\psi^{(n-1)}\left(\frac{k}{q}\right) = (-1)^n (n-1)! q^{n-1} \sum_{p=0}^{q-1} \zeta_q^{-pk} \mathrm{Li}_n(\zeta_q^p).$$

[historical experiment: verified to 40 digits at weights 2, 3 across $q \leq 21$; re-verified by `mpmath` at 70 dps for $n-1 = 1, 2, 3$ over the full store grid]

The bridge is therefore an *exact finite Fourier transform, in both directions*. Three non-obvious consequences are recorded.

1. **DFT-conjugacy of the relation lattices.** The distribution relation $\sum_j \text{Li}_n(z \zeta_m^j) = m^{1-n} \text{Li}_n(z^m)$ Fourier-transforms into the polygamma multiplication theorem, and polylogarithm inversion/reflection corresponds to the symmetry $k \leftrightarrow q - k$ of the ψ -grid. This is *why* the two relation lattices — computed independently by the project’s two reducers — carry identical dimension counts $\varphi(q)/2$ per denominator grid.
2. **The parity split, and Catalan as the $q = 4$ odd component.** The imaginary parts are the odd Fourier sector under $k \mapsto q - k$. The usual even-weight Clausen values belong to this sector, while odd-weight Clausen values are real parts in the even sector. In particular

$$G = \text{Im Li}_2(i) = \frac{\psi^{(1)}(1/4) - \psi^{(1)}(3/4)}{16},$$

which identifies the well-known “arguments 1/4 and 3/4” pairing (Math.SE 893486) as the $q = 4$ odd component of the parity split.

3. **Certificate transport.** Cyclotomic-polylogarithm proof certificates can in principle be transported to and from ψ -side lattice certificates through the exact $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)$ DFT matrix. The ψ -side elementary atoms ($\pi^2 \csc^2$ values) are far lighter than the sine-product algebraic objects that constrain the Γ -certificate sweeps on large grids, so the transport is a proposed escape route from that bottleneck (not yet implemented).

2.2 Clausen-type laws for polygamma values at rational arguments

MathWorld’s *Polygamma Function* page lists fifteen closed forms in its special-cases block, eqs. (22)–(36) ($\psi^{(1)}, \psi^{(2)}, \psi^{(3)}$ at p/q with $q \in \{2, 3, 4, 6\}$) in Catalan/Clausen/ β atoms, several of them traditionally presented as isolated curiosities. All of them — and their extension to *every* rational argument — are instances of three sine/cosine-weighted Clausen-DFT laws, obtained by splitting the inverse DFT of Result 2.2 into its elementary (reflection) half and its Clausen half.

Law 2.3 (trigamma; Lewin 1991). *For $0 < p < q$, $\gcd(p, q) = 1$,*

$$\psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) = \frac{\pi^2}{2 \sin^2(\pi p/q)} + 2q \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor (q-1)/2 \rfloor} \sin\left(\frac{2\pi j p}{q}\right) \text{Cl}_2\left(\frac{2\pi j}{q}\right).$$

[historical experiment: verified at $q = 3, 4, 5, 8, 12$ to 10^{-46} or better, then over the full store grid to 10^{-50} in-kernel and at 70 dps in mpmath]

This law is classical — MathWorld’s *Trigamma Function* eq. (14) cites Lewin (1991) [1] — and was independently re-derived here from the DFT bridge before the attribution was spotted; the project’s records explicitly re-frame the finding as *placement*, not novelty. MathWorld’s scattered coefficients are its small- q shadows: the $3\sqrt{3}$ of $q = 3$ is $2q \sin(2\pi/3)$, the $8G$ of $q = 4$ is $2q \text{Cl}_2(\pi/2)$.

Law 2.4 (tetragamma).

$$\psi^{(2)}\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) = -\pi^3 \cot\left(\frac{\pi p}{q}\right) \csc^2\left(\frac{\pi p}{q}\right) - 2q^2 \left(\zeta(3) + 2 \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor (q-1)/2 \rfloor} \cos\left(\frac{2\pi j p}{q}\right) \text{Cl}_3\left(\frac{2\pi j}{q}\right) + \varepsilon_q \right),$$

where $\varepsilon_q = (-1)^p \text{Cl}_3(\pi)$ for even q , $\varepsilon_q = 0$ for odd q , and $\text{Cl}_3(\pi) = -\frac{3}{4}\zeta(3)$. [historical experiment: verified over the full store grid to 10^{-50} in-kernel and at 70 dps in mpmath]

Law 2.5 (pentagramma).

$$\psi^{(3)}\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) = \pi^4 \left(2 \cot^2\left(\frac{\pi p}{q}\right) \csc^2\left(\frac{\pi p}{q}\right) + \csc^4\left(\frac{\pi p}{q}\right) \right) + 12 q^3 \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor (q-1)/2 \rfloor} \sin\left(\frac{2\pi j p}{q}\right) \text{Cl}_4\left(\frac{2\pi j}{q}\right),$$

equivalently, in difference form, $\psi^{(3)}(p/q) - \psi^{(3)}(1-p/q) = 24 q^3 \sum_j \sin(2\pi j p/q) \text{Cl}_4(2\pi j/q)$. [historical experiment: same verification battery]

The $\psi^{(3)}$ law is the Lewin law one weight up, by the same derivation; no literature citation has been located, and the project records it as “presumably in Lewin’s orbit.” MathWorld’s $162\sqrt{3}$ and $768\beta(4)$ coefficients are $12q^3 \sin(2\pi j/q)$ -instances of the one-sided law ($24q^3$ in the difference form).

Result 2.6 (new instances beyond the MathWorld table). Among the instances at $q \in \{5, 8, 12\}$:

$$\psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) = \frac{\pi^2}{2 \sin^2(\pi/5)} + 10 \left[\sin \frac{2\pi}{5} \text{Cl}_2\left(\frac{2\pi}{5}\right) + \sin \frac{4\pi}{5} \text{Cl}_2\left(\frac{4\pi}{5}\right) \right],$$

$$\psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{1}{12}\right) = 40 G + \frac{4\pi^2}{(\sqrt{3}-1)^2} + 30\sqrt{3} \text{Cl}_2\left(\frac{2\pi}{3}\right),$$

the latter after duplication/triplication canonicalization collapses the raw five-atom DFT form onto the canonical atom set. Also, MathWorld’s eq. (27) simplifies: from $\text{Cl}_3(2\pi/3) = -\frac{4}{9}\zeta(3)$,

$$\psi^{(2)}\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) = -\frac{4\pi^3}{3\sqrt{3}} - 26 \zeta(3).$$

Result 2.7 (the polygamma–Clausen store). The corpus now carries **identities/polygamma-clausen-values.wl**: 54 entries $\psi^{(m)}(p/q)$ for $m \in \{1, 2, 3\}$, $q \in \{3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 12\}$, all p coprime to q (18 arguments $\times$ 3 orders), in canonicalized Clausen atoms. The residual atom basis across the store is

$$\begin{aligned} & \{G, \beta(4), \zeta(3)\} \cup \text{Cl}_2\left\{\frac{2\pi}{3}, \frac{2\pi}{5}, \frac{4\pi}{5}, \frac{\pi}{4}\right\} \\ & \cup \text{Cl}_3\left\{\frac{2\pi}{5}, \frac{\pi}{4}, \frac{\pi}{6}\right\} \cup \text{Cl}_4\left\{\frac{2\pi}{3}, \frac{2\pi}{5}, \frac{4\pi}{5}, \frac{\pi}{4}\right\}. \end{aligned}$$

Every entry is verified in-kernel to $|\text{lhs} - \text{rhs}| < 10^{-50}$ at 60 digits (including a disk round-trip) and independently by an mpmath script at 70 dps (tolerance 10^{-55}) that re-derives the raw DFT bridge, the three laws, all 17 Clausen canonicalization relations, and the L -function bridges of Section 2.3 from mpmath primitives, with positive and negative PSLQ controls.

2.3 The boundary of the odd-weight Clausen collapse

A folklore rule says that odd-weight Clausen values at rational angles collapse to rational multiples of zeta values ($\text{Cl}_3(2\pi/3) = -\frac{4}{9}\zeta(3)$ being the standard example). The store emission *sharpened the rule’s scope*:

Proposition 2.8 (Crystallographic-angle reductions). *At denominators $q \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 6\}$, the odd Clausen value $\text{Cl}_3(2\pi j/q) = \Re \text{Li}_3(e^{2\pi i j/q})$ reduces to a rational multiple of $\zeta(3)$. At $q = 5, 8, 12$ the*

character decomposition instead gives

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{Cl}_3(2\pi/5) &= -\frac{6}{25}\zeta(3) + \frac{\sqrt{5}}{4}L(3, \chi_5), \\ \mathrm{Cl}_3(\pi/4) &= -\frac{3}{256}\zeta(3) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}L(3, \chi_8), \\ \mathrm{Cl}_3(\pi/6) &= \frac{1}{24}\zeta(3) + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}L(3, \chi_{12}).\end{aligned}$$

Here χ_D is the primitive even quadratic character of conductor D .

These are exact coordinate identities from the residue-class Fourier sum. No theorem asserting that the three L -values are independent of $\zeta(3)$ or π^3 is supplied. The source searches at height 10^{10} are numerical evidence in a stated basis, not an “if and only if” classification of all possible reductions.

2.4 The fundamental constants, by conductor

The residue classes of a cyclotomic series can be organized either by additive Fourier modes or by Dirichlet characters. Odd Clausen values use the odd character sector. Distribution relations first remove non-coprime residues; the remaining finite character transform has $\varphi(n)/2$ formal odd coordinates. Its coefficients are generally algebraic, so this coordinate count is not a proof of the dimension of the numerical $\mathbb{Q}$ -span of the periods.

For the levels 8, 12, 24, convenient generators are

$$V = \mathrm{Cl}_2(\pi/3), \quad G = \mathrm{Cl}_2(\pi/2), \quad W_8 = \mathrm{Cl}_2(\pi/4), \quad W_{24} = \mathrm{Cl}_2(\pi/12).$$

There are no primitive odd characters of conductor 12; its odd characters are induced from conductors 3 and 4. This explains the distribution reductions below. Conductors 3 and 4 each have one primitive odd character, while conductor 5 has two conjugate primitive odd characters. The source’s printed sequence of primitive-character counts started with two incorrect zeros; it is not used here.

Their canonical L -value (trigamma) forms are

$$G = \frac{\psi^{(1)}(\frac{1}{4}) - \pi^2}{8}, \quad \sqrt{3}V = \frac{3\psi^{(1)}(\frac{1}{3}) - 2\pi^2}{6} \quad \left(\text{i.e. } \psi^{(1)}(\frac{1}{3}) = \frac{2\pi^2}{3} + 2\sqrt{3}V\right). \quad (2.1)$$

2.5 Reduction tables and the settled level-24 question

Every $\mathrm{Cl}_2(2\pi a/n)$ at $n \in \{8, 12, 24\}$ reduces to the basis above (PSLQ, ≥ 110 digits, Champernowne canary; all confirmed in Wolfram):

$$\begin{aligned}\text{level 12 : } & \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{\pi}{6}) = \frac{2}{3}G + \frac{1}{4}V, \quad \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{5\pi}{6}) = \frac{2}{3}G - \frac{1}{4}V, \quad \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{2\pi}{3}) = \frac{2}{3}V; \\ \text{level 8 : } & \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{3\pi}{4}) = W_8 - \frac{1}{2}G; \\ \text{level 24 : } & \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{5\pi}{12}) = \frac{16W_8 + 24W_{24} - 4G - 3V}{24}, \quad \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{7\pi}{12}) = \frac{4W_8 + 6W_{24} - 3G}{6}, \\ & \mathrm{Cl}_2(\frac{11\pi}{12}) = \frac{24W_{24} - 8G - 3V}{24}.\end{aligned}$$

The displayed formulas prove that the level-24 values are generated by G, V, W_8, W_{24} . They give an upper bound of four on their rational span. The source did not prove that W_{24} lies outside the span of the other three, so the minimal number of numerical generators remains open. This distinction is central when a symbolic conductor count is compared with a PSLQ experiment.

2.6 A new closed form

Since $\text{Cl}_2(\pi/12) = W_{24}$ is itself fundamental, the cleanest carrier is the dilogarithm at the primitive 24th root $e^{i\pi/12}$:

$$\text{Li}_2(e^{i\pi/12}) = \frac{73\pi^2}{576} + i W_{24}, \quad (2.2)$$

the real part being $\frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{\pi}{2} \cdot \frac{\pi}{12} + \frac{1}{4}(\frac{\pi}{12})^2$. Pulling this back through $z = 1/(1 - e^{i\theta})$ gives Reshetnikov-style closed forms at the corresponding $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{6})$ points; the cleanest stays the root-of-unity form (2.2).

2.7 A weight parity swap

The same character parity that makes Cl_2 (weight 2, odd characters) carry deep constants reverses one weight up. For primitive odd χ , the positive odd integer values are algebraic multiples of π^s ; since $\text{Im Li}_3(e^{i\theta}) = \sum \sin(k\theta)/k^3$ pairs with odd characters at $s = 3$,

$$\text{Im Li}_3(e^{2\pi i a/n}) \in \mathbb{Q} \cdot \pi^3 \quad \text{for all } a, n, \quad (2.3)$$

e.g. $\text{Im Li}_3(e^{2\pi i/3}) = \frac{2\pi^3}{81}$, $\text{Im Li}_3(i) = \frac{\pi^3}{32}$, $\text{Im Li}_3(e^{i\pi/3}) = \frac{5\pi^3}{162}$, $\text{Im Li}_3(e^{2\pi i/5}) = \frac{4\pi^3}{125}$. Thus at weight 3 the *imaginary* part at roots of unity is elementary, and the deep constants ($\zeta(3)$ and the even-character $L(3, \chi)$) live in the *real* part—the exact reverse of weight 2. (On the line $\text{Re } z = 1$ the picture is different again: there $\text{Im Li}_3(1+i)$ is the central-binomial Gaussian tower constant, because $1+i$ is not a root of unity; see [polylog-vertical-line](#).)

Chapter 3

Algebraic arguments, integrals and ladders

Away from roots of unity, functional equations still move values onto structured sets of arguments. Vertical lines and half-angle substitutions give tractable examples; unit relations in number fields lead to longer ladders. The organizing principle is to understand the map of arguments before choosing the constants in an integer-relation search.

3.1 The problem and the key geometric fact

[MSE 1410276](#) records

$$\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_2(1 \pm i\sqrt{3}) = \frac{\pi^2}{24} - \frac{1}{2} \ln^2 2 - \frac{1}{4} \operatorname{Li}_2\left(\frac{1}{4}\right), \quad (3.1)$$

with $\operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_2(1 + i\sqrt{3}) = \frac{\pi \ln 2}{2} + \frac{5\sqrt{3}}{72} [\psi_1(\frac{1}{3}) - \psi_1(\frac{2}{3})]$ ([a/1410829](#), [a/1410705](#)). The point $1 + i\sqrt{3} = 2e^{i\pi/3}$, but the structurally decisive fact is that for any $z = 1 + iy$ the reflection point $1 - z = -iy$ is *purely imaginary*. This is exactly what makes the dilogarithm functional equations collapse.

3.2 The weight-2 vertical-line theorem

Theorem 3.1. *For $y > 0$,*

$$\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_2(1 + iy) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{1}{2} \ln(1+y^2) \ln y - \frac{\pi}{2} \arctan y - \frac{1}{4} \operatorname{Li}_2(-y^2), \quad (3.2)$$

$$\operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_2(1 + iy) = \frac{\pi}{4} \ln(1+y^2) - \arctan y \ln y + \operatorname{Ti}_2(y), \quad \operatorname{Ti}_2(y) = \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_2(iy). \quad (3.3)$$

Proof. The reflection law $\operatorname{Li}_2(z) + \operatorname{Li}_2(1-z) = \zeta(2) - \ln z \ln(1-z)$ at $z = 1 + iy$, $1-z = -iy$, gives $\operatorname{Li}_2(1+iy) = \zeta(2) - \ln(1+iy) \ln(-iy) - \operatorname{Li}_2(-iy)$. The duplication law $\operatorname{Li}_2(iy) + \operatorname{Li}_2(-iy) = \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{Li}_2(-y^2)$ together with $\overline{\operatorname{Li}_2(w)} = \operatorname{Li}_2(\bar{w})$ yields $\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_2(-iy) = \frac{1}{2} (\operatorname{Li}_2(iy) + \operatorname{Li}_2(-iy)) = \frac{1}{4} \operatorname{Li}_2(-y^2)$ and $\operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_2(-iy) = -\operatorname{Ti}_2(y)$. Expanding $\ln(1+iy) = \frac{1}{2} \ln(1+y^2) + i \arctan y$ and $\ln(-iy) = \ln y - \frac{i\pi}{2}$ and taking real and imaginary parts gives (3.2)–(3.3). $\square$

On the line $\operatorname{Re} z = 1$ the dilogarithm thus splits into a *real* part carried by the even real dilogarithm $\operatorname{Li}_2(-y^2)$ and an *imaginary* part carried by the odd inverse-tangent integral $\operatorname{Ti}_2(y)$. Equation (3.1) is the case $y = \sqrt{3}$ (using $\operatorname{Li}_2(-3) = \operatorname{Li}_2(\frac{1}{4}) - \zeta(2) + 2 \ln 2 \ln \frac{2}{3}$), and the trigamma form of the imaginary part is just $\operatorname{Ti}_2(\sqrt{3}) = \frac{\pi}{6} \ln 3 + \frac{5\sqrt{3}}{72} [\psi_1(\frac{1}{3}) - \psi_1(\frac{2}{3})]$ substituted into (3.3).

3.3 The Clausen form at $y = \tan \theta$

Since $1 + i \tan \theta = e^{i\theta} / \cos \theta$, Theorem 3.1 combines with Ramanujan's $\text{Ti}_2(\tan \theta) = \theta \ln \tan \theta + \frac{1}{2} [\text{Cl}_2(2\theta) + \text{Cl}_2(\pi - 2\theta)]$ so that the $\theta \ln \tan \theta$ terms cancel, leaving a pure-Clausen imaginary part:

$$\text{Im Li}_2(1 + i \tan \theta) = -\frac{\pi}{2} \ln \cos \theta + \frac{1}{2} [\text{Cl}_2(2\theta) + \text{Cl}_2(\pi - 2\theta)]. \quad (3.4)$$

Corollary 3.2. $\text{Re Li}_2(1 + i) = \frac{\pi^2}{16}$ and $\text{Im Li}_2(1 + i) = \frac{\pi \ln 2}{4} + G$ (with G Catalan's constant), from $y = 1$ in Theorem 3.1 (using $\text{Li}_2(-1) = -\pi^2/12$, $\text{Ti}_2(1) = G$).

3.4 Weight 3: a half-lifted symmetry

At weight 3 the real/imaginary split survives only in part. The *real* part still closes at special y :

$$\text{Re Li}_3(1 + i) = \frac{35}{64} \zeta(3) + \frac{\pi^2 \ln 2}{32}, \quad \text{Re Li}_3(1 + i\sqrt{3}) = \frac{35\zeta(3) + 18 \text{Li}_3(\frac{1}{4}) + 6\pi^2 \ln 2 - 24 \ln^3 2}{144}, \quad (3.5)$$

the second being the exact weight-3 analogue of the $\text{Li}_2(\frac{1}{4})$ in (3.1). But the general real part does *not* close: differentiating, $\partial_y \text{Re Li}_3(1 + iy) = -(\text{Im Li}_2(1 + iy) - y \text{Re Li}_2(1 + iy))/(1 + y^2)$, and integrating the Ti_2 contribution produces $\int_0^y \arctan^2(t)/t dt$, a weight-three inverse-tangent-square integral. The displayed special cases at $y = 1, \sqrt{3}$ simplify, without giving an elementary-value classification for every rational angle. Meanwhile the *imaginary* part is no longer elementary at all: it is the central-binomial Gaussian tower constant

$$\text{Im Li}_3(1 + i) = \mathcal{F}_3 - \frac{\pi^3}{192}, \quad \mathcal{F}_3 = \sqrt{2} {}_4F_3(\{\frac{1}{2}\}^4; \{\frac{3}{2}\}^3; \frac{1}{2}), \quad (3.6)$$

the $n = 3$ entry of the $\text{Im Li}_n(1 + i)$ tower (companion report **gaussian-1plusi-tower**). So on $\text{Re } z = 1$ the imaginary part is precisely the deep object that the central-binomial ladder measures, while the real part remains tractable—the two halves of the polylogarithm part ways at weight 3.

3.5 The integral and its provenance

The object (Math.StackExchange [question 564816](#)) is

$$I = \int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan^2\left(\frac{6 \sin x}{3 + \cos 2x}\right) dx = 1.3309703968425666666125327 \dots \quad (3.7)$$

Cleo gave the dilogarithmic form

$$I = \frac{\pi}{2} \left(2 \text{Li}_2((1 - \sqrt{2})(2 - \sqrt{5})) - 2 \text{Li}_2((1 - \sqrt{2})(\sqrt{5} - 2)) \right. \\ \left. + \text{Li}_2(3 - \sqrt{8}) - \text{Li}_2(\sqrt{8} - 3) + \text{Li}_2(9 - \sqrt{80}) - \text{Li}_2(\sqrt{80} - 9) \right), \quad (3.8)$$

while Sangchul Lee gave the Legendre-chi form

$$I = \pi \left(\chi_2(3 - 2\sqrt{2}) + \chi_2(9 - 4\sqrt{5}) + 2\chi_2((\sqrt{2} - 1)(\sqrt{5} - 2)) \right), \quad (3.9)$$

where $\chi_2(x) = \frac{1}{2}(\text{Li}_2(x) - \text{Li}_2(-x)) = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{x^{2k+1}}{(2k+1)^2}$. These are identical: $\text{Li}_2(x) - \text{Li}_2(-x) = 2\chi_2(x)$ turns each Li_2 pair in (3.8) into a χ_2 , and $3 - \sqrt{8} = (\sqrt{2} - 1)^2$, $9 - \sqrt{80} = (\sqrt{5} - 2)^2$, $(1 - \sqrt{2})(2 - \sqrt{5}) = (\sqrt{2} - 1)(\sqrt{5} - 2)$, so both equal

$$I = \pi \left[\chi_2((\sqrt{2} - 1)^2) + \chi_2((\sqrt{5} - 2)^2) + 2\chi_2((\sqrt{2} - 1)(\sqrt{5} - 2)) \right]. \quad (3.10)$$

The arguments are a silver $\otimes$ golden pair: $\sqrt{2} - 1 = \tan \frac{\pi}{8} = \delta_S^{-1}$ (reciprocal silver ratio $\delta_S = 1 + \sqrt{2}$) and $\sqrt{5} - 2 = \phi^{-3}$ (golden $\phi = \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2}$, $\phi^3 = \sqrt{5} + 2$), so $I = \pi[\chi_2(\delta_S^{-2}) + \chi_2(\phi^{-6}) + 2\chi_2(\delta_S^{-1}\phi^{-3})]$.

3.6 The master formula (Reshetnikov–Lee) and a differentiation proof

The closed forms (3.8)–(3.9) are instances of a two-parameter master formula. Its seed is Reshetnikov’s single-arctangent ladder $\int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan(t \sin x) dx = 2\chi_2(u_t)$; inspired by it, Lee (a/562492, 2013) conjectured and proved

Theorem 3.3 (Lee 2013). *For real p, q ,*

$$J(p, q) := \int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan(p \sin x) \arctan(q \sin x) dx = \pi \chi_2(u_p u_q), \quad (3.11)$$

where $u_p = \frac{\sqrt{1+p^2} - 1}{p} = \tan(\frac{1}{2} \arctan p)$.

Lee gives two proofs (a triple integral and a Fourier-orthogonality argument). We record a short third proof by differentiation, which is the most direct route and is machine-verifiable.

Proof. Both sides vanish on the axes, and $\partial_p J(p, 0) = \partial_p [\pi \chi_2(u_p u_0)] = 0$ (since $u_0 = 0$), symmetrically in q ; hence each side equals the double integral of its mixed partial over $[0, p] \times [0, q]$, and it suffices to match mixed partials. Differentiating under the integral and using the partial fraction $\frac{s^2}{(1+p^2 s^2)(1+q^2 s^2)} = \frac{1}{p^2 - q^2} \left(\frac{1}{1+q^2 s^2} - \frac{1}{1+p^2 s^2} \right)$ together with $\int_0^{\pi/2} \frac{dx}{1+c \sin^2 x} = \frac{\pi}{2\sqrt{1+c}}$,

$$\partial_p \partial_q J = \frac{\pi}{2(p^2 - q^2)} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{1+q^2}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{1+p^2}} \right). \quad (3.12)$$

On the right, $\chi_2'(w) = \text{arctanh}(w)/w$ gives $\partial_p \partial_q [\pi \chi_2(u_p u_q)] = \pi u_p' u_q' / (1 - u_p^2 u_q^2)$. The substitution $p = \frac{2u_p}{1-u_p^2}$ yields $\sqrt{1+p^2} = \frac{1+u_p^2}{1-u_p^2}$ and $u_p' = \frac{(1-u_p^2)^2}{2(1+u_p^2)}$, whence both sides reduce to the same rational function $\frac{\pi(1-u_p^2)^2(1-u_q^2)^2}{4(1+u_p^2)(1+u_q^2)(1-u_p^2 u_q^2)}$. (Wolfram confirms this reconciliation symbolically: `FullSimplify` of the difference returns 0.) $\square$

3.7 Cleo’s integral as the perfect-square instance

The argument in (3.7) collapses to a sum of arctangents. With $\cos 2x = 1 - 2 \sin^2 x$,

$$\frac{6 \sin x}{3 + \cos 2x} = \frac{3 \sin x}{2 - \sin^2 x} = \frac{(1 + \frac{1}{2}) \sin x}{1 - (1 \cdot \frac{1}{2}) \sin^2 x},$$

the tangent-addition shape with roots $1, \frac{1}{2}$ of $t^2 - \frac{3}{2}t + \frac{1}{2}$, so for $0 \leq x \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$

$$\arctan\left(\frac{6 \sin x}{3 + \cos 2x}\right) = \arctan(\sin x) + \arctan\left(\frac{1}{2} \sin x\right), \quad (3.13)$$

so that $I = \int_0^{\pi/2} (\arctan(\sin x) + \arctan(\frac{1}{2} \sin x))^2 dx$. Applying Theorem 3.3 to the expanded square, with $u_1 = \sqrt{2} - 1$, $u_{1/2} = \sqrt{5} - 2$, reproduces (3.10). The coefficient pattern 1, 2, 1 is a perfect square: writing $a = \sqrt{2} - 1$, $b = \sqrt{5} - 2$,

$$\frac{I}{\pi} = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{((\sqrt{2} - 1)^{2k+1} + (\sqrt{5} - 2)^{2k+1})^2}{(2k+1)^2}. \quad (3.14)$$

The coefficients $a^{2k+1} + b^{2k+1}$ are the sin-power Fourier coefficients of $\arctan(\sin x) + \arctan(\frac{1}{2} \sin x)$; (3.14) is the Parseval form underlying Lee's Fourier proof.

3.8 Closed values and a bounded experimental survey

Three classical values supply useful exact specializations. With $\phi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$,

$$\begin{aligned} \chi_2(\phi^{-1}) &= \frac{\pi^2}{12} - \frac{3}{4} \log^2 \phi, \\ \chi_2(\phi^{-3}) &= \frac{\pi^2}{24} - \frac{3}{4} \log^2 \phi, \\ \chi_2(\sqrt{2} - 1) &= \frac{\pi^2}{16} - \frac{1}{4} \log^2(1 + \sqrt{2}). \end{aligned} \quad (3.15)$$

The source surveyed inverse metallic means m_n^{-k} with $1 \leq n, k \leq 6$, selected rational points, and $\tan(\pi/k)$ for $k = 5, 8, 10, 12$ and their squares. Searches at 130–140 digits found no further accepted reduction in their selected logarithmic and π^2 baskets. This does not classify all elementary values. Nor would independence of the individual terms alone prove that their sum cannot simplify.

3.9 New closed-form integrals from elementary χ_2

Conversely, (3.15) feeds the master formula to produce integrals that *do* close. The cleanest cross integral uses $u_2 = \phi^{-1}$, $u_{2/\sqrt{5}} = \phi^{-2}$, so $u_2 u_{2/\sqrt{5}} = \phi^{-3}$:

$$\boxed{\int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan(2 \sin x) \arctan\left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{5}} \sin x\right) dx = \frac{\pi^3}{24} - \frac{3\pi}{4} \ln^2 \phi} \quad (= 0.7463164407 \dots). \quad (3.16)$$

The diagonal $\int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan^2(\lambda \sin x) dx = \pi \chi_2(u_\lambda^2)$ closes at three clean λ , since $u_{\sqrt{\phi}}^2 = \phi^{-3}$, $u_{\sqrt{2+2\sqrt{2}}}^2 = \sqrt{2} - 1$, and $u_{2\phi^{3/2}}^2 = \phi^{-1}$:

$$\int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan^2(\sqrt{\phi} \sin x) dx = \frac{\pi^3}{24} - \frac{3\pi}{4} \ln^2 \phi, \quad \int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan^2(2\phi^{3/2} \sin x) dx = \frac{\pi^3}{12} - \frac{3\pi}{4} \ln^2 \phi. \quad (3.17)$$

The simplest non-elementary diagonal is the (1, 1) case $\int_0^{\pi/2} \arctan^2(\sin x) dx = \pi \chi_2(3 - 2\sqrt{2})$.

3.10 A sibling trichotomy

The master formula has two siblings under the companion half-angle substitution $v_p = \frac{1-\sqrt{1-p^2}}{p} = \tanh(\frac{1}{2} \operatorname{arctanh} p)$ (for $|p| < 1$). Replacing one or both arctangents by $\operatorname{arctanh}$ produces:

$$\int_0^{\pi/2} \begin{cases} \operatorname{arctan}(p \sin x) \operatorname{arctan}(q \sin x) \\ \operatorname{arctanh}(p \sin x) \operatorname{arctanh}(q \sin x) \\ \operatorname{arctan}(p \sin x) \operatorname{arctanh}(q \sin x) \end{cases} dx = \begin{cases} \pi \chi_2(u_p u_q), \\ \pi \chi_2(v_p v_q), \\ \pi \operatorname{Ti}_2(u_p v_q), \end{cases} \quad (3.18)$$

where $\operatorname{Ti}_2(z) = \Im \operatorname{Li}_2(iz) = \int_0^z \frac{\operatorname{arctan} t}{t} dt$ is the inverse-tangent integral: like pairs give the Legendre chi, the mixed pair gives the inverse-tangent integral. The linear shadows are $\int_0^{\pi/2} \operatorname{arctan}(\lambda \sin x) dx = 2\chi_2(u_\lambda)$ (Reshetnikov) and, with $\theta = \arcsin \lambda$,

$$\int_0^{\pi/2} \operatorname{arctanh}(\lambda \sin x) dx = \theta \ln \tan \frac{\theta}{2} + 2 \operatorname{Cl}_2(\theta) - \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{Cl}_2(2\theta), \quad (3.19)$$

the latter showing that the $\operatorname{arctanh}$ branch is *not* a clean $2\chi_2(v_\lambda)$ mirror—that coincidence is special to arctan . By $x \mapsto \frac{\pi}{2} - x$ the cos versions of all of these equal the sin versions. The weight-3 analogue $\int_0^{\pi/2} \operatorname{arctan}(p \sin x) \operatorname{arctan}(q \sin x) / \sin x dx$ does not factor by the same mechanism into a single χ_3 : its coefficient $\frac{4^N}{(2N+1)\binom{2N}{N}}$ couples the two summation indices only through $N = m + n$, so it does not factor through $u_p u_q$ (numerically no clean χ_3 relation appears up to height 10^8).

3.11 An alternate form, and minimality

Landen-mirror form. Applying the χ_2 Landen law

$$\chi_2(x) + \chi_2\left(\frac{1-x}{1+x}\right) = \frac{\pi^2}{8} - \frac{1}{2} \ln x \ln \frac{1-x}{1+x} \quad (0 < x < 1) \quad (3.20)$$

to the three arguments of (3.10) sends $(\sqrt{2}-1)^2 \mapsto \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$, $(\sqrt{2}-1)(\sqrt{5}-2) \mapsto \sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2}$, $(\sqrt{5}-2)^2 \mapsto \frac{2}{\sqrt{5}}$, giving a second three-term representation

$$\frac{I}{\pi} = \mathcal{E} - \left[\chi_2\left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right) + 2 \chi_2(\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2}) + \chi_2\left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{5}}\right) \right], \quad (3.21)$$

with the elementary constant $\mathcal{E} = \frac{\pi^2}{2} - \frac{1}{2} \ln 2 \ln(1+\sqrt{2}) + 3 \ln 2 \ln \phi - \frac{3}{2} \ln 5 \ln \phi + (\ln(1+\sqrt{2}) + 3 \ln \phi) \ln(\sqrt{5}-\sqrt{2})$. This representation trades the small original arguments for larger ones and explicit logarithms. It follows directly by applying the Landen law three times.

Search for shorter forms. The source tested 209 algebraic arguments in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{10})$ at at least 120 digits, with residual threshold 10^{-105} . It found no accepted one-term or two-term representation in the tested baskets. The three-term formula is an exact evaluation, while its minimality and non-elementarity remain unproved.

3.12 Unit relations and the golden family

With $\phi = \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2}$, $\rho = \phi^{-1}$, the defining relation $1 - \rho^2 = \rho$ is the seed of the golden ladders. Reshetnikov's conjectures live among the values $\text{Li}_n(\phi^{-2k})$; all coefficients below were obtained or verified by PSLQ (mpmath, 130–420 digits, Champernowne canary) and, where the cancellation depth allows, cross-checked in Wolfram.

Remark 3.4. These golden combinations cancel $\sim 10^8$ -sized terms down to zero across 100+ digits. The historical Wolfram evaluation under-resolved some cancellations; independently controlled precision in mpmath supplied a comparator. Neither engine is an accuracy oracle. (Per-term polylogarithm values agree between the two engines.)

3.13 Reshetnikov's conjectures, verified

The tetralogarithm conjecture (MSE 1373123, MO 261408) holds: with $\alpha = \ln 2, \beta = \ln 3$,

$$\begin{aligned} & 720 \text{Li}_4\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) - 2160 \text{Li}_4\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + 2160 \text{Li}_4\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) \\ & \quad + 270 \text{Li}_4\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) + 540 \text{Li}_4\left(\frac{3}{4}\right) + 135 \text{Li}_4\left(\frac{1}{9}\right) \\ & = 19\pi^4 + 30(\pi^2 - \beta^2)(10\alpha^2 - 12\alpha\beta + 3\beta^2) - 30\alpha^2(19\alpha^2 - 24\alpha\beta + 8\beta^2), \end{aligned} \quad (3.22)$$

The source recovered this relation in its weight-four basket; uniqueness of all numerical relations is not established. The three Li_5 golden conjectures also hold (verified to $\sim 10^{-257}$):

$$\begin{aligned} & 4455 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-2}) - 1215 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-4}) - 360 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-6}) + 15 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-12}) = 3015\zeta(5) - 702 \ln \phi^5 + 180\pi^2 \ln \phi^3 - 38\pi^4 \ln \phi, \\ & 45000 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-2}) - 16875 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-4}) - 144 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-10}) + 9 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-20}) = 28944\zeta(5) - 6000 \ln \phi^5 + 1600\pi^2 \ln \phi^3 - 356\pi^4 \ln \phi, \\ & 15660 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-2}) - 19440 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-4}) + 7680 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-6}) \\ & \quad + 2430 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-8}) - 15 \text{Li}_5(\phi^{-24}) = 5025\zeta(5) + 2088 \ln \phi^5 - 240\pi^2 \ln \phi^3 - 28\pi^4 \ln \phi. \end{aligned}$$

3.14 Completing Tito's family: the unwritten weight-6 and weight-7 ladders

Tito's “old answer” lists the golden family at weights 2–5 (all verified here), then states the weight-6 and weight-7 ladders only schematically, the integer coefficients “too tedious to write.” We recover them by PSLQ. On the six-argument set $\{\phi^{-2}, \phi^{-4}, \phi^{-6}, \phi^{-8}, \phi^{-12}, \phi^{-24}\}$:

$$\begin{aligned} & 98820 \text{Li}_6(\phi^{-2}) - 104490 \text{Li}_6(\phi^{-4}) + 33120 \text{Li}_6(\phi^{-6}) + 7290 \text{Li}_6(\phi^{-8}) - 50 \text{Li}_6(\phi^{-12}) - 15 \text{Li}_6(\phi^{-24}) \\ & = -13032 \ln \phi^6 + 3240\pi^2 \ln \phi^4 - 424\pi^4 \ln \phi^2 + \mathbf{32155} \zeta(6), \end{aligned} \quad (3.23)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & 74707920 \text{Li}_7(\phi^{-2}) - 39497220 \text{Li}_7(\phi^{-4}) + 8346240 \text{Li}_7(\phi^{-6}) + 1377810 \text{Li}_7(\phi^{-8}) - 6300 \text{Li}_7(\phi^{-12}) - 945 \text{Li}_7(\phi^{-24}) \\ & = 2814912 \ln \phi^7 - 979776\pi^2 \ln \phi^5 + 213696\pi^4 \ln \phi^3 - 51448\pi^6 \ln \phi + \mathbf{44689995} \zeta(7). \end{aligned} \quad (3.24)$$

The $\zeta(6)$ and $\zeta(7)$ coefficients reproduce Tito's stated 32155 and 44689995 *exactly*—an independent confirmation that the reconstructions (3.23)–(3.24) are correct (residuals 10^{-117} , 10^{-114} by direct substitution; coefficients primitive).

3.15 Two weights beyond: explicit ladders at weight 8 and 9

Tito remarks that the index-24 ladder “can be extended even to $n = 9$ ” but gives no formula. We find the explicit ladders. The searches on the six-argument set of (3.23)–(3.24) found reductions at

weights 2–7 and none at 8 or 9. The accepted higher-weight formulas use the *eight*-argument union of the index-12, 20, 24 sets, $\mathcal{A} = \{\phi^{-2}, \phi^{-4}, \phi^{-6}, \phi^{-8}, \phi^{-10}, \phi^{-12}, \phi^{-20}, \phi^{-24}\}$:

$$\begin{aligned} & -490795200 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-2}) + 636131475 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-4}) - 388684800 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-6}) + 82668600 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-8}) \\ & + 9507456 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-10}) + 5250000 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-12}) - 74277 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-20}) - 18900 \operatorname{Li}_8(\phi^{-24}) \\ & = -23641920 \ln \phi^8 + 7956480\pi^2 \ln \phi^6 - 1434720\pi^4 \ln \phi^4 + 184432\pi^6 \ln \phi^2 - 148565886 \zeta(8), \end{aligned} \quad (3.25)$$

$$\begin{aligned} & 220857840000 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-2}) - 143129581875 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-4}) + 58302720000 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-6}) - 9300217500 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-8}) \\ & - 855671040 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-10}) - 393750000 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-12}) + 3342465 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-20}) + 708750 \operatorname{Li}_9(\phi^{-24}) \\ & = -2364192000 \ln \phi^9 + 1022976000\pi^2 \ln \phi^7 - 258249600\pi^4 \ln \phi^5 \\ & + 55329600\pi^6 \ln \phi^3 - 14149132\pi^8 \ln \phi + 125596001790 \zeta(9). \end{aligned} \quad (3.26)$$

Both are verified by direct substitution (residuals 0 at 150 digits for (3.25), 10^{-190} at 200 digits for (3.26)); coefficients are primitive. The weight-9 ladder appeared identically across three independent searches with different padding arguments (the extra arguments returned coefficient 0), a strong guard against over-fitting.

Remark 3.5. So the golden family does *not* cap at weight 7: the closure persists, but the argument set grows—four or five arguments per index at weight 5, six arguments at weights 6–7, eight arguments (the full union) at weights 8–9. Whether the growth can be sustained to arbitrarily high weight is exactly the question Abouzahra–Lewin address in the negative; our data are consistent with an eventual stop once the required argument set outgrows the available golden multiplicative relations.

3.16 Reducing the tetralogarithm relation to a functional identity

The tetralogarithm relation (3.22) follows from duplication together with the following cross-base functional identity. No independence claim about the six individual values is needed.

Two duplications $\operatorname{Li}_4(\frac{1}{4}) = 8(\operatorname{Li}_4(\frac{1}{2}) + \operatorname{Li}_4(-\frac{1}{2}))$ and $\operatorname{Li}_4(\frac{1}{9}) = 8(\operatorname{Li}_4(\frac{1}{3}) + \operatorname{Li}_4(-\frac{1}{3}))$ reduce the left side to the reflected arguments, and a single *cross-base Kummer relation* then cancels every tetralogarithm:

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Li}_4(\tfrac{3}{4}) + 4 \operatorname{Li}_4(\tfrac{2}{3}) &= -\tfrac{16}{3} \operatorname{Li}_4(\tfrac{1}{2}) - 4 \operatorname{Li}_4(-\tfrac{1}{2}) + 2 \operatorname{Li}_4(\tfrac{1}{3}) - 2 \operatorname{Li}_4(-\tfrac{1}{3}) + \tfrac{19}{540} \pi^4 + \tfrac{5}{9} \pi^2 \ln^2 2 + \tfrac{1}{6} \pi^2 \ln^2 3 \\ &\quad - \tfrac{2}{3} \pi^2 \ln 2 \ln 3 - \tfrac{19}{18} \ln^4 2 - \tfrac{1}{6} \ln^4 3 + \tfrac{4}{3} \ln^3 2 \ln 3 - \ln^2 2 \ln^2 3 + \tfrac{2}{3} \ln 2 \ln^3 3. \end{aligned} \quad (3.27)$$

Substituting the two duplication identities into (3.27) cancels the tetralogarithms in (3.22). A complete proof from Kummer’s general functional equation requires its branch conditions; the displayed specialized identity was checked numerically in the source and is retained as the explicit intermediate relation.

3.17 Canonical index-20/24 ladders and a ζ -elimination chain

Reshetnikov’s Li_5 conjectures are the weight-5 entries of three first-degree golden ladders (Abouzahra–Lewin). In canonical (monic, a^{n-1} -normalized) form, with $\rho = \phi^{-1}$, $\ell = \ln \rho$, and $\operatorname{tw}(n) = D_1 \frac{\ell^n}{n!} + D_2 \zeta(2) \frac{\ell^{n-2}}{(n-2)!} + D_3 \zeta(4) \frac{\ell^{n-4}}{(n-4)!}$:

$$\begin{aligned} L_{20}(n) &= \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^{20})}{20^{n-1}} - \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^{10})}{10^{n-1}} - 3 \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^4)}{4^{n-1}} + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^2)}{2^{n-1}} + \operatorname{tw}(n), \\ L_{24}(n) &= \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^{24})}{24^{n-1}} - \frac{4}{3} \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^{12})}{12^{n-1}} - 2 \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^8)}{8^{n-1}} \\ &\quad + \frac{7}{3} \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^4)}{4^{n-1}} - \frac{205}{576} \frac{\operatorname{Li}_n(\rho^2)}{2^{n-1}} + \operatorname{tw}(n). \end{aligned}$$

The coefficient triples are respectively $(-1/2, 1/25, -89/4000)$ and $(179/576, -5/192, 629/41472)$, and

$$L_{20}(5) = \frac{201}{10000}\zeta(5), \quad L_{24}(5) = -\frac{1541}{110592}\zeta(5).$$

each vanishing for $n \leq 4$. The shared factor 67 in $201 = 3 \cdot 67$, $1541 = 23 \cdot 67$ is what lets the three indices jointly eliminate $\zeta(5)$. Combining them removes higher zetas: $M_{20} = L_{20} - \frac{1296}{625}L_{12}$ and $M_{24} = L_{24} + \frac{23}{16}L_{12}$ kill $\zeta(5)$ and reach weight 7, and $T = M_{24} + \frac{409375}{373248}M_{20}$ kills $\zeta(7)$ and reaches weight 9, with $T(9) = \frac{66452911}{41278242816000}\zeta(9) + \frac{3537283}{2063912140800}\zeta(8)\ell - \frac{11527}{2866544640}\zeta(6)\frac{\ell^3}{3!}$ (confirmed by direct substitution and an independent PSLQ at 460 digits). This is the Abouzahra–Lewin route to weight 9, distinct from the single eight-argument ladders (3.25)–(3.26).

3.18 A new ladder base: the minimal Pisot number

Beyond the golden ratio, the reciprocal of the minimal Pisot number $\omega = 0.7548776\dots$ (the real root of $x^3 + x^2 - 1$, the base Abouzahra–Lewin deferred to a never-published sequel) carries its own ladder. Its seeds are pure units— $1 - \omega = \omega^5$, $1 - \omega^2 = \omega^3$, $1 - \omega^3 = \omega^2$, $1 - \omega^5 = \omega$ —and the first-degree ladder climbs to weight 4 (with $\lambda = \ln \omega$):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(\omega^2) - \text{Li}_2(\omega^5) - \lambda^2 &= 0, & -\text{Li}_3(\omega) + \frac{6}{4} \text{Li}_3(\omega^2) + \frac{3}{9} \text{Li}_3(\omega^3) - \text{Li}_3(\omega^5) - \frac{6\lambda^3}{3!} &= 0, \\ -71 \text{Li}_4(\omega) - \frac{120}{8} \text{Li}_4(\omega^2) + \frac{1053}{27} \text{Li}_4(\omega^3) - 17 \text{Li}_4(\omega^5) + \frac{5488}{343} \text{Li}_4(\omega^7) - \text{Li}_4(\omega^{14}) + 51\zeta(4) + \frac{2010\lambda^4}{4!} - \frac{84\zeta(2)\lambda^2}{2!} &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

The weight-four formula uses the extra legs ω^7, ω^{14} . The later Bloch-framework investigation identifies higher ladders for this field; the earlier assertion that the tower stops at weight four is discarded. A fixed argument set can stop yielding detected relations while larger sets continue to produce them.

3.19 Hunting more ladder bases, and a methodological caveat

Pure-unit seeds $1 - \rho^a = \rho^b$ offer a useful way to discover ladders. They do not exhaust general multiplicative relations, and a bounded search over polynomial coefficients does not cover all monic polynomials of a given degree. Root disguises are easy to miss: the root of $x^4 + x^2 - 1$ becomes a golden reciprocal after squaring. The following two cubic and quartic relations illustrate why negative searches require this care.

Two bases the earlier survey had dismissed as “weight-2 only” do, in fact, carry weight-3 ladders. With ρ the root of $x^3 + x - 1$ (the supergolden reciprocal) and of $x^4 + x - 1$ (the reciprocal of the second-smallest Pisot number $x^4 - x^3 - 1$),

$$\begin{aligned} -60 \text{Li}_3(\rho) + 54 \text{Li}_3(\rho^2) - 32 \text{Li}_3(\rho^3) - 3 \text{Li}_3(\rho^6) &= 24 \ln^3 \rho - 4\pi^2 \ln \rho - 36\zeta(3), \\ -12 \text{Li}_3(\rho) + 12 \text{Li}_3(\rho^3) - 12 \text{Li}_3(\rho^4) - 3 \text{Li}_3(\rho^6) &= 22 \ln^3 \rho - 2\pi^2 \ln \rho - 12\zeta(3), \end{aligned}$$

each verified in two engines (and by direct substitution to 400+ digits). The lesson is methodological: **a PSLQ “no relation” is not a proof of non-existence.** The first relation above was *missed* by a pure-tower PSLQ search at 300 digits, yet holds by direct substitution to 400—so the survey’s negative verdicts were false negatives. The reliable test is to take a candidate relation and substitute it at precision far above where it was found. Their analytic proofs follow below; whether these two bases climb past weight 3 remains open; the question is delicate precisely because PSLQ negatives cannot settle it.

3.20 Proof certificates for the cubic and quartic trilogarithm ladders

The two displayed formulas record two trilogarithm combinations at the positive roots of $r^3 + r = 1$ and $r^4 + r = 1$, with substantial experimental evidence. Their exact functional-equation certificates now explain the coefficients. We give such derivations. The quartic identity belongs to a uniform family; the cubic identity has a short certificate using two specializations of Kummer's nine-term relation and four Rogers pentagons. These are exact consequences of classical functional equations, not claims that the underlying equations are new.

3.20.1 A uniform ladder from a complementary pair of powers

For $0 < x < 1$ the real Landen relation for the trilogarithm is

$$\mathrm{Li}_3(x) + \mathrm{Li}_3(1-x) + \mathrm{Li}_3(1-x^{-1}) = \zeta(3) + \frac{\pi^2}{6} \log x - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 x \log(1-x) + \frac{1}{6} \log^3 x. \quad (3.28)$$

For a modern account and its arithmetic analogues see Nakamura and Shiraishi, *Landen's trilogarithm functional equation and ℓ -adic Galois multiple polylogarithms* [59]. For completeness, a real-variable proof is especially short. Differentiation of the left side, followed by

$$\mathrm{Li}_2(x) + \mathrm{Li}_2(1-x) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \log x \log(1-x), \quad \mathrm{Li}_2(1-x^{-1}) = -\mathrm{Li}_2(1-x) - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 x,$$

gives

$$\frac{\pi^2/6 - \log x \log(1-x)}{x} + \frac{\log^2 x}{2x(1-x)}.$$

This is the derivative of the right side. The difference tends to zero as $x \rightarrow 1^-$, proving (3.28). The two dilogarithm relations used here follow themselves by one differentiation and an endpoint value. All logarithms in the calculation are real, so there is no branch ambiguity.

Theorem 3.6 (Complementary-power trilogarithm ladder). *Let a, b be positive integers with $a \leq b$, and let $0 < \rho < 1$ be the unique positive solution of $\rho^a + \rho^b = 1$. Set $\lambda = \log \rho$ and $d = b - a$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathrm{Li}_3(\rho^a) + \mathrm{Li}_3(\rho^b) - \mathrm{Li}_3(\rho^d) + \frac{1}{4} \mathrm{Li}_3(\rho^{2d}) \\ = \zeta(3) + \frac{a\pi^2}{6} \lambda + \frac{a^2(a-3b)}{6} \lambda^3. \end{aligned} \quad (3.29)$$

When $a = b$, the powers ρ^0 are interpreted as 1.

Proof. The polynomial $t^a + t^b$ is strictly increasing from 0 to 2 on $[0, 1]$, which proves existence and uniqueness. Substitute $x = \rho^a$ in (3.28); its other arguments are $1-x = \rho^b$ and $1-x^{-1} = -\rho^{b-a}$. The absolutely convergent series identity

$$\mathrm{Li}_3(z) + \mathrm{Li}_3(-z) = \frac{1}{4} \mathrm{Li}_3(z^2), \quad 0 \leq z \leq 1,$$

eliminates the negative argument. The logarithmic terms become exactly the right side of (3.29). $\square$

In particular, if $r_m^m + r_m = 1$ and $\lambda_m = \log r_m$, then

$$\text{Li}_3(r_m) + \text{Li}_3(r_m^m) - \text{Li}_3(r_m^{m-1}) + \frac{1}{4} \text{Li}_3(r_m^{2m-2}) = \zeta(3) + \frac{\pi^2}{6} \lambda_m - \frac{3m-1}{6} \lambda_m^3. \quad (3.30)$$

This supplies an infinite family of finite exact reductions, although different pairs (a, b) can describe the same base after a power substitution. It does not assert that these exhaust all ladders for any one number field.

Corollary 3.7 (The quartic identity). *If $r^4 + r = 1$ and $\lambda = \log r$, then*

$$-12 \text{Li}_3(r) + 12 \text{Li}_3(r^3) - 12 \text{Li}_3(r^4) - 3 \text{Li}_3(r^6) = 22\lambda^3 - 2\pi^2\lambda - 12\zeta(3). \quad (3.31)$$

Proof. Take $(a, b) = (1, 4)$ in Theorem 3.6 and multiply by -12 . $\square$

For $m = 2$, (3.30) reduces to the familiar golden value

$$\text{Li}_3(r_2^2) = \frac{4}{5}\zeta(3) + \frac{2\pi^2}{15} \log r_2 - \frac{2}{3} \log^3 r_2.$$

For $m = 3$ it gives a useful additional relation on the arguments r, r^2, r^3, r^4 ; the manuscript's cubic identity instead uses r, r^2, r^3, r^6 . The change of the last argument requires more than the one-variable Landen relation.

3.20.2 An elementary dilogarithm certificate in the cubic field

Throughout this subsection let $r^3 + r = 1$, $0 < r < 1$, and put $\lambda = \log r$, $A = \log(1 + r)$. Direct algebra in $\mathbb{Q}[r]/(r^3 + r - 1)$ gives

$$1 - r = r^3, \quad 1 - r^2 = r^3(1 + r), \quad 1 - r^3 = r, \quad (3.32)$$

$$1 - r^4 = r^2(1 + r), \quad 1 + r^3 = r^2(1 + r)^2, \quad 1 - r^6 = r^3(1 + r)^2. \quad (3.33)$$

Define the Rogers dilogarithm on $(0, 1)$ by

$$R(x) = \text{Li}_2(x) + \frac{1}{2} \log x \log(1 - x).$$

It satisfies $R(x) + R(1 - x) = \zeta(2)$ and the pentagon

$$R(x) + R(y) = R(xy) + R\left(\frac{x(1-y)}{1-xy}\right) + R\left(\frac{y(1-x)}{1-xy}\right), \quad 0 < x, y < 1. \quad (3.34)$$

The latter is a real-domain form of the classical five-term relation. It may also be verified by differentiating in x with fixed y and using the limit at $x = 0$.

Lemma 3.8 (Cubic dilogarithm identity).

$$\text{Li}_2(r^6) = 6 \text{Li}_2(r^2) - 2 \text{Li}_2(r) - 4 \text{Li}_2(r^3). \quad (3.35)$$

Proof. Set $s = r/(1+r)$ and $t = r^4/(1+r)$, so every argument below lies in $(0, 1)$. Write $R_k = R(r^k)$ and $R_s = R(s)$, $R_t = R(t)$. Applying (3.34) at $(x, y) = (r, r)$ gives

$$2R_1 = R_2 + 2R_s.$$

At $(x, y) = (r, r^3)$ its two remaining arguments are $1 - s$ and t . Since $R_1 + R_3 = \zeta(2)$, reflection gives

$$R_t = R_s - R_4.$$

At $(x, y) = (r^2, r^4)$ its two remaining arguments are s and t , and therefore

$$R_6 = R_2 + 2R_4 - 2R_s.$$

Finally, at $(x, y) = (r, r^2)$ these arguments are $1 - r^2$ and r^4 . Using reflection twice gives

$$R_4 = 2R_2 - 2R_3.$$

Eliminating R_s, R_t, R_4 now yields $R_6 = 6R_2 - 2R_1 - 4R_3$. The difference between $R(r^k)$ and $\text{Li}_2(r^k)$ is $(k\lambda/2)\log(1 - r^k)$. In the indicated combination these terms cancel: by (3.33), the required check is

$$3\lambda(3\lambda + 2A) - 6\lambda(3\lambda + A) + 3\lambda^2 + 6\lambda^2 = 0.$$

This proves the claimed ordinary dilogarithm identity. $\square$

3.20.3 Two Kummer substitutions prove the cubic trilogarithm

The single-valued trilogarithm used in the manuscript is

$$P_3(z) = \text{Re Li}_3(z) - \log |z| \text{Re Li}_2(z) - \frac{1}{3} \log^2 |z| \log |1 - z|.$$

The value at $z = 1$ is defined by continuity. It obeys

$$P_3(z^{-1}) = P_3(z), \quad P_3(z) + P_3(-z) = \frac{1}{4} P_3(z^2),$$

and the single-valued Landen relation $P_3(x) + P_3(1 - x) + P_3(1 - x^{-1}) = \zeta(3)$ for real $0 < x < 1$. The latter follows from (3.28) and the two dilogarithm identities in its proof.

We use Kummer's classical equation in the form stated and justified by Zagier, *Special values and functional equations of polylogarithms*, §7, Example 3, equation (7) [58]:

$$\begin{aligned} & 2P_3(x) + 2P_3(y) + 2P_3\left(\frac{x(1-y)}{x-1}\right) + 2P_3\left(\frac{y(1-x)}{y-1}\right) \\ & + 2P_3\left(\frac{1-x}{1-y}\right) + 2P_3\left(\frac{x(1-y)}{y(1-x)}\right) - P_3(xy) - P_3(x/y) \\ & - P_3\left(\frac{x(1-y)^2}{y(1-x)^2}\right) = 2\zeta(3). \end{aligned} \tag{3.36}$$

We only use specializations with nonzero denominators and finite arguments. Since P_3 is single-valued, some real arguments exceeding 1 cause no branch correction in this equation; after inversion and duplication, all remaining arguments are $r^k \in (0, 1)$.

Theorem 3.9 (The cubic identity). *Let $r^3 + r = 1$ with $0 < r < 1$, and let $\lambda = \log r$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} & -60 \text{Li}_3(r) + 54 \text{Li}_3(r^2) - 32 \text{Li}_3(r^3) - 3 \text{Li}_3(r^6) \\ & = 24\lambda^3 - 4\pi^2\lambda - 36\zeta(3). \end{aligned} \tag{3.37}$$

Proof. Write $P_k = P_3(r^k)$. Landen at r and duplication give

$$A := P_1 - P_2 + P_3 + \frac{1}{4}P_4 = \zeta(3).$$

The nine arguments of (3.36) at $(x, y) = (r, r^3)$ and $(-r, r^2)$, in their displayed order, are

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
(r, r^3)	r	r^3	$-r^{-1}$	$-r^5$	r^2	r^{-4}	r^4	r^{-2}	r^{-6}
$(-r, r^2)$	$-r$	r^2	r^4	$-r^{-1}$	r^{-3}	$-r^2$	$-r^3$	$-r^{-1}$	$-r^5$

respectively. Using inversion and $P_3(-r^k) = \frac{1}{4}P_{2|k|} - P_{|k|}$, these two equations reduce to

$$\begin{aligned} B &:= \frac{3}{2}P_2 + 2P_3 + P_4 - 2P_5 - P_6 + \frac{1}{2}P_{10} = 2\zeta(3), \\ C &:= -3P_1 + \frac{3}{4}P_2 + 3P_3 + \frac{5}{2}P_4 + P_5 - \frac{1}{4}P_6 - \frac{1}{4}P_{10} = 2\zeta(3). \end{aligned}$$

The exact rational row operation $4C + 2B - 48A$ therefore proves

$$-60P_1 + 54P_2 - 32P_3 - 3P_6 = -36\zeta(3). \quad (3.38)$$

To recover ordinary trilogarithms, put $c_1 = -60, c_2 = 54, c_3 = -32, c_6 = -3$ and

$$D = \sum_{k \in \{1,2,3,6\}} c_k \operatorname{Li}_3(r^k), \quad S = \sum_{k \in \{1,2,3,6\}} c_k k \operatorname{Li}_2(r^k), \quad T = \sum_{k \in \{1,2,3,6\}} c_k k^2 \log(1 - r^k).$$

Expansion of the definition gives $\sum c_k P_k = D - \lambda S - \lambda^2 T/3$. Lemma 3.8, together with $\operatorname{Li}_2(r) + \operatorname{Li}_2(r^3) = \pi^2/6 - 3\lambda^2$, gives

$$S = 72\lambda^2 - 4\pi^2.$$

The factorizations (3.33) give

$$T = -60(3\lambda) + 216(3\lambda + A) - 288\lambda - 108(3\lambda + 2A) = -144\lambda.$$

Consequently (3.38) becomes $D - 24\lambda^3 + 4\pi^2\lambda = -36\zeta(3)$, which is (3.37). $\square$

3.20.4 What the certificate establishes and what remains open

The proofs settle the two displayed cubic and quartic trilogarithm identities without period-independence assumptions, numerical recognition, or unproved higher Bloch-group assertions. The universal family (3.29) also gives a principled generator of additional exact identities. It does not justify pseudointegration to weight four or above: differentiating with respect to an algebraic base does not preserve its isolated defining relation.

Natural next problems are to derive comparable local certificates for the weight-five through weight-nine golden formulas, find the smallest useful functional-equation closure for a chosen base, and extend the exact argument/substitution checker to arbitrary algebraic number fields. Any claim of minimality of the surviving period basket remains distinct from the existence of the displayed reductions.

3.21 Rigidity of complementary powers

The earlier complementary-power ladder starts from a relation $r^a + r^b = 1$, where $0 < r < 1$ and a, b are positive integers. That construction raises a concrete completeness question: can one base have many different pairs of complementary powers? We settle this question for pure powers, including arbitrary common divisors in the exponents. The decisive arithmetic input is a classical irreducibility theorem for trinomials. Our conclusions concern this precisely specified class of seeds; they do not classify general multiplicative relations among $1 - r^k$, or bound the maximum weight of polylogarithm ladders.

For $0 < r < 1$, define

$$\mathcal{C}(r) = \{(a, b) \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}^2 : a \leq b, r^a + r^b = 1\}.$$

Let ω be the unique root in $(0, 1)$ of $X^3 + X^2 - 1$. Thus ω is the reciprocal of the plastic number.

Theorem 3.10 (Complete classification of collisions). *For every real $0 < r < 1$, the set $\mathcal{C}(r)$ has at most two elements. It has two elements if and only if $r^d = \omega$ for some positive integer d , in which case*

$$\mathcal{C}(r) = \{(d, 5d), (2d, 3d)\}.$$

If $\mathcal{C}(r)$ contains (a, a) , then $\mathcal{C}(r) = \{(a, a)\}$ and $r = 2^{-1/a}$.

The theorem supplies an exact answer to the seed-classification question posed after the earlier cubic and quartic ladder certificates. It is proved below as a consequence of the Ljunggren–Tverberg theorem, with all additional arguments included. We make no claim that this consequence is globally new in the literature. The related theorem of Aarts, Fokkink, and Kruijtzter classifies the two morphic numbers, by requiring both $p+1$ and $p-1$ to be powers of p ; their proof also uses trinomial irreducibility [70]. Our formulation permits arbitrary positive exponent pairs and explicitly handles power substitutions.

3.21.1 The irreducibility input and the entire cyclotomic factor

For $1 \leq a < b$, put $d = \gcd(a, b)$, $A = a/d$, $B = b/d$, and

$$F_{a,b}(X) = X^b + X^a - 1.$$

The following precise specialization is the arithmetic input.

Theorem 3.11 (Ljunggren–Tverberg, specialized). *The polynomial $F_{a,b}$ has exactly one irreducible factor over $\mathbb{Q}$ whose roots are not roots of unity. Its other factor is*

$$C_{a,b}(X) = \begin{cases} X^{2d} - X^d + 1, & (A, B) \equiv (1, 5) \text{ or } (5, 1) \pmod{6}, \\ 1, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

In particular $H_{a,b} = F_{a,b}/C_{a,b}$ is irreducible, monic, and has constant term -1 . Moreover $H_{a,b}(X) = H_{A,B}(X^d)$.

This is the trinomial result of Ljunggren and Tverberg [71, 72]; a modern explicit formulation, including the assertion that $H_{A,B}(X^d)$ remains irreducible, is Boyd–Martin–Thom, Lemma 4.1(a),(b) [73]. Only the trinomial theorem is used. Its separate quadrinomial analogue has a more delicate history and plays no role here.

For clarity, the displayed cyclotomic factor can be obtained directly, without relying on a table of sign cases. Suppose $|z| = 1$ and $z^a + z^b = 1$. The two unit vectors must be the two numbers $e^{i\pi/3}$ and $e^{-i\pi/3}$, in either order. If $w = z^d$, then w^A and w^B are these primitive sixth roots. A Bezout identity for A, B implies $w^6 = 1$, and w^A of order six then implies that w itself has order six. Consequently A, B have opposite residues 1, 5 modulo six. Conversely those residues make every root of $X^{2d} - X^d + 1$ a root of $F_{a,b}$. These roots are simple: a common zero of $F_{a,b}$ and its derivative on the unit circle would give $a|z^a| = b|z^b|$, hence $a = b$, a contradiction. Thus the formula for $C_{a,b}$ accounts for the *entire* cyclotomic factor. The remaining assertion, irreducibility of $H_{a,b}$, is the cited theorem.

3.21.2 A conjugate-rotation invariant

Lemma 3.12 (The common divisor is intrinsic). *Suppose $r^a + r^b = r^c + r^e = 1$, where $0 < r < 1$, $1 \leq a < b$, and $1 \leq c < e$. Then*

$$\gcd(a, b) = \gcd(c, e).$$

Proof. Set $d = \gcd(a, b)$. Since $0 < r < 1$, it is not a root of unity, so its minimal polynomial is $H_{a,b}$. Theorem 3.11 shows that this polynomial is a polynomial in X^d . If ζ is a primitive d th root of unity, $r\zeta$ is therefore a conjugate of r . The second equation also holds at this conjugate:

$$r^c \zeta^c + r^e \zeta^e = 1.$$

Taking absolute values gives equality in the triangle inequality, because $r^c + r^e = 1$. Both summands must have the argument of their positive real sum. Thus $\zeta^c = \zeta^e = 1$, proving $d \mid \gcd(c, e)$. Interchanging the pairs proves the reverse divisibility. $\square$

This step prevents a gap that would arise from normalizing the two pairs independently. The cyclotomic factor can have degree $2d$, so a degree comparison before proving that the common divisors agree would not suffice.

3.21.3 The primitive coefficient comparison

Proof of Theorem 3.10. First suppose an equal pair occurs. Then $r^a = 1/2$, so r cannot be an algebraic integer: otherwise the rational number $r^a = 1/2$ would be an algebraic integer. Any unequal pair would make r a root of the monic integer polynomial $F_{c,e}$, a contradiction. There is only one equal pair because the powers of r strictly decrease.

Now suppose two distinct unequal pairs occur. By Lemma 3.12 they have a common $\gcd d$. Replace r by r^d and divide all four exponents by d . Both pairs are now primitive. Their trinomials have the same irreducible noncyclotomic factor, and their cyclotomic factors belong to $\{1, \Phi_6\}$, where $\Phi_6 = X^2 - X + 1$. If the two cyclotomic factors agree, the trinomials agree, contrary to distinctness. After interchanging them if necessary, there must therefore be a polynomial identity

$$(X^2 - X + 1)(X^n + X^m - 1) = X^{n+2} + X^k - 1, \quad 1 \leq m < n, \quad 1 \leq k < n + 2. \quad (3.39)$$

The coefficient of X^{n+1} on the left is -1 unless $m = n - 1$, in which case it is zero. The right-hand coefficient is zero or one. Hence $m = n - 1$, and the identity reduces to

$$X^{n+2} + X^{n-1} - X^2 + X - 1 = X^{n+2} + X^k - 1.$$

For $n = 2$ the remaining polynomial is $2X - X^2$, which is not a monomial. For $n > 3$ its coefficient at X^2 is -1 . Thus $n = 3$, which gives $m = 2$ and $k = 1$. The common factor is $X^3 + X^2 - 1$, and the two normalized pairs are $(1, 5)$ and $(2, 3)$. Conversely,

$$X^5 + X - 1 = (X^2 - X + 1)(X^3 + X^2 - 1)$$

shows that these two pairs do occur at ω . Finally, a third pair would have to be the same exceptional companion of either existing pair, so no third pair occurs. $\square$

3.21.4 All signed pure-power unit equations

The functional equations for polylogarithms use signs and inverses as well as positive powers. The preceding classification automatically controls all such complementary arguments.

Corollary 3.13 (Sharp signed-unit count). *Let $\Gamma_r = \{\pm r^k : k \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ and*

$$\mathcal{U}(r) = \{x \in \Gamma_r : 1 - x \in \Gamma_r\}.$$

Then $|\mathcal{U}(r)|$ is one of $0, 3, 6, 12$. For every unequal pair $(a, b) \in \mathcal{C}(r)$, its contribution is the six-element set

$$\{r^a, r^b, r^{-a}, r^{-b}, -r^{b-a}, -r^{a-b}\}. \quad (3.40)$$

These sets are disjoint for different unordered pairs. An equal pair contributes precisely $\{1/2, 2, -1\}$. The case $|\mathcal{U}(r)| = 12$ occurs exactly when $r^d = \omega$ for some positive integer d .

Proof. The transformations $x \mapsto 1 - x$ and $x \mapsto 1/x$ preserve $\mathcal{U}(r)$. For example, $1 - 1/x = -(1 - x)/x \in \Gamma_r$ whenever $x, 1 - x \in \Gamma_r$. Their orbit consists of

$$x, \quad 1 - x, \quad x^{-1}, \quad (1 - x)^{-1}, \quad x/(x - 1), \quad (x - 1)/x.$$

Every real orbit has a representative in $(0, 1)$: use $1/x$ if $x > 1$ and $1/(1 - x)$ if $x < 0$. Such a representative and its complement are r^a, r^b with $a, b > 0$. The two members of a nondegenerate real orbit that lie in $(0, 1)$ are exactly x and $1 - x$, so its unordered positive pair is unique. Substituting $x = r^a$, $1 - x = r^b$ gives (3.40). All six entries are distinct unless $a = b$, when they reduce to the stated three values. The cardinalities now follow from Theorem 3.10. $\square$

All four possibilities occur: $r = 1/3, 1/2$, the reciprocal golden ratio, and ω give respectively $0, 3, 6, 12$. The conclusion classifies *pure signed-power complements*. It does not say that there are at most twelve useful polylogarithm arguments: products of units $1 - r^k$ can introduce many more arguments.

Corollary 3.14 (Rational exponents). *The same collision classification holds for positive rational exponents, with the exceptional common scale d allowed to be a positive rational number. In particular there are at most two unordered positive rational pairs, and*

$$\#\{x \in \{\pm r^q : q \in \mathbb{Q}\} : 1 - x \in \{\pm r^q : q \in \mathbb{Q}\}\} \leq 12.$$

Proof. Given two pairs, choose a common denominator N and apply Theorem 3.10 to $r^{1/N}$. A third rational pair could be included in the same denominator and would contradict the integer theorem. The orbit proof is unchanged. $\square$

3.21.5 A provably complete bounded-degree search

Corollary 3.15 (Degree and an exhaustive exponent bound). *If $r^a + r^b = 1$ with $1 \leq a < b$, then*

$$[\mathbb{Q}(r) : \mathbb{Q}] = \begin{cases} b - 2d, & (a/d, b/d) \equiv (1, 5) \text{ or } (5, 1) \pmod{6}, \\ b, & \text{otherwise,} \end{cases} \quad d = \gcd(a, b).$$

Consequently all such bases of degree at most D are found by enumerating

$$1 \leq a < b \leq \left\lfloor \frac{5D}{3} \right\rfloor$$

and retaining those whose displayed degree is at most D . For primitive pairs it suffices to enumerate $b \leq D + 2$. The only repeated bases in either enumeration are the classified plastic pairs. Equal pairs add the separate bases $2^{-1/a}$, with $a \leq D$.

Proof. The degree formula is Theorem 3.11. In the exceptional case $b/d \geq 5$, so $b - 2d \geq 3d$. If the degree is at most D , then $d \leq D/3$ and $b = (b - 2d) + 2d \leq 5D/3$. The nonexceptional case is immediate. For primitive pairs the possible degree loss is only two. The equal-pair polynomial $2X^a - 1$ has degree a and is irreducible: its reciprocal is, up to a nonzero scalar, $X^a - 2$, which is Eisenstein at 2. $\square$

This bound is sharp for infinitely many D : the pair $(d, 5d)$ has degree $3d$ and largest exponent $5d$. Unlike a search over bounded polynomial coefficients, the algorithm has an explicit completeness theorem for its stated class. No numerical equality test is required. A base is stored by the exact irreducible polynomial $H_{a,b}$ together with its unique root in $(0, 1)$, and duplicate detection is exact polynomial comparison.

For illustration, the complete unequal-pair list through degree four is

degree	complement pair(s)	minimal polynomial
2	(1, 2)	$X^2 + X - 1$
3	(1, 3)	$X^3 + X - 1$
3	(1, 5), (2, 3)	$X^3 + X^2 - 1$
4	(1, 4)	$X^4 + X - 1$
4	(2, 4)	$X^4 + X^2 - 1$
4	(3, 4)	$X^4 + X^3 - 1$

The degree-four entry with pair (2, 4) is exactly a square root of the reciprocal golden ratio. Its presence illustrates why normalization of exponents is necessary when counting bases rather than primitive seed types.

The exact enumeration in the accompanying certificate gives:

D	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
unequal-pair bases	0	1	3	6	10	15	20	27	37	46	56	67
primitive bases	0	1	3	5	9	11	16	20	28	32	42	46
all bases	1	3	6	10	15	21	27	35	46	56	67	79

Each row counts bases of degree at most D . A primitive base has an unequal complementary pair of gcd one; the intrinsic-gcd lemma makes this definition independent of the choice of pair. The last row also includes the D equal-pair bases $2^{-1/a}$, $1 \leq a \leq D$.

3.21.6 An exact counting formula

The classification also counts bases without constructing or factoring their minimal polynomials. For $n \geq 1$ define

$$e(n) = \#\{a : 1 \leq a < n, \gcd(a, n) = 1, (a, n) \equiv (1, 5) \text{ or } (5, 1) \pmod{6}\}.$$

In particular $e(n) = 0$ unless $n \equiv 1$ or $5 \pmod{6}$, and $e(1) = 0$.

Corollary 3.16 (Counting all bases by algebraic degree). *Let $N(D)$ be the number of real $0 < r < 1$ with $[\mathbb{Q}(r) : \mathbb{Q}] \leq D$ and $\mathcal{C}(r) \neq \emptyset$. For every positive integer D ,*

$$\begin{aligned} N(D) &= \frac{D(D+1)}{2} - \left\lfloor \frac{D}{3} \right\rfloor \\ &\quad + \sum_{d=1}^{\lfloor D/3 \rfloor} \left\{ e\left(\left\lfloor \frac{D}{d} \right\rfloor + 1\right) + e\left(\left\lfloor \frac{D}{d} \right\rfloor + 2\right) \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (3.41)$$

In particular,

$$N(D) = \frac{1}{2}D^2 + O(D \log D), \quad D \rightarrow \infty.$$

Proof. There are $D(D-1)/2$ unequal pairs with largest exponent at most D , and their associated bases all have degree at most D . A pair with largest exponent greater than D can still have degree at most D only in the exceptional cyclotomic case. Write that pair (dA, dB) , where $\gcd(A, B) = 1$ and the residues are opposite 1, 5 modulo six. The two inequalities are

$$dB > D, \quad d(B-2) \leq D.$$

Equivalently, $B \in \{\lfloor D/d \rfloor + 1, \lfloor D/d \rfloor + 2\}$. Since the exceptional normalized degree $B-2$ is at least three, only $d \leq D/3$ can occur. This gives the sum in (3.41). Every base counted twice is $\omega^{1/d}$, of degree $3d$; there are exactly $\lfloor D/3 \rfloor$ such duplicates. Finally the D equal-pair bases are distinct from all unequal-pair bases and from each other. This proves the exact formula.

For the asymptotic statement, use $0 \leq e(n) \leq n$ to bound the sum by

$$\sum_{d \leq D/3} \left(2 \left\lfloor \frac{D}{d} \right\rfloor + 3 \right) \leq 2D \sum_{d \leq D/3} \frac{1}{d} + D.$$

The harmonic sum is $O(\log D)$, proving the claim. $\square$

For an alternative exact implementation, when $n > 1$ is coprime to six, Mobius inversion gives

$$e(n) = \sum_{d|n} \mu(d) \left\lfloor \frac{n/d+1}{6} \right\rfloor. \quad (3.42)$$

Indeed, after writing $a = dj$, the condition $a \equiv -n \pmod{6}$ becomes $j \equiv -(n/d) \pmod{6}$ because every unit modulo six is its own inverse. For t coprime to six, the number of integers $1 \leq j < t$ in the residue class $-t$ is $\lfloor (t+1)/6 \rfloor$. Summing with $\mu(d)$ imposes $\gcd(a, n) = 1$.

3.22 Exact proofs and log-free ladders at the plastic base

The exceptional base in Theorem 3.10 has two complementary pairs. This additional structure produces short proofs of two previously numerically supported formulas in the manuscript, as well as log-free identities for $\zeta(2)$ and $\zeta(3)$.

Throughout this section, $0 < q < 1$, $q^2 + q^3 = 1$, and $\lambda = \log q$. The factorization in the preceding proof gives

$$1 - q = q^5, \quad 1 - q^2 = q^3, \quad 1 - q^3 = q^2, \quad 1 - q^5 = q. \quad (3.43)$$

All logarithms used in the final identities are real.

3.22.1 The dilogarithm formula: one Rogers pentagon

Write

$$R(x) = \text{Li}_2(x) + \frac{1}{2} \log x \log(1 - x), \quad 0 < x < 1.$$

The Rogers reflection and pentagon equations are

$$R(x) + R(1 - x) = \zeta(2), \quad (3.44)$$

$$R(x) + R(y) = R(xy) + R\left(\frac{x(1 - y)}{1 - xy}\right) + R\left(\frac{y(1 - x)}{1 - xy}\right). \quad (3.45)$$

They hold for $0 < x, y < 1$ and follow from the classical dilogarithm functional equations; alternatively one can differentiate in x and evaluate at $x = 0$. This real-domain formulation avoids branch choices [58].

Theorem 3.17 (The manuscript's plastic dilogarithm formula).

$$\frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(q^2) - \text{Li}_2(q^5) = \lambda^2. \quad (3.46)$$

Proof. Set $R_k = R(q^k)$. At $(x, y) = (q, q^2)$ the three pentagon arguments are

$$xy = q^3, \quad \frac{x(1 - y)}{1 - xy} = q^2, \quad \frac{y(1 - x)}{1 - xy} = q^5.$$

Hence $R_1 + R_2 = R_3 + R_2 + R_5$, or $R_1 = R_3 + R_5$. Reflection gives $R_1 + R_5 = R_2 + R_3 = \zeta(2)$, so $R_2 = 2R_5$. Expanding the logarithmic corrections by (3.43) gives

$$\text{Li}_2(q^2) + 3\lambda^2 = 2 \text{Li}_2(q^5) + 5\lambda^2,$$

as required. □

3.22.2 The trilogarithm formula: one Kummer specialization

For real nonzero $z \neq 1$, define the single-valued trilogarithm

$$P(z) = \text{Re Li}_3(z) - \log |z| \text{Re Li}_2(z) - \frac{1}{3} \log^2 |z| \log |1 - z|,$$

with the continuous value $P(1) = \zeta(3)$. The inversion and duplication equations are

$$P(z^{-1}) = P(z), \quad P(z) + P(-z) = \frac{1}{4} P(z^2).$$

Kummer's equation is (3.36), with $P = P_3$. We use the form recorded by Zagier, Section 7, Example 3, equation (7) [58].

The single-valued Landen equation is

$$P(x) + P(1-x) + P(1-x^{-1}) = \zeta(3), \quad 0 < x < 1.$$

Its ordinary real counterpart is

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Li}_3(x) + \text{Li}_3(1-x) + \text{Li}_3(1-x^{-1}) &= \zeta(3) + \zeta(2) \log x \\ &\quad - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 x \log(1-x) + \frac{1}{6} \log^3 x. \end{aligned} \quad (3.47)$$

One obtains it by differentiation using dilogarithm reflection and Landen, with the integration constant determined at $x = 1$. See also Nakamura–Shiraishi [59].

Theorem 3.18 (The manuscript's plastic trilogarithm formula).

$$-\text{Li}_3(q) + \frac{3}{2} \text{Li}_3(q^2) + \frac{1}{3} \text{Li}_3(q^3) - \text{Li}_3(q^5) = \lambda^3. \quad (3.48)$$

Proof. Put $P_k = P(q^k)$. At $(x, y) = (q, q^2)$, the nine arguments in (3.36), in displayed order, are

$$q, \quad q^2, \quad -q^{-1}, \quad -q^4, \quad q^2, \quad q^{-3}, \quad q^3, \quad q^{-1}, \quad q^{-5}.$$

Using inversion and duplication, the equation becomes

$$\mathbf{K} = -P_1 + \frac{9}{2}P_2 + P_3 - 2P_4 - P_5 + \frac{1}{2}P_8 = 2\zeta(3).$$

Landen at $x = q$, with $1 - q = q^5$, similarly gives

$$\mathbf{A} = P_1 + P_5 - P_4 + \frac{1}{4}P_8 = \zeta(3).$$

Consequently the exact row operation $(\mathbf{K} - 2\mathbf{A})/3$ proves

$$-P_1 + \frac{3}{2}P_2 + \frac{1}{3}P_3 - P_5 = 0. \quad (3.49)$$

It remains to convert this to ordinary trilogarithms. Denote the left side of (3.48) by D , and put

$$S = -\text{Li}_2(q) + 3\text{Li}_2(q^2) + \text{Li}_2(q^3) - 5\text{Li}_2(q^5).$$

The two ordinary reflection equations and Theorem 3.17 give

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Li}_2(q) + \text{Li}_2(q^5) &= \zeta(2) - 5\lambda^2, \\ \text{Li}_2(q^2) + \text{Li}_2(q^3) &= \zeta(2) - 6\lambda^2, \\ \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(q^2) - \text{Li}_2(q^5) &= \lambda^2. \end{aligned}$$

Taking minus the first row, plus the second, plus four times the third yields $S = 3\lambda^2$. The remaining logarithmic coefficient in the definition of P is

$$T = \{-1 \cdot 1^2 \cdot 5 + (3/2) \cdot 2^2 \cdot 3 + (1/3) \cdot 3^2 \cdot 2 - 1 \cdot 5^2 \cdot 1\} \lambda = -6\lambda.$$

Thus the left side of (3.49) is

$$D - \lambda S - \frac{\lambda^2}{3} T = D - 3\lambda^3 + 2\lambda^3 = D - \lambda^3.$$

This proves (3.48). □

The proof promotes the two displayed manuscript formulas from numerical support to exact consequences of classical functional equations. It does not rely on pseudointegration at an isolated algebraic base.

3.22.3 Two log-free identities

Theorem 3.19 (Log-free plastic ladders). *At the same base q , the following identities hold:*

$$6 \operatorname{Li}_2(q) - 5 \operatorname{Li}_2(q^2) - 5 \operatorname{Li}_2(q^3) + 6 \operatorname{Li}_2(q^5) = \zeta(2), \quad (3.50)$$

$$12 \operatorname{Li}_3(q) - 5 \operatorname{Li}_3(q^2) - 4 \operatorname{Li}_3(q^3) - 8 \operatorname{Li}_3(q^4) + 8 \operatorname{Li}_3(q^5) + 2 \operatorname{Li}_3(q^8) = 4\zeta(3). \quad (3.51)$$

Proof. Six times the first ordinary reflection equation minus five times the second proves (3.50). For the trilogarithm, write $L_k = \operatorname{Li}_3(q^k)$. Equation (3.47) at $x = q$ and $x = q^2$, with duplication to eliminate negative arguments, gives

$$\begin{aligned} A &= L_1 + L_5 - L_4 + \frac{1}{4}L_8 = \zeta(3) + \zeta(2)\lambda - \frac{7}{3}\lambda^3, \\ B &= \frac{5}{4}L_2 + L_3 - L_1 = \zeta(3) + 2\zeta(2)\lambda - \frac{14}{3}\lambda^3. \end{aligned}$$

The logarithmic tails are proportional. Therefore $4(2A - B) = 4\zeta(3)$, exactly the claimed six-argument identity. $\square$

These formulas are explicit additional identities for the package. Their derivations and the classical origins of the functional equations are given in full; no global priority claim is made. They also give exponentially convergent algebraic series, for example

$$\zeta(3) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{3q^n - \frac{5}{4}q^{2n} - q^{3n} - 2q^{4n} + 2q^{5n} + \frac{1}{2}q^{8n}}{n^3}. \quad (3.52)$$

Absolute convergence justifies expansion of the polylogarithms. If this series is truncated after N terms, its absolute tail is at most

$$\frac{39}{4} \frac{q^{N+1}}{(N+1)^3(1-q)},$$

obtained by summing the absolute coefficients and using $q^{kn} \leq q^n$ for $k \geq 1$. The constant $39/4$ is deliberately simple; the sharper sum of the six individual geometric tails can also be used.

3.23 The modified polylogarithm

Zagier's one-valued modified polylogarithm (his eq. (33)) is

$$P_m(x) = \operatorname{Re}_m \left(\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} \frac{2^j B_j}{j!} (\log |x|)^j \operatorname{Li}_{m-j}(x) \right), \quad \operatorname{Re}_m = \begin{cases} \operatorname{Re}, & m \text{ odd}, \\ \operatorname{Im}, & m \text{ even}, \end{cases} \quad (3.53)$$

with B_j the Bernoulli numbers and $\operatorname{Li}_1(x) = -\log(1-x)$. It is continuous on the Riemann sphere away from $\{0, 1, \infty\}$, satisfies $P_m(\bar{x}) = (-1)^{m-1} P_m(x)$, and $P_m(1) = \zeta(m)$ for odd m , 0 for even m ; $P_2(i)$ is Catalan's constant. We verified our implementation against Zagier's worked examples $P_5(-\frac{1}{8}) - 126P_5(\frac{1}{2}) - 162P_5(-\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{403}{16}\zeta(5)$ (his eq. (825)) and the long thirteen-term relation (825)/(833), to 60 digits.

3.24 Ladders are Bloch-group elements

The Bloch-group viewpoint records the obstruction to simplifying a dilogarithm combination. At weight two the boundary sends $[x] \mapsto x \wedge (1 - x)$; a vanishing boundary makes a combination a candidate for the Bloch group, modulo the five-term relation. Higher weights require further relations and compatibility conditions: a weight-one unit relation alone does not prove that its pseudointegrations are higher Bloch-group elements. Modified polylogarithms remove explicit logarithmic tails and make the following ladder combinations transparent:

$$\text{golden : } 15 P_3(\phi^{-2}) = 12 \zeta(3), \quad (3.54)$$

$$\text{supergolden : } -60 P_3(\rho) + 54 P_3(\rho^2) - 32 P_3(\rho^3) - 3 P_3(\rho^6) = -36 \zeta(3), \quad (3.55)$$

both exact. Compare (3.54) with the “raw” form $15 \text{Li}_3(\phi^{-2}) = 10 \ln^3 \phi - 2\pi^2 \ln \phi + 12\zeta(3)$: the modified trilogarithm removes the explicit logarithmic tail. At odd weight, comparable modified combinations require the appropriate lower-weight identities. At even weight the definition takes an imaginary part, and every term is real on $0 < x < 1$, so $P_{2j}(x) = 0$. The ordinary even-weight golden formulas retain their content; under this definition they cannot become nonzero even-zeta multiples. This distinction concerns the chosen modification, not a universal bound on regulator directions.

3.25 The bases as number fields

base ρ	minimal polynomial of $1/\rho$	field F	signature	disc
golden ϕ^{-1}	$x^2 - x - 1$	$\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$	(2, 0) totally real	5
minimal Pisot ω	$x^3 - x - 1$	$\mathbb{Q}(\theta)$	(1, 1)	-23
supergolden recip.	$x^3 - x^2 - 1$	$\mathbb{Q}(\sigma)$	(1, 1)	-31

The middle row is Zagier’s own running example (§4–5, §9C): the field $\mathbb{Q}(\theta)$, $\theta^3 - \theta - 1 = 0$, whose ladder he calls “particularly spectacular,” and whose defining unit relations $1 - \theta = -\theta^{-4}$, $1 + \theta = \theta^3$, $\dots$ are precisely the seeds we rediscovered. Our supergolden base gives a *different* complex cubic field, discriminant -31.

3.26 Regulator parity and the limits of ladder counting

For $m \geq 2$, Borel’s rank theorem gives rank $r_1 + r_2$ for $K_{2m-1}(F)$ when m is odd, and r_2 when m is even. The modified polylogarithm uses its real part at odd weight and imaginary part at even weight. In particular P_{2m} vanishes on real arguments, even when the number field has nonzero regulator directions at its complex embeddings. This explains why a real-argument search can miss arithmetic content visible at a complex embedding.

Cyclotomic unit searches compute $\text{Norm } \Phi_k(\rho) = \text{Res}(p, \Phi_k)$ and select the unit cases. For a fixed finite seed set, imposing successive regulator constraints is a finite linear-algebra problem. A dimension count can give a lower bound for a kernel or exhaust that chosen construction. It does not prove there are no additional seeds, no dependencies among constraints, and no other functional identities at higher weight.

The later source identifies the minimal-Pisot ladders through weight six and points to Cohen–Lewin–Zagier’s published numerical sixteenth-order Lehmer ladder [36]. These supersede earlier

negative searches. Its stronger assertion that the supergolden field has no weight-five real ladder is not justified by exhausting its selected seed set, and is omitted. Determining a maximal ladder weight requires a completeness theorem for the chosen class of relations.

3.27 Attributed dilogarithm and inverse-binomial examples

The following examples are attributed to Hakimoglu-Brown [37]. Their displayed numerical checks in the source are historical.

All to ≥ 38 digits (`tools/scratch/dilog-inverse-binomial/`); a representative selection:

- **Sun’s open conjecture** (eq. (24)), proved in the paper via the $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$ evaluation (25):

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{\binom{2n}{n}}{(2n+1)8^n} \left(\sum_{0 \leq k < n} \frac{(-1)^k}{2k+1} - \frac{(-1)^n}{2n+1} \right) = -\frac{\sqrt{2}}{16} \pi^2.$$

- **Theorem 2** ($\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$): $8 \operatorname{Li}_2(2 - \sqrt{3}) - \operatorname{Li}_2(4\sqrt{3} - 7) = \frac{5\pi^2}{12} + \ln(2 - \sqrt{3}) \ln(2 + \sqrt{3})$, and $3 \operatorname{Li}_2(7 - 4\sqrt{3}) = 6 \operatorname{Li}_2(2 - \sqrt{3}) + 6 \operatorname{Li}_2(\sqrt{3} - 2)$.
- **Lima’s identity** ($\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$, eq. (26)): $\operatorname{Li}_2(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}) - \operatorname{Li}_2(1 - \sqrt{2}) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{\ln^2 2}{8} + \frac{1}{2} \ln 2 \ln(\sqrt{2} - 1)$.
- **Zagier’s four-term** (eq. (27)): $3L(-\frac{1}{6}) - L(\frac{1}{8}) + L(\frac{1}{9}) + L(\frac{1}{28}) = -\frac{\pi^2}{12}$, with the (unnormalized) Rogers $L(x) = \operatorname{Li}_2(x) + \frac{1}{2} \ln |x| \ln |1 - x|$; and its compressed three-term form.
- the rational-argument $\frac{\pi^2}{18} + 2 \ln 2 \ln 3 - 2 \ln^2 2 - \frac{2}{3} \ln^2 3 = \operatorname{Li}_2(\frac{1}{4}) + \frac{1}{3} \operatorname{Li}_2(\frac{1}{9})$, the inverse-tangent/ $\operatorname{Cl}_2(\frac{\pi}{3})$ relation (30), and $\operatorname{Li}_2(\frac{4}{3}) + \operatorname{Li}_2(4) = \frac{1}{2}(\pi^2 - \ln^2 3)$ (real parts).
- the **engine**: ${}_4F_3(\{1, 1, 1, \frac{3}{2}\}; \{\frac{5}{2}, \frac{5}{2}, \frac{5}{2}\}; 1) = \frac{27}{2}(7\zeta(3) + (3 - 2G)\pi - 12)$ (D’Aurizio) and the cube-binomial ${}_4F_3$ of eq. (1).
- the paper’s **claimed-original elliptic** ${}_4F_3(1)$ **evaluations** (eqs. 32, 33, 35):

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Cl}_2\left(\frac{\pi}{3}\right) &= \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} {}_4F_3\left(\left\{1, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2}\right\}; \left\{\frac{3}{2}, \frac{5}{6}, \frac{7}{6}\right\}; 1\right), \\ {}_4F_3\left(\left\{1, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{2}{3}, \frac{1}{3}\right\}; \left\{\frac{3}{2}, \frac{5}{4}, \frac{3}{4}\right\}; 1\right) &= \frac{3\sqrt{3}}{4} (2 \ln(4 + 3\sqrt{2}) + \ln(\frac{7}{2} - 2\sqrt{3})), \\ \ln^2\left(\frac{5+\sqrt{13}}{2\sqrt{3}}\right) - \frac{\pi^2}{12} &= \frac{1}{180} {}_4F_3\left(\left\{1, 1, 1, \frac{3}{2}\right\}; \left\{\frac{7}{6}, \frac{11}{6}, 2\right\}; -\frac{1}{324}\right). \end{aligned}$$

All check out. One caution worth recording: equation (27) uses the *unnormalized* Rogers L (so the right side is $-\frac{\pi^2}{12}$, not a pure rational); with the $\frac{6}{\pi^2}$ -normalized L the identity reads $3L(-\frac{1}{6}) - L(\frac{1}{8}) + L(\frac{1}{9}) + L(\frac{1}{28}) = -\frac{1}{2}$.

Connection. The paper evaluates inverse-binomial series with $\binom{2n}{n}^2$ and $\binom{3n}{n}$ via beta integrals; this is the reciprocal-binomial sibling of the central-binomial ladder $\sum \binom{2n}{n} 4^{-n} (2n+1)^{-p}$ studied in `harvested-central-binomial-arcsin.wl`. The verified identities are stored (with attribution) in `src/PolyLog/identities/harvested-dilogarithm-ladders-2506.10206.wl`.

Chapter 4

Gaussian and Eisenstein depth

The classical transformations suggest a sharper question: how much nesting is necessary after known identities have been used? We first prove an infinite family of reductions. The shuffle and parity proofs below settle several of the source’s numerical relations. The other families illustrate how a successful experimental identity gives an upper bound on depth, while a failed search leaves open both a large-coefficient reduction and a missing argument family.

4.1 Depth conventions and Gaussian generators

Write $G = \beta(2)$, $\beta(s) = \sum_{n \geq 0} (-1)^n / (2n+1)^s$, and

$$g_{a,b} = \Im \operatorname{Li}_{a,b}(i, 1), \quad h_{a,b} = \Re \operatorname{Li}_{a,b}(i, 1), \quad \lambda_n = \Im \operatorname{Li}_n((1+i)/2).$$

Subscripts such as g_{41} mean $g_{4,1}$. Series depth counts nested indices. In the experimental tables, a “depth-one reduction” means a polynomial in the stated single-value basket, which is a different convention from the additive depth filtration on a motivic algebra. Products of two depth-two factors have additive depth at most four; their membership in an algebra generated by doubles does not make them depth at most two in that additive filtration.

4.2 An infinite even-weight reduction

Define

$$S_p = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n H_n}{(2n+1)^p}, \quad p \geq 1.$$

For $p = 1$ the sum is conditionally convergent; for $p > 1$ it is absolute.

Theorem 4.1 (Odd-denominator harmonic sums at even weight). *For every integer $m \geq 0$,*

$$S_{2m+1} = (2m+1)\beta(2m+2) - [t^{2m}] \frac{\pi}{4 \cos(\pi t/2)} \left(2 \log 2 + \sum_{j \geq 1} (2 - 2^{-2j}) \zeta(2j+1) t^{2j} \right). \quad (4.1)$$

In particular, each sum of even weight $2m+2$ belongs to the algebra generated by $\pi, \log 2$, odd zeta values and even beta values.

Proof. Put

$$I(t) = \int_0^1 \frac{x^t \log(1+x^2)}{1+x^2} dx, \quad J(t) = \int_0^1 \frac{x^t}{1+x^2} dx, \quad A(t) = \int_0^\infty \frac{x^t \log(1+x^2)}{1+x^2} dx.$$

These are analytic near $t = 0$. Splitting A at one and substituting $x = 1/u$ in the second part gives $A(t) = I(t) + I(-t) - 2J'(-t)$. The generating function $\sum H_n z^n = -\log(1-z)/(1-z)$, used first with an Abel factor and then by dominated convergence, gives $I^{(2m)}(0) = -(2m)!S_{2m+1}$. Also $J^{(2m+1)}(0) = -(2m+1)!\beta(2m+2)$, by the geometric series for $1/(1+x^2)$; its integrated absolute majorant is summable. Consequently

$$S_{2m+1} = (2m+1)\beta(2m+2) - \frac{[t^{2m}]A(t)}{2}.$$

Differentiating the beta integral in its second parameter yields

$$A(t) = \frac{\pi}{2 \cos(\pi t/2)} \left[\psi(1) - \psi\left(\frac{1-t}{2}\right) \right], \quad |\Re t| < 1.$$

Its even part follows from $\psi(1) - \psi(1/2) = 2 \log 2$ and $\psi^{(2j)}(1/2) = -(2j)!(2^{2j+1} - 1)\zeta(2j+1)$. Extracting the coefficient proves the formula. $\square$

The first cases are

$$S_1 = G - \frac{\pi}{2} \log 2, \tag{4.2}$$

$$S_3 = 3\beta(4) - \frac{\pi^3}{16} \log 2 - \frac{7\pi}{16} \zeta(3), \tag{4.3}$$

$$768S_5 = 3840\beta(6) - 5\pi^5 \log 2 - 42\pi^3 \zeta(3) - 372\pi \zeta(5), \tag{4.4}$$

$$92160S_7 = 645120\beta(8) - 61\pi^7 \log 2 - 525\pi^5 \zeta(3) - 5580\pi^3 \zeta(5) - 45720\pi \zeta(7). \tag{4.5}$$

The source's high-precision experiments suggested the last two identities; the generating integral proves them and every higher odd-index case at once. The proof gives a sufficient reduction. It does not prove that the even beta values are independent, nor that the odd-weight sums have minimal depth two. No such conclusion follows merely from the absence of a new odd beta value.

Literature and normalization. The odd-index formulas specialize the established Euler-sum theory of Xu and Wang [55]. In their notation

$$R_{1,q}^{1,-1} = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^{n-1} H_{n-1}}{(n-1/2)^q} = 2^q S_q.$$

The independent beta-integral and reflection proofs are retained because they make the normalization and the later certified generalizations transparent. No claim of worldwide priority is made for this evaluation.

4.3 Generators and their exact singularities

For this section, put $\mathbf{q}(x) = \log(1+x^2)/(1+x^2)$. The beta-integral calculation above gives

$$\mathcal{M}(s) := \int_0^\infty x^{s-1} \mathbf{q}(x) dx = \frac{\pi}{2 \sin(\pi s/2)} [\psi(1) - \psi(1-s/2)], \quad 0 < \Re s < 2. \tag{4.6}$$

The harmonic generating function also gives, for integer $p \geq 1$,

$$S_p = -\frac{1}{(p-1)!} \int_0^1 (-\log x)^{p-1} \mathfrak{q}(x) dx. \quad (4.7)$$

The first-omitted-term theorem below gives $|S_p| \leq 3^{-p}$. These facts make the actual poles visible even when a special-function expression contains removable singularities.

Theorem 4.2 (Even generator). *The power series*

$$\mathcal{S}_e(t) = \sum_{m \geq 0} S_{2m+1} t^{2m}$$

has radius of convergence exactly 3. It extends to an even meromorphic function on $\mathbb{C}$, with the closed form

$$\mathcal{S}_e(t) = \frac{\psi_1((1+t)/4) - \psi_1((3+t)/4)}{16} + \frac{\pi [\psi((1+t)/2) - \psi(1)]}{4 \cos(\pi t/2)}, \quad (4.8)$$

where $\psi_1 = \psi'$, and apparent singularities are interpreted by meromorphic continuation. Its only poles are simple and occur at $t = \pm(2n+1)$, $n \geq 1$, with

$$\text{Res}_{t=2n+1} \mathcal{S}_e(t) = \frac{(-1)^{n+1} H_n}{2}, \quad \text{Res}_{t=-(2n+1)} \mathcal{S}_e(t) = \frac{(-1)^n H_n}{2}. \quad (4.9)$$

In particular, the apparent singularities at $t = \pm 1$ are removable, and

$$\mathcal{S}_e(1) = \mathcal{S}_e(-1) = -\frac{\pi^2}{48}. \quad (4.10)$$

Proof. The Mellin representation (4.7) and the bound $|S_p| \leq 3^{-p}$ first define E on $|t| < 3$. Summing the even exponential series under the Mellin integral gives

$$\mathcal{S}_e(t) = -\frac{1}{2} \int_0^1 (x^t + x^{-t}) \mathfrak{q}(x) dx. \quad (4.11)$$

For $|t| < 3$, absolute values of the summed integrand are bounded by $\mathfrak{q}(x) \cosh(|t| \log x)$, which is integrable at zero since $\mathfrak{q}(x) = O(x^2)$. The right-hand side of (4.11) is holomorphic on the larger vertical strip $|\text{Re } t| < 3$: on each compact subset, the same argument applies with a fixed exponent strictly smaller than 3, and all parameter derivatives add only powers of $|\log x|$. It also proves evenness there.

To evaluate the integral, let

$$J(t) = \int_0^1 x^t \mathfrak{q}(x) dx, \quad K(t) = \int_0^1 \frac{x^t \log x}{1+x^2} dx.$$

For $|\text{Re } t| < 1$, splitting the full Mellin integral at one and inverting the second part gives

$$\mathcal{M}(1-t) = J(-t) + J(t) - 2K(t).$$

In this strip, expansion of $(1+x^2)^{-1}$ and absolute summability after integration give

$$\begin{aligned} K(t) &= -\sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{(2n+1+t)^2} \\ &= -\frac{1}{16} [\psi_1((1+t)/4) - \psi_1((3+t)/4)]. \end{aligned}$$

Since $\mathcal{S}_e(t) = -\mathcal{M}(1-t)/2 - K(t)$, substitution of (4.6) proves (4.8) in $|\operatorname{Re} t| < 1$.

The exact global singularity statement should not be inferred merely from the individual terms of that formula, because they have cancelling poles. Instead, retain the conditionally convergent coefficient S_1 separately and sum all the absolutely convergent higher coefficients. For $|t| < 3$, this gives

$$\mathcal{S}_e(t) = S_1 + \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^n H_n t^2}{(2n+1)((2n+1)^2 - t^2)}. \quad (4.12)$$

The interchange is valid because

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{H_n}{2n+1} \sum_{m \geq 1} \left(\frac{|t|}{2n+1} \right)^{2m} = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{H_n |t|^2}{(2n+1)((2n+1)^2 - |t|^2)} < \infty.$$

For any compact set avoiding the displayed poles in (4.12), the summands for sufficiently large n are uniformly $O((1 + \log n)/n^3)$. Thus the series converges normally there and defines a meromorphic function on $\mathbb{C}$. At a point $2n+1$ or $-(2n+1)$, precisely one summand is singular; its elementary residue is (4.9). These residues are nonzero, and there are no further poles. The right-hand side of (4.8) is also meromorphic on $\mathbb{C}$ and agrees on an open strip, so the meromorphic identity theorem proves that the two representations agree everywhere. In particular, all additional apparent poles in the polygamma expression cancel. The nearest actual poles to zero are 3 and -3 , proving that the Taylor radius is exactly 3.

Finally, (4.11) can be evaluated directly at $t = 1$, inside its holomorphy strip:

$$\mathcal{S}_e(1) = -\frac{1}{2} \int_0^1 \frac{\log(1+x^2)}{x} dx = \frac{1}{4} \operatorname{Li}_2(-1) = -\frac{\pi^2}{48}.$$

Evenness gives the same value at -1 , proving (4.10) without a delicate cancellation of separate Laurent expansions. $\square$

4.3.1 The full generator and the unresolved parity direction

The symmetry can be stated more precisely by keeping all indices.

Proposition 4.3. *The full generating function*

$$\mathcal{S}(t) = \sum_{p \geq 1} S_p t^{p-1}$$

has Taylor radius 3, integral representation

$$\mathcal{S}(t) = - \int_0^1 x^{-t} \mathbf{q}(x) dx, \quad \operatorname{Re} t < 3, \quad (4.13)$$

and global meromorphic representation

$$\mathcal{S}(t) = S_1 + \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{(-1)^n H_n t}{(2n+1)(2n+1-t)}. \quad (4.14)$$

Its only poles are simple, at $t = 2n+1$, $n \geq 1$, with residue $(-1)^{n+1} H_n$. Moreover,

$$\frac{\mathcal{S}(t) + \mathcal{S}(-t)}{2} = \mathcal{S}_e(t), \quad \frac{\mathcal{S}(t) - \mathcal{S}(-t)}{2} = \sum_{m \geq 1} S_{2m} t^{2m-1} \quad (|t| < 3). \quad (4.15)$$

Proof. For $|t| < 3$, insert (4.7) and sum the exponential series $\sum_{p \geq 1} t^{p-1} (-\log x)^{p-1} / (p-1)! = x^{-t}$. The absolute sum is bounded by $x^{-|t|} \mathbf{q}(x)$, which is integrable. The resulting integral is holomorphic for $\operatorname{Re} t < 3$, by the same compact-set bounds as above. Separating $p = 1$ and summing the geometric series for $p \geq 2$ gives (4.14); the needed absolute bound is

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{H_n |t|}{(2n+1)(2n+1-|t|)} < \infty, \quad |t| < 3.$$

On a compact set avoiding positive odd integers at least three, the resulting rational summands are uniformly $O((1 + \log n)/n^2)$. Normal convergence gives the stated global continuation. The single summand singular at $t = 2n + 1$ has residue $(-1)^{n+1} H_n$, and that residue is nonzero. This proves both the complete pole list and the exact radius. Taking even and odd parts of the Taylor series proves (4.15). $\square$

The inversion $x \mapsto 1/x$ determines the even part of A through the full Mellin transform. It leaves the odd part as a different analytic quantity. The absence of the same reduction for that part is not a proof that its coefficients lie outside the algebra generated by single polylogarithmic values. In particular, no result here proves nonmembership for S_{2m} , which have odd total weight. Such a claim requires an additional arithmetic or motivic argument for the specified constants and specified algebra. The presence of an even beta value likewise supplies no independence certificate: even the irrationality of $G = \beta(2)$ is not known. The correction to the draft is therefore precise: replace the proposed two-sided alternation theorem by (4.1) and its proved even-weight membership statement, and retain the opposite direction as a research question.

4.4 Exact shuffle quotients and a two-product proof at weight five

4.4.1 The quotient being computed

Let $\mathcal{H}^1$ be the rational vector space on the empty word and all binary words ending in 1, with shuffle multiplication. It is bigraded by word length w and number of ones d . Let $\mathcal{J}$ be its augmentation ideal, spanned by nonempty words. The indecomposable quotient

$$Q_{w,d} = (\mathcal{J}/\mathcal{J}^2)_{w,d}$$

sets products of two positive-weight elements equal to zero. This is a formal combinatorial construction. Shuffle equalities evaluate to analytic identities at z ; the corresponding map on indecomposable quotients requires also quotienting the evaluated algebra by products. Evaluation can introduce further relations. In particular, the formal dimension is not the dimension of a space of numerical periods.

Theorem 4.4 (The exact formal shuffle count). *For $w \geq 1$ and $1 \leq d \leq w$,*

$$\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} Q_{w,d} = \ell_{w,d} := \frac{1}{w} \sum_{k \mid \gcd(w,d)} \mu(k) \binom{w/k}{d/k}.$$

A basis is represented by the binary Lyndon words of length w with d ones. Every such word belongs to $\mathcal{H}^1$. Every other word has a finite, exact polynomial expression in the full family of Lyndon generators, each monomial having the original total bidegree. The number of independent product relations in this component is

$$\binom{w-1}{d-1} - \ell_{w,d}.$$

Proof. Order the alphabet by $0 < 1$ and words lexicographically. A Lyndon word is strictly smaller than every nontrivial rotation. Every word has a unique Chen–Fox–Lyndon factorization into a nonincreasing concatenation of Lyndon words. In characteristic zero, shuffle monomials in Lyndon words form a polynomial basis [56]. One can see the constructive point directly: if the factorization is $u_1^{m_1} \cdots u_r^{m_r}$ with distinct $u_1 > \cdots > u_r$, then the shuffle product $u_1^{\Pi m_1} \Pi \cdots \Pi u_r^{\Pi m_r}$ has this concatenation as its lexicographically largest word, with coefficient $m_1! \cdots m_r!$. All other words are smaller. Induction therefore gives a triangular polynomial expression, and the same triangularity proves linear independence of the monomials.

Every Lyndon word of length greater than one that contains both letters starts with 0 and ends with 1. The single-letter words are 0 and 1. The factorization of a word ending in 1 cannot contain the factor 0, because that smallest factor would be last, forcing the concatenation to end in 0. Thus $\mathcal{H}^1$ is exactly the polynomial algebra on all Lyndon words other than 0. Passing to its augmentation quotient leaves one class for each generator.

It remains to count. A primitive binary word of length w with d ones has w distinct rotations and exactly one Lyndon rotation. Every binary word is a power of a unique primitive word. Möbius inversion on this power decomposition gives $\sum_{k|\gcd(w,d)} \mu(k) \binom{w/k}{d/k}$ primitive words, proving the formula. Finally, there are $\binom{w-1}{d-1}$ words ending in 1 in the component, which gives the claimed product rank. $\square$

Weight w	$d = 1$	$d = 2$	$d = 3$	$d = 4$	$d = 5$
3	1	1	0	–	–
4	1	1	1	0	–
5	1	2	2	1	0
6	1	2	3	2	1
7	1	3	5	5	3
8	1	3	7	8	7
9	1	4	9	14	14

Table 4.1: The exact formal indecomposable counts $\ell_{w,d}$. They count Lyndon generators, not independent numerical constants.

For $w = 6, d = 3$, the ten words reduce modulo products to three Lyndon words:

$$000111, \quad 001011, \quad 001101,$$

corresponding respectively to $F_{4,1,1}$, $F_{3,2,1}$, and $F_{3,1,2}$. This explains the manuscript’s finite rank-seven observation and gives its uniform extension. The companion code records the full polynomial normal forms of all ten triples. For a compact view of the quotient, put $X = [F_{4,1,1}]$, $Y = [F_{3,2,1}]$, $Z = [F_{3,1,2}]$, where brackets mean classes modulo products. Exact triangular elimination gives

	X	Y	Z		X	Y	Z
$[F_{4,1,1}]$	1	0	0	$[F_{1,4,1}]$	6	3	1
$[F_{3,2,1}]$	0	1	0	$[F_{1,3,2}]$	–12	–6	–2
$[F_{3,1,2}]$	0	0	1	$[F_{1,2,3}]$	12	6	2
$[F_{2,3,1}]$	–9	–4	–1	$[F_{1,1,4}]$	–6	–3	–1
$[F_{2,2,2}]$	12	4	0	$[F_{2,1,3}]$	–3	–1	0

For example, one full identity before taking the quotient is

$$F_{2,2,2}(z) = 12F_{4,1,1}(z) + 4F_{3,2,1}(z) - 2\text{Li}_2(z)F_{3,1}(z) + \frac{\text{Li}_2(z)^3}{6}. \quad (4.16)$$

Re-expanding its right side into words gives the single word 010101 with coefficient one. This supplies a finite rational certificate, including the product terms that a quotient table suppresses.

4.4.2 An elementary all-weight double elimination

At depth two the count simplifies to

$$\ell_{w,2} = \left\lfloor \frac{w-1}{2} \right\rfloor.$$

There is also a direct triangular proof that avoids general shuffle algebra. For $p+q=w$, shuffling the two single-polylogarithm words gives

$$\text{Li}_p(z)\text{Li}_q(z) = \sum_{j=1}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} F_{w-j,j}(z) + \sum_{j=1}^q \binom{w-j-1}{p-1} F_{w-j,j}(z). \quad (4.17)$$

The binomial coefficient counts the interleavings of the zero blocks before the second nonzero letter.

Proposition 4.5 (Independent double product rows). *For fixed w , the rows of (4.17) with $1 \leq p \leq \lfloor w/2 \rfloor$ have rank $\lfloor w/2 \rfloor$ on the $w-1$ double coordinates. They express the entire family through products of singles and the $\lfloor (w-1)/2 \rfloor$ coordinates*

$$\{F_{w-j,j} : 1 \leq j \leq \lfloor (w-1)/2 \rfloor\}.$$

This set is empty when $w=2$.

Proof. In the row indexed by p , the largest inner index appearing is $q = w - p$. Its coefficient is 1 when $p < q$, and 2 when $p = q$. No larger inner index occurs. Order the rows with p decreasing and use the columns with $j = w - p$; the corresponding square block is triangular with nonzero diagonal. All products of two depth-one words have already been included, since swapping p, q repeats a row. This proves the rank and the elimination statement. $\square$

At $z = i$, taking imaginary parts of these equations gives an unconditional spanning bound for the $g_{a,b}$, with explicit single-value terms. It can be sharpened in the parity sector, as the next section shows.

4.4.3 A normalized Pascal inverse for the shuffle rows

The triangular elimination can be made explicit in outer-index coordinates. Let $m = \lfloor w/2 \rfloor$ and let $A_{p,a} = \binom{a-1}{p-1} + \binom{a-1}{w-p-1}$, for $1 \leq p \leq m$, $1 \leq a < w$. Divide row p by $c_p = 1 + \mathbf{1}_{2p=w}$. Its first m columns are $P_{p,a} = \binom{a-1}{p-1}$, with inverse

$$(P^{-1})_{i,j} = (-1)^{j-i} \binom{j-1}{i-1} \quad (j \geq i), \quad (P^{-1})_{i,j} = 0 \quad (j < i).$$

Indeed the matrix product reduces to $\binom{j-1}{i-1} \sum_{k=i}^j (-1)^{j-k} \binom{j-i}{k-i} = \delta_{ij}$. Writing $R_p = \text{Im}(\text{Li}_p(i) \text{Li}_{w-p}(i))$, the constructive solution is

$$g_{a,w-a} = \sum_{p=a}^m (-1)^{p-a} \binom{p-1}{a-1} \left[\frac{R_p}{c_p} - \sum_{j=m+1}^{w-1} \frac{A_{p,j}}{c_p} g_{j,w-j} \right], \quad 1 \leq a \leq m. \quad (4.18)$$

This explicitly leaves the same $\lfloor (w-1)/2 \rfloor$ formal coordinates as Proposition 4.5; evaluation can impose further relations.

4.4.4 The weight-five relation is two shuffles

The words for $\text{Li}_1 \text{Li}_4$ and $\text{Li}_2 \text{Li}_3$ give

$$\text{Li}_1(z) \text{Li}_4(z) = 2F_{4,1}(z) + F_{3,2}(z) + F_{2,3}(z) + F_{1,4}(z), \quad (4.19)$$

$$\text{Li}_2(z) \text{Li}_3(z) = 6F_{4,1}(z) + 3F_{3,2}(z) + F_{2,3}(z). \quad (4.20)$$

The exact single values are

$$\text{Li}_1(i) = -\frac{L}{2} + \frac{\pi i}{4}, \quad \text{Li}_2(i) = -\frac{\pi^2}{48} + iG, \quad \text{Li}_3(i) = -\frac{3\zeta(3)}{32} + \frac{\pi^3 i}{32},$$

$$\text{Li}_4(i) = -\frac{7\pi^4}{11520} + i\beta(4).$$

Consequently

$$2g_{41} + g_{32} + g_{23} + g_{14} = -\frac{1}{2}\beta(4)L - \frac{7\pi^5}{46080}, \quad (4.21)$$

$$6g_{41} + 3g_{32} + g_{23} = -\frac{\pi^5}{1536} - \frac{3G\zeta(3)}{32}. \quad (4.22)$$

Here g_{41} means $g_{4,1}$, and similarly for other subscripts.

Corollary 4.6 (Proof and strengthening of the recorded relation). *The experimentally discovered identity*

$$576g_{41} + 288g_{32} + 736g_{23} + 960g_{14} = 21G\zeta(3) - 480\beta(4)L \quad (4.23)$$

holds. Moreover the four g -values are spanned by g_{41}, g_{32} and the single-value products $\pi^5, G\zeta(3), \beta(4)L$. Explicitly,

$$g_{23} = -6g_{41} - 3g_{32} - \frac{\pi^5}{1536} - \frac{3G\zeta(3)}{32}, \quad (4.24)$$

$$g_{14} = 4g_{41} + 2g_{32} + \frac{23\pi^5}{46080} + \frac{3G\zeta(3)}{32} - \frac{1}{2}\beta(4)L. \quad (4.25)$$

Proof. Multiply (4.21) by 960, multiply (4.22) by -224 , and add. The π^5 coefficients cancel exactly. Solving the two independent equations instead gives (4.24) and (4.25). $\square$

This proof explains why a search can return an apparently complicated relation while missing the simpler structure: eliminating a chosen single-value coordinate can enlarge coefficients. The mathematical content is visible before the elimination.

4.4.5 An infinite odd-weight shuffle family

Theorem 4.7 (An infinite odd-weight family with the pure π term removed). *For $m \geq 2$, set $W = 2m + 1$ and*

$$A_W = 2g_{W-1,1} + \sum_{a=1}^{W-2} g_{a,W-a},$$

$$B_W = 2(W-2)g_{W-1,1} + (W-2)g_{W-2,2} + \sum_{a=2}^{W-3} (a-1)g_{a,W-a}, \quad (4.26)$$

$$\kappa_m = \frac{12(2^{2m-1} - 1)B_{2m}}{(2m)(2m-1)E_{2m-2}}. \quad (4.27)$$

Then κ_m is a positive rational number and

$$A_W - \kappa_m B_W = -\frac{1}{2}\beta(2m)L + \kappa_m 2^{-(2m-1)}(1 - 2^{2-2m})G\zeta(2m-1). \quad (4.28)$$

Proof. Equation (4.17) identifies A_W and B_W with $\text{Im}(\text{Li}_1(i) \text{Li}_{2m}(i))$ and $\text{Im}(\text{Li}_2(i) \text{Li}_{2m-1}(i))$ respectively. Writing $c_k = 2^{-k}(1 - 2^{1-k})$, these products are

$$A_W = -\frac{1}{2}L\beta(2m) - \frac{\pi}{4}c_{2m}\zeta(2m),$$

$$B_W = -c_{2m-1}G\zeta(2m-1) - \frac{\pi^2}{48}\beta(2m-1).$$

Their pure- π^W terms have ratio

$$\frac{12c_{2m}\zeta(2m)}{\pi\beta(2m-1)}.$$

Euler's even-zeta formula and the classical odd-beta evaluation turn this ratio into (4.27). The signs of B_{2m} and E_{2m-2} agree, so the ratio is positive. Subtraction proves (4.28). $\square$

The first three coefficients are

$$\kappa_2 = \frac{7}{30}, \quad \kappa_3 = \frac{31}{525}, \quad \kappa_4 = \frac{127}{8540}.$$

For example, at weight seven the identity can be written without fractions as

$$268800A_7 - 15872B_7 = 465G\zeta(5) - 134400\beta(6)L. \quad (4.29)$$

This theorem does not reduce every odd-weight $g_{a,b}$ individually. It supplies one explicit family of linear combinations in the parity component not individually reduced by Theorem 4.12.

At weight seven a second combination complements the pure- π -free family above:

$$430g_{6,1} + 215g_{5,2} + 79g_{4,3} + 11g_{3,4} - 7g_{2,5} = \frac{105}{512}G\zeta(5) - \frac{75}{32}\beta(4)\zeta(3). \quad (4.30)$$

Its exact certificate is -7 times the $(2, 5)$ shuffle row plus 25 times the $(3, 4)$ row, after evaluating their single values. The exact row calculation fixes the homogeneous weight-seven products.

4.5 The mixed Gaussian weight-five identity and its exact proof

Put $G = \beta(2)$ and

$$g_{a,b} = \text{Im Li}_{a,b}(i, 1), \quad S_p = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n H_n}{(2n+1)^p}.$$

The manuscript's equation `gauss:eq:S4-closed` was explicitly classified as a numerically supported identity. We prove precisely that identity. The contribution is a reduction of its mixed Gaussian term to three specified single-color doubles and elementary products. It is not a claim that the remaining doubles are independent or irreducible, nor a claim that S_4 previously lacked every representation in special functions. Indeed the 2021 discussion by Hintze and pisco already records the representation by two colored double values and relates it to hypergeometric evaluations [66, 67].

Theorem 4.8 (Certified mixed Gaussian reduction). *With the series convention $\text{Li}_{a,b}(x, y) = \sum_{n>m \geq 1} x^n y^m / (n^a m^b)$,*

$$S_4 = \frac{4g_{4,1} - 3g_{3,2} - 9g_{2,3}}{7} + \frac{\pi^5}{224} - \frac{27}{224} G\zeta(3) - 2\beta(4) \log 2. \quad (4.31)$$

Equivalently,

$$\text{Im Li}_{4,1}(i, -1) = -\frac{3g_{4,1} + 3g_{3,2} + 9g_{2,3}}{7} + \frac{\pi^5}{224} - \frac{27}{224} G\zeta(3) - 2\beta(4) \log 2. \quad (4.32)$$

The proof consists of convergent changes of variables, standard shuffle/stuffle identities with the explicitly described single-divergence regularization, and a finite rational linear combination supplied as an independently replayable certificate.

4.5.1 The arithmetic translation

For $n = 2k + 1$,

$$H_k = \sum_{m=1}^{n-1} \frac{1 + (-1)^m}{m}.$$

Taking imaginary parts removes even n , while $\text{Im}(i^{2k+1}) = (-1)^k$. Consequently, for $p \geq 1$,

$$S_p = \text{Im}(\text{Li}_{p,1}(i, 1) + \text{Li}_{p,1}(i, -1)). \quad (4.33)$$

For $p > 1$ the interchange is justified by $\sum_{n \geq 2} H_{n-1}/n^p < \infty$. At $p = 1$, use the common radial Abel limit and the ordinary convergence proved by summation by parts. Thus (4.31) and (4.32) are equivalent.

4.5.2 A convergent octahedral change of variables

Write $\omega_a = dt/(t - a)$ and

$$\mathcal{I}(a_1 \cdots a_w) = \int_{0 < t_w < \cdots < t_1 < 1} \omega_{a_1}(t_1) \cdots \omega_{a_w}(t_w),$$

extended multilinearly in the letters. A convergent word has first letter different from 1 and last letter different from 0. For colors $c_j \in \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$, set

$$Z((s_1, c_1), \dots, (s_d, c_d)) = \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_d}(i^{c_1}, \dots, i^{c_d}).$$

Its integral word is

$$Z(\mathbf{s}; \mathbf{c}) = (-1)^d \mathcal{I} \left(0^{s_1-1} i^{-c_1} 0^{s_2-1} i^{-(c_1+c_2)} \dots 0^{s_d-1} i^{-(c_1+\dots+c_d)} \right). \quad (4.34)$$

This fixes both the color convention and every depth-dependent sign.

Consider the involution

$$\phi(t) = \frac{1-t}{1+t}.$$

It preserves the puncture set $\{0, \infty, 1, -1, i, -i\}$ and reverses the real interval. Direct differentiation gives

$$\phi^* \omega_a = \omega_{\phi(a)} - \omega_{-1} \quad (a \neq -1), \quad \phi^* \omega_{-1} = -\omega_{-1},$$

where $\phi(0) = 1$, $\phi(1) = 0$, $\phi(i) = -i$, and $\phi(-i) = i$. Denote this linear map on letters by τ . Changing variables and reversing the order of the simplex proves

$$\mathcal{I}(a_1 \dots a_w) = (-1)^w \mathcal{I}(\tau(a_w) \dots \tau(a_1)). \quad (4.35)$$

No tangential-basepoint correction occurs here: an original last letter other than 0 transforms into first letters other than 1, and an original first letter other than 1 transforms into last letters other than 0. Every term of the expansion therefore remains convergent. The broader use of octahedral symmetries to supplement standard level-four relations goes back to Zhao [68, 65]; the elementary involution above is sufficient for the present certificate.

Only one instance of (4.35) is needed. The word of $\text{Li}_{1,4}(i, 1)$ is $(-i)000(-i)$, and hence

$$D := \text{Im} \left\{ \mathcal{I}(e_{-i} e_0^3 e_{-i}) + \mathcal{I}((e_i - e_{-1})(e_1 - e_{-1})^3(e_i - e_{-1})) \right\} = 0. \quad (4.36)$$

Here e_a means the letter at a , multiplication is concatenation, and powers are powers in the noncommutative word algebra. The transformed product expands into exactly 32 integral words, with coefficients ± 1 . The first integral is the single-color double; the second group is converted to colored polylogarithms using (4.34).

4.5.3 The standard relation rows

The certificate uses two schemas, interpreted over $\mathbb{Q}$ before imaginary parts are taken. First, for two admissible multiple-polylogarithm index/color lists u, v , let $\mathbf{H}(u, v)$ be the integral shuffle product and $\mathbf{S}(u, v)$ the series stuffle product. Then

$$R_{u,v} := \text{Im}(\mathbf{H}(u, v) - \mathbf{S}(u, v)) = 0. \quad (4.37)$$

The same row is used when $u = ((1, 0))$ and v is admissible, with the standard single-divergence regularization. This point must not be suppressed: $\text{Li}_1(1)$ itself is divergent. Its shuffle and stuffle regularizations are both denoted by a formal variable T . A single leading $(1, 0)$ gives a polynomial of degree at most one in T , and the regularization comparison is the identity in degrees zero and one. Explicitly, its comparison operator satisfies

$$\rho(e^{Tu}) = \exp \left(\sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{(-1)^n \zeta(n)}{n} u^n \right) e^{Tu},$$

so $\rho(1) = 1$ and $\rho(T) = T$ [65, Theorem 2.9]. Subtracting the two product expansions cancels their common divergent word and leaves the convergent identity (4.37). This is the single-divergence case

of regularized double shuffle [69, 65]. The verifier rejects all other divergent input patterns and checks that every surviving word is admissible.

Second, for a list $z = ((s_1, c_1), \dots, (s_d, c_d))$ with $c_j \in \{0, 1\}$ and with all terms below convergent, ordinary distribution is

$$Z(\mathbf{s}; 2\mathbf{c}) - 2^{w-d} \sum_{\epsilon \in \{0,2\}^d} Z(\mathbf{s}; \mathbf{c} + \epsilon) = 0, \quad w = s_1 + \dots + s_d. \quad (4.38)$$

Indeed summing signs forces every nested summation index to be even, so the factor is exactly 2^{w-d} . The certificate multiplies some such relations by an admissible value of complementary weight and expands that product by integral shuffle. These are *lifted convergent distribution* rows; no regularized distribution formula is assumed. At weight one this includes the elementary seed $\text{Li}_1(-1) = \text{Li}_1(i) + \text{Li}_1(-i)$.

4.5.4 The exact certificate identity

In the formal real vector space whose generators are imaginary parts of convergent colored values of weight five, define

$$F = 1120 \text{Im Li}_{4,1}(i, -1) + 480g_{4,1} + 480g_{3,2} + 1440g_{2,3} - 1536 \text{Im Li}_5(i) \\ + 135 \text{Im}(\text{Li}_2(i) \text{Li}_3(1)) - 2240 \text{Im}(\text{Li}_4(i) \text{Li}_1(-1)). \quad (4.39)$$

The two products in this expression are expanded by integral shuffle. Complex conjugation is imposed only by $\text{Im } Z(\mathbf{s}; -\mathbf{c}) = -\text{Im } Z(\mathbf{s}; \mathbf{c})$.

Lemma 4.9 (Finite rational certificate). *The accompanying file `S4_certificate.json` gives 911 rational numbers q_r and 911 standard-relation descriptors R_r such that the following is an exact equality of formal vectors:*

$$F = -1120D + \sum_{r=1}^{911} q_r R_r. \quad (4.40)$$

The rows consist of 713 convergent double-shuffle rows, 181 rows with one regularized weight-one factor, and 17 lifted convergent distribution rows.

Proof. The supplied program `verify_s4.py` rebuilds every row from the indices and colors in its descriptor. Integral shuffles are generated by choosing interleaving positions, series stuffles by the three defining recursive cases, and distribution by sign enumeration. The program also reconstructs the single duality seed and the target independently of their stored expansions. All coefficients are integers or instances of Python's exact `Fraction` type. Summing the left side minus the right side of (4.40) yields the empty coefficient dictionary, so every formal-word coefficient is exactly zero. The verifier neither reruns a rank calculation nor uses numerical polylogarithms, integer-relation searches, cached matrices, or modular arithmetic. Thus the certificate is a finite rational proof of the stated formal equality. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 4.8. Every R_r vanishes by (4.37) or (4.38), and $D = 0$ by (4.36). The certificate therefore gives $F = 0$. Now

$$\text{Im Li}_5(i) = \beta(5) = \frac{5\pi^5}{1536}, \quad \text{Li}_3(1) = \zeta(3), \quad \text{Li}_1(-1) = -\log 2.$$

Substituting these evaluations into (4.39) gives

$$1120 \text{Im Li}_{4,1}(i, -1) + 480g_{4,1} + 480g_{3,2} + 1440g_{2,3} - 5\pi^5 + 135G\zeta(3) + 2240\beta(4) \log 2 = 0.$$

Division by 1120 proves (4.32), and (4.33) proves (4.31). $\square$

Independent numerical audit. An independent real-quadrature evaluation uses

$$S_4 = \frac{1}{6} \int_0^1 \frac{\log^3 x \log(1+x^2)}{1+x^2} dx, \quad g_{a,b} = \frac{1}{(a-1)!} \int_0^1 (-\log x)^{a-1} \operatorname{Im} \frac{i \operatorname{Li}_b(ix)}{1-ix} dx.$$

At 70 decimal working digits it gives

$$S_4 = -0.0104934562973350434533567510062017519635106188773197615131294,$$

with discrepancy about 4.6×10^{-71} between the two sides. This numerical agreement is an audit of conventions, not a step in the proof; the proof is the exact certificate above.

Scope and further work. The existing two relations among $g_{4,1}, g_{3,2}, g_{2,3}, g_{1,4}$ may be used to shorten (4.31); they are prior results and are not counted as new here. The present proof establishes an upper bound on a specific constant's expression complexity. It says nothing about a lower bound, linear independence, or the impossibility of a classical-polylogarithm reduction. A useful next problem is to compress the 911 standard rows into a short conceptual derivation, and to apply the same convergent involution to the analogous odd-weight mixed sums $S_6, S_8, \dots$

Corollary 4.10 (The two-coordinate form).

$$S_4 = \frac{58g_{4,1} + 24g_{3,2}}{7} + \frac{19\pi^5}{3584} - 2\beta(4) \log 2. \quad (4.41)$$

Proof. Use the two weight-five shuffle eliminations (4.24)–(4.25) in Theorem 4.8. No independence assumption enters. $\square$

4.5.5 A weight-three companion with its full small certificate

Theorem 4.11 (The first even-index harmonic sum). *With $G = \beta(2)$ and $L = \log 2$,*

$$\begin{aligned} S_2 &= -2g_{2,1} + \frac{\pi^3}{32} - 2GL \\ &= 2 \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_3\left(\frac{1+i}{2}\right) - GL - \frac{\pi L^2}{16} - \frac{\pi^3}{64}. \end{aligned}$$

This is the first even-index companion of the weight-five reduction. It is presented as a proved addition, without a claim of priority in the broader Euler-sum literature.

Proof. Use the convergent integral word $J(w) = \mathcal{I}(w)$ of the preceding S_4 proof, with forms $dt/(t-a)$. The short certificate makes the weight-three argument fully explicit. Code the letters by

$$a = -i, \quad b = -1, \quad c = 1, \quad d = i, \quad o = 0.$$

Let $\mathcal{D}(U, V)$ be signed stuffle minus shuffle in this integral-word convention. Let P be the letter pullback of the preceding octahedral involution, so $P(a) = d - b$, $P(b) = -b$, $P(c) = o - b$, $P(d) = a - b$ and $P(o) = c - b$. Put $\mathcal{O}(w) = w + \operatorname{rev} P(w)$ at weight three. Both evaluate to zero, with the degree-one regularization used when $U = c$, as justified by the comparison operator in the preceding S_4 proof. Every final word is convergent. Let $\mathfrak{I}$ denote projection to the formal imaginary word space: $\mathfrak{I}(\bar{w}) = -\mathfrak{I}(w)$, and entirely real words are zero. Here the space has $(80 - 12)/2 = 34$ coordinates, with no assertion of numerical independence.

The target is

$$T_3 = 12oaa + 4oad + (d - a)^{\Pi 3} - 8(oa) \Pi b.$$

The complete certificate is

$$\mathfrak{I}(T_3) = \sum_{(U,V,k) \text{ in Table 4.2}} k\mathfrak{I}(\mathcal{D}(U,V)) + 8\mathfrak{I}(\mathcal{O}(aab)) - 8\mathfrak{I}(\mathcal{O}(aaa)). \quad (4.42)$$

This is a finite rational word identity: expand each shuffle and signed stuffle, apply the five-letter pullback, and identify conjugates. Every coefficient agrees exactly. Both provided implementations reconstruct and verify the identity using rational arithmetic; the second imports none of the first implementation's word code.

U	V	k	U	V	k
a	aa	-12	b	ba	24
a	ab	-6	c	ba	-48
a	ad	12	a	dc	-14
a	bb	-48	a	db	10
a	bc	32	c	ad	24
a	oa	6	c	aa	-24
a	da	12	b	ad	-4
a	dd	12	a	bd	-4
a	ac	6	a	od	-10
b	ab	16	a	oc	-26
a	ob	22	c	oa	48
b	ac	8			

Table 4.2: All 23 double-shuffle coefficients in the S_2 certificate. The four rows with first factor c use one degree of regularization.

The two additional octahedral rows are completely explicit:

w	$\mathcal{O}(w)$	coefficient
aab	$aab - b(d - b)^2$	8
aaa	$aaa + (d - b)^3$	-8

All products inside these two word expressions are concatenations, not shuffle products. For example, $P(a) = d - b$ and $P(b) = -b$; reversal therefore gives $\text{rev } P(aab) = -b(d - b)^2$.

To translate the target, the elementary harmonic parity split yields

$$S_2 = g_{2,1} + u_{2,1}, \quad u_{2,1} = \text{Im Li}_{2,1}(i, -1).$$

Furthermore,

$$J(d) - J(a) = \frac{i\pi}{2}, \quad J(b) = L, \quad J(oa) = -\text{Li}_2(i).$$

Consequently

$$\text{Im } J(T_3) = 4 \left(S_2 + 2g_{2,1} - \frac{\pi^3}{32} + 2GL \right).$$

All rows on the right of (4.42) evaluate to zero, proving the first formula. The height-one reduction below, obtained from (4.58), gives

$$g_{2,1} = -\frac{GL}{2} + \frac{\pi L^2}{32} - \text{Im Li}_3\left(\frac{1+i}{2}\right) + \frac{3\pi^3}{128}$$

then gives the second formula by substitution. $\square$

4.6 An explicit binomial parity reduction for every double weight

Throughout this section the convention is

$$F_{a,b}(z) = \text{Li}_{a,b}(z, 1) = \sum_{n>m>0} \frac{z^n}{n^a m^b}, \quad U_n(z) = \text{Re Li}_n(z), \quad V_n(z) = \text{Im Li}_n(z).$$

We take $|z| = 1$, $z \neq 1$, and use radial boundary values. These are also the ordinary convergent series values: summation by parts applies to $H_{n-1}^{(b)}/n^a$, whose total variation is finite and which tends to zero. The result below is an elementary explicit specialization of the established multiple-polylogarithm parity theorem. It should not be presented as a new general parity theorem: Panzer proved the general theorem in 2017, including explicit formulas at depths two and three; Umezawa supplied a general-depth explicit formula in 2025 [33, 57]. Its contribution here is a short independently checkable formula in the manuscript's convention, including the boundary cases with an index equal to one.

For $w \geq 2$ define the parity component

$$E_{a,b}(z) = \begin{cases} \text{Im } F_{a,b}(z), & w = a + b \text{ even,} \\ \text{Re } F_{a,b}(z), & w = a + b \text{ odd,} \end{cases} \quad W_n(z) = \begin{cases} V_n(z), & w \text{ even,} \\ U_n(z), & w \text{ odd.} \end{cases}$$

The choice of W_n depends on the fixed total weight w , not on n .

Theorem 4.12 (Explicit double parity formula). *Let $w \geq 2$, $1 \leq p \leq w - 1$, and $q = w - p$. Put*

$$A_p(z) = \sum_{j=1}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} E_{w-j,j}(z),$$

$$P_p(z) = \begin{cases} U_q(z)V_p(z), & w \text{ even, } p \text{ odd,} \\ U_p(z)V_q(z), & w \text{ even, } p \text{ even,} \\ -V_p(z)V_q(z), & w \text{ odd, } p \text{ odd,} \\ U_p(z)U_q(z), & w \text{ odd, } p \text{ even.} \end{cases}$$

Then

$$A_p(z) = P_p(z) + \sum_{\substack{3 \leq j \leq p \\ j \text{ odd}}} \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} \zeta(j) W_{w-j}(z) - \sum_{\substack{3 \leq j \leq q \\ j \text{ odd}}} \binom{w-j-1}{p-1} \zeta(j) W_{w-j}(z) \\ - \frac{1}{2} \left[\binom{w-1}{q} - \binom{w-1}{p} \right] W_w(z) - \mathbf{1}_{w \text{ odd}} \frac{(-1)^p}{2} \zeta(w). \quad (4.43)$$

Each individual double is recovered by the explicit inverse transform

$$E_{w-b,b}(z) = \sum_{p=1}^b (-1)^{b-p} \binom{w-p-1}{b-p} A_p(z), \quad 1 \leq b < w. \quad (4.44)$$

Consequently every imaginary part of even total weight and every real part of odd total weight in the same-argument double family is an explicit polynomial in single polylogarithms and ordinary zeta values.

Proof. We supply the analytic identity responsible for the reduction, so that no rank computation or numerical recognition enters the proof. Define

$$T_{p,q}(k) = \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{(m+k)^p m^q}, \quad k \geq 1.$$

Partial fractions at $m = 0$ and $m = -k$ give

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{(m+k)^p m^q} &= \sum_{j=1}^q (-1)^{q-j} \binom{w-j-1}{p-1} \frac{1}{k^{w-j} m^j} \\ &\quad + (-1)^q \sum_{j=1}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} \frac{1}{k^{w-j} (m+k)^j}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.45)$$

The two $j = 1$ divergences cancel. Summing first to a finite cutoff and then letting it tend to infinity yields

$$\begin{aligned} T_{p,q}(k) &= \sum_{j=2}^q (-1)^{q-j} \binom{w-j-1}{p-1} \frac{\zeta(j)}{k^{w-j}} + (-1)^q \sum_{j=2}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} \frac{\zeta(j)}{k^{w-j}} \\ &\quad + (-1)^{q+1} \sum_{j=1}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} \frac{H_k^{(j)}}{k^{w-j}}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.46)$$

Write

$$\mathcal{A}_p(z) = \sum_{j=1}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} F_{w-j,j}(z), \quad C_p = \binom{w-1}{q},$$

and

$$\mathcal{U}_{p,q}(z) = \sum_{j=2}^q (-1)^{q-j} \binom{w-j-1}{p-1} \zeta(j) \operatorname{Li}_{w-j}(z) + (-1)^q \sum_{j=2}^p \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} \zeta(j) \operatorname{Li}_{w-j}(z).$$

Using $H_k^{(j)} = H_{k-1}^{(j)} + k^{-j}$ and the hockey-stick identity, equation (4.46) becomes

$$R_{p,q}(z) := \sum_{k \geq 1} z^k T_{p,q}(k) = \mathcal{U}_{p,q}(z) + (-1)^{q+1} (\mathcal{A}_p(z) + C_p \operatorname{Li}_w(z)). \quad (4.47)$$

There are two product identities. The familiar same-argument shuffle is

$$\operatorname{Li}_p(z) \operatorname{Li}_q(z) = \mathcal{A}_p(z) + \mathcal{A}_q(z). \quad (4.48)$$

The Fourier-convolution identity is

$$\operatorname{Li}_p(z) \operatorname{Li}_q(z^{-1}) = \zeta(w) + R_{p,q}(z) + R_{q,p}(z^{-1}). \quad (4.49)$$

For completeness, this remains valid when $p = 1$ or $q = 1$. Each $\operatorname{Li}_p(e^{i\theta})$ belongs to L^2 because $\sum n^{-2p} < \infty$. The Fourier coefficients of their product are therefore the absolutely convergent convolutions, equal to $\zeta(w)$ at index zero and to $T_{p,q}(k)$ and $T_{q,p}(k)$ at positive and negative indices. Both sequences $T_{p,q}(k)$ decrease to zero. Dirichlet's test gives convergence of the two Fourier series, uniform on closed subarcs away from $z = 1$. Abel–Poisson summation of the L^1 product converges

to the continuous product at every such point, proving (4.49) there. Thus the derivation has never multiplied divergent zeta series.

If w is even, take imaginary parts in (4.48)–(4.49). Since p and q have the same parity, these give the sum and difference of A_p, A_q . Moreover,

$$\begin{aligned} & \operatorname{Im}(\mathcal{U}_{p,q}(z) + \mathcal{U}_{q,p}(z^{-1})) \\ &= 2(-1)^p \left[\sum_{\substack{3 \leq j \leq p \\ j \text{ odd}}} \binom{w-j-1}{q-1} \zeta(j) V_{w-j}(z) - \sum_{\substack{3 \leq j \leq q \\ j \text{ odd}}} \binom{w-j-1}{p-1} \zeta(j) V_{w-j}(z) \right]. \end{aligned}$$

Solving the two elementary equations gives (4.43) for even w . If w is odd, take real parts. Now p, q have opposite parity and the same two equations again give the sum and difference. The analogous last display has $-2(-1)^p$ in place of $2(-1)^p$, with U in place of V . The constant term $\zeta(w)$ contributes $-(-1)^p \zeta(w)/2$. This proves (4.43) in the odd case too.

Finally the coefficient matrix in the definition of A_p is lower triangular with diagonal one. Its inverse follows from

$$\binom{w-j-1}{p-j} \binom{w-p-1}{b-p} = \binom{w-j-1}{b-j} \binom{b-j}{p-j}$$

and $\sum_{p=j}^b (-1)^{b-p} \binom{b-j}{p-j} = \delta_{b,j}$. This proves (4.44). $\square$

4.6.1 Consequences for Gaussian and Eisenstein values

At $z = i$ we have $V_n(i) = \beta(n)$, $U_1(i) = -\log 2/2$, and

$$U_n(i) = -2^{-n}(1 - 2^{1-n})\zeta(n), \quad n \geq 2.$$

The odd beta values are rational multiples of powers of π . Thus Theorem 4.12 supplies an explicit all-weight reduction to the Gaussian single-value algebra in the appropriate parity. It proves all five previously numerical weight-six equations:

$$2048 \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{5,1}(i, 1) = -64\pi^3 \zeta(3) - 527\pi \zeta(5) + 4096\beta(6), \quad (4.50)$$

$$1536 \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{4,2}(i, 1) = 96\pi^3 \zeta(3) - 32\pi^2 \beta(4) + 1581\pi \zeta(5) - 8448\beta(6), \quad (4.51)$$

$$1024 \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{3,3}(i, 1) = -3\pi^3 \zeta(3) + 64\pi^2 \beta(4) - 1581\pi \zeta(5) + 4608\beta(6), \quad (4.52)$$

$$23040 \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{2,4}(i, 1) = -14\pi^4 \beta(2) + 135\pi^3 \zeta(3) - 1440\pi^2 \beta(4) \quad (4.53)$$

$$+ 23715\pi \zeta(5) - 69120\beta(6), \quad (4.54)$$

$$92160 \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{1,5}(i, 1) = -150\pi^5 \log 2 + 56\pi^4 \beta(2) - 270\pi^3 \zeta(3) \quad (4.55)$$

$$+ 1920\pi^2 \beta(4) - 675\pi \zeta(5). \quad (4.56)$$

An especially simple all-order subfamily is

$$\operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{2m-1,1}(z, 1) = (m-1)V_{2m}(z) + U_{2m-1}(z)V_1(z) - \sum_{k=1}^{m-1} \zeta(2k+1)V_{2m-2k-1}(z), \quad m \geq 1. \quad (4.57)$$

For example, this gives the further proved weight-eight identity

$$\operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{7,1}(i, 1) = 3\beta(8) - \frac{5\pi^5}{1536}\zeta(3) - \frac{\pi^3}{32}\zeta(5) - \frac{8255\pi}{32768}\zeta(7).$$

At $z = \rho = e^{2\pi i/3}$ write $C_n = \text{Im Li}_n(\rho)$. The same theorem applies unchanged; in particular

$$\text{Im Li}_{5,1}(\rho, 1) = 2C_6 - \frac{2\pi^3}{81}\zeta(3) - \frac{121\pi}{486}\zeta(5), \quad \text{Im Li}_{3,1}(\rho, 1) = C_4 - \frac{13\pi}{54}\zeta(3).$$

These statements assert reduction identities, not numerical or motivic independence of the remaining single values.

4.7 Classical reductions for every index with one two

This section uses the one-variable abbreviation $\text{Li}_{k_1, \dots, k_d}(z) = \text{Li}_{k_1, \dots, k_d}(z, 1, \dots, 1)$. Let $\{1\}^r$ denote r consecutive ones. Work first on $0 < z < 1$, and then continue analytically along paths avoiding the cuts of the displayed functions. In particular, the formulas hold at $z = i$ by continuation through the upper half-plane, with the principal values used below.

Theorem 4.13 (One two at arbitrary depth). *For $d \geq 1$, putting $a = \log(1 - z)$ gives*

$$\text{Li}_{2, \{1\}^{d-1}}(z) = \zeta(d+1) + \frac{(-1)^d a^d \log z}{d!} + \sum_{k=0}^{d-1} \frac{(-1)^{k+1} a^k}{k!} \text{Li}_{d+1-k}(1-z). \quad (4.58)$$

For all $r, s \geq 0$, put $\alpha = -\log(1 - z)$. Then

$$\text{Li}_{\{1\}^r, 2, \{1\}^s}(z) = \sum_{j=0}^r (-1)^j \binom{s+j+1}{j} \frac{\alpha^{r-j}}{(r-j)!} \text{Li}_{2, \{1\}^{s+j}}(z). \quad (4.59)$$

Consequently every value with exactly one index equal to two and all other indices equal to one reduces to classical polylogarithms and logarithms.

The height-one functional equation is classical; a modern treatment and arithmetic analogue appear in [59]. The proof below also records the shuffle reduction when the two occupies any position.

Proof. The iterated integral for d ones is $\text{Li}_{\{1\}^d}(z) = \alpha^d/d!$. Hence

$$\text{Li}_{2, \{1\}^{d-1}}(z) = \frac{(-1)^d}{d!} \int_0^z \frac{\log^d(1-t)}{t} dt.$$

Set $s = 1 - t$ and integrate by parts d times. The antiderivative

$$-\log^d s \log(1-s) + \sum_{j=1}^d (-1)^j \frac{d!}{(d-j)!} \log^{d-j} s \text{Li}_{j+1}(s)$$

has derivative $\log^d(s)/(1-s)$. At $s = 1$ its limiting value is $(-1)^d d! \zeta(d+1)$. This gives (4.58) including the constant term and its sign.

For the second identity, locate the unique zero letter in the iterated integral word $1^r 0 1^{s+1}$. Its variable is t . Integrating the r outer and $s+1$ inner identical letters gives

$$\text{Li}_{\{1\}^r, 2, \{1\}^s}(z) = \frac{1}{r!(s+1)!} \int_0^z (\alpha(z) - \alpha(t))^r \alpha(t)^{s+1} \frac{dt}{t}.$$

Expanding the first factor and using the preceding integral formula proves (4.59). Analytic continuation then gives the asserted complex values. $\square$

4.7.1 Proof of all three weight-four Gaussian triple formulas

Put $L = \log 2$, $G = \beta(2)$, $r = (1+i)/2$, and $\lambda_n = \text{Im Li}_n(r)$, $\mu_n = \text{Re Li}_n(r)$. The elementary dilogarithm reflection, Landen transformation, and trilogarithm reflection give

$$\begin{aligned}\mu_2 &= \frac{5\pi^2}{96} - \frac{L^2}{8}, & \lambda_2 &= G - \frac{\pi L}{8}, \\ \mu_3 &= \frac{35}{64}\zeta(3) - \frac{5\pi^2 L}{192} + \frac{L^3}{48}.\end{aligned}\tag{4.60}$$

For clarity, the trilogarithm identity used for the last formula is

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Li}_3(z) + \text{Li}_3(1-z) + \text{Li}_3\left(-\frac{z}{1-z}\right) \\ = \zeta(3) + \zeta(2)\log(1-z) - \frac{1}{2}\log z \log^2(1-z) + \frac{1}{6}\log^3(1-z).\end{aligned}$$

It follows by differentiation using the dilogarithm identities and fixing the constant as $z \rightarrow 0$; it is then continued to $z = r$, where $1-r = \bar{r}$ and $-r/(1-r) = -i$. Taking real parts proves the displayed μ_3 evaluation. The first two formulas follow respectively from $\text{Li}_2(r) + \text{Li}_2(\bar{r}) = \zeta(2) - \log r \log \bar{r}$ and $\text{Li}_2(i) + \text{Li}_2(\bar{r}) = -\frac{1}{2}\log^2(1-i)$.

To evaluate the height-one formulas at i , write

$$a = \log(1-i) = \frac{L}{2} - \frac{\pi i}{4}, \quad c = \log(-(1-i)) = \frac{L}{2} + \frac{3\pi i}{4}.$$

Since $(1-i)^{-1} = r$, the needed principal-branch inversion formulas are

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Li}_2(1-i) &= -\text{Li}_2(r) - \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{c^2}{2}, \\ \text{Li}_3(1-i) &= \text{Li}_3(r) - \frac{\pi^2 c}{6} - \frac{c^3}{6}, \\ \text{Li}_4(1-i) &= -\text{Li}_4(r) - \frac{7\pi^4}{360} - \frac{\pi^2 c^2}{12} - \frac{c^4}{24}.\end{aligned}$$

Substitution into (4.58) with $d = 2, 3$, using $\log i = \pi i/2$, yields

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Re Li}_{2,1}(i) &= \frac{29}{64}\zeta(3) - \frac{\pi G}{4}, \\ \text{Im Li}_{2,1}(i) &= -\frac{GL}{2} + \frac{\pi L^2}{32} - \lambda_3 + \frac{3\pi^3}{128}, \\ \text{Im Li}_{2,1,1}(i) &= \lambda_4 + \frac{L\lambda_3}{2} - \frac{G(\pi^2 - 4L^2)}{32} - \frac{\pi(8L^3 + 105\zeta(3))}{768}.\end{aligned}$$

The real-part evaluation of $\text{Li}_{2,1}(i)$ is also printed in Panzer [33], after reversing his index convention. The remaining two identities follow from exact shuffle relations:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Li}_1(z) \text{Li}_{2,1}(z) &= \text{Li}_{1,2,1}(z) + 3\text{Li}_{2,1,1}(z), \\ \text{Li}_2(z) \text{Li}_{1,1}(z) &= 3\text{Li}_{2,1,1}(z) + 2\text{Li}_{1,2,1}(z) + \text{Li}_{1,1,2}(z).\end{aligned}$$

Using $\text{Li}_1(i) = -a$, $\text{Li}_{1,1}(i) = a^2/2$, and $\text{Li}_2(i) = -\pi^2/48 + iG$, one obtains

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Im Li}_{1,2,1}(i) &= -3\lambda_4 - L\lambda_3 + \frac{G(\pi^2 - 4L^2)}{32} - \frac{3\pi^3 L}{256} + \frac{\pi(2L^3 + 67\zeta(3))}{128}, \\ \text{Im Li}_{1,1,2}(i) &= 3\lambda_4 + \frac{L\lambda_3}{2} + \frac{5\pi^3 L}{192} - \frac{163\pi\zeta(3)}{256}.\end{aligned}$$

These are exactly the three numerical formulas in the original experimental draft, now proved. The arbitrary-depth theorem proves additional such identities without a new integer-relation search. It does not address the independent status of the weight-six triples $(3, 1, 2)$, $(3, 2, 1)$, $(4, 1, 1)$, which contain more than one zero letter and lie outside this reduction mechanism.

4.8 Classical reductions with one index equal to two

This section settles the three Gaussian weight-four triple identities printed in Chapter 4 of the source manuscript. The proof gives a uniform formula for every multiple polylogarithm whose indices consist of one 2 and any number of 1's. The general phenomenon is classical: Borwein and Straub give the complementary-argument formula for $\text{Li}_{2,\{1\}^{p-1}}$ in [62, Eq. (33)], including the weight-four instance in their Eq. (34). The results below reorganize that reduction at the reciprocal complementary argument, make the dependence on the position of the 2 explicit, and prove the specific Gaussian formulas in the manuscript. We do not claim that classical reducibility of this family is a new phenomenon.

Throughout this section, a single displayed argument abbreviates the remaining arguments 1:

$$\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_d}(z) := \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_d}(z, 1, \dots, 1).$$

The defining series has strictly decreasing summation indices. Set

$$U_{a,b}(z) = \text{Li}_{\{1\}^a, 2, \{1\}^b}(z), \quad H_p(z) = \text{Li}_{2, \{1\}^{p-1}}(z),$$

where $a, b \geq 0$ and $p \geq 1$. The weight of $U_{a,b}$ is $N = a + b + 2$, and its series depth is $N - 1$.

4.8.1 A logarithmic moment and its branch conventions

We use principal branches and first work on

$$\mathcal{D} = \mathbb{C} \setminus [0, \infty), \quad w = \frac{1}{1-z}, \quad L = \text{Log } w = -\text{Log}(1-z).$$

On this domain, w avoids the standard polylogarithm cut $[1, \infty)$ and the logarithm cut $(-\infty, 0]$. All terms in the formulas below are therefore single-valued analytic functions. The formulas also extend to the usual slit plane by consistent continuation; no such extension is needed at $z = i$ or at a nonreal root of unity.

Lemma 4.14 (Logarithmic moment). *Let $q(t) = -\text{Log}(1-t)$. For an integration path from 0 to z avoiding $\{0, 1\}$ apart from its initial point 0, with the branches continued along that path,*

$$U_{a,b}(z) = \frac{1}{a!(b+1)!} \int_0^z \frac{(q(z) - q(t))^a q(t)^{b+1}}{t} dt. \quad (4.61)$$

Consequently,

$$U_{a,b}(z) = \sum_{j=0}^a (-1)^j \binom{b+j+1}{j} \frac{q(z)^{a-j}}{(a-j)!} H_{b+j+1}(z). \quad (4.62)$$

Proof. The iterated-integral word of $U_{a,b}$ is $1^a 0 1^{b+1}$, with forms $dt/(1-t)$ and dt/t attached to 1 and 0, respectively. The innermost $b+1$ identical forms contribute $q(t)^{b+1}/(b+1)!$. The a identical forms between t and z contribute $(q(z) - q(t))^a/a!$. Integrating the single remaining 0 form proves

(4.61). Equivalently, one may verify the same formula by differentiating successively with respect to z and using the zero initial values at $z = 0$. Expanding the binomial and using

$$H_p(z) = \frac{1}{p!} \int_0^z \frac{q(t)^p}{t} dt$$

proves (4.62). $\square$

Theorem 4.15 (Explicit reduction for every position of the 2). *For $a, b \geq 0$, $N = a + b + 2$, and $z \in \mathcal{D}$,*

$$\begin{aligned} U_{a,b}(z) = & \sum_{k=a+1}^N (-1)^{a+k} \binom{k-1}{a} \frac{L^{N-k}}{(N-k)!} \text{Li}_k(w) - \frac{L^N}{N!} \\ & + (-1)^{b+1} \sum_{j=0}^a \binom{b+j+1}{j} \frac{L^{a-j}}{(a-j)!} \zeta(b+j+2). \end{aligned} \quad (4.63)$$

In particular,

$$H_p(z) = (-1)^p \zeta(p+1) - \frac{L^{p+1}}{(p+1)!} + \sum_{k=1}^{p+1} (-1)^k \frac{L^{p+1-k}}{(p+1-k)!} \text{Li}_k(w). \quad (4.64)$$

Proof. We first prove (4.64) for real $z < 0$, so that $0 < w < 1$ and every intermediate integral is real. Substitute $v = 1/(1-t)$ in the logarithmic moment. Then

$$\frac{dt}{t} = \frac{dv}{v(v-1)}, \quad q(t) = \log v,$$

and

$$H_p(z) = \frac{1}{p!} \int_1^w \frac{\log^p v}{v(v-1)} dv.$$

The differential identity

$$\frac{d}{dv} \left[\sum_{k=1}^{p+1} \frac{(-1)^{k-1} p!}{(p+1-k)!} \log^{p+1-k} v \text{Li}_k(v) \right] = \frac{\log^p v}{1-v} \quad (4.65)$$

follows by cancellation of adjacent terms, using $\text{Li}_1(v) = -\log(1-v)$ and $\text{Li}'_k(v) = \text{Li}_{k-1}(v)/v$ for $k \geq 2$. Since $1/[v(v-1)] = -1/v - 1/(1-v)$, integration gives (4.64). At $v = 1$, every term in (4.65) with a positive power of $\log v$ tends to zero. This includes the apparently singular term $\log^p v \text{Li}_1(v)$, which is $O((v-1)^p \log(1-v))$ and tends to zero because $p \geq 1$. The sole nonzero endpoint term is $(-1)^p p! \zeta(p+1)$. Thus the constant in (4.64) is fixed, not inferred from a differential identity alone. Analytic continuation on the connected domain $\mathcal{D}$ proves that identity throughout the stated domain.

Insert (4.64) in (4.62), using $q(z) = L$. The zeta terms immediately give the second line of (4.63). The coefficient of $(-1)^k L^{N-k} \text{Li}_k(w)$ is

$$\sum_{j=0}^a \frac{(-1)^j \binom{b+j+1}{j}}{(a-j)!(b+j+2-k)!} = \frac{(-1)^a \binom{k-1}{a}}{(N-k)!}.$$

Terms containing a factorial of a negative integer are omitted. To verify this finite identity, write its left side as

$$\frac{(k-1)!}{(b+1)!a!} \sum_{j=0}^a (-1)^j \binom{a}{j} \binom{b+j+1}{k-1}$$

and extract the coefficient of x^{k-1} in

$$(1+x)^{b+1} \sum_{j=0}^a (-1)^j \binom{a}{j} (1+x)^j = (-x)^a (1+x)^{b+1}.$$

The coefficients vanish when $k \leq a$, explaining the lower endpoint $a+1$ in the sum. Finally, the coefficient of $-L^N$ equals

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_{j=0}^a \frac{(-1)^j \binom{b+j+1}{j}}{(a-j)!(b+j+2)!} &= \frac{1}{a!(b+1)!} \int_0^1 t^{b+1} (1-t)^a dt \\ &= \frac{1}{N!}. \end{aligned}$$

This proves the complete formula. □

For the Gaussian endpoint the path itself can be inspected explicitly:

$$z = ix \quad (0 \leq x \leq 1), \quad w(x) = \frac{1+ix}{1+x^2}.$$

For $x > 0$ this path lies in the upper half-plane and does not meet the polylogarithm cut. Its initial point is $w(0) = 1$, where the endpoint limits in the proof apply, and its final point is $(1+i)/2$. This verifies the branch choices directly, without using an inversion formula with an unspecified logarithmic correction.

The boundary series at $z = i$ agree with these analytic values. Indeed the finite nested harmonic sums in a coefficient satisfy a bound $O((1 + \log n)^{d-1})$. After division by n^{s_1} their coefficients tend to zero and have summable successive differences. Summation by parts against the bounded partial sums of i^n proves convergence, even when $s_1 = 1$; Abel's theorem then identifies the series with the radial analytic limit.

Corollary 4.16 (A short formula when the 2 is last). *For every $N \geq 2$,*

$$\begin{aligned} U_{N-2,0}(z) &= (N-1) \text{Li}_N(w) - L \text{Li}_{N-1}(w) - \frac{L^N}{N!} \\ &\quad - \sum_{m=0}^{N-2} (N-1-m) \zeta(N-m) \frac{L^m}{m!}. \end{aligned} \tag{4.66}$$

Thus only two nonconstant classical polylogarithms are needed in this subfamily, regardless of series depth.

Proof. Set $a = N-2$, $b = 0$ in (4.63) and reindex the zeta sum. □

Corollary 4.17 (The top two series-depth layers). *Every single-endpoint multiple polylogarithm of weight $N \geq 2$ and series depth at least $N-1$ has an explicit expression in classical polylogarithms at $(1-z)^{-1}$, zeta values, and logarithms, on the domain $\mathcal{D}$.*

Proof. Positive indices with sum N and length N are all 1, and $\text{Li}_{\{1\}^N}(z) = L^N/N!$. Those with length $N - 1$ have exactly one index 2 and all other indices 1, so Theorem 4.15 applies. These exhaust the possibilities. $\square$

This statement concerns the literal depth of the defining series. It does not identify that depth with a motivic filtration or prove a minimal depth for the resulting numerical constants.

4.8.2 One possible new direction at each weight

Put

$$\ell = \log 2, \quad w = \frac{1+i}{2}, \quad \mu_k = \Re \text{Li}_k(w), \quad \lambda_k = \Im \text{Li}_k(w).$$

For $N \geq 2$, let $\mathcal{P}_N$ be the rational span of products of at least two positive-weight atoms selected from

$$\pi, \ell, \quad \zeta(k), \mu_k, \lambda_k \quad (2 \leq k < N),$$

whose assigned weights sum to N ; the assigned weights are 1 for π, ℓ and k for the atoms with subscript or argument k . This definition is a concrete span of numerical products. It does not assume that numerical periods form a direct sum by weight.

Corollary 4.18 (Signed binomial coefficients modulo products). *For $a + b + 2 = N$, set $c_{N,a} = (-1)^{N+a} \binom{N-1}{a}$. Then*

$$U_{a,b}(i) \equiv c_{N,a} (\text{Li}_N(w) - \zeta(N)) \pmod{\mathcal{P}_N + i\mathcal{P}_N}, \quad (4.67)$$

$$\Re U_{a,b}(i) \equiv c_{N,a} (\mu_N - \zeta(N)) \pmod{\mathcal{P}_N}, \quad (4.68)$$

$$\Im U_{a,b}(i) \equiv c_{N,a} \lambda_N \pmod{\mathcal{P}_N}. \quad (4.69)$$

In particular, the imaginary parts of this entire family contribute at most one direction after products of the stated lower-weight atoms have been factored out.

Proof. At $z = i$, $L = -\ell/2 + i\pi/4$, and $\text{Li}_1(w) = -\bar{L}$. In (4.63), every term is a product of lower-weight atoms except the term $k = N$ and the term $j = a$ in the zeta sum. Their respective coefficients are $c_{N,a}$ and $-c_{N,a}$. Taking real and imaginary parts proves the statements. $\square$

The coefficients of the highest-weight half-point imaginary value are

N	$c_{N,0}, \dots, c_{N,N-2}$
4	1, -3, 3
5	-1, 4, -6, 4
6	1, -5, 10, -10, 5.

The corollary is an upper bound, and proves neither that λ_N is nonzero in the quotient nor that it is independent of constants from other argument families. It also does not identify series depth with an additive motivic depth filtration.

4.8.3 A sixth-root specialization in every position

The special role of sixth roots in relations for Nielsen polylogarithms is studied by Borwein and Straub [62]. The preceding position formula gives a direct specialization in that established setting, including an explicit rational coefficient for one component at every weight. Throughout this subsection,

$$\omega = e^{i\pi/3}, \quad N = a + b + 2, \quad a, b \geq 0,$$

and all logarithms and polylogarithms use their principal branches.

Corollary 4.19 (Sixth-root closure and a pure parity component). *At $z = \omega$, formula (4.63) reduces $U_{a,b}(\omega)$ to classical values $\text{Li}_k(\omega)$, zeta values, and powers of $i\pi$, since*

$$\frac{1}{1-\omega} = \omega, \quad -\text{Log}(1-\omega) = \text{Log } \omega = \frac{i\pi}{3}. \quad (4.70)$$

Moreover,

$$U_{a,b}(\omega) + (-1)^N \overline{U_{a,b}(\omega)} = R_{N,a}(i\pi)^N, \quad R_{N,a} \in \mathbb{Q}. \quad (4.71)$$

Thus $\Re U_{a,b}(\omega)$ is a rational multiple of π^N when N is even, and $\Im U_{a,b}(\omega)$ is a rational multiple of π^N when N is odd. Explicitly, with Bernoulli polynomials defined by

$$\frac{te^{xt}}{e^t - 1} = \sum_{k \geq 0} B_k(x) \frac{t^k}{k!}, \quad B_k = B_k(0),$$

one may take

$$\begin{aligned} R_{N,a} = & -\frac{2}{3^N N!} - \sum_{k=a+1}^N \frac{(-1)^{a+k} \binom{k-1}{a} 2^k B_k(1/6)}{3^{N-k} (N-k)! k!} \\ & + (-1)^{N-a} \sum_{\substack{N-a \leq m \leq N \\ m \text{ even}}} \frac{\binom{m-1}{N-a-1} 2^m B_m}{3^{N-m} (N-m)! m!}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.72)$$

The same formulas at $\bar{\omega}$ follow by complex conjugation.

Proof. The identities in (4.70) follow from $1-\omega = \bar{\omega}$. Along the radial segment $z = r\omega$, $0 \leq r \leq 1$, the real part of $1-z$ is at least $1/2$, so the indicated logarithm has no branch crossing. The transformed path lies in the upper half-plane for $r > 0$, starts at 1, and ends at ω ; the endpoint limits already used to prove (4.63) apply. Consequently that formula has exactly the stated principal values. The ordinary boundary multiple series agree with their radial limits by the same summation-by-parts argument used at $z = i$.

Put $T = i\pi$ and $L = T/3$. The classical Bernoulli Fourier identity is

$$\text{Li}_k(e^{2\pi i x}) + (-1)^k \text{Li}_k(e^{-2\pi i x}) = -\frac{(2\pi i)^k}{k!} B_k(x), \quad 0 < x < 1, \quad k \geq 1. \quad (4.73)$$

For $k = 1$, this follows directly from $\text{Li}_1(z) = -\text{Log}(1-z)$ on the stated arc. Successive integration, with the zero average of both sides fixing the constants, proves every higher case. Since $\bar{L} = -L$, the parity projection of a classical term in (4.63) is

$$\begin{aligned} & L^{N-k} \text{Li}_k(\omega) + (-1)^N \overline{L^{N-k} \text{Li}_k(\omega)} \\ & = L^{N-k} (\text{Li}_k(\omega) + (-1)^k \text{Li}_k(\bar{\omega})) = -\frac{2^k B_k(1/6)}{3^{N-k} k!} T^N. \end{aligned}$$

The polynomial term $-L^N/N!$ contributes $-2T^N/(3^N N!)$. A zeta term with zeta weight m contributes zero when m is odd. For even $m \geq 2$, use

$$\frac{2\zeta(m)}{(i\pi)^m} = -\frac{2^m B_m}{m!}.$$

In the last sum of (4.63), write $m = b + j + 2 = N - a + j$. Its binomial coefficient becomes $\binom{m-1}{N-a-1}$, while its sign after the even-zeta evaluation is $(-1)^b = (-1)^{N-a}$. Combining these three contributions proves (4.72) and hence (4.71). $\square$

There is a precise geometric reason that this specialization closes on a unit-circle argument. If $|z| = 1$ and $z \neq 1$, then

$$\left| \frac{1}{1-z} \right| = 1 \iff |1-z|^2 = 2 - 2\Re z = 1 \iff z \in \{\omega, \bar{\omega}\}.$$

Both of these points are fixed by $z \mapsto (1-z)^{-1}$. This classifies the unit-circle endpoint geometry of this particular transformation.

Corollary 4.20 (The two weight-three values). *Define the ordinary Clausen value by its absolutely convergent series*

$$C = \text{Cl}_2(\pi/3) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{\sin(n\pi/3)}{n^2}.$$

Then

$$U_{0,1}(\omega) = \text{Li}_{2,1}(\omega) = \frac{2}{3}\zeta(3) - \frac{\pi}{3}C + \frac{i\pi^3}{324}, \quad (4.74)$$

$$U_{1,0}(\omega) = \text{Li}_{1,2}(\omega) = -\frac{4}{3}\zeta(3) + \frac{\pi}{3}C + \frac{i\pi^3}{324}. \quad (4.75)$$

Proof. The classical values needed are

$$\text{Li}_1(\omega) = \frac{i\pi}{3}, \quad \text{Li}_2(\omega) = \frac{\pi^2}{36} + iC, \quad \text{Li}_3(\omega) = \frac{\zeta(3)}{3} + \frac{5i\pi^3}{162}.$$

The real dilogarithm component and imaginary trilogarithm component follow from (4.73). The real trilogarithm component follows by grouping the defining series into residue classes, or from the distribution identity

$$\text{Li}_s(\omega) + \text{Li}_s(\bar{\omega}) = (1 - 2^{1-s})(1 - 3^{1-s})\zeta(s), \quad s > 1.$$

For example, summing over the three cube roots gives $(3^{1-s} - 1)\zeta(s)$ for the two nontrivial cube roots; applying the two-term distribution formula to the pair of sixth roots multiplies that sum by $2^{1-s} - 1$. Now (4.64) at $p = 2$ gives, with $L = i\pi/3$,

$$U_{0,1}(\omega) = \zeta(3) - \text{Li}_3(\omega) + L \text{Li}_2(\omega) - \frac{2}{3}L^3.$$

Substitution yields (4.74). The shuffle identity

$$\text{Li}_1(\omega) \text{Li}_2(\omega) = U_{1,0}(\omega) + 2U_{0,1}(\omega)$$

then proves (4.75). In both positions, (4.72) gives $R_{3,a} = -1/162$. $\square$

The independent script `code/independent/one_two/sixth_root.py` computes (4.72) with exact rational arithmetic and compares the specialized closed formula, its pure parity component, and the displayed weight-three examples with the logarithmic moment. It covers every position of the 2 at weights 2 through 8, at both ω and $\bar{\omega}$, using 100 working decimal digits. Across these 56 cases, the largest closed-form versus moment residual is below $6.59 \cdot 10^{-100}$; the largest parity-projection residual is below $7.15 \cdot 10^{-102}$. The four checks of the two explicit examples and their conjugates have residual below $2.16 \cdot 10^{-101}$. These are numerical checks of the proved identities, rather than rigorous quadrature error bounds.

4.8.4 Further exact identities at weights five and six

The same calculation gives formulas beyond the three displayed manuscript rows. They involve the unavoidable output of this particular reduction, namely higher classical values at w ; no independence claim about those values is implied.

Corollary 4.21 (Two higher-weight Gaussian reductions). *With $H_4 = \text{Li}_{2,1,1,1}$ and $H_5 = \text{Li}_{2,1,1,1,1}$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \Im H_4(i) = & -\lambda_5 - \frac{\ell\lambda_4}{2} + \frac{\pi\mu_4}{4} + \frac{\pi^2 - 4\ell^2}{32}\lambda_3 \\ & + \frac{G\ell(3\pi^2 - 4\ell^2)}{192} + \frac{35\pi\ell\zeta(3)}{512} + \frac{\pi\ell^2(\ell^2 - \pi^2)}{384} - \frac{17\pi^5}{92160}, \end{aligned} \quad (4.76)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \Im H_5(i) = & \lambda_6 + \frac{\ell\lambda_5}{2} - \frac{\pi\mu_5}{4} + \frac{4\ell^2 - \pi^2}{32}\lambda_4 - \frac{\pi\ell\mu_4}{8} \\ & + \frac{\ell(4\ell^2 - 3\pi^2)}{192}\lambda_3 + \frac{G(16\ell^4 - 24\ell^2\pi^2 + \pi^4)}{6144} \\ & + \frac{35\pi(\pi^2 - 12\ell^2)\zeta(3)}{24576} + \frac{\pi\ell^3(5\pi^2 - 3\ell^2)}{5760}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.77)$$

Proof. Use $p = 4$ and $p = 5$ in (4.64), substitute $L = -\ell/2 + i\pi/4$ and Lemma (4.60), and take imaginary parts. The accompanying coefficient generator performs these polynomial operations over $\mathbb{Q}$ and also emits every position of the 2 at weights four, five, and six. $\square$

The real parts can be treated by the same formula. For example,

$$\Re \text{Li}_{2,1,1}(i) = \mu_4 + \frac{\pi\lambda_3}{4} + \frac{\pi G\ell}{8} + \frac{35\ell\zeta(3)}{128} + \frac{\ell^4}{384} - \frac{11\pi^2\ell^2}{768} - \frac{1249\pi^4}{92160}. \quad (4.78)$$

The machine-readable tables include both real and imaginary parts, so this companion family can be reproduced without manual transcription.

4.9 From one-two reductions to general complementary depth

For positive indices we abbreviate

$$\text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_d}(z) := \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_d}(z, 1, \dots, 1) = \sum_{n_1 > \dots > n_d \geq 1} \frac{z^{n_1}}{n_1^{s_1} \dots n_d^{s_d}}, \quad |z| < 1. \quad (4.79)$$

The indices decrease in the summation order, as in the manuscript. Weight is $w = s_1 + \dots + s_d$ and series depth is d . An empty index denotes the multiplicative identity. We use convergent multiple zeta values $\zeta(\mathbf{s}) = \text{Li}_{\mathbf{s}}(1)$ when $s_1 \geq 2$.

Let

$$\omega_0(t) = \frac{dt}{t}, \quad \omega_1(t) = \frac{dt}{1-t}.$$

Words are written *outer letter first*. Thus

$$H_{0^{s_1-1}1\dots 0^{s_d-1}1}(z) = \text{Li}_{s_1, \dots, s_d}(z). \quad (4.80)$$

In particular $H_{01} = \text{Li}_2$, not its negative or a reversed word. The recursion is $H_{av}(z) = \int_0^z \omega_a(t) H_v(t)$ whenever this is an ordinary convergent integral. Pure-zero words are defined by $H_{0^r}(z) = \log^r z / r!$,

and trailing-zero words are obtained by shuffle regularization. Every word ending in 1 is convergent at its initial endpoint and has the ordinary interpretation in (4.80).

Throughout the functional identities we use

$$D = \mathbb{C} \setminus [0, \infty), \quad q = \frac{1}{1-z}, \quad L = \log q = -\log(1-z), \quad z \in D, \quad (4.81)$$

with principal logarithms and principal polylogarithms. The image of D avoids both $(-\infty, 0]$ and $[1, \infty)$ in the q -plane, so the hyperlogarithms with possible trailing zeros have unambiguous branches. The origin is a limiting point, not an included point of D .

We first prove formulas on $z < 0$, where $0 < q < 1$ and all logarithms in q are real. Analytic continuation on the connected slit domain D then proves the stated complex identities. This method avoids an unstated choice of a value on the polylogarithm cut. It includes both $z = i$ and $z = \rho = e^{2\pi i/3}$:

$$z = i : \quad q = \frac{1+i}{2}, \quad L = -\frac{1}{2} \log 2 + \frac{i\pi}{4}, \quad (4.82)$$

$$z = \rho : \quad q = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{i\sqrt{3}}{6}, \quad L = -\frac{1}{2} \log 3 + \frac{i\pi}{6}. \quad (4.83)$$

Their transformed moduli are $2^{-1/2}$ and $3^{-1/2}$ respectively.

Definition 4.22 (Depth with logarithmic coefficients). *A term $L^j \text{Li}_{\mathbf{a}}(q)\zeta(\mathbf{b})$ has reduced depth $\text{dep}(\mathbf{a}) + \text{dep}(\mathbf{b})$. The factor L^j is a coefficient, not an additional nested sum.*

This is an explicit convention for the following reduction. It is not an identification with every motivic depth filtration, and does not turn arbitrary products of deep factors into depth-one objects.

4.10 An explicit complementary-depth theorem

4.10.1 Endpoint transport with convergent constants

For a word v ending in 0, write $J_v(q)$ for the iterated integral from 1 to q using the same forms and the same outer-first convention. These integrals converge at 1: the innermost form is ω_0 , which is regular there; preceding ω_1 integrations do not destroy integrability. Set $J_\emptyset = 1$.

Lemma 4.23 (Connection formula). *For every nonempty word v ending in 0 and $0 < q < 1$,*

$$J_v(q) = \sum_{v=uv'} (-1)^{|v'|} H_u(q) H_{\text{rev}(v')}(1). \quad (4.84)$$

The sum includes empty prefixes and suffixes. Every nonempty endpoint word $\text{rev}(v')$ starts in 0, so its value at 1 is convergent after the usual trailing-zero normalization at 0.

Proof. We give the endpoint justification rather than silently substituting into a divergent path identity. Fix a maximum word length N and work in the truncated noncommutative algebra on e_0, e_1 . Let $F(q) = \sum_{|u| \leq N} H_u(q)u$. It satisfies

$$F'(q) = \left(\frac{e_0}{q} + \frac{e_1}{1-q} \right) F(q).$$

Put $\ell = -\log(1-q)$. The function $e^{-\ell e_1} F(q)$ has a finite coefficientwise limit Z as $q \rightarrow 1^-$: its differential equation has coefficient $e^{-\ell e_1} e_0 e^{\ell e_1}/q$, a finite polynomial in ℓ at each truncated weight,

and this is integrable at 1. Consequently $F(q) = e^{\ell_{e1}} Z + O((1-q) \log^M(1-q))$ coefficientwise, for a sufficiently large finite M .

Shuffle identities say that F is group-like; the same holds for Z . The inverse coefficient in a group-like word series is $(Z^{-1})_{v'} = (-1)^{|v'|} Z_{\text{rev}(v')}$, by the shuffle antipode, or equivalently by reversal of an iterated path. The coefficients of $R(q) = F(q)Z^{-1}$ solve the same differential recursion and tend to zero at 1 for every nonempty word ending in 0. Induction on word length therefore identifies them with the convergent integrals $J_v(q)$.

If v' is a nonempty suffix of v , its reverse begins in 0. The corresponding coefficient of Z is simply $H_{\text{rev}(v')}(1)$: multiplication by $e^{-\ell_{e1}}$ only changes words beginning with 1. Taking the coefficient of v in $F(q)Z^{-1}$ proves (4.84). Since N was arbitrary, this proves every finite word identity. $\square$

4.10.2 The word formula and the depth bound

For a word w ending in 1, let K be its number of zeros. Replace each original 1 by 0, and replace each original 0 independently by either 0 or 1. Denote the resulting 2^K words by $\tau_A(w)$, where A records the zero positions replaced by 1. Every $\tau_A(w)$ ends in 0.

Theorem 4.24 (Complementary depth). *For $z \in D$ and every nonempty word w ending in 1,*

$$H_w(z) = (-1)^K \sum_A \sum_{\tau_A(w)=uv} (-1)^{|v|} H_u(q) H_{\text{rev}(v)}(1). \quad (4.85)$$

After trailing-zero normalization, this is a finite rational linear combination of terms

$$L^j \text{Li}_{\mathbf{a}}(q) \zeta(\mathbf{b}), \quad j + \text{wt}(\mathbf{a}) + \text{wt}(\mathbf{b}) = |w|, \quad \text{dep}(\mathbf{a}) + \text{dep}(\mathbf{b}) \leq K. \quad (4.86)$$

Nonempty zeta indices are convergent. Thus a one-variable polylogarithm of weight w and depth d has the stated reduction with $K = w - d$.

Proof. On $z < 0$, make the substitution $u = (1-t)^{-1}$ in every integration. Its pullbacks are

$$\frac{dt}{t} = -\frac{du}{u} - \frac{du}{1-u}, \quad \frac{dt}{1-t} = \frac{du}{u}. \quad (4.87)$$

The initial endpoint $t = 0$ becomes $u = 1$. Multilinearity gives $H_w(z) = (-1)^K \sum_A J_{\tau_A(w)}(q)$. Lemma 4.23 proves (4.85).

It remains to check the claimed normal form. The identity $H_v H_0 = H_{v \Pi_0}$ removes a trailing zero. If a word ends in exactly r zeros, its coefficient in the shuffle of its prefix with 0 is r ; all other words in that shuffle have fewer trailing zeros. Induction therefore expresses each $H_u(q)$ as a rational combination of $L^j H_{u'}(q)$ with u' empty or ending in 1. The operation preserves the number of 1 letters.

For an endpoint word beginning in 0, the same normalization preserves its initial 0 in every nonzero term with no logarithmic factor. Terms containing a positive power of $\log 1$ vanish. The surviving nonempty terms begin in 0 and end in 1, hence are convergent MZVs. In each split of $\tau_A(w)$ the total number of 1 letters in the two factors is $|A| \leq K$. This proves the depth bound and the weight identity. Finally continue analytically from $z < 0$ to D . $\square$

Corollary 4.25 (An argument-enlarged depth bound). *For $w \geq 2$, every one-variable MPL of weight w can be represented using nonlogarithmic factors of depth at most $\lfloor w/2 \rfloor$, allowing both the original argument z and $q = (1-z)^{-1}$, MZVs, and powers of L as coefficients. More precisely, use the original expression when $d \leq w/2$, and Theorem 4.24 otherwise. The all-one case is $L^w/w!$.*

This corollary is deliberately not phrased as a theorem about arbitrary multivariable MPLs, or as a reduction inside an unchanged root-of-unity basket. At $z = i$ the half-point q is not a root of unity. The theorem explains an argument-enlarged upper bound; it does not prove the absence or presence of new cyclotomic periods in a smaller comparison algebra.

For the next family put $F_r(z) = \text{Li}_{2,\{1\}^{r-1}}(z)$, as in the one-two formulas above. Their reciprocal-complementary form is

$$F_r(z) = \sum_{k=1}^{r+1} \frac{(-1)^k L^{r+1-k}}{(r+1-k)!} \text{Li}_k(q) + (-1)^r \zeta(r+1) - \frac{L^{r+1}}{(r+1)!}.$$

4.11 A double-polylogarithm formula for an all-weight family

The next formula addresses the first case beyond the classical ladder. It reduces the height-one family with initial index 3 to singles and doubles at q , irrespective of its original depth. Let

$$C_1(q) = 0, \quad C_k(q) = \sum_{a=1}^{k-1} \text{Li}_{a,k-a}(q) \quad (k \geq 2). \quad (4.88)$$

All MPLs on the right have the one-variable meaning (4.79).

Theorem 4.26 (Two-zero height-one identity). *For every $w \geq 3$ and $z \in D$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Li}_{3,\{1\}^{w-3}}(z) &= \frac{L^w}{w!} + \sum_{k=1}^w \frac{(-1)^k L^{w-k}}{(w-k)!} ((k-2) \text{Li}_k(q) + C_k(q)) \\ &\quad + (-1)^{w-1} \left((L + \text{Li}_1(q)) \zeta(w-1) + (w-2) \zeta(w) - \zeta(w-1, 1) \right). \end{aligned} \quad (4.89)$$

The right side has reduced depth at most two.

Proof. Write $D_q = q d/dq = d/dL$. Direct differentiation of the nested series, followed by continuation, gives

$$D_q C_k = C_{k-1} + \frac{q}{1-q} \text{Li}_{k-1} \quad (k \geq 2).$$

Put $V_k = (k-2) \text{Li}_k + C_k$, with $V_1 = -\text{Li}_1$. Then

$$D_q V_k = V_{k-1} + \frac{\text{Li}_{k-1}}{1-q} \quad (k \geq 2), \quad D_q V_1 = -\frac{q}{1-q}.$$

Differentiating the finite sum in (4.89) telescopes and yields

$$\frac{F_{w-2}(z) - (-1)^{w-2} \zeta(w-1)}{q-1}.$$

The derivative of the explicit $(L + \text{Li}_1(q)) \zeta(w-1)$ term supplies the missing constant term, because $D_q(L + \text{Li}_1(q)) = 1/(1-q)$. The derivative of the entire right side is therefore $F_{w-2}(z)/(q-1)$. The left side has the same derivative, since $d \text{Li}_{3,\{1\}^{w-3}}(z)/dz = F_{w-2}(z)/z$ and $dz/z = dL/(q-1)$.

For the endpoint constant, recall the convergent depth-two sum identity

$$\sum_{a=2}^{w-1} \zeta(a, w-a) = \zeta(w), \quad w \geq 3. \quad (4.90)$$

It follows, for example, by subtracting the shuffle and stuffle expansions of the once-regularized product $\zeta(1)\zeta(w-1)$: its common divergent term $\zeta(1, w-1)$ cancels, leaving precisely (4.90). Only one logarithmic divergence is involved, so no higher regularization correction enters. Equivalently one may use finite cutoffs and subtract the common harmonic-logarithmic part before taking the limit.

The convergent colored stuffle identity, for $0 < q < 1$, gives

$$\text{Li}_{1,w-1}(q) - \text{Li}_1(q)\zeta(w-1) = -\text{Li}_{w-1,1}(1, q) - \text{Li}_w(q).$$

The right side tends to $-\zeta(w-1, 1) - \zeta(w)$ by dominated convergence. Combining this with (4.90) yields

$$\lim_{q \rightarrow 1^-} (C_w(q) - \text{Li}_1(q)\zeta(w-1)) = -\zeta(w-1, 1).$$

All positive powers of L multiplying at most logarithmically singular terms vanish. The remaining constants in (4.89) cancel, so its right side tends to zero as $z \rightarrow 0^-$. The left side does too. Equality of derivatives and the endpoint limit proves the result; continue to D . $\square$

Remark 4.27 (The sum identity and the proof dependency). Equation (4.90) is the classical depth-two Euler sum formula, not a new conjecture assumed here. The same two-zero formula can also be obtained directly from Theorem 4.24 by expanding its two zero positions and normalizing trailing zeros. The supplied code verifies the agreement of these two independently specified formulas through weight twelve.

At weight six, (4.89) is a complete depth-two representation of $\text{Li}_{3,1,1,1}(i)$ and of $\text{Li}_{3,1,1,1}(\rho)$. In particular a depth-four index does not by itself identify a new depth-four period in the enlarged comparison algebra. The endpoint double is harmless as a named convergent constant; standard Euler reductions can simplify it further. For example,

$$\zeta(4, 1) = 2\zeta(5) - \zeta(2)\zeta(3), \quad \zeta(5, 1) = \frac{3}{4}\zeta(6) - \frac{1}{2}\zeta(3)^2.$$

These last simplifications are not required for the theorem.

4.12 The colored stuffle identity

Whenever the defining sums are absolutely convergent, sorting the two indices in a product proves

$$\text{Li}_a(x) \text{Li}_b(y) = \text{Li}_{a,b}(x, y) + \text{Li}_{b,a}(y, x) + \text{Li}_{a+b}(xy). \quad (4.91)$$

At conditionally convergent boundary points, Abel limits give the same identity when the limiting products and constituent series exist.

4.13 Gaussian doubles: closed forms

Write $\text{Li}_{a,b}$ at the three Gaussian base points beyond $(i, 1)$:

$$(i, i), \quad (-1, i), \quad (i, -1),$$

all generated to 700 digits by an accelerated evaluator (Section 12) and agreeing with Wolfram 15 to full precision. Under the level-4 complex conjugation $i \mapsto -i$ the imaginary parts are odd and the real parts even.

4.13.1 Family 1: the stuffle closed forms

Specializing (4.91) at the Gaussian points ($uv = -1$ at (i, i) ; $uv = -i$ at the mixed pair) gives a complete set of exact closed forms for the symmetric combinations:

$$\mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(i, i) + \mathrm{Li}_{b,a}(i, i) = \mathrm{Li}_a(i) \mathrm{Li}_b(i) - \mathrm{Li}_{a+b}(-1), \quad (4.92)$$

$$\mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(-1, i) + \mathrm{Li}_{b,a}(i, -1) = \mathrm{Li}_a(-1) \mathrm{Li}_b(i) - \mathrm{Li}_{a+b}(-i), \quad (4.93)$$

$$\mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(i, -1) + \mathrm{Li}_{b,a}(-1, i) = \mathrm{Li}_a(i) \mathrm{Li}_b(-1) - \mathrm{Li}_{a+b}(-i),$$

with the clean diagonal corollary

$$\mathrm{Li}_{a,a}(i, i) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathrm{Li}_a(i)^2 - \mathrm{Li}_{2a}(-1)). \quad (4.94)$$

Every single polylogarithm on the right is elementary in the level-4 vocabulary: $\mathrm{Im} \mathrm{Li}_n(i) = \beta(n)$ is the Dirichlet beta value, $\mathrm{Re} \mathrm{Li}_n(i)$ and $\mathrm{Li}_n(-1) = -\eta(n)$ are rational multiples of $\zeta(n)$ for $n \geq 2$ (or π^n at even n), and $\mathrm{Li}_n(-i) = \overline{\mathrm{Li}_n(i)}$. At $n = 1$, the real values are $\mathrm{Re} \mathrm{Li}_1(i) = -\log 2/2$ and $\mathrm{Li}_1(-1) = -\log 2$. So Family 1 reduces every symmetric and diagonal Gaussian double to single L -values in closed form.

Remark 4.28. The three stuffle identities (4.92)–(4.93) were checked against the stored 700-digit values to $\sim 10^{-692}$ for every admissible a, b , and the closed forms were confirmed symbolically and numerically by Wolfram 15 at low weight, including the weight-6 diagonal. Its exact homogeneous expression follows directly from stuffle:

$$\mathrm{Li}_{3,3}(i, i) = \frac{9}{2048}\zeta(3)^2 + \frac{47\pi^6}{1935360} - \frac{3i\pi^3\zeta(3)}{1024}.$$

Indeed $\mathrm{Li}_3(i) = (-3\zeta(3) + i\pi^3)/32$ and $\mathrm{Li}_6(-1) = -31\pi^6/30240$.

After the symmetric stuffle combinations have been removed, the remaining information is carried by $\mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(x, y) - \mathrm{Li}_{b,a}(y, x)$, exchanging both indices and colors. Equal indices alone do not force it to vanish at mixed points. The same-color diagonal is a special case.

Here is an exact counterexample entirely inside the manuscript's alphabet:

$$\Im(\mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(-1, i) - \mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(i, -1)) = \frac{\pi}{2} \log 2 - G = \int_0^1 \frac{\log(1+t^2)}{1+t^2} dt > 0. \quad (4.95)$$

To prove the first equality, differentiating the convergent defining series in the disk gives

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial x} \mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(x, y) = \frac{\mathrm{Li}_1(xy)}{1-x}.$$

Continuation along the segment to $x = -1$ is nonsingular, and hence

$$\Im \mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(-1, i) = \int_0^1 \frac{\arctan t}{1+t} dt.$$

Put $K = \int_0^1 \log(1+t)/(1+t^2) dt$. With $t = \tan \theta$,

$$K = \int_0^{\pi/4} \left(\frac{1}{2} \log 2 + \log \sin(\theta + \pi/4) - \log \cos \theta \right) d\theta = \frac{\pi}{8} \log 2.$$

The last two integrals cancel after reflection about $\pi/2$. Integration by parts now gives $\Im \mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(-1, i) = \pi \log 2/4 - K = \pi \log 2/8$. Stuffle and

$$\mathrm{Li}_1(-1) = -\log 2, \quad \mathrm{Li}_1(i) = -\frac{1}{2} \log 2 + \frac{\pi i}{4}, \quad \Im \mathrm{Li}_2(-i) = -G$$

give

$$\Im(\mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(-1, i) + \mathrm{Li}_{1,1}(i, -1)) = G - \frac{\pi}{4} \log 2.$$

Subtracting proves the first equality in (4.95); the second also follows directly by setting $t = \tan \theta$. Indeed,

$$\int_0^{\pi/4} \log \cos \theta \, d\theta = -\frac{\pi}{4} \log 2 + \frac{G}{2},$$

which follows from the sum and difference of the corresponding log-sine and log-cosine integrals: their difference is G , and their sum is $-\pi \log 2/2$ by the double-angle formula. Thus the displayed integral is $-2 \int_0^{\pi/4} \log \cos \theta \, d\theta$. Its integrand is positive away from zero. The difference is approximately 0.17282745097458205019574093418642286289514247590297.

4.13.2 Family 2: antisymmetric reductions to the $(i, 1)$ algebra

Against the basis of single-polylog monomials together with the $(i, 1)$ generators $g_{a,b} = \mathrm{Im} \, \mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(i, 1)$, $h_{a,b} = \mathrm{Re} \, \mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(i, 1)$, the *low-weight* antisymmetric parts reduce, each reduction a new closed-form identity found by integer-relation search and confirmed in Wolfram 15. A representative instance, with $\mu_n = \mathrm{Re} \, \mathrm{Li}_n(\frac{1+i}{2})$ and $\lambda_n = \mathrm{Im} \, \mathrm{Li}_n(\frac{1+i}{2})$:

$$\mathrm{Re}[\mathrm{Li}_{1,2}(i, i) - \mathrm{Li}_{2,1}(i, i)] = 3\zeta(3) - 4 \log 2 \, \mu_2 - \pi \lambda_2 - 4h_{1,1} \log 2 + 3h_{1,2}. \quad (4.96)$$

Such reductions exist at weights 2–4 at the mixed points and at weight 3 at (i, i) ; at higher weight the antisymmetric parts do not reduce *against the $(i, 1)$ basis alone*. To go further—and to learn how many are genuinely new—one needs the shuffle.

4.14 Gaussian doubles: the double-shuffle dimension

4.14.1 A cautionary integer-relation count

A first attempt to count the genuinely-new depth-2 directions proceeds by integer-relation search: test each antisymmetric part for membership in the span of the $(i, 1)$ generators and single-polylog products, and tabulate those that fail. Carried out at 700 digits, this reports **30** independent new directions through weight 6. The number is wrong. It is an artifact of the spurious scale: the genuine reductions are of large height, and against a basis of a hundred-odd atoms the search cannot see them. (Three searches against bases of 46, 55, and the $(i, 1)$ -plus-single set returned “dimensions” of 3, 6, and 30 respectively—all different, all wrong, the count *decreasing* as the basis grew and the ceiling fell.)

4.14.2 The shuffle, and the correct count

The shuffle settles it. The key relation is that the shuffle of a (-1) -polylogarithm with an i -polylogarithm produces (i, i) and $(-1, i)$ doubles, for instance

$$\mathrm{Li}_2(-1) \, \mathrm{Li}_2(i) = \mathrm{Li}_{2,2}(i, i) + 2 \mathrm{Li}_{3,1}(i, i) + \overline{\mathrm{Li}_{2,2}(-1, i)} + 2 \overline{\mathrm{Li}_{3,1}(-1, i)} \quad (4.97)$$

(verified to $\sim 10^{-694}$), whereas the *stuffle* of the same product produces the $(-1, i), (i, -1)$ doubles. Equating ties all three Gaussian points together. Collecting all 240 stuffle and shuffle relations from the products $\mathrm{Li}_p(s) \mathrm{Li}_q(t)$, $s, t \in \{i, -1, -i\}$, $2 \leq p + q \leq 6$, verifying each to $\sim 10^{-600}$, and computing the exact rational rank of the linear system on the doubles, modulo single polylogarithms and the $(i, 1)$ generators, gives:

weight	unknowns (Re+Im)	dim (stuffle only)	dim (double shuffle)
4	18	8	1
5	24	12	2
6	30	14	2
total		34	5

Observation 4.29. Modulo single polylogarithms and the $(i, 1)$ generators, the Gaussian double points (i, i) , $(-1, i)$, $(i, -1)$ contribute exactly **5** candidate depth-two generators through weight 6—one at weight 4, two at weight 5, two at weight 6. A representative basis is

$$\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_{3,1}(i, -1); \quad \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{3,2}(i, -1), \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{4,1}(i, -1); \quad \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_{4,2}(i, -1), \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_{5,1}(i, -1).$$

Every other Gaussian double of weight ≤ 6 is an explicit combination of these five, the $(i, 1)$ generators, and products of single L -values.

The rank is verified two ways: each relation reproduces its value to 10^{-600} , and the exact-rational rank is precision-independent. As a final gold-check at weight 4, fixing the single survivor $\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_{3,1}(i, -1)$ to its true value and solving the system predicts all other 17 weight-4 components to $\sim 10^{-692}$.

Remark 4.30 (the methodological moral). [Observation 4.29](#) corrects the integer-relation count of 30 by a factor of six. The reductions are exact consequences of the small-height double-shuffle generators, but the *net* reductions are of large height—so a search at a specified precision and coefficient bound can miss them. This is the recurring trap of high-precision experimental mathematics, here biting in the direction of *over*-stating independence. The exact-rank calculation determines the formal quotient by the supplied valid relations. It does not make an arithmetic-independence claim.

4.15 Triple sums and the scope of formal quotient dimensions

The word for $\operatorname{Li}_{a,b,c}(i, 1, 1)$ is $0^{a-1}(-i)0^{b-1}(-i)0^{c-1}(-i)$ in the outer-letter-first convention. Shuffle relations express products of lower-weight functions as sums of such triples. At weight six the source reports rank seven for thirteen relations on ten triple coordinates, leaving three formal coordinates represented by $(3, 1, 2)$, $(3, 2, 1)$, $(4, 1, 1)$. Rank seven means that seven coordinates can be eliminated using the chosen relations and the three remaining coordinates. It does not mean that seven particular triples are individually products, or that the remaining three numerical values are independent.

The source also claimed binomial dimensions $\binom{n}{p}$ for the actual depth filtration from a total Hilbert series $1/(1-2t)$. A total Hilbert series alone cannot determine a depth grading. A grading by the length of a chosen motivic word basis must first be identified with the filtration under discussion; moreover a motivic lower bound does not give a numerical lower bound without injectivity of the period map. We therefore make no unconditional claim that genuine numerical depth three first occurs at weight six. A rigorous reduction or obstruction for these specific triples is an open problem. Panzer’s parity theorem [\[33\]](#) supplies exact lower-depth conjugation combinations, but does not assert independence of the complementary components.

4.16 The Eisenstein analogue

Everything above has a level-3 counterpart at the cube roots of unity. Write $\rho = e^{2\pi i/3}$, so $\rho^2 = \bar{\rho}$.

4.16.1 Family 1, with an arithmetic twist

The stuffle closed forms read

$$\mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(\rho, \rho) + \mathrm{Li}_{b,a}(\rho, \rho) = \mathrm{Li}_a(\rho) \mathrm{Li}_b(\rho) - \mathrm{Li}_{a+b}(\rho^2), \quad (4.98)$$

$$\mathrm{Li}_{a,b}(\rho^2, \rho) + \mathrm{Li}_{b,a}(\rho, \rho^2) = \mathrm{Li}_a(\rho^2) \mathrm{Li}_b(\rho) - \zeta(a+b), \quad (4.99)$$

with the diagonal corollary $\mathrm{Li}_{a,a}(\rho, \rho) = \frac{1}{2}(\mathrm{Li}_a(\rho)^2 - \mathrm{Li}_{2a}(\rho^2))$. The arithmetic twist is in (4.99): because $\rho^2 \cdot \rho = \rho^3 = 1$, the colored tail degenerates to the *ordinary* zeta value $\zeta(a+b)$, not a level-3 value. The single cube-root L -values at $n \geq 2$ split cleanly under the distribution relation $\mathrm{Li}_n(\rho) + \mathrm{Li}_n(\rho^2) = (3^{1-n} - 1)\zeta(n)$:

$$\mathrm{Re} \mathrm{Li}_n(\rho) = \frac{1}{2}(3^{1-n} - 1)\zeta(n), \quad \mathrm{Im} \mathrm{Li}_n(\rho) = \mathrm{Sl}_n(2\pi/3), \quad (4.100)$$

At weight one, $\mathrm{Li}_1(\rho) = -\frac{1}{2}\log 3 + i\pi/6$. For the displayed higher-weight formula, $\mathrm{Sl}_n(\theta) = \sum_{k \geq 1} \sin(k\theta)/k^n$. The real part is a rational multiple of $\zeta(n)$; the sine series agrees with Cl_n at even weight and is elementary at rational angles at odd weight. Also $\mathrm{Cl}_2(2\pi/3) = 2V/3$, where $V = \mathrm{Cl}_2(\pi/3)$ is the Gieseking constant. All of (4.98)–(4.100) are confirmed in Wolfram 15.

4.16.2 The (ρ, ρ) frontier: one constant

Running the level-3 double shuffle as in Section 4.14—90 stuffle and shuffle relations from products $\mathrm{Li}_p(s) \mathrm{Li}_q(t)$, $s, t \in \{\rho, \rho^2\}$, each verified to $\sim 10^{-600}$, exact rational rank—collapses the (ρ, ρ) doubles still more sharply than the Gaussian:

weight	unknowns (Re+Im)	dim (stuffle only)	dim (double shuffle)
2	2	0	0
3	4	2	0
4	6	2	0
5	8	4	1
6	10	4	0
total		12	1

Observation 4.31. Modulo single polylogarithms and the $(\rho, 1)$ generators, the entire (ρ, ρ) family through weight 6 reduces to a *single* candidate depth-two generator— $\mathrm{Im} \mathrm{Li}_{3,2}(\rho, \rho)$, at weight 5—with weights 2, 3, 4 and 6 collapsing completely.

A gold-check at weight 5 fixes the survivor and predicts all seven other weight-5 components to $\sim 10^{-696}$. The pattern mirrors the Gaussian: there too the weight-5 survivors are imaginary $\mathrm{Li}_{3,2}/\mathrm{Li}_{4,1}$ directions.

Remark 4.32 (a genuine cube-root obstacle). The decisive shuffle $\mathrm{Li}_p(\rho^2) \mathrm{Li}_q(\rho) \rightarrow (\rho, \rho) + (\rho^2, \rho^2)$ lands only on points with $w = z_1 z_2 \neq 1$, so the computation never needs the mixed points $(\rho^2, \rho), (\rho, \rho^2)$, where $w = \rho^3 = 1$. Those points presented a numerical obstacle in the earlier evaluator: both the Lerch-plus-Wynn evaluator and a direct cumulative-sum evaluator stall there at ~ 8 digits—the period-three, non-oscillating tail defeats Wynn’s ε -algorithm, unlike the even-period $i, -1$ cases, which converge to full precision. Folding the mixed cube-root points in (for the *full* level-3 frontier) requires a period-three-aware accelerated evaluator, or Wolfram; the following mixed-point method addresses that computational gap.

4.17 Why the standard evaluator degenerates at $w = 1$

With the convention the nested-series definition, the accelerated evaluator of the article writes the inner tail as a Lerch transcendent and sums the *outer* series with an acceleration factor $w^n = (z_1 z_2)^n$. At the mixed points $w = 1$, that factor is identically 1: the oscillation Wynn’s ε -algorithm relies on disappears, leaving a bare period-three power-law tail that the algorithm cannot resolve past a handful of digits. Summing over the *larger* index instead keeps an oscillating factor $z_1^{n_1}$, but for $z_1 = \rho^2$ this is a *period-three* oscillation, and a plain ε -algorithm (tuned for geometric tails) again stalls.

4.18 A robust $w = 1$ evaluator

Two ingredients fix it.

(a) A smooth correction identity. Writing $l = n_1$ (the larger index) and splitting the inner partial sum $P(l) = \sum_{n < l} z_2^n / n^b = \text{Li}_b(z_2) - R(l)$ with tail $R(l) = \sum_{n \geq l} z_2^n / n^b = z_2^l \Phi(z_2, b, l)$ (Lerch Φ), one gets the exact identity

$$\boxed{\text{Li}_{a,b}(z_1, z_2) = \text{Li}_a(z_1) \text{Li}_b(z_2) - \sum_{l \geq 1} \frac{w^l}{l^a} \Phi(z_2, b, l)} \quad (4.101)$$

At $w = 1$ the correction summand $\Phi(z_2, b, l)/l^a$ is *smooth*—every oscillating factor $z_1^l z_2^l = w^l$ collapses to 1—with the clean asymptotic $\Phi(z_2, b, l) \sim \sum_{j \geq 0} \binom{-b}{j} c_j(z_2) l^{-b-j}$, where $c_0 = \frac{1}{1-z_2}$ and $c_{j \geq 1} = \text{Li}_{-j}(z_2)$ (rational in z_2). The subtle point—the source of a factor-of-one bug that cost five digits in a first draft—is that $c_0 = \sum_{k \geq 0} z_2^k = \frac{1}{1-z_2}$ is *not* $\text{Li}_0(z_2) = \frac{z_2}{1-z_2}$; they differ by exactly 1. This gives an Euler–Maclaurin tail in Hurwitz zetas, $\sum_{l > M} \Phi/l^a = \sum_j \binom{-b}{j} c_j \zeta(a+b+j, M+1)$, a fast and accurate cross-check at low to medium precision.

(b) Period-aware ρ -acceleration for production. For high precision the production evaluator sums the outer cumulative series directly, samples the partial sums at the common period $N = \text{lcm}(\text{ord } z_1, \text{ord } z_2)$ (so every oscillating factor realigns to 1 at the sample points), and accelerates the resulting smooth, power-law-convergent sequence with **Wynn’s ρ -algorithm**—the algebraic-convergence counterpart of the ε -algorithm. The ρ -algorithm yields empirical convergence on the tested families; precision inflation and independent comparison are needed to assess its conditioning (`mpl_w1.py`).

The general certified evaluators and their geometric bounds are developed in Chapter 5. The historical Lerch evaluator above remains a useful independent comparison.

4.19 Validation

The evaluator is checked by three independent, Wolfram-free routes plus one Wolfram cross-check.

1. **Exact symmetric closed form** (single polylogs only, an entirely separate code path):

$$\text{Li}_{a,b}(\rho^2, \rho) + \text{Li}_{b,a}(\rho, \rho^2) = \text{Li}_a(\rho^2) \text{Li}_b(\rho) - \zeta(a+b), \quad (4.102)$$

and the Gaussian analogue $\text{Li}_{a,b}(i, -i) + \text{Li}_{b,a}(-i, i) = \text{Li}_a(i) \text{Li}_b(-i) - \zeta(a+b)$. (The collision term is $\text{Li}_{a+b}(z_1 z_2) = \text{Li}_{a+b}(1) = \zeta(a+b)$.)

2. **Conjugation** $\text{Li}_{a,b}(\rho, \rho^2) = \overline{\text{Li}_{a,b}(\rho^2, \rho)}$.
3. **Two independent summation methods**—the ρ -accelerated cumulative sum and the Euler–Maclaurin smooth-correction series—agree to full working precision.
4. **Wolfram 15 MultiplePolyLog** at moderate precision.

All four agree; the symmetric closed form (4.102) holds to the full generated precision ($\sim 10^{-500}$) for every (a, b) .

4.20 Closed forms for the Eisenstein mixed-point values

With 500-digit values in hand, an integer-relation (PSLQ/LLL) search against the level-3 basis—monomials in the single L -values $\{\pi, \log 3, \zeta(3), \zeta(5), \text{Cl}_2(\frac{2\pi}{3}), \text{Cl}_4(\frac{2\pi}{3}), \text{Cl}_6(\frac{2\pi}{3})\}$ times the $(\rho, 1)$ generators $g_{a,b} = \text{Im Li}_{a,b}(\rho, 1)$, $h_{a,b} = \text{Re Li}_{a,b}(\rho, 1)$, and the lone (ρ, ρ) double-shuffle survivor $\text{Im Li}_{3,2}(\rho, \rho)$ —**reduces every mixed value through weight 4, and every weight-5 imaginary part**, to explicit closed forms (each canary-clean, height ≤ 10 , re-verified to 10^{-425} against the *complete* weight-graded basis). The two simplest:

$$\text{Im Li}_{1,1}(\rho^2, \rho) = -(\text{Cl}_2(\frac{2\pi}{3}) + \text{Im Li}_{1,1}(\rho, 1)), \quad \text{Re Li}_{1,1}(\rho^2, \rho) = 5 \text{Re Li}_{1,1}(\rho, 1) - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 3. \quad (4.103)$$

(The full list of ~ 16 reductions is in `harvest_eis_mixed.py`.) The original weight-five real and weight-six searches failed in their selected baskets. The exact inverse-color reduction below supersedes the interpretation of that failure as a new mixed-point obstruction.

4.21 Inverse colors: the exact reduction that the searches missed

The numerical evaluator above made the mixed points accessible, but its failed relation searches did not identify the correct quotient. An exact partial-fraction argument now proves that inverse-color doubles add no directions relative to the one-direction family and single-value products. This supersedes the earlier mixed-point candidate counts at weights five and six, in both the Gaussian and Eisenstein cases.

Put $M_{a,b}(z) = \text{Li}_{a,b}(z, z^{-1})$ and $w = a + b$. We allow $0 < |z| < 1$, and $|z| = 1, z \neq 1$, with positive integers a, b . Boundary sums use the stated outer-index order. They converge absolutely if $a \geq 2$. For $a = 1$, the inner colored harmonic sum equals its limit plus $O(n^{-b})$; the outer sum is therefore a convergent oscillatory series plus an absolutely convergent remainder.

Theorem 4.33 (All-weight inverse-argument reduction). *In this domain,*

$$\begin{aligned} M_{a,b}(z) &= (-1)^{b+1} \sum_{j=1}^a \binom{w-j-1}{b-1} \text{Li}_{w-j,j}(z, 1) + (-1)^{b+1} \binom{w-1}{b} \text{Li}_w(z) \\ &\quad + \sum_{j=2}^b (-1)^{b-j} \binom{w-j-1}{a-1} \zeta(j) \text{Li}_{w-j}(z) \\ &\quad + (-1)^b \sum_{j=2}^a \binom{w-j-1}{b-1} \zeta(j) \text{Li}_{w-j}(z). \end{aligned} \quad (4.104)$$

Empty sums are zero. In particular, $F_a = M_{a,1}$ satisfies

$$F_a(z) = a \text{Li}_{a+1}(z) + \sum_{j=1}^a \text{Li}_{a+1-j,j}(z, 1) - \sum_{j=2}^a \zeta(j) \text{Li}_{a+1-j}(z). \quad (4.105)$$

Proof. Set $h = n - m$. Principal parts at $m = 0, -h$ give

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{1}{m^b(m+h)^a} &= \sum_{j=1}^b \frac{(-1)^{b-j} \binom{w-j-1}{a-1}}{h^{w-j} m^j} \\ &\quad + (-1)^b \sum_{j=1}^a \frac{\binom{w-j-1}{b-1}}{h^{w-j} (m+h)^j}. \end{aligned} \quad (4.106)$$

Indeed, the difference has no poles and tends to zero at infinity. The $j = 1$ coefficients are opposite; their sum over m is finite because $\sum_{m \geq 1} (1/m - 1/(m+h)) = H_h$. For $j \geq 2$, the shifted sum is $\zeta(j) - H_h^{(j)}$. Consequently

$$\begin{aligned} c_h := \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{1}{m^b(m+h)^a} &= (-1)^{b+1} \sum_{j=1}^a \binom{w-j-1}{b-1} \frac{H_h^{(j)}}{h^{w-j}} \\ &\quad + \sum_{j=2}^b (-1)^{b-j} \binom{w-j-1}{a-1} \frac{\zeta(j)}{h^{w-j}} + (-1)^b \sum_{j=2}^a \binom{w-j-1}{b-1} \frac{\zeta(j)}{h^{w-j}}. \end{aligned}$$

Multiply by z^h , sum, and use

$$\sum_{h \geq 1} \frac{z^h H_h^{(j)}}{h^{w-j}} = \text{Li}_{w-j,j}(z, 1) + \text{Li}_w(z), \quad \sum_{j=1}^a \binom{w-j-1}{b-1} = \binom{w-1}{b}.$$

For $|z| < 1$ these operations are absolute.

To justify the boundary even when $a = 1$, let O_N be the original sum over $n \leq N$ and $D_N = \sum_{h=1}^{N-1} z^h c_h$. Partial summation gives

$$\left| \sum_{h=h_0}^{h_1} \frac{z^h}{(m+h)^a} \right| \leq \frac{4}{|1-z|(m+h_0)^a}.$$

Splitting the discrepancy at $m = N$ now yields

$$|D_N - O_N| \leq \frac{4}{|1-z|} \left(N^{-a} H_N^{(b)} + \sum_{m > N} m^{-a-b} \right) \rightarrow 0.$$

The coefficients c_h decrease to zero, the latter by dominated convergence with majorant m^{-a-b} . Dirichlet's test proves convergence of $\sum z^h c_h$. The one-direction doubles on the right also converge. This proves the identity in the original boundary convention. $\square$

Corollary 4.34 (The mixed quotient is zero). *Let $\mathcal{A}_w(z)$ be the $\mathbb{Q}$ -span of*

$$\text{Li}_{r,w-r}(z, 1) \ (1 \leq r < w), \quad \text{Li}_w(z), \quad \zeta(j) \text{Li}_{w-j}(z) \ (2 \leq j < w).$$

Every $M_{a,b}(z)$ of weight w belongs to $\mathcal{A}_w(z)$. Adding the mixed values contributes zero dimension modulo this space.

At $z = i$, this is the Gaussian family already used in the report. At $z = \omega^2$, the one-direction values are conjugates of its $(\omega, 1)$ values, whose real and imaginary parts it includes. Thus the proposed additional mixed directions disappear at every weight. The result concerns inverse-color pairs, and does not assert that all colored double polylogarithms reduce to one direction.

4.21.1 An independent integral representation

Proposition 4.35. *In the same domain,*

$$M_{a,b}(z) = \frac{z}{(a-1)!} \int_0^1 \frac{(-\log t)^{a-1} \text{Li}_b(t)}{1-zt} dt, \quad (4.107)$$

$$\text{Li}_{a,b}(z, 1) = \frac{z}{(a-1)!} \int_0^1 \frac{(-\log t)^{a-1} \text{Li}_b(z t)}{1-zt} dt. \quad (4.108)$$

Proof. Insert $n^{-a} = (a-1)!^{-1} \int_0^1 (-\log t)^{a-1} t^{n-1} dt$. The $h = n - m$ geometric sum gives $zt/(1-zt)$; the m -sum gives $\text{Li}_b(t)$ or $\text{Li}_b(z t)$. At a fixed boundary point $z \neq 1$, the denominator is bounded away from zero on $[0, 1]$, and the possible logarithmic endpoint singularities are integrable. Dominated convergence and the preceding boundary argument complete the proof. $\square$

These formulas supply independent numerical checks without the power-law acceleration problem at $z_1 z_2 = 1$. Quadrature itself is not a rigorous certificate unless its numerical error is enclosed.

4.21.2 The mixed parity component reduces to single values

Panzer's theorem predicts lower depth for the real component at odd weight and the imaginary component at even weight [33]. Here is a direct proof for the mixed F_a family.

Theorem 4.36 (Mixed parity formulas). *For $|z| = 1, z \neq 1$ and $m \geq 1$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Re } F_{2m}(z) &= \frac{2m+1}{2} \text{Re } \text{Li}_{2m+1}(z) - \sum_{j=1}^m \zeta(2j) \text{Re } \text{Li}_{2m+1-2j}(z) \\ &\quad - \frac{1}{2} \zeta(2m+1) + \text{Re } \text{Li}_{2m}(z) \text{Re } \text{Li}_1(z). \end{aligned} \quad (4.109)$$

For $m \geq 0$,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Im } F_{2m+1}(z) &= (m+1) \text{Im } \text{Li}_{2m+2}(z) - \sum_{j=1}^m \zeta(2j) \text{Im } \text{Li}_{2m+2-2j}(z) \\ &\quad + \text{Im } \text{Li}_{2m+1}(z) \text{Re } \text{Li}_1(z). \end{aligned} \quad (4.110)$$

Proof. For $a \geq 2$, set $\mathcal{B}_a(z) = -\text{Li}_a(z) - (-1)^a \text{Li}_a(z^{-1})$. The Fourier series $-\mathcal{B}_a(z) = \sum_{n \neq 0} z^n / n^a$ is absolutely summable, while $\text{Li}_1(z^{-1}) = \sum_{\ell \geq 1} z^{-\ell} / \ell$ belongs to L^2 on the circle. Their product has positive h -th coefficient $c_h = \sum_{\ell \geq 1} [\ell(\ell+h)^a]^{-1}$, constant coefficient $\zeta(a+1)$, and negative h -th coefficient

$$q_{-h} = \sum_{\ell \geq 1, \ell \neq h} \frac{1}{\ell(\ell-h)^a}.$$

The difference $q_{-h} - (-1)^a c_h$ is

$$\sum_{\ell \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0, h\}} \frac{1}{\ell(\ell-h)^a} = (-1)^a \left[2 \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor a/2 \rfloor} \frac{\zeta(2j)}{h^{a+1-2j}} - \frac{a+1}{h^{a+1}} \right]. \quad (4.111)$$

To check this absolutely convergent bilateral sum, use

$$\frac{1}{\ell(\ell-h)^a} = \frac{1}{(-h)^a \ell} - \sum_{r=1}^a \frac{1}{(-h)^{a+1-r} (\ell-h)^r}.$$

Symmetric summation of the $r = 1$ terms gives respectively $-1/h$ and $1/h$. For $r \geq 2$, the shifted sum is $(1 + (-1)^r)\zeta(r) - (-h)^{-r}$. Substitution gives (4.111). Comparing all Fourier coefficients now gives

$$F_a(z) + (-1)^a F_a(z^{-1}) = (-1)^a \left[(a+1) \text{Li}_{a+1}(z^{-1}) - 2 \sum_{j=1}^{\lfloor a/2 \rfloor} \zeta(2j) \text{Li}_{a+1-2j}(z^{-1}) \right] - \zeta(a+1) - \text{Li}_1(z^{-1}) \mathcal{B}_a(z). \quad (4.112)$$

The equality holds first in L^2 , then pointwise by continuity away from $z = 1$. Real parts for even a , and imaginary parts for odd a , give the claims. The remaining case $a = 1$ follows from $F_1(z) = \text{Li}_2(z) + \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_1(z)^2$, itself a consequence of (4.105) and the elementary shuffle identity. $\square$

4.21.3 Four explicit replacements for the claimed survivors

Corollary 4.37. *The four highlighted mixed-point constants satisfy*

$$\text{Re Li}_{4,1}(i, -i) = -\frac{587}{1024}\zeta(5) + \frac{3}{32}\zeta(2)\zeta(3) + \frac{135}{256}\zeta(4)\log 2, \quad (4.113)$$

$$\text{Im Li}_{5,1}(i, -i) = 3\beta(6) - \zeta(2)\beta(4) - \zeta(4)G - \frac{5\pi^5 \log 2}{3072}, \quad (4.114)$$

$$\text{Re Li}_{4,1}(\omega^2, \omega) = -\frac{281}{162}\zeta(5) + \frac{4}{9}\zeta(2)\zeta(3) + \frac{20}{27}\zeta(4)\log 3, \quad (4.115)$$

$$\text{Im Li}_{5,1}(\omega^2, \omega) = -3C_6 + \zeta(2)C_4 + \zeta(4)C_2 + \frac{\pi^5 \log 3}{729}. \quad (4.116)$$

Proof. Use Theorem 4.36 with $m = 2$, together with

$$\text{Re Li}_s(i) = -2^{-s}(1 - 2^{1-s})\zeta(s), \quad \text{Re Li}_s(\omega) = \frac{3^{1-s} - 1}{2}\zeta(s) \quad (s > 1),$$

and

$$\text{Re Li}_1(i) = -\frac{1}{2}\log 2, \quad \text{Re Li}_1(\omega) = -\frac{1}{2}\log 3, \quad \text{Im Li}_5(i) = \frac{5\pi^5}{1536}, \quad \text{Im Li}_5(\omega) = \frac{2\pi^5}{729}.$$

The real identities follow by residue-class splitting; the imaginary fifth-order values follow from the odd-beta and Bernoulli Fourier formulas, with $B_5(1/3) = -5/243$. Conjugation changes the sign of imaginary parts at ω^2 . $\square$

The four values, in the displayed order, are approximately

$$\begin{array}{ll} -0.01342026735728779, & 0.03269424445221378, \\ -0.03903921845650667, & -0.02533938136807792. \end{array}$$

Their right sides already belong to the report's listed single-value bases. Its `thm:parallel` is therefore false in the printed convention. The evaluator scripts and value stores cited by that report were not imported into ProveIt, so their precise failure cannot be diagnosed from the available files. Replace the survivor claims by Theorem 4.33 and Corollary 4.37, and recompute any dimension conclusions that depended on the proposed new directions.

4.22 Mixed endpoints and all-weight cyclotomic product quotients

Put $A_{a,b} = \text{Im Li}_{a,b}(i, i)$ and $K_{a,b} = \text{Im Li}_{a,b}(i, -1)$; retain $g_{a,b}$ and S_p as above. The all-exponent endpoint identity relates the mixed family to the same-color family before any period-independence question is asked.

4.22.1 An all-exponent mixed endpoint identity

Theorem 4.38 (Gaussian mixed endpoint). *For every integer $p \geq 1$,*

$$K_{p,1} + (-1)^{p-1} A_{1,p} = \beta(p+1) - 2 \log 2 \beta(p) + \sum_{j=2}^p (-1)^j \eta(j) \beta(p+1-j). \quad (4.117)$$

Moreover,

$$S_p = g_{p,1} + K_{p,1}. \quad (4.118)$$

Proof. All the boundary values used here converge. First-index-one values with first argument i can be obtained by Dirichlet's test or radial Abel limits. The shuffle and stuffle identities may therefore be justified by convergent iterated integrals and Abel limiting.

Fix $w = p + 1$, and define homogeneous generating polynomials of degree $w - 2$:

$$\mathcal{A}(X, Y) = \sum_{a+b=w} A_{a,b} X^{a-1} Y^{b-1}, \quad \mathcal{K}(X, Y) = \sum_{a+b=w} K_{a,b} X^{a-1} Y^{b-1}.$$

Let $\mathcal{V}$ denote the same polynomial for $\text{Im Li}_{a,b}(-1, i)$, and put

$$P(X, Y) = \sum_{a+b=w} \text{Im}[\text{Li}_a(-1) \text{Li}_b(i)] X^{a-1} Y^{b-1}, \quad H(X, Y) = \sum_{a+b=w} X^{a-1} Y^{b-1}.$$

Stuffle and shuffle respectively give

$$\mathcal{V}(X, Y) + \mathcal{K}(Y, X) = P(X, Y) + \beta(w) H(X, Y),$$

$$\mathcal{A}(X + Y, X) - \mathcal{V}(X + Y, Y) = P(X, Y).$$

The collision term in the first equation is $-\text{Im Li}_w(-i) = \beta(w)$. Eliminating $\mathcal{V}$ yields

$$\mathcal{K}(U, V) = P(V - U, U) + P(V, U) + \beta(w) H(V, U) - \mathcal{A}(V, V - U).$$

Set $V = 0$ and compare coefficients of U^{w-2} . The evaluation $\text{Li}_j(-1) = -\eta(j)$ gives (4.117), including the two occurrences of $-\log 2 \beta(p)$.

For (4.118), taking imaginary parts of the outer index in $\text{Li}_{p,1}(i, 1) + \text{Li}_{p,1}(i, -1)$ retains indices $2n + 1$, with sign $(-1)^n$. Their inner sum is

$$\sum_{m=1}^{2n} \frac{1 + (-1)^m}{m} = H_n.$$

Absolute convergence proves the result directly for $p > 1$. An Abel limit gives the endpoint $p = 1$. $\square$

At $p = 4$ this specializes to

$$K_{4,1} = A_{1,4} + \frac{191\pi^5}{23040} - \frac{3}{4} G\zeta(3) - 2\beta(4) \log 2. \quad (4.119)$$

4.22.2 A precisely defined formal presentation

Fix a level $L = 3$ or 4 and a weight $w \geq 2$. Let $\omega = e^{2\pi i/L}$. Introduce rational formal symbols

$$D_a(r, s) \quad (1 \leq a < w, \quad r, s \in \mathbb{Z}/L\mathbb{Z})$$

for imaginary parts of $\text{Li}_{a, w-a}(\omega^r, \omega^s)$. Impose conjugation $D_a(-r, -s) = -D_a(r, s)$. Symbols fixed by this involution vanish. Put all single values and imaginary parts of products of two single values in the background, and also set $D_a(1, 0) = 0$. The latter is precisely quotienting by the chosen g -family.

The only further rows imposed are, for $p + q = w$,

$$D_p(r, s) + D_q(s, r) = 0, \quad (4.120)$$

$$\sum_{j=0}^{p-1} \binom{q+j-1}{j} D_{q+j}(s, r-s) + \sum_{j=0}^{q-1} \binom{p+j-1}{j} D_{p+j}(r, s-r) = 0. \quad (4.121)$$

They are the stuffle and shuffle rows of two single values, with their one-leading-one regularizations. A regularized product involving the real parameter T belongs to the background. At $w = 2$, the only two-divergent-factor correction is real and disappears on taking imaginary parts. Call the resulting quotient $V_{L,w}$.

This is *not* the full cyclotomic double-shuffle algebra. Products involving a depth-two factor, relations lifted through higher depths, additional functional equations, and motivic period assertions have not been imposed. In particular, Zhao's standard relations [77] are substantially broader than this presentation. The theorem below computes $V_{L,w}$, not a dimension of actual numbers.

For a scalar assignment to the symbols, introduce

$$\mathcal{F}^{r,s}(X, Y) = \sum_{a=1}^{w-1} D_a(r, s) X^{a-1} Y^{w-a-1}.$$

The conditions that the assignment annihilate all rows are exactly

$$\mathcal{F}^{r,s}(X, Y) + \mathcal{F}^{s,r}(Y, X) = 0, \quad (4.122)$$

$$\mathcal{F}^{s, r-s}(X + Y, X) + \mathcal{F}^{r, s-r}(X + Y, Y) = 0. \quad (4.123)$$

These follow by comparing binomial coefficients after substitution. They describe the dual of $V_{L,w}$, so their solution dimension is the required quotient dimension.

4.22.3 All-weight dimension theorems

Theorem 4.39 (Level four). *The formal quotient satisfies*

$$\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} V_{4,w} = \begin{cases} 0, & w \text{ even}, \\ (w-1)/2, & w \text{ odd}. \end{cases} \quad \sum_{w \geq 2} \dim V_{4,w} t^w = \frac{t^3}{(1-t^2)^2}.$$

At odd weight, its dual is parameterized by arbitrary antisymmetric homogeneous polynomials of degree $w - 2$.

Proof. Up to conjugation, the six color pairs are $(0, 1), (1, 0), (1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 1)$. Write their polynomials as U, G, A, K, M, V , respectively, and let $n = w - 2$. The background condition gives $G = 0$; stuffle gives

$$U = 0, \quad A(Y, X) = -A(X, Y), \quad V(X, Y) = -K(Y, X), \quad M(Y, X) = M(X, Y).$$

The shuffle with colors $(1, 0)$ forces $M = 0$. The shuffle with colors $(2, 1)$ gives

$$A(X + Y, X) + K(Y, X + Y) = 0,$$

hence $K(X, Y) = -A(Y, Y - X)$. The shuffle with colors $(1, 3)$ is $K(X, Y) = K(X, X - Y)$. After substitution and antisymmetry this condition is $A = (-1)^{n+1}A$.

For even n all polynomials therefore vanish. For odd n , any antisymmetric A , with K, V as above and $U = G = M = 0$, satisfies the rows. To check exhaustiveness, the unordered color classes up to conjugation are

$$(0, 0), (0, 1), (0, 2), (1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 2).$$

The real classes vanish, and the remaining classes are precisely the conditions just used, together with their transposes. Thus there are no unexamined rows. A basis for A at odd w is

$$X^{a-1}Y^{w-a-1} - X^{w-a-1}Y^{a-1}, \quad 1 \leq a \leq (w-1)/2.$$

Counting these basis vectors and summing over odd weights proves the formulas. $\square$

Theorem 4.40 (Level three). *The formal quotient satisfies*

$$\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} V_{3,w} = \begin{cases} 0, & w \text{ even}, \\ \lfloor (w+1)/6 \rfloor, & w \text{ odd}, \end{cases} \quad \sum_{w \geq 2} \dim V_{3,w} t^w = \frac{t^5}{(1-t^2)(1-t^6)}.$$

Writing $\Delta = XY(X - Y)$, $Q = X^2 - XY + Y^2$, the dual is parameterized by the homogeneous polynomials

$$A(X, Y) = \Delta P(Q, \Delta^2)$$

of degree $w - 2$.

Proof. Up to conjugation the four pairs are $(0, 1), (1, 0), (1, 1), (1, 2)$. As before the first two vanish and the shuffle with a zeta factor kills the inverse-argument polynomial. The remaining polynomial A satisfies exactly

$$A(Y, X) = -A(X, Y), \quad A(X, X - Y) = A(X, Y).$$

Antisymmetry implies divisibility by $X - Y$; the second symmetry then forces divisibility by Y , and antisymmetry forces divisibility by X . Hence $A = \Delta B$. The polynomial Δ has the same two transformation signs as A , so B is invariant under swapping X, Y and under $(X, Y) \mapsto (X, X - Y)$.

On the plane $a + b + c = 0$, with $(a, b, c) = (X, -Y, Y - X)$, the second transformation swaps b, c ; the first is global negation followed by the transposition of a, b . The generated group contains global negation, obtained by cubing the product, and all permutations. The elementary symmetric-polynomial theorem therefore identifies its invariant ring with

$$\mathbb{Q}[e_2, e_3^2] = \mathbb{Q}[Q, \Delta^2].$$

Conversely every $\Delta P(Q, \Delta^2)$ has the required symmetries, and direct substitution verifies all the original color rows. Counting monomials of degrees $3 + 2a + 6b = w - 2$ gives the result. Explicitly, at odd $w \geq 5$ a basis is

$$\Delta^{2b+1} Q^{(w-5)/2-3b}, \quad 0 \leq b \leq \lfloor (w-5)/6 \rfloor.$$

$\square$

For comparison, the exact dimensions at the first few odd weights are

w	3	5	7	9	11	13	15
$\dim V_{3,w}$	0	1	1	1	2	2	2
$\dim V_{4,w}$	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

and all even-weight dimensions are zero. The exact matrix script checks both formulas through weight 16, including that the displayed polynomial bases annihilate every raw row and have the stated rank.

4.22.4 A separating functional and the scope of the S4 proof

At every odd weight $w \geq 3$, choose $A(X, Y) = (Y - X)^{w-2}$ in the level-four theorem. Then $K(X, Y) = X^{w-2}$, $V(X, Y) = -Y^{w-2}$. This gives a rational linear functional ℓ that annihilates every defining row and every background value:

$$\begin{aligned}\ell(D_a(1, 1)) &= (-1)^{a+1} \binom{w-2}{a-1}, \\ \ell(D_{w-1}(1, 2)) &= 1, \quad \ell(D_1(2, 1)) = -1.\end{aligned}\tag{4.124}$$

All other entries vanish, apart from conjugates with opposite signs.

At weight five its nonzero entries are particularly transparent:

symbol	$A_{1,4}$	$A_{2,3}$	$A_{3,2}$	$A_{4,1}$	$\text{Im Li}_{1,4}(-1, i)$	$K_{4,1}$
ℓ	1	-3	3	-1	-1	1

The polynomial proof verifies all weights; the delivered certificate also checks this six-entry vector against every exact weight-five row.

The now-proved identity of Theorem 4.8 has an informative image in this restricted presentation.

The exact identity (4.119) makes this equivalent to

$$161280A_{1,4} + 69120(g_{4,1} + g_{3,2} + 3g_{2,3}) + 617\pi^5 - 101520G\zeta(3) = 0.\tag{4.125}$$

The functional ℓ sends its left side to 161280. Consequently this relation does not follow from (4.120)–(4.121) and the stated background alone. This is an exact obstruction to a specific proof strategy. The convergent octahedral relation used in its proof supplies precisely information outside this presentation.

4.22.5 A new weight-seven candidate

Proposition 4.41 (Two weight-seven coordinate baskets). *The Gaussian doubles satisfy the exact identity*

$$\begin{aligned}g_{2,5} &= 30g_{6,1} + 15g_{5,2} + 5g_{4,3} - \frac{15}{512}G\zeta(5) \\ &\quad + \frac{3}{16}\beta(4)\zeta(3) - \frac{11\pi^7}{368640}.\end{aligned}\tag{4.126}$$

Proof. The convergent same-point shuffles give

$$\begin{aligned}g_{2,5} + 2g_{3,4} + 3g_{4,3} + 5g_{5,2} + 10g_{6,1} &= \text{Im}(\text{Li}_2(i) \text{Li}_5(i)), \\ g_{3,4} + 4g_{4,3} + 10g_{5,2} + 20g_{6,1} &= \text{Im}(\text{Li}_3(i) \text{Li}_4(i)).\end{aligned}$$

Subtract twice the second row from the first and use

$$\begin{aligned}\operatorname{Im}(\operatorname{Li}_2(i) \operatorname{Li}_5(i)) &= -\frac{15}{512}G\zeta(5) - \frac{5\pi^7}{73728}, \\ \operatorname{Im}(\operatorname{Li}_3(i) \operatorname{Li}_4(i)) &= -\frac{3}{32}\beta(4)\zeta(3) - \frac{7\pi^7}{368640}.\end{aligned}$$

These product evaluations follow from the ordinary depth-one fourth-root formulas. The coefficient of $g_{3,4}$ cancels, giving the identity. $\square$

The new Cayley report's proposed formula

$$\begin{aligned}S_6 &= -\frac{12334}{527}g_{6,1} - \frac{384}{31}g_{5,2} - \frac{2136}{527}g_{4,3} + \frac{3179\pi^7}{5713920} \\ &\quad - \frac{801}{2108}\beta(4)\zeta(3) - 2\beta(6)\log 2\end{aligned}$$

is therefore exactly the same conjecture as the following earlier form, written in a different Gaussian basket. If the two residuals mean left side minus right side, their difference is $-128/155$ times the zero relation obtained by moving (4.126) to the left. The exact two-row check has zero rational residual. This proves equivalence of the candidates, not the conjectured vanishing of either one.

Conjecture 4.42 (A reduction for S_6). *With the same definitions,*

$$\begin{aligned}S_6 &= \frac{722}{527}g_{6,1} + \frac{40}{527}g_{4,3} - \frac{128}{155}g_{2,5} + \frac{15191}{28569600}\pi^7 \\ &\quad - \frac{3}{124}G\zeta(5) - \frac{2373}{10540}\beta(4)\zeta(3) - 2\beta(6)\log 2.\end{aligned}\tag{4.127}$$

The candidate was found in the ordered basket

$$(S_6, g_{6,1}, g_{4,3}, g_{2,5}, \pi^7, G\zeta(5), \beta(4)\zeta(3), \beta(6)\log 2).$$

Its primitive integer relation vector is

$$\begin{aligned}(485683200, -665395200, -36864000, 401080320, \\ -258247, 11750400, 109347840, 971366400).\end{aligned}$$

A 100-digit search used coefficient bound 10^{12} and tolerance 10^{-90} . After the coefficients were frozen, reevaluation by Mellin integrals at 220 working digits gave an integer-normalized residual of approximately -2.315×10^{-213} . An independent Euler transformation of the defining alternating series, using 900 terms and 300 working digits, gave approximately 2.854×10^{-263} . The script records the full values and the exact integer vector. These are numerical evidence, not a proof or an interval certificate.

For the second method, the defining series are

$$g_{a,b} = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n H_{2n}^{(b)}}{(2n+1)^a}, \quad H_m^{(b)} = \sum_{j=1}^m j^{-b},$$

and the analogous series with H_n for S_6 . Thus the second evaluation does not reuse the discovery integral. Last transformed terms are recorded as diagnostics; their small size alone is not asserted to bound the complete tail.

The weight-seven functional (4.124) sends the integer-normalized candidate to 485683200. Its proof therefore also requires information beyond the restricted single-product presentation. The S4 certificate suggests seeking a corresponding weight-seven functional equation for (4.127), with the nonzero functional serving as a check that the missing relation has actually been introduced.

4.23 Harmonic index, reflection and certified asymptotics

The first-index sum S_p is part of a larger family. Here the harmonic index measures the displayed nesting length, not the minimal arithmetic or motivic depth. The same beta kernel gives reflection identities, signed truncation certificates and a joint index–exponent transition. These are analytic consequences of a positive kernel, and therefore remain useful independently of unresolved period-independence questions.

4.24 The harmonic-index family and its integral representation

Definition 4.43. For integers $n, r \geq 0$, put

$$e_r(n) = [u^r] \prod_{j=1}^n \left(1 + \frac{u}{j}\right), \quad e_0(n) = 1. \quad (4.128)$$

Thus $e_r(n) = 0$ for $n < r$, $e_1(n) = H_n$, and $e_2(n) = (H_n^2 - H_n^{(2)})/2$. For real $a, p > 0$, define

$$T_{p,r}(a) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n e_r(n)}{(n+a)^p}, \quad S_{p,r} = 2^{-p} T_{p,r}(1/2). \quad (4.129)$$

The original S_p is $S_{p,1}$, while $S_{p,0} = \beta(p)$.

Lemma 4.44 (Convergence). For fixed $r \geq 0$ and $a, p > 0$, the series (4.129) converges. It converges absolutely for $p > 1$.

Proof. The bound $e_r(n) \leq H_n^r/r!$ proves absolute convergence for $p > 1$ and convergence of the summand magnitude to zero for every $p > 0$. For eventual monotonicity, when $r \geq 1$ and $n \geq r$, counting each r -element subset in r ways gives

$$r e_r(n) = \sum_{|A|=r-1} \left(\prod_{j \in A} \frac{1}{j} \right) \left(H_n - \sum_{j \in A} \frac{1}{j} \right) \geq (H_n - H_{r-1}) e_{r-1}(n).$$

Together with $e_r(n+1) = e_r(n) + e_{r-1}(n)/(n+1)$, this shows that the logarithm of the ratio of consecutive magnitudes is at most

$$\frac{r}{(n+1)(H_n - H_{r-1})} - p \log \left(1 + \frac{1}{n+a} \right) < 0$$

for sufficiently large n . The alternating-series test applies. The case $r = 0$ is immediate. $\square$

Proposition 4.45 (Mellin integral). For the same parameters,

$$T_{p,r}(a) = \frac{(-1)^r}{r! \Gamma(p)} \int_0^1 t^{a-1} (-\log t)^{p-1} \frac{\log^r(1+t)}{1+t} dt. \quad (4.130)$$

In particular, $(-1)^r T_{p,r}(a) > 0$.

Proof. The binomial theorem and (4.128) give, for $|t| < 1$,

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} (-1)^n e_r(n) t^n = [u^r] (1+t)^{-1-u} = \frac{(-1)^r \log^r(1+t)}{r! (1+t)}. \quad (4.131)$$

Insert an Abel factor ρ^n with $0 < \rho < 1$, integrate termwise using $\int_0^1 t^{n+a-1} (-\log t)^{p-1} dt = \Gamma(p)/(n+a)^p$, and let $\rho \uparrow 1$. Dominated convergence applies on the integral side, and Lemma 4.44 identifies the Abel limit with the ordinary sum. The integrand in (4.130) is strictly positive almost everywhere after removing the sign. $\square$

4.24.1 Exact cyclotomic realizations

For integer $p \geq 1$, the series connects directly to the repository's Gaussian multiple polylogarithms:

$$S_{p,r} = \sum_{\epsilon_1, \dots, \epsilon_r \in \{1, -1\}} \Im \text{Li}_{p, \underbrace{1, \dots, 1}_r}(\mathbf{i}, \epsilon_1, \dots, \epsilon_r). \quad (4.132)$$

Indeed, write the outer index as $m_0 = 2n + 1$ and the inner indices as $m_j = 2k_j$. The 2^r from $1/k_j = 2/m_j$ cancels the factors $1/2$ in the even-index filters. Finally, $\Im(\mathbf{i}^{m_0})$ is exactly $(-1)^n$ for odd m_0 and zero for even m_0 . This proves (4.132), first with an Abel factor and then by convergence. For $r = 1$, both second arguments 1 and -1 occur; S_p is not simply one of the draft's $g_{a,b}$.

More generally, let $a = m/q$ with $0 < m < q$ and $\xi = e^{\pi i/q}$. Residue-class filters give

$$T_{p,r}(m/q) = q^{p-1} \sum_{h=0}^{q-1} \sum_{b_1, \dots, b_r=0}^{q-1} \xi^{-(2h+1)m} \cdot \text{Li}_{p,1,\dots,1}(\xi^{2h+1}, \xi^{2b_1}, \dots, \xi^{2b_r}). \quad (4.133)$$

To check the normalization, the denominator rescaling contributes q^{p+r} , while the $r + 1$ residue filters contribute q^{-r-1} . Thus rational parameters lead to level $2q$ values. This is a representation of nesting length at most $r + 1$, not a minimal-depth assertion.

4.25 An all-index reflection identity

Define, initially for $\Re(a - z) > 0$,

$$\Phi_a(z, u) = \int_0^1 t^{a-z-1} (1+t)^{-1-u} dt. \quad (4.134)$$

Near $(z, u) = (0, 0)$, coefficient extraction in (4.130) yields

$$\Phi_a(z, u) = \sum_{p \geq 1} \sum_{r \geq 0} T_{p,r}(a) z^{p-1} u^r. \quad (4.135)$$

There are no factorials in this ordinary Taylor series. This convention matters for every coefficient below.

Theorem 4.46 (Reflection). *If $0 < a < 1$, then as analytic germs at the origin,*

$$\boxed{\Phi_a(z, u) + \Phi_{1-a}(-z - u, u) = \frac{\Gamma(a - z)\Gamma(1 - a + z + u)}{\Gamma(1 + u)}}. \quad (4.136)$$

More generally the identity holds whenever $\Re(a - z) > 0$ and $\Re(1 - a + z + u) > 0$.

Proof. The beta integral evaluates

$$\int_0^\infty t^{a-z-1} (1+t)^{-1-u} dt = \frac{\Gamma(a - z)\Gamma(1 - a + z + u)}{\Gamma(1 + u)}.$$

The part over $(0, 1)$ is (4.134). In the part over $(1, \infty)$, substitute $t = 1/x$. The transformed integrand is $x^{-a+z+u}(1+x)^{-1-u}$, which is exactly the second term of (4.136). The stated inequalities justify both integrals. $\square$

Let

$$C_{p,r}(a) = [z^{p-1}u^r] \frac{\Gamma(a-z)\Gamma(1-a+z+u)}{\Gamma(1+u)}. \quad (4.137)$$

Corollary 4.47 (Finite triangular reduction). *For integers $p \geq 1, r \geq 0$ and $0 < a < 1$,*

$$T_{p,r}(a) + (-1)^{p-1}T_{p,r}(1-a) = C_{p,r}(a) - \sum_{j=1}^r (-1)^{p-1+j} \binom{p-1+j}{j} T_{p+j,r-j}(1-a). \quad (4.138)$$

Every sum on the right has smaller harmonic index.

Proof. The coefficient of $z^{p-1}u^r$ in $\Phi_{1-a}(-z-u, u)$ is

$$\sum_{j=0}^r (-1)^{p-1+j} \binom{p-1+j}{j} T_{p+j,r-j}(1-a).$$

Separate $j = 0$ in Theorem 4.46. □

4.25.1 A finite compiler for the gamma coefficient

Put $R_a(z, u)$ equal to the gamma quotient in (4.137), and write $R_a = (\pi/\sin \pi a) \exp(\sum_{d \geq 1} \ell_d)$, with ℓ_d homogeneous of total degree d . Then

$$\ell_d(z, u) = \frac{\psi^{(d-1)}(a)(-z)^d + \psi^{(d-1)}(1-a)(z+u)^d - \psi^{(d-1)}(1)u^d}{d!}. \quad (4.139)$$

Here $\psi^{(0)} = \psi$. If E_n is the homogeneous degree- n part of the exponential, then

$$E_0 = 1, \quad E_n = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{d=1}^n d \ell_d E_{n-d}. \quad (4.140)$$

Only degrees through $p+r-1$ are needed for $C_{p,r}$. These recurrences are a finite identity certificate, not a relation search.

For rational a , the coefficients reduce to ordinary cyclotomic values and their products. For derivatives of positive order, use $\psi^{(k)}(a) = (-1)^{k+1} k! \zeta(k+1, a)$. For $s \geq 2$,

$$\zeta(s, m/q) = q^{s-1} \sum_{h=0}^{q-1} e^{-2\pi i h m/q} \text{Li}_s(e^{2\pi i h/q}).$$

The Euler constants cancel in the linear part of (4.139); the remaining rational digamma combinations are expressible in logarithms and trigonometric constants. Thus (4.138) reduces the reflection combination to lower-index sums and products of depth-one values. It does not prove that the complementary combination is irreducible.

4.25.2 The self-reflecting Gaussian case

Set

$$F(z, u) = \frac{1}{2} \Phi_{1/2}(z/2, u) = \sum_{p \geq 1, r \geq 0} S_{p,r} z^{p-1} u^r.$$

Then

$$F(z, u) + F(-z - 2u, u) = K(z, u), \quad K(z, u) = \frac{\Gamma((1-z)/2)\Gamma((1+z)/2+u)}{2\Gamma(1+u)}. \quad (4.141)$$

For odd p ,

$$2S_{p,r} = [z^{p-1}u^r]K - \sum_{j=1}^r (-1)^j 2^j \binom{p-1+j}{j} S_{p+j,r-j}. \quad (4.142)$$

For example,

$$S_{p,2} = pS_{p+1,1} - p(p+1)\beta(p+2) + \frac{1}{2}[z^{p-1}u^2]K \quad (p \text{ odd}).$$

At even p , the coefficient of $S_{p,r}$ cancels. The identity then supplies relations among lower-index quantities rather than an unsupported converse to the odd- p reduction.

4.26 The first harmonic index revisited

At $r = 1$, the preceding reflection identity recovers equation (4.1). Its explicit coefficient form is equivalent to the generating-integral proof at the beginning of this chapter. This is one theorem reached from two useful representations: the full beta integral and the incomplete-beta reflection germ.

4.27 Complete monotonicity and globally enveloping truncations

Define

$$h_r(t) = \frac{1}{1+t} \left(\frac{\log(1+t)}{t} \right)^r, \quad h_r(0) = 1. \quad (4.143)$$

The elementary representation

$$h_r(t) = \int_{[0,1]^r} \frac{1}{1+t} \prod_{j=1}^r \frac{1}{1+x_j t} dx_1 \cdots dx_r \quad (4.144)$$

is the source of the signed bounds.

Lemma 4.48. *For $t \geq 0$, h_r is completely monotone: $(-1)^k h_r^{(k)}(t) \geq 0$ for all $k \geq 0$. Moreover,*

$$h_r(t) = r! \sum_{j \geq 0} (-1)^j e_r(r+j) t^j \quad (|t| < 1). \quad (4.145)$$

For every integer $M \geq 0$ and $0 \leq t \leq 1$,

$$0 \leq (-1)^M \left(h_r(t) - r! \sum_{j=0}^{M-1} (-1)^j e_r(r+j) t^j \right) \leq r! e_r(r+M) t^M. \quad (4.146)$$

Proof. Every factor in (4.144) has derivatives of alternating sign, and products preserve this property by Leibniz's rule. Integration preserves it as well. Formula (4.145) follows from (4.131) after removing the zero of order r at $t = 0$. Taylor's integral remainder has sign $(-1)^M$. Its magnitude is at most $|h_r^{(M)}(0)|t^M/M!$ because complete monotonicity makes $|h_r^{(M)}(t)|$ nonincreasing. This is (4.146); $M = 0$ means $0 \leq h_r(t) \leq 1$. $\square$

Theorem 4.49 (First-omitted-term certificate). *For every real $p, a > 0$, integer $r \geq 0$, and integer $M \geq 0$,*

$$0 \leq (-1)^{r+M} \left(T_{p,r}(a) - \sum_{n=r}^{r+M-1} \frac{(-1)^n e_r(n)}{(n+a)^p} \right) \leq \frac{e_r(r+M)}{(r+M+a)^p}. \quad (4.147)$$

In the Gaussian normalization, replace every $(n+a)^p$ by $(2n+1)^p$.

Proof. Multiply (4.146) by $t^{a+r-1}(-\log t)^{p-1}/(r!\Gamma(p))$ and integrate. Equation (4.130) gives the middle term, and each monomial integrates explicitly. $\square$

Remark 4.50. The certificate holds even when the first few summand magnitudes increase. Its proof is not an application of the alternating-series remainder theorem at an unjustified starting index. For example r may be large and p small; the positivity of the integral, rather than early term monotonicity, controls the error.

Since $e_r(r) = 1/r!$ and $e_r(r+1) = (r+2)/(2r!)$, we obtain

$$0 \leq 1 - (-1)^r r!(r+a)^p T_{p,r}(a) \leq \frac{r+2}{2} \left(\frac{r+a}{r+a+1} \right)^p. \quad (4.148)$$

The lower expression furnished by this bound may be negative for small p ; positivity from Proposition 4.45 remains available. For fixed r, a and $p \rightarrow \infty$,

$$T_{p,r}(a) = \frac{(-1)^r}{r!(r+a)^p} + \frac{(-1)^{r+1}(r+2)}{2r!(r+a+1)^p} + R_{p,r}, \quad |R_{p,r}| \leq \frac{e_r(r+2)}{(r+a+2)^p}. \quad (4.149)$$

More generally, every finite number of exponential terms has its own signed explicit remainder. The first-omitted-term constant is asymptotically sharp for fixed r, a, M , by applying the bound once more to the remainder.

4.27.1 An exact symmetric-function certificate

Expanding (4.144) at zero gives

$$r!e_r(r+j) = \sum_{k_0+\dots+k_r=j} \prod_{i=1}^r \frac{1}{k_i+1}. \quad (4.150)$$

Equivalently, it is the integral of the complete homogeneous polynomial $h_j(1, x_1, \dots, x_r)$ over $[0, 1]^r$. This identity is checked using exact rational arithmetic by two different recurrences in the supplied code. In particular, for fixed j ,

$$r!e_r(r+j) = \frac{r^j}{2^j j!} + O_j(r^{j-1}). \quad (4.151)$$

The leading contribution comes from j distinct variables among $x_1, \dots, x_r$; repeated variables and use of the distinguished entry 1 contribute $O_j(r^{j-1})$.

4.27.2 Pole stripping and exact Taylor radius

Let $F_{a,r}(z) = [u^r]\Phi_a(z, u)$. The integral representation shows that it extends holomorphically to $\Re z < a + r$, because the numerator vanishes to order r at the origin. Subtracting finitely many terms of (4.131) then continues it meromorphically to the entire z -plane, with precisely the simple poles

$$z = a + n \quad (n \geq r), \quad \text{Res}_{z=a+n} F_{a,r}(z) = (-1)^{n+1} e_r(n). \quad (4.152)$$

For clarity, subtract through degree N inside the integral. The remainder is $O(t^{N+1})$ at zero and is holomorphic for $\Re z < a + N + 1$; the subtracted terms are $(-1)^n e_r(n)/(a + n - z)$. Every residue in (4.152) is nonzero. Therefore the Taylor series $F_{a,r}(z) = \sum_{p \geq 1} T_{p,r}(a) z^{p-1}$ has exact radius $a + r$. This explains the first exponential scale in (4.149).

4.28 The joint depth–exponent transition

For $r \geq 1$, set

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) = (-1)^r r! (r + a)^p T_{p,r}(a), \quad L = p/r, \quad c = L - \log r, \quad \lambda = \frac{1}{2} e^{-c}. \quad (4.153)$$

At $a = 1/2$, this is $(-1)^r r! (2r + 1)^p S_{p,r}$. By the strictly positive integral and $0 < h_r(t) < 1$ for $t > 0$, we have $0 < \mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) < 1$.

Proposition 4.51 (Gamma expectation). *If Y has gamma distribution with shape p and rate $r + a$, then*

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) = \mathbb{E} h_r(e^{-Y}). \quad (4.154)$$

Proof. Set $t = e^{-y}$ in (4.130) and factor e^{-ry} out of $\log^r(1 + e^{-y})$. Multiplying by the normalization in (4.153) leaves precisely the gamma density $(r + a)^p y^{p-1} e^{-(r+a)y} / \Gamma(p)$. $\square$

Theorem 4.52 (Uniform transition and first correction). *Let a range over a fixed compact subset of $(0, \infty)$ and let c range over a fixed compact subset of $\mathbb{R}$. Put $p = r(\log r + c)$ and $L = \log r + c$. As the integer $r \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) = e^{-\lambda} \left[1 + \frac{1}{r} \left\{ \left(\frac{\lambda^2}{2} - (a + \frac{1}{2})\lambda \right) L + \frac{5\lambda^2}{6} - 2\lambda \right\} \right] + O\left(\frac{L^2}{r^2}\right), \quad \lambda = \frac{1}{2} e^{-c}. \quad (4.155)$$

The implied constant is uniform on those compact sets. In particular,

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) \longrightarrow \exp(-e^{-c}/2). \quad (4.156)$$

For integer p , use $c = p/r - \log r$ in the expansion; rounding $r(\log r + c_0)$ to an integer preserves the limit with c_0 .

We prove a uniform kernel lemma first. It is also the basis of the all-orders result.

Lemma 4.53 (Uniform kernel expansion). *Write*

$$\log\left(\frac{\log(1+t)}{t}\right) = \sum_{m \geq 1} b_m t^m, \quad b_1 = -\frac{1}{2}, \quad b_2 = \frac{5}{24}. \quad (4.157)$$

Define polynomials $\mathcal{U}_j(v)$ by

$$\sum_{j \geq 0} \mathcal{U}_j(v) \varepsilon^j = \exp\left(\sum_{k \geq 1} \varepsilon^k \left(2^{k+1} b_{k+1} v^{k+1} + \frac{(-1)^k 2^k v^k}{k}\right)\right). \quad (4.158)$$

For each fixed $J \geq 0$,

$$\sup_{0 \leq t \leq 1} \left| h_r(t) - e^{-rt/2} \sum_{j=0}^J \frac{\mathcal{U}_j(rt/2)}{r^j} \right| \leq C_J r^{-J-1}. \quad (4.159)$$

In particular $\mathcal{U}_0 = 1$ and $\mathcal{U}_1(v) = 5v^2/6 - 2v$.

Proof. Put $v = rt/2$. Expanding $r \log(\log(1+t)/t) - \log(1+t)$ at zero gives $-v$ plus the exponent in (4.158) with $\varepsilon = 1/r$. Fix a sufficiently small $\delta > 0$. On $0 \leq t \leq \delta$, Taylor remainders are bounded by r^{-J-1} times a fixed polynomial in v , after expansion through the required order. The perturbation of $-v$ is bounded by a small fixed multiple of v (enlarge the threshold for r if needed). Taylor's remainder for the exponential is consequently dominated by $r^{-J-1} \Theta_J(v) e^{-\eta v}$ for some $\eta > 0$. Its supremum is finite.

On $\delta \leq t \leq 1$, the ratio $\log(1+t)/t$ is bounded above by a number strictly less than one. Hence $h_r(t)$ decays exponentially in r , while every term of the proposed approximation is a polynomial in r times $e^{-r\delta/2}$. Both are $O_J(r^{-J-1})$. Combining the two ranges proves the claim. All constants here depend only on J and the chosen fixed δ . $\square$

Proof of Theorem 4.52. Let $\Delta = Y - L$. Its mean and centered gamma moments give, uniformly in the stated parameter sets,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}\Delta &= -\frac{aL}{r} + O(L/r^2), & \mathbb{E}\Delta^2 &= \frac{L}{r} + O(L^2/r^2), \\ \mathbb{E}\Delta^3 &= O(L^2/r^2), & \mathbb{E}\Delta^4 &= O(L^2/r^2). \end{aligned} \quad (4.160)$$

For example $\mathbb{E}Y = rL/(r+a)$, $\text{Var } Y = rL/(r+a)^2$, and the centered third and fourth moments are $2rL/(r+a)^3$ and $3(rL)^2/(r+a)^4 + 6rL/(r+a)^4$. These formulas imply (4.160) by translation.

Define $v = \lambda e^{-\Delta}$, $f(\Delta) = e^{-\lambda e^{-\Delta}}$, and $g(\Delta) = e^{-v}(5v^2/6 - 2v)$. All derivatives of f and g of fixed order are bounded on the real line: each is a polynomial in $v \geq 0$ times e^{-v} . Lemma 4.53 with $J = 1$ gives

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) = \mathbb{E}f(\Delta) + r^{-1}\mathbb{E}g(\Delta) + O(r^{-2}).$$

Taylor-expand f through degree three, retaining the fourth-order remainder. Since $f'(0) = \lambda e^{-\lambda}$ and $f''(0) = (\lambda^2 - \lambda)e^{-\lambda}$, (4.160) yields

$$\mathbb{E}f(\Delta) = e^{-\lambda} \left[1 + \frac{L}{r} \left(\frac{\lambda^2}{2} - (a + \tfrac{1}{2})\lambda \right) \right] + O(L^2/r^2).$$

A second-order Taylor bound gives $\mathbb{E}g(\Delta) = e^{-\lambda}(5\lambda^2/6 - 2\lambda) + O(L/r)$. Substitute the two estimates. Since $L \asymp \log r$, this is exactly (4.155). $\square$

4.28.1 A second proof of the limiting profile

Theorem 4.49 and (4.151) provide a useful independent explanation. For fixed j and $p = r(\log r + c)$,

$$r!e_r(r+j) \left(\frac{r+a}{r+a+j} \right)^p \rightarrow \frac{\lambda^j}{j!}.$$

Every even and odd truncation bounds $\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a)$ from opposite sides. Taking $r \rightarrow \infty$ for a fixed truncation and then increasing the truncation squeezes the limit between the alternating Taylor bounds for $e^{-\lambda}$. This argument does not interchange an uncontrolled infinite sum with a limit. It also gives compact- c uniform convergence by making the finite exponential remainder uniformly small.

4.28.2 The threshold outside the compact transition window

For fixed $a > 0$ (also uniformly on compact a -sets), if $p/r - \log r \rightarrow +\infty$, then (4.148) implies $\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) \rightarrow 1$. One may split into $p/r \leq 2 \log r$ and $p/r > 2 \log r$ to verify the exponential estimate without assuming p/r^2 is small.

If $p/r - \log r \rightarrow -\infty$, with $p > 0$, then eventually $L \leq \log r$, and $Y - L \rightarrow 0$ in probability because its variance and mean shift tend to zero. Thus $re^{-Y} \rightarrow \infty$ in probability. The elementary inequality $\log(1+t)/t \leq 1 - t/6$ on $0 \leq t \leq 1$ gives $h_r(t) \leq e^{-rt/6}$. Bounded convergence in probability in (4.154) now gives $\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) \rightarrow 0$. Therefore $p \sim r \log r$ is the actual threshold for first-pole dominance.

4.28.3 All-orders transition polynomials

Define the operator on polynomials in v

$$\mathcal{D}P(v) = vP(v) - vP'(v), \quad (4.161)$$

and the polynomials

$$d_j(t; a) = \frac{(-1)^j}{j+1} (a^{j+1} - (a-t)^{j+1}) \quad (j \geq 1). \quad (4.162)$$

The operator convention follows from $\partial_\Delta(e^{-v}P(v)) = e^{-v}\mathcal{D}P(v)$ for $v = \lambda e^{-\Delta}$.

Theorem 4.54 (All-orders compiler). *For every fixed $J \geq 0$, in the parameter range of Theorem 4.52,*

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,r}(a) = e^{-\lambda} \sum_{j=0}^J \frac{\Theta_j(L, \lambda; a)}{r^j} + O_J \left(\frac{L^{J+1}}{r^{J+1}} \right), \quad (4.163)$$

uniformly on compact a, c -sets. The Θ_j have rational coefficients and degree at most j in L . They are determined by the finite formal prescription

$$\sum_{j \geq 0} \Theta_j(L, v; a) \varepsilon^j = \exp \left(L \sum_{k \geq 1} \varepsilon^k d_k(\mathcal{D}; a) \right) \left(\sum_{k \geq 0} \varepsilon^k \mathcal{U}_k(v) \right). \quad (4.164)$$

In particular

$$\Theta_1 = \left(\frac{v^2}{2} - (a + \frac{1}{2})v \right) L + \frac{5}{6}v^2 - 2v. \quad (4.165)$$

Proof. The exact moment-generating function of Δ is

$$\log \mathbb{E} e^{t\Delta} = -Lt + rL \{ \log(1 + a/r) - \log(1 + (a-t)/r) \} = L \sum_{j \geq 1} r^{-j} d_j(t; a).$$

Consequently expectation, formally through any fixed order in r^{-1} , is the differential operator $\exp(L \sum r^{-j} d_j(\partial_\Delta; a))$ evaluated at $\Delta = 0$. Conjugation by e^{-v} turns ∂_Δ into (4.161), proving the coefficient rule.

For the error justification, apply Lemma 4.53 through order J . For the term containing $r^{-k}\mathcal{U}_k$, Taylor-expand $e^{-v}\mathcal{U}_k(v)$ as a function of Δ through degree $2(J-k)+1$. Its fixed-order derivatives are bounded, and the gamma moments imply $\mathbb{E}|\Delta|^{2s} = O_s((L/r)^s)$ for each fixed s , since $L \asymp \log r$. The Taylor remainder therefore contributes $O(r^{-J-1}L^{J-k+1})$. The finitely many retained moments are explicit rational functions of $r+a$ with polynomial dependence on rL ; expanding them through order J yields the stated formal operator and an error $O_J(L^{J+1}/r^{J+1})$. This also controls the uniform kernel error. Finally, each factor in the operator exponent carries one L and at least one power of ε , so the coefficient of ε^j has degree at most j in L . $\square$

For reproducibility, write $\Theta_2 = A_2 L^2 + B_2 L + C_2$, where

$$\begin{aligned} A_2 &= \frac{v^4}{8} - \left(\frac{a}{2} + \frac{3}{4}\right) v^3 + \left(\frac{a^2}{2} + \frac{3a}{2} + \frac{7}{8}\right) v^2 - \left(\frac{a^2}{2} + \frac{a}{2} + \frac{1}{8}\right) v, \\ B_2 &= \frac{5v^4}{12} - \left(\frac{5a}{6} + \frac{11}{4}\right) v^3 + \left(\frac{8a}{3} + \frac{11}{3}\right) v^2 + \left(a^2 - a - \frac{2}{3}\right) v, \\ C_2 &= \frac{25v^4}{72} - \frac{8}{3} v^3 + 4v^2. \end{aligned}$$

The supplementary symbolic script produces $\Theta_0, \dots, \Theta_4$ from (4.164); it does not fit them to numerical data.

4.28.4 The complementary fixed-exponent regime

The transition theorem is not uniform down to fixed p . A separate endpoint expansion describes that regime.

Theorem 4.55 (Fixed p , growing harmonic index). *Let $b = \log 2$. For p, a in compact subsets of $(0, \infty)$ and $r \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$T_{p,r}(a) = \frac{(-1)^r 2^{p-1} b^{r+p}}{r! r^p} \left[1 + \frac{(1-2a)bp + (b-1)p(p+1)/2}{r} + O(r^{-2}) \right]. \quad (4.166)$$

Thus

$$S_{p,r} = \frac{(-1)^r b^{r+p}}{2r! r^p} \left[1 + \frac{(b-1)p(p+1)}{2r} + O_p(r^{-2}) \right]. \quad (4.167)$$

Proof. In the $y = -\log t$ form of (4.130), the factor $\log^x(1 + e^{-y})$ localizes the integral near $y = 0$. Its logarithm expands as

$$\log \left(\frac{\log(1 + e^{-y})}{b} \right) = -\frac{y}{2b} + \frac{b-1}{8b^2} y^2 + O(y^3),$$

while $e^{-ay}/(1 + e^{-y}) = \frac{1}{2}(1 + (1/2 - a)y + O(y^2))$. Set $y = 2bv/r$. The integrand becomes $v^{p-1}e^{-v}$ times

$$1 + \frac{(1-2a)bv + (b-1)v^2/2}{r} + O(r^{-2}P(v))$$

in a fixed small- y interval, with an integrable exponential majorant after the usual smaller-interval split. The complementary y -interval is exponentially small relative to $b^r r^{-p}$: the logarithmic ratio is uniformly below one there, and its large- y decay supplies integrability. Integrating the displayed terms uses $\Gamma(p+1)/\Gamma(p) = p$ and $\Gamma(p+2)/\Gamma(p) = p(p+1)$. Uniform Taylor bounds on compact a, p -sets give the stated remainder. Finally divide by 2^p at $a = 1/2$. $\square$

4.29 Geometric evaluation with explicit error bounds

The signed partial-sum bounds are exact but may converge slowly at small p . An incomplete-beta expansion supplies geometric convergence. In (4.134), put $y = t/(1+t)$; then

$$\Phi_a(z, u) = \int_0^{1/2} y^{a-z-1} (1-y)^{u-a+z} dy = 2^{-a+z} \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(a-z-u)_n}{n! 2^n (n+a-z)}. \quad (4.168)$$

This is the usual binomial expansion of the incomplete-beta integral, with all variables and normalizations displayed.

Theorem 4.56 (Explicit Cauchy tail bound). *Let $p \geq 1$ and $r \geq 0$ be integers, and let $a > 0$. Choose $0 < \rho < a$, $\sigma > 0$, and let $A = a + \rho + \sigma$. For an integer $N \geq 1$, put*

$$q_N = \frac{1}{2} \max \left(1, \frac{N + A}{N + 1} \right), \quad B_N = 2^{-a+\rho} \frac{(A)_N}{N! 2^N (N + a - \rho)}.$$

If $q_N < 1$, the error after retaining $0 \leq n < N$ in (4.168) has modulus at most $B_N/(1 - q_N)$ on $|z| \leq \rho, |u| \leq \sigma$. Consequently the error in $T_{p,r}(a)$ is at most

$$\rho^{-(p-1)} \sigma^{-r} \frac{B_N}{1 - q_N}. \quad (4.169)$$

Proof. For every factor of the rising factorial, $|a - z - u + j| \leq A + j$. Also $|n + a - z| \geq n + a - \rho$ and $|2^{-a+z}| \leq 2^{-a+\rho}$. The resulting positive majorant term has ratio

$$\frac{n + A}{2(n + 1)} \frac{n + a - \rho}{n + 1 + a - \rho} \leq q_N \quad (n \geq N).$$

Sum the geometric majorant. The bivariate Cauchy coefficient estimate gives (4.169). $\square$

Corollary 4.57 (A rational Gaussian error bound). *For $a = 1/2$ take $\rho = \sigma = 1/4$. Let $S_{p,r}^{[N]}$ be the coefficient approximation from (4.168), divided by 2^p . Then*

$$|S_{p,r} - S_{p,r}^{[N]}| \leq \frac{2^{p+2r-1-N}}{N + 1/4}.$$

(4.170)

Proof. Here $A = 1$, $(A)_N/N! = 1$, $q_N = 1/2$, and $2^{-1/4} < 1$. Insert these values into (4.169) and multiply by 2^{-p} . $\square$

4.29.1 How the supplied exact certificates are constructed

For rational $a = 1/2$, the finite approximation has the form

$$S_{p,r}^{[N]} = 2^{-p-1/2} \sum_{\ell=0}^{p-1} c_\ell (\log 2)^\ell, \quad c_\ell \in \mathbb{Q}. \quad (4.171)$$

The coefficients are computed exactly. Maintain the truncated bivariate polynomial $\Theta_n(z, u) = (1/2 - z - u)_n/n!$ using

$$\Theta_{n+1} = \frac{n + 1/2 - z - u}{n + 1} \Theta_n.$$

Multiply by the truncated geometric expansion of $(n + 1/2 - z)^{-1}$, accumulate the 2^{-n} terms, and finally multiply by the Taylor polynomial of $e^{z \log 2}$. All operations up to (4.171) are rational.

The code then encloses $\log 2$ using

$$\log 2 = 2 \sum_{k=0}^{K-1} \frac{1}{(2k+1)3^{2k+1}} + \eta_K, \quad 0 < \eta_K \leq \frac{9}{4(2K+1)3^{2K+1}},$$

and encloses $2^{-1/2}$ by an integer square-root computation on a dyadic scale. Rational interval Horner evaluation controls the error in (4.171), and the rational bound (4.170) controls the infinite

tail. Thus the resulting interval endpoints are exact fractions. They do not depend on trusting a floating-point quadrature result or a special-function library.

These certificates establish enclosures for individual constants. Overlap of two intervals would not, by itself, prove an identity between the constants; the analytic proofs in earlier sections perform that task. Conversely, disjoint validated intervals can rigorously disprove a proposed equality. A finite-height exclusion program would require a further certified enumeration or lattice argument, which is not included here.

4.30 Exponential cancellation at proportional harmonic depth

The positive integral representation now leads to an analytic question left open by the earlier alternating-harmonic report Chapter 4: how rapidly does its normalized sum tend to zero below the first-term transition? The case of proportional outer exponent and harmonic depth has an explicit rate function. This is a continuation of that report's results, not another proof of its already established reflection identity.

For integers $h, n \geq 0$, define

$$e_h(n) = [u^h] \prod_{j=1}^n (1 + u/j), \quad T_{p,h}(a) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n e_h(n)}{(n+a)^p}, \quad a, p > 0.$$

Thus $e_0(n) = 1$, $e_1(n) = H_n$, and $e_2(n) = (H_n^2 - H_n^{(2)})/2$. Ordinary convergence holds for $p > 0$; absolute convergence holds for $p > 1$. The Gaussian normalization is $S_{p,h} = 2^{-p} T_{p,h}(1/2)$. The positive Mellin integral

$$T_{p,h}(a) = \frac{(-1)^h}{h! \Gamma(p)} \int_0^\infty \frac{x^{p-1} e^{-ax} \log^h(1 + e^{-x})}{1 + e^{-x}} dx \quad (4.172)$$

follows from

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} e_h(n) z^n = \frac{(-\log(1-z))^h}{h!(1-z)}$$

by inserting an Abel factor, using the gamma integral, and taking its limit. The exponential decay at infinity and the bound $\log(1 + e^{-x}) \leq \log 2$ near zero justify the integral limit. The convergence and Abel-limit argument are also proved in the integral representation above. In particular, $(-1)^h T_{p,h}(a) > 0$.

Put

$$R_{p,h}(a) = (-1)^h h! (h+a)^p T_{p,h}(a). \quad (4.173)$$

The earlier report proves $0 < R_{p,h}(a) < 1$ and identifies the threshold $p \sim h \log h$. When $p/h - \log h \rightarrow -\infty$, it proves that $R_{p,h}(a) \rightarrow 0$. The following theorem quantifies this statement when p/h remains in a fixed positive compact interval.

4.30.1 The unique saddle and the rate function

Write

$$L(x) = \log(1 + e^{-x}), \quad w(x) = \frac{1}{(1 + e^x)L(x)} = -\frac{d}{dx} \log L(x), \quad x > 0. \quad (4.174)$$

Lemma 4.58. *The function w is strictly increasing, with*

$$\frac{1}{2\log 2} < w(x) < 1.$$

For every $\alpha > 0$ there is exactly one $x_\alpha > 0$ satisfying

$$x_\alpha w(x_\alpha) = \alpha. \quad (4.175)$$

Moreover $\alpha < x_\alpha < 2\alpha \log 2$.

Proof. Set $t = e^{-x} \in (0, 1)$. Then $w = t/((1+t)\log(1+t))$ and

$$\frac{d}{dt} \log w = \frac{\log(1+t) - t}{t(1+t)\log(1+t)} < 0.$$

Consequently w increases with x . Its endpoint limits give the bounds. The function $xw(x)$ has derivative $w + xw' > 0$, tends to zero at zero, and tends to infinity at infinity. This proves existence, uniqueness, and the stated enclosure. $\square$

For $x = x_\alpha$, set

$$\Phi_\alpha(y) = \alpha \log y + \log L(y), \quad (4.176)$$

$$A_\alpha = \frac{\alpha}{x^2} + w'(x) > 0, \quad (4.177)$$

$$I(\alpha) = -\alpha \log(x/\alpha) - \alpha - \log L(x), \quad (4.178)$$

$$C(\alpha, a) = \frac{\sqrt{\alpha/A_\alpha}}{x(1+e^{-x})} \exp(a(\alpha - x)). \quad (4.179)$$

All of these functions are real analytic for $\alpha > 0$.

Theorem 4.59 (Proportional-depth asymptotics). *Let a and α range over fixed compact subsets of $(0, \infty)$, and put $p = \alpha h$. As the integer $h \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$R_{\alpha h, h}(a) = C(\alpha, a) e^{-hI(\alpha)} (1 + O(h^{-1})), \quad (4.180)$$

uniformly on those compact sets. In fact

$$R_{\alpha h, h}(a) = C(\alpha, a) e^{-hI(\alpha)} \left(1 + \frac{D(\alpha, a)}{h} + O(h^{-2}) \right), \quad (4.181)$$

where, with $x = x_\alpha$, $A = A_\alpha$, and $g(y) = e^{-ay}/(y(1+e^{-y}))$,

$$D(\alpha, a) = \frac{g''(x)}{2Ag(x)} + \frac{\Phi_\alpha'''(x)g'(x)}{2A^2g(x)} + \frac{\Phi_\alpha''''(x)}{8A^2} + \frac{5\Phi_\alpha'''(x)^2}{24A^3} - \frac{\alpha a^2}{2} - \frac{1}{12\alpha}. \quad (4.182)$$

Every fixed further order in h^{-1} exists and is effectively obtained from derivatives of L and g at x_α and the Stirling series. The remainder at every fixed order is uniform on the same compact sets.

Proof. Equation (4.172) gives

$$R_{\alpha h, h}(a) = \frac{(h+a)^{\alpha h}}{\Gamma(\alpha h)} \int_0^\infty e^{h\Phi_\alpha(y)} g(y) dy.$$

We have $\Phi'_\alpha(y) = \alpha/y - w(y)$ and $\Phi''_\alpha(y) = -\alpha/y^2 - w'(y) < 0$. The sole critical point is therefore a strict global maximum. Its location stays in a fixed compact subinterval of $(0, \infty)$ as α varies in the prescribed compact set, and its curvature is bounded away from zero.

Here are explicit tail controls for the application of Laplace's method [74, §2.3(iii)] [74, Section 2.3(iii)]. Near zero, $\exp(h\Phi_\alpha(y)) \leq y^{h\alpha}(\log 2)^h$, while $g(y) = O(y^{-1})$ uniformly in a . Choosing the endpoint interval small enough makes its integral exponentially smaller than the maximum, uniformly in α . At infinity, $L(y) < e^{-y}$ implies $\Phi_\alpha(y) < \alpha \log y - y$; this supplies an integrable exponential bound uniform in the same compact parameters. On the remaining compact set outside a fixed neighborhood of x_α , strict concavity and compactness give a uniform negative gap from the maximum. These observations justify discarding both tails with an exponentially small relative error.

In the neighborhood, substitute $y = x + v/\sqrt{h}$. Taylor expansion, followed by Gaussian integration, gives

$$\int_0^\infty e^{h\Phi_\alpha(y)} g(y) dy = e^{h\Phi_\alpha(x)} g(x) \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{hA}} \left(1 + \frac{E}{h} + O(h^{-2}) \right),$$

$$E = \frac{g''}{2Ag} + \frac{\Phi'''g'}{2A^2g} + \frac{\Phi''''}{8A^2} + \frac{5(\Phi''')^2}{24A^3},$$

with all derivatives evaluated at x . Odd Gaussian moments vanish; the even moments $1/A$, $3/A^2$, and $15/A^3$ produce precisely these four terms. The analytic functions have uniformly bounded derivatives on a common neighborhood of the saddle. Taylor remainders there, together with the tail bounds just given, prove the claimed uniform error and also permit expansion to any prescribed order.

Finally Stirling's formula, uniformly for α in its compact set, and $\alpha h \log(1 + a/h) = \alpha a - \alpha a^2/(2h) + O(h^{-2})$ give

$$\frac{(h+a)^{\alpha h}}{\Gamma(\alpha h)} = \sqrt{\frac{\alpha h}{2\pi}} e^{h\alpha(1-\log \alpha) + \alpha a} \left(1 - \frac{\alpha a^2/2 + 1/(12\alpha)}{h} + O(h^{-2}) \right).$$

Multiplying the two expansions proves (4.180)–(4.182). □

Remark 4.60 (Integer exponents and rounding). For integer p , set $\alpha = p/h$ in the theorem. If instead one fixes α_0 and rounds $\alpha_0 h$ to p , the $O(1/h)$ change of α must remain inside $e^{-hI(\alpha)}$: replacing it by $e^{-hI(\alpha_0)}$ changes the leading constant by a generally nontrivial bounded factor. This is a practical distinction in numerical comparisons.

4.30.2 Monotonicity, convexity, and matching limits

Proposition 4.61. *The rate I is positive, strictly decreasing, and strictly convex on $(0, \infty)$. More explicitly,*

$$I'(\alpha) = \log \frac{\alpha}{x_\alpha} = \log w(x_\alpha) < 0, \quad I''(\alpha) = \frac{w'(x_\alpha)}{w(x_\alpha)(w(x_\alpha) + x_\alpha w'(x_\alpha))} > 0. \quad (4.183)$$

Its endpoint limits are

$$I(0+) = -\log \log 2, \quad I(+\infty) = 0.$$

As $\alpha \rightarrow \infty$,

$$x_\alpha = \alpha + \frac{\alpha}{2}e^{-\alpha} + O(\alpha^2 e^{-2\alpha}), \quad (4.184)$$

$$I(\alpha) = \frac{1}{2}e^{-\alpha} - \frac{3\alpha + 5}{24}e^{-2\alpha} + O(\alpha^2 e^{-3\alpha}), \quad (4.185)$$

$$C(\alpha, a) = 1 - \left(\frac{(a + 1/2)\alpha}{2} + 1 \right) e^{-\alpha} + O_a(\alpha^2 e^{-2\alpha}). \quad (4.186)$$

Also $C(\alpha, a) \rightarrow 1/2$ as $\alpha \downarrow 0$.

Proof. Differentiating the optimized value in (4.178) cancels its x'_α terms by (4.175). This gives the first identity in (4.183). Differentiating $\alpha = xw(x)$ gives the second. Positivity also follows directly: $\log L(y) < -y$, so

$$\max_{y>0} \{\alpha \log(y/\alpha) + \alpha + \log L(y)\} < \max_{y>0} \{\alpha \log(y/\alpha) + \alpha - y\} = 0.$$

The strict inequality is valid because the first maximum is attained; at its maximizing point the second expression is at most zero.

The small- α limits follow from $x_\alpha/\alpha \rightarrow 2 \log 2$ and $A_\alpha \sim \alpha/x_\alpha^2$. At infinity, put $t = e^{-y}$ and use

$$\log L(y) = -y - \frac{t}{2} + \frac{5t^2}{24} + O(t^3), \quad w(y) = 1 - \frac{t}{2} + \frac{5t^2}{12} + O(t^3).$$

Substitution in (4.175) first gives (4.184). Taylor expansion of (4.178) around $y = \alpha$, retaining the quadratic displacement, gives (4.185). Expansion of (4.179) and $A_\alpha = \alpha/x_\alpha^2 + w'(x_\alpha)$ gives (4.186). The remainders stated above follow from analyticity of $\log(\log(1+t)/t)$ for t near zero, with $x_\alpha - \alpha = O(\alpha e^{-\alpha})$. $\square$

The rate formula explains the scale of cancellation even when the terms of the original alternating sum are much larger than its value. For example, $I(1) = 0.15091647898554\dots$ and $C(1, 1/2) = 0.66325765726435\dots$. Thus

$$R_{h,h}(1/2) \sim 0.66325765726435\dots e^{-0.15091647898554\dots h}.$$

This is a proved exponential rate, rather than just a limit of zero.

The large- α expansions also explain why the transition parameter in the previous report was $\lambda = he^{-\alpha}/2$. Formally putting $\alpha = \log h + c$ in $hI(\alpha)$ gives the leading value $e^{-c}/2$. This agrees with the independently proved transition $R \rightarrow \exp(-e^{-c}/2)$ in Chapter 4. Such matching is a consistency calculation: the compact- α theorem proved here does *not* by itself establish a uniform error for growing α . Obtaining a single effective formula across that expanding range remains a precise further problem.

4.30.3 A probability law at the saddle

There is a useful formulation independent of the alternating series. Normalize the positive integrand in (4.172), with $p = \alpha h$, to a probability density and call the resulting random variable X_h . Then

$$\sqrt{hA_\alpha}(X_h - x_\alpha) \implies N(0, 1). \quad (4.187)$$

Indeed, the same change of variables used in the proof of Theorem 4.59, its uniform Gaussian domination on a shrinking neighborhood, and its exponentially negligible tails prove convergence against every bounded continuous test function. The associated rate for X_h is $\Phi_\alpha(x_\alpha) - \Phi_\alpha(y)$. This identifies which part of the positive integral carries the very small alternating sum and gives a stable center for numerical quadrature.

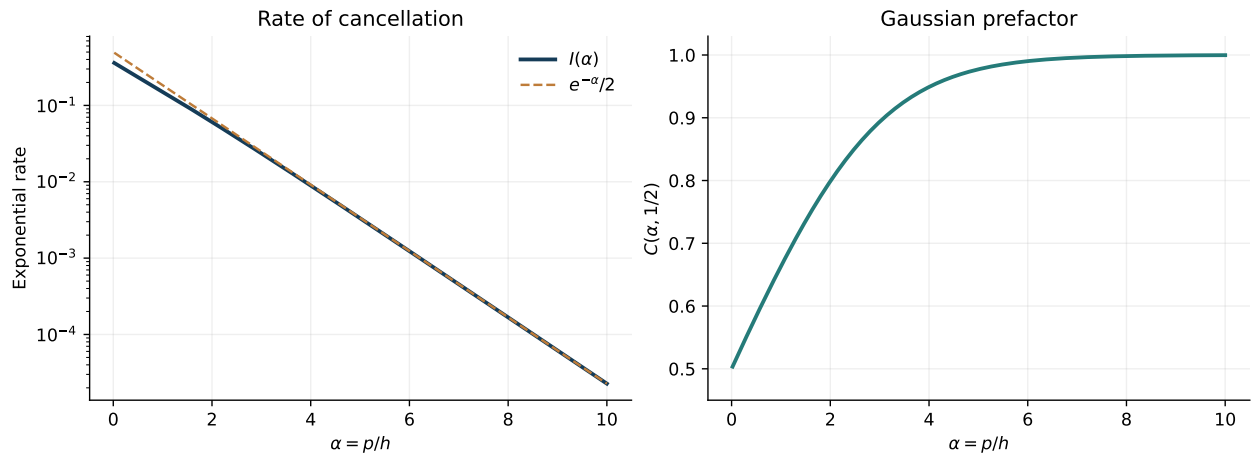


Figure 4.1: The proportional-depth rate and normalized asymptotic. The positive, decreasing and convex rate is proved in the text; sampled values illustrate it. The compact-parameter theorem does not by itself cover a growing $\alpha = \log h + c$ transition.

Chapter 5

Signed kernels and certified polylogarithm computation

The exact reductions suggest evaluation methods that expose more analytic structure. A signed density for $F_{a,b}(z) = \text{Li}_{a,b}(z, 1)$ proves a unique angular zero and makes Gaussian Euler errors one-sided. The general double integral supports Chebyshev and midpoint expansions, while Holder convolution provides uniform rational certificates for a wider alphabet. These methods connect experiments, geometry and finite arithmetic: their tail theorems and rounding contracts determine what a numerical comparison establishes. Write $D_{a,b}(x, y) = \text{Li}_{a,b}(x, y)$. Throughout the signed-density discussion, $H_n^{(b)} = \sum_{j=1}^n j^{-b}$, $H_0^{(b)} = 0$, and $g_{a,b} = \text{Im } F_{a,b}(i)$; real $b > 0$ is allowed where stated.

5.1 A signed-kernel representation

Definition 5.1. For real $b > 0$ and $T > 0$, define

$$\kappa_{1,b}(e^{-T}) = -\frac{T^b}{\Gamma(b+1)} + \frac{1}{\Gamma(b)} \int_T^\infty \frac{v^{b-1}}{e^v - 1} dv. \quad (5.1)$$

For an integer $a \geq 2$, define successively

$$\kappa_{a,b}(u) = \int_u^1 \frac{\kappa_{a-1,b}(v)}{v} dv, \quad 0 < u < 1. \quad (5.2)$$

Theorem 5.2 (Moments and one sign change). For every integer $a \geq 1$ and real $b > 0$, the density $\kappa_{a,b}$ is integrable on $(0, 1)$ and

$$\int_0^1 u^{n-1} \kappa_{a,b}(u) du = \frac{H_{n-1}^{(b)}}{n^a}, \quad n \geq 1. \quad (5.3)$$

In particular its total mass is zero. There is exactly one $r_{a,b} \in (0, 1)$ such that

$$\kappa_{a,b}(u) < 0 \quad (0 < u < r_{a,b}), \quad \kappa_{a,b}(u) > 0 \quad (r_{a,b} < u < 1). \quad (5.4)$$

The crossing is strict, and $r_{a,b} < r_{a-1,b}$ when $a \geq 2$.

Proof. First consider $a = 1$. The negative term in (5.1) has moment $-n^{-b-1}$. Substituting $u = e^{-T}$ and interchanging nonnegative integrands in the positive term gives

$$\begin{aligned} & \frac{1}{\Gamma(b)} \int_0^\infty e^{-nT} \int_T^\infty \frac{v^{b-1}}{e^v - 1} dv dT \\ &= \frac{1}{n\Gamma(b)} \int_0^\infty \frac{v^{b-1}(1 - e^{-nv})}{e^v - 1} dv = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=1}^n k^{-b}. \end{aligned}$$

The final equality uses the finite geometric identity $(1 - e^{-nv})/(e^v - 1) = \sum_{k=1}^n e^{-kv}$. Subtracting n^{-b-1} proves the base moment formula. At $n = 1$, both positive and negative terms have finite integral 1, so integrability and zero mass are established without subtracting divergent quantities.

As a function of T , the base density has derivative

$$\frac{d}{dT} \kappa_{1,b}(e^{-T}) = -\frac{T^{b-1}}{\Gamma(b)(1 - e^{-T})} < 0. \quad (5.5)$$

It is positive as $T \downarrow 0$: the limit is $\zeta(b) > 0$ if $b > 1$, and is $+\infty$ if $0 < b \leq 1$. It tends to $-\infty$ as $T \rightarrow \infty$. Thus it has exactly one crossing, with the sign pattern stated in the u coordinate.

For the induction, the integral operator in (5.2) is an L^1 contraction:

$$\int_0^1 \left| \int_u^1 \frac{f(v)}{v} dv \right| du \leq \int_0^1 |f(v)| dv.$$

Fubini's theorem gives the moment of the new density as $1/n$ times the previous moment; in particular it preserves zero mass. If the preceding crossing is r , the new density is positive on $[r, 1)$, while on $(0, r)$ its derivative is $-\kappa_{a-1,b}(u)/u > 0$. Zero mass forces it to be negative somewhere on that interval. Strict increase then gives exactly one crossing in $(0, r)$. This completes the induction. $\square$

Corollary 5.3 (Integral continuation). *For $z \in \mathbb{C} \setminus [1, \infty)$,*

$$F_{a,b}(z) = \int_0^1 \frac{z}{1 - zu} \kappa_{a,b}(u) du. \quad (5.6)$$

In particular, if $0 < \theta < \pi$,

$$\operatorname{Im} F_{a,b}(e^{i\theta}) = \sin \theta J_{a,b}(\cos \theta), \quad J_{a,b}(c) = \int_0^1 \frac{\kappa_{a,b}(u)}{1 - 2cu + u^2} du. \quad (5.7)$$

Proof. For $|z| < 1$, expand $z/(1 - zu)$ and use the moments. On compact subsets of the slit plane the denominator is bounded away from zero uniformly in $u \in [0, 1]$, so the integral is analytic there. This continues the disk identity. Taking the imaginary part of $e^{i\theta}/(1 - ue^{i\theta})$ gives (5.7). $\square$

Lemma 5.4 (A sign test for zero-mass densities). *Let κ have zero integral and the strict sign pattern (5.4), with crossing r . If q is strictly decreasing and the integral exists, then $\int q\kappa < 0$. If q is strictly increasing, the sign is positive.*

Proof. Subtract $q(r) \int \kappa = 0$. The product $(q(u) - q(r))\kappa(u)$ has the asserted strict sign on each side of r . $\square$

5.2 The unique zero on the upper semicircle

Theorem 5.5 (Existence, uniqueness, and simplicity). *Let $a \geq 1$ be an integer and let $b > 0$ be real. There is exactly one $\theta_{a,b} \in (0, \pi)$ such that $\operatorname{Im} F_{a,b}(e^{i\theta_{a,b}}) = 0$. It satisfies*

$$0 < \theta_{a,b} < \frac{\pi}{2}. \quad (5.8)$$

The imaginary part is positive for $0 < \theta < \theta_{a,b}$ and negative for $\theta_{a,b} < \theta < \pi$. At its zero the angular derivative is strictly negative. Consequently,

$$g_{a,b} < 0. \quad (5.9)$$

Proof. Suppress the indices in J and κ . The kernel $u \mapsto (1 + u^2)^{-1}$ is strictly decreasing, so Lemma 5.4 gives $J(0) < 0$.

We next show that the limit of $J(c)$ as $c \uparrow 1$ is positive, possibly infinite. The negative density is supported in $(0, r)$, away from the singular endpoint, and its contribution has a finite limit. On $(r, 1)$ monotone convergence applies. Expanding $(1 - u)^{-2}$, treating these two parts separately, and using (5.3) yields

$$\lim_{c \uparrow 1} J(c) = \int_0^1 \frac{\kappa(u)}{(1 - u)^2} du = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{H_n^{(b)}}{(n + 1)^{a-1}} > 0. \quad (5.10)$$

Every summand from $n = 1$ onward is positive. Thus continuity produces at least one zero $c_0 \in (0, 1)$.

For uniqueness, write $K_c(u) = (1 - 2cu + u^2)^{-1}$. If $c' > c$, then

$$\frac{d}{du} \frac{K_{c'}(u)}{K_c(u)} = \frac{2(c' - c)(1 - u^2)}{(1 - 2c'u + u^2)^2} > 0. \quad (5.11)$$

At a zero $J(c) = 0$, the signed density $K_c \kappa$ still has one sign change and zero mass. Applying Lemma 5.4 to the ratio in (5.11) gives $J(c') > 0$ for every $c' > c$. The same argument with a smaller parameter gives $J(c') < 0$ for $c' < c$. There can be only one zero in $(-1, 1)$, with the indicated signs.

Finally,

$$J'(c_0) = \int_0^1 K_{c_0}(u) \kappa(u) \frac{2u}{1 - 2c_0u + u^2} du > 0,$$

because the last factor has derivative $2(1 - u^2)/(1 - 2c_0u + u^2)^2 > 0$. Equation (5.7) therefore has derivative $-\sin^2 \theta_{a,b} J'(c_0) < 0$ at $\theta_{a,b} = \arccos c_0$. Since $c_0 > 0$, this zero is below $\pi/2$. The Gaussian inequality is its value at $\theta = \pi/2$. $\square$

Remark 5.6 (The first zero is elementary). The identity $F_{1,1}(z) = \frac{1}{2} \log^2(1 - z)$ gives

$$\operatorname{Im} F_{1,1}(e^{i\theta}) = \log \left(2 \sin \frac{\theta}{2} \right) \frac{\theta - \pi}{2}.$$

Hence $\theta_{1,1} = \pi/3$ and $g_{1,1} = -\pi \log 2/8$. This example also checks the direction of the sign change in Theorem 5.5.

5.3 A four-term asymptotic for the zero

Put $\delta_{a,b} = \pi/2 - \theta_{a,b}$. The first surviving Fourier mode at $\pi/2$ is the $n = 3$ term, whereas the $n = 2$ term controls the derivative. Their ratio suggests $(2/3)^a$; the theorem below identifies both the next Fourier corrections and the first nonlinear correction.

Theorem 5.7 (Uniform zero asymptotic). *For integer $a \rightarrow \infty$, uniformly for real $b \geq 1$, set $A = H_2^{(b)}$, $B = H_3^{(b)}$, and $C = H_4^{(b)}$. Then*

$$\delta_{a,b} = \frac{A}{2} \left(\frac{2}{3}\right)^a - \frac{C}{2} \left(\frac{2}{5}\right)^a + AB \left(\frac{1}{3}\right)^a - \frac{23A^3}{48} \left(\frac{8}{27}\right)^a + O\left(\left(\frac{2}{7}\right)^a\right). \quad (5.12)$$

The implied constant and the threshold for a can be chosen independently of $b \geq 1$.

Proof. For sufficiently large a , the boundary series and its derivative converge absolutely. Normalize the imaginary part by multiplying by 2^a , and write $\theta = \pi/2 - \delta$. The modes $n = 2, 3, 4, 5$ give

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = & \sin(2\delta) - Aq^a \cos(3\delta) - Bs^a \sin(4\delta) + Cr^a \cos(5\delta) \\ & + O(\delta 3^{-a} + (2/7)^a), \quad q = \frac{2}{3}, \quad s = \frac{1}{2}, \quad r = \frac{2}{5}. \end{aligned} \quad (5.13)$$

The $n = 6$ mode is $O(\delta 3^{-a})$. For $n \geq 7$, the bound $H_{n-1}^{(b)} \leq 1 + \log n$ gives a uniform tail estimate: for $a \geq 3$,

$$\sum_{n \geq 7} (1 + \log n)(2/n)^a \leq (2/7)^a \sum_{n \geq 7} (1 + \log n)(7/n)^3.$$

The constant is finite and independent of b .

Since $1 \leq A \leq 3/2$ and B, C are bounded uniformly in b , the normalized expression is negative at $\delta = 0$ and positive at $\delta = q^a$ for all sufficiently large a . Theorem 5.5 identifies the root in that interval. Thus $\delta = O(q^a)$ uniformly.

Taylor expansion of (5.13) now gives

$$0 = 2\delta - Aq^a - 4Bs^a\delta + Cr^a + \frac{9}{2}Aq^a\delta^2 - \frac{4}{3}\delta^3 + O((2/7)^a). \quad (5.14)$$

For example, the omitted terms have exponential bases bounded by q^5 , sq^3 , rq^2 , and $q/3$, all smaller than $2/7$. Insert first $\delta_0 = Aq^a/2$. The linear perturbation $-4Bs^a\delta_0$ requires the correction $AB(qs)^a$, while the $n = 5$ mode requires $-Cr^a/2$. The cubic contribution at δ_0 is

$$\frac{9}{2}Aq^a\delta_0^2 - \frac{4}{3}\delta_0^3 = \frac{23}{24}A^3q^{3a},$$

so its compensating correction is $-23A^3q^{3a}/48$. Substitution of the full displayed approximation in (5.14) leaves a residual $O((2/7)^a)$; all cross-products of the corrections have smaller exponential bases. The derivative of the normalized expression with respect to δ is $2 + o(1)$, uniformly on this interval. The mean-value theorem therefore converts the residual estimate into the error in (5.12). $\square$

a	b	$\theta_{a,b}$, approximately	$\delta_{a,b}$, approximately
8	1	1.541868140889	0.02892818590626
8	2	1.546656477391	0.02413984940401
8	4	1.550268639150	0.02052768764464
12	1	1.565028587360	0.005767739435093
12	2	1.565988233290	0.004808093504888
12	4	1.566708834682	0.004087492112621
20	1	1.570570790993	0.0002255358018452
20	2	1.570608378737	0.0001879480579893
20	4	1.570636570306	0.0001597564888279

These entries are numerical illustrations from a 300-term Fourier sum, not certified root intervals. Existence, uniqueness, and the asymptotic estimate do not depend on the table. At $a = 20, 40, 80$ and $b = 1, 2, 8$, the computed next normalized remainder approaches $H_6^{(b)}/2$, as suggested by the $n = 7$ mode. A systematic expansion beyond the proved four terms is a separate research problem.

5.4 Certified Euler evaluation

5.4.1 A one-sided rational enclosure

Define the difference operator with the sign convention

$$(Df)(n) = f(n) - f(n+1).$$

This is the negative of the usual forward difference; it makes the Euler transformation particularly simple. Let

$$f_{a,b}(n) = \frac{H_{2n}^{(b)}}{(2n+1)^a}, \quad d_k = D^k f_{a,b}(0), \quad E_N(a, b) = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} \frac{d_k}{2^{k+1}}. \quad (5.15)$$

Theorem 5.8 (Signed Euler certificate). *For positive integers a, b ,*

$$d_0 = 0, \quad d_k < 0 \quad (k \geq 1), \quad g_{a,b} = \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{d_k}{2^{k+1}}. \quad (5.16)$$

For every $N \geq 1$,

$$E_N(a, b) - C_b 2^{-N} \leq g_{a,b} \leq E_N(a, b), \quad C_b = \begin{cases} 1, & b = 1, \\ b/(b-1), & b \geq 2. \end{cases} \quad (5.17)$$

The approximants decrease strictly from $E_1 = 0$ to $g_{a,b}$.

Proof. The moment representation gives

$$d_k = \int_0^1 (1-u^2)^k \kappa_{a,b}(u) \, du. \quad (5.18)$$

For $k = 0$ this is zero mass. For $k \geq 1$ the weight is strictly decreasing, so Lemma 5.4 gives $d_k < 0$.

We bound either signed mass or the density. When $b = 1$,

$$\kappa_{1,1}(u) = \log \frac{u}{1-u}, \quad \int_0^1 (\kappa_{1,1})_+ \, du = \log 2 < 1.$$

When $b \geq 2$, the positive term of (5.1) is at most $\zeta(b)$, so the positive mass is at most $\zeta(b) < 1 + 1/(b-1) = C_b$. Zero mass makes the negative mass equal to the positive mass. The L^1 contraction used in Theorem 5.2, together with preservation of zero mass, gives the same bound for every a . Since $0 \leq (1-u^2)^k \leq 1$, we obtain $|d_k| \leq C_b$.

The series in (5.16) is now absolutely convergent. Summing its geometric kernel gives

$$\sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{d_k}{2^{k+1}} = \int_0^1 \frac{\kappa_{a,b}(u)}{1+u^2} \, du = g_{a,b},$$

where the last equality is (5.6) at $z = i$. All tail terms are negative, and their total absolute value is at most $C_b \sum_{k \geq N} 2^{-k-1} = C_b 2^{-N}$. This proves the certificate and strict monotonicity. $\square$

The theorem is stronger than applying a general-purpose extrapolation rule and observing stability. Every endpoint in (5.17) is rational. For $N = 400$, the interval width is at most $2 \cdot 2^{-400} < 8 \cdot 10^{-121}$. The accompanying files round the enclosures outward to convenient decimal strings; that display rounding is separate from the internal rational width.

5.4.2 An exact linear-work finite formula

Computing a full triangular difference table uses quadratic work. A finite rearrangement avoids it.

Proposition 5.9 (Binomial-tail weights). *For $N \geq 1$,*

$$E_N(a, b) = 2^{-N} \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} (-1)^n \frac{H_{2n}^{(b)}}{(2n+1)^a} \sum_{j=n+1}^N \binom{N}{j}. \quad (5.19)$$

At fixed a, b , the right side can be formed with $O(N)$ exact rational or integer updates after choosing N . All denominators divide

$$2^N \operatorname{lcm}(1, 2, \dots, 2N)^{a+b}. \quad (5.20)$$

In particular, the number of bit operations is polynomial in the requested precision at fixed indices.

Proof. Expand $D^k f(0) = \sum_{n=0}^k (-1)^n \binom{k}{n} f(n)$ and interchange the two finite sums. The required weight identity is

$$\sum_{k=n}^{N-1} 2^{N-k-1} \binom{k}{n} = \sum_{j=n+1}^N \binom{N}{j}.$$

It follows by induction on N using Pascal's recurrence, or by comparing binomial-tail generating functions. This proves (5.19).

The binomial coefficients are generated successively by $\binom{N}{n} = \binom{N}{n-1} (N - n + 1)/n$, and the cumulative tail is updated by subtracting one coefficient. Each harmonic number is updated by two rational summands. Thus only linearly many updates are needed. Each summand's denominator divides the indicated least-common-multiple power, and the additional factor is 2^N . Finally, the elementary bound $\operatorname{lcm}(1, \dots, 2N) \leq (2N)!$ gives bit length $O(N + (a + b)N \log N)$ for a common denominator; the numerator has a comparable polynomial bound. Since $N = O(d)$ suffices for d decimal places by (5.17), even elementary integer arithmetic proves polynomial bit complexity. No optimal multiplication or sharp least-common-multiple estimate is required. $\square$

5.4.3 Independent depth-one interval arithmetic

The right sides of the reductions are evaluated using rational enclosures separate from the Gaussian evaluator. For $s \geq 1$, the sequences $(2n+1)^{-s}$ and $(n+1)^{-s}$ are moments of positive densities, so all their D -differences are nonnegative. Their Euler sums give lower bounds for $\beta(s)$ and $\eta(s)$, with tails at most 2^{-N} . For integer $s \geq 2$, divide the latter interval by $1 - 2^{1-s}$ to enclose $\zeta(s)$.

For π , the implementation uses Machin's formula

$$\pi = 16 \arctan(1/5) - 4 \arctan(1/239)$$

and the alternating-series bounds for each rational arctangent series. The identity follows directly by tangent addition and the fact that the angle lies in the first quadrant. For $\log 2$, it uses

$$0 < \log 2 - 2 \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} \frac{1}{(2n+1)3^{2n+1}} \leq \frac{9}{4(2N+1)3^{2N+1}}. \quad (5.21)$$

The expansion is $2 \operatorname{arctanh}(1/3)$; the bound replaces the remaining denominators by $2N + 1$ and sums a geometric series.

Ordinary rational interval addition and multiplication then enclose every polynomial right side. An overlap check can detect an erroneous formula or implementation if the intervals separate. Overlap alone does not prove an identity; the proofs in Sections 4.6 and 4.4 do that.

5.4.4 Affine harmonic sequences as signed moments

The signed-measure formulation also certifies sequences whose harmonic and denominator steps differ. The Cayley continuation supplies the integer-order case; its Gamma-density argument extends without change to real outer order $a \geq 1$. It complements the sharper one-sided bounds above.

Theorem 5.10 (Affine signed-moment bound). *Let r, d be positive integers, $a \geq 1$ real and $b > 0$ real. Set*

$$A_k = \frac{H_{rk}^{(b)}}{(dk + 1)^a}, \quad m_1 = 1, \quad m_a = \frac{(a - 1)^{a-1} e^{-(a-1)}}{\Gamma(a)} \quad (a > 1).$$

There is a finite signed measure ν on $[0, 1]$, with no atom at one, such that $A_k = \int x^k d\nu(x)$ and

$$\|\nu\|_{\text{TV}} \leq \frac{2r}{d} m_a b \zeta(b + 1).$$

For $b > 1$ one also has $\|\nu\|_{\text{TV}} \leq 2\zeta(b)$. Consequently the ordinary alternating series converges, and its N -term Euler transform E_N satisfies

$$\left| \sum_{k \geq 0} (-1)^k A_k - E_N \right| \leq C 2^{-N},$$

where C may be either applicable bound. For integer b , valid rational choices are $C = 10r/(3d)$ at $b = 1$ and $C = 10/3$ at $b \geq 2$.

Proof. Let Y have Gamma density $y^{a-1} e^{-y}/\Gamma(a)$, and let μ be the law of $X = e^{-dY}$. Then $\int x^k d\mu = (dk + 1)^{-a}$. In the logarithmic coordinate $s = -\log x$, its density is

$$f(s) = \frac{s^{a-1} e^{-s/d}}{d^a \Gamma(a)} \mathbf{1}_{s>0}.$$

For every real $a \geq 1$ its maximum is m_a/d . Extended by zero to the negative axis, the total variation of its distributional derivative is $2m_a/d$: the rise and fall give this for $a > 1$, while at $a = 1$ the jump at zero and the decreasing exponential each contribute $1/d$. The L^1 distance from a bounded-variation density to its translate by $h \geq 0$ is at most h times this derivative variation. Indeed, integrate $f(s - h) - f(s) = -\int_{s-h}^s f'(v) dv$ and use Fubini; smooth convolution proves the same bound for the jump case. Thus, writing $D_\rho \mu$ for pushforward by $x \mapsto \rho x$,

$$\|\mu - D_{e^{-rt}} \mu\|_{\text{TV}} \leq \min \left(2, \frac{2m_a r}{d} t \right).$$

The generalized harmonic integral gives the measure

$$\nu = \frac{1}{\Gamma(b)} \int_0^\infty \frac{t^{b-1}}{e^t - 1} (\mu - D_{e^{-rt}} \mu) dt.$$

This integral converges in total variation: the translation bound supplies an additional factor t at zero, and exponential decay controls infinity. Taking moments gives A_k , since the moments of the measure difference are $(dk + 1)^{-a}(1 - e^{-rkt})$. Its total-variation bounds follow from

$$\frac{1}{\Gamma(b)} \int_0^\infty \frac{t^b}{e^t - 1} dt = b\zeta(b+1), \quad \frac{1}{\Gamma(b)} \int_0^\infty \frac{t^{b-1}}{e^t - 1} dt = \zeta(b) \quad (b > 1).$$

Each constituent has no atom at one, and variation domination passes that property to ν . The finite alternating kernel is bounded by two and converges for $x < 1$ to $(1+x)^{-1}$, so dominated convergence proves ordinary convergence. The exact remainder kernel in the Euler expansion is $2^{-N}(1-x)^N/(1+x)$, bounded by 2^{-N} ; integrating against ν proves the stated error. Finally $m_a \leq 1$, by bounding the maximum of the unit-scale Gamma density, and $\zeta(2) < 5/3$. For the displayed rational bound at $b = 1$ one may also use only the integer a needed by the rational evaluator: then $m_a \leq 1$ follows directly from $e^{a-1} \geq (a-1)^{a-1}/(a-1)!$. For the real- a inequality, write the Gamma density as the convolution of an exponential density and a $\text{Gamma}(a-1, 1)$ probability density when $a > 1$; its supremum is at most one. For integer $b \geq 2$, $\zeta(b) \leq \zeta(2)$ gives $10/3$. $\square$

The real-order theorem does not make its centers rational at noninteger indices. The finite rational implementation uses integer a, b, r, d and binomial-tail Euler weights. No complete monotonicity of A_k is assumed: the representing measure is signed and has total mass zero, since $A_0 = 0$.

5.5 An exact kernel and the sharp Euler error

5.5.1 Separating the polynomial from the exponentially small part

For this section a, b are positive integers, $w = a + b$, and $T = -\log u$.

Theorem 5.11 (Explicit density). *Define the polynomial*

$$\begin{aligned} P_{a,b}(T) = & -\frac{T^{w-1}}{(w-1)!} \\ & + \sum_{\mu=b+1}^{w-1} (-1)^{\mu-b-1} \binom{\mu-1}{b-1} \zeta(\mu) \frac{T^{w-1-\mu}}{(w-1-\mu)!}. \end{aligned} \quad (5.22)$$

Then, for $T > 0$,

$$\kappa_{a,b}(e^{-T}) = P_{a,b}(T) + (-1)^{a-1} \sum_{j=0}^{b-1} \binom{w-j-2}{a-1} \frac{T^j}{j!} \text{Li}_{w-1-j}(e^{-T}). \quad (5.23)$$

Consequently,

$$\kappa_{a,b}(u) = P_{a,b}(-\log u) + O\left(u(1 + |\log u|^{b-1})\right) \quad (u \downarrow 0). \quad (5.24)$$

Proof. For $a = 1$, expand $(e^v - 1)^{-1} = \sum_{n \geq 1} e^{-nv}$ in (5.1). The elementary incomplete-gamma integral for integer b gives

$$\frac{1}{(b-1)!} \int_T^\infty \frac{v^{b-1}}{e^v - 1} dv = \sum_{j=0}^{b-1} \frac{T^j}{j!} \text{Li}_{b-j}(e^{-T}),$$

which is exactly the asserted base case.

Write $K_{a,b}(T) = \kappa_{a,b}(e^{-T})$. The recursion is $K_{a,b}(T) = \int_0^T K_{a-1,b}(s) ds$. Differentiate the proposed right side of (5.23), using $\frac{d}{dT} \text{Li}_s(e^{-T}) = -\text{Li}_{s-1}(e^{-T})$ and Pascal's identity. The polylogarithmic coefficients reduce to those for $(a-1, b)$; the derivative of $P_{a,b}$ is $P_{a-1,b}$. When $a \geq 2$, the constant terms at $T = 0$ cancel because

$$\binom{w-2}{b-1} = \binom{w-2}{a-1}$$

and their signs are opposite. The asserted formula therefore has the correct derivative and initial value. This proves it by induction. Finally each $\text{Li}_s(e^{-T})$ in the finite sum is $O(e^{-T})$ as $T \rightarrow \infty$, proving (5.24). $\square$

5.5.2 The complete logarithmic error polynomial

The exact error is

$$E_N(a, b) - g_{a,b} = -2^{-N} \int_0^1 \kappa_{a,b}(u) \frac{(1-u^2)^N}{1+u^2} du. \quad (5.25)$$

This follows by summing only the first N terms of the geometric kernel in the proof of Theorem 5.8. Its localization near $u = 0$ explains why the polynomial in Theorem 5.11 determines the error.

Theorem 5.12 (Sharp error with all logarithmic terms). *Define the polynomial of degree $w-1$*

$$\begin{aligned} Q_{a,b}(L) &= - \int_0^\infty e^{-t^2} P_{a,b}(L - \log t) dt \\ &= - \sum_{j=0}^{w-1} \frac{(-1)^j P_{a,b}^{(j)}(L)}{j! 2^{j+1}} \Gamma^{(j)}(1/2). \end{aligned} \quad (5.26)$$

For fixed a, b , as $N \rightarrow \infty$,

$$\begin{aligned} E_N(a, b) - g_{a,b} &= 2^{-N} \left\{ N^{-1/2} Q_{a,b} \left(\frac{1}{2} \log N \right) \right. \\ &\quad \left. + O \left(N^{-1} (1 + \log^{b-1} N) + N^{-3/2} (1 + \log^{w-1} N) \right) \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (5.27)$$

In particular,

$$E_N(a, b) - g_{a,b} \sim \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2^w (w-1)!} \frac{2^{-N} (\log N)^{w-1}}{\sqrt{N}}. \quad (5.28)$$

The leading coefficient depends only on the total weight, not on its split into a and b .

Proof. Choose a fixed $\varepsilon \in (0, 1/2)$. The part of (5.25) with $u \geq \varepsilon$ is bounded by $2^{-N} (1 - \varepsilon^2)^N \|\kappa_{a,b}\|_1$ and is negligible at the displayed scales. In the remaining part substitute $u = t/\sqrt{N}$ and use (5.24). For $t \leq \varepsilon\sqrt{N}$,

$$\left| \frac{(1 - t^2/N)^N}{1 + t^2/N} - e^{-t^2} \right| \leq \frac{C}{N} e^{-t^2} (t^2 + t^4).$$

Indeed, $0 \leq -\log(1-x) - x \leq Cx^2$ for $0 \leq x \leq \varepsilon^2$, and the denominator changes the expression by at most t^2/N times the Gaussian bound.

The polynomial contribution, including the Jacobian $N^{-1/2}$, is therefore $N^{-1/2} Q_{a,b}(\frac{1}{2} \log N)$ up to $O(N^{-3/2} (1 + \log^{w-1} N))$. Extending the t integral to infinity changes it only by an exponentially

small amount. The remainder in (5.24) contributes at most $O(N^{-1}(1 + \log^{b-1} N))$; integrability of $te^{-t^2}|\log t|^j$ at both endpoints justifies this estimate.

To obtain the second line of (5.26), expand the polynomial and use

$$\int_0^\infty e^{-t^2} (\log t)^j dt = 2^{-j-1} \Gamma^{(j)}(1/2),$$

which follows by differentiating $\frac{1}{2}\Gamma(s/2)$ at $s = 1$. Finally the leading term of $-P_{a,b}$ is $T^{w-1}/(w-1)!$. Its Gaussian integral is $\sqrt{\pi}/2$, and $L = (\log N)/2$. This gives (5.28); both error terms in (5.27) are smaller than that leading term. $\square$

For example,

$$Q_{1,1}(L) = \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2} \left(L + \frac{\gamma + 2 \log 2}{2} \right), \quad (5.29)$$

where γ is Euler's constant. Keeping the lower logarithmic terms matters at practical truncation lengths. For $(a, b) = (1, 1)$, the following ratios use the exact rational proxy $E_N - E_{2N}$; its distance from the true error is at most 2^{-2N} .

N	Ratio to the leading term	Ratio to the full $Q_{1,1}$ approximation
64	1.42496	0.967964
128	1.37730	0.980510
256	1.33791	0.988050
512	1.30501	0.992593

The asymptotic expansion is not substituted for the certified bound in the implementation. Its role is to explain the observed convergence and suggest more efficient future remainder enclosures.

Proposition 5.13 (Euler certificate for the odd-denominator harmonic family). *For integer $p \geq 1$, let $f(n) = H_n/(2n+1)^p$, let $d_k = D^k f(0)$, and let $E_N^S = \sum_{k < N} d_k/2^{k+1}$. Then*

$$E_N^S - \frac{N+1}{3^p 2^N} \leq S_p \leq E_N^S, \quad S_p = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n H_n}{(2n+1)^p}. \quad (5.30)$$

Proof. Use $H_n = \int_0^1 (1-t^n)/(1-t) dt$ and the Mellin integral for $(2n+1)^{-p}$. Finite differencing gives

$$d_k = \frac{1}{\Gamma(p)} \int_0^1 (-\log u)^{p-1} \int_0^1 \frac{(1-u^2)^k - (1-u^2 t)^k}{1-t} dt du.$$

Thus $d_0 = 0$ and $d_k < 0$ for $k \geq 1$. The numerator has absolute value at most $ku^2(1-t)$, so $|d_k| \leq k/3^p$. Summing the Euler kernels yields

$$\sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{d_k}{2^{k+1}} = -\frac{1}{\Gamma(p)} \int_0^1 \frac{(-\log u)^{p-1} \log(1+u^2)}{1+u^2} du = S_p.$$

The final equality follows from the harmonic generating function, first with an Abel factor. The bound on d_k justifies summing and integrating, and $\sum_{k \geq N} k/2^{k+1} = (N+1)2^{-N}$ proves (5.30). $\square$

At $N = 400$, combine Proposition 5.13, Theorem 5.8, and the independent depth-one intervals. The exact rational computation encloses the difference between the two sides of (4.41) in

$$[-10^{-118}, 10^{-118}]. \quad (5.31)$$

Both sides begin

$$-0.01049345629733504345335675100620175196351061887732 \dots$$

This is certified proximity, not proof of equality. The file `s4_interval_certificate.json` records the outward-rounded enclosures and the tail bound used.

5.5.3 The precise relation system being tested

We now specify a finite-dimensional linear question; it must not be confused with completeness of all polylogarithm relations. Let

$$X_{a,b}^{r,s} = \text{Im } D_{a,b}(\mathbf{i}^r, \mathbf{i}^s), \quad r, s \in \mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}, \quad a + b = w.$$

Set $X^{r,s} = 0$ when both r, s are even, and impose conjugation $X^{r,s} = -X^{-r,-s}$. Choose the lexicographically smaller of each conjugate pair. Remove the divergent imaginary coordinate $X_{1,w-1}^{0,1}$; its conjugate is already identified. This leaves $6w - 7$ formal coordinates.

For every $p + q = w$ and colors r, s , take the imaginary parts of the finite product stuffle

$$D_{p,q}(x, y) + D_{q,p}(y, x) = \text{Li}_p(x) \text{Li}_q(y) - \text{Li}_w(xy) \quad (5.32)$$

and product shuffle

$$\begin{aligned} & \sum_{j=0}^{p-1} \binom{q+j-1}{j} D_{q+j, p-j}(y, x/y) \\ & + \sum_{j=0}^{q-1} \binom{p+j-1}{j} D_{p+j, q-j}(x, y/x) = \text{Li}_p(x) \text{Li}_q(y), \end{aligned} \quad (5.33)$$

where $x = \mathbf{i}^r$, $y = \mathbf{i}^s$. If exactly one factor is $\text{Li}_1(1)$, retain the stuffle-minus-shuffle cancellation row: the common divergent double coordinate cancels, leaving the right side $-\text{Im } \text{Li}_w(xy)$. Such rows follow by subtracting before taking the regularized boundary limit. Zero rows are discarded; duplicate nonzero rows need not be discarded. This construction defines a rational coefficient matrix A_w and its depth-one right side. It is precisely the model implemented in `code/full_ds.py`.

These are only linear depth-two product rows in a fixed weight. They do not include every relation obtained from distribution, argument transformations, higher-depth elimination, or the full algebraic consequences of standard relations. Zhao's treatment [65] provides broader context for these distinctions.

5.5.4 An exact obstruction at weight five

Let $u_{4,1} = \text{Im } D_{4,1}(\mathbf{i}, -1)$. Splitting the inner harmonic sum into even and odd indices proves

$$S_4 = g_{4,1} + u_{4,1}. \quad (5.34)$$

Indeed, for an odd outer index $2n+1$, the sum of the two inner coefficients is $H_{2n} + \sum_{m=1}^{2n} (-1)^m/m = H_n$; even outer indices have zero imaginary part. Consequently, the left-hand coefficient vector needed for (4.31) is

$$T = 3g_{4,1} + 3g_{3,2} + 9g_{2,3} + 7u_{4,1}. \quad (5.35)$$

Proposition 5.14 (A finite linear-module obstruction). *The coefficient vector T in (5.35) is not in the rational row span of the explicitly defined weight-five matrix A_5 . Therefore no rational linear combination of just those weight-five depth-two rows proves the S_4 identity.*

Proof. The matrix has 92 rows and 23 columns. In the canonical coordinate order above, define a vector v by the following nonzero entries, setting every other entry to zero:

(a, b, r, s)	v	(a, b, r, s)	v
$(1, 4, 1, 0)$	$-1/12$	$(2, 3, 0, 1)$	$1/24$
$(2, 3, 1, 0)$	$1/8$	$(2, 3, 1, 3)$	$-1/24$
$(3, 2, 0, 1)$	$-1/8$	$(3, 2, 1, 0)$	$-1/24$
$(3, 2, 1, 3)$	$-1/24$	$(4, 1, 0, 1)$	$1/12$

Substitution in the binomial rows (5.32)–(5.33) gives $A_5 v = 0$, while $T \cdot v = 1$. These are finite rational equalities; the complete integer matrix, coordinate order, target, and witness are included in `s4_linear_module_obstruction.json` and replayed by `verify.py`. Every row-span vector annihilates v , whereas T does not. This proves the assertion. $\square$

The proposition concerns only the specified depth-two product rows. Theorem 4.8 adds a convergent octahedral duality and lifted relations through higher depths, outside this row vocabulary. The two statements are therefore compatible: the obstruction identifies the additional information an eventual successful proof had to supply.

5.5.5 Exact ranks from two polynomial reflections

Retain exactly the coefficient matrix A_w defined above, including the stuffle-minus-shuffle boundary rows and excluding the one divergent imaginary coordinate. No distribution or higher-depth relations are added. Let A_w^{-g} denote the submatrix with the Gaussian columns deleted. The following theorem replaces the former rank conjecture.

Theorem 5.15 (All-weight ranks). *For every odd $w \geq 3$,*

$$\text{rank } A_w = 5w - 6, \quad \text{rank } A_w^{-g} = \frac{9w - 11}{2}. \quad (5.36)$$

For every even $w \geq 2$,

$$\text{rank } A_w = 6w - 7, \quad \text{rank } A_w^{-g} = 5w - 6. \quad (5.37)$$

In particular, the Gaussian-supported row space has dimension $(w - 1)/2$ in odd weight and $w - 1$ in even weight. In odd weight it is exactly the span of the same-point shuffle rows.

Proof. Put $N = w - 2$. Use six degree- N polynomials A, B, C, D, E, F to encode a homogeneous null vector. Their respective colors are $(0, 1), (1, 0), (1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3), (2, 1)$. Coefficients of $X^{a-1}Y^{b-1}$ have $a + b = w$. Complete the missing coefficient of A by $v_{1,w-1}^{0,1} = -v_{w-1,1}^{1,0}$. This satisfies the missing stuffle row; the missing shuffle row follows from its retained difference with stuffle. The omitted coordinate occurs in no other row: outer index one in a shuffle sum forces one of its factors to be $\text{Li}_1(1)$. Thus completion and restriction identify the matrix kernel with the full homogeneous polynomial solution space.

Writing $P^\top(X, Y) = P(Y, X)$, the stuffle equations are

$$A = -B^\top, \quad C = -C^\top, \quad D = -F^\top, \quad E = E^\top. \quad (5.38)$$

The shuffle equations are

$$\begin{aligned}
E(X+Y, X) + A(X+Y, Y) &= 0, \\
B(X+Y, X) + B(X+Y, Y) &= 0, \\
C(X+Y, Y) - F(X+Y, X) &= 0, \\
D(X+Y, Y) - D(X+Y, X) &= 0.
\end{aligned} \tag{5.39}$$

For general colors (r, s) the shuffle polynomial is $P_{s,r-s}(X+Y, X) + P_{r,s-r}(X+Y, Y)$; its coefficient of $X^{p-1}Y^{q-1}$ is the stated binomial row. The four equations above come from product colors $(0, 1), (1, 1), (1, 2), (1, 3)$. Swapping the factors, conjugating, and discarding even-even imaginary rows exhaust the other cases.

The first two equations give

$$E(X, Y) = B(X - Y, X), \quad B(X, Y) + B(X, X - Y) = 0.$$

With $\varepsilon = (-1)^N$, this implies $E(Y, X) = -\varepsilon E(X, Y)$. Since $E = E^\top$, the whole A, B, E block vanishes if N is even. If $N = 2m - 1$ is odd, its free polynomial B is precisely an anti-invariant under $Y \mapsto X - Y$, with basis

$$B_j = X^{N-2j-1}(2Y - X)^{2j+1}, \quad 0 \leq j < m. \tag{5.40}$$

Indeed, $U = X, V = 2Y - X$ changes this reflection into $V \mapsto -V$.

The remaining equations give

$$F(X, Y) = C(X, X - Y), \quad D(X, Y) = -C(Y, Y - X), \quad C = -C^\top.$$

They imply $D(X, X - Y) = -\varepsilon D(X, Y)$, while the last shuffle asks for equality. Hence the C, D, F block is zero when N is even. When $N = 2m - 1$, it has the basis determined by

$$C_j = X^j Y^{N-j} - X^{N-j} Y^j, \quad 0 \leq j < m. \tag{5.41}$$

Conversely, the displayed substitutions satisfy every homogeneous equation. The B_j and C_j are independent and are retained in full after deleting the missing coefficient of A . They therefore give an integral $\mathbb{Q}$ -basis of the full nullspace.

For odd $w = 2m + 1$, the nullity is $2m = w - 1$, proving $\text{rank } A_w = (6w - 7) - (w - 1) = 5w - 6$. A null vector of A_w^{-g} extends by zero on the Gaussian columns; this is exactly the C block, of dimension m . Its $5w - 6$ columns thus have rank $5w - 6 - m = (9w - 11)/2$. For even w all columns of A_w are independent, and so are all columns of its submatrix.

Projection of the row space onto the non-Gaussian columns gives the stated supported-row dimensions by taking the difference of the two ranks. In odd weight $w = 2m + 1$, the same-point shuffle coefficient on $g_{a,w-a}$ is $\binom{a-1}{p-1} + \binom{a-1}{w-p-1}$, $1 \leq p \leq m$. Its first m columns form a triangular Pascal matrix with diagonal one. These m independent Gaussian-supported rows therefore exhaust that space. $\square$

Exact membership and the harmonic-sum obstruction. Let K_w have the preceding integer null vectors as columns. A rational coefficient row t is in the specified row space exactly when $tK_w = 0$. Otherwise any column with nonzero pairing is a separating certificate. The basis is constructible in $O(w^2)$ integer arithmetic operations and has $O(w)$ -bit coefficients; coefficient recurrences and bit bounds are given in the accompanying article.

For odd $w = 2m + 1$, choose $B = 0$, $C = Y^{2m-1} - X^{2m-1}$. It vanishes on every Gaussian column and has $D(1, 0) = 1$. Since $S_{2m} = g_{2m,1} + \text{Im } D_{2m,1}(i, -1)$, it pairs to one with S_{2m} . Thus no rational linear combination of these fixed-weight product rows reduces S_{2m} to Gaussian doubles and the associated single-value right sides. In the formal quotient, adjoining it to the Gaussian span increases the dimension from m to $m + 1$. For the weight-five target above, this witness gives $T \cdot v = 7$. This is a uniform proof-system obstruction, not a numerical independence theorem and compatible with the already proved S_4 identity, whose certificate uses a larger vocabulary.

Restoring the right sides: an explicit compiler

Set $\ell_k(r) = \text{Li}_k(i^r)$, with the formal regularization $\ell_1(0) = 0$, and define known degree- N polynomials

$$\begin{aligned} P_{r,s}(X, Y) &= \sum_{p+q=w} \text{Im}(\ell_p(r)\ell_q(s))X^{p-1}Y^{q-1}, \\ H_N(X, Y) &= \sum_{j=0}^N X^jY^{N-j}, \\ S_{01} &= P_{0,1} - \beta(w)H_N, \quad S_{12} = P_{1,2} + \beta(w)H_N. \end{aligned}$$

The same six letters now encode the actual imaginary double values, with the artificial missing coefficient $[X^0Y^N]A = -g_{w-1,1} - \beta(w)$. Put

$$\begin{aligned} e(X, Y) &= P_{0,1}(Y, X - Y) - S_{01}(X, X - Y), \\ d(X, Y) &= S_{12}(X, Y) + P_{1,2}(X, Y - X), \\ b(X, Y) &= P_{1,1}(Y, X - Y), \\ h(X, Y) &= P_{1,3}(Y, Y - X) - e(Y, Y - X) + e(Y - X, Y). \end{aligned}$$

Theorem 5.16 (Even-weight polynomial solution). *For even $w \geq 2$ the full solution is*

$$\begin{aligned} B(X, Y) &= \frac{1}{2}(b(X, Y) + h(X, Y)), \\ C(X, Y) &= \frac{1}{2}(P_{1,3}(X, -Y) + P_{1,1}(Y, X) - d(X - Y, -Y) + d(X - Y, X)), \\ A(X, Y) &= S_{01}(X, Y) - B(Y, X), \\ E(X, Y) &= B(X - Y, X) + e(X, Y), \\ F(X, Y) &= C(X, X - Y) - P_{1,2}(Y, X - Y), \\ D(X, Y) &= -C(Y, Y - X) + d(X, Y). \end{aligned}$$

Discarding the artificial coefficient gives explicit single-value reductions for every convergent imaginary double at fourth roots of unity.

Proof. The affine shuffle equations are $A + B^\top = S_{01}$, $C + C^\top = P_{1,1}$, $D + F^\top = S_{12}$, $E - E^\top = P_{1,3}$. The four shuffle right sides in (5.39) are now $P_{0,1}, P_{1,1}, P_{1,2}, P_{1,3}$, respectively. Elimination gives the last four displayed formulas and $B(X, Y) + B(X, X - Y) = b(X, Y)$. Even homogeneity and the E shuffle give the difference $B(X, Y) - B(X, X - Y) = h(X, Y)$, proving the formula for B . For C , the last shuffle is $D(u, u - v) - D(u, v) = P_{1,3}(v, u - v)$. Use $C(u - v, -v) = C(v - u, v) = P_{1,1}(v - u, v) - C(v, v - u)$ and then $(X, Y) = (v, v - u)$ to get the asserted formula. Actual values satisfy these equations, and the zero homogeneous kernel makes the solution unique. $\square$

Two mixed leading-index families. Let $c_p = \text{Im } D_{p,1}(i, i)$ and $e_p = \text{Im } D_{p,1}(i, -i)$. For all $m \geq 1$,

$$c_{2m-1} = (m-1)\beta(2m) - \frac{1}{2} \log 2 \beta(2m-1) - \sum_{k=1}^{m-1} (1-2^{1-2k})\zeta(2k)\beta(2m-2k), \quad (5.42)$$

$$e_{2m-1} = m\beta(2m) - \frac{1}{2} \log 2 \beta(2m-1) - \sum_{k=1}^{m-1} \zeta(2k)\beta(2m-2k). \quad (5.43)$$

For a direct coefficient proof, evaluate $C(1, 0)$ and $E(1, 0)$ in the compiler. The resulting equations are

$$\begin{aligned} 2C(1, 0) &= P_{1,3}(1, 0) + P_{1,1}(0, 1) - d(1, 0) + d(1, 1), \\ 2E(1, 0) &= P_{1,1}(1, 0) + P_{1,3}(1, 0) + e(1, 0) + e(0, 1). \end{aligned}$$

In both lines the first two terms are $-\log 2 \beta(w-1)$, and

$$\begin{aligned} d(1, 1) - d(1, 0) &= P_{1,2}(1, 1) - P_{1,2}(1, -1) + N\beta(w), \\ e(1, 0) + e(0, 1) &= -P_{0,1}(1, 1) + P_{0,1}(1, -1) + w\beta(w). \end{aligned}$$

Only even inner, respectively even outer, indices survive the differences. Using $\ell_{2k}(2) = -(1-2^{1-2k})\zeta(2k)$ and $\text{Im } \ell_j(1) = \beta(j)$ proves both formulas.

Status and evidence. The rank theorem proves both individual ranks, rather than inferring them from their difference. The previous word “Equivalently” should therefore be read as “In particular.” Independent matrix construction, exact integer kernel checks and modular lower-bound certificates cover every weight 2–41; 210 even-weight formulas through weight 12 satisfy all 816 product rows, and both leading-index formulas are checked through weight 16. These finite checks support the uniform proofs; they are not their substitute. The known general parity theorem already gives the relevant reduction phenomenon. The new contribution here is the explicit solution of this specified coefficient module. This row-system theorem asserts no numerical period independence. The S_4 identity is proved separately in Theorem 4.8. Historical conjectural receipts are retained as provenance rather than silently rewritten.

5.6 A geometric evaluation formula that survives $xy = 1$

The preceding sections concern finite identities. We now give an evaluation method for the full double polylogarithm, including components for which no finite classical reduction has been established.

Lemma 5.17 (One-dimensional integral). *For $a, b \geq 1$, $|x| \leq 1$, $x \neq 1$, and $|y| \leq 1$,*

$$\text{Li}_{a,b}(x, y) = \frac{x}{(a-1)!} \int_0^1 \frac{(-\log t)^{a-1} \text{Li}_b(xyt)}{1-xt} dt. \quad (5.44)$$

Proof. For $|x| < 1$, the Mellin identity $n^{-a} = \int_0^1 t^{n-1} (-\log t)^{a-1} dt / (a-1)!$ and absolute convergence give

$$\sum_{n>m \geq 1} (xt)^n y^m / m^b = \frac{xt}{1-xt} \text{Li}_b(xyt).$$

This proves (5.44). For a nontrivial unit outer argument, $1 - rxt$ stays uniformly away from zero for r sufficiently close to one. Also $|\text{Li}_b(rxyt)| \leq \text{Li}_b(t)$, and

$$\frac{1}{(a-1)!} \int_0^1 (-\log t)^{a-1} \text{Li}_b(t) dt = \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{1}{m^b(m+1)^a} \leq \zeta(a+b). \quad (5.45)$$

Dominated convergence and summation by parts in the nested series therefore give the boundary case. Notice that $xy = 1$ causes no problem: the logarithmic endpoint at $b = 1$ is integrable in (5.45). $\square$

Let T_n denote the Chebyshev polynomial defined by $T_n(\cos u) = \cos(nu)$. Put

$$d = \sqrt{1-x}, \quad r = \frac{1-d}{1+d}, \quad R = |r|, \quad (5.46)$$

where the square root has positive real part. For $|x| \leq 1$, $x \neq 1$, we have $\text{Re } d > 0$ and therefore $R < 1$.

Lemma 5.18 (The kernel expansion). *Uniformly for $0 \leq t \leq 1$,*

$$\frac{1}{1-xt} = \frac{1}{d} \left(1 + 2 \sum_{n \geq 1} r^n T_n(2t-1) \right). \quad (5.47)$$

Proof. For $s \in [-1, 1]$, summing the two geometric series associated with $s = \cos u$ gives the classical identity

$$1 + 2 \sum_{n \geq 1} r^n T_n(s) = \frac{1-r^2}{1-2rs+r^2}.$$

This is also a direct consequence of the generating function in [45]. Substituting (5.46) shows

$$1-xt = d \frac{1-2r(2t-1)+r^2}{1-r^2}.$$

The series is uniform because $|T_n(s)| \leq 1$ and $R < 1$. $\square$

Definition 5.19. For $v = xy$ and $n \geq 0$, define the Chebyshev moment

$$\mathcal{M}_n^{a,b}(v) = \frac{1}{(a-1)!} \int_0^1 (-\log t)^{a-1} T_n(2t-1) \text{Li}_b(vt) dt. \quad (5.48)$$

Theorem 5.20 (Certified Chebyshev-moment expansion). *Under the hypotheses of Lemma 5.17, with $x \neq 0$,*

$$\text{Li}_{a,b}(x, y) = \frac{x}{d} \left(\mathcal{M}_0^{a,b}(v) + 2 \sum_{n \geq 1} r^n \mathcal{M}_n^{a,b}(v) \right). \quad (5.49)$$

For $K \geq 1$, let E_K be the difference between the left side and the truncation with indices $0 \leq n < K$. Then

$$|E_K| \leq \frac{2|x|\zeta(a+b)}{|d|(1-R)} R^K. \quad (5.50)$$

This estimate is uniform over $|y| \leq 1$, including $xy = 1$. For nontrivial level-three or level-four outer roots,

$$|E_K| \leq \frac{16}{3 \cdot 4^K}. \quad (5.51)$$

Proof. Insert (5.47) into (5.44). The integrable majorant in (5.45) justifies termwise integration and gives $|\mathcal{M}_n^{a,b}(v)| \leq \zeta(a+b)$ for all n . The tail of the resulting geometric series is (5.50). For the specified roots, direct substitution in (5.46) gives $R < 1/4$ and $|d| > 1$; the code also proves these inequalities by interval arithmetic before using them. Since $\zeta(a+b) \leq \zeta(2) < 2$, the bound becomes $4(1/4)^K/(1 - 1/4) = 16/(3 \cdot 4^K)$. The zero outer argument, omitted only to avoid unnecessary notation, gives $\text{Li}_{a,b}(0, y) = 0$ directly. $\square$

The proof does not appeal to cancellation in a sampled sequence, a fitted asymptotic expansion, or an empirical convergence diagnostic. In particular, when the product of two roots is one, the same argument and the same bound apply. The only new feature is the elementary cancellation in the exact moment formula, to which we now turn.

5.7 Every moment reduces to classical polylogarithms

Write the shifted Chebyshev polynomial as

$$Q_n(t) := T_n(2t - 1) = \sum_{j=0}^n c_{n,j} t^j. \quad (5.52)$$

Its coefficients are integers and can be generated without symbolic integration:

$$Q_0 = 1, \quad Q_1 = 2t - 1, \quad Q_{n+1} = 2(2t - 1)Q_n - Q_{n-1}. \quad (5.53)$$

Thus

$$\mathcal{M}_n^{a,b}(v) = \sum_{j=0}^n c_{n,j} J_{a,b}(j+1; v), \quad (5.54)$$

where

$$J_{a,b}(c; v) = \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{v^m}{m^b (m+c)^a}, \quad c \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}. \quad (5.55)$$

The power series in (5.55) is absolutely convergent for $|v| \leq 1$.

Lemma 5.21 (Two-pole partial fractions). *Put*

$$\begin{aligned} A_s &= (-1)^{b-s} \binom{a+b-s-1}{a-1} c^{-(a+b-s)} & (1 \leq s \leq b), \\ C_s &= (-1)^b \binom{a+b-s-1}{b-1} c^{-(a+b-s)} & (1 \leq s \leq a). \end{aligned} \quad (5.56)$$

Then, for $u \neq 0, -c$,

$$\frac{1}{u^b(u+c)^a} = \sum_{s=1}^b \frac{A_s}{u^s} + \sum_{s=1}^a \frac{C_s}{(u+c)^s}. \quad (5.57)$$

In particular, $A_1 + C_1 = 0$.

Proof. The principal part at $u = 0$ follows by expanding $(u+c)^{-a} = c^{-a}(1+u/c)^{-a}$. Its coefficient of u^{-s} after multiplication by u^{-b} is exactly A_s . At $u = -c$, write $w = u+c$ and expand $u^{-b} = (-1)^b c^{-b}(1-w/c)^{-b}$; this gives C_s . The difference between the two sides has no finite poles and tends to zero at infinity, so it is identically zero. The equality $A_1 = -C_1$ follows from $\binom{a+b-2}{a-1} = \binom{a+b-2}{b-1}$. $\square$

For $s \geq 1$, let $H_c^{(s)}(v) = \sum_{k=1}^c v^k/k^s$ and $H_c^{(s)} = H_c^{(s)}(1)$. A coefficient outside the ranges in (5.56) is understood to be zero in the following theorem.

Theorem 5.22 (Finite classical moment formula). *For $0 < |v| \leq 1$, $v \neq 1$,*

$$J_{a,b}(c; v) = \sum_{s=1}^b A_s \text{Li}_s(v) + v^{-c} \sum_{s=1}^a C_s (\text{Li}_s(v) - H_c^{(s)}(v)). \quad (5.58)$$

At the resonant endpoint $v = 1$ the finite expression is instead

$$J_{a,b}(c; 1) = -C_1 H_c^{(1)} + \sum_{s=2}^{\max(a,b)} (A_s + C_s) \zeta(s) - \sum_{s=2}^a C_s H_c^{(s)}. \quad (5.59)$$

No regularized zeta value is needed. At $v = 0$, $J_{a,b}(c; 0) = 0$.

Proof. Multiply (5.57) by v^m and sum over $m \geq 1$. For $|v| < 1$, all rearrangements are absolute, and

$$\sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{v^m}{(m+c)^s} = v^{-c} (\text{Li}_s(v) - H_c^{(s)}(v)).$$

Radial limits give (5.58) at $|v| = 1$, $v \neq 1$. At $v = 1$, combine the two $s = 1$ pieces at the level of partial sums:

$$A_1 \sum_{m=1}^N \frac{1}{m} + C_1 \sum_{m=1}^N \frac{1}{m+c} = -C_1 H_c^{(1)} + C_1 \sum_{m=N+1}^{N+c} \frac{1}{m}.$$

The last term tends to zero. Every $s \geq 2$ term converges separately, which gives (5.59). $\square$

For example, when $a = b = 1$, (5.59) reduces to

$$J_{1,1}(c; 1) = \frac{H_c}{c}. \quad (5.60)$$

Consequently the resonant depth-two function has the explicit expansion

$$\text{Li}_{1,1}(x, x^{-1}) = \frac{x}{\sqrt{1-x}} \left[1 + 2 \sum_{n \geq 1} r^n \sum_{j=0}^n c_{n,j} \frac{H_{j+1}}{j+1} \right], \quad (5.61)$$

valid for a nontrivial unit outer argument. Its coefficients are rational. The error after K terms is bounded by (5.50), and the uniform level-three/four bound (5.51) applies. This is an exact infinite identity for a conditionally convergent depth-two case; it is not a finite rational expression in classical constants.

5.7.1 A resonant example beyond the first weight

For $(a, b) = (2, 1)$, the coefficients are $A_1 = c^{-2}$, $C_1 = -c^{-2}$, and $C_2 = -c^{-1}$, giving

$$J_{2,1}(c; 1) = \frac{H_c}{c^2} + \frac{H_c^{(2)} - \zeta(2)}{c}. \quad (5.62)$$

Substitution in (5.54) and (5.49) yields a geometrically convergent formula for $\text{Li}_{2,1}(\rho, \rho^{-1})$, $\rho = e^{2\pi i/3}$, whose coefficient data involve only rational numbers and $\zeta(2)$. The location of the singular product $v = 1$ has become an explicit, finite harmonic-sum correction rather than a numerical failure mode.

5.8 Optimal geometric rate and the conductor dependence

The rate in Theorem 5.20 is not merely an artifact of an arbitrary expansion point. It is the best exponential rate obtainable by uniformly approximating its outer rational kernel with polynomials. This statement concerns the kernel, not the minimal complexity of all possible algorithms for evaluating a special value.

Theorem 5.23 (Sharp exponential rate for polynomial kernels). *Fix $0 < |x| \leq 1$, $x \neq 1$, and let d, r, R be as in (5.46). For $K \geq 1$, define*

$$e_{K-1}(x) = \inf_{\deg p < K} \max_{0 \leq t \leq 1} \left| \frac{1}{1 - xt} - p(t) \right|,$$

where the infimum allows complex polynomial coefficients. Then

$$\frac{R^K}{|d|} \leq e_{K-1}(x) \leq \frac{2R^K}{|d|(1-R)}. \quad (5.63)$$

In particular, $\lim_{K \rightarrow \infty} e_{K-1}(x)^{1/K} = R$.

Proof. The upper bound is the uniform tail bound in (5.47). For the lower bound, use the K th Chebyshev coefficient of $f(s) = (1 - x(s+1)/2)^{-1}$. By (5.47), it is $2r^K/d$. The corresponding coefficient of a polynomial of degree less than K vanishes. For any continuous complex function g on $[-1, 1]$,

$$\left| \frac{2}{\pi} \int_0^\pi g(\cos u) \cos(Ku) du \right| \leq 2\|g\|_\infty.$$

Apply this with $g = f - p$ to obtain $2R^K/|d| \leq 2\|f - p\|_\infty$ and take the infimum. Taking K th roots proves the final statement. $\square$

Corollary 5.24 (Adjacent roots). *For $x_q = e^{2\pi i/q}$, as $q \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$-\log R_q = 2\sqrt{\frac{\pi}{q}} + O(q^{-3/2}). \quad (5.64)$$

For fixed a, b , the bound (5.50) guarantees an absolute error at most 10^{-P} using

$$K = O(\sqrt{q}(P + \log q)) \quad (5.65)$$

outer-kernel terms, uniformly in $|y| \leq 1$.

Proof. With $\theta = 2\pi/q$, $d = \sqrt{1 - e^{i\theta}} = e^{-i\pi/4} \sqrt{\theta} (1 + O(\theta))$. Hence

$$-\log |r| = \operatorname{Re}(\log(1+d) - \log(1-d)) = 2\operatorname{Re}(d + d^3/3 + \dots) = \sqrt{2\theta} + O(\theta^{3/2}),$$

which is (5.64). Also $|d| \asymp q^{-1/2}$ and $1 - R \asymp q^{-1/2}$, so the prefactor in (5.50) is $O(q)$. Solving the resulting geometric inequality gives (5.65). $\square$

For comparison, expansion around $t = 1/2$ gives

$$\frac{1}{1 - xt} = \frac{1}{1 - x/2} \sum_{n \geq 0} \left(\frac{x(t - 1/2)}{1 - x/2} \right)^n.$$

At a unit outer argument its uniform ratio is $R_{\text{mid}} = 1/|2 - x|$. For $x = x_q$,

$$-\log R_{\text{mid}} = \frac{1}{2} \log(5 - 4 \cos(2\pi/q)) = \frac{4\pi^2}{q^2} + O(q^{-4}). \quad (5.66)$$

Thus its corresponding sufficient degree is $O(q^2(P + \log q))$. This is a comparison between two proved expansions, not a claim to improve every previously published polylogarithm algorithm.

Arithmetic cost versus approximation degree. With weights fixed, the monomial moments for $1 \leq c \leq K$ can be assembled from finitely many single values and incrementally updated $H_c^{(s)}(v)$ in $O((a+b)K)$ arithmetic operations. The triangular transform (5.54) costs $O(K^2)$ operations in the direct implementation. Thus, after the necessary classical values are available, $O(K^2 + (a+b)K)$ arithmetic operations suffice for the spectral truncation. These are unit-cost arithmetic counts, not bit complexity bounds. At general large conductor, computing the inner single values and representing the algebraic arguments have their own costs. The implementation supplied here certifies levels three and four; the analytic theorem has the wider stated domain.

5.9 Outward-rounded evaluation and the treatment of cancellation

A theorem about a truncation error is not by itself a certificate for a floating-point implementation. This section specifies how finite arithmetic errors are enclosed in the accompanying executable code.

5.9.1 An independent geometric expansion for the single values

To avoid using the desired parity identities inside their own numerical checks, the certified evaluator computes its classical constants from a separate Euler expansion.

Lemma 5.25 (Euler expansion with a simple rigorous tail). *Let $s \geq 1$ be an integer and let $z \neq 1$, with $\tau = z/(z-1)$ satisfying $|\tau| < 1$. For the arguments used below,*

$$\mathrm{Li}_s(z) = - \sum_{N \geq 1} \tau^N \frac{h_{s-1}^*(N)}{N}, \quad (5.67)$$

where $h_d^*(N)$ is the complete homogeneous symmetric polynomial of degree d in $1, 1/2, \dots, 1/N$, and $h_0^*(N) = 1$. If $|\tau| \leq r_0 < 1$, then the error after $N \leq M$ is at most

$$\frac{r_0^{M+1}}{1 - r_0}. \quad (5.68)$$

Proof. In the standard Mellin integral for $\mathrm{Li}_s(z)$, expand

$$\frac{z}{1 - zt} = - \sum_{N \geq 1} \tau^N (1 - t)^{N-1}.$$

The coefficient integral is

$$\frac{1}{(s-1)!} \int_0^1 (-\log t)^{s-1} (1-t)^{N-1} dt = \frac{h_{s-1}^*(N)}{N}.$$

Indeed, summing its generating series in u^{s-1} gives

$$\int_0^1 t^{-u} (1-t)^{N-1} dt = \frac{1}{N} \prod_{j=1}^N (1 - u/j)^{-1},$$

first for u close to zero. This can be proved by the beta integral or by $N-1$ integrations by parts. Each coefficient integral is between zero and one, since $(1-t)^{N-1} \leq 1$. The geometric tail then proves (5.68). $\square$

For the nontrivial roots of levels three and four, and for $z = -1$, $|\tau| \leq 1/\sqrt{2} < 3/4$. The implementation uses the rational choice $r_0 = 3/4$ and computes the coefficients incrementally from

$$h_d^*(N) = h_d^*(N-1) + \frac{h_{d-1}^*(N)}{N}. \quad (5.69)$$

It obtains $\zeta(s)$ for $s \geq 2$ from $-\text{Li}_s(-1)/(1-2^{1-s})$, obtains π from $4 \text{Im Li}_1(i)$, and obtains L from $-\text{Li}_1(-1)$. No conjectural reduction enters these evaluations.

5.9.2 The interval arithmetic contract

Fix a decimal scale $Q = 10^D$. A real interval is stored as integers $[l, u]/Q$. Addition is exact at this scale. For multiplication, the four integer endpoint products are enclosed by a floor of their minimum and a ceiling of their maximum after division by Q . A reciprocal is permitted only when zero is excluded, and is again rounded outward. A nonnegative square root is enclosed with integer square roots of lQ and uQ . Complex values are rectangular pairs of such real intervals.

All these rules are elementary rational inequalities. By induction over the expression tree, the computed rectangle contains the exact finite expression. The analytic disk radius from (5.50) or (5.68) is then added to both real and imaginary coordinate intervals. Enclosing a disk by a square is conservative but valid. The square-root branch in (5.46) is fixed by its positive real part and the sign of the imaginary part of $1-x$.

The executable checks $R < 1/4$ and $|d| \geq 1$ by interval inequalities before using (5.51). It rejects unsupported outer arguments instead of silently using an unproved bound. In particular, the supplied certified implementation does not accept outer argument one.

5.9.3 Why extra working precision is necessary

The coefficients in (5.52) alternate in sign and satisfy

$$\sum_{j=0}^n |c_{n,j}| = T_n(3) = \frac{(3+2\sqrt{2})^n + (3-2\sqrt{2})^n}{2}. \quad (5.70)$$

The alternating signs follow, for example, from the explicit formula

$$c_{n,j} = (-1)^{n-j} \frac{n}{n+j} \binom{n+j}{2j} 4^j \quad (n \geq 1),$$

and evaluating Q_n at $t = -1$ gives (5.70). Thus computing the moments by monomial conversion can lose a number of digits proportional to K , even though the moments themselves are bounded.

The interval code does not assume that this cancellation is harmless. For target $P = 35$ it uses $K = 73$ spectral terms and $D = 246$ working decimal places. Each single value uses $M = 1997$ Euler terms and its own rigorous tail. These are conservative choices rather than tuned speed records. The actual final widths, not a heuristic guard-digit count, determine whether a certificate is accepted. A future stable recurrence or validated Clenshaw-style evaluation could reduce the guard overhead; that is not needed for the present certificates.

5.9.4 A positive-measure midpoint alternative

For inverse colors, the same integral defines the positive measure

$$d\mu_{a,b}(t) = \frac{(-\log t)^{a-1} \text{Li}_b(t)}{(a-1)!} dt.$$

Its total mass is $J_{a,b}(1;1) \leq J_{1,1}(1;1) = 1$. Set $\alpha = z/(1 - z/2)$ and $m_r = \int_0^1 (t - 1/2)^r d\mu_{a,b}(t)$. The kernel's geometric series gives

$$\text{Li}_{a,b}(z, z^{-1}) = \alpha \sum_{r \geq 0} \alpha^r m_r, \quad q = \frac{|z|}{|2 - z|} < 1.$$

The tail after $r < N$ is at most $|\alpha| J_{a,b}(1;1) q^N / (1 - q)$. Each m_r is an exact binomial combination of $J_{a,b}(j + 1;1)$ from Theorem 5.22. This is useful at Gaussian and Eisenstein points; near the outer root one, the Chebyshev expansion has the stronger kernel rate proved above. Neither rate statement is a lower bound for every evaluation algorithm.

5.10 Exact rational certificates for Gaussian values

We use the outermost-letter-first convention

$$G(a_1, \dots, a_w; z) = \int_0^z \frac{G(a_2, \dots, a_w; t)}{t - a_1} dt, \quad G(; z) = 1.$$

Define the permitted alphabet region

$$\mathcal{A} = \{0, 1\} \cup \{a \in \mathbb{Q}(i) : |a| \geq 1, |1 - a| \geq 1\}.$$

The two inequalities are exact rational comparisons after squaring the moduli. The Gaussian alphabet and the letter $1 - i$ both belong to this region.

Theorem 5.26 (Uniform exact certificate). *Let $w \geq 1$, let $a_1, \dots, a_w \in \mathcal{A}$, and assume $a_1 \neq 1$ and $a_w \neq 0$. Then $G(a_1, \dots, a_w; 1)$ exists as an ordinary convergent iterated integral. It has the Hölder decomposition*

$$G(a_1, \dots, a_w; 1) = \sum_{j=0}^w (-1)^j G(1 - a_j, \dots, 1 - a_1; 1/2) G(a_{j+1}, \dots, a_w; 1/2), \quad (5.71)$$

where a missing word denotes 1. Replace each factor by its Taylor polynomial through degree N , evaluated at $1/2$, and call the resulting Gaussian rational number C_N . Then

$$|G(a_1, \dots, a_w; 1) - C_N| \leq 2(w + 1) T_w(N), \quad T_d(N) = 2^{-N} \sum_{k=0}^{d-1} \binom{N}{k}. \quad (5.72)$$

Here $\binom{N}{k} = 0$ for $k > N$ and $T_0(N) = 0$. All the Taylor polynomials required by one word are computed using $O(wN)$ exact rational arithmetic operations. For an integer $P \geq 0$, the explicit choice

$$N = 3(P + w + \lceil \log_2(w + 1) \rceil) \quad (5.73)$$

guarantees an error at most 2^{-P} . In particular, $N = O(P + w)$.

Proof. The hypotheses exclude singularities in the open integration segment. They also ensure integrability at its endpoints: the last letter is nonzero, and any logarithmic singularities at 1 are integrated against an outermost kernel regular there. Partition the ordered integration simplex according to the number j of variables above $1/2$. Replacing those variables by their complements reverses their word and contributes $(-1)^j$. This gives (5.71); this is the standard Hölder convolution, with its endpoint hypotheses made explicit.

Every nonzero letter in either factor of (5.71) has modulus at least 1. Moreover, every nonempty right factor ends at $a_w \neq 0$, and every nonempty left factor ends at $1 - a_1 \neq 0$. Thus these factors have Taylor series with zero constant coefficient.

Consider a word v of this kind, with d nonzero letters, and write $G(v; z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} c_n z^n$. Coefficientwise absolute values are bounded by replacing each nonzero kernel with $1/(1 - z)$. Inserting a zero kernel divides the coefficient of z^n by $n \geq 1$, so deleting all zero letters can only increase this majorant. Consequently

$$|c_n| \leq [z^n] \frac{(-\log(1 - z))^d}{d!} \leq \binom{n-1}{d-1} \quad (n \geq d), \quad c_n = 0 \quad (n < d).$$

For the second inequality, expand the d logarithms; each composition of n into d positive parts contributes at most 1, and the additional factor $1/d!$ can be discarded. The empty word is handled separately. It follows that

$$|G(v; 1/2)| \leq 1, \quad \left| \sum_{n=0}^N c_n 2^{-n} \right| \leq 1,$$

because $\sum_{n \geq d} \binom{n-1}{d-1} 2^{-n} = 1$. The tail of this majorant is exactly

$$\sum_{n > N} \binom{n-1}{d-1} 2^{-n} = 2^{-N} \sum_{k=0}^{d-1} \binom{N}{k} = T_d(N).$$

One proof interprets the left side as the probability that the d th success in fair independent Bernoulli trials occurs after trial N ; the right side counts fewer than d successes among the first N trials. Equivalently, the equality follows by Pascal's identity.

For each product AB in the Hölder sum, with truncations A_N, B_N ,

$$|AB - A_N B_N| \leq |A - A_N| |B| + |A_N| |B - B_N| \leq T_{d_A}(N) + T_{d_B}(N) \leq 2T_w(N).$$

Summing over the $w + 1$ cuts proves (5.72).

For the complexity claim, let b_n be the Taylor coefficients of a tail and c_n those of the word obtained by prepending a . For $n \geq 1$,

$$c_n = \begin{cases} b_n/n, & a = 0, \\ ((n-1)c_{n-1} - b_{n-1})/(an), & a \neq 0. \end{cases} \quad (5.74)$$

In both cases $c_0 = 0$, and the empty tail has $b_0 = 1$, $b_n = 0$ for $n \geq 1$. The second recurrence is coefficient comparison in $(z - a)G'(a, v; z) = G(v; z)$. It takes $O(N)$ operations per prepended letter. Compute the original suffix chain starting from the last letter; this gives every right factor. Compute the reflected reversed-prefix chain by successively prepending $1 - a_1, 1 - a_2, \dots, 1 - a_w$; this gives every left factor. Each chain requires $O(wN)$ operations in total. Summing the $w + 1$ products adds $O(w)$ operations.

Finally, the binomial theorem gives the useful bound

$$T_w(N) \leq 2^{w-1} (3/4)^N.$$

Indeed, for $k \leq w - 1$ one has $2^{-k} \geq 2^{-(w-1)}$, so

$$\sum_{k=0}^{w-1} \binom{N}{k} \leq 2^{w-1} \sum_{k=0}^N \binom{N}{k} 2^{-k} = 2^{w-1} (3/2)^N.$$

With $M = P + w + \lceil \log_2(w + 1) \rceil$ and $N = 3M$,

$$2(w + 1)T_w(N) \leq (w + 1)2^w(3/4)^{3M} \leq (w + 1)2^{w-M} \leq 2^{-P},$$

since $27/64 < 1/2$. This proves (5.73). $\square$

Corollary 5.27 (Fixed imaginary quadratic fields). *Let $K \subset \mathbb{C}$ be an imaginary quadratic field with its fixed complex embedding. Replace $\mathbb{Q}(i)$ in the alphabet definition by K . The same Hölder sum, tail bound, precision prescription, and $O(wN)$ arithmetic-operation count hold, with the center now in K .*

Proof. The proof of Theorem 5.26 uses the coefficient field only for exact additions, multiplications, and reciprocals. Each Taylor coefficient therefore lies in K , and the analytic majorant is unchanged. The tests $|a|^2 \geq 1$ and $|1 - a|^2 \geq 1$ are exact rational comparisons because these squared moduli are field norms. Arithmetic in a fixed quadratic field requires a bounded number of rational operations per field operation. $\square$

In particular, every sixth root of unity satisfies the alphabet condition: apart from 1, its distance from 1 is at least 1. Thus the theorem also supplies an exact-certificate route for the Eisenstein values. The supplied core implementation specializes to $\mathbb{Q}(i)$; the four mixed Eisenstein formulas are established analytically and checked numerically in the independent scripts.

A safe bit-complexity statement. The count $O(wN)$ is an arithmetic-operation count; it does not assign unit cost to arbitrarily large integers. Let Q be a common positive denominator for the real and imaginary components of the reciprocals of all nonzero letters used in both Hölder chains. Let $L_N = \text{lcm}(1, \dots, N)$. For a word of length $\ell \leq w$, each component of its degree- n Taylor coefficient has denominator dividing $Q^n L_n^\ell$. This follows from the convolution form of (5.74): a term uses total reciprocal-letter degree n and one integer divisor at most n for each integration. Thus all evaluated partial sums have denominators dividing

$$D_N = (2Q)^N L_N^w.$$

The coefficient majorant bounds their numerator bit lengths by

$$B = O(N \log(2Q) + wN \log(N + 1) + N),$$

using only the elementary estimate $L_N \leq N!$. All product sums have denominator dividing D_N^2 and comparable operand lengths. Therefore standard exact rational arithmetic yields polynomial bit complexity in $w, N, \log Q$. For an entirely conservative explicit estimate, naive multiplication and division use $O(B^2)$ bit operations, the Euclidean algorithm uses at most $O(B)$ such divisions, and normalization after every operation yields $O(wNB^3)$ bit operations. This deliberately loose bound requires no fast-arithmetic assumptions. Standard fast multiplication and gcd algorithms improve it.

What is and is not new here. Hölder convolution and its use for numerical multiple-polylogarithm evaluation are established; see Borwein–Bradley–Broadhurst–Lisoněk [63] and Vollinga–Weinzierl [64]. The contribution of this specialization is the explicit rational tail certificate, the permitted rational Gaussian letter region, the reuse of both chains, and the uniform linear bound $N = O(P + w)$. This is an error bound for computing periods, not a proof of an identity inferred from a small residual.

Application to the manuscript's constants. The letters needed for π , $\log 2$, $\zeta(n)$ for $n \geq 2$, $\beta(n)$, and $\lambda_n = \Im \operatorname{Li}_n((1+i)/2)$ all satisfy the hypotheses:

$$\pi = 4\Im \operatorname{Li}_1(i), \quad \log 2 = -2\Re \operatorname{Li}_1(i), \quad \operatorname{Li}_n(z) = -G(0^{n-1}, z^{-1}; 1).$$

For the half point the nonzero letter is $1-i$, whose reflected letter is i . Hence both sides of the Gaussian conjectures can be enclosed using one exact Gaussian-rational arithmetic framework.

5.10.1 Agreement with ordinary boundary series

For completeness, suppose $s_1, \dots, s_d$ are positive integers and $|z_j| = 1$. The outer-first colored multiple-polylogarithm series converges absolutely if $s_1 \geq 2$, and converges ordinarily if $s_1 = 1$ and $z_1 \neq 1$. These sufficient conditions include every colored value used in the Gaussian tables.

For $d \geq 2$, put

$$B_n = \sum_{n > n_2 > \dots > n_d \geq 1} \prod_{j=2}^d \frac{z_j^{n_j}}{n_j^{s_j}}.$$

The elementary symmetric harmonic bound gives $|B_n| = O((1 + \log n)^{d-1})$ and

$$|B_{n+1} - B_n| = O((1 + \log n)^{d-2}/n).$$

The first estimate proves absolute convergence for $s_1 \geq 2$. For $s_1 = 1$ set $b_n = B_n/n$. Then $b_n \rightarrow 0$ and

$$|b_{n+1} - b_n| = O((1 + \log n)^{d-1}/n^2),$$

which is summable. The geometric partial sums of z_1^n are bounded when $z_1 \neq 1$, so summation by parts proves convergence of $\sum z_1^n b_n$. At $d = 1$ this is the usual Dirichlet test.

Introduce $0 < r < 1$ in the outer color, $z_1 \mapsto rz_1$. The absolutely convergent series/integral dictionary gives the GPL with the original word and endpoint r . Abel's theorem identifies the limit of the series with its ordinary boundary sum. On the integral side, the last letter is nonzero. Near zero every nonempty suffix is analytic and $O(t)$. Near one, recursive integration gives at worst powers of $|\log(1-t)|$ in an interior suffix. The outer letter is either 0 (when $s_1 \geq 2$) or $z_1^{-1} \neq 1$ (when $s_1 = 1$), so its kernel is bounded near one and these logarithmic powers are integrable. Thus the GPL has a continuous limit as $r \uparrow 1$ and agrees with the ordinary boundary series. No regularization is being silently used in these cases.

Chapter 6

Gamma grids and exact certificates

An experiment proposes a relation; a certificate explains why it holds. For gamma values at rational points, taking logarithms turns reflection and multiplication into rational rows. Their row combinations yield an exact, terminating reduction procedure relative to a specified law matrix. This computational completeness must be distinguished from the open arithmetic completeness conjecture.

6.1 The lattice model

Work on the denominator- N grid, in coordinates $x_k = \log \Gamma(k/N)$, $k = 1, \dots, N-1$. The two classical law families become exact $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear rows with symbolic right-hand sides over the atoms $\log \pi$, $\log n$, $\log \sin(\pi k/N)$:

- reflection, for $k < N/2$:

$$x_k + x_{N-k} = \log \pi - \log \sin\left(\frac{\pi k}{N}\right);$$

- Gauss multiplication, for each divisor $d \geq 2$ of N and $k = 1, \dots, N/d$:

$$\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} x_{k+jN/d} - [dk < N] x_{dk} = \frac{d-1}{2} (\log 2 + \log \pi) + \left(\frac{1}{2} - \frac{dk}{N}\right) \log d,$$

the instance at $z = k/N$ of the Gauss multiplication theorem [11],

$$\prod_{j=0}^{d-1} \Gamma\left(z + \frac{j}{d}\right) = (2\pi)^{(d-1)/2} d^{1/2-dz} \Gamma(dz),$$

with the convention $x_N := \log \Gamma(1) = 0$ in the boundary case $dk = N$.

The raw matrix has $\lfloor (N-1)/2 \rfloor + \sigma(N) - N$ rows and $(N-1)$ columns, before redundant rows are removed. One exact row reduction of the augmented block $[M \mid I]$ over $\mathbb{Q}$ (columns ordered numerator-descending, so pivots land on large numerators) yields simultaneously:

1. a reduction $\Gamma(k/N) = \exp(\text{elementary}) \cdot \prod \Gamma(\text{basis})^{\mathbb{Q}}$ for *every* non-basis k at once, the elementary side computed exactly as (combination matrix) $\cdot$ (right-hand-side vector) — no `FullSimplify` anywhere;

2. the grid’s *basis* — its free formal gamma coordinates — and with it a termination guarantee: the lattice rank says the number of free coordinates in this presented system.

Proposition 6.1 (Completeness relative to the law matrix). *For a fixed denominator grid and a fixed finite family of reflection and multiplication rows, exact row reduction computes every linear consequence of those rows. The free columns give a basis of the formal quotient by that row space, and the augmented matrix records a certificate for each reduction.*

Proof. Elementary row operations preserve the row space and are invertible. The reduced echelon matrix therefore spans exactly the same consequences. Each pivot equation is a recorded rational combination of the original rows. The nonpivot columns are free in the presented quotient. $\square$

Unrestricted completeness of the standard relations for gamma monomials at rational arguments is Rohrlich’s conjecture. Koblitz–Ogus prove a sufficient algebraicity criterion, not its converse. Thus irreducibility of the numerical gamma basis is conditional, and a finite-grid computation also needs care if it is compared with relations using larger grids. See the discussion of standard relations in Rivoal and Roques, *Hadamard products of algebraic functions* (Section 3) [34].

Result 6.2 (benchmarks and coverage). Implementations: `tools/gamma-reducer.wl` (Wolfram) and `tools/gamma_reducer.py` (pure Python: exact $\mathbb{Q}$ arithmetic via `fractions.Fraction`, sparse atom-coefficient right-hand sides, `mpmath` verification). Both produce *identical* output (same rules, same bases).

workload (generation only)	Wolfram	Python
denominator-120 grid (103 rules, 16-element basis)	0.42 s	0.056 s
all 151 legacy-database grids, denominators ≤ 308 (15 588 rules)	75.3 s	7.44 s
<code>mpmath</code> verification of all 15 588 rules	—	8.32 s

Coverage of the 550 recovered `GammaRules.wdx` arguments: 550/550. The original prover needed multi-hour sessions for 550 rules with no terminus; either implementation beats it by orders of magnitude *with* a completeness guarantee. Sample output (the sine values collapse to radicals on their own):

$$\Gamma\left(\frac{5}{12}\right) = \frac{2^{2/3} \sqrt{\pi} \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{12}\right)}{(1 + \sqrt{3}) \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{6}\right)}.$$

Remark 6.3. The row-combination matrix produced by the augmented reduction is, at the same time, a *multiplier certificate* in the sense of Section 6.5: the reducer’s output is born proved, not merely verified.

6.2 Trig-root Γ identities: mechanism and census

The prompt for this investigation was the identity

$$\frac{\Gamma\left(\frac{2}{7}\right)\Gamma\left(\frac{11}{42}\right)}{\Gamma\left(\frac{1}{21}\right)} = \frac{8 \sin\left(\frac{\pi}{7}\right) \sqrt{\pi \sin\left(\frac{\pi}{21}\right) \sin\left(\frac{4\pi}{21}\right) \sin\left(\frac{5\pi}{21}\right)}}{2^{1/42} 7^{1/3} 3^{9/28}},$$

of the kind that has surprised mathematicians before the mechanism was recognized [historical experiment: verified `RootReduce`-exactly against the legacy table].

Result 6.4 (the mechanism, in lattice terms). When the lattice solve expresses a target $\log \Gamma(k/N)$, the elimination may pass through a combination in which the target appears with multiplicity $D > 1$ — i.e. the relation natively proves $\Gamma(k/N)^D = (\text{elementary}) \cdot (\Gamma\text{-monomial})$. Dividing by D puts coefficient $1/D$ on the elementary logsin atoms, and exponentiating yields a D -th root of a sine product; positivity of all factors fixes the branch. The root is a property of the *derivation path*, not of the value: the same $\Gamma(11/42)$ carries a square root in the harvested spelling above and cube roots in the lattice’s own reduction — both exactly correct.

The surprise dissolves further at grids whose sines are radical-expressible: for $N = 30, 60$ the renderer collapses $\sqrt{\sin \cdots}$ into golden-ratio radicals and nothing looks trig-rooted at all. The phenomenon is only *visible* when the sine arguments have large totient (21, 39, 78, ...), where nested square-root expressions need not exist; general radical expressibility is a different question.

Result 6.5 (census, denominator grids $N \leq 200$, primitive arguments). 856 lattice reductions carry fractional logsin coefficients. By root degree D (the lcm of the coefficient denominators):

D	2	3	4	6	8	16
rules	616	46	106	26	42	20

Demanding *integral* Γ -exponents (so only the trigonometric part is rooted, as in the prompt identity) leaves exactly 10 rules, all $D = 4$, at $\Gamma(71/78)$, $\Gamma(85/156)$, $\Gamma(65/114)$, $\Gamma(167/198)$ and conjugate-numerator siblings. The $D = 16$ cases live on the $N = 168$ grid with 26 sines under the radical.

Result 6.6 (showpieces). [historical experiment: verified to 30+ digits in both implementations] The fourth-root champion ($N = 78$; $\varphi(78) = 24$, so square-root-only expressions are unavailable):

$$\Gamma\left(\frac{71}{78}\right) = 2 \cdot 2^{55/312} \pi \sqrt{\cos \frac{\pi}{78}} \cos^{1/8} \frac{\pi}{39} \cos^{3/4} \frac{\pi}{26} \cos^{5/8} \frac{2\pi}{39} \cos^{11/8} \frac{4\pi}{39} \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{13} \sec \frac{7\pi}{78}\right)^{3/8} \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{39}\right) \\ / \left[13^{1/48} \cos^{1/4} \frac{5\pi}{78} \cos^{3/2} \frac{3\pi}{26} \cos^{7/8} \frac{5\pi}{39} \cos^{5/8} \frac{11\pi}{78} \Gamma\left(\frac{2}{39}\right) \Gamma\left(\frac{5}{78}\right) \right],$$

and the lattice’s cube-root reduction of the prompt’s own $\Gamma(11/42)$:

$$\Gamma\left(\frac{11}{42}\right) = \frac{7^{1/6} \sqrt{\pi} \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{42}\right) \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{21}\right) \left(\sec \frac{\pi}{42} \sec \frac{\pi}{21}\right)^{2/3} \sec^2 \frac{\pi}{14} \left(\cos \frac{2\pi}{21} \sec \frac{5\pi}{42}\right)^{1/3}}{8 \cdot 2^{5/21} 3^{3/7} \Gamma\left(\frac{2}{21}\right) \Gamma\left(\frac{3}{14}\right)}.$$

6.3 The trigamma analogue

The same construction applies one weight up. On the grid $y_k = \psi^{(1)}(k/N)$ the lattice rows are the reflection law $\psi^{(1)}(k/N) + \psi^{(1)}(1 - k/N) = \pi^2 \csc^2(\pi k/N)$ and the multiplication theorem $\psi^{(1)}(dk/N) = d^{-2} \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \psi^{(1)}(k/N + j/d)$, with the pin $\psi^{(1)}(1) = \pi^2/6$ wherever an argument hits 1; the elementary atoms are π^2 and the $\pi^2 \csc^2(\pi k/N)$ values.

Result 6.7. `tools/psi_reducer.py` derives the complete trigamma reduction tables for grids $N = 3, \dots, 100$: 3428 rules, all mpmath-verified, in 7.7 s total, with basis dimensions equal to $\varphi(N)/2$ throughout — the same dimension count as the cyclotomic-polylogarithm lattice, which the exact DFT bridge between the two worlds explains (the DFT provides a change of algebraic coordinates between the value systems).

This subsumes, by a factor of ~ 50 , a legacy 70-entry hand/PSLQ-era workbook of $\psi^{(1)}(k/n)$ closed forms (denominators 2–16), which is preserved separately as a harvested store.

6.4 The harvest: legacy notebooks, verified and taxonomized

A kernel-free pipeline (notebook box parser, custom `TraditionalForm/InputForm` interpreter, `mpmath` 60-digit verification) mined the owner’s OneDrive notebook corpus into verified identity stores:

- `harvested-gammaprover-rules.wl` — the recovered 550-rule saturation-prover database, every rule verified in-kernel to $|N[\Gamma(\arg) - \text{closed form}, 40]| < 10^{-30}$, zero failures;
- `harvested-gamma-values.wl` — 508 verified Γ reductions from four further notebook families (including a 451-rule table recovered from a single 700 KB output cell, and 637 sine-product reductions from a working-table pair identified during the sweep);
- `harvested-trigamma-values.wl` — all 70 identities of the trigamma workbook, `mpmath`-verified at 60 digits and re-verified in-kernel.

Result 6.8 (novelty taxonomy). Measured against the 670-rule `FunctionTransformations` Γ table [12] (denominators ≤ 120) that anchors the corpus: 314 distinct harvested arguments lie beyond the table — 280 ceiling-breakers from the prover database (denominators 123–308) plus 34 arguments that only the notebook harvest reaches: one further ceiling-breaker, $\Gamma(67/160)$, and 33 upper-half reflection twins of table arguments. (Eight more harvest ceiling-breakers duplicate prover-database arguments; an earlier recorded decomposition “280 + 8 + 34” double-counted them.)

6.5 Multiplier certificates

Before this program, every identity in the project’s stores carried one badge: *numerically verified* ($\gtrsim 25$ digits). The certificate program adds a qualitatively stronger badge: *derived* — a recorded, machine-checkable certificate exhibiting the value as an exact linear combination of verified functional-equation instances, replayed with no search and no numerics in the algebraic replay path of the historical checker. Its numerical branch guards remain outside the exact certificate guarantee.

6.5.1 The model

A certificate stores law *names* plus concrete substitution strings (parsed through a restricted substitution grammar; strings alone do not guarantee safe or valid instantiation) and two exact multiplier vectors over a canonical real/imaginary splitting of the instances. Validity means the claim $\text{lhs} - \text{rhs}$ equals the recorded linear combination *identically*: every inert Li/ψ atom coefficient cancels `RootReduce`-exactly, and the elementary residual is killed by a dedicated sound zero test (certified principal-branch log normalization, certified multiplicative log-basis reduction, formal coefficient comparison). Numerics appear in exactly two proposal/guard roles: proposing root-of-unity decompositions that exact algebra then certifies, and a numerical per-instance branch guard. That guard can reject bad instances, but is not an exact domain proof; branch validity is a separate obligation. Linear systems subsume orbit words, fixed-point arguments, and multi-value systems in one format.

A **derived** certificate proves its claim *relative to* a declared axiom layer: (a) the classical laws of the project’s functional-equation store [1] — Euler reflection, inversion, Landen, duplication/triplication/multiplication, the five-term family, the Kummer-class relations, Schwarz conjugation, the cyclotomic polygamma sum, and the polygamma reflection/multiplication laws, each numerically verified at recorded test points; (b) definitional pins ($\text{Li}_n(1) = \zeta(n)$, $\psi^{(m)}(1) = (-1)^{m+1} m! \zeta(m+1)$,

and the two Catalan pins below); (c) Euler’s $\zeta(2k) \in \mathbb{Q}\pi^{2k}$ and trigonometric values at rational multiples of π ; (d) **RootReduce** as the exact algebraic-number oracle.

6.5.2 Findings the linear algebra produced

Finding 6.9 (Schwarz conjugation is a necessary axiom). The anharmonic orbit of i is the six-point family $\{i, -i, 1 \pm i, (1 \pm i)/2\}$, and inversion and duplication at i produce the same sum relation. The full system of reflection/inversion/Landen/duplication instances over the orbit is rank-deficient by *exactly one* dimension, and the missing direction is precisely $\text{Li}_2(\bar{z}) = \overline{\text{Li}_2(z)}$. No combination of the single-variable transformation laws separates $\text{Li}_2(i)$ from $\text{Li}_2(-i)$ — the transformation laws are Möbius/algebraic in the argument and blind to conjugation. Obvious in hindsight; the linear algebra *measured* it.

Finding 6.10 (Catalan is definitional; the rest is not). $\beta(2)$ admits no derivation from the stored laws: it enters every certificate that needs it through one of two recorded definitional pins, both termwise series identities,

$$\text{Im Li}_2(i) = G \quad \text{or} \quad \psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) - \psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{3}{4}\right) = 16G.$$

By contrast $\text{Li}_2(-1) = -\pi^2/12$ (duplication at $z = 1$), the four golden-ratio dilogarithm values, $\text{Li}_3(\frac{1}{2})$, the golden trilogarithm $\text{Li}_3(1/\varphi^2)$, and $\text{Li}_2(2)$ are all honestly derived; the flagship compaction is $\text{Li}_2(\frac{1}{2})$ as a *one-instance* certificate (Euler reflection at its own fixed point), and each golden-ratio dilogarithm carries exactly the classical four-equation linear system, the coincidence $1 - 1/\varphi = 1/\varphi^2 = (1/\varphi)^2$ doing all the work. Within this law vocabulary, the tested imaginary orbit uses Catalan as its single additional named constant. The whole imaginary line also carries $\text{Ti}_2(y)$; this finite orbit calculation is not a universal reduction theorem.

Finding 6.11 (prime denominators need the full multiplication row). For the cyclotomic values $\text{Li}_n(e^{2\pi i p/q})$ the polygamma vocabulary pins the ψ -grid via proper-divisor multiplication instances when q is composite; for *prime* q the only ψ -sum relation is the full row $d = q$ — the multiplication theorem at $z = 1/q$,

$$\psi^{(m)}(1) = q^{-m-1} \sum_{k=1}^q \psi^{(m)}\left(\frac{k}{q}\right),$$

whose $k = q$ term is $\psi^{(m)}(1)$ itself — and the DFT coefficients are the source of the algebraic irrational coefficients — e.g. the $\sqrt{5}\zeta(3)$ terms in the $q = 5$ trilogarithm closed forms. Omitting $d = q$ cost precisely the prime- q certificates and nothing else.

Finding 6.12 (a trusted layer must be applied, not assumed). In the historical checker, a trigonometric normalization step was omitted: the $q = 8$ certificates initially failed because $\csc^2(\pi/8)$ survived as an opaque atom in the formal zero test while being numerically zero all along. The fix is policy, not code volume: trig at rational multiples of π is part of the declared trusted base and is applied explicitly during law instantiation and residual checking. A trusted constant layer is only trusted if the checker actually *invokes* it; silent reliance on auto-evaluation makes the trust boundary version-dependent.

6.5.3 Coverage ledger

At the repository snapshot, the certificate ledger replayed by the independent checker under the regression guard is 212 **derived** + 4 **definitional**, **zero failures**:

store	derived / attempted	notes
curated values	45 + 4 definitional	every concrete curated value
legacy polylog table, order-2 real	82/83	one honest holdout (below)
legacy Γ table, denominators ≤ 40	85/100	complete-lattice law pool

The Γ certificates use the complete denominator- q relation lattice of Section 6.1 as the law pool (20/20 on the pilot slice, versus 3/20 for the earlier heuristic pool). The polylog order-2 sweep was driven by three cumulative generator upgrades — atom-closure five-term pairs with structured one-parameter pair families $(x, 1 - x)$, $(x, x/(x - 1))$, $(x, -x)$; square-root argument seeding for duplication ladders; and a height-weighted cluster retry that pools orbit vocabulary across related rules without ever using a related *claim* (no circularity) — the largest certificate being 80 instances.

Search observation 6.13 (the honest holdout). $\text{Li}_2(-7/10)$, the deepest reduction ladder in its slice (10 residual dilogarithms), remains rank-deficient even at deep search caps: the orbit pairs demand an internal 17-flavoured cancellation that no implemented pair family reaches. The natural next lever is second-order stray matching or ladder relations beyond the stored law set. On the Γ side, the frontier is 15 no-certs of $q = 40$ grade (sine-product exact algebra blow-ups) and the $q > 40$ tail, awaiting cyclotomic-unit arithmetic or certificate transport through the exact DFT bridge to the lighter ψ -side atoms.

Chapter 7

Polygamma row sums at complex multiplication points

Rational gamma grids account for periods that reappear in modular forms. At imaginary quadratic arguments the polygamma series becomes a row of a lattice Eisenstein sum. Symmetry isolates elementary components; modular periods and class-field coordinates account for the non-elementary ones. Individual values and full row sums require different evidence.

7.1 Lattice normalization and row sums

For even $w \geq 4$ and $\Im\tau > 0$, define the absolutely convergent

$$G_w(\tau) = \sum_{(m,n) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 \setminus \{(0,0)\}} \frac{1}{(m + n\tau)^w} = 2\zeta(w)E_w(\tau).$$

Pair positive and negative n , and use the defining polygamma series:

$$G_w(\tau) = 2\zeta(w) + \frac{2}{(w-1)!} \sum_{n \geq 1} \left[\psi^{(w-1)}(n\tau) + \psi^{(w-1)}(1 - n\tau) \right]. \quad (7.1)$$

The hexagonal point in this chapter is $\rho = e^{i\pi/3}$. The modular invariant $\mathfrak{g}_2 = E_4/\eta^8$ below is unrelated to the second Stieltjes constant. Algebraic fits and historical numerical residuals are labeled as such; class polynomials are formed from normalized modular functions, rather than untreated modular-form values.

7.2 The elementary layer: reflection composed with conjugation

Before any CM input, one family of components is fixed by symmetry alone. The Schwarz reflection $\psi^{(m)}(\bar{z}) = \overline{\psi^{(m)}(z)}$ turns the reflection law into a statement about a single real component, leaving the other component untouched.

Result 7.1 (vertical-line trigamma law). On the line $\operatorname{Re} z = \frac{1}{2}$ the reflection law alone evaluates the real part of the trigamma function at every height: for all real t ,

$$\operatorname{Re} \psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{1}{2} + it\right) = \frac{\pi^2}{2 \cosh^2(\pi t)}.$$

In particular $\operatorname{Re} \psi^{(1)}(\frac{1+i}{2}) = \pi^2/(2 \cosh^2(\pi/2))$ [historical experiment: residual 0 at 50 dps]. Off the symmetric line, combining reflection, conjugation and the recurrence gives e.g.

$$\operatorname{Re} \psi^{(1)}(i) = -\frac{1}{2} - \frac{\pi^2}{2 \sinh^2 \pi} \quad [\text{historical experiment: residual 0 at 50 dps}].$$

The proof of the first identity is one line: on $\operatorname{Re} z = \frac{1}{2}$ one has $1 - z = \bar{z}$, so the reflection law $\psi^{(1)}(z) + \psi^{(1)}(1 - z) = \pi^2/\sin^2(\pi z)$ reads $2 \operatorname{Re} \psi^{(1)}(z) = \pi^2/\sin^2(\pi z)$ there.

The imaginary parts on this line stay opaque — they are odd-row lattice data in the sense of Section 7.9.

7.2.1 The FoxTrot identity demystified

MathWorld's *Digamma Function* page [17] calls the following identity “surprising”; it arises from the FoxTrot series $\sum (-1)^{n-1} n^2/(n^3 + 1)$, whose partial fractions hit the roots of $n^3 - n + 1$:

$$-\psi\left(\frac{\omega}{2}\right) - \psi\left(-\frac{\omega^2}{2}\right) + \psi\left(\frac{1+\omega}{2}\right) + \psi\left(\frac{1-\omega^2}{2}\right) = 2\pi \operatorname{sech}\left(\frac{\sqrt{3}\pi}{2}\right), \quad \omega = e^{i\pi/3}. \quad (7.2)$$

Law 7.2 (line law for digamma differences). *For every shift $c \in (0, 1)$, on the line $\operatorname{Re} z = (1 - c)/2$,*

$$\operatorname{Re}[\psi(z + c) - \psi(z)] = \pi \operatorname{Re} \cot(\pi \bar{z}).$$

[historical experiment: verified for $c = \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{3}, \frac{2}{3}$ at generic heights t]

The mechanism is the same one-liner: on that line the shift satisfies $z + c = 1 - \bar{z}$, so reflection composed with conjugation eliminates the digamma values, leaving an elementary $\sinh/\cos$ closed form. The FoxTrot identity (7.2) is the instance $c = \frac{1}{2}$, $z = \frac{1}{4} + i\frac{\sqrt{3}}{4}$: its four arguments pair into $2 \operatorname{Re}[\psi(z + \frac{1}{2}) - \psi(z)]$, and on $\operatorname{Re} z = \frac{1}{4}$ one has $\pi \operatorname{Re} \cot(\pi \bar{z}) = \pi \operatorname{sech}(2\pi t)$. The identity is thus the point $t = \sqrt{3}/4$ on a line of identities, itself one member of a two-parameter family — no complex multiplication required.

Differentiating in t ladders the law up the polygamma tower [historical experiment: weights 2, 3 verified at 10^{-50}]:

$$\begin{aligned} \operatorname{Im}[\psi^{(1)}(\tfrac{3}{4} + it) - \psi^{(1)}(\tfrac{1}{4} + it)] &= 2\pi^2 \operatorname{sech}(2\pi t) \tanh(2\pi t), \\ \operatorname{Re}[\psi^{(2)}(\tfrac{3}{4} + it) - \psi^{(2)}(\tfrac{1}{4} + it)] &= 8\pi^3 \operatorname{sech}^3(2\pi t) - 4\pi^3 \operatorname{sech}(2\pi t). \end{aligned}$$

More generally, for $0 < c < 1$, let $z = (1 - c)/2 + it$ and $R_c(t) = \pi \sin(\pi c)/(\cosh(2\pi t) + \cos(\pi c))$. Reflection and conjugation give $\operatorname{Re}(\psi(z + c) - \psi(z)) = R_c(t)$. Differentiating m times yields

$$\operatorname{Re}\left(i^m [\psi^{(m)}(z + c) - \psi^{(m)}(z)]\right) = R_c^{(m)}(t).$$

Thus the real part is determined for even m and the imaginary part for odd m . With weight $w = m + 1$, these are the real component at odd weight and imaginary component at even weight. Their complementary components are not determined by this reflection identity; that leaves open reductions by other methods. This shifted-difference statement is distinct from individual polygamma values on $\operatorname{Re} z = 1/2$.

7.3 Maximal symmetry: vanishing identities and Γ -periods

At the two CM points with extra symmetry — $\tau = i$ (square lattice, $j = 1728$) and $\tau = \rho = e^{i\pi/3}$ (hexagonal lattice, $j = 0$) — classical theory pins every G_{2k} exactly. The square lattice admits no weight-6 form ($i \cdot (\mathbb{Z} + \mathbb{Z}i) = \mathbb{Z} + \mathbb{Z}i$ forces $G_6(i) = i^{-6}G_6(i) = -G_6(i)$), and the hexagonal lattice no weight-4 form; $G_4(i)$ and $G_6(\rho)$ are the lemniscatic and equianharmonic period powers — monomials in $\Gamma(1/4)$, resp. $\Gamma(1/3)$, by Chowla–Selberg [13].

7.3.1 Vanishing identities

Result 7.3 (the CM gems).

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} \left[\psi^{(5)}(ni) + \psi^{(5)}(1 - ni) \right] = -120 \zeta(6) \quad [\text{historical experiment: residual } 1.7 \times 10^{-49}],$$

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} \left[\psi^{(3)}(n\rho) + \psi^{(3)}(1 - n\rho) \right] = -6 \zeta(4), \quad \rho = e^{i\pi/3} \quad [\text{historical experiment: residual } 6.8 \times 10^{-50}].$$

Each individual bracket is a transcendental-looking complex number (elementary in $\coth / \operatorname{csch}$ of $\pi n \sqrt{3}/2$ and the like after the bilateral cotangent expansion, but nobody would guess the totals); the sums collapse to rational multiples of $\zeta(6)$, $\zeta(4)$ *because lattice rotation multiplies the corresponding value by a nontrivial root of unity*. Via (7.1) these are exactly the statements $G_6(i) = 0$ and $G_4(\rho) = 0$.

7.3.2 Chowla–Selberg made polygamma-visible

Result 7.4 (period identities).

$$2\zeta(4) + \frac{1}{3} \sum_{n \geq 1} \left[\psi^{(3)}(ni) + \psi^{(3)}(1 - ni) \right] = \frac{\Gamma(1/4)^8}{960 \pi^2} \quad [\text{historical experiment: residual } 2.1 \times 10^{-50}],$$

$$2\zeta(6) + \frac{1}{60} \sum_{n \geq 1} \left[\psi^{(5)}(n\rho) + \psi^{(5)}(1 - n\rho) \right] = \frac{\Gamma(1/3)^{18}}{8960 \pi^6} \quad [\text{historical experiment: residual } 2.0 \times 10^{-60}].$$

Polygamma values at purely imaginary (resp. hexagonal) points, summed over the integer multiples of the point, know the lemniscate constant and its equianharmonic sibling. The atoms $\Gamma(1/4)^2/\pi$ and $\Gamma(1/3)$ are precisely the CM-period currency of the repository’s hypergeometric reducer (`cmPeriodReduce` in `src/Hypergeometric`), so these identities tie the polygamma world directly to that corpus.

7.3.3 The complete low-weight table

The symmetry argument and the classical Hurwitz recursion [15]

$$(2n+1)(2n-1)(n-3) G_{2n} = 3 \sum_{m=2}^{n-2} (2m-1)(2n-2m-1) G_{2m} G_{2n-2m}$$

extend both subsections through weight 12 with no new constants [historical experiment: all entries verified, residuals 10^{-60} – 10^{-263}]:

weight $2k$	square lattice $\tau = i$	hexagonal lattice $\tau = \rho$
4	$\Gamma(1/4)^8/(960\pi^2)$	0
6	0	$\Gamma(1/3)^{18}/(8960\pi^6)$
8	$\frac{3}{7}G_4(i)^2 = 3\Gamma(1/4)^{16}/(7 \cdot 960^2\pi^4)$	0
10	0	0
12	$\frac{1}{143}(18G_4(i)^3 + 25G_6(i)^2)$ type	$\frac{25}{143}G_6(\rho)^2 \propto \Gamma(1/3)^{36}$

Every bold zero is a vanishing identity $\sum_{n \geq 1} [\psi^{(w-1)}(n\tau) + \psi^{(w-1)}(1-n\tau)] = -(w-1)!\zeta(w)$, and every non-zero entry is a $\psi^{(w-1)}$ -sum evaluation. The pattern is exhaustive: $G_{2k}(i) = 0$ iff $2k \not\equiv 0 \pmod{4}$, $G_{2k}(\rho) = 0$ iff $2k \not\equiv 0 \pmod{6}$, and all non-zero values are $\mathbb{Q}$ -monomials in the two period powers — so the *entire* Eisenstein tower over both lattices is polygamma-explicit.

7.4 Beyond maximal symmetry: $2i$ and $i\sqrt{2}$

The same row-sum at the next two CM points, with closed forms found by PSLQ [historical experiment: 120-dps canaries]:

Result 7.5.

$$G_4(2i) = \frac{11}{15360} \frac{\Gamma(1/4)^8}{\pi^2} \quad [\text{historical experiment: canary 0 at 120 dps}],$$

$$G_4(i\sqrt{2}) = \frac{\Gamma(1/8)^4 \Gamma(3/8)^4}{4608 \pi^2} \quad [\text{historical experiment: canary } 3.9 \times 10^{-121}].$$

The weight-6 row at the same points [historical experiment: 160-dps canaries]:

$$G_6(2i) = \frac{\Gamma(1/4)^{12}}{2^{14} \cdot 5 \cdot \pi^3}, \quad G_6(i\sqrt{2}) = \frac{\Gamma(1/8)^6 \Gamma(3/8)^6}{2^{12} \cdot 3^3 \cdot 5 \cdot \pi^3}.$$

The first value confirms the isogeny picture: $2i$ sits over the same field $\mathbb{Q}(i)$, so only the rational factor changes ($G_4(i)/G_4(2i) = 16/11$). The second imports a genuinely *new period*: discriminant -8 , field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-2})$ — the polygamma sum $\sum_n [\psi^{(3)}(ni\sqrt{2}) + \psi^{(3)}(1-ni\sqrt{2})]$ evaluates in $\Gamma(1/8)\Gamma(3/8)$. The fundamental unit $1 + \sqrt{2}$ was offered in the PSLQ basis and declined (exponent 0). Together with Section 7.3 this makes three distinct Chowla–Selberg periods polygamma-visible.

7.5 Class number 2: discriminants -20 and -15

At $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-5})$ (class number 2) a monomial-only logarithmic basket can miss the value: the algebraic factor in G_4/Ω^4 lives in the Hilbert class field and is not a monomial. The structure that works is the Hecke/Damerell pair [14] over the two reduced forms $x^2 + 5y^2$ ($\tau_1 = i\sqrt{5}$) and $2x^2 + 2xy + 3y^2$ ($\tau_2 = (-1 + i\sqrt{5})/2$).

Result 7.6 (disc -20).

$$\frac{G_4(\tau_1)}{G_4(\tau_2)} = \frac{29 + 12\sqrt{5}}{44} = \frac{(3 + 2\sqrt{5})^2}{44} \quad [\text{historical experiment: canary 0 at 160 dps}],$$

$$G_4(\tau_1) G_4(\tau_2) = \frac{11 \varphi^4 \Gamma(3/20)^8 \Gamma(7/20)^8}{2^{14} \cdot 3^4 \cdot 5^4 \cdot \pi^4} \quad [\text{historical experiment: canary } 5.3 \times 10^{-160}],$$

where φ is the golden ratio. The ratio is algebraic of degree 2 with norm $N(29 + 12\sqrt{5}) = 121 = 11^2$; the class product is a period monomial carrying the prime 11 and a golden unit.

Result 7.7 (disc -15). With $\tau_1 = (1 + i\sqrt{15})/2$ for $x^2 + xy + 4y^2$ and the conjugate pair $\tau_{2,3} = (\pm 1 + i\sqrt{15})/4$ representing $2x^2 + xy + 2y^2$, write $\widehat{G}_4 = \frac{1}{2}[G_4(\tau_2) + G_4(\tau_3)] = \text{Re } G_4(\tau_2)$ for the class-pair average. Then [historical experiment: 160-dps canaries]:

$$\frac{G_4(\tau_1)}{\widehat{G}_4} = \frac{2(4 + \sqrt{5})^2}{77}, \quad G_4(\tau_1) \widehat{G}_4 = \frac{77 \left(\Gamma(\frac{1}{15})\Gamma(\frac{2}{15})\Gamma(\frac{4}{15})\Gamma(\frac{8}{15})\right)^4}{2^{13} \cdot 3^6 \cdot 5^5 \cdot \pi^4}.$$

Unlike disc -20 , the non-principal value here is genuinely complex (the form $(2, 1, 2)$ has $|\tau_2| = 1$, where conjugation acts nontrivially on G_4); the class-pair average is the Galois-natural object.

The Γ -block in Result 7.7 is exactly the set of residues $\{1, 2, 4, 8\}$ with $\chi_{-15} = +1$; the golden unit is declined by PSLQ (exponent 0); and the prime content $77 = 7 \cdot 11$ of the product matches the ratio's denominator ($N(4 + \sqrt{5}) = 11$). The heuristic that emerges, used at every later discriminant: *run the ratio first; its norm names the primes the class-product basis needs.*

7.6 Class number 3: discriminant -23

$\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-23})$ has $h = 3$, with Hilbert class field generated over $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-23})$ by a root of $x^3 - x - 1$. The three reduced forms give $\tau_1 = (1 + i\sqrt{23})/2$ and $\tau_{2,3} = (\pm 1 + i\sqrt{23})/4$; $G_4(\tau_1)$ is real and $G_4(\tau_{2,3})$ form a conjugate pair.

Result 7.8 (disc -23 class product). [historical experiment: canary 1.4×10^{-160}]

$$G_4(\tau_1) G_4(\tau_2) G_4(\tau_3) = \frac{11 \cdot 17 P^4}{2^{24} \cdot 3^6 \cdot 23^5 \cdot \pi^{16}}, \quad P = \prod_{\substack{k \bmod 23 \\ \left(\frac{k}{23}\right) = +1}} \Gamma\left(\frac{k}{23}\right) \quad (11 \text{ factors}).$$

Result 7.9 (the $\mathfrak{g}_2$ class polynomial from row-sums). With $\mathfrak{g}_2 = E_4/\eta^8$ phase-corrected by the canonical cube root (the $q^{1/3}$ ambiguity of η^8 at these points), the three values $\mathfrak{g}_2(\tau_i)$ computed from the polygamma row-sums are exactly the roots of the classical class polynomial

$$x^3 + 155x^2 + 650x + 23375 = 0 \quad [\text{historical experiment: coefficients integer to } 10^{-80}],$$

whose constant term $23375 = 5^3 \cdot 11 \cdot 17$ forecast the primes 11, 17 in the class product — the norm heuristic of Section 7.5, one degree up.

Search observation 7.10 (weight-4 sums are not Galois-clean). The dimensionless symmetric functions e_1^3/e_3 and e_2^3/e_3^2 of the raw G_4 values were not recognized as rational in the source search (height 10^{30} , 300 digits). Unlike the value *product* (a norm) and the weight-0 $\mathfrak{g}_2$ invariants, sums of weight-4 CM values across ideal classes are not Galois-stable — the period correction under $\text{Gal}(H/K)$ is nontrivial at weight 4. Class polynomials must be formed from $\mathfrak{g}_2 = E_4/\eta^8$ (or j), not from the G_4 values themselves.

7.7 Class number 4: discriminant -39 and genus structure

The four reduced forms of discriminant -39 , namely $(1, 1, 10)$, $(2, \pm 1, 5)$, $(3, 3, 4)$, give $\tau \in \{(1 + i\sqrt{39})/2, (\pm 1 + i\sqrt{39})/4, (3 + i\sqrt{39})/6\}$.

Result 7.11 (disc -39 class product). [historical experiment: 160-dps canary]

$$\prod_{i=1}^4 G_4(\tau_i) = \frac{17 \cdot 23 \cdot 29 P^4}{2^{28} \cdot 3^9 \cdot 5^4 \cdot 13^8 \cdot \pi^{16}}, \quad P = \prod_{\substack{k \bmod 39 \\ \chi_{-39}(k) = +1}} \Gamma\left(\frac{k}{39}\right) \quad (12 \text{ factors}).$$

A wrinkle relative to Section 7.6: $\mathfrak{g}_2$ is *not* a class invariant here ($3 \mid 39$, the classical obstruction [16]; observed directly — no cube-root phase choice makes the $\mathfrak{g}_2$ -sums rational). But j always is, and the row-sum values deliver the Hilbert class polynomial outright.

Result 7.12 (Hilbert class polynomial of disc -39).

$$H_{-39}(x) = x^4 + 331531596 x^3 - 429878960946 x^2 + 109873509788637459 x + 20919104368024767633$$

[historical experiment: $e_1, \dots, e_3$ PSLQ-exact integers; e_4 integral to 10^{-137}].

Worth dwelling on: a quartic with 20-digit integer coefficients recovered from sums of polygamma values at quadratic-irrational complex points. The polygamma row-sum is a perfectly serviceable special-function front door to the classical CM tower.

Result 7.13 (genus structure inside the quartet). The class group is $\mathbb{Z}/4$, with the ambiguous form $(3, 3, 4)$ as the order-2 class. The raw cross-class ratio v_1/v_4 is a quartic candidate; no degree-two polynomial was found up to height 10^{12} , but the genus-wise ratio — principal genus $\{1, A^2\}$ over $\{A, A^3\}$ — is exactly quadratic, in the real part of the genus field $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-3}, \sqrt{13})$ as genus theory demands [historical experiment: 160-dps canary; $\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{39}$ declined by PSLQ]:

$$\frac{G_4(\tau_1) G_4(\tau_4)}{G_4(\tau_2) G_4(\tau_3)} = \frac{103299 + 4440\sqrt{13}}{181424}, \quad N = \left(\frac{9}{16}\right)^2, \quad 181424 = 16 \cdot 17 \cdot 23 \cdot 29.$$

The denominator reuses the class-product primes 17, 23, 29.

7.8 Class number 5: discriminant -47

The five reduced forms $(1, 1, 12)$, $(2, \pm 1, 6)$, $(3, \pm 1, 4)$ give the quintet $\tau \in \{(1 + i\sqrt{47})/2, (\pm 1 + i\sqrt{47})/4, (\pm 1 + i\sqrt{47})/6\}$.

Result 7.14 (disc -47 class product). [historical experiment: 200-dps canary]

$$\prod_{i=1}^5 G_4(\tau_i) = \frac{11^2 \cdot 23 \cdot 29 P^4}{2^{52} \cdot 3^6 \cdot 47^9 \cdot \pi^{36}}, \quad P = \prod_{\substack{k \bmod 47 \\ \left(\frac{k}{47}\right)=+1}} \Gamma\left(\frac{k}{47}\right) \quad (23 \text{ factors}).$$

Result 7.15 (Hilbert class polynomial of disc -47). The row-sum j -values deliver the quintic Hilbert class polynomial [historical experiment: all symmetric functions integral to 10^{-129} or better]:

$$H_{-47}(x) = x^5 + 2257834125 x^4 - 9987963828125 x^3 + 5115161850595703125 x^2 - 14982472850828613281250 x + 16042929600623870849609375.$$

The CM tower is now polygamma-explicit through class number 5 with one uniform recipe: *row-sum* $\rightarrow$ *class-product log-PSLQ (norm-forecast primes)* $\rightarrow$ *j-symmetric-function integrality*.

7.9 The opaque components

The components *not* fixed by reflection-conjugation or by the even-row mechanism — $\text{Im } \psi^{(1)}(i)$, $\text{Re } \psi(i)$ beyond γ , $\text{Im } \psi^{(1)}\left(\frac{1+i}{2}\right)$ — are *odd-row* lattice data: for example

$$\text{Im } \psi^{(1)}(i) = -2 \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{k}{(k^2 + 1)^2}$$

is an odd-power analogue of the coth family, which the bilateral (even) cotangent expansion cannot reach. These are Eichler-integral/quasi-modular territory — the E_2 -flavoured layer; compare $\sum_{k \geq 1} k/(e^{2\pi k} - 1) = \frac{1}{24} - \frac{1}{8\pi}$, which is $E_2(i) = 3/\pi$ in Lambert-series clothing.

Search observation 7.16. A PSLQ basket for these constants against products drawn from

$$\{1, \pi, \coth \pi, \pi^2/\sinh^2 \pi, \pi \coth \pi, \dots\}$$

found nothing at small coefficient heights — consistent with genuinely new constants. Recorded as an honest negative; the Lambert-series face ($\sum \sigma_5(n)q^n$ at $q = e^{-2\pi}$ and $q = -e^{-\pi\sqrt{3}}$) is the natural next probe surface.

7.10 Summation order, differentiation and certified tails

Absolute convergence made the preceding weights straightforward. Weight two needs a specified order of summation. Once that boundary is handled, Ramanujan's differential algebra turns the existing CM period seeds into all derivative evaluations, with explicit exponential tail estimates.

7.11 Regularized modular rows and all derivative evaluations

The modular draft obtains even-weight Eisenstein series by pairing polygamma values along lattice rows. Its weight-two question requires care: the paired rows converge rapidly, although the ungrouped lattice sum is not absolutely convergent. We first prove an explicit bound for every differentiated row. We then determine the change of summation order directly, before using any modular transformation law. Finally, Ramanujan's differential system evaluates all the resulting derivative rows at the square and hexagonal CM points.

Throughout this section, let

$$\tau \in \mathbb{H} := \{z \in \mathbb{C} : \operatorname{Im} z > 0\}, \quad q = e^{2\pi i \tau}, \quad r = |q| = e^{-2\pi \operatorname{Im} \tau} < 1, \quad \rho = \tau_{\text{hex}} = \frac{1 + i\sqrt{3}}{2}.$$

For even $w \geq 2$ and an integer $j \geq 0$, put

$$\mathcal{T}_{w,j}(\tau) = \sum_{n \geq 1} n^j \left[\psi^{(w-1+j)}(n\tau) + (-1)^j \psi^{(w-1+j)}(1-n\tau) \right]. \quad (7.3)$$

Convergence will follow from the next theorem. The sign on the reflected term is part of the definition; differentiating that term changes its sign at every step.

7.11.1 Rational row formulas and explicit tail bounds

The negative-index polylogarithms appearing below are elementary rational functions. For $d \geq 0$, define

$$R_d(t) = \operatorname{Li}_{-d}(t), \quad R_0(t) = \frac{t}{1-t}, \quad R_{d+1}(t) = t \frac{d}{dt} R_d(t).$$

These relations are identities of rational functions, since on $|t| < 1$ they follow by differentiating $R_d(t) = \sum_{\ell \geq 1} \ell^d t^\ell$. In particular,

$$R_1(t) = \frac{t}{(1-t)^2}, \quad R_2(t) = \frac{t(1+t)}{(1-t)^3}, \quad R_3(t) = \frac{t(1+4t+t^2)}{(1-t)^4}.$$

Theorem 7.17 (Rational rows and an explicit remainder). *For w, j, τ as above,*

$$\psi^{(w-1+j)}(n\tau) + (-1)^j \psi^{(w-1+j)}(1-n\tau) = (2\pi i)^{w+j} \text{Li}_{1-w-j}(q^n), \quad (7.4)$$

$$\mathcal{T}_{w,j}(\tau) = (2\pi i)^{w+j} \sum_{n \geq 1} n^j \text{Li}_{1-w-j}(q^n). \quad (7.5)$$

The series converges normally on every compact subset of $\mathbb{H}$. If $\mathcal{T}_{w,j}^{[N]}$ is its sum through $n = N$, where $N \geq 0$, then

$$\left| \mathcal{T}_{w,j}(\tau) - \mathcal{T}_{w,j}^{[N]}(\tau) \right| \leq (2\pi)^{w+j} (N+1)^j \frac{\text{Li}_{-j}(r)}{r} \text{Li}_{1-w-j}(r^{N+1}). \quad (7.6)$$

Thus the bound contains only rational functions of r and r^{N+1} , together with an explicit power of π .

Proof. For $\text{Im } z > 0$, splitting the absolutely convergent bilateral power sum into its nonnegative and negative indices gives

$$\sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} (m+z)^{-w} = \frac{\psi^{(w-1)}(z) + \psi^{(w-1)}(1-z)}{(w-1)!}. \quad (7.7)$$

Here evenness of w is essential. The classical cotangent expansion and its partial-fraction interpretation [45] read

$$\pi \cot(\pi z) = -\pi i - 2\pi i \sum_{\ell \geq 1} e^{2\pi i \ell z}, \quad \pi \cot(\pi z) = \lim_{M \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{m=-M}^M \frac{1}{m+z}.$$

Differentiate $w-1$ times. On compact subsets of the upper half-plane the exponential series and its derivatives converge uniformly. After the first derivative, the bilateral series and all its subsequent derivatives also converge normally. Since $(-1)^{w-1} = -1$, the two minus signs cancel and yield

$$\psi^{(w-1)}(z) + \psi^{(w-1)}(1-z) = (2\pi i)^w \sum_{\ell \geq 1} \ell^{w-1} e^{2\pi i \ell z}.$$

Differentiating another j times with respect to z proves (7.4). Multiplication by n^j gives the summand in (7.5).

To prove the remainder bound, expand the rational polylogarithm in its nonnegative majorizing series. The absolute value of the omitted rows is at most

$$(2\pi)^{w+j} \sum_{\ell \geq 1} \ell^{w+j-1} \sum_{n > N} n^j r^{n\ell}. \quad (7.8)$$

Write $n = N+1+a$. For $a \geq 0$ and $\ell \geq 1$,

$$n^j \leq (N+1)^j (a+1)^j, \quad r^{a\ell} \leq r^a.$$

Consequently

$$\sum_{n > N} n^j r^{n\ell} \leq (N+1)^j r^{(N+1)\ell} \sum_{a \geq 0} (a+1)^j r^a = (N+1)^j r^{(N+1)\ell} \frac{\text{Li}_{-j}(r)}{r}.$$

Substitution in (7.8) proves (7.6). In particular, the majorant is finite. On a compact subset of $\mathbb{H}$, one has $r \leq r_0 < 1$, and each of its power series with nonnegative coefficients is bounded by its value at r_0 . This proves normal convergence, for every fixed w, j , and justifies all subsequent termwise differentiations. $\square$

For $j = 0$, the tail formula simplifies to

$$\left| \mathcal{T}_{w,0} - \mathcal{T}_{w,0}^{[N]} \right| \leq \frac{(2\pi)^w}{1-r} \text{Li}_{1-w}(r^{N+1}).$$

The case $w = 2$, which will be particularly useful, is

$$\left| \mathcal{T}_{2,0} - \mathcal{T}_{2,0}^{[N]} \right| \leq \frac{4\pi^2 r^{N+1}}{(1-r)(1-r^{N+1})^2}. \quad (7.9)$$

Theorem 7.17 also proves

$$\frac{d^j}{d\tau^j} \mathcal{T}_{w,0}(\tau) = \mathcal{T}_{w,j}(\tau). \quad (7.10)$$

Computationally, (7.4) is preferable to evaluating its two polygamma terms separately. Their algebraic asymptotic contributions cancel, leaving the exponentially small paired row. The rational formula performs that cancellation exactly before numerical evaluation.

7.11.2 The weight-two ordering correction from telescoping

For $w \geq 4$, the ordinary absolutely convergent lattice series is

$$G_w(\tau) = \sum_{(m,n) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 \setminus \{(0,0)\}} (m + n\tau)^{-w} = 2\zeta(w) + \frac{2}{(w-1)!} \mathcal{T}_{w,0}(\tau).$$

For $w = 2$, specify the order explicitly:

$$G_2(\tau) = \sum_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} \left(\sum'_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} (m + n\tau)^{-2} \right) = \frac{\pi^2}{3} + 2\mathcal{T}_{2,0}(\tau), \quad (7.11)$$

$$C_2(\tau) = \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} \left(\sum'_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} (m + n\tau)^{-2} \right). \quad (7.12)$$

The prime omits only $(m, n) = (0, 0)$. In the first expression, each inner row and the outer series of completed rows converge absolutely. The reverse expression exists as well: changing the names and signs of the one-dimensional indices gives

$$C_2(\tau) = \tau^{-2} G_2(-1/\tau). \quad (7.13)$$

This is a coordinate identity for the prescribed iterated sums, not an assumption of modularity. The series of absolute values over all lattice points diverges, so an interchange of the two orders still requires a calculation.

Theorem 7.18 (Summation-order anomaly). *For every $\tau \in \mathbb{H}$,*

$$C_2(\tau) = G_2(\tau) - \frac{2\pi i}{\tau}. \quad (7.14)$$

Consequently

$$G_2(-1/\tau) = \tau^2 G_2(\tau) - 2\pi i \tau, \quad G_2(\tau + 1) = G_2(\tau). \quad (7.15)$$

Proof. We prove the difference of the two orders by replacing their common part with an absolutely convergent series. Put

$$h(z) = \frac{1}{z} - \frac{1}{z+1}, \quad f(z) = \frac{1}{z^2} - h(z) = \frac{1}{z^2(z+1)},$$

and define

$$F(\tau) = \sum_{\substack{n \in \mathbb{Z} \setminus \{0\} \\ m \in \mathbb{Z}}} f(m + n\tau).$$

No pole occurs in this sum. The real-linear map $(m, n) \mapsto m + n\tau$ is invertible, so for some $c_\tau > 0$, $|m + n\tau| \geq c_\tau \sqrt{m^2 + n^2}$. Outside a finite set, $|f(z)| \leq 2|z|^{-3}$; hence F converges absolutely. It can therefore be summed in either order.

For each fixed $n \neq 0$, the series $\sum_m h(m + n\tau)$ is absolutely convergent and its symmetric partial sum telescopes:

$$\sum_{m=-M}^M h(m + n\tau) = \frac{1}{-M + n\tau} - \frac{1}{M + 1 + n\tau} \rightarrow 0.$$

Separating the row $n = 0$ proves

$$G_2(\tau) = \frac{\pi^2}{3} + F(\tau). \quad (7.16)$$

For the reverse order, define for integer m

$$A(m) = \lim_{K \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{0 < |n| \leq K} \frac{1}{m + n\tau}.$$

This symmetric limit exists: pairing n and $-n$ gives an $O(n^{-2})$ summand. The cotangent partial-fraction formula gives

$$A(m) = \frac{\pi}{\tau} \cot\left(\frac{\pi m}{\tau}\right) - \frac{1}{m} \quad (m \neq 0), \quad A(0) = 0. \quad (7.17)$$

The value at zero is also the removable limit of the expression on the right. For each fixed m , the n -series of $h(m + n\tau)$ is absolutely convergent. Taking its symmetric partial sums shows

$$\sum_{n \neq 0} h(m + n\tau) = A(m) - A(m + 1).$$

It follows that

$$\begin{aligned} C_2(\tau) - \frac{\pi^2}{3} - F(\tau) &= \lim_{M \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{m=-M}^M \sum_{n \neq 0} h(m + n\tau) \\ &= \lim_{M \rightarrow \infty} (A(-M) - A(M + 1)). \end{aligned}$$

The extraction of F here is legitimate by its absolute convergence; no rearrangement of the original double power sum has been made.

Since $\text{Im}(1/\tau) < 0$,

$$\cot(\pi m/\tau) \rightarrow i \quad (m \rightarrow +\infty), \quad \cot(\pi m/\tau) \rightarrow -i \quad (m \rightarrow -\infty).$$

Equation (7.17) therefore gives $A(-M) - A(M + 1) \rightarrow -2\pi i/\tau$. Combining this with (7.16) proves (7.14). Equation (7.13) now gives the first transformation in (7.15). Periodicity follows directly from the q -series in (7.5). $\square$

The anomaly is classical; Romik and Scherer discuss it together with more general shape-dependent summation procedures [53]. The proof above fixes both its sign and the normalization needed for the draft's polygamma sums.

Corollary 7.19 (The missing weight-two CM rows). *One has*

$$G_2(i) = \pi, \quad G_2(\rho) = \frac{2\pi}{\sqrt{3}}, \quad (7.18)$$

$$\mathcal{T}_{2,0}(i) = \frac{\pi}{2} - \frac{\pi^2}{6}, \quad \mathcal{T}_{2,0}(\rho) = \frac{\pi}{\sqrt{3}} - \frac{\pi^2}{6}. \quad (7.19)$$

Proof. At $\tau = i$, the first transformation in (7.15) gives $G_2(i) = -G_2(i) + 2\pi$. For ρ , use $-1/\rho = \rho - 1$ and periodicity. The same transformation becomes

$$(\rho^2 - 1)G_2(\rho) = 2\pi i\rho.$$

Since $\rho^2 - 1 = i\sqrt{3}\rho$, this proves the second value in (7.18). Substitution into (7.11) proves (7.19). $\square$

7.11.3 CM seeds and the complete differential tower

Normalize the Eisenstein series by

$$E_2 = \frac{3G_2}{\pi^2}, \quad E_4 = \frac{G_4}{2\zeta(4)}, \quad E_6 = \frac{G_6}{2\zeta(6)}.$$

The seed values, in precisely this normalization, are

$$(E_2(i), E_4(i), E_6(i)) = \left(\frac{3}{\pi}, \frac{3\Gamma(1/4)^8}{64\pi^6}, 0 \right), \quad (7.20)$$

$$(E_2(\rho), E_4(\rho), E_6(\rho)) = \left(\frac{2\sqrt{3}}{\pi}, 0, \frac{27\Gamma(1/3)^{18}}{512\pi^{12}} \right). \quad (7.21)$$

We have already proved the weight-two entries. The zero entries follow by rotating the absolutely convergent lattices. Multiplication by i fixes the square lattice and sends its weight-six sum to its negative; multiplication by ρ fixes the hexagonal lattice and multiplies its weight-four sum by $\rho^{-4} \neq 1$.

For completeness, the classical period integrals fix the nonzero entries without numerical identification. The standard inverse Weierstrass integral [45], with $g_2 = 60G_4$ and $g_3 = 140G_6$, gives positive real periods

$$p_{\text{sq}} = 2 \int_1^\infty \frac{dx}{\sqrt{4x^3 - 4x}} = 2 \int_0^1 \frac{du}{\sqrt{1 - u^4}} = \frac{1}{2} B\left(\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{\Gamma(1/4)^2}{2\sqrt{2}\pi},$$

$$p_{\text{hex}} = 2 \int_1^\infty \frac{dx}{\sqrt{4x^3 - 4}} = \frac{1}{3} B\left(\frac{1}{6}, \frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{\Gamma(1/3)^3}{2^{4/3}\pi}.$$

The corresponding lattices are $p_{\text{sq}}(\mathbb{Z} + i\mathbb{Z})$ for $(g_2, g_3) = (4, 0)$, and $p_{\text{hex}}(\mathbb{Z} + \rho\mathbb{Z})$ for $(g_2, g_3) = (0, 4)$. Their square and equianharmonic shapes follow from the rotations of the respective cubics; the real period integral fixes the scale and orientation. The first substitution above is $x = u^{-2}$; in the second beta integral use $t = x^{-3}$. Euler's reflection and duplication formulas give the displayed gamma evaluations. Scaling the lattice invariants consequently yields

$$G_4(i) = \frac{p_{\text{sq}}^4}{15} = \frac{\Gamma(1/4)^8}{960\pi^2}, \quad G_6(\rho) = \frac{p_{\text{hex}}^6}{35} = \frac{\Gamma(1/3)^{18}}{8960\pi^6}.$$

Using $2\zeta(4) = \pi^4/45$ and $2\zeta(6) = 2\pi^6/945$ proves the remaining entries of (7.20)–(7.21).

Ramanujan's classical differential identities [54] are

$$\theta E_2 = \frac{E_2^2 - E_4}{12}, \quad \theta E_4 = \frac{E_2 E_4 - E_6}{3}, \quad \theta E_6 = \frac{E_2 E_6 - E_4^2}{2}, \quad \theta = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \frac{d}{d\tau}. \quad (7.22)$$

Encode these identities by the rational derivation

$$\mathcal{V} = \frac{X^2 - Y}{12} \frac{\partial}{\partial X} + \frac{XY - Z}{3} \frac{\partial}{\partial Y} + \frac{XZ - Y^2}{2} \frac{\partial}{\partial Z}, \quad P_0 = X, \quad P_{j+1} = \mathcal{V}P_j. \quad (7.23)$$

For example,

$$\begin{aligned} P_1 &= \frac{X^2 - Y}{12}, \\ P_2 &= \frac{X^3 - 3XY + 2Z}{72}, \\ P_3 &= \frac{X^4 - 6X^2Y + 8XZ - 3Y^2}{288}. \end{aligned}$$

Theorem 7.20 (All differentiated weight-two rows). *Set $\mathcal{S}_j(\tau) = \mathcal{T}_{2,j}(\tau)$. For every $\tau \in \mathbb{H}$,*

$$\mathcal{S}_0(\tau) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} (E_2(\tau) - 1), \quad (7.24)$$

$$\mathcal{S}_j(\tau) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} (2\pi i)^j P_j(E_2(\tau), E_4(\tau), E_6(\tau)), \quad j \geq 1. \quad (7.25)$$

In particular, substitution of (7.20)–(7.21) evaluates every $\mathcal{S}_j(i)$ and $\mathcal{S}_j(\rho)$ by a finite polynomial calculation over $\mathbb{Q}$ and the indicated gamma periods.

Proof. Equation (7.11) and the definition of E_2 give (7.24). By the chain rule and (7.22), every polynomial $P \in \mathbb{Q}[X, Y, Z]$ satisfies

$$\theta(P(E_2, E_4, E_6)) = (\mathcal{V}P)(E_2, E_4, E_6).$$

Induction from $P_0 = X$ therefore gives $\theta^j E_2 = P_j(E_2, E_4, E_6)$. Differentiate (7.24) $j \geq 1$ times and use (7.10). The constant term disappears, and $d/d\tau = 2\pi i \theta$ contributes the factor $(2\pi i)^j$. This proves (7.25); the CM specializations use the established seed values. $\square$

For clarity, the first two differentiated evaluations are

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} n [\psi''(ni) - \psi''(1 - ni)] = \frac{i\pi}{4} - \frac{i\Gamma(1/4)^8}{768\pi^3}, \quad (7.26)$$

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} n [\psi''(n\rho) - \psi''(1 - n\rho)] = \frac{i\pi}{3}, \quad (7.27)$$

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} n^2 [\psi'''(ni) + \psi'''(1 - ni)] = -\frac{\pi}{4} + \frac{\Gamma(1/4)^8}{256\pi^3}, \quad (7.28)$$

$$\sum_{n \geq 1} n^2 [\psi'''(n\rho) + \psi'''(1 - n\rho)] = -\frac{2\sqrt{3}\pi}{9} - \frac{\Gamma(1/3)^{18}}{1024\pi^8}. \quad (7.29)$$

These follow by substituting the seed values into P_1, P_2 , so their derivation contains no integer-relation search.

Corollary 7.21 (Polynomial degree bounds for the CM row formulas). *Put $A = \Gamma(1/4)^8/\pi^4$ and $B = \Gamma(1/3)^{18}/\pi^9$. For each $j \geq 1$, there are polynomials $U_j \in \mathbb{Q}[t]$ and $V_j \in \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})[t]$ such that*

$$\frac{\mathcal{S}_j(i)}{i^j \pi} = U_j(A), \quad \frac{\mathcal{S}_j(\rho)}{i^j \pi} = V_j(B),$$

with

$$\deg U_j \leq \left\lfloor \frac{j+1}{2} \right\rfloor, \quad \deg V_j \leq \left\lfloor \frac{j+1}{3} \right\rfloor.$$

Proof. Give X, Y, Z weights 2, 4, 6. Each term of $\mathcal{V}$ raises weight by two, so P_j is homogeneous of weight $2j + 2$. At the square point, the surviving monomials $X^a Y^b$ have $a + 2b = j + 1$. On inserting the seeds into (7.25) and dividing by $i^j \pi$, each becomes a rational multiple of A^b . At the hexagonal point, the surviving monomials $X^a Z^c$ satisfy $a + 3c = j + 1$, and the same substitution produces an element of $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})B^c$. The stated degree bounds follow. $\square$

7.11.4 What this resolves and how it is verified

Corollary 7.19 resolves the weight-two row-sum question posed in the modular draft. Theorem 7.20 extends it to all polynomially weighted derivative rows, with the explicit error estimate of Theorem 7.17. These are evaluations of specified infinite aggregates. They do not evaluate an isolated component such as $\text{Im } \psi'(i)$, nor do they prove that such a component is an Eichler integral. Any proposed identification of that isolated constant needs its own exact transform or functional equation.

The accompanying `code/modular_rows.py` constructs the rational functions R_d and the polynomials P_j by exact arithmetic. It checks individual rows against a separate complex-polygamma implementation, compares the CM formulas for $j = 0, \dots, 4$ with their rapidly convergent row sums, and checks representative tails. The output `data/modular_rows.json` records the exact coefficients, analytic truncation bounds, and numerical residuals. Its decimal calculations use ordinary high-precision arithmetic; they are numerical checks, not outward-rounded interval certificates. A machine enclosure can be obtained by evaluating the rational formulas and (7.6) with directed interval arithmetic. The identities themselves are proved above and do not depend on the numerical checks.

Chapter 8

Zeta jets, Stieltjes antiderivatives and negative polygamma

The gamma function is the first spectral derivative of Hurwitz zeta at zero. Further derivatives give a natural language for integrating Stieltjes functions. Integration in the Hurwitz parameter moves the spectral argument downward, creating the negative-order polygamma ladder. This chapter develops that common mechanism before tabulating its moments and rational values.

8.1 Below the digamma: $\psi^{(-2)}$ at rationals

One integration below the digamma sits $\psi^{(-2)}(z) = \int_0^z \log \Gamma(t) dt$. At denominators 3, 4, 6, reflection and distribution reduce the integral to Clausen values, $\zeta'(-1)$ and logarithms. The odd character part is Clausen-explicit at general rational points, but the even part can retain Dirichlet derivatives. The three original examples below are correct; their earlier extrapolation to every denominator was too broad.

Result 8.1 (log-gamma integrals in the Clausen lattice).

$$\begin{aligned}\int_0^{1/4} \log \Gamma(t) dt &= \frac{3}{32} + \frac{\log 2}{8} + \frac{\log \pi}{8} + \frac{G}{4\pi} - \frac{9}{8} \zeta'(-1), \\ \int_0^{1/3} \log \Gamma(t) dt &= \frac{1}{9} + \frac{\log 2}{6} - \frac{\log 3}{72} + \frac{\log \pi}{6} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi/3)}{4\pi} - \frac{4}{3} \zeta'(-1), \\ \int_0^{1/6} \log \Gamma(t) dt &= \frac{5}{72} + \frac{7 \log 2}{72} + \frac{\log 3}{144} + \frac{\log \pi}{12} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(\pi/3)}{4\pi} - \frac{5}{6} \zeta'(-1).\end{aligned}$$

The structural punchline: the quarter-point integral carries Catalan ($\text{Cl}_2(\pi/2) = G$) and the third-point integral carries $\text{Cl}_2(2\pi/3) = \frac{2}{3} \text{Cl}_2(\pi/3)$, two-thirds of Gieseking’s constant — the “level-3 Catalan” that had surfaced independently in the repository’s Eisenstein-ladder work — now arriving from a completely different direction.

Search observation 8.2 (recorded on purpose). (i) The half-point probe $\int_0^{1/2} \log \Gamma$ initially found no relation — because $\log \Gamma(1/2) = \frac{1}{2} \log \pi$ made the PSLQ basis $\mathbb{Q}$ -dependent, and PSLQ returned that degeneracy instead of the target. Basis atoms must be $\mathbb{Q}$ -independent. (ii) A $\psi^{(-3)}(1/4)$ probe via Cauchy’s repeated-integration kernel produced only a large-coefficient candidate (heights $\sim 10^6$) with a weak canary (10^{-46} at 100 dps) — *rejected* as a PSLQ false positive. The weight-3 level needs a properly prepared basis (presumably $\zeta'(-2)$ -equivalents plus Barnes- G -layer logarithms).

8.2 The general log-gamma integral and the fifth-point obstruction

Proposition 8.3 (An exact denominator-five correction). *Let χ_5 be the quadratic character modulo 5, with values $(1, -1, -1, 1)$ on residues $1, 2, 3, 4$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^{1/5} \log \Gamma(t) dt &= \frac{2}{25} + \frac{\log(2\pi)}{10} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi/5)}{4\pi} - \frac{6}{5}\zeta'(-1) \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{20}L'(-1, \chi_5) - \frac{29}{1200}\log 5. \end{aligned} \quad (8.1)$$

More generally, for $a > 0$,

$$\int_0^a \log \Gamma(t) dt = \zeta'(-1, a) - \zeta'(-1) + \frac{a - a^2}{2} + \frac{a}{2} \log(2\pi). \quad (8.2)$$

Proof. Differentiate $\partial_a \zeta(s, a) = -s\zeta(s+1, a)$ with respect to s at $s = -1$. Lerch's identity and $\zeta(0, a) = \frac{1}{2} - a$ give

$$\partial_a \zeta'(-1, a) = \zeta'(0, a) - \zeta(0, a) = \log \Gamma(a) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) - \frac{1}{2} + a.$$

The shift identity for Hurwitz zeta shows that $\zeta'(-1, a) \rightarrow \zeta'(-1)$ as $a \downarrow 0$, since the additional term is $-a \log a$. Integration proves (8.2). These are classical Hurwitz-zeta identities [45]; the integrated theory is also developed by Espinosa and Moll [50].

Put $Z_r = \zeta'(-1, r/5)$ and $Z = \zeta'(-1)$. The Fourier reflection formula at this weight is

$$\zeta'(-1, a) - \zeta'(-1, 1-a) = \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi a)}{2\pi}, \quad 0 < a < 1. \quad (8.3)$$

For completeness, subtract the two Hurwitz Fourier expansions

$$\zeta(1-s, a) - \zeta(1-s, 1-a) = \frac{4\Gamma(s)}{(2\pi)^s} \sin \frac{\pi s}{2} \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{\sin(2\pi m a)}{m^s}$$

and differentiate at $s = 2$. Absolute local convergence of the series and its logarithmic derivative justifies the differentiation; the zero of the sine factor leaves precisely (8.3).

Differentiating distribution and the character decomposition at $s = -1$ gives

$$\begin{aligned} Z_1 + Z_2 + Z_3 + Z_4 &= -\frac{4}{5}Z - \frac{\log 5}{60}, \\ Z_1 - Z_2 - Z_3 + Z_4 &= \frac{1}{5}(L'(-1, \chi_5) + \log 5 L(-1, \chi_5)). \end{aligned}$$

Here $L(-1, \chi_5) = -2/5$, obtained directly from $\zeta(-1, a) = -B_2(a)/2$. Combining these equations with $Z_1 - Z_4 = \text{Cl}_2(2\pi/5)/(2\pi)$ yields

$$Z_1 = -\frac{1}{5}Z + \frac{1}{20}L'(-1, \chi_5) - \frac{29}{1200}\log 5 + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi/5)}{4\pi}.$$

Insert this into (8.2) at $a = 1/5$. □

The correction concerns the scope of the available reduction laws. It does not prove that $L'(-1, \chi_5)$ is transcendental or independent of the other constants in (8.1). A precise replacement for the earlier assertion is: the odd reflection component is Clausen-explicit, while the even component requires the appropriate Dirichlet- L derivatives unless further relations have been proved. The general Hurwitz-jet ladder below agrees with this corrected scope.

8.3 Binet’s second formula and Malmsten’s integrals: the Lambert-kernel face

Binet’s second formula

$$\log \Gamma(z) = \left(z - \frac{1}{2}\right) \log z - z + \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) + 2 \int_0^\infty \frac{\arctan(t/z)}{e^{2\pi t} - 1} dt$$

is the integrated Abel–Plana formula with the *Lambert kernel* $1/(e^{2\pi t} - 1)$ — the same kernel whose moment sums are the Eisenstein q -series of the companion CM article. Malmsten/Vardi log-log integrals $\int_0^1 \ln \ln(1/x) R(x) dx$ are the *Mellin avatars* of Kummer’s Fourier series: expanding the rational kernel R in a geometric series produces $L'(\chi, 1)$ -type sums, and Kummer’s formula converts odd-character $L'(1)$ into $\log \Gamma$ at rationals.

Result 8.4. Binet’s formula replays exactly at $z = 1, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{4}$ [historical experiment: residuals $\leq 10^{-52}$], turning every Γ -store atom into a closed-form arctan–Lambert integral; e.g.

$$\int_0^\infty \frac{\arctan(4t)}{e^{2\pi t} - 1} dt = \frac{1}{2} \left[\log \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) - \frac{1}{2} \log 2 + \frac{1}{4} - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) \right].$$

Result 8.5 (Vardi’s integral [5], re-derived blind). PSLQ over $\{\pi\gamma, \pi \log 2, \pi \log \pi, \pi \log \Gamma(1/4)\}$, with the γ atom *declined* (coefficient 0) [historical experiment: canary exact at 80 dps]:

$$\int_0^1 \frac{\ln \ln(1/x)}{1 + x^2} dx = \frac{\pi}{4} \ln\left(\frac{4\pi^3}{\Gamma(1/4)^4}\right).$$

The $q = 3$ Malmsten variant [historical experiment: canary 3.4×10^{-81} ; γ declined again]:

$$\int_0^1 \frac{\ln \ln(1/x)}{1 + x + x^2} dx = \frac{\pi}{6\sqrt{3}} \ln\left(\frac{2^8 \pi^8}{3^3 \Gamma(1/3)^{12}}\right).$$

Both integrals carry exactly the harvested- Γ -store atoms: the log-log family is a systematic *integral-representation generator* for the identity stores — every odd Dirichlet character (each denominator q) yields one such evaluation through Kummer’s formula, with the Γ -lattice reducer supplying the closed form mechanically.

8.4 The log-gamma moment ladder

Result 8.6 (Hurwitz ladder; classical (Whittaker–Watson [8])).

$$\log \Gamma(z) = \left(z - \frac{1}{2}\right) \log z - z + \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi) + \frac{1}{2} \sum_{n \geq 2} \frac{n-1}{n(n+1)} \zeta(n, z+1).$$

Since $\zeta(n, z+1)$ is $\psi^{(n-1)}(z+1)$ up to factorials, this is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear ladder between $\log \Gamma$ and the *entire polygamma tower at the same point* — a candidate certificate law binding the Γ and trigamma stores into one linear system.

Result 8.7 (second moment; classical (Espinosa–Moll [7])). With $L = \log(2\pi)$,

$$\int_0^1 [\log \Gamma(x)]^2 dx = \frac{\gamma^2}{12} + \frac{\pi^2}{48} + \frac{\gamma L}{6} + \frac{L^2}{3} - (\gamma + L) \frac{\zeta'(2)}{\pi^2} + \frac{\zeta''(2)}{2\pi^2}.$$

The quadratic-moment layer adds $\zeta''(2)$ to the atom inventory.

The numerical cubic moment originally suggested enlarging the constant basket. Its known Tornheim representation and the convergent certificate below settle that representation question; reduction to a specified smaller algebra remains separate.

8.5 Log-gamma moments: poles, late coefficients, and effective remainders

Let

$$M_n = \int_0^1 \log^n \Gamma(x) dx, \quad L = \log(2\pi), \quad A = \gamma + L.$$

The cubic moment is a test of whether an experiment has selected the right coordinate system. Bailey, D. Borwein and J. M. Borwein evaluated it in Tornheim derivatives [61, Theorem 6]. A smaller single-zeta basket can miss that structure; failure of such a search gives no independence theorem. We give the explicit representation and its convergence proof.

Similarly, the full fixed-order expansion of $M_n/n!$ into the exponential scales k^{-n} is Theorem 8.1 of Amdeberhan et al. [60]. The results proved below add an explicit late-coefficient asymptotic, identify the divergent character of that expansion, and give a uniform remainder bound when the number of retained terms grows linearly with n . These are refinements of a known expansion, not a claim to have discovered that expansion or the cubic Tornheim representation.

8.5.1 A compact form of the cubic identity

Define the holomorphic germ near $(1, 1, 1)$

$$T(r, s, t) = \sum_{m, n \geq 1} \frac{1}{m^r n^s (m+n)^t}.$$

A subscript j denotes partial differentiation in its j th argument; all unmarked Tornheim terms in the next formula are evaluated at $(1, 1, 1)$. The double sums and all the derivatives used here converge absolutely.

Theorem 8.8 (Cubic moment in one Tornheim differential operator). *With $A = \gamma + L$,*

$$\begin{aligned} M_3 = & \frac{L^3}{8} + \frac{\pi^2 L}{32} + \frac{3\zeta(3)}{16} + \frac{3L}{4\pi^2} (A^2 \zeta(2) - 2A\zeta'(2) + \zeta''(2)) \\ & + \frac{3}{8\pi^2} (A^2 T - 2AT_3 + 2T_{13} - T_{12}). \end{aligned} \quad (8.4)$$

This is an equivalent form of the known cubic evaluation in [61, Theorem 6].

Proof. Write the Kummer Fourier series as

$$\log \Gamma(x) = \frac{L}{2} + \frac{1}{2}C(x) + \frac{1}{\pi}S(x), \quad C(x) = \sum_{j \geq 1} \frac{\cos(2\pi jx)}{j}, \quad S(x) = \sum_{j \geq 1} \frac{A + \log j}{j} \sin(2\pi jx).$$

Reflection $x \mapsto 1 - x$ makes C even and S odd. Parseval gives

$$\int_0^1 C^2 = \frac{1}{2}\zeta(2), \quad \int_0^1 S^2 = \frac{1}{2}(A^2 \zeta(2) - 2A\zeta'(2) + \zeta''(2)).$$

The cosine resonance gives $\int C^3 = 3\zeta(3)/2$. Equivalently, one can differentiate the beta integral for $\int_0^1 (2 \sin \pi x)^u dx$ three times at zero and use $C = -\log(2 \sin \pi x)$. For the only remaining cubic term,

the elementary product rule for two sines and one cosine gives

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 CS^2 &= \frac{1}{2} \sum_{m,n \geq 1} \frac{(A + \log m)(A + \log(m+n))}{mn(m+n)} \\ &\quad - \frac{1}{4} \sum_{m,n \geq 1} \frac{(A + \log m)(A + \log n)}{mn(m+n)} \\ &= \frac{1}{4} (A^2T - 2AT_3 + 2T_{13} - T_{12}). \end{aligned}$$

Expansion of the cube now proves the formula.

For the convergence justification, first put an Abel factor r^j in every Fourier series, $0 < r < 1$. All products can then be integrated termwise. The functions C and S belong to every finite $L^p(0, 1)$, since the identities with $\log \Gamma(x)$ and $\log \Gamma(1-x)$ bound them by endpoint logarithms. Poisson convolution therefore converges to them in L^3 , so the integrated cubic products converge. In the resulting resonance sums the logarithmic numerator is bounded by a constant times $(1 + \log(m+n))^2$. Summing first over $m+n = q$ uses

$$\sum_{m=1}^{q-1} \frac{1}{m(q-m)q} = \frac{2H_{q-1}}{q^2},$$

which proves absolute convergence and legitimizes the Abel limit. $\square$

The double-coordinate derivative in (8.4) can also be written as a positive sum. Put

$$\mathcal{R}_A = \sum_{m,n \geq 1} \frac{(A + \log(m+n))^2 - \log((m+n)/m) \log((m+n)/n)}{mn(m+n)}.$$

Symmetry in m, n proves $\mathcal{R}_A = A^2T - 2AT_3 + 2T_{13} - T_{12}$. The numerator is positive: after expansion it is $A^2 + 2A \log(m+n) + (\log m + \log n) \log(m+n) - \log m \log n$. It is bounded above by $(A + \log(m+n))^2$. Consequently, if $\mathcal{R}_{A,N}$ restricts $m+n \leq N$ and $N \geq 3$ is an integer, then

$$0 < \mathcal{R}_A - \mathcal{R}_{A,N} \leq \frac{2}{N} (P(\log N) + P'(\log N) + P''(\log N) + P'''(\log N)), \quad P(u) = (1+u)(A+u)^2. \quad (8.5)$$

Indeed $H_{q-1} \leq 1 + \log q$, and $(1 + \log x)(A + \log x)^2/x^2$ decreases for $x \geq 3$. Integration of the resulting tail gives (8.5). This bound is elementary and rigorous but converges only as $O(\log^3 N/N)$; it is useful as an independent sign and normalization check, not as the preferred high-precision algorithm.

8.5.2 A positive summand form and an explicit tail bound

The combination in (8.4) can be computed without cancellation between separate Tornheim constants. For $k = m+n$, define

$$R_A(m, n) = A^2 + 2A \log k + \log m \log k + \log n \log k - \log m \log n.$$

Since $A > 0$, $\log k \geq \log m$, $\log n \geq 0$, we have $R_A(m, n) > 0$. Writing $p = \log m$, $q = \log n$, $r = \log k$, one also has $r(p+q) - pq \leq r^2$: for fixed r , the expression is increasing separately in $p, q \in [0, r]$. Consequently

$$0 < R_A(m, n) \leq (A + \log k)^2.$$

Therefore the diagonal partial sums

$$C_N = \frac{3}{32} \sum_{m+n \leq N} \frac{1}{mn(m+n)} + \frac{3}{8\pi^2} \sum_{m+n \leq N} \frac{R_A(m, n)}{mn(m+n)}$$

increase to the centered cubic moment $M_3 - a^3 - 3aV$. Moreover,

$$0 < (M_3 - a^3 - 3aV) - C_N \leq \sum_{k > N} \frac{2(1 + \log k)}{k^2} \left(\frac{3}{32} + \frac{3(A + \log k)^2}{8\pi^2} \right).$$

This gives a transparent computable enclosure, although its convergence is only $O(\log^3 N/N)$. An integral bound may be used once the explicit summand is decreasing; direct summation can handle the finite initial range. This positivity observation is an immediate corollary of the Fourier calculation, not a claim of a new classical-constant evaluation.

8.5.3 Exponentially convergent numerical reproduction

For $t > 0$, put

$$C(t) = \text{Li}_1(e^{-t}) = -\log(1 - e^{-t}), \quad F(t) = \partial_s \text{Li}_s(e^{-t}) \Big|_{s=1}.$$

The usual Mellin representation of the Tornheim sum gives

$$T_{12} = \int_0^\infty F(t)^2 dt, \quad T_{13} = \int_0^\infty F(t)C(t)(\log t + \gamma) dt, \quad T_3 = \int_0^\infty C(t)^2(\log t + \gamma) dt. \quad (8.6)$$

For $0 < t < 2\pi$, cancellation of the two poles in Jonquière's expansion produces

$$\begin{aligned} C(t) &= -\log t + \sum_{k \geq 1} c_k t^k, & c_k &= \frac{(-1)^k \zeta(1-k)}{k!}, \\ F(t) &= -\alpha - \gamma \log t - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 t + \sum_{k \geq 1} b_k t^k, & b_k &= \frac{(-1)^k \zeta'(1-k)}{k!}, \\ \alpha &= \gamma_1 + \frac{\gamma^2}{2} + \frac{\pi^2}{12}. \end{aligned}$$

Here the Stieltjes convention is $\zeta(1+z) = z^{-1} + \sum_{j \geq 0} (-1)^j \gamma_j z^j / j!$. For computational stability the coefficient formulas can be rewritten as

$$\begin{aligned} c_1 &= \frac{1}{2}, & b_1 &= \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi), \\ c_{2j} &= \frac{(-1)^j \zeta(2j)}{j(2\pi)^{2j}}, & b_{2j} &= c_{2j} \left(\log(2\pi) - \psi(2j) - \frac{\zeta'(2j)}{\zeta(2j)} \right), \\ c_{2j+1} &= 0 \quad (j \geq 1), & b_{2j+1} &= \frac{(-1)^{j+1} \pi \zeta(2j+1)}{(2j+1)(2\pi)^{2j+1}} \quad (j \geq 1). \end{aligned}$$

The functional equation of the Riemann zeta function proves these identities. Elementary bounds $\zeta(k) < 2$, $|\zeta'(k)| < 2$, $H_{k-1} \leq k-1$, $\gamma < 1$, $\log(2\pi) < 2$, and $2\pi > 6$ give, for $k \geq 2$,

$$|b_k| \leq 12 \cdot 6^{-k}, \quad |c_k| \leq 2 \cdot 6^{-k}.$$

Thus after degree $K \geq 1$ their remainders on $0 < t \leq 1$ are at most

$$\epsilon_b = \frac{12}{5}6^{-K}, \quad \epsilon_c = \frac{2}{5}6^{-K}.$$

All integrals of the resulting polynomials in t and $\log t$ are evaluated using $\int_0^1 t^k \log^j t \, dt = (-1)^j j! / (k+1)^{j+1}$.

On $t \geq 1$, insert $C(t) = \sum_{n \geq 1} e^{-nt}/n$ and $F(t) = -\sum_{n \geq 1} (\log n) e^{-nt}/n$. The integral with the logarithmic factor uses

$$\int_1^\infty e^{-kt} (\log t + \gamma) \, dt = \frac{E_1(k) + \gamma e^{-k}}{k}.$$

Truncate this sum at $m+n \leq N$. A common upper bound for the three omitted tails is

$$B_N = 4 \sum_{k > N} k e^{-k} = \frac{4e^{-(N+1)}((N+1) - Ne^{-1})}{(1 - e^{-1})^2}.$$

For the three integrals in the order T_{12}, T_{13}, T_3 , safe total series-truncation bounds are respectively

$$\epsilon_b(12 + \epsilon_b) + B_N, \quad 5\epsilon_b + 15\epsilon_c + 2\epsilon_b\epsilon_c + B_N, \quad 10\epsilon_c + 2\epsilon_c^2 + B_N.$$

For example the elementary estimates $C(t) \leq -\log t + 1$ and $|F(t)| \leq 4 - \log t + \frac{1}{2} \log^2 t$ on $(0, 1]$ imply all the constants above. The sharper bound $\int_0^1 |F(t)| \, dt < 6$ follows directly from its coefficient expansion (one may use $0 < \alpha < 2$). An elementary verification of the latter constant bound is available: the defining limit for γ_1 and the total variation of $x \mapsto \log x/x$ on $[1, \infty)$ give $|\gamma_1| \leq 2/e < 3/4$; combine this with $0 < \gamma < 3/5$ and $3 < \pi < \sqrt{12}$. This is an analytic truncation certificate; floating-point rounding must be handled separately to turn an implementation into interval arithmetic.

The independent implementation `verify_tornheim.py` evaluates the three partials and compares (8.4) against direct log-gamma quadrature. Its output explicitly labels the rounding qualification.

8.5.4 A sign check for an auxiliary identity

If the June 2012 preprint is used, an auxiliary sign should be checked before copying its Remark 3. Put

$$S_\gamma = \sum_{m, n \geq 1} \frac{(\gamma + \log m)(\gamma + \log n)}{mn(m+n)}.$$

Directly expanding the numerator, with absolutely convergent sums, gives

$$T_{12} = S_\gamma + 2\gamma(\zeta'(2, 1) + \zeta'(3)) - 2\gamma^2\zeta(3).$$

The coefficient of S_γ is positive. The displayed minus sign in equations (63) and (65) of the author-hosted June 2012 preprint would make their right side negative, although $T_{12} > 0$. This issue does not affect the cubic formula proved above. This note does not assert that the same typographical error occurs in the final journal typesetting.

8.5.5 Meromorphic moment generating function

For $\Re z < 1$, let

$$F(z) = \int_0^1 \Gamma(x)^z dx = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{M_n}{n!} z^n \quad (|z| < 1).$$

The power uses the real logarithm of $\Gamma(x) > 0$. Introduce the positive numbers

$$c_k = \frac{1}{k} [u^{k-1}] \Gamma(1-u)^k, \quad k \geq 1. \quad (8.7)$$

Their first values are

$$c_1 = 1, \quad c_2 = \gamma, \quad c_3 = \frac{3\gamma^2 + \zeta(2)}{2}, \quad c_4 = \frac{8\gamma^3 + 6\gamma\zeta(2) + \zeta(3)}{3}.$$

These agree with the coefficients in [60, Theorem 8.1].

Proposition 8.9 (All moment poles and their residues). *The function F extends meromorphically to the whole z -plane. Its only poles are simple poles at every positive integer, with*

$$\operatorname{Res}_{z=k} F(z) = (-1)^k k c_k \neq 0.$$

Proof. Fix $0 < a < 1$ and expand

$$\Gamma(x)^z = x^{-z} \Gamma(1+x)^z = x^{-z} \sum_{j=0}^{J-1} b_j(z) x^j + x^{J-z} E_J(x, z).$$

The b_j are entire functions (in fact polynomials) of z , and E_J is uniformly bounded for $0 \leq x \leq a$ and z in compact subsets of the plane. Integration from zero to a gives

$$\sum_{j=0}^{J-1} \frac{b_j(z) a^{j+1-z}}{j+1-z} + \int_0^a x^{J-z} E_J(x, z) dx.$$

The second term is holomorphic for $\Re z < J+1$; the integral from a to one is entire. Since J is arbitrary, these formulas give the claimed continuation. At $z = k$ the residue is $-b_{k-1}(k) = (-1)^k [u^{k-1}] \Gamma(1-u)^k$. Finally

$$\log \Gamma(1-u) = \gamma u + \sum_{j \geq 2} \frac{\zeta(j)}{j} u^j$$

has strictly positive coefficients, so (8.7) is positive. $\square$

The pole at k contributes $(-1)^{k-1} c_k / k^n$ to the Taylor coefficient of F at zero. This explains the exponential scales in the known moment asymptotics, but an infinite partial-fraction sum cannot be inferred without controlling the growth of c_k . That growth is decisive.

8.5.6 Late coefficients and the inverse reciprocal gamma function

Set $\phi(u) = \Gamma(1 - u)$ and let τ be the unique point in $(0, 1)$ satisfying

$$-\tau\psi(1 - \tau) = 1. \quad (8.8)$$

Equivalently $\psi(-\tau) = 0$. Define

$$\rho = \frac{\tau}{\Gamma(1 - \tau)}, \quad \alpha = -\log \rho, \quad v = 1 + \tau^2\psi'(1 - \tau), \quad C = \frac{\tau}{\sqrt{2\pi v}}. \quad (8.9)$$

Numerically,

$$\begin{aligned} \tau &= 0.50408300826445540925826930453330249895538518236858\dots, \\ \rho &= 0.28211580900629804215379660062046372823230190757940\dots, \\ \alpha &= 1.26543762211086561338203591116547399218544556554213\dots, \\ v &= 2.27159994608893009911993485126846348661898954658806\dots, \\ C &= 0.13342776130944528489602057053941782432703493711204\dots \end{aligned}$$

These displayed approximations are numerical evaluations; the theorem uses the exact definitions (8.8)–(8.9).

Theorem 8.10 (Late-coefficient asymptotic). *The coefficients (8.7) satisfy*

$$c_k = C\rho^{-k}k^{-3/2}(1 + O(k^{-1})). \quad (8.10)$$

In fact they have a full expansion in inverse powers of k . The power series $h(w) = \sum_{k \geq 1} c_k w^k$ has radius of convergence ρ , converges absolutely on $|w| \leq \rho$, and satisfies

$$h(w) = w\Gamma(1 - h(w)), \quad h(\rho) = \tau.$$

For every fixed real n , the formal moment series $\sum_{k \geq 1} (-1)^{k-1} c_k / k^n$ diverges, since its terms do not tend to zero.

Proof. Let $D = u d/du$. The function

$$\mu(u) = D \log \phi(u) = -u\psi(1 - u) = \gamma u + \sum_{j \geq 2} \zeta(j) u^j$$

is strictly increasing from zero to infinity on $(0, 1)$. Hence (8.8) has exactly one solution. Moreover $\phi(u) > 1$ there, so $0 < \rho < 1$ and $\alpha > 0$.

Write $\phi(u) = \sum_{j \geq 0} a_j u^j$ and introduce an integer-valued random variable X by

$$\Pr(X = j) = \frac{a_j \tau^j}{\phi(\tau)}.$$

All its probabilities are positive, in particular those at 0 and 1; it has lattice span one. Analyticity of ϕ on $|u| < 1$ gives an exponential moment. Its mean is $\mu(\tau) = 1$ and its variance is $D^2 \log \phi(\tau) = 1 + \tau^2\psi'(1 - \tau) = v > 0$. For independent copies and $S_k = X_1 + \dots + X_k$, coefficient extraction gives

$$c_k = \frac{\tau \rho^{-k}}{k} \Pr(S_k = k - 1). \quad (8.11)$$

Fourier inversion gives

$$\Pr(S_k = k - 1) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} \left(\frac{\phi(\tau e^{it})}{\phi(\tau)} e^{-it} \right)^k e^{it} dt.$$

For $t \neq 0$ modulo 2π , the modulus of the bracket is strictly less than one, because the distribution has positive mass at 0 and 1. On a small interval around zero its logarithm is $-vt^2/2 + O(t^3)$. Split off the complement of that interval, whose contribution is exponentially small, and put $t = y/\sqrt{k}$ in the remaining integral. Taylor expansion, dominated by a Gaussian on a shrinking central interval, gives

$$\Pr(S_k = k - 1) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi vk}} (1 + O(k^{-1})).$$

For a fully quantitative split, use $|t| \leq k^{-2/5}$, the band $k^{-2/5} < |t| \leq \delta$, and the fixed outer band. On the middle band the modulus is at most $e^{-ck^{1/5}}$; on the outer band it is $O(q^k)$ for some $q < 1$. The nominal $k^{-1/2}$ correction on the central band is odd and integrates to zero. Taylor expansion to arbitrary even order with its analytic remainder gives the full inverse-power expansion. This elementary saddle argument proves (8.10) and avoids any assumption about unexamined complex critical values of the reciprocal gamma function.

Lagrange inversion gives the stated functional equation for h near zero. Equation (8.10) proves that its radius is ρ and that it converges absolutely at the boundary. On $[0, \tau]$, the function $f(u) = u/\phi(u)$ increases from zero to ρ , with positive derivative before τ , since $f'(u) = (1 - \mu(u))/\phi(u)$. Its inverse is the positive real branch of h , hence continuity at the boundary gives $h(\rho) = \tau$. Finally (8.10) proves the stated divergence. $\square$

For completeness, the first correction in (8.10) is

$$c_k = C\rho^{-k}k^{-3/2} \left(1 + \frac{\beta_1}{k} + O(k^{-2}) \right),$$

where, with $\kappa_j = D^j \log \phi(\tau)$,

$$\begin{aligned} \beta_1 &= -\frac{1}{2v} + \frac{\kappa_3}{2v^2} + \frac{\kappa_4}{8v^2} - \frac{5\kappa_3^2}{24v^3} \\ &= 0.30196282878120524112458668271647811378573305248468 \dots \end{aligned}$$

This follows by retaining the quartic and squared cubic terms, together with the factor e^{it} , in the Fourier integral.

8.5.7 An effective remainder with a growing number of terms

Theorem 8.11 (Explicit truncation bound). *For integers $n \geq 1$ and $K \geq 1$ with $K\alpha < n$, put*

$$R_{n,K} = \frac{M_n}{n!} - \sum_{k=1}^K \frac{(-1)^{k-1} c_k}{k^n}.$$

Then, writing $\Gamma(n, z) = \int_z^\infty t^{n-1} e^{-t} dt$,

$$|R_{n,K}| \leq \frac{\alpha^n}{n!} \left(1 + \frac{n\tau}{n - K\alpha} \right) + \frac{\tau\rho^{-(K+1)}}{(K+1)^n} \frac{\Gamma(n, (K+1)\alpha)}{\Gamma(n)}. \quad (8.12)$$

In particular, whenever $n \geq \max\{2, 4\alpha^2\}$, the choice $K = \lfloor n/\alpha - \sqrt{n} \rfloor$ is positive and gives

$$|R_{n,K}| \leq \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi n}} + \frac{\tau}{\alpha\sqrt{2\pi}} + \tau e^{2\alpha^2} \right) \left(\frac{e\alpha}{n} \right)^n. \quad (8.13)$$

In particular every integer $n \geq 7$ meets the displayed hypothesis. Indeed $\rho \geq 1/(2\sqrt{\pi})$ by evaluating $u/\Gamma(1-u)$ at $u = 1/2$, and therefore $\alpha \leq \log(2\sqrt{\pi}) < 13/10$, so $4\alpha^2 < 169/25 < 7$.

Proof. The function $\log \Gamma(x)$ decreases strictly from infinity to zero on $(0, 1]$, because $\psi'(x) > 0$ and $\psi(1) = -\gamma < 0$. Let $x(y) \in (0, 1]$ be its inverse. The layer-cake formula, or integration by parts after this monotone change of variables, gives

$$\frac{M_n}{n!} = \frac{1}{\Gamma(n)} \int_0^\infty y^{n-1} x(y) dy. \quad (8.14)$$

For $y \geq \alpha$, Lagrange inversion and continuity on the convergence circle give

$$x(y) = -h(-e^{-y}) = \sum_{k \geq 1} (-1)^{k-1} c_k e^{-ky}.$$

The identity initially holds for sufficiently large y and extends along the negative real inverse branch. This branch cannot fail before $w = -\rho$: for $0 < x \leq 1$, the derivative of $1/\Gamma(x)$ is $-\psi(x)/\Gamma(x) > 0$.

For $y \geq \alpha$, positivity and $\sum c_k \rho^k = \tau$ give

$$\left| x(y) - \sum_{k=1}^K (-1)^{k-1} c_k e^{-ky} \right| \leq \tau \rho^{-(K+1)} e^{-(K+1)y}.$$

Integrating this on $[\alpha, \infty)$ produces the second term of (8.12). For the interval $[0, \alpha]$ use $0 < x(y) \leq 1$ and, since $n > k\alpha$,

$$\int_0^\alpha y^{n-1} e^{-ky} dy \leq \frac{\alpha^n e^{-k\alpha}}{n - k\alpha}.$$

To see this inequality, differentiate $y^n e^{-ky}$ and use $n - ky \geq n - k\alpha$. Sum over $1 \leq k \leq K$ and bound $\sum c_k e^{-k\alpha} \leq \tau$ to obtain the first term.

For the stated choice of K , $n - K\alpha \geq \alpha\sqrt{n}$. Let $\theta = (K+1)\alpha/n$. Then $1 - \alpha/\sqrt{n} < \theta \leq 1$ and the hypothesis ensures $\theta \geq 1/2$. Since

$$\theta - 1 - \log \theta \leq 2(1 - \theta)^2 \quad (1/2 \leq \theta \leq 1),$$

we have

$$\rho^{-(K+1)} (K+1)^{-n} = \left(\frac{e\alpha}{n} \right)^n e^{n(\theta-1-\log \theta)} \leq e^{2\alpha^2} \left(\frac{e\alpha}{n} \right)^n.$$

Finally use $\Gamma(n, z)/\Gamma(n) \leq 1$ and the lower Stirling bound $n! \geq \sqrt{2\pi n}(n/e)^n$. $\square$

For each fixed K , retaining one additional term in (8.12) recovers the usual asymptotic interpretation. The stronger content of (8.13) is that K may grow with n . The bound has the scale $(e\alpha/n)^n$. The late-coefficient theorem puts the least term near $(n + 3/2)/\alpha$ and gives its magnitude

$$C \left(\frac{e\alpha}{n + 3/2} \right)^{n+3/2} (1 + O(n^{-1})).$$

The rigorously proved remainder bound is within a polynomial factor of this scale. A least-term estimate alone would not prove a remainder bound; the inverse-function integral is what supplies that missing control.

The following values are numerical diagnostics from an independent integral in the variable $t = -\log x$, computed at 180 decimal digits. The rightmost column evaluates the explicit bound in (8.13); the inequality itself is proved above.

n	K	Observed $ R_{n,K} $	Explicit upper bound
8	3	$3.1162 \cdot 10^{-5}$	$1.4837 \cdot 10^{-2}$
20	11	$2.1101 \cdot 10^{-18}$	$6.4881 \cdot 10^{-15}$
40	25	$2.8961 \cdot 10^{-46}$	$3.0208 \cdot 10^{-42}$
80	54	$1.8102 \cdot 10^{-113}$	$5.9717 \cdot 10^{-109}$

The displayed bound decimals have been rounded upward. They serve as a scale comparison; exact theorem constants are defined by (8.9). Full numerical data are in `moment_diagnostics.json`.

8.5.8 A 112-digit rational certificate for the cubic moment

The file `certify_cubic.py` implements a separate high-precision calculation using integer outward intervals. No floating-point special function is trusted. Put $a = 1/2$, $\ell = \log 2$ and

$$b_1 = \gamma, \quad b_j = \frac{\zeta(j)}{j} \quad (j \geq 2), \quad B_M(x) = \sum_{j=1}^M b_j x^j.$$

On $0 < x \leq a$ we approximate $\log \Gamma(x)$ by $-\log x + B_M(-x)$; on the upper half of the interval, put $t = 1 - x$ and approximate $\log \Gamma(1 - t)$ by $B_M(t)$. Both errors are at most

$$Dx^{M+1}, \quad D = \frac{2\zeta(2)}{M+1},$$

with the corresponding variable x or t . This follows from the Taylor series and $\zeta(j) \leq \zeta(2)$ for $j \geq 2$. Define the exact elementary integrals

$$J_{j,p} = \int_0^{1/2} x^j (-\log x)^p dx = \frac{2^{-j-1} p!}{(j+1)^{p+1}} \sum_{r=0}^p \frac{((j+1)\ell)^r}{r!}.$$

If b_j^{*r} are the coefficients of B_M^r , the integrated polynomial approximation is

$$V_M = J_{0,3} + 3 \sum_{j=1}^M (-1)^j b_j J_{j,2} + 3 \sum_{j=2}^{2M} (-1)^j b_j^{*2} J_{j,1} + 2 \sum_{\substack{j \leq 3M \\ j \text{ even}}} b_j^{*3} J_{j,0}.$$

The last sum starts at $j = 4$. Since $0 \leq \log \Gamma(x) \leq -\log x$ on the lower half and $0 \leq \log \Gamma(1 - t) \leq 1$ on the upper half,

$$\begin{aligned} |M_3 - V_M| &\leq E_M := 3D(J_{M+1,2} + J_{M+1,0}) \\ &\quad + 3D^2(J_{2M+2,1} + J_{2M+2,0}) + 2D^3 J_{3M+3,0}. \end{aligned} \quad (8.15)$$

Here $\Gamma(1+x) \leq 1$ follows from log-convexity between 1 and 2; the upper-half bound follows from $\gamma < 1$, $\zeta(j) < 2$, and $\sum_{j \geq 2} (1/2)^j / j \leq 1/4$.

For reproducibility, the constant intervals come from the positive atanh series for $\log 2$, the Euler–Maclaurin formula for $\zeta(s)$ at $N = 128$, and the harmonic-number formula for γ . With $m = 96$, their respective analytic error bounds are

$$\frac{|B_{2m}|}{(2m)!}(s)_{2m-1}N^{-s-2m+1}, \quad \frac{|B_{2m}|}{2mN^{2m}}.$$

The sharper first-omitted-term zeta bound uses the Stieltjes remainder property, not just an absolute periodic-Bernoulli estimate. Namely,

$$\frac{1}{1-e^{-t}} = \frac{1}{t} + \frac{1}{2} + 2t \sum_{r \geq 1} \frac{1}{t^2 + 4\pi^2 r^2}.$$

Expanding each denominator geometrically through the term preceding B_{2m} gives a signed remainder bounded in absolute value by $|B_{2m}|t^{2m-1}/(2m)!$. Integrate this against $t^{s-1}e^{-Nt}/\Gamma(s)$ to obtain the stated bound. This argument also specifies exactly which Euler–Maclaurin terms are retained: $j = 1, \dots, m-1$. The gamma bound follows by expanding the geometric factor in Binet’s integral for the digamma function. For $s \geq 64$ the code instead brackets the tail of the direct positive sum by the two adjacent integrals. All rational operations round outwards at a fixed denominator 10^{130} . Exact Bernoulli numbers are provided by SymPy; no numerical Bernoulli approximation is involved.

At $M = 360$, the total interval has width less than $2.387 \cdot 10^{-113}$. In particular it certifies the displayed digits

$$M_3 = 5.74038880722947428001957168810246146296101300745487 \dots$$

The full lower and upper rational endpoints, and the analytic error bound, are stored in `cubic_certificate.json`. An independent 150-digit mpmath quadrature lies inside this proved interval; that numerical check is a diagnostic, whereas (8.15) and the outward arithmetic supply the certificate.

8.6 Sharp truncation of the log-gamma moment expansion

Use the constants τ, ρ, C of the preceding late-coefficient theorem, and put $\Lambda = -\log \rho$. In this section write $b_k = c_k > 0$ for those positive coefficients, and $\tilde{c}_k = (-1)^{k-1}b_k$. The real inverse $g(t)$ of $1/\Gamma(x)$ on $0 \leq x \leq 1$ satisfies $g(t) = -h(-t)$, where $h(w) = w\Gamma(1-h(w))$ is the earlier inverse germ. Thus $g(t) = \sum_{k \geq 1} \tilde{c}_k t^k$ near zero. The moment integral is

$$m_n := M_n/n! = \frac{1}{\Gamma(n)} \int_0^\infty y^{n-1} g(e^{-y}) dy.$$

The first relative coefficient d_1 below is the earlier β_1 . Set $P = \psi'(-\tau)$, $Q = \psi''(-\tau)$, and $R = \psi^{(3)}(-\tau)$; equivalently $d_1 = R/(8P^2) - 5Q^2/(24P^3)$.

Lemma 8.12 (The dominant inverse singularity). *The germ g continues to a slit disk of radius greater than ρ , with its only singularity on $|t| = \rho$ at $t = -\rho$, a square-root branch point.*

Proof. The positive inverse h has $h(\rho) = \tau$ and is absolutely convergent on that circle. Its positive coefficients of degrees one and two imply $|h(t)| < \tau$ at every other point of the circle. With $\Phi(u) = \Gamma(1-u)$, one then has $|t\Phi'(h(t))| \leq \rho\Phi'(|h(t)|) < \rho\Phi'(\tau) = 1$. The implicit-function theorem continues the inverse across those points. At $t = \rho$, local inversion at the simple critical point gives a convergent square-root expansion. Compactness supplies a slightly larger slit disk; replace t by $-t$ for g . This verifies the usual smooth implicit-function hypotheses directly. [75] $\square$

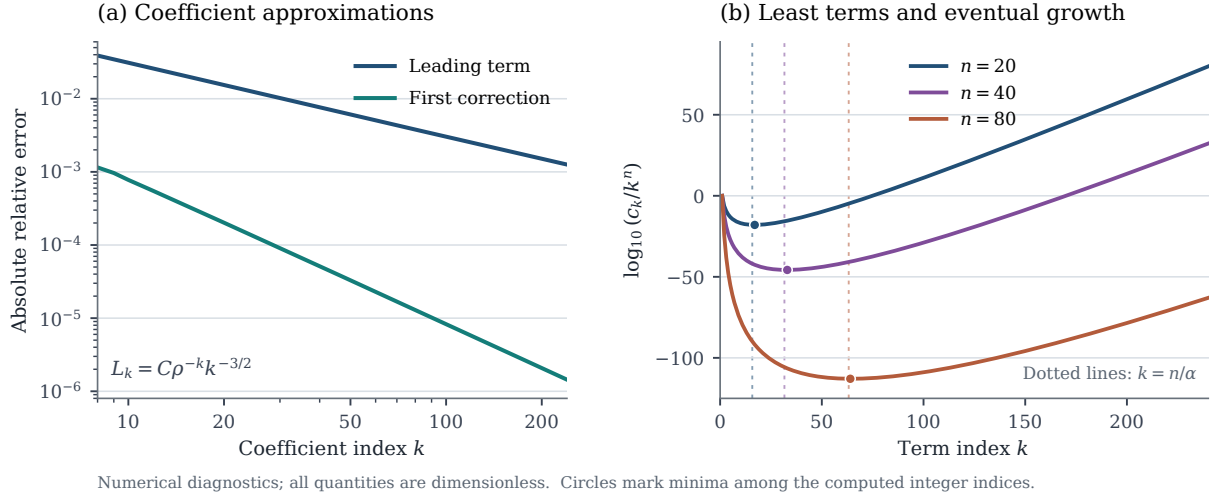


Figure 8.1: Numerical diagnostics for the proved coefficient and moment asymptotics. Left: absolute relative errors of $C\rho^{-k}k^{-3/2}$ and $C\rho^{-k}k^{-3/2}(1 + \beta_1/k)$, using coefficients computed from their positive defining recurrence. Right: $\log_{10}(c_k/k^n)$ for $n = 20, 40, 80$. Dotted vertical lines mark $k = n/\alpha$; circles mark the sampled minima. All plotted quantities are dimensionless. The figure illustrates the theorems and supplies no independent error certificate.

8.6.1 A uniform Taylor-remainder lemma

The next statement is the key passage from fixed-order asymptotics to optimal truncation. It explicitly crosses the radius of convergence on the positive real axis; merely summing an infinite Taylor tail there would be invalid.

Lemma 8.13 (Uniform inverse remainder). *For some $\delta > 0$, uniformly for $t \in [\rho e^{-\delta}, \rho e^{\delta}]$, put $r = t/\rho$. Then*

$$\frac{g(t) - \sum_{k=1}^{N-1} \tilde{c}_k t^k}{\tilde{c}_N t^N} = \frac{1}{1+r} + \frac{3r}{2N(1+r)^2} + O(N^{-2}). \quad (8.16)$$

On each of the remaining real intervals $0 < t \leq \rho e^{-\delta}$ and $\rho e^{\delta} \leq t \leq 1$, the same normalized remainder is bounded uniformly in N sufficiently large.

Proof. The preceding theorem gives a slit disk of continuation for g , with its only singularity at $-\rho$. Choose its outer radius $R > \rho$, and then $\delta > 0$ so small that $\rho e^{\delta} < R$ and $\rho e^{\delta} < 1$. Cauchy's integral formula for $g(t)$, less its first $N - 1$ Taylor terms, has kernel $t^N/(z^N(z - t))$. Deform its contour to the two banks of the negative cut and an outer contour. The coefficient $\tilde{c}_N$ uses kernel z^{-N-1} . On the cut $z = -s$, the ratio of these kernels, after removing t^N , is

$$\frac{z}{z - t} = \frac{s}{s + t}.$$

The jump of g at $s = \rho$ is a nonzero constant times $(s - \rho)^{1/2}(1 + O(s - \rho))$, with a complete expansion. The coefficient integral is thus a Watson-type endpoint integral whose normalized variable $u = (s - \rho)/\rho$ has

$$\langle u \rangle = \frac{3}{2N} + O(N^{-2}), \quad \langle u^2 \rangle = O(N^{-2}).$$

These formulas follow directly by comparing $\int_0^\epsilon u^{j+1/2}(1+u)^{-N-1} du$ with its beta integral extended to infinity. Terms outside a fixed small neighborhood of zero are exponentially smaller. Expanding

$$\frac{s}{s+t} = \frac{1}{1+r} + \frac{r}{(1+r)^2}u + O(u^2)$$

proves (8.16). The outer contour contributes $O(R^{-N})$ to the coefficient and $O((t/R)^N)$ to the remainder; after normalization these errors are exponentially small uniformly on the stated compact t -interval. This contour argument defines and estimates the actual analytic remainder on both sides of $t = \rho$.

It remains to bound the two outer real intervals. The estimate $b_k \asymp \rho^{-k}k^{-3/2}$ implies that, below $\rho e^{-\delta}$, the absolutely convergent tail is bounded by a constant times $b_N t^N$. Above ρe^δ , use

$$\sum_{k < N} \frac{b_k t^k}{b_N t^N} \ll \sum_{k < N} (N/k)^{3/2} (\rho/t)^{N-k}.$$

Splitting at $k = N/2$ bounds this uniformly by a geometric series plus an exponentially small term times a polynomial in N . Furthermore $0 \leq g(t) \leq 1$, whereas $b_N t^N$ grows exponentially uniformly on this interval. This proves the last claim. $\square$

8.6.2 Sharp optimal truncation

Theorem 8.14 (Half the first omitted term). *Let n, N tend to infinity through positive integers with $\eta = N\Lambda - n$ in a fixed bounded interval. Then*

$$m_n - \sum_{k=1}^{N-1} \frac{(-1)^{k-1} b_k}{k^n} = \frac{(-1)^{N-1} b_N}{N^n} \left(\frac{1}{2} + \frac{3-2\eta}{8N} + O(N^{-2}) \right). \quad (8.17)$$

The O -constant is uniform for bounded η . The ratio in parentheses has a complete asymptotic expansion in $1/N$, with coefficients computable from the local inverse expansion and gamma moments. In particular, taking the nearest integer to $(n + 3/2)/\Lambda$ gives a rigorously justified least-term approximation. The error eventually has the sign of the first omitted term and is asymptotic to one half of that term.

Proof. Subtract the finite sum under (8.14), using

$$\frac{1}{(n-1)!} \int_0^\infty y^{n-1} e^{-ky} dy = k^{-n}.$$

With Y having the gamma density $N^n y^{n-1} e^{-Ny}/(n-1)!$, the error divided by $\tilde{c}_N/N^n$ is the expectation of the normalized inverse remainder at $t = e^{-Y}$.

The gamma distribution concentrates at Λ :

$$\mathbb{E}Y = \frac{n}{N} = \Lambda - \frac{\eta}{N}, \quad \text{Var } Y = \frac{n}{N^2}.$$

For every fixed small $\delta > 0$, its probability outside $[\Lambda - \delta, \Lambda + \delta]$ is $O(e^{-a_\delta N})$. This follows from its moment-generating function $(1 - u/N)^{-n}$ and Chernoff's inequality. The uniform outer bounds in Lemma 8.13 therefore make the outer contribution exponentially small.

On the middle interval, the leading kernel is

$$L(Y - \Lambda) = \frac{1}{1 + e^{\Lambda - Y}}, \quad L(v) = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{v}{4} - \frac{v^3}{48} + O(v^4).$$

Writing $V = Y - \Lambda$, its centered gamma moments give

$$\mathbb{E}V = -\frac{\eta}{N}, \quad \mathbb{E}V^3 = O(N^{-2}), \quad \mathbb{E}V^4 = O(N^{-2}),$$

uniformly for bounded η . Thus $\mathbb{E}L(V) = 1/2 - \eta/(4N) + O(N^{-2})$. It is essential here to use the signed third moment; an absolute cubic bound alone would lose half a power. The correction kernel in (8.16) is

$$\frac{3e^{-V}}{2N(1 + e^{-V})^2}.$$

Its value at zero is $3/(8N)$, and its first derivative vanishes there, so its expectation is $3/(8N) + O(N^{-2})$. Adding these terms proves (8.17). The contour calculation and the Taylor/gamma-moment calculation can both be continued to arbitrary fixed order. Gamma central moments are polynomials in n and N^{-1} ; their parity and degree give integer powers of N^{-1} . $\square$

The theorem strengthens the classical expansion in two ways. It allows N to grow linearly with n , and it estimates the actual error after truncation. The least-term estimate alone would not justify either conclusion. No global sign assertion for every n, N is needed.

Corollary 8.15 (Second correction). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 8.14, the normalized error has the more precise expansion*

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{m_n - \sum_{k < N} \tilde{c}_k/k^n}{\tilde{c}_N/N^n} &= \frac{1}{2} + \frac{3 - 2\eta}{8N} \\ &+ \frac{1}{N^2} \left(\frac{d_1}{4} + \frac{\Lambda(6\eta - 13)}{96} \right) + O(N^{-3}). \end{aligned} \quad (8.18)$$

Proof. Here are the additional local coefficients, so that the assertion is independently reproducible. Let $v = B - \tau$, and use P, Q, R from (8.12). The characteristic inverse satisfies

$$\log \frac{B/\Gamma(1 - B)}{\rho} = -\frac{P}{2}v^2 + \frac{Q}{6}v^3 - \frac{R}{24}v^4 + O(v^5).$$

Putting $w = \sqrt{1 - t/\rho}$ and $\alpha_* = \sqrt{2/P}$, inversion gives

$$B(t) = \tau - \alpha_* w + \frac{Q}{3P^2}w^2 + \mu w^3 + O(w^4), \quad D := \frac{\mu}{\alpha_*} = -\frac{1}{4} + \frac{R}{12P^2} - \frac{5Q^2}{36P^3}.$$

Thus the positive cut density for B is $(\alpha_*/\pi)u^{1/2}(1 + Du + O(u^2))$, where $u = t/\rho - 1$. Transfer gives $d_1 = 3/8 + 3D/2$, proving (8.12) as well. The normalized endpoint moments are

$$\langle u \rangle = \frac{3}{2N} + \frac{9/4 + 3D/2}{N^2} + O(N^{-3}), \quad \langle u^2 \rangle = \frac{15}{4N^2} + O(N^{-3}), \quad \langle u^3 \rangle = O(N^{-3}).$$

They follow from beta integrals and the displayed cut density. The coefficient of N^{-2} in the inverse remainder at $r = t/\rho$ is therefore

$$K_2(r) = \frac{r}{(1 + r)^2} \left(\frac{9}{4} + \frac{3D}{2} \right) - \frac{15r}{4(1 + r)^3}, \quad K_2(1) = d_1/4.$$

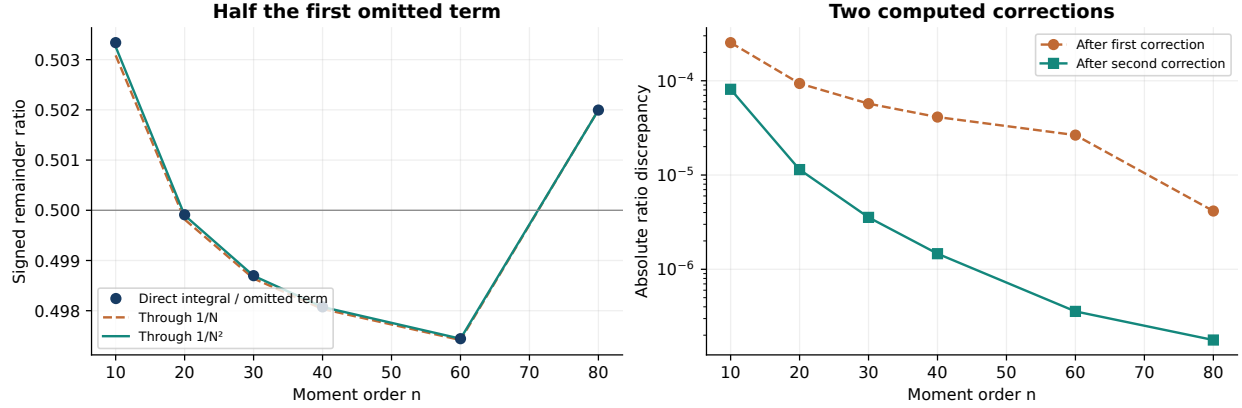


Figure 8.2: The signed error divided by the first omitted term, at a truncation near $(n + 3/2)/\Lambda$. The first-correction formula tracks the small changes caused by rounding the truncation index. The plot is numerical corroboration; Theorem 8.14 supplies the proof.

For the gamma average, put $K_1(v) = 3e^{-v}/[2(1 + e^{-v})^2]$ and $V = Y - \Lambda$. Taylor expansion through degree five, using $\mathbb{E}|V|^6 = O(N^{-3})$, gives

$$\mathbb{E}L(V) = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{\eta}{4N} + \frac{\Lambda(3\eta - 2)}{48N^2} + O(N^{-3}), \quad \mathbb{E}K_1(V) = \frac{3}{8} - \frac{3\Lambda}{32N} + O(N^{-2}).$$

For example $\mathbb{E}V^3 = \Lambda(2 - 3\eta)N^{-2} + O(N^{-3})$; the signed fifth moment is $O(N^{-3})$. Also $\mathbb{E}K_2(e^{-V}) = K_2(1) + O(N^{-1})$. The uniform outer bound again makes all outer contributions exponentially small. Combining the three terms proves (8.18). $\square$

8.6.3 A convergent identity with an explicit tail bound

An asymptotic series should not be used as an infinite exact sum. The same inverse coordinate gives an exact convergent alternative.

Proposition 8.16 (Cutoff identity). *For $n \geq 1$ and $Y > \Lambda$,*

$$m_n = \frac{1}{(n-1)!} \int_0^Y y^{n-1} g(e^{-y}) dy + \sum_{k \geq 1} \frac{\tilde{c}_k}{k^n} Q(n, kY), \quad Q(n, z) = e^{-z} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \frac{z^j}{j!}. \quad (8.19)$$

The sum is absolutely convergent. If $Y > \log 4$, the absolute tail after $k = K$ is at most

$$\frac{(4e^{-Y})^{K+1}}{2(1 - 4e^{-Y})} \sum_{j=0}^{n-1} \frac{Y^j}{j!(K+1)^{n-j}}. \quad (8.20)$$

Proof. Split (8.14) at Y , substitute the convergent inverse series on the tail, and integrate term by term. The coefficient growth theorem proves absolute convergence. For the elementary explicit bound, note that

$$\frac{1/2}{\Phi(1/2)} = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{\pi}} > \frac{1}{4}.$$

The smaller solution to $B = t\Phi(B)$ at $t = 1/4$ is therefore less than $1/2$; equivalently $B(1/4) < 1/2$. Positivity gives $b_k \leq 4^k/2$. For $k > K$ and $j \leq n-1$, $k^{j-n} \leq (K+1)^{j-n}$. The geometric tail now gives (8.20). $\square$

The numerical implementation uses ordinary high-precision arithmetic and explicitly distinguishes analytic truncation bounds from interval rounding bounds. Formula (8.19) is also suitable for a future ball-arithmetic evaluator: the finite inverse integral and all constant evaluations can be enclosed separately.

8.7 Reflected log-gamma moments and their late coefficients

Set $f(x) = \log \Gamma(x)$ for $0 < x < 1$, and define

$$M_{n,m} = \int_0^1 f(x)^n f(1-x)^m dx, \quad n, m \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}.$$

These integrals already occur as $T_{n+m,n}$ in Amdeberhan et al. [60, Section 5]. Their symmetry $M_{n,m} = M_{m,n}$ and the identities obtained by expanding Euler's reflection formula are therefore classical. The asymptotic question here is different: keep the reflected exponent m fixed and let n tend to infinity. The factor $f(1-x)^m$ vanishes to order m at the endpoint that produces the factorial growth. This shifts the first exponential scale from 1 to $m+1$ without removing the eventual divergence of the full expansion. Theorem 8.18 identifies its late terms, including their signs and the first relative correction.

8.7.1 The meromorphic transform and all finite asymptotic orders

Put

$$B(x) = \log \Gamma(1-x) = \gamma x + \sum_{j \geq 2} \frac{\zeta(j)}{j} x^j, \quad |x| < 1,$$

where γ is Euler's constant. For $k \geq 1$ define

$$A_{k,m} = \frac{1}{k} [x^{k-1}] \exp\{kB(-x)\} B(x)^m. \quad (8.21)$$

The convention $B(x)^0 = 1$ is in force. In particular $A_{k,m} = 0$ when $k \leq m$. Every coefficient is a finite polynomial over $\mathbb{Q}$ in $\gamma, \zeta(2), \dots, \zeta(k-1)$.

Theorem 8.17 (Reflected moment expansion). *For each fixed integer $m \geq 0$, the function*

$$F_m(z) = \int_0^1 \Gamma(x)^z f(1-x)^m dx$$

is holomorphic for $\operatorname{Re} z < m+1$, has Taylor expansion

$$F_m(z) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{M_{n,m}}{n!} z^n \quad (|z| < m+1),$$

and extends meromorphically to $\mathbb{C}$. Its only possible poles are simple poles at integers $k \geq m+1$, with

$$\operatorname{Res}_{z=k} F_m(z) = -k A_{k,m}. \quad (8.22)$$

The first pole is present. For every fixed integer $K \geq m+1$,

$$\frac{M_{n,m}}{n!} = \sum_{k=m+1}^K \frac{A_{k,m}}{k^n} + O_{m,K}((K+1)^{-n}), \quad n \rightarrow \infty. \quad (8.23)$$

Consequently

$$M_{n,m} \sim \frac{\gamma^m n!}{(m+1)^{n+1}}. \quad (8.24)$$

Proof. As $x \downarrow 0$, $f(x) = -\log x + O(x)$ and $B(x) = \gamma x + O(x^2)$. At the other endpoint, $f(x) = O(1-x)$ and $f(1-x) = O(1+|\log(1-x)|)$. These estimates prove absolute convergence and compact domination in the asserted half-plane, including after any number of differentiations in z . They also justify the Taylor expansion near zero.

Fix $0 < a < 1$ and an integer $J \geq 1$. Taylor expansion in x gives

$$\Gamma(1+x)^z B(x)^m = \sum_{j=0}^{J-1} b_{j,m}(z) x^j + x^J E_{J,m}(x, z),$$

where each $b_{j,m}$ is an entire function of z , and the remainder is uniformly bounded for $0 \leq x \leq a$ and z in compact sets. The integral over $[0, a]$ is therefore

$$\sum_{j=0}^{J-1} \frac{b_{j,m}(z) a^{j+1-z}}{j+1-z} + \int_0^a x^{J-z} E_{J,m}(x, z) dx.$$

The last integral is holomorphic for $\operatorname{Re} z < J+1$. The integral over $[a, 1]$ is entire, since its logarithmic singularity at 1 is integrable uniformly for z in compact sets. Letting J increase gives the continuation. At $z = k$ its residue is $-b_{k-1,m}(k) = -k A_{k,m}$. Since $B(x)^m$ starts with $\gamma^m x^m$, the first nonzero coefficient is $A_{m+1,m} = \gamma^m / (m+1) > 0$.

For the asymptotic assertion, subtract the polar functions

$$\sum_{k=m+1}^{K+1} \frac{k A_{k,m}}{k-z}$$

from $F_m(z)$. The difference is holomorphic on $|z| < K+2$. Cauchy's estimate on any circle $K+1 < R < K+2$ bounds its n th Taylor coefficient by $O_{m,K,R}(R^{-n})$. Restoring the term at $K+1$ proves (8.23), even if that particular coefficient happens to vanish. Taking $K = m+1$ proves (8.24). $\square$

The first three coefficients are explicit. Write $k = m+3$ in the last line:

$$\begin{aligned} A_{m+1,m} &= \frac{\gamma^m}{m+1}, \\ A_{m+2,m} &= \frac{\gamma^{m-1}}{m+2} \left(\frac{m\zeta(2)}{2} - (m+2)\gamma^2 \right), \\ A_{m+3,m} &= \frac{\gamma^m}{k} \left\{ \frac{m\zeta(3)}{3\gamma} + \frac{m(m-1)\zeta(2)^2}{8\gamma^2} + \frac{k(1-m)\zeta(2)}{2} + \frac{k^2\gamma^2}{2} \right\}. \end{aligned} \quad (8.25)$$

These displays also apply to $m = 0$, since $\gamma > 0$ and factors of m remove the superfluous terms. For example,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{M_{n,1}}{n!} &= \frac{\gamma}{2^{n+1}} + \frac{\zeta(2)/2 - 3\gamma^2}{3^{n+1}} + \frac{\zeta(3)/3 + 8\gamma^3}{4^{n+1}} + O(5^{-n}), \\ \frac{M_{n,2}}{n!} &= \frac{\gamma^2}{3^{n+1}} + \frac{\gamma\zeta(2) - 4\gamma^3}{4^{n+1}} + O(5^{-n}). \end{aligned}$$

The second displayed correction is positive, whereas the corresponding correction for $m = 1$ is negative. Thus strict alternation from the first term cannot be imported from the unreflected family. The two signs can, for instance, be checked using the elementary enclosures $0.577 < \gamma < 0.578$ and $1.644 < \zeta(2) < 1.646$. Eventual alternation has a different, precise rule.

8.7.2 Late coefficients and a universal inverse-gamma scale

Let $\phi(u) = \Gamma(1 - u)$ and $D = u d/du$. Define $\tau \in (0, 1)$ by

$$D \log \phi(\tau) = -\tau \psi(1 - \tau) = 1, \quad (8.26)$$

and put

$$\rho = \frac{\tau}{\phi(\tau)}, \quad v = D^2 \log \phi(\tau) = 1 + \tau^2 \psi'(1 - \tau), \quad C = \frac{\tau}{\sqrt{2\pi v}}, \quad b = -\log \Gamma(1 + \tau). \quad (8.27)$$

The equation for τ has a unique solution: its left side equals $\gamma u + \sum_{j \geq 2} \zeta(j) u^j$, which is strictly increasing from zero to infinity. Also $0 < \rho < 1$ and $b > 0$, the latter by strict log-convexity of Γ between 1 and 2. Numerically, $\tau = 0.5040830082\dots$ and $\rho = 0.2821158090\dots$. Only the exact definitions are used below.

Theorem 8.18 (Late reflected coefficients). *For every fixed nonnegative integer m ,*

$$A_{k,m} = (-1)^{k+m-1} C b^m \rho^{-k} k^{-3/2} \left(1 + \frac{\beta_m}{k} + O_m(k^{-2}) \right). \quad (8.28)$$

There is a full asymptotic expansion in integer powers of $1/k$. To specify the first correction, set $G(u) = \log \Gamma(1 + u)$, $H_m(u) = G(u)^m$, and $\kappa_j = D^j \log \phi(\tau)$. All quantities on the right below are evaluated at $u = \tau$:

$$\beta_m = -\frac{(D+1)^2 H_m}{2v H_m} + \frac{\kappa_3 (D+1) H_m}{2v^2 H_m} + \frac{\kappa_4}{8v^2} - \frac{5\kappa_3^2}{24v^3}. \quad (8.29)$$

In particular, every sufficiently large possible pole in Theorem 8.17 is present. More explicitly,

$$\text{Res}_{z=k} F_m(z) = (-1)^{k+m} C b^m \rho^{-k} k^{-1/2} \left(1 + \frac{\beta_m}{k} + O_m(k^{-2}) \right),$$

so the eventual residue sign is $(-1)^{k+m}$. For every fixed real n , the formal series $\sum_{k \geq m+1} A_{k,m}/k^n$ diverges because its terms do not tend to zero.

Proof. Replacing x by $-u$ in (8.21) gives

$$A_{k,m} = \frac{(-1)^{k-1}}{k} [u^{k-1}] \phi(u)^k H_m(u).$$

The function H_m is holomorphic for $|u| < 1$. If $\phi(u) = \sum_{j \geq 0} a_j u^j$, all the a_j are strictly positive, since $\log \phi$ has positive coefficients. Thus

$$p_j = \frac{a_j \tau^j}{\phi(\tau)}$$

is a probability distribution with exponential moments, mean one, variance $v > 0$, and positive mass at both 0 and 1. It follows that the function

$$Q(t) = \frac{\phi(\tau e^{it})}{\phi(\tau)} e^{-it}$$

has modulus strictly less than one for $0 < |t| \leq \pi$, while

$$\log Q(t) = -\frac{v}{2} t^2 - \frac{i\kappa_3}{6} t^3 + \frac{\kappa_4}{24} t^4 + O(t^5)$$

near zero. Cauchy's coefficient formula becomes

$$A_{k,m} = \frac{(-1)^{k-1} \tau \rho^{-k}}{2\pi k} \int_{-\pi}^{\pi} Q(t)^k e^{it} H_m(\tau e^{it}) dt. \quad (8.30)$$

Fix a sufficiently small $\delta > 0$. On $\delta \leq |t| \leq \pi$ the integral is $O(q^k)$ for some $q < 1$. On $k^{-2/5} \leq |t| \leq \delta$ it is $O(e^{-ck^{1/5}})$, because $|Q(t)| \leq e^{-ct^2}$. The analytic amplitude is bounded on the whole circle. On the remaining interval set $t = y/\sqrt{k}$. Gaussian domination and Taylor expansion to any fixed order, with an analytic remainder, give a full expansion. Odd terms integrate to zero, so only integer powers of $1/k$ occur. The leading integral is

$$H_m(\tau) \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{vk}} = (-1)^m b^m \sqrt{\frac{2\pi}{vk}},$$

which proves the leading term in (8.28).

For the first correction, the amplitude derivatives at $t = 0$ are H_m , $i(D+1)H_m$, and $-(D+1)^2 H_m$. The Gaussian moments of degrees 2, 4, and 6 contribute, respectively, the amplitude's quadratic term, the amplitude-cubic cross term together with the quartic phase term, and the square of the cubic phase term. Their normalized sum is exactly (8.29). Expanding two further even orders gives a relative $O_m(k^{-2})$ remainder after the displayed correction. Since $Cb^m > 0$ and $\rho < 1$, the assertions about nonvanishing, signs, and divergence follow at once. $\square$

This proof uses the circle $|u| = \tau$ and a strict modulus inequality; it does not presume a classification of all complex critical values of the reciprocal gamma function. The same circle governs every fixed reflected exponent. With $\alpha = -\log \rho$, the continuous minimum of the leading term magnitude $\rho^{-k} k^{-n-3/2}$ occurs at $k = (n + 3/2)/\alpha$. A least-term calculation alone does not bound the remainder. The next result supplies an explicit bound with a growing number of terms.

8.7.3 An effective remainder despite the initial sign changes

Theorem 8.19 (Explicit reflected truncation bound). *Let $m \geq 0$, $n \geq 1$, and $K \geq 1$ be integers, put $\alpha = -\log \rho$ and $T_m = \tau B(\tau)^m$, and suppose $K\alpha < n$. With*

$$R_{n,K}^{(m)} = \frac{M_{n,m}}{n!} - \sum_{k=1}^K \frac{A_{k,m}}{k^n}, \quad \Gamma(n, s) = \int_s^\infty t^{n-1} e^{-t} dt,$$

one has the entirely explicit estimate

$$\begin{aligned} |R_{n,K}^{(m)}| &\leq \frac{\alpha^n}{n!} \left(m! + \frac{nT_m}{n - K\alpha} \right) \\ &\quad + \frac{T_m \rho^{-K-1}}{(K+1)^n} \frac{\Gamma(n, (K+1)\alpha)}{\Gamma(n)}. \end{aligned} \quad (8.31)$$

If $n \geq \max\{2, 4\alpha^2\}$ and $K = \lfloor n/\alpha - \sqrt{n} \rfloor$, then $K \geq 1$ and

$$|R_{n,K}^{(m)}| \leq \left(\frac{m!}{\sqrt{2\pi n}} + \frac{T_m}{\alpha\sqrt{2\pi}} + T_m e^{2\alpha^2} \right) \left(\frac{e\alpha}{n} \right)^n. \quad (8.32)$$

This bound holds for every m , but no useful uniform relative error is asserted when m grows with n .

Proof. The function f decreases from infinity to zero on $(0, 1]$: $\psi'(x) > 0$ and $\psi(1) = -\gamma < 0$. Let $x(y)$ denote its inverse, and set $W_m(x) = \int_0^x B(t)^m dt$. Tonelli's theorem applied to $f(x)^n = n \int_0^{f(x)} y^{n-1} dy$ gives

$$\frac{M_{n,m}}{n!} = \frac{1}{\Gamma(n)} \int_0^\infty y^{n-1} W_m(x(y)) dy. \quad (8.33)$$

Let $h(q)$ be the local solution of $h = q\phi(h)$ with $h(0) = 0$. Lagrange inversion gives positive coefficients

$$h(q) = \sum_{k \geq 1} c_k q^k, \quad c_k = \frac{1}{k} [u^{k-1}] \phi(u)^k.$$

The $m = 0$ case of Theorem 8.18 proves that its radius is ρ and that the series converges absolutely on $|q| \leq \rho$. The map $u \mapsto u/\phi(u)$ increases strictly from 0 to ρ on $[0, \tau]$, so inversion along this interval and continuity imply $h(\rho) = \tau$. No other inverse branch is used.

Lagrange–Bürmann inversion now gives

$$W_m(x(y)) = \sum_{k \geq 1} A_{k,m} e^{-ky} \quad (y \geq \alpha).$$

Indeed $x(y) = -h(-e^{-y})$ initially for large y , and then throughout $y > \alpha$ by analytic continuation along the strictly monotone real inverse. The endpoint follows by absolute convergence. To prove that convergence and obtain its quantitative majorant, define

$$d_{k,m} = \frac{1}{k} [u^{k-1}] \phi(u)^k B(u)^m \geq 0.$$

Coefficientwise absolute values in $B(-u)^m$ are $B(u)^m$. Consequently $|A_{k,m}| \leq d_{k,m}$, while another application of Lagrange–Bürmann gives

$$\sum_{k \geq 1} d_{k,m} \rho^k = W_m(h(\rho)) = W_m(\tau) \leq \tau B(\tau)^m = T_m.$$

Here B has positive Taylor coefficients and is increasing on $[0, \tau]$. Thus on $y \geq \alpha$,

$$\left| W_m(x(y)) - \sum_{k=1}^K A_{k,m} e^{-ky} \right| \leq T_m \rho^{-K-1} e^{-(K+1)y}.$$

Its integral in (8.33) is the second term of (8.31).

On $0 \leq y \leq \alpha$, use $0 \leq W_m(x(y)) \leq M_{m,0} \leq m!$. The last inequality follows from $0 \leq \log \Gamma(x) \leq -\log x$, since log-convexity gives $\Gamma(1+x) \leq 1$ for $0 \leq x \leq 1$. Also, for $k \leq K$,

$$\int_0^\alpha y^{n-1} e^{-ky} dy \leq \frac{\alpha^n e^{-k\alpha}}{n - k\alpha}.$$

This follows by differentiating $y^n e^{-ky}$ and using $n - ky \geq n - k\alpha > 0$. Summing with $\sum |A_{k,m}| \rho^k \leq T_m$ proves the first term of (8.31).

For the stated choice of K , $n - K\alpha \geq \alpha\sqrt{n}$ and $\theta = (K+1)\alpha/n$ lies in $[1/2, 1]$. The inequality $\theta - 1 - \log \theta \leq 2(1 - \theta)^2$ gives

$$\rho^{-K-1} (K+1)^{-n} \leq e^{2\alpha^2} (e\alpha/n)^n.$$

Finally, $\Gamma(n, s) \leq \Gamma(n)$ and $n! \geq \sqrt{2\pi n} (n/e)^n$ yield (8.32). $\square$

8.7.4 Sharp truncation for every fixed reflected exponent

The reflected coefficient expansion and the sharp inverse remainder now combine. This statement uses the two incoming developments together; it is stronger than their separate absolute-bound and unreflected results. Write $\Lambda = -\log \rho$, and retain β_m from (8.29).

Corollary 8.20 (Half the first omitted reflected term). *Fix an integer $m \geq 0$. Let $n, N \rightarrow \infty$ through positive integers, with $\eta = N\Lambda - n$ in a fixed bounded interval. Then*

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{M_{n,m}/n! - \sum_{k=1}^{N-1} A_{k,m}/k^n}{A_{N,m}/N^n} &= \frac{1}{2} + \frac{3-2\eta}{8N} \\ &+ \frac{1}{N^2} \left[\frac{\beta_m}{4} + \frac{\Lambda(6\eta-13)}{96} \right] + O_m(N^{-3}), \end{aligned} \quad (8.34)$$

uniformly for bounded η . In particular the error eventually has sign $(-1)^{N+m-1}$ and is asymptotic to half the first omitted term. The denominator is nonzero for every sufficiently large N .

Proof. Set $W_m(x) = \int_0^x B(u)^m du$ and $G_m(t) = W_m(g(t))$, where g is the real inverse used in the preceding sharp-moment section. Lagrange–Bürmann inversion gives $G_m(t) = \sum_{k \geq 1} A_{k,m} t^k$ near zero. The layer-cake formula (8.33) becomes

$$M_{n,m}/n! = \frac{1}{\Gamma(n)} \int_0^\infty y^{n-1} G_m(e^{-y}) dy.$$

Since W_m is holomorphic on $|x| < 1$, it can be composed with the slit-disk inverse of Lemma 8.12. At the dominant point $g(-\rho) = -\tau$ its derivative is

$$W'_m(-\tau) = B(-\tau)^m = (\log \Gamma(1+\tau))^m = (-b)^m \neq 0.$$

Thus G_m has the same sole dominant square-root singularity, with a nonzero leading amplitude. Its late coefficients have the relative coefficient β_m established in Theorem 8.18. The Cauchy cut-contour argument in Lemma 8.13 therefore applies to G_m with the same leading kernel $1/(1+t/\rho)$ and the same $3/(2N)$ endpoint-moment correction. The sign of the leading jump cancels against $A_{N,m}$ in this ratio. The second normalized cut coefficient at $t = \rho$ is $\beta_m/4$, by the same square-root transfer and beta-moment calculation used in Corollary 8.15.

The outer real-interval bounds also persist. Above the convergence radius, the finite coefficient sum is bounded using $|A_{k,m}| \asymp_m \rho^{-k} k^{-3/2}$, while $0 \leq G_m(t) \leq m!$ for $0 \leq t \leq 1$. The finitely many exceptional early coefficients contribute only an exponentially small term after normalization. Below the radius, the absolute Taylor tail gives the corresponding uniform bound. Average the normalized remainder against the gamma density with shape n and rate N . Its signed moments are exactly those used in the unreflected calculation. The first two corrections are consequently (8.34), with d_1 replaced by β_m ; the analytic cut expansion and moments through degree six give the stated uniform $O_m(N^{-3})$ remainder. Eventual nonvanishing and the sign follow from (8.28). $\square$

This fixed- m corollary does not supply uniform relative estimates when m grows with n . That joint regime remains a separate problem.

8.7.5 An exact identity coupling all reflected residues

The coefficients across different m satisfy a finite identity in which Euler’s constant and all odd zeta values cancel.

Proposition 8.21 (Reflection sum for the residues). *For every integer $k \geq 1$,*

$$\sum_{m=0}^{k-1} \frac{k^m}{m!} A_{k,m} = \begin{cases} 0, & k \text{ even}, \\ \frac{\pi^{k-1}}{k 2^{k-1}} \binom{k-1}{(k-1)/2}, & k \text{ odd}. \end{cases} \quad (8.35)$$

Proof. Because $B(x)^m$ has order m , extending the sum over m to infinity does not affect $[x^{k-1}]$. Euler's reflection formula gives

$$\sum_{m=0}^{k-1} \frac{k^m}{m!} A_{k,m} = \frac{1}{k} [x^{k-1}] (\Gamma(1+x)\Gamma(1-x))^k = \frac{1}{k} [x^{k-1}] \left(\frac{\pi x}{\sin \pi x} \right)^k.$$

The coefficient is zero for even k . For odd k , compute it as the residue at $x = 0$ of $(\pi/\sin \pi x)^k dx$. The local change of variable $t = \sin \pi x$ gives

$$[x^{k-1}] \left(\frac{\pi x}{\sin \pi x} \right)^k = \pi^{k-1} [t^{k-1}] (1-t^2)^{-1/2},$$

and the binomial expansion proves (8.35). $\square$

For example, the cases $k = 2, 3$ read $A_{2,0} + 2A_{2,1} = 0$ and $A_{3,0} + 3A_{3,1} + \frac{9}{2}A_{3,2} = \pi^2/6$. They are exact identities among the asymptotic coefficients, rather than convergent sums of the moment expansions. No summation over the late index k is used.

8.7.6 A recorded log-sine conjecture has a formal proof

There is also a small but useful correction to the logical status of a claim in the literature. The author preprint of [60] labels a coefficient identity as Conjecture 5.5 and motivates it using transcendence assumptions on $\log 2$ and $\log \pi$. For the canonical formal polynomials supplied by the beta integral, the coefficient identity needs none of those assumptions. Under the preprint's assumptions these formal coefficients coincide with its uniquely specified numerical coefficients, so the result also proves that stated implication. We do not assert uniqueness of arbitrary numerical expressions in zeta values and logarithms, nor priority over any later treatment.

Define polynomials $\mathcal{P}_N(X)$ by

$$\sum_{N \geq 0} \mathcal{P}_N(X) \frac{z^N}{N!} = \exp \left\{ Xz + \sum_{j \geq 2} \frac{(1-2^{1-j})\zeta(j)}{j} z^j \right\}. \quad (8.36)$$

Proposition 8.22 (Unconditional coefficient and translation identities). *For $N \geq 0$,*

$$\int_0^1 [-\log \sin(\pi x)]^N dx = \mathcal{P}_N(\log 2), \quad (8.37)$$

$$[X^j] \mathcal{P}_N(X) = \binom{N}{j} \mathcal{P}_{N-j}(0), \quad 0 \leq j \leq N,$$

$$\sum_{j=0}^N \binom{N}{j} M_{j,N-j} = \mathcal{P}_N(\log(2\pi)).$$

Moreover, the coefficients admit the finite partition formula

$$\mathcal{P}_N(X) = N! \sum_{r_1+2r_2+\dots+Nr_N=N} \frac{X^{r_1}}{r_1!} \prod_{j=2}^N \frac{1}{r_j!} \left(\frac{(1-2^{1-j})\zeta(j)}{j} \right)^{r_j}. \quad (8.38)$$

Proof. For $\operatorname{Re} z < 1$, the beta integral gives

$$\int_0^1 \sin(\pi x)^{-z} dx = \frac{\Gamma((1-z)/2)}{\sqrt{\pi} \Gamma(1-z/2)}.$$

Expanding its logarithm at zero gives the right side of (8.36) with $X = \log 2$; its degree- j coefficient for $j \geq 2$ is $(1 - 2^{1-j})\zeta(j)/j$. Extracting Taylor coefficients proves (8.37). The factor e^{Xz} gives $[X^j]\mathcal{P}_N = \binom{N}{j}\mathcal{P}_{N-j}(0)$ by formal coefficient extraction. Euler's reflection formula turns the sum of mixed moments into the integral of $(\log \pi - \log \sin \pi x)^N$, which translates X by $\log \pi$. Expanding each exponential factor separately proves (8.38). All formal operations in a fixed degree involve only finitely many coefficients. $\square$

The constant-column generating function has the additional factorization

$$\sum_{N \geq 0} \mathcal{P}_N(0) \frac{z^N}{N!} = \sqrt{\frac{\tan(\pi z/2)}{\pi z/2}} \exp \left\{ \sum_{\substack{j \geq 3 \\ j \text{ odd}}} \frac{(1 - 2^{1-j})\zeta(j)}{j} z^j \right\}, \quad (8.39)$$

where the square root is the formal branch with constant term one. Indeed, multiplying the left side by its value at $-z$ and applying the reflection formula yields $\tan(\pi z/2)/(\pi z/2)$. The even logarithmic part is therefore the displayed square root. This makes the multiplicative factorization of its formal odd-zeta monomial coefficients explicit, while the even-zeta contribution has an elementary trigonometric generating function.

Verification and remaining questions. The accompanying script `code/verify_reflected_moments.py` checks the three coefficient formulas by exact symbolic arithmetic, checks finite reflection sums and the formal Appell formulas, and compares independent quadrature with the fixed-order expansion. It also compares the late coefficients with (8.28) and (8.29). The numerical calculations are diagnostics; the preceding analytic and formal arguments are the proofs. The fixed-reflected-exponent signed remainder is now supplied by Corollary 8.20. Uniformity when m increases with n remains a substantive next question. In the former regime the endpoint approximation $B(x)^m \approx \gamma^m x^m$ need not be uniform, so the fixed- m theorem does not settle the simultaneous large-exponent problem.

8.8 The Stieltjes layer

Differentiating $L(s, \chi) = q^{-s} \sum_k \chi(k) \zeta(s, k/q)$ at $s = 1$ gives the exact ladder

$$L'(\chi, 1) = -\ln q L(1, \chi) - \frac{1}{q} \sum_k \chi(k) \gamma_1\left(\frac{k}{q}\right),$$

so every Malmsten log-log integral is a statement about *first generalized Stieltjes constants* $\gamma_1(k/q)$ — Blagouchine's program, equivalent to Deninger's $\zeta''(0, a)$ layer via the functional equation.

Result 8.23 (even-character Malmsten integral). [historical experiment: verified to 10^{-51} ; even character mod 5; φ the golden ratio]

$$\int_0^1 \ln \ln \frac{1}{x} \cdot \frac{(1-x)(1-x^2)}{1-x^5} dx = -(\gamma + \ln 5) \frac{2 \ln \varphi}{\sqrt{5}} - \frac{\gamma_1(\frac{1}{5}) - \gamma_1(\frac{2}{5}) - \gamma_1(\frac{3}{5}) + \gamma_1(\frac{4}{5})}{5}.$$

Result 8.24 (the parity dichotomy). The dichotomy is empirically sharp. The *odd* γ_1 -combination reduces exactly as differentiated-Kummer predicts [historical experiment: verified blind]:

$$\gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) - \gamma_1\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) = -\frac{\pi}{\sqrt{3}}\left(\gamma + 4\ln 2 - \frac{1}{2}\ln 3 + 4\ln \pi - 6\ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)\right),$$

which is *Malmsten's 1846 reflection identity* [4] (long misattributed to Almkvist–Meurman). The even combination did not reduce in the tested standard basket [historical experiment: PSLQ junk at coefficient height 10^8 — honest negative]; pushing Blagouchine's rational-arguments theorem [6] through it collapses everything except a ζ'' -block [historical experiment: derived and verified to 10^{-50}]:

$$\gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) - \gamma_1\left(\frac{2}{5}\right) - \gamma_1\left(\frac{3}{5}\right) + \gamma_1\left(\frac{4}{5}\right) = \sqrt{5}\left[\zeta''\left(0, \frac{1}{5}\right) - \zeta''\left(0, \frac{2}{5}\right) - \zeta''\left(0, \frac{3}{5}\right) + \zeta''\left(0, \frac{4}{5}\right)\right] - 2\sqrt{5}\ln \varphi(\gamma + \ln 10\pi).$$

The canonical atom for the even layer is thus the even-character $\zeta''(0, l/q)$ combination (Deninger's layer [9]); Malmsten integrals, even γ_1 -combinations, and even $L'(\chi, 1)$ are all elementary-equivalent to it. Two practical records: Blagouchine's particular value $\gamma_1(1/4)$ was re-verified exactly against `mpmath`'s generalized Stieltjes constants, and the reduction coefficients live in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{q})$ — rational-coefficient PSLQ baskets *miss* the relation, so a $\sqrt{q}$ -weighted basket or direct derivation is required.

8.9 The common Hurwitz-jet calculus

The generalized Stieltjes constants $\gamma_n(x)$ are defined by the Laurent expansion of the Hurwitz zeta function at its pole,

$$\zeta(s, x) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n(x) (s-1)^n, \quad (8.40)$$

so that $\gamma_0(x) = -\psi(x)$ and $\gamma_n(1) = \gamma_n$ are the classical Stieltjes constants, $\gamma_0 = \gamma$. Although universally called *constants*, the $\gamma_n(x)$ are real-analytic functions of the argument on $(0, \infty)$, and it is this function-theoretic point of view we adopt. Following Blagouchine [22, 6] we write

$$\Gamma_n(p) := \int_1^p \gamma_n(x) dx, \quad \text{so that } \Gamma_n(1) = 0,$$

for the antiderivative normalized at 1. (The notation is Blagouchine's; the clash with the Euler Γ -function is resolved by the subscript, and indeed $\Gamma_0(p) = -\ln \Gamma(p)$, as Theorem 8.25 makes plain.) Throughout, $\zeta^{(k)}(s_0, a) := \partial_s^k \zeta(s, a)|_{s=s_0}$ and $\zeta^{(k)}(s_0) := \zeta^{(k)}(s_0, 1)$ denote derivative jets with respect to the *order*; $\Lambda_q := \gamma + \ln(2\pi q)$; $H_n = \sum_{i \leq n} 1/i$ and $H_n^{(2)} = \sum_{i \leq n} 1/i^2$ are harmonic numbers; A is the Glaisher–Kinkelin constant, $\ln A = \frac{1}{12} - \zeta'(-1)$; and

$$S_j\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) := \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} \sin \frac{2\pi kp}{q} \zeta^{(j)}\left(0, \frac{k}{q}\right), \quad S_0\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) = \frac{1}{2} \cot \frac{\pi p}{q}, \quad S_1\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) = \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} \sin \frac{2\pi kp}{q} \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{k}{q}\right)$$

(the closed forms for S_0, S_1 use $\zeta(0, a) = \frac{1}{2} - a$, $\zeta'(0, a) = \ln \Gamma(a) - \frac{1}{2} \ln(2\pi)$, and $\sum_k \sin(2\pi kp/q) = 0$).

The starting observation is elementary but organizing: differentiating (8.40) in x against $\partial_x \zeta(s, x) = -s \zeta(s+1, x)$ identifies every derivative and antiderivative of every γ_n with a derivative jet of the Hurwitz zeta function at an *integer* value of s . Antiderivatives live at $s = 0$; the functions themselves at $s = 1$; their x -derivatives at $s = 2$ [25] — a single ladder.

The preceding gamma-integral examples are the first rung of this calculus. We now prove the integration identity, build its spectral jets, and use reflection and distribution to compute rational arguments. All source residuals in this chapter are historical; locally rerun checks are recorded separately in the verification directory.

8.10 Underived Stieltjes grids and character coordinates

Expanding the Hurwitz distribution identity at $s = 1$ gives

$$\begin{aligned}\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \gamma_1((x+j)/d) &= d\gamma_1(x) + d \log d \psi(x) - \frac{d}{2} \log^2 d, \\ \sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \gamma_2((x+j)/d) &= d \left[\gamma_2(x) - 2 \log d \gamma_1(x) - \log^2 d \psi(x) + \frac{1}{3} \log^3 d \right].\end{aligned}$$

For a nonprincipal character,

$$L'(1, \chi) = -\log q L(1, \chi) - \frac{1}{q} \sum_{p=1}^q \chi(p) \gamma_1(p/q).$$

For a real quadratic character χ_D , $\zeta_{\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{D})}(s) = \zeta(s)L(s, \chi_D)$ shows $L'(1, \chi_D)/L(1, \chi_D) = \gamma_{\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{D})} - \gamma$, where the first term is the field's Euler–Kronecker constant. The source's exact finite matrices for $3 \leq q \leq 30$ left $\varphi(q)/2 - 1$ coordinates after distribution and first-constant reflection. Their negative searches constrain the selected baskets, without proving independence of Euler–Kronecker constants. The reflection formulas below retain the conductor factor $\gamma + \log(2\pi q)$: the earlier printed $q = 5$ specialization without $\log 5$ was corrected in the source reports.

8.11 The ladder

Theorem 8.25 (antiderivative ladder). *For $n \geq 0$ and $p > 0$,*

$$\frac{d}{dp} \zeta^{(n+1)}(0, p) = (-1)^{n+1} (n+1) \gamma_n(p), \quad (8.41)$$

and consequently

$$\Gamma_n(p) = \frac{(-1)^{n+1}}{n+1} \left[\zeta^{(n+1)}(0, p) - \zeta^{(n+1)}(0) \right]. \quad (8.42)$$

Proof. Differentiating $\partial_x \zeta(s, x) = -s \zeta(s+1, x)$ is legitimate termwise for $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$ and extends by analytic continuation. Expand both sides around $s = 0$: on the right, $-s \zeta(s+1, x) = -s \left[\frac{1}{s} + \sum_k \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} \gamma_k(x) s^k \right] = -1 - \sum_k \frac{(-1)^k}{k!} \gamma_k(x) s^{k+1}$, whose s^{n+1} -coefficient is $(-1)^{n+1} \gamma_n(x)/n!$. On the left the s^{n+1} -coefficient is $\partial_x \zeta^{(n+1)}(0, x)/(n+1)!$. Equating gives (8.41); integrating from 1 to p gives (8.42). $\square$

The differential form (8.41) is Lemma 2 of Chakraborty–Kanemitsu–Kuzumaki [23] (for $n = 1$ it is Deninger's R' -law [9]); the integrated form (8.42) is eq. (2.16) of Connon [26]. For $n = 0$, $\zeta'(0, p) = \ln \Gamma(p) - \frac{1}{2} \ln(2\pi)$ recovers $\Gamma_0(p) = -\ln \Gamma(p)$.

Theorem 8.26 (interpolation of power sums of logarithms). *For $k \geq 1$ and integer $N \geq 0$,*

$$\Gamma_{k-1}(N+1) = -\frac{1}{k} \sum_{j=1}^N \ln^k j.$$

Proof. From $\zeta(s, N+1) = \zeta(s) - \sum_{j=1}^N j^{-s}$, $\zeta^{(k)}(0, N+1) = \zeta^{(k)}(0) - \sum_j (-\ln j)^k = \zeta^{(k)}(0) - (-1)^k \sum_j \ln^k j$. Insert into (8.42) with $n = k-1$. $\square$

Thus Γ_{k-1} is an analytic interpolant of the power sums $\sum \ln^k j$ (up to the factor $-1/k$), exactly as $\ln \Gamma$ interpolates $\ln N!$: the heuristic “differentiate $1^r + \cdots + N^r = \zeta(-r) - \zeta(-r, N+1)$ k times at $r = 0$ ” becomes precise through Theorem 8.25.

Corollary 8.27 (unit translates). *For $k \geq 0$ and integer $n \geq 1$,*

$$\int_n^{n+1} \gamma_k(x) dx = -\frac{\ln^{k+1} n}{k+1}; \quad \text{in particular} \quad \int_1^2 \gamma_k(x) dx = 0.$$

(The case $n = 1$ is eqs. (2.18)–(2.19) of [26].)

8.12 Zeta jets and the conversion dictionary

Making (8.42) explicit requires the constants $\zeta^{(k)}(0)$ and, for the moment evaluations of Section 8.14, the jets at negative integers. All of them follow mechanically from the functional equation $\zeta(s) = 2^s \pi^{s-1} \sin(\pi s/2) \Gamma(1-s) \zeta(1-s)$ by expanding $\Gamma(1-s) = \exp(\gamma s + \sum_{k \geq 2} \zeta(k) s^k/k)$ and the Laurent series of $\zeta(1-s)$ at the pole.

Proposition 8.28 (jets at 0). *With $L := \ln(2\pi)$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \zeta'(0) &= -\frac{L}{2}, \\ \zeta''(0) &= \frac{\gamma^2}{2} + \gamma_1 - \frac{\pi^2}{24} - \frac{L^2}{2}, \\ \zeta'''(0) &= \gamma^3 + 3\gamma\gamma_1 + \frac{3}{2}\gamma_2 - \zeta(3) + \frac{3}{2}\gamma^2 L + 3\gamma_1 L - \frac{\pi^2}{8} L - \frac{L^3}{2}, \\ \zeta^{(4)}(0) &= \frac{3}{2}\gamma^4 + 4\gamma^3 L + 6\gamma^2\gamma_1 + 3\gamma^2 L^2 + \frac{\pi^2}{4}\gamma^2 + 12\gamma\gamma_1 L + 6\gamma\gamma_2 + 6\gamma_1 L^2 + \frac{\pi^2}{2}\gamma_1 \\ &\quad + 6\gamma_2 L + 2\gamma_3 - \frac{L^4}{2} - \frac{\pi^2}{4} L^2 - 4\zeta(3)L - \frac{19\pi^4}{480}. \end{aligned}$$

Proposition 8.29 (fifth jet at 0). *With $L := \ln(2\pi)$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \zeta^{(5)}(0) &= 2\gamma^5 + \frac{15}{2}\gamma^4 L + \gamma^3 \left(10L^2 + \frac{5\pi^2}{6}\right) + \gamma^2 \left(5L^3 + \frac{5\pi^2}{4} L + 10\zeta(3)\right) \\ &\quad + \gamma\gamma_1 \left(30L^2 + \frac{5\pi^2}{2}\right) + \gamma_1 \left(10\gamma^3 + 30\gamma^2 L + 10L^3 + \frac{5\pi^2}{2} L + 20\zeta(3)\right) \\ &\quad + \gamma_2 \left(15\gamma^2 + 30\gamma L + 15L^2 + \frac{5\pi^2}{4}\right) + \gamma_3 (10\gamma + 10L) + \frac{5}{2}\gamma_4 \\ &\quad - \zeta(3) \left(10L^2 + \frac{5\pi^2}{6}\right) - 12\zeta(5) - \frac{L^5}{2} - \frac{5\pi^2}{12} L^3 - \frac{19\pi^4}{96} L. \end{aligned}$$

The values $\zeta''(0)$ and $\zeta'''(0)$ are classical (Ramanujan [21]; Apostol [19]; Choudhury [24]). Apostol’s Theorem 3 [19] in fact gives a closed form of $\zeta^{(n)}(0)$ at every order, in terms of the Laurent coefficients of $\Gamma(s)\zeta(s)$ at $s = 1$, and prints the example $n = 4$ in that vocabulary; we have not located the fully expanded forms above — nor any explicit form of $\zeta^{(5)}(0)$ — in print. The pattern continues to every order by the same expansion, which packages into the following closed recurrence.

Remark 8.30 (explicit recurrence for the jets at 0). In $\zeta(s) = \chi(s)\zeta(1-s)$ with $\chi(s) = 2^s \pi^{s-1} \sin(\pi s/2) \Gamma(1-s)$, the simple zero of χ at $s = 0$ cancels the pole of $\zeta(1-s)$; factor it out as $\chi(s) = \frac{s}{2} e^{g(s)}$ with $g(s) := \ln(2\chi(s)/s) = \ln[(2\pi)^s \frac{\sin(\pi s/2)}{\pi s/2} \Gamma(1-s)]$, analytic on $|s| < 1$ and real on $(-1, 1)$ (the bracket is positive there), $g(0) = 0$. From $\ln \Gamma(1-s) = \gamma s + \sum_{k \geq 2} \zeta(k) s^k/k$ and $\ln[\sin(\pi s/2)/(\pi s/2)] = -\sum_{m \geq 1} \zeta(2m)(s/2)^{2m}/m$,

$$g(s) = (\gamma + L)s + \sum_{k \geq 2} c_k s^k, \quad c_k = \frac{\zeta(k)}{k} \cdot \begin{cases} 1, & k \text{ odd,} \\ 1 - 2^{1-k}, & k \text{ even,} \end{cases}$$

so $c_2 = \frac{\pi^2}{24}$, $c_3 = \frac{\zeta(3)}{3}$, $c_4 = \frac{7\pi^4}{2880}$, $c_5 = \frac{\zeta(5)}{5}$. Since $s\zeta(1-s) = -1 + \sum_{m \geq 1} \gamma_{m-1} s^m / (m-1)!$ is entire, the Leibniz rule gives

$$\zeta^{(n)}(0) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} B_k(1!c_1, 2!c_2, \dots, k!c_k) h_{n-k}, \quad h_0 = -1, \quad h_m = m \gamma_{m-1} \quad (m \geq 1),$$

where $c_1 = \gamma + L$ and B_k is the complete Bell polynomial, $B_k(g'(0), \dots, g^{(k)}(0)) = (e^g)^{(k)}(0)$: $B_0 = 1$, $B_1 = c_1$, $B_2 = c_1^2 + 2c_2$, $B_3 = c_1^3 + 6c_1c_2 + 6c_3$. The cases $n = 0, 1$ recover $\zeta(0) = -\frac{1}{2}$ and $\zeta'(0) = -\frac{L}{2}$; $n = 2, \dots, 5$ reproduce the two propositions verbatim.

Proposition 8.31 (jets at -1 and -2). *Expanding the functional equation around $s = -1$ (where $\zeta(2 - \varepsilon)$ is regular) and $s = -2$ (a trivial zero) gives, with $L = \ln(2\pi)$:*

$$\zeta(-1) = -\frac{1}{12}, \quad \zeta'(-1) = \frac{\zeta'(2)}{2\pi^2} + \frac{1 - \gamma - L}{12}, \quad (8.43)$$

$$\zeta''(-1) = -\frac{\zeta''(2)}{2\pi^2} + \frac{\zeta'(2)}{\pi^2}(\gamma + L - 1) - \frac{(\gamma + L)^2}{12} + \frac{\gamma + L}{6} + \frac{\pi^2}{144}, \quad (8.44)$$

$$\zeta(-2) = 0, \quad \zeta'(-2) = -\frac{\zeta(3)}{4\pi^2}, \quad \zeta''(-2) = \frac{\zeta(3)}{4\pi^2}(3 - 2\gamma - 2L) + \frac{\zeta'(3)}{2\pi^2}. \quad (8.45)$$

Remark 8.32 (Glaisher spelling). Since $\ln A = \frac{1}{12} - \zeta'(-1)$, eq. (8.43) is equivalent to

$$\zeta'(2) = \zeta(2)(\gamma + \ln 2 + \ln \pi - 12 \ln A),$$

the form returned by Mathematica's `FunctionExpand[Zeta'[2]]`. Either spelling may be used in all the moment formulas below; we keep $\zeta'(2), \zeta''(2), \zeta'(3)$ as the canonical second-layer constants.

8.13 Reflection formulas

Hurwitz's formula (see, e.g., [20, Ch. 12]), for $0 < p/q < 1$,

$$\zeta\left(1 - s, \frac{p}{q}\right) = \frac{2\Gamma(s)}{(2\pi q)^s} \sum_{k=1}^q \left[\cos\left(\frac{\pi s}{2} - \frac{2\pi kp}{q}\right) \right] \zeta\left(s, \frac{k}{q}\right),$$

expanded around $s = 0$, expresses every $\gamma_n(p/q)$ through the jets $\zeta^{(j)}(0, k/q)$, $j \leq n + 1$. Taking the part odd under $p \mapsto q - p$ isolates the sine sums S_j and yields reflection formulas. Write $E(s) := \exp(-\Lambda_q s + \sum_{k \geq 2} (-1)^k \zeta(k) s^k / k) = \sum_i e_i s^i$ for the prefactor expansion $(2\Gamma(s)(2\pi q)^{-s} = \frac{2}{s} E(s))$.

Theorem 8.33 (reflection, general mechanism). *For $n \geq 1$ and $0 < p < q$,*

$$\gamma_n\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) - \gamma_n\left(1 - \frac{p}{q}\right) = 4n! \sum_{i+2l+1+j=n+1} e_i \frac{(-1)^l (\pi/2)^{2l+1}}{(2l+1)!} \frac{S_j(p/q)}{j!}.$$

Explicitly, with $\Lambda = \Lambda_q = \gamma + \ln 2\pi q$ (the letter distinguishes it from the Glaisher constant A):

$$\gamma_2\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) - \gamma_2\left(1 - \frac{p}{q}\right) = 2\pi S_2 - 4\pi \Lambda S_1 + \left(2\Lambda^2 + \frac{\pi^2}{6}\right) \pi S_0, \quad (8.46)$$

$$\gamma_3\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) - \gamma_3\left(1 - \frac{p}{q}\right) = 2\pi S_3 - 6\pi \Lambda S_2 + \left(6\Lambda^2 + \frac{\pi^2}{2}\right) \pi S_1 - \left(2\Lambda^3 + \frac{\pi^2}{2} \Lambda + 4\zeta(3)\right) \pi S_0, \quad (8.47)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma_4\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) - \gamma_4\left(1 - \frac{p}{q}\right) &= 2\pi S_4 - 8\pi \Lambda S_3 + (12\Lambda^2 + \pi^2) \pi S_2 - (8\Lambda^3 + 2\pi^2 \Lambda + 16\zeta(3)) \pi S_1 \\ &\quad + \left(2\Lambda^4 + \pi^2 \Lambda^2 + 16\Lambda \zeta(3) + \frac{19\pi^4}{120}\right) \pi S_0. \end{aligned} \quad (8.48)$$

Proof. Split the cosine, $\cos(\pi s/2 - \theta) = \cos(\pi s/2)\cos\theta + \sin(\pi s/2)\sin\theta$. Under $p \mapsto q - p$ the cosine sums are even and the sine sums odd, so the odd part of $\zeta(1 - s, p/q)$ equals $\frac{2}{s} E(s) \sin(\pi s/2) \sum_j S_j s^j/j!$. By (8.40), $\zeta(1 - s, p/q) = -\frac{1}{s} + \sum_n \gamma_n(p/q) s^n/n!$, whose odd part has s^n -coefficient $\frac{1}{2n!} [\gamma_n(p/q) - \gamma_n(1 - p/q)]$. Matching coefficients of s^n (i.e. s^{n+1} of $E \cdot \sin \cdot \sum S_j s^j/j!$) gives the general formula; instantiating $e_0 = 1$, $e_1 = -\Lambda$, $e_2 = \frac{\Lambda^2}{2} + \frac{\pi^2}{12}$, $e_3 = -\frac{\Lambda^3}{6} - \frac{\pi^2}{12}\Lambda - \frac{\zeta(3)}{3}$, $e_4 = \frac{\Lambda^4}{24} + \frac{\pi^2}{24}\Lambda^2 + \frac{\zeta(3)}{3}\Lambda + \frac{\pi^4}{288} + \frac{\pi^4}{360}$ yields (8.46)–(8.48). $\square$

Formula (8.46) is eq. (89) of Blagouchine [6], where a footnote records that it also appears in unpublished work of D. Connon; (8.47) and (8.48) appear to be new. The same expansion, one order down, recovers Malmsten's reflection formula for γ_1 [6]; an elementary alternative proof of that $n = 1$ case, via Kummer's Fourier expansion of $\ln \Gamma$ rather than Hurwitz's functional equation, is given by Kouba [30]. For $q = 3$ and $q = 4$ the sums collapse ($S_j(\frac{1}{3}) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} [\zeta^{(j)}(0, \frac{1}{3}) - \zeta^{(j)}(0, \frac{2}{3})]$, $S_j(\frac{1}{4}) = \zeta^{(j)}(0, \frac{1}{4}) - \zeta^{(j)}(0, \frac{3}{4})$), so (8.46)–(8.48) can be *inverted* to express the odd jet differences through the Stieltjes differences $\gamma_n(p) - \gamma_n(1 - p)$ — the key to Section 8.15.

8.14 Moments

Theorem 8.34 (Hurwitz transform and variants). *For $m \geq 1$ and $\operatorname{Re} s < 1$,*

$$\int_0^1 x^m \zeta(s, x) dx = - \sum_{j=1}^m \frac{m!}{(m-j+1)!} \frac{\zeta(s-j)}{(s-1)(s-2)\cdots(s-j)}, \quad (8.49)$$

and $\int_0^1 \zeta(s, x) dx = 0$. The same recursion with boundary terms $\zeta(\sigma, \frac{1}{2}) = (2^\sigma - 1)\zeta(\sigma)$ and $\zeta(\sigma, 2) = \zeta(\sigma) - 1$ gives the analogous closed forms for $\int_{1/2}^1$ and $\int_1^2$.

Proof. Since $\zeta(s, x) = -\partial_x \zeta(s-1, x)/(s-1)$, integration by parts gives $I_m(s) = -\zeta(s-1)/(s-1) + \frac{m}{s-1} I_{m-1}(s-1)$ with $I_0 \equiv 0$ (the boundary term at $x = 0$ vanishes for $\operatorname{Re} s < m+1$ since $\zeta(\sigma, x) = x^{-\sigma} + O(1)$); unrolling yields (8.49), which then extends meromorphically in s . $\square$

For the unit interval, (8.49) is Theorem 3.7 of Espinosa–Moll [28]. Expanding (8.49) at $s = 1 + t$ against $\int_0^1 x^m \zeta(1+t, x) dx = \frac{1}{(m+1)t} + M_0 - M_1 t + \frac{M_2}{2} t^2 - \cdots$, where $M_k = \int_0^1 x^m \gamma_k(x) dx$, reads off every Stieltjes moment. The expansion $1/[(t-1)\cdots(t-j+1)] = \frac{(-1)^{j-1}}{(j-1)!} (1 + H_{j-1}t + \frac{H_{j-1}^2 + H_{j-1}^{(2)}}{2} t^2 + \cdots)$ gives the coefficients in closed form:

Theorem 8.35 (general first moment). *For every integer $m \geq 1$,*

$$\int_0^1 x^m \gamma_1(x) dx = \sum_{j=1}^m (-1)^{j-1} \binom{m}{j-1} \left[\frac{\zeta''(1-j)}{2} + H_{j-1} \zeta'(1-j) + \frac{H_{j-1}^2 + H_{j-1}^{(2)}}{2} \zeta(1-j) \right].$$

The γ_n -moment carries the analogous formula with the order- $(n+1)$ jet leading and complete homogeneous symmetric functions of $1, \frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{j-1}$ as coefficients.

Combining Theorems 8.34 and 8.35 with the dictionary of Proposition 8.31 produces the following table. Items (8.50)–(8.53) are restated from the corpus that motivated this work; the remaining

evaluations appear to be new.

$$\int_{1/2}^1 \gamma_1(x) dx = \frac{\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{\gamma^2}{4} - \frac{\pi^2}{48} + \frac{\ln^2 2}{2} - \frac{\ln^2 \pi}{4}, \quad (8.50)$$

$$\int_1^2 x \gamma_1(x) dx = 1 + \frac{\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{\gamma^2}{4} - \frac{\pi^2}{48} - \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{4}, \quad (8.51)$$

$$\int_0^1 x^2 \gamma_1(x) dx = \frac{\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{\gamma^2}{3} - \frac{\pi^2}{36} - \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{6} + \frac{\gamma}{6} \ln 2\pi - \frac{\zeta'(2)}{\pi^2} (\gamma + \ln 2\pi) + \frac{\zeta''(2)}{2\pi^2}, \quad (8.52)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{1/2}^1 x \gamma_1(x) dx &= \frac{\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{5\gamma^2}{16} - \frac{5\pi^2}{192} + \frac{\ln^2 2}{8} - \frac{\ln 2 \ln \pi}{6} - \frac{3 \ln^2 \pi}{16} + \gamma \left(\frac{\ln 2}{12} + \frac{\ln \pi}{8} \right) \\ &\quad - \frac{\zeta'(2)}{4\pi^2} (3\gamma + 2 \ln 2 + 3 \ln \pi) + \frac{3 \zeta''(2)}{8\pi^2}, \end{aligned} \quad (8.53)$$

$$\int_0^1 x \gamma_1(x) dx = \frac{\zeta''(0)}{2} = \frac{\gamma^2}{4} + \frac{\gamma_1}{2} - \frac{\pi^2}{48} - \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{4}, \quad (8.54)$$

$$\begin{aligned} \int_0^1 x^3 \gamma_1(x) dx &= \frac{3\gamma^2}{8} + \frac{\gamma_1}{2} - \frac{\pi^2}{32} + \frac{\gamma \ln 2\pi}{4} - \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{8} - \frac{3(\zeta(3) + 2\zeta'(2))}{4\pi^2} (\gamma + \ln 2\pi) \\ &\quad + \frac{3(\zeta'(3) + \zeta''(2))}{4\pi^2}, \end{aligned} \quad (8.55)$$

$$\int_1^2 x^2 \gamma_1(x) dx = \frac{9}{4} + \frac{3\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{5\gamma^2}{6} - \frac{5\pi^2}{72} + \frac{\gamma \ln 2\pi}{6} - \frac{2 \ln^2 2\pi}{3} - \frac{\zeta'(2)}{\pi^2} (\gamma + \ln 2\pi) + \frac{\zeta''(2)}{2\pi^2}, \quad (8.56)$$

$$\int_0^1 x \gamma_2(x) dx = -\frac{\zeta'''(0)}{3} = \frac{\zeta(3)}{3} - \frac{\gamma^3}{3} - \gamma\gamma_1 - \frac{\gamma_2}{2} - \frac{\gamma^2}{2} \ln 2\pi - \gamma_1 \ln 2\pi + \frac{\pi^2}{24} \ln 2\pi + \frac{\ln^3 2\pi}{6}, \quad (8.57)$$

$$\int_1^2 x \gamma_2(x) dx = \int_0^1 x \gamma_2(x) dx - 2, \quad \int_{1/2}^1 \gamma_2(x) dx = -\Gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{2}\right). \quad (8.58)$$

At $m = 3$ the constants $\zeta(3)$ and $\zeta'(3)$ enter through (8.45), and each further unit of m opens one more column of jets at the next negative integer; the second moment of γ_1 over $[1/2, 1]$ and the higher γ_2 -moments are equally mechanical but bulkier, and we omit them.

8.15 Explicit values of Γ_n

8.15.1 The first antiderivative

Theorem 8.36 (Γ_1 in closed form). *For all $p > 0$,*

$$\Gamma_1(p) = c + \frac{1}{2} \zeta''(0, p), \quad c := -\frac{1}{2} \zeta''(0) = \frac{\pi^2}{48} + \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{4} - \frac{\gamma^2}{4} - \frac{\gamma_1}{2}.$$

Moreover $\int_0^1 \Gamma_1(x) dx = c$, equivalently (8.54) (since $\int_0^1 \zeta''(0, x) dx = 0$ [9, 25]).

Theorem 8.37 (half-integral and even-sum values).

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) &= \frac{\pi^2}{48} - \frac{\gamma^2}{4} - \frac{\gamma_1}{2} - \frac{\ln^2 2}{4} - \frac{\ln 2 \ln 2\pi}{2} + \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{4}, \\ \Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + \Gamma_1\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) &= 2c - \frac{\ln^2 3}{4} - \frac{\ln 3 \ln 2\pi}{2}, \quad \Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) + \Gamma_1\left(\frac{3}{4}\right) = 2c - \frac{3 \ln^2 2}{4} - \frac{\ln 2 \ln 2\pi}{2}, \\ \Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{6}\right) + \Gamma_1\left(\frac{5}{6}\right) &= 2c - \frac{\ln 2 \ln 3}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

Proof. $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{2}) = (2^s - 1)\zeta(s)$ gives $\zeta''(0, \frac{1}{2}) = -\frac{1}{2} \ln^2 2 - \ln 2 \ln(2\pi)$; the multiplication identities $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{3}) + \zeta(s, \frac{2}{3}) = (3^s - 1)\zeta(s)$, $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{4}) + \zeta(s, \frac{3}{4}) = (4^s - 2^s)\zeta(s)$, $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{6}) + \zeta(s, \frac{5}{6}) = (6^s - 3^s - 2^s + 1)\zeta(s)$, twice differentiated at $s = 0$, give the even sums (for $q = 6$ the $\zeta(0)$ -coefficient $\ln^2 6 - \ln^2 3 - \ln^2 2 = 2 \ln 2 \ln 3$ and the $\zeta'(0)$ -coefficient $\ln 6 - \ln 3 - \ln 2 = 0$ produce the strikingly short third identity). Apply Theorem 8.36. $\square$

Theorem 8.38 (third and quarter values).

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) &= \frac{\pi^2}{72} - \frac{\ln^2 2\pi}{3} + \frac{\ln^2 3}{24} - \frac{2}{3} \ln 3 \ln 2\pi - \frac{\gamma}{12} (4\gamma + 8 \ln 2\pi - \ln 3) + (\gamma + \ln 6\pi) \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) \\ &\quad - \frac{\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{12\pi} \left(\gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) - \gamma_2\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) \right), \\ \Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) &= \frac{\pi^2}{96} - \frac{3}{8} \ln^2 \pi - \frac{9}{4} \ln 2 \ln 2\pi - \frac{\gamma}{8} (3\gamma + 8 \ln 2 + 6 \ln \pi) + (\gamma + \ln 8\pi) \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) \\ &\quad - \frac{\gamma_1}{2} + \frac{1}{8\pi} \left(\gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) - \gamma_2\left(\frac{3}{4}\right) \right),\end{aligned}$$

and $\Gamma_1(\frac{2}{3})$, $\Gamma_1(\frac{3}{4})$ follow from Theorem 8.37. Furthermore, with the abbreviation $D_j := \zeta^{(j)}(0, \frac{1}{3}) - \zeta^{(j)}(0, \frac{2}{3})$,

$$\Gamma_1\left(\frac{1}{6}\right) - \Gamma_1\left(\frac{5}{6}\right) = \frac{\ln 2 \ln 18}{6} + \ln 2 \left(2 \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + \frac{\ln 3}{6} - \ln 2 - \ln \pi \right) + D_2,$$

which together with the even sum of Theorem 8.37 gives $\Gamma_1(\frac{1}{6})$ and $\Gamma_1(\frac{5}{6})$ explicitly — in the same obstruction atom $\gamma_2(\frac{1}{3}) - \gamma_2(\frac{2}{3})$, since inverting (8.46) at $q = 3$ expresses $D_2 = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} S_2(\frac{1}{3})$ through it.

Proof. By Theorem 8.36 everything reduces to the single jets $\zeta''(0, p)$ at $p = \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{6}$. Their even parts are in Theorem 8.37; their odd parts are the inversions of (8.46) at $q = 3, 4$:

$$S_2 = \frac{1}{2\pi} \left[\gamma_2\left(\frac{p}{q}\right) - \gamma_2\left(1 - \frac{p}{q}\right) + 4\pi\Lambda S_1 - \left(2\Lambda^2 + \frac{\pi^2}{6}\right) \pi S_0 \right],$$

with $S_1(\frac{1}{3}) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} (2 \ln \Gamma(\frac{1}{3}) - \ln \frac{2\pi}{\sqrt{3}})$, $S_0(\frac{1}{3}) = \frac{1}{2\sqrt{3}}$, $S_1(\frac{1}{4}) = 2 \ln \Gamma(\frac{1}{4}) - \ln(\pi\sqrt{2})$, $S_0(\frac{1}{4}) = \frac{1}{2}$. For $q = 6$, the Dirichlet character χ_{-3} gives $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{6}) - \zeta(s, \frac{5}{6}) = (6^s + 3^s) L(s, \chi_{-3})$ while $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{3}) - \zeta(s, \frac{2}{3}) = 3^s L(s, \chi_{-3})$; eliminating the jets of $L(s, \chi_{-3})$ at $s = 0$ ($L(0, \chi_{-3}) = \frac{1}{3}$, $L'(0, \chi_{-3}) = 2 \ln \Gamma(\frac{1}{3}) + \frac{\ln 3}{6} - \ln 2 - \ln \pi$) yields the displayed transport identity. $\square$

8.15.2 The second and third antiderivatives

Theorem 8.39 (Γ_2 values).

$$\Gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{\gamma_2}{2} + \frac{\gamma^3}{3} - \frac{\zeta(3)}{3} + \ln^3 2 - \frac{\ln^3 \pi}{6} + \frac{\ln \pi}{24} (12\gamma^2 - \pi^2 + 24 \ln^2 2) + (\gamma + \ln \pi) \gamma_1,$$

and at the third and quarter points, with $Z_3(\frac{1}{q}) := \zeta'''(0, \frac{1}{q}) + \zeta'''(0, 1 - \frac{1}{q})$ and $D_3(\frac{1}{q}) := \zeta'''(0, \frac{1}{q}) - \zeta'''(0, 1 - \frac{1}{q})$,

$$\Gamma_2(\frac{1}{q}) = -\frac{1}{3} \left[\frac{Z_3 + D_3}{2} - \zeta'''(0) \right], \quad q \in \{3, 4\},$$

where the even parts are elementary,

$$Z_3(\frac{1}{3}) = -\frac{\ln^3 3}{2} - \frac{3 \ln^2 3 \ln 2\pi}{2} + 3 \ln 3 \zeta''(0), \quad Z_3(\frac{1}{4}) = \partial_s^3 [(4^s - 2^s) \zeta(s)]_{s=0},$$

and the odd parts are the inversions of (8.47): $D_3 = \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}} S_3$ at $q = 3$, $D_3 = S_3$ at $q = 4$, with

$$S_3 = \frac{1}{2\pi} \left[\gamma_3(\frac{1}{q}) - \gamma_3(1 - \frac{1}{q}) + 6\pi\Lambda S_2 - \left(6\Lambda^2 + \frac{\pi^2}{2}\right)\pi S_1 + \left(2\Lambda^3 + \frac{\pi^2}{2}\Lambda + 4\zeta(3)\right)\pi S_0 \right]$$

and S_2 as in the proof of Theorem 8.38. Thus $\Gamma_2(\frac{1}{3})$ and $\Gamma_2(\frac{1}{4})$ are explicit in the constants $\{\gamma, \gamma_1, \gamma_2, \zeta(3), \ln 2, \ln 3, \ln \pi, \ln \Gamma(\frac{1}{q}), \gamma_2(\frac{1}{q}) - \gamma_2(1 - \frac{1}{q}), \gamma_3(\frac{1}{q}) - \gamma_3(1 - \frac{1}{q})\}$, the two Stieltjes differences being the only non-classical ingredients.

Proof. $\Gamma_2(p) = -\frac{1}{3}[\zeta'''(0, p) - \zeta'''(0)]$ by Theorem 8.25. At $p = \frac{1}{2}$ use $\zeta'''(0, \frac{1}{2}) = \partial_s^3 [(2^s - 1)\zeta(s)]_{s=0} = \ln^3 2 \zeta(0) + 3 \ln^2 2 \zeta'(0) + 3 \ln 2 \zeta''(0)$ and Proposition 8.28; at $p = \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{4}$ split into even and odd parts as displayed. $\square$

Corollary 8.40 (Γ_2 even sums). *With $L = \ln 2\pi$,*

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma_2(\frac{1}{3}) + \Gamma_2(\frac{2}{3}) &= \frac{2}{3} \zeta'''(0) - \ln 3 \zeta''(0) + \frac{L}{2} \ln^2 3 + \frac{\ln^3 3}{6}, \\ \Gamma_2(\frac{1}{4}) + \Gamma_2(\frac{3}{4}) &= \frac{2}{3} \zeta'''(0) - \ln 2 \zeta''(0) + \frac{3L}{2} \ln^2 2 + \frac{7 \ln^3 2}{6}, \\ \Gamma_2(\frac{1}{6}) + \Gamma_2(\frac{5}{6}) &= \frac{2}{3} \zeta'''(0) + L \ln 2 \ln 3 + \frac{\ln 2 \ln 3 \ln 6}{2}, \end{aligned}$$

so that $\Gamma_2(\frac{2}{3}), \Gamma_2(\frac{3}{4})$ follow from Theorem 8.39; as in Theorem 8.37, the $\zeta''(0)$ -term vanishes at $q = 6$ because $\ln 6 - \ln 3 - \ln 2 = 0$. (Generally, with the inclusion-exclusion combination $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{q}) + \zeta(s, 1 - \frac{1}{q}) = (\sum_i c_i m_i^s) \zeta(s)$, the even sum equals $\frac{2}{3} \zeta'''(0) + \frac{1}{6} \sum_i c_i \ln^3 m_i + \frac{L}{2} \sum_i c_i \ln^2 m_i - \zeta''(0) \sum_i c_i \ln m_i$.)

Theorem 8.41 (Γ_3 values).

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma_3(\frac{1}{2}) &= -\frac{7 \ln^4 2}{4} + \frac{\ln^4 \pi}{8} - \frac{3\gamma^4}{8} - \frac{\gamma_3}{2} + \frac{19\pi^4}{1920} + \gamma_1 \left(3 \ln^2 2 - \frac{3\gamma^2}{2} - \frac{3 \ln^2 \pi}{2} - \frac{\pi^2}{8} \right) \\ &\quad - \frac{3\gamma_2}{2} (\gamma + \ln \pi) + \zeta(3) \ln \pi + \gamma^2 \left(\frac{3 \ln^2 2}{2} - \frac{3 \ln^2 \pi}{4} - \frac{\pi^2}{16} \right) - \gamma^3 \ln \pi - 3\gamma\gamma_1 \ln \pi \\ &\quad - 3 \ln \pi \ln^3 2 - \frac{3 \ln^2 2 \ln^2 \pi}{2} - \frac{\pi^2 \ln^2 2}{8} + \frac{\pi^2 \ln^2 \pi}{16}, \end{aligned}$$

and $\Gamma_3(\frac{1}{3}), \Gamma_3(\frac{1}{4})$ are given by $\Gamma_3(\frac{1}{q}) = \frac{1}{4}[\zeta^{(4)}(0, \frac{1}{q}) - \zeta^{(4)}(0)]$ with the even part $\partial_s^4 [(q\text{-orbit}) \zeta(s)]_{s=0}$ as in Theorem 8.39 and the odd part inverted from (8.48); the resulting expressions are explicit in the same vocabulary augmented by $\gamma_4(\frac{1}{q}) - \gamma_4(1 - \frac{1}{q})$.

8.15.3 The fourth antiderivative at $1/2$

Theorem 8.42 ($\Gamma_4(1/2)$).

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_4\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) &= \frac{\gamma_4}{2} + 3 \ln^5 2 - \frac{12 \zeta(5)}{5} - \frac{\ln^5 \pi}{10} + \frac{2\gamma^5}{5} + \frac{3\gamma^4 \ln \pi}{2} \\ &\quad + \gamma_1 \left(2\gamma^3 - 12 \ln^3 2 + 2 \ln^3 \pi + 4\zeta(3) + \frac{\pi^2 \ln \pi}{2} - 12 \ln \pi \ln^2 2 + 6\gamma^2 \ln \pi \right) \\ &\quad + \gamma\gamma_1 \left(\frac{\pi^2}{2} - 12 \ln^2 2 + 6 \ln^2 \pi \right) + \gamma_2 \left(3\gamma^2 - 6 \ln^2 2 + 3 \ln^2 \pi + \frac{\pi^2}{4} + 6\gamma \ln \pi \right) \\ &\quad + 2\gamma_3 (\gamma + \ln \pi) + \zeta(3) \left(4 \ln^2 2 - 2 \ln^2 \pi - \frac{\pi^2}{6} \right) \\ &\quad + \gamma^2 \left(\ln^3 \pi - 6 \ln^3 2 + 2\zeta(3) - 6 \ln \pi \ln^2 2 + \frac{\pi^2 \ln \pi}{4} \right) + \gamma^3 \left(2 \ln^2 \pi - 4 \ln^2 2 + \frac{\pi^2}{6} \right) \\ &\quad + \frac{\pi^2 \ln^3 2}{2} + 2 \ln^2 2 \ln^3 \pi + 6 \ln^3 2 \ln^2 \pi + 7 \ln \pi \ln^4 2 \\ &\quad - \frac{19\pi^4 \ln \pi}{480} - \frac{\pi^2 \ln^3 \pi}{12} + \frac{\pi^2 \ln \pi \ln^2 2}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

Proof. $\Gamma_4(\frac{1}{2}) = -\frac{1}{5}[\zeta^{(5)}(0, \frac{1}{2}) - \zeta^{(5)}(0)]$, with

$$\zeta^{(5)}\left(0, \frac{1}{2}\right) = \partial_s^5[(2^s - 1)\zeta(s)]_{s=0} = \sum_{k=0}^4 \binom{5}{k} \ln^{5-k} 2 \zeta^{(k)}(0)$$

(the $k = 5$ term carries the factor $2^0 - 1 = 0$) and Proposition 8.29. $\square$

The pattern of Theorems 8.39–8.42 is general: each rung Γ_n adds the next Stieltjes constant γ_n and the functional-equation zeta terms, and one degree to the logarithmic monomials at $p = \frac{1}{2}$; at $p = \frac{1}{3}, \frac{1}{4}$ it adds the single new obstruction atom $\gamma_{n+1}(p) - \gamma_{n+1}(1-p)$, delivered by the order- $(n+1)$ reflection formula of Theorem 8.33. At denominators such as 5, 8, 12 the even character decomposition introduces additional coordinates (the multiplication identities no longer close over the principal character), and the values $\Gamma_n(p/q)$ additionally involve the even-character combinations of $\zeta^{(n+1)}(0, \cdot)$ — the obstruction layer studied, at $n = 1$, in [6].

8.16 The negative-order polygamma floor

The ladder of Section 8.11 integrates the coefficient functions of the Laurent expansion at $s = 1$ in their argument. The same Hurwitz-jet calculus has a second, equally natural direction, and this section — a second main act rather than an appendix — follows it downward. Integrating in the *argument* at the s -jet floor produces the polygamma functions of negative integer order (“negapolygamma”, a term Adamchik [18] credits to Gosper): for real $z > 0$,

$$\psi^{(-1)}(z) = \ln \Gamma(z), \quad \psi^{(-n)}(z) = \int_0^z \psi^{(-(n-1))}(t) dt = \frac{1}{(n-2)!} \int_0^z (z-t)^{n-2} \ln \Gamma(t) dt,$$

which is precisely Mathematica’s `PolyGamma[-n, z]` (all identities below are stated on $0 < z < 1$, where the rational arguments live, and extend to $z > 0$ by the same formulas wherever both sides are defined). Everything built for the Stieltjes side transfers wholesale: the ladder identity has a one-line analogue, the reflection mechanism of Section 8.13 reappears at the jet floor with bare

Clausen values in place of the sine sums S_j , the obstruction constants again organize along Dirichlet characters — and the bridge identities for those constants close a circle the Stieltjes side leaves open. The tools: a one-line ladder, reflection and multiplication laws, bridge identities, and explicit rational-argument values.

8.16.1 The ladder

Theorem 8.43. *For $n \geq 2$ and $z > 0$,*

$$\psi^{(-n)}(z) = \frac{\zeta'(1-n, z) - \zeta'(1-n)}{(n-1)!} + Q_n(z),$$

where Q_n is an explicit polynomial with coefficients in $\mathbb{Q}[\ln 2\pi, \zeta'(-1), \dots, \zeta'(2-n)]$:

$$\begin{aligned} Q_2(z) &= \frac{z}{2} \ln 2\pi + \frac{z(1-z)}{2}, \\ Q_3(z) &= \frac{z^2}{4} \ln 2\pi - \frac{z^3}{4} + \frac{3z^2}{8} - \frac{z}{24} - z\zeta'(-1), \\ Q_4(z) &= \frac{z^3}{12} \ln 2\pi - \frac{11z^4}{144} + \frac{11z^3}{72} - \frac{5z^2}{144} - \frac{z^2}{2}\zeta'(-1) - \frac{z}{2}\zeta'(-2), \end{aligned}$$

and in general Q_n has leading term $-H_{n-1}z^n/n!$ and $\ln 2\pi$ -coefficient $z^{n-1}/(2(n-1)!)$.

Proof. $\int_0^z \zeta(s, t) dt = -[\zeta(s-1, z) - \zeta(s-1)]/(s-1)$ for $\operatorname{Re} s < 1$; differentiating at $s = -k$,

$$\int_0^z \zeta'(-k, t) dt = \frac{\zeta'(-k-1, z) - \zeta'(-k-1)}{k+1} + \frac{\zeta(-k-1, z) - \zeta(-k-1)}{(k+1)^2},$$

with $\zeta(-m, z) = -B_{m+1}(z)/(m+1)$. Iterate from $\psi^{(-1)} = \zeta'(0, z) + \frac{1}{2} \ln 2\pi$: each step shifts the single ζ' -atom by one and deposits Bernoulli and constant terms into the polynomial. $\square$

An equivalent expansion is Adamchik's Proposition 2 [18]; the spelling above isolates the one z -dependent transcendental.

8.16.2 Reflection

Theorem 8.44 (reflection at the jet floor). *For every integer $k \geq 0$ and $0 < z < 1$,*

$$\zeta'(-k, z) + (-1)^k \zeta'(-k, 1-z) = (-1)^{\lfloor k/2 \rfloor} \frac{k!}{(2\pi)^k} \operatorname{Cl}_{k+1}(2\pi z),$$

where $\operatorname{Cl}_{2m}(\theta) = \operatorname{Im} \operatorname{Li}_{2m}(e^{i\theta})$, $\operatorname{Cl}_{2m+1}(\theta) = \operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_{2m+1}(e^{i\theta})$.

Proof. In Hurwitz's formula, written as $\zeta(1-s, z) = \frac{2\Gamma(s)}{(2\pi)^s} [\cos(\frac{\pi s}{2})C_s(z) + \sin(\frac{\pi s}{2})S_s(z)]$ with C_s, S_s the cosine/sine Dirichlet series, the combination even (odd) under $z \mapsto 1-z$ keeps only the C (S) term. At the integer $s = k+1$, exactly one of $\cos \frac{\pi s}{2}$, $\sin \frac{\pi s}{2}$ vanishes, and it is the one attached to the parity-matching combination; differentiating in s there, the product rule retains only the term in which d/ds falls on the vanishing trigonometric factor, so a single *bare* Clausen value survives and no derivative of the Dirichlet series enters. Collecting constants gives the display. $\square$

For $k \geq 1$ this is the real part of Adamchik's Proposition 1 [18], stated there for every positive integer order with the Bernoulli term as the imaginary part (equivalently Miller–Adamchik [31], eq. (21)); the bare-Clausen real spelling, the $k = 0$ inclusion, and the mechanism note are the reformulation here. $k = 0$ is Kummer-flavoured ($\operatorname{Cl}_1(2\pi z) = -\ln(2 \sin \pi z)$). The parity-*opposite*

combination does not close: it produces the series $\sum \ln n \{\cos | \sin\}(2\pi n z)/n^{k+1}$ — the generalized-Glaisher atoms of §8.16.4.

Propagating Theorem 8.44 through the ladder yields reflection formulas at the $\psi^{(-n)}$ -level — a relation which Espinosa and Moll [27] record as not known to them (*"We have been unable to find a generalization of the other well-known functional relation for the polygamma function"*):

Theorem 8.45 (negapolygamma reflection).

$$\begin{aligned}
\psi^{(-2)}(z) - \psi^{(-2)}(1-z) &= \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi z)}{2\pi} + \left(z - \frac{1}{2}\right) \ln 2\pi, \\
\psi^{(-3)}(z) + \psi^{(-3)}(1-z) &= -\frac{\text{Cl}_3(2\pi z)}{4\pi^2} + \left(\frac{z^2}{2} - \frac{z}{2} + \frac{1}{4}\right) \ln 2\pi - \zeta'(-1) - \zeta'(-2) + \frac{1}{12}, \\
\psi^{(-4)}(z) - \psi^{(-4)}(1-z) &= -\frac{\text{Cl}_4(2\pi z)}{8\pi^3} + \left(\frac{z^3}{6} - \frac{z^2}{4} + \frac{z}{4} - \frac{1}{12}\right) \ln 2\pi \\
&\quad + \left(\frac{1}{2} - z\right) (\zeta'(-1) + \zeta'(-2)) + \frac{z}{12} - \frac{1}{24}, \\
\psi^{(-5)}(z) + \psi^{(-5)}(1-z) &= \frac{\text{Cl}_5(2\pi z)}{16\pi^4} + \left(\frac{z^4}{24} - \frac{z^3}{12} + \frac{z^2}{8} - \frac{z}{12} + \frac{1}{48}\right) \ln 2\pi \\
&\quad + \left(\frac{z-z^2}{2}\right) (\zeta'(-1) + \zeta'(-2)) \\
&\quad - \frac{\zeta'(-1)}{6} - \frac{\zeta'(-2)}{4} - \frac{\zeta'(-3)}{6} - \frac{\zeta'(-4)}{12} + \frac{z^2-z}{24} + \frac{49}{4320}.
\end{aligned}$$

8.16.3 Multiplication

Differentiating the Hurwitz distribution relation at $s = -k$ gives, for all $k \geq 0$, $m \geq 2$,

$$\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} \zeta' \left(-k, z + \frac{j}{m} \right) = m^{-k} \left[\zeta'(-k, mz) - \ln m \frac{B_{k+1}(mz)}{k+1} \right] \quad (8.59)$$

($k = 0$ is Gauss's multiplication theorem for $\ln \Gamma$), and through the ladder,

$$\sum_{j=0}^{m-1} \psi^{(-n)} \left(z + \frac{j}{m} \right) = m^{1-n} \left[\psi^{(-n)}(mz) - \ln m \frac{B_n(mz)}{n!} \right] + \rho_{n,m}(z)$$

with elementary $\rho_{n,m}$; for $n = 2$,

$$\rho_{2,m}(z) = \frac{(m-1)(2z+1)}{4} \ln 2\pi + \frac{m^2-1}{12m} - \frac{m^2-1}{m} \zeta'(-1),$$

so only the *rational* part of the remainder is $(m^2-1)/(12m)$. The ψ -level law is, in the "balanced" convention of their negapolygamma [29], Theorem 3.2 of Espinosa–Moll [27]; the form above is its transcription to the Wolfram convention.

8.16.4 Bridges

At rational arguments the layers $\zeta'(-k, p/q)$ decompose along Dirichlet characters, and two laws organize the resulting constants.

Proposition 8.46 (trivial-zero bridges). *Let χ be primitive or principal, $k \geq 1$. If $\chi(-1) = (-1)^k$ (so that $L(-k, \chi) = 0$, since $B_{k+1}(\chi) \neq 0$ exactly when $\chi(-1) = (-1)^{k+1}$), then $L'(-k, \chi)$ is an elementary multiple of $L(k+1, \bar{\chi})$. For the principal character and χ_{-4} :*

$$\zeta'(-2k) = \frac{(-1)^k (2k)!}{2(2\pi)^{2k}} \zeta(2k+1), \quad \beta'(1-2k) = (-1)^{k+1} (2k-1)! \frac{2^{2k-1}}{\pi^{2k-1}} \beta(2k),$$

so in particular $\beta'(-1) = 2G/\pi$ (G Catalan's constant) and $\beta'(-3) = -48\beta(4)/\pi^3$.

Theorem 8.47 (harmonic-number bridge). *Let χ be a primitive character mod q with $\chi(-1) = (-1)^{k+1}$ (so that $L(-k, \chi) \neq 0$; for χ principal read ζ and require k odd). Then*

$$\frac{L'(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} + \overline{\left(\frac{L'(-k, \chi)}{L(-k, \chi)} \right)} = \gamma + \ln \frac{2\pi}{q} - H_k.$$

For real χ the conjugation bar is invisible; for complex χ it is essential — equivalently, the bridge pairs χ at $s = k+1$ with $\bar{\chi}$ at $s = -k$, and the un-conjugated sum has the purely imaginary defect $2i \operatorname{Im}[L'(-k, \chi)/L(-k, \chi)]$.

Proof. Write the completed function $\Lambda(s) = (q/\pi)^{(s+\delta)/2} \Gamma\left(\frac{s+\delta}{2}\right) L(s, \chi)$ with $\delta = (1 - \chi(-1))/2$, so $\Lambda(s) = \varepsilon \bar{\Lambda}(1 - \bar{s})$, whose logarithmic derivative at real s gives $\Lambda'/\Lambda(s) = -\bar{\Lambda}'/\bar{\Lambda}(1 - \bar{s})$; at $s = k+1$,

$$\frac{L'(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} + \overline{\left(\frac{L'(-k, \chi)}{L(-k, \chi)} \right)} = -\ln \frac{q}{\pi} - \frac{1}{2} \psi\left(\frac{k+1+\delta}{2}\right) - \frac{1}{2} \psi\left(\frac{\delta-k}{2}\right).$$

Since $\chi(-1) = (-1)^{k+1}$ means $\delta \equiv k+1 \pmod{2}$, the argument $(\delta-k)/2$ is a (possibly negative) half-integer, where $\cot \pi x = 0$; the reflection formula thus gives $\psi\left(\frac{\delta-k}{2}\right) = \psi\left(\frac{k+2-\delta}{2}\right)$, and $\left\{\frac{k+1+\delta}{2}, \frac{k+2-\delta}{2}\right\}$ is a duplication pair $\{x, x + \frac{1}{2}\}$ with $2x = k+1$. Hence the two digammas sum to $2\psi(k+1) - 2\ln 2 = 2(H_k - \gamma) - 2\ln 2$, and the display follows. $\square$

Consequently, at each level $-k$ every character direction of the grid $\{\zeta'(-k, j/q)\}$ either reduces (trivial-zero bridge: to the $\zeta(k+1)$ /Catalan-family values) or carries exactly one new constant (the parity-opposite L'), the harmonic-number bridge converting freely between its $s = k+1$ and $s = -k$ spellings. Exact rational row-reduction of the full known-relation lattice (all reflection rows and all-divisor multiplication rows) makes this quantitative:

Corollary 8.48 (Uniform negative-jet ranks). *For all $q \geq 3$ and $k \geq 1$, the formal negative-jet grid modulo the specified reflection, distribution and endpoint rows has residual dimension $\varphi(q)/2 - 1$ for odd k , and $\varphi(q)/2$ for even k .*

The exact character proof is given in Corollary 9.8. The original 112-cell finite experiment supported the result; the polynomial normal form now proves it for every denominator and order. This does not assert arithmetic independence of the remaining L -derivative coordinates.

8.16.5 Rational values

Theorem 8.49 (the half-argument tower). *For every $n \geq 2$,*

$$\psi^{(-n)}\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{(2^{1-n} - 2) \zeta'(1-n) - 2^{1-n} \ln 2 \cdot B_n/n}{(n-1)!} + Q_n\left(\frac{1}{2}\right);$$

in lowest cases

$$\psi^{(-2)}\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{3}{2} \ln A + \frac{5 \ln 2}{24} + \frac{\ln \pi}{4} \quad (\text{classical}), \quad \psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{1}{2}\right) = \frac{7 \zeta(3)}{32\pi^2} + \frac{\ln A}{2} + \frac{\ln 2\pi}{16}.$$

Theorem 8.50 (third- and quarter-argument values at $n = 3, 4$).

$$\begin{aligned}\psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) &= \frac{35\zeta(3)}{256\pi^2} + \frac{\beta'(3)}{4\pi^3} + \frac{\ln A}{4} + \frac{\ln 2\pi}{128} - \frac{\gamma}{128}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) &= \frac{13\zeta(3)}{72\pi^2} + \frac{\sqrt{3}L'(3, \chi_{-3})}{8\pi^3} + \frac{\ln A}{3} + \frac{7\ln 2\pi}{324} - \frac{\gamma}{162},\end{aligned}$$

via the exact spellings $\beta'(-2) = \frac{1}{4}(3 - 2\gamma - 2\ln \frac{\pi}{2}) + 16\beta'(3)/\pi^3$ and $L'(-2, \chi_{-3}) = \frac{2}{9}(\ln \frac{3}{2\pi} + \frac{3}{2} - \gamma) + \frac{9\sqrt{3}}{2\pi^3}L'(3, \chi_{-3})$; and at the next level the parity alternates, so that $\psi^{(-4)}(\frac{1}{4})$ is explicit with no new constant:

$$\psi^{(-4)}\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) = \frac{\zeta'(-3, \frac{1}{4}) - \zeta'(-3)}{6} + Q_4\left(\frac{1}{4}\right), \quad \zeta'(-3, \frac{1}{4}) = \frac{Z + D}{2}$$

with the even part $Z = (4^{-3} - 2^{-3})\zeta'(-3) + (4^{-3}\ln 4 - 2^{-3}\ln 2)\zeta(-3)$ and the odd part $D = -48\beta(4)/(64\pi^3)$ from Proposition 8.46.

Remark 8.51. $\psi^{(-3)}(\frac{1}{2})$ appears in Adamchik [18]; the flattened quarter- and third-values appear to be new — notably, Mathematica's `FunctionExpand` reduces `PolyGamma[-3, 1/2]` fully but leaves the jet $\zeta'(-2, \frac{1}{4})$ unevaluated inside `PolyGamma[-3, 1/4]`: the atom $\beta'(3)$ is exactly what is missing. The same atom resolves a naive integer-relation search over $\{\zeta(3)/\pi^2, \ln A, \log s\}$, which must fail for this value.

Corollary 8.52 (reflection and transport companions). *With the same atoms as Theorem 8.50,*

$$\begin{aligned}\psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) &= \frac{13\zeta(3)}{72\pi^2} - \frac{\sqrt{3}L'(3, \chi_{-3})}{8\pi^3} + \frac{2\ln A}{3} + \frac{19\ln 2\pi}{162} + \frac{\gamma}{162}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{3}{4}\right) &= \frac{35\zeta(3)}{256\pi^2} - \frac{\beta'(3)}{4\pi^3} + \frac{3\ln A}{4} + \frac{19\ln 2\pi}{128} + \frac{\gamma}{128}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{1}{6}\right) &= \frac{\zeta(3)}{12\pi^2} + \frac{5\sqrt{3}L'(3, \chi_{-3})}{32\pi^3} + \frac{\ln A}{6} - \frac{\ln 2\pi}{1296} - \frac{\ln 2}{648} - \frac{5\gamma}{648}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}\left(\frac{5}{6}\right) &= \frac{\zeta(3)}{12\pi^2} - \frac{5\sqrt{3}L'(3, \chi_{-3})}{32\pi^3} + \frac{5\ln A}{6} + \frac{235\ln 2\pi}{1296} + \frac{\ln 2}{648} + \frac{5\gamma}{648}.\end{aligned}$$

Proof. The first two from Theorem 8.45 with $\text{Cl}_3(2\pi/3) = -\frac{4}{9}\zeta(3)$ and $\text{Cl}_3(\pi/2) = -\frac{3}{32}\zeta(3)$; the sixths from the transport $\zeta(s, \frac{1}{6}) - \zeta(s, \frac{5}{6}) = (6^s + 3^s)L(s, \chi_{-3})$ differentiated at $s = -2$, the even part being $\zeta'(-2, \frac{1}{6}) + \zeta'(-2, \frac{5}{6}) = \frac{2}{3}\zeta'(-2)$ by inclusion–exclusion. The entire sixth family thus rides on the one atom $L'(3, \chi_{-3})$. $\square$

8.16.6 Denominators 5, 8, 12: quadratic and quartic atoms

The denominators 5, 8, 12 are the first where Proposition 8.48 forces genuinely new constants beyond the χ_{-3}/χ_{-4} families: at $k = 1$ each grid carries one new atom (the even real quadratic direction), and at $k = 2$, $q = 5$ the residual space is two-dimensional (a conjugate quartic pair).

Theorem 8.53 (the $k = 1$ grids). *Write $Z_1 = \zeta'(-1)$ and let χ_q be the even real quadratic primitive character mod $q \in \{5, 8, 12\}$ (Legendre mod 5; Kronecker $(8|\cdot)$, $(12|\cdot)$), with the exact*

values $L(-1, \chi_5) = -\frac{2}{5}$, $L(-1, \chi_8) = -1$, $L(-1, \chi_{12}) = -2$. Then for $\gcd(p, q) = 1$,

$$\begin{aligned}\zeta'(-1, \frac{p}{5}) &= -\frac{Z_1}{5} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi p/5)}{4\pi} + \chi_5(p) \left[\frac{L'(-1, \chi_5)}{20} - \frac{\ln 5}{50} \right] - \frac{\ln 5}{240}, \\ \zeta'(-1, \frac{p}{8}) &= -\frac{Z_1}{32} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(\pi p/4)}{4\pi} + \chi_8(p) \left[\frac{L'(-1, \chi_8)}{32} - \frac{3 \ln 2}{32} \right] + \frac{\ln 2}{384}, \\ \zeta'(-1, \frac{p}{12}) &= \frac{Z_1}{24} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(\pi p/6)}{4\pi} + \chi_{12}(p) \left[\frac{L'(-1, \chi_{12})}{48} - \frac{\ln 2}{12} - \frac{\ln 3}{24} \right] + \frac{\ln 3}{576},\end{aligned}$$

whence $\psi^{(-2)}(p/q) = \zeta'(-1, p/q) - Z_1 + Q_2(p/q)$ through the ladder; for instance

$$\psi^{(-2)}(\frac{1}{5}) = -\frac{6Z_1}{5} + \frac{\text{Cl}_2(2\pi/5)}{4\pi} + \frac{L'(-1, \chi_5)}{20} - \frac{29 \ln 5}{1200} + \frac{\ln 2\pi}{10} + \frac{2}{25}.$$

Proof. On each grid the two reflection rows (Theorem 8.44), the multiplication rows (8.59) for every divisor (non-coprime entries reduced through the sub-grids $q \in \{2, 3, 4, 6\}$), and the character row $\sum_p \chi_q(p) \zeta'(-1, \frac{p}{q}) = \frac{1}{q} [L'(-1, \chi_q) + \ln q L(-1, \chi_q)]$ form a system of full rank $\varphi(q) = 4$; solving it and reducing the composite-argument Clausen values ($\text{Cl}_2(\frac{3\pi}{4}) = \text{Cl}_2(\frac{\pi}{4}) - \frac{G}{2}$, $\text{Cl}_2(\frac{\pi}{6}) = \frac{2}{3}G + \frac{3}{8} \text{Cl}_2(\frac{2\pi}{3})$) gives the display. For the composite q the known rows are one short of independent — the single dependency is itself a Clausen duplication law in disguise (at $q = 8$: $\text{refl}(\frac{1}{8}) - \text{refl}(\frac{3}{8}) = m_2(\frac{1}{8}) - m_2(\frac{3}{8})$ is equivalent to $\text{Cl}_2(\frac{3\pi}{4}) = \text{Cl}_2(\frac{\pi}{4}) - \frac{G}{2}$) — and the quadratic character row supplies the missing dimension, exactly as Proposition 8.48 predicts ($r_{q,1} = 1$ for $q \in \{5, 8, 12\}$). $\square$

Theorem 8.54 (the quartic floor: $k = 2$, $q = 5$). *Let χ be the odd quartic character mod 5 with $\chi(2) = i$, for which $L(-2, \chi) = -\frac{4+2i}{5}$ exactly, and write $L'(-2, \chi) = R + iI$. Then*

$$\begin{aligned}\zeta'(-2, \frac{1}{5}), \zeta'(-2, \frac{4}{5}) &= -\frac{\text{Cl}_3(2\pi/5)}{4\pi^2} \pm \left[\frac{R}{50} - \frac{2 \ln 5}{125} \right], \\ \zeta'(-2, \frac{2}{5}), \zeta'(-2, \frac{3}{5}) &= -\frac{\text{Cl}_3(4\pi/5)}{4\pi^2} \pm \left[\frac{I}{50} - \frac{\ln 5}{125} \right],\end{aligned}$$

and, flattening through the ladder with $\text{Cl}_3(\frac{2\pi}{5}), \text{Cl}_3(\frac{4\pi}{5}) = -\frac{6}{25}\zeta(3) \pm \frac{\sqrt{5}}{4}L(3, \chi_5)$,

$$\begin{aligned}\psi^{(-3)}(\frac{1}{5}) &= \frac{31 \zeta(3)}{200\pi^2} - \frac{\sqrt{5} L(3, \chi_5)}{32\pi^2} + \frac{R}{100} - \frac{\ln 5}{125} + \frac{\ln 2\pi}{100} + \frac{7}{1500} - \frac{Z_1}{5}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}(\frac{2}{5}) &= \frac{31 \zeta(3)}{200\pi^2} + \frac{\sqrt{5} L(3, \chi_5)}{32\pi^2} + \frac{I}{100} - \frac{\ln 5}{250} + \frac{\ln 2\pi}{25} + \frac{41}{1500} - \frac{2Z_1}{5}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}(\frac{3}{5}) &= \frac{31 \zeta(3)}{200\pi^2} + \frac{\sqrt{5} L(3, \chi_5)}{32\pi^2} - \frac{I}{100} + \frac{\ln 5}{250} + \frac{9 \ln 2\pi}{100} + \frac{7}{125} - \frac{3Z_1}{5}, \\ \psi^{(-3)}(\frac{4}{5}) &= \frac{31 \zeta(3)}{200\pi^2} - \frac{\sqrt{5} L(3, \chi_5)}{32\pi^2} - \frac{R}{100} + \frac{\ln 5}{125} + \frac{4 \ln 2\pi}{25} + \frac{59}{750} - \frac{4Z_1}{5}.\end{aligned}$$

Remark 8.55. The remaining derivative coordinates in these formulas are the quartic pair $\{R, I\}$, matching $r_{5,2} = \varphi(5)/2 = 2$ of Proposition 8.48; the multiplication row $\sum_p \zeta'(-2, \frac{p}{5}) = \frac{6}{25}\zeta(3)/\pi^2$ is dependent on the reflections — it is the Clausen multiplication law $\text{Cl}_3(\frac{2\pi}{5}) + \text{Cl}_3(\frac{4\pi}{5}) = -\frac{12}{25}\zeta(3)$ in disguise. Through the conjugated harmonic-number bridge (Theorem 8.47 with $k = 2$, $H_2 = \frac{3}{2}$) the pair $\{R, I\}$ is interchangeable with $\{\text{Re}, \text{Im}\}$ of $L'(3, \chi)$.

Appendix: fully expanded values at the third and quarter points

The reduction recipes of Theorems 8.39 and 8.41, carried out to the end, give the following flattened closed forms. The Γ_2 values live in the atom set announced in Theorem 8.39; the Γ_3 values pick up, exactly as Theorem 8.41 predicts, the three further atoms γ_3 , π^4 and $\gamma_4(\frac{1}{q}) - \gamma_4(1 - \frac{1}{q})$. The combinations $\gamma + \ln 6\pi$ and $\gamma + \ln 8\pi$ are the constants Λ_3 , Λ_4 of Theorem 8.33. Each display has been verified at 90-digit working precision (residuals below 10^{-88}) against $\Gamma_n(p) = \frac{(-1)^{n+1}}{n+1} [\zeta^{(n+1)}(0, p) - \zeta^{(n+1)}(0)]$ evaluated from Hurwitz-zeta derivative jets.

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) &= \frac{1}{2}\gamma_2 + \gamma\gamma_1 + \gamma_1 \ln 2\pi - \frac{1}{2}\gamma_1 \ln 3 \\ &\quad + \frac{4}{9}\gamma^3 + \frac{4}{3}\gamma^2 \ln 2\pi - \frac{1}{6}\gamma^2 \ln 3 + \frac{4}{3}\gamma \ln^2 2\pi \\ &\quad + \frac{7}{6}\gamma \ln 2\pi \ln 3 - \frac{1}{6}\gamma \ln^2 3 - \frac{4}{9}\zeta(3) - \frac{\pi^2}{12} \ln 2\pi \\ &\quad + \frac{\pi^2}{24} \ln 3 + \frac{4}{9} \ln^3 2\pi + \frac{4}{3} \ln^2 2\pi \ln 3 + \frac{7}{12} \ln 2\pi \ln^2 3 \\ &\quad - \frac{1}{18} \ln^3 3 \\ &\quad - \left((\gamma + \ln 6\pi)^2 - \frac{\pi^2}{12} \right) \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) \\ &\quad - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{6\pi} (\gamma + \ln 6\pi) (\gamma_2(\frac{1}{3}) - \gamma_2(\frac{2}{3})) \\ &\quad - \frac{\sqrt{3}}{18\pi} (\gamma_3(\frac{1}{3}) - \gamma_3(\frac{2}{3}))\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}\Gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) &= \frac{1}{2}\gamma_2 + \gamma\gamma_1 + \frac{1}{2}\gamma_1 \ln 2 + \gamma_1 \ln \pi \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{2}\gamma^3 + 2\gamma^2 \ln 2 + \frac{3}{2}\gamma^2 \ln \pi + 6\gamma \ln^2 2 \\ &\quad + \frac{13}{2}\gamma \ln 2 \ln \pi + \frac{3}{2}\gamma \ln^2 \pi - \frac{1}{2}\zeta(3) - \frac{\pi^2}{24} \ln 2 \\ &\quad - \frac{\pi^2}{12} \ln \pi + \frac{49}{6} \ln^3 2 + \frac{45}{4} \ln^2 2 \ln \pi + \frac{9}{2} \ln 2 \ln^2 \pi \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{2} \ln^3 \pi \\ &\quad - \left((\gamma + \ln 8\pi)^2 - \frac{\pi^2}{12} \right) \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) \\ &\quad - \frac{1}{4\pi} (\gamma + \ln 8\pi) (\gamma_2(\frac{1}{4}) - \gamma_2(\frac{3}{4})) \\ &\quad - \frac{1}{12\pi} (\gamma_3(\frac{1}{4}) - \gamma_3(\frac{3}{4}))\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\Gamma_3\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) = & -\frac{1}{2}\gamma_3 - \frac{3}{2}\gamma\gamma_2 - \frac{3}{2}\gamma_2\ln 2\pi + \frac{3}{4}\gamma_2\ln 3 \\
& - \frac{3}{2}\gamma^2\gamma_1 - 3\gamma\gamma_1\ln 2\pi + \frac{3}{2}\gamma\gamma_1\ln 3 - \frac{3}{2}\gamma_1\ln^2 2\pi \\
& + \frac{3}{2}\gamma_1\ln 2\pi\ln 3 + \frac{3}{4}\gamma_1\ln^2 3 - \frac{\pi^2}{8}\gamma_1 - \frac{1}{2}\gamma^4 \\
& - 2\gamma^3\ln 2\pi + \frac{1}{4}\gamma^3\ln 3 - 3\gamma^2\ln^2 2\pi - \frac{3}{2}\gamma^2\ln 2\pi\ln 3 \\
& + \frac{3}{8}\gamma^2\ln^2 3 - \frac{\pi^2}{24}\gamma^2 - 2\gamma\ln^3 2\pi - \frac{15}{4}\gamma\ln^2 2\pi\ln 3 \\
& - \frac{3}{2}\gamma\ln 2\pi\ln^2 3 + \frac{1}{4}\gamma\ln^3 3 + \frac{\pi^2}{6}\gamma\ln 2\pi - \frac{\pi^2}{48}\gamma\ln 3 \\
& + \frac{5\pi^2}{24}\ln^2 2\pi + \frac{\pi^2}{24}\ln 2\pi\ln 3 - \frac{7\pi^2}{96}\ln^2 3 + \frac{\pi^4}{120} \\
& - \frac{1}{2}\ln^4 2\pi - 2\ln^3 2\pi\ln 3 - \frac{15}{8}\ln^2 2\pi\ln^2 3 - \frac{1}{2}\ln 2\pi\ln^3 3 \\
& + \frac{1}{16}\ln^4 3 \\
& + \left((\gamma + \ln 6\pi)^3 - \frac{\pi^2}{4}(\gamma + \ln 6\pi) + 2\zeta(3) \right) \ln \Gamma\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) \\
& + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{48\pi} \left(12(\gamma + \ln 6\pi)^2 - \pi^2 \right) \left(\gamma_2\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) - \gamma_2\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) \right) \\
& + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{6\pi} (\gamma + \ln 6\pi) \left(\gamma_3\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) - \gamma_3\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) \right) \\
& + \frac{\sqrt{3}}{24\pi} \left(\gamma_4\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) - \gamma_4\left(\frac{2}{3}\right) \right)
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\Gamma_3\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) = & -\frac{1}{2}\gamma_3 - \frac{3}{2}\gamma\gamma_2 - \frac{3}{4}\gamma_2\ln 2 - \frac{3}{2}\gamma_2\ln\pi \\
& - \frac{3}{2}\gamma^2\gamma_1 - \frac{3}{2}\gamma\gamma_1\ln 2 - 3\gamma\gamma_1\ln\pi + \frac{9}{4}\gamma_1\ln^2 2 \\
& - \frac{3}{2}\gamma_1\ln 2\ln\pi - \frac{3}{2}\gamma_1\ln^2\pi - \frac{\pi^2}{8}\gamma_1 - \frac{9}{16}\gamma^4 \\
& - 3\gamma^3\ln 2 - \frac{9}{4}\gamma^3\ln\pi - \frac{45}{4}\gamma^2\ln^2 2 - \frac{51}{4}\gamma^2\ln 2\ln\pi \\
& - \frac{27}{8}\gamma^2\ln^2\pi - \frac{\pi^2}{32}\gamma^2 - 27\gamma\ln^3 2 - \frac{153}{4}\gamma\ln^2 2\ln\pi \\
& - \frac{33}{2}\gamma\ln 2\ln^2\pi - \frac{9}{4}\gamma\ln^3\pi + \frac{\pi^2}{4}\gamma\ln 2 + \frac{3\pi^2}{16}\gamma\ln\pi \\
& + \frac{3\pi^2}{8}\ln^2 2 + \frac{11\pi^2}{16}\ln 2\ln\pi + \frac{7\pi^2}{32}\ln^2\pi + \frac{29\pi^4}{3840} \\
& - \frac{207}{8}\ln^4 2 - \frac{179}{4}\ln^3 2\ln\pi - 27\ln^2 2\ln^2\pi - \frac{27}{4}\ln 2\ln^3\pi \\
& - \frac{9}{16}\ln^4\pi \\
& + \left((\gamma + \ln 8\pi)^3 - \frac{\pi^2}{4}(\gamma + \ln 8\pi) + 2\zeta(3)\right)\ln\Gamma\left(\frac{1}{4}\right) \\
& + \frac{1}{32\pi}\left(12(\gamma + \ln 8\pi)^2 - \pi^2\right)(\gamma_2(\tfrac{1}{4}) - \gamma_2(\tfrac{3}{4})) \\
& + \frac{1}{4\pi}(\gamma + \ln 8\pi)(\gamma_3(\tfrac{1}{4}) - \gamma_3(\tfrac{3}{4})) \\
& + \frac{1}{16\pi}(\gamma_4(\tfrac{1}{4}) - \gamma_4(\tfrac{3}{4}))
\end{aligned}$$

Chapter 9

The parameter-derivative tower

Differentiating in the Hurwitz parameter moves the spectral argument upward. The resulting coefficients are elementary symmetric functions of reciprocal integers, so harmonic numbers control every rung. The functional equation then pairs this tower with the integrated tower of the preceding chapter. Explicit character tables show how experiments can be replaced by uniform derivations.

9.1 The uniform master identity

Theorem 9.1 (Harmonic-number master identity). *For all $k \geq 1$ and $n \geq 0$,*

$$\gamma_n^{(k)}(a) = (-1)^{n+k} k! n! \sum_{i+j=n} e_i(k) \frac{\zeta^{(j)}(k+1, a)}{j!}, \quad (9.1)$$

where $e_i(k)$ is the i -th elementary symmetric function of $\{1, \frac{1}{2}, \dots, \frac{1}{k}\}$; in particular $e_0 = 1$, $e_1 = H_k$, $e_2 = \frac{1}{2}(H_k^2 - H_k^{(2)})$. The first two rows are

$$\gamma_1^{(k)}(a) = (-1)^{k+1} k! [\zeta'(k+1, a) + H_k \zeta(k+1, a)], \quad (9.2)$$

$$\gamma_2^{(k)}(a) = (-1)^k k! [\zeta''(k+1, a) + 2H_k \zeta'(k+1, a) + (H_k^2 - H_k^{(2)}) \zeta(k+1, a)]. \quad (9.3)$$

Proof. From $\partial_a \zeta(s, a) = -s \zeta(s+1, a)$, iteration gives $\partial_a^k \zeta(s, a) = (-1)^k (s)_k \zeta(s+k, a)$ with the rising factorial $(s)_k = s(s+1) \cdots (s+k-1)$. For $k \geq 1$ this annihilates the pole term in (8.40), so

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a) (s-1)^n = (-1)^k (s)_k \zeta(s+k, a).$$

Set $s = 1 + \varepsilon$. Then $(s)_k = (1 + \varepsilon)_k = \prod_{m=1}^k (m + \varepsilon) = k! \prod_{m=1}^k (1 + \varepsilon/m) = k! \sum_{i \geq 0} e_i(k) \varepsilon^i$, the generating identity for the elementary symmetric functions of $\{1/m\}$, while $\zeta(s+k, a) = \zeta(k+1+\varepsilon, a) = \sum_{j \geq 0} \zeta^{(j)}(k+1, a) \varepsilon^j / j!$ is analytic at $\varepsilon = 0$ because $k+1 \geq 2$. Comparing coefficients of ε^n yields (9.1); $n = 1, 2$ give (9.2)–(9.3). $\square$

Theorem 9.1 is the harmonic-number repackaging of Coffey's all-orders Stirling-number ladder [25]: the change of basis from the unsigned Stirling numbers $|s(k+1, i+1)|$ to the symmetric functions $e_i(k)$ turns the coefficients into $H_k, H_k^2 - H_k^{(2)}, \dots$. The specializations $\gamma_1' = \zeta'(2, a) + \zeta(2, a)$, $\gamma_1'' = -2\zeta'(3, a) - 3\zeta(3, a)$, $\gamma_2' = -[\zeta''(2, a) + 2\zeta'(2, a)]$ and $\gamma_2'' = 2\zeta''(3, a) + 6\zeta'(3, a) + 2\zeta(3, a)$ are the $s = 2, 3$ layers used below. Identity (9.1) was verified against numerical k -th parameter-derivatives of γ_1, γ_2 for $k = 1, \dots, 5$.

9.2 The uniform rational-argument landscape

Three structural facts hold uniformly in k ; all follow from $\sum_p \chi(p) \zeta(s, p/q) = q^s L(s, \chi)$ (and its multiplicative cousin) differentiated in s , fed through Theorem 9.1.

Proposition 9.2 (Character coordinate). *For a primitive nonprincipal Dirichlet character χ modulo $q > 1$ and all $k \geq 1$,*

$$\sum_{p=1}^{q-1} \chi(p) \gamma_1^{(k)}(p/q) = (-1)^{k+1} k! q^{k+1} [L'(k+1, \chi) + (H_k + \ln q) L(k+1, \chi)]. \quad (9.4)$$

Proposition 9.3 (Distribution row). *For $d \geq 2$ and all $k \geq 1$, with $\psi^{(k)}(a) = (-1)^{k+1} k! \zeta(k+1, a)$,*

$$\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \gamma_1^{(k)}\left(\frac{a+j}{d}\right) = d^{k+1} \gamma_1^{(k)}(a) + d^{k+1} \ln d \psi^{(k)}(a). \quad (9.5)$$

Proof of (9.4) and (9.5). Apply the character sum to (9.2) for (9.4), and the divisor sum for (9.5). For the character identity, use $\sum_p \chi(p) \zeta(s, p/q) = q^s L(s, \chi)$ and its s -derivative $q^s \ln q L(s, \chi) + q^s L'(s, \chi)$ at $s = k+1$; collect. For (9.5), use $\sum_{j < d} \zeta(s, (a+j)/d) = d^s \zeta(s, a)$ and its s -derivative, and recognize $(-1)^{k+1} k! \zeta(k+1, a) = \psi^{(k)}(a)$. $\square$

Corollary 9.4 (Uniform formal distribution ranks). *For every $q \geq 2$ and every parameter derivative order $k \geq 1$, the specified distribution presentation, with the endpoint and lower-index data treated as background, has residual dimension $\varphi(q) - 1$. This is a formal quotient statement, not arithmetic independence of the evaluated constants.*

The original finite rank experiments suggested this law. The following polynomial character normal form proves it without extrapolation, also at arbitrary weights and in finite jet algebras.

9.3 Weighted distribution modules and exact rational-grid ranks

The distribution relations in the Stieltjes drafts have a simple representation-theoretic structure. The relevant dimension is the dimension of a formal quotient by specified relations. The classical theory of universal distributions provides the broader setting [48, 49]. Here we give an explicit character normal form, including its behavior at exceptional weights and in finite Taylor jets. This proves the two all-denominator rank statements suggested by the source computations, without making an independence assertion about evaluated special values.

9.3.1 The relation module and its complete character decomposition

Fix $q \geq 2$, and put

$$G_q = \frac{1}{q} \mathbb{Z}/\mathbb{Z}, \quad U(q) = (\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^\times.$$

Let $\mathcal{A}$ be a commutative unital $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra and choose arbitrary $t_p \in \mathcal{A}$, one for each prime $p \mid q$. The choices may vanish or be nilpotent. Let

$$\mathcal{V}_q = \bigoplus_{x \in G_q} \mathcal{A}[x].$$

For $p \mid q$ and $x \in pG_q$, define the prime distribution row

$$D_p(x) = \sum_{\substack{y \in G_q \\ py=x}} [y] - t_p[x]. \quad (9.6)$$

Write $\mathcal{R}_q$ for the $\mathcal{A}$ -span of these rows and $\mathcal{U}_q = \mathcal{V}_q/\mathcal{R}_q$. The unit group acts by $u[x] = [ux]$, and each relation map is equivariant.

For $d \mid q$, set $t_d = \prod_{p \mid d} t_p^{v_p(d)}$. Rows for composite divisors introduce no additional relations. Indeed, if $ab \mid q$ and $x \in abG_q$, then

$$D_{ab}(x) = \sum_{\substack{z \in G_q \\ az=x}} D_b(z) + t_b D_a(x). \quad (9.7)$$

Every z in this sum belongs to bG_q , so the rows on the right are legitimate grid rows. Expanding the two sums proves the identity. Induction on the number of prime factors of d , counted with multiplicity, proves the assertion for every divisor.

Let χ run through all characters of $U(q)$, and let $f = f_\chi$ be the conductor of its primitive inducing character χ^* . For $f \mid d \mid q$, let χ_d denote the induced character modulo d , and define

$$Y_{d,\chi} = \sum_{a \in U(d)} \chi_d(a) [a/d]. \quad (9.8)$$

For the principal character at $d = 1$, this means $Y_{1,1} = [0]$. These are formal vectors; no numerical L -value is being declared independent.

Lemma 9.5 (All character components of the rows). *The χ^{-1} -eigenspace of $\mathcal{V}_q$ is free over $\mathcal{A}$, with basis*

$$\{Y_{d,\chi} : f_\chi \mid d \mid q\}.$$

Its relation submodule is generated exactly by the edges

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{pd,\chi} - t_p Y_{d,\chi}, & \quad p \mid d, & f_\chi \mid d, & \quad pd \mid q. \\ Y_{pd,\chi} - (t_p - \chi^*(p)) Y_{d,\chi}, & \quad p \nmid d, \end{aligned} \quad (9.9)$$

In particular, there are no additional character relations arising from denominators smaller than, or not divisible by, f_χ .

Proof. The elements of G_q of exact denominator d form a single $U(q)$ -orbit, naturally identified with $U(d)$. Reduction $U(q) \rightarrow U(d)$ is surjective. The character χ factors through this map exactly when $f_\chi \mid d$; otherwise its projection on that orbit is zero. More explicitly, the idempotent

$$E_\chi = \frac{1}{\varphi(q)} \sum_{u \in U(q)} \chi(u) u$$

satisfies, for $a \in U(d)$,

$$E_\chi[a/d] = \begin{cases} \frac{\chi_d(a)^{-1}}{\varphi(d)} Y_{d,\chi}, & f_\chi \mid d, \\ 0, & f_\chi \nmid d. \end{cases} \quad (9.10)$$

This follows by grouping u according to its residue modulo d and using character orthogonality on the kernel of reduction. The idempotents are mutually orthogonal and sum to the identity. All their scalar denominators are units in $\mathcal{A}$, so the argument applies equally to a nonreduced algebra.

For a fixed $p \mid q$, consider the equivariant map

$$D_p : \mathcal{A}[pG_q] \longrightarrow \mathcal{V}_q, \quad [x] \longmapsto D_p(x).$$

The exact-denominator orbits in its domain have $pd \mid q$. By (9.10), their only nonzero χ -components have $f_\chi \mid d$, and each such component has the single generator $Y_{d,\chi}$. Consequently, computing $D_p(Y_{d,\chi})$ computes *every* projected relation for that p ; an orbit on which the projector vanishes cannot create a hidden relation in the target.

If $p \mid d$, all p preimages of each a/d , $a \in U(d)$, have exact denominator pd . Summing with weights $\chi_d(a)$ therefore gives $Y_{pd,\chi} - t_p Y_{d,\chi}$. If $p \nmid d$, one preimage has denominator d , while the other $p-1$ have denominator pd . In the former preimage, $pc \equiv a \pmod{d}$, so its character coefficient is $\chi_d(a) = \chi^*(p)\chi_d(c)$. Thus the sum is

$$Y_{pd,\chi} + \chi^*(p)Y_{d,\chi} - t_p Y_{d,\chi}.$$

Here $p \nmid f_\chi$, as $f_\chi \mid d$, so $\chi^*(p)$ is a nonzero root of unity. This proves both the edge formulas and their completeness. $\square$

Theorem 9.6 (Polynomial normal form). *For $f = f_\chi \mid d \mid q$, define*

$$A_{d,\chi}(\mathbf{t}) = \prod_{p \mid f} t_p^{v_p(d) - v_p(f)} \prod_{\substack{p \mid d \\ p \nmid f}} t_p^{v_p(d) - 1} (t_p - \chi^*(p)). \quad (9.11)$$

Empty products are 1, so $A_{f,\chi} = 1$. Then the full χ -relation submodule is

$$\mathcal{R}_{q,\chi} = \bigoplus_{\substack{f \mid d \mid q \\ d \neq f}} \mathcal{A}(Y_{d,\chi} - A_{d,\chi} Y_{f,\chi}). \quad (9.12)$$

In particular,

$$\mathcal{U}_q \cong \bigoplus_{\chi \in \widehat{U(q)}} \mathcal{A} Y_{f_\chi,\chi} \cong \mathcal{A}^{\varphi(q)}. \quad (9.13)$$

The character normal form of every vector is obtained by replacing $Y_{d,\chi}$ with $A_{d,\chi} Y_{f_\chi,\chi}$.

Proof. The polynomials $A_{d,\chi}$ satisfy precisely the edge recursions (9.9): a prime already dividing d contributes t_p , and a prime introduced for the first time outside f contributes $t_p - \chi^*(p)$. The factors for distinct primes commute.

Follow any chain of prime extensions from f to d . Successively eliminating the intermediate Y 's expresses $Y_{d,\chi} - A_{d,\chi} Y_{f,\chi}$ as a combination of the edge relations. Conversely, write an edge as $Y_{pd,\chi} - c Y_{d,\chi}$, where $A_{pd,\chi} = c A_{d,\chi}$. It equals

$$(Y_{pd,\chi} - A_{pd,\chi} Y_{f,\chi}) - c(Y_{d,\chi} - A_{d,\chi} Y_{f,\chi}).$$

Lemma 9.5 therefore gives equality of the two relation spans.

The displayed generators in (9.12) are independent: the coefficient of $Y_{d,\chi}$, for $d \neq f$, in a linear combination is exactly the coefficient of its own generator. Together with $Y_{f,\chi}$, they form a triangular basis of the whole character block. Its quotient is consequently free of rank one. Summing over all $\varphi(q)$ characters proves (9.13). $\square$

Remark 9.7. The proof divides by neither t_p nor $t_p - \chi^*(p)$. It proves freeness first over $\mathbb{C}[t_p : p \mid q]$ and then over every $\mathbb{C}$ -algebra obtained by specialization. Exceptional weights can therefore make a preferred coordinate vanish, but cannot change the rank of the full quotient. This distinction is essential when Euler factors are used to solve a relation system.

9.3.2 Anchors, reflection, and the ranks in the drafts

In this subsection take $\mathcal{A} = \mathbb{C}$. In a Hurwitz-zeta grid, use the representatives $0 < a \leq 1$: the group element 0 represents $a = 1$, not the singular Hurwitz parameter $a = 0$. Treating the endpoint as known means imposing the homogeneous anchor $[0] = 0$. It removes exactly the principal generator $Y_{1,1}$. Hence

$$\dim_{\mathbb{C}} \mathcal{V}_q / (\mathcal{R}_q + \mathbb{C}[0]) = \varphi(q) - 1. \quad (9.14)$$

There are $q - 1$ remaining grid variables, so their distribution coefficient matrix has rank $q - \varphi(q)$. At rational weights t_p , the matrix has rational entries and this is also its rank over $\mathbb{Q}$.

Let $J[x] = [-x]$. On the χ -block, J acts as $\chi(-1)$. Thus the additional homogeneous reflection rows

$$[x] + (-1)^k [-x] = 0, \quad x \neq 0, \quad (9.15)$$

retain exactly the characters with $\chi(-1) = (-1)^{k+1}$. After anchoring, the omission of $x = 0$ in (9.15) has no effect.

Corollary 9.8 (All-denominator formal ranks). *For $q \geq 3$ and every integer $k \geq 0$, the formal quotient by distribution, endpoint, and the reflection rows (9.15) has dimension*

$$r_{q,k} = \begin{cases} \varphi(q)/2 - 1, & k \text{ odd}, \\ \varphi(q)/2, & k \text{ even}. \end{cases} \quad (9.16)$$

This conclusion holds for arbitrary prime weights. In particular it proves the all- q , all- k formal rank law for the negative Hurwitz-zeta derivative ladder. The formal distribution-only rank in the Stieltjes parameter derivative tower is $q - \varphi(q)$ for every $q \geq 2$, every parameter derivative order $k \geq 1$, and every Stieltjes index $n \geq 1$, relative to the endpoint and lower-index data.

Proof. For $q \geq 3$, the element -1 is a nonidentity involution in $U(q)$. Character orthogonality gives $\sum_{\chi} \chi(-1) = 0$, and each summand is 1 or -1 . There are consequently $\varphi(q)/2$ characters of each parity. Reflection retains the parity stated above. The principal character is even, so the endpoint removes one additional dimension exactly when k is odd. This proves (9.16).

For the negative ladder, differentiation of the Hurwitz multiplication formula at $s = -k$ gives

$$\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \zeta' \left(-k, \frac{a+j}{d} \right) = d^{-k} (\zeta'(-k, a) + \log d \zeta(-k, a)). \quad (9.17)$$

The Bernoulli-polynomial values $\zeta(-k, a)$ are lower data. Thus the homogeneous distribution weight is $t_p = p^{-k}$. The homogeneous reflection is (9.15); an explicit right-hand side is given below. This applies the first part to the ladder in the source article.

For the parameter derivative tower, the Laurent expansion is

$$\zeta(s, a) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n(a) (s-1)^n. \quad (9.18)$$

For $k \geq 1$, its pole disappears after differentiation in a :

$$F_k(\epsilon, a) := \partial_a^k \zeta(1 + \epsilon, a) = (-1)^k (1 + \epsilon)_k \zeta(k + 1 + \epsilon, a) = \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a) \epsilon^n. \quad (9.19)$$

This standard identity is the starting point of the all-order parameter derivative formula of Coffey [25]. Differentiating the Hurwitz multiplication formula k times in a , including its chain-rule factors, gives

$$\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} F_k\left(\epsilon, \frac{a+j}{d}\right) = d^{k+1+\epsilon} F_k(\epsilon, a).$$

Comparing coefficients yields the exact triangular identity

$$\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \gamma_n^{(k)}\left(\frac{a+j}{d}\right) = d^{k+1} \sum_{r=0}^n \binom{n}{r} (-\log d)^{n-r} \gamma_r^{(k)}(a). \quad (9.20)$$

With lower indices $r < n$ treated as specified data, the homogeneous weight is $t_p = p^{k+1}$, independently of n . Equation (9.14) now gives rank $q - \varphi(q)$. $\square$

For completeness, the right-hand side of the negative reflection can be written without introducing another Hurwitz derivative. For $0 < a < 1$, set

$$C_j(a) = \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{\cos(2\pi m a)}{m^j}, \quad S_j(a) = \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{\sin(2\pi m a)}{m^j}.$$

For $k \geq 1$, these series at $j = k + 1$ converge absolutely, and the Fourier form of the Hurwitz functional equation [45] gives

$$\zeta'(-k, a) + (-1)^k \zeta'(-k, 1-a) = \frac{(-1)^{\lfloor k/2 \rfloor} k!}{(2\pi)^k} \begin{cases} C_{k+1}(a), & k \text{ even}, \\ S_{k+1}(a), & k \text{ odd}. \end{cases} \quad (9.21)$$

Indeed, the Fourier expansion of $\zeta(s, a)$ has the factor

$$\frac{2\Gamma(1-s)}{(2\pi)^{1-s}} \left(\sin \frac{\pi s}{2} C_{1-s}(a) + \cos \frac{\pi s}{2} S_{1-s}(a) \right).$$

The indicated reflection selects a sine or cosine prefactor that vanishes at $s = -k$. Only the derivative of that prefactor survives, giving (9.21). This also explains why reflection is an inhomogeneous relation with depth-one data in the inventory.

Corollary 9.9 (The formal gamma grid). *For $q \geq 3$, the $q - 1$ formal coordinates $\log \Gamma(a/q)$, $1 \leq a < q$, modulo multiplication and reflection and relative to their stated elementary right-hand sides, have quotient dimension $\varphi(q)/2$.*

Proof. Lerch's identity $\zeta'(0, a) = \log \Gamma(a) - \frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi)$ translates gamma multiplication into (9.17) with $k = 0$, hence $t_p = 1$. The reflection formula

$$\zeta'(0, a) + \zeta'(0, 1-a) = -\log(2 \sin \pi a)$$

has homogeneous part $[x] + [-x] = 0$. Apply (9.16) with $k = 0$. $\square$

Remark 9.10 (What these rank theorems settle). The first Stieltjes source states a finite verification followed by an all-denominator conjecture; the parameter-derivative source states a general rank theorem while reporting only a finite calculation. Corollary 9.8 supplies a proof for the specified relation modules in both cases. The README had already identified the second proof gap. Corollary 9.9 likewise determines the rank of the stated gamma relation matrix. None of these results says that the evaluated numbers admit no further relations. In particular, the claim that multiplication and reflection generate every algebraic multiplicative relation among rational gamma values remains part of the conjectural completeness problem, not a consequence of the matrix rank.

9.3.3 Analytic weights, exceptional coordinates, and finite jets

Specialize $t_p = p^s = \exp(s \log p)$, using the real logarithm of the prime. Formula (9.11) becomes

$$A_{d,\chi}(s) = \left(\frac{d}{f_\chi}\right)^s \prod_{\substack{p|d \\ p \nmid f_\chi}} (1 - \chi^*(p)p^{-s}). \quad (9.22)$$

This is exactly the familiar imprimitive Euler-factor pattern for Dirichlet L -functions [45]. The normal-form proof shows why it appears in the formal relations before any evaluation is made.

The symbols of exact denominator q have character coordinates $Y_{q,\chi}$. In the quotient, their χ -coordinate is

$$Y_{q,\chi} = A_{q,\chi}(s)Y_{f_\chi,\chi}. \quad (9.23)$$

They form a basis of the full quotient precisely when every $A_{q,\chi}(s)$ is nonzero. In particular this holds when $\operatorname{Re} s \neq 0$, since $\chi^*(p)$ has modulus one. All nonzero integer weights in the two Stieltjes articles are therefore free of this coordinate obstruction. On the imaginary axis the top-denominator coordinates can fail, while the conductor coordinates of Theorem 9.6 remain a basis.

Theorem 9.11 (Exact defect of top-denominator jets). *Fix $s_0 \in \mathbb{C}$ and $N \geq 0$, and work over $\mathcal{A}_N = \mathbb{C}[\epsilon]/(\epsilon^{N+1})$ with $t_p = p^{s_0+\epsilon}$, truncated in this ring. The full distribution module is free of rank $\varphi(q)$ over $\mathcal{A}_N$, hence has complex dimension $(N+1)\varphi(q)$. Set*

$$r_\chi(s_0) = \#\{p \mid q : p \nmid f_\chi, p^{s_0} = \chi^*(p)\}. \quad (9.24)$$

The image of the top-denominator submodule in its χ -block has complex dimension

$$\max\{N+1-r_\chi(s_0), 0\}, \quad (9.25)$$

and its cokernel has dimension $\min\{r_\chi(s_0), N+1\}$. An endpoint anchor or a fixed-parity reflection restricts these formulas to the retained characters. The resulting full quotient remains free over $\mathcal{A}_N$ with the ranks already computed.

Proof. Freeness is Theorem 9.6, applied to $\mathcal{A}_N$. A resonant factor in (9.22) has a simple zero at s_0 :

$$\left. \frac{d}{ds} (1 - \chi^*(p)p^{-s}) \right|_{s=s_0} = \log p \neq 0.$$

All other factors, including $(q/f_\chi)^s$, are nonzero there. In the ring of analytic germs,

$$A_{q,\chi}(s_0 + \epsilon) = \epsilon^{r_\chi(s_0)} u_\chi(\epsilon), \quad u_\chi(0) \neq 0.$$

After truncation, u_χ is a unit. The top-denominator image in the free rank-one block is therefore the ideal $\epsilon^{r_\chi(s_0)} \mathcal{A}_N$. Its basis consists of the powers $\epsilon^{r_\chi}, \dots, \epsilon^N$ when $r_\chi \leq N$, and it is zero otherwise. This proves both dimensions. Anchoring and reflection remove entire character blocks, so the same calculation applies to each retained block. $\square$

Comparing Taylor coefficients of a weighted distribution identity gives the corresponding stacked finite-jet system. If one identifies the coefficient at order j with $\epsilon^{N-j}[x]$, its relation space is the $\mathcal{A}_N$ -span above; factorial normalizations merely rescale coordinates. Thus freeness also gives the rank of the complete simultaneous jet system, rather than just its successive highest layers.

Proposition 9.12 (Multiplicity of nonzero resonances). *Resonances occur only on $\operatorname{Re} s_0 = 0$. For $s_0 \neq 0$, each $r_\chi(s_0)$ is at most one. Multiple resonant primes in a single character block can occur only at $s_0 = 0$.*

Proof. Taking absolute values in $p^{s_0} = \chi^*(p)$ gives $\operatorname{Re} s_0 = 0$. Write $s_0 = it$, with $t \neq 0$. Because every character value is a root of unity, resonance at p implies $t \log p / (2\pi) \in \mathbb{Q}$. This rational number is nonzero. If distinct primes p and ℓ both resonate, then $\log p / \log \ell \in \mathbb{Q}$. Writing this positive rational as a/b would give $p^b = \ell^a$ for positive integers a, b , contradicting unique factorization. $\square$

For a concrete origin resonance, take $q = 14$ and let χ^* be the quadratic character modulo 7. Its conductor is 7, its parity is odd, and $\chi^*(2) = 1$. Then

$$Y_{14,\chi}(s) = (2^s - 1)Y_{7,\chi}(s). \quad (9.26)$$

At $s = 0$, the top-denominator coordinate vanishes although the conductor direction persists. For any analytic realization of this relation,

$$\begin{aligned} Y'_{14,\chi}(0) &= \log 2 Y_{7,\chi}(0), \\ Y''_{14,\chi}(0) &= 2 \log 2 Y'_{7,\chi}(0) + (\log 2)^2 Y_{7,\chi}(0). \end{aligned} \quad (9.27)$$

Thus recovering the first conductor derivative from these top-denominator data requires the second top-denominator jet. The actual realization

$$Y_{d,\chi}(s) = \sum_{a \in U(d)} \chi_d(a) \zeta(s, a/d) = d^s L(s, \chi_d)$$

obeys the same identity. This example concerns an imprimitive Euler factor; it is distinct from the trivial-zero regularization of the primitive L -function in the next section.

9.4 Primitive-grid determinants, local defects and finite descent

The polynomial character normal form above remains valid over arbitrary complex coefficient algebras. Here identify the prime weights A_p with t_p , write $\mathcal{D}_q$ for that quotient, and put $v_{m,\chi} = Y_{m,\chi}$, $b_\chi = Y_{f,\chi}$ for $f = \operatorname{cond}(\chi)$. The coefficient $E_{m,\chi}$ is $A_{m,\chi}$ of Theorem 9.6. Thus

$$[v_{m,\chi}] = E_{m,\chi} b_\chi. \quad (9.28)$$

No Euler-factor division is used. Let $U_q = \{u \bmod q : (u, q) = 1\}$, and use $r = 0$ for the Hurwitz endpoint $x_r = 1$. Distinguish the rank of the full quotient from the image of its primitive-grid coordinate map.

Conductor coordinates are polynomial and globally valid, but it is often more convenient to use the $\varphi(q)$ primitive-grid points $e_{u/q}$, $u \in U_q$. Fourier-transforming those points gives $v_{q,\chi}$. By Theorem 9.6, the map from their formal span into $\mathcal{D}_q$ is diagonal in character coordinates:

$$v_{q,\chi} \mapsto E_{q,\chi} b_\chi. \quad (9.29)$$

Its determinant in these specified Fourier and conductor bases is $\Delta_q = \prod_{\chi \bmod q} E_{q,\chi}$.

For $p^e \parallel q$, write

$$M_p = q/p^e, \quad h_p = \operatorname{ord}_{M_p}(p),$$

with $h_p = 1$ when $M_p = 1$.

Theorem 9.13 (Determinant factorization). *One has the polynomial identity*

$$\Delta_q(\mathbf{A}) = \prod_{p^e \parallel q} A_p^{\varphi(M_p)(p^{e-1}-1)} (A_p^{h_p} - 1)^{\varphi(M_p)/h_p}. \quad (9.30)$$

Thus primitive-grid coordinates form a basis precisely when all the factors in (9.30) are invertible in a field specialization. Their failure does not change the rank of $\mathcal{D}_q$.

Proof. Fix $p^e \parallel q$ and inspect the p factor of $\prod_{\chi} E_{q,\chi}$. Characters whose conductor is not divisible by p are exactly the characters of U_{M_p} . Their additional factors are $A_p - \chi(p)$. In the character group of U_{M_p} , the values $\chi(p)$ run through every h_p th root of unity with multiplicity $\varphi(M_p)/h_p$. This follows by duality from the fact that p has order h_p in U_{M_p} . Their product is therefore $(A_p^{h_p} - 1)^{\varphi(M_p)/h_p}$.

It remains to count the pure powers of A_p . If $a = v_p(f)$, the exponent contributed by one character is $e - \max(1, a)$. Writing this as a sum of indicators gives

$$\sum_{\chi \bmod q} (e - \max(1, v_p(f_\chi))) = \sum_{j=1}^{e-1} \#\{\chi : v_p(f_\chi) \leq j\}.$$

The count in the last sum is $\varphi(p^j)\varphi(M_p)$, since these are exactly the characters induced from level $p^j M_p$. Hence the exponent is $\varphi(M_p) \sum_{j=1}^{e-1} \varphi(p^j) = \varphi(M_p)(p^{e-1} - 1)$. Multiply over the primes. $\square$

Example 9.14 (Level twelve). Let χ_3 and χ_4 be the nonprincipal quadratic characters of conductors three and four, and let $\chi_{12} = \chi_3\chi_4$. Their conductor generators are

$$\begin{aligned} b_3 &= e_{1/3} - e_{2/3}, & b_4 &= e_{1/4} - e_{3/4}, \\ b_{12} &= e_{1/12} - e_{5/12} - e_{7/12} + e_{11/12}. \end{aligned}$$

For $r \in U_{12}$, the normal form reads

$$\begin{aligned} [e_{r/12}] &= \frac{1}{4} [A_2(A_2 - 1)(A_3 - 1)e_0 + \chi_3(r)A_2(A_2 + 1)b_3 \\ &\quad + \chi_4(r)(A_3 + 1)b_4 + \chi_{12}(r)b_{12}]. \end{aligned} \quad (9.31)$$

Consequently

$$\Delta_{12} = A_2^2(A_2^2 - 1)(A_3^2 - 1).$$

At $A_2 = A_3 = 1$, the primitive-grid span misses the principal conductor coordinate, even though the full quotient still has rank four.

9.4.1 Local jet defects of the primitive-grid map

Specialize to $A_p(s) = p^s$, and let $s = s_0 + t$. All exponential factors are nonzero. A factor $p^s - \chi(p)$ vanishes precisely when $p^{s_0} = \chi(p)$, and any such zero is simple because its derivative is $p^{s_0} \log p \neq 0$.

Theorem 9.15 (Local Smith factors and primitive-jet ranks). *Define*

$$\rho_\chi(s_0) = \#\{p \mid q : p \nmid f_\chi, p^{s_0} = \chi(p)\}. \quad (9.32)$$

Over $\mathbb{C}[[t]]$, the diagonal factors of the primitive-grid map are units times $t^{\rho_\chi(s_0)}$. Consequently its rank on order- N truncated jets, as a complex linear map, is

$$\sum_{\chi \bmod q} \max\{N + 1 - \rho_\chi(s_0), 0\}. \quad (9.33)$$

At $s_0 = 0$, this is determined by $\rho_\chi(0) = \#\{p \mid q : p \nmid f_\chi, \chi(p) = 1\}$.

Proof. Factor $E_{q,\chi}(s_0 + t)$ into its simple vanishing factors and a unit. The primitive Fourier matrix is constant and invertible, so these are also the local invariant factors, up to permutation and units. Multiplication by t^r on $\mathbb{C}[t]/(t^{N+1})$ has rank $\max(N + 1 - r, 0)$. Summing over the diagonal coordinates proves the formula. This is the rank of a *coordinate inclusion map*, not the rank of the distribution relation matrix. $\square$

Corollary 9.16 (Multiple-prime resonances are central). *If $s_0 \neq 0$, at most one prime can satisfy $p^{s_0 h_p} = 1$. At a nonzero resonant point for that prime p , the primitive-grid rank defect is $\varphi(M_p)/h_p$, and every affected local factor has order one. The order- N inclusion rank is then $(N + 1)\varphi(q) - \varphi(M_p)/h_p$ for all $N \geq 0$.*

Proof. A resonance forces s_0 to be purely imaginary. Resonances at distinct primes would make $\log p / \log \ell$ rational, because each phase is a rational multiple of 2π . Unique prime factorization rules this out unless $s_0 = 0$. For the one resonant prime, the multiplicity count in Theorem 9.13 gives the number of affected characters. Apply Theorem 9.15. $\square$

Example 9.17 (Two exact jet-rank profiles). At level 12 and $s_0 = 0$, the principal character has $\rho = 2$ and the other three characters have $\rho = 0$. For $N = 0, 1, 2$, the primitive-jet ranks are 3, 6, 10, while the full quotient dimensions are 4, 8, 12. At level 21, the principal character has $\rho = 2$, the character induced from conductor three has $\rho = 1$, and the other ten characters have $\rho = 0$. The inclusion ranks are 10, 21, 33, compared with full quotient dimensions 12, 24, 36. Indeed,

$$\Delta_{21} = (A_3^6 - 1)(A_7 - 1)^2.$$

Exact character-phase certificates for these examples are supplied.

9.5 Explicit primitive-grid reduction coefficients

Away from the exceptional locus, the conductor normal form can be inverted to express all grid points through the primitive ones. For Hurwitz weights there is a particularly concrete answer that avoids character-field arithmetic.

Let $\mathcal{S}_q$ be the multiplicative semigroup of positive integers whose prime factors divide q , including 1. For $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$, define

$$C_{r,u}(s) = \sum_{\substack{d \in \mathcal{S}_q \\ du \equiv r \pmod{q}}} d^{-s}, \quad 0 \leq r < q, \quad u \in U_q. \quad (9.34)$$

The series is absolutely convergent, since $\sum_{d \in \mathcal{S}_q} d^{-\sigma} = \prod_{p|q} (1 - p^{-\sigma})^{-1}$ for $\sigma > 0$.

Theorem 9.18 (Primitive-grid extension). *For $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$, the $q \times \varphi(q)$ matrix $C(s)$ satisfies every prime and divisor distribution relation with weights p^s , and its primitive rows form the identity matrix. It is the unique extension matrix from primitive-grid data. In particular,*

$$\zeta(s, r/q) = \sum_{u \in U_q} C_{r,u}(s) \zeta(s, u/q) \quad (9.35)$$

with the endpoint convention for $r = 0$, initially for $\operatorname{Re} s > 1$ and then meromorphically wherever the coefficients are defined.

Proof. For a primitive row r , the congruence $du \equiv r \pmod{q}$ forces d to be prime to q , hence $d = 1$. This gives the identity submatrix. For a prime distribution row indexed by $a \equiv 0 \pmod{p}$,

$$\sum_{pr \equiv a \pmod{q}} C_{r,u}(s) = \sum_{\substack{d \in \mathcal{S}_q \\ pdu \equiv a \pmod{q}}} d^{-s} = p^s \sum_{\substack{d' \in \mathcal{S}_q \\ d'u \equiv a \pmod{q}}} (d')^{-s}.$$

In the last step $d' = pd$; conversely every d' in the last sum is divisible by p , because u is a unit and a is divisible by p . The last expression is $p^s C_{a,u}(s)$. Prime sufficiency gives all divisor rows. Theorem 9.6 and the identity submatrix show that these $\varphi(q)$ independent columns exhaust the solution space. Hurwitz zeta satisfies the same distribution equations by regrouping its absolutely convergent defining series, proving (9.35). $\square$

9.5.1 A finite formula, including negative spectral parameters

For $0 \leq r < q$, let

$$g = \gcd(r, q), \quad m = q/g, \quad a = r/g, \quad P_r = \{p \mid q : p \nmid m\}.$$

When $r = 0$, this means $g = q$, $m = 1$, $a = 0$. For $p \in P_r$, put $h_{p,m} = \text{ord}_m(p)$, with order one modulo one.

Theorem 9.19 (Finite residue formula). *The meromorphic continuation of (9.34) is*

$$C_{r,u}(s) = g^{-s} \frac{\sum_{\substack{0 \leq b_p < h_{p,m} \\ p \in P_r}} \prod_{p \in P_r} p^{-sb_p}}{\prod_{p \in P_r} (1 - p^{-sh_{p,m}})} \cdot \prod_{p \in P_r} p^{b_p \equiv a \pmod{m}}. \quad (9.36)$$

Empty products have their usual value one. In particular,

$$C_{0,u}(s) = q^{-s} \prod_{p|q} (1 - p^{-s})^{-1}, \quad (9.37)$$

independently of u .

Proof. The congruence in (9.34) forces the valuation of d at an unsaturated prime, one dividing m , to be exactly $v_p(g)$. At a saturated prime, one not dividing m , it is at least $v_p(g)$. Thus $d = g \prod_{p \in P_r} p^{c_p}$ with $c_p \geq 0$, and the remaining congruence is $u \prod p^{c_p} \equiv a \pmod{m}$. Write $c_p = b_p + h_{p,m} j_p$ and sum the independent geometric series in j_p . This proves the formula in $\text{Re } s > 0$ and hence its meromorphic continuation. The endpoint has trivial congruence modulo one. $\square$

Formula (9.36), not the divergent smooth-number series, is the definition used at negative real s . It has no pole at any nonzero real s , and the continued distribution identities remain valid there. At a zero of a displayed denominator, one should use the polynomial conductor normal form rather than cancel poles numerically. Some individual coefficients may have removable singularities, but Theorem 9.13 gives the criterion for the entire primitive-grid coordinate system.

Corollary 9.20 (Exact support and signs). *Let H_r be the subgroup of U_m generated by the classes of the primes in P_r . For every nonzero real s ,*

$$C_{r,u}(s) \neq 0 \iff au^{-1} \in H_r.$$

The number of supported primitive coordinates is

$$\frac{\varphi(q)}{\varphi(m)} |H_r|. \quad (9.38)$$

All supported coefficients are positive for $s > 0$. For $s < 0$, they all have sign $(-1)^{|P_r|}$.

Proof. The numerator of (9.36) is a sum of positive real terms and is nonempty exactly under the subgroup condition. The reduction map $U_q \rightarrow U_m$ has fibers of cardinality $\varphi(q)/\varphi(m)$, giving (9.38). For $s > 0$ every denominator factor is positive. For $s < 0$ each of the $|P_r|$ denominator factors is negative, while the numerator and g^{-s} are positive. $\square$

Corollary 9.21 (Complete monotonicity and normalization). *For $s > 0$ and $j \geq 0$, put*

$$W_{r,u}^{[j]}(s) = (-1)^j \frac{d^j}{ds^j} C_{r,u}(s) = \sum_{\substack{d \in \mathcal{S}_q \\ du \equiv r \pmod{q}}} \frac{(\log d)^j}{d^s}. \quad (9.39)$$

These quantities are nonnegative. Moreover, $\sum_u C_{r,u}(1) = 1$ for every r , and $0 \leq C_{r,u}(k) \leq 1$ for integer $k \geq 1$.

Proof. The logarithmically weighted semigroup series converges locally uniformly in $\operatorname{Re} s > 0$, so termwise differentiation is valid. The constant grid vector satisfies the distribution equations at $s = 1$, and its primitive entries are all one. Uniqueness of extension proves the row-sum identity. Monotonicity gives $C_{r,u}(k) \leq C_{r,u}(1) \leq 1$. $\square$

Example 9.22 (Two reductions at denominator six). The nontrivial coefficients for $r = 2$ are

$$C_{2,1}(s) = \frac{2^s}{2^{2s} - 1}, \quad C_{2,5}(s) = \frac{1}{2^{2s} - 1}.$$

Thus, meromorphically,

$$\zeta(s, 1/3) = \frac{2^s \zeta(s, 1/6) + \zeta(s, 5/6)}{2^{2s} - 1}, \quad (9.40)$$

$$\zeta(s, 1/2) = \frac{\zeta(s, 1/6) + \zeta(s, 5/6)}{3^s - 1}. \quad (9.41)$$

At $s = 1$, the coefficients in (9.40) are $2/3$ and $1/3$. At $s = -1$ they are $-2/3$ and $-4/3$, illustrating the sign theorem without using a divergent series. The poles at $s = 0$ reflect a singular primitive basis, not a failure of the underlying distribution relations.

9.5.2 Denominator certificates and construction cost

Let M_p also denote, in this paragraph only, the pushforward matrix on grid vectors defined by

$$(M_p f)_r = \sum_{pu \equiv r \pmod{q}} f_u.$$

To avoid confusion with the integer complement in Section 9.4, write that complement as $q_p = q/p^e$ here and put $h_p = \operatorname{ord}_{q_p}(p)$. Multiplication of residues gives $M_p^{e+h_p} = M_p^e$. For $z = p^{-s}$,

$$(I - zM_p)^{-1} = \sum_{j=0}^{e-1} z^j M_p^j + \frac{z^e}{1 - z^{h_p}} \sum_{j=0}^{h_p-1} z^j M_p^{e+j}. \quad (9.42)$$

This follows first from a geometric series for $|z| < 1$, then as a rational matrix identity. The commuting product of these inverses, applied to vectors supported on U_q , is the extension $C(s)$.

Proposition 9.23 (A uniform rational denominator). *For integer $k \geq 1$, every reduced denominator of $C_{r,u}(k)$ divides*

$$D_q(k) = \prod_{p^e \parallel q} p^{k(e-1)}(p^{kh_p} - 1). \quad (9.43)$$

Its bit length is $O(kq \log q)$. The coefficients of the raw derivative $C_{r,u}^{(j)}(k)$, viewed as a polynomial in the symbols $\log p$, have denominators dividing $D_q(k)^{j+1}$.

Proof. Every scalar coefficient on the right of (9.42) has denominator dividing $p^{k(e-1)}(p^{kh_p} - 1)$. Multiplication over primes proves the first claim. Since $h_p \leq q$ and $\sum_{p|q} \log p \leq \log q$, its logarithm is at most a constant times $kq \log q$. The matrix product can be written as a ratio of integer polynomials in p^s , with denominator obtained from (9.43) by replacing k with s . Repeated differentiation introduces polynomial factors in $\log p$ and raises the denominator power by at most one each time. For normalized Taylor coefficients, an additional factor $j!$ may be needed. $\square$

The implementation computes (9.36) by convolution on residue classes modulo m , separately for each $m \mid q$. At a fixed m , each prime update takes at most $\varphi(m)^2$ rational arithmetic operations. A complete matrix can therefore be constructed in

$$O\left(\omega(q) \sum_{m|q} \varphi(m)^2 + q\varphi(q)\right) = O(\omega(q)q^2)$$

rational arithmetic operations, using $\sum_{m|q} \varphi(m) = q$. This is an arithmetic-operation bound, not a constant-cost bit model or a claim of optimality. The denominator estimate supplies a conservative size control at positive integer orders.

9.6 All-orders Hurwitz–Stieltjes identities

Write the Laurent expansion as

$$\zeta(1+t, x) = \frac{1}{t} + \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n(x) t^n, \quad x > 0. \quad (9.44)$$

Here $\gamma_n^{(k)}$ always means k derivatives in x ; a derivative on $C(s)$ is in the spectral variable. The coefficient identities in this section are analytic theorems, distinct from formal rank claims.

Theorem 9.24 (Derived Stieltjes reduction). *For $k \geq 1$, $n \geq 0$, and $x_r = r/q$ with the endpoint convention,*

$$\gamma_n^{(k)}(x_r) = \sum_{u \in U_q} \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} W_{r,u}^{[j]}(k+1) \gamma_{n-j}^{(k)}(u/q). \quad (9.45)$$

All the coefficient functions are given by the finite formula (9.36) and its derivatives.

Proof. Differentiating Hurwitz zeta in its parameter yields

$$\partial_x^k \zeta(1+t, x) = (-1)^k (1+t)_k \zeta(k+1+t, x).$$

The pole in (9.44) is independent of x , so for $k \geq 1$ the left side is $\sum_n (-1)^n \gamma_n^{(k)}(x) t^n / n!$. Apply (9.35) at spectral parameter $k + 1 + t$ and multiply by the common scalar $(-1)^k (1 + t)_k$. Taylor multiplication gives (9.45), because $(-1)^j C_{r,u}^{(j)} = W_{r,u}^{[j]}$. $\square$

This proof also explains why the harmonic-number master identity in Chapter 8 is compatible with the same reduction matrix at every Stieltjes order: the rising factorial is common to every rational argument. It does not create new independent distribution coordinates.

Theorem 9.25 (Underived Stieltjes reduction, with the pole term). *For $n \geq 0$,*

$$\gamma_n(x_r) = \sum_{u \in U_q} \sum_{j=0}^n \binom{n}{j} W_{r,u}^{[j]}(1) \gamma_{n-j}(u/q) - \frac{1}{n+1} \sum_{u \in U_q} W_{r,u}^{[n+1]}(1). \quad (9.46)$$

Proof. Apply (9.35) at $s = 1 + t$. The coefficients are analytic there. Multiplying their Taylor expansions by (9.44), the coefficient of t^n receives the usual product terms and also $\sum_u C_{r,u}^{(n+1)}(1)/(n+1)!$ from the pole $1/t$. Multiplication by $(-1)^n n!$ converts that additional term to the negative last term of (9.46). The coefficient of $1/t$ agrees because $\sum_u C_{r,u}(1) = 1$. $\square$

Omitting the last term would already give an incorrect formula for γ_0 . The point is not a rank correction: a known scalar right side does not change a homogeneous rank. It is a correction to the actual analytic value identity.

Example 9.26 (An explicit first-order identity). From (9.40), direct differentiation at $s = 1$ gives

$$W_{2,1}^{[1]}(1) = \frac{10}{9} \log 2, \quad W_{2,5}^{[1]}(1) = \frac{8}{9} \log 2.$$

Consequently

$$\gamma_0(1/3) = \frac{2}{3} \gamma_0(1/6) + \frac{1}{3} \gamma_0(5/6) - 2 \log 2. \quad (9.47)$$

At $s = 2$, the analogous coefficients give

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma_1'(1/3) &= \frac{4}{15} \gamma_1'(1/6) + \frac{1}{15} \gamma_1'(5/6) \\ &\quad + \frac{68 \log 2}{225} \gamma_0'(1/6) + \frac{32 \log 2}{225} \gamma_0'(5/6). \end{aligned} \quad (9.48)$$

Since $\gamma_0' = -\psi'$, the signs can also be checked against the parameter-differentiated digamma multiplication identity. The verification program checks (9.46) through $n = 2$ and (9.48) by numerical parameter differentiation of Stieltjes functions.

9.7 Finite conductor descent for all Stieltjes layers

For a primitive character χ of conductor $f \mid d$, define

$$G_{d,\chi}^{(n,k)} = \sum_{a \in \mathcal{U}_d} \chi(a) \gamma_n^{(k)}(a/d). \quad (9.49)$$

Set

$$R(d, f) = \prod_{\substack{p \mid d \\ p \nmid f}} p, \quad m_r = \frac{d}{f r} \quad (r \mid R(d, f)). \quad (9.50)$$

Each m_r is a positive integer. Upon substituting $t_p = p^s$, (9.11) becomes the entire exponential polynomial

$$\begin{aligned} A_{d,f,\chi}(s) &= \left(\frac{d}{f}\right)^s \prod_{\substack{p|d \\ p \nmid f}} (1 - \chi(p)p^{-s}) \\ &= \sum_{r|R(d,f)} \mu(r)\chi(r)m_r^s. \end{aligned} \quad (9.51)$$

In particular,

$$A_{d,f,\chi}^{(j)}(s) = \sum_{r|R(d,f)} \mu(r)\chi(r)m_r^s \log^j m_r. \quad (9.52)$$

Theorem 9.27 (All-index, all-parameter-order descent). *For $n \geq 0$, $k \geq 1$ and $f \mid d$,*

$$\begin{aligned} G_{d,\chi}^{(n,k)} &= \sum_{r|R(d,f)} \mu(r)\chi(r)m_r^{k+1} \\ &\quad \cdot \sum_{j=0}^n (-1)^j \binom{n}{j} \log^j m_r G_{f,\chi}^{(n-j,k)}. \end{aligned} \quad (9.53)$$

No Euler-factor denominator occurs. Equivalently,

$$G_{d,\chi}^{(n,k)} = \sum_{j=0}^n (-1)^j \binom{n}{j} A_{d,f,\chi}^{(j)}(k+1) G_{f,\chi}^{(n-j,k)}. \quad (9.54)$$

Proof. For $\text{Re } s > 1$, sorting a Dirichlet series by residue classes gives

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{U}_d} \chi(a)\zeta(s, a/d) = d^s L(s, \chi_d),$$

where χ_d is the induced character modulo d . Removing the extra Euler factors from its primitive L -series yields

$$L(s, \chi_d) = L(s, \chi) \prod_{\substack{p|d \\ p \nmid f}} (1 - \chi(p)p^{-s}).$$

Thus the character sum at d is $A_{d,f,\chi}(s)$ times the character sum at f . This is also the analytic realization of Theorem 9.6.

Insert $s = k + 1 + \varepsilon$, multiply by the common factor $(-1)^k(1 + \varepsilon)_k$, and use (9.1). Comparison of $(-1)^n \varepsilon^n / n!$ gives (9.54); the sign $(-1)^j$ comes from the Stieltjes Laurent convention. Finally apply (9.52). $\square$

9.7.1 Concrete second-index identities at level twelve

The multipliers are

$$A_{12,3,\chi_3}(s) = 4^s + 2^s, \quad A_{12,4,\chi_4}(s) = 3^s + 1.$$

Therefore, at $n = 2$, $k = 1$,

$$G_{12,\chi_3}^{(2,1)} = 20G_{3,\chi_3}^{(2,1)} - 72 \log 2 G_{3,\chi_3}^{(1,1)} + 68 \log^2 2 G_{3,\chi_3}^{(0,1)}, \quad (9.55)$$

$$G_{12,\chi_4}^{(2,1)} = 10G_{4,\chi_4}^{(2,1)} - 18 \log 3 G_{4,\chi_4}^{(1,1)} + 9 \log^2 3 G_{4,\chi_4}^{(0,1)}. \quad (9.56)$$

For instance,

$$G_{12,\chi_3}^{(2,1)} = \gamma'_2(1/12) - \gamma'_2(5/12) + \gamma'_2(7/12) - \gamma'_2(11/12),$$

and $G_{3,\chi_3}^{(2,1)} = \gamma'_2(1/3) - \gamma'_2(2/3)$. These are exact identities between explicitly specified signed sums; they require no integer-relation search. The two identities were also checked numerically using independent finite Hurwitz character sums.

9.7.2 The undifferentiated layer and its pole correction

For $k = 0$, a principal character sum still contains the Hurwitz pole. The same formula without a correction would be wrong.

Proposition 9.28 (The $k = 0$ correction). *For nonprincipal primitive χ the formula (9.54) remains valid with $k = 0$. For $f = 1$, put $A_d(s) = A_{d,1,1}(s)$. Then*

$$G_{d,1}^{(n,0)} = \sum_{j=0}^n (-1)^j \binom{n}{j} A_d^{(j)}(1) \gamma_{n-j}(1) + \frac{(-1)^n}{n+1} A_d^{(n+1)}(1). \quad (9.57)$$

Proof. For a nonprincipal character, the sum of its values over units is zero, so the $1/\varepsilon$ residues cancel. Coefficient comparison is unchanged. For the principal conductor, multiply

$$A_d(1 + \varepsilon) \left(\frac{1}{\varepsilon} + \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n \gamma_n(1)}{n!} \varepsilon^n \right).$$

The pole term contributes $A_d^{(n+1)}(1)/(n+1)!$ to the coefficient of ε^n . Multiplying by $(-1)^n n!$ gives the correction in (9.57). The residue itself is $A_d(1) = d \prod_{p|d} (1 - p^{-1}) = \varphi(d)$, as required. $\square$

For the non-character multiplication formula this specializes to

$$\sum_{j=0}^{d-1} \gamma_n \left(\frac{a+j}{d} \right) = d \sum_{r=0}^n \binom{n}{r} (-\log d)^r \gamma_{n-r}(a) + \frac{(-1)^n d \log^{n+1} d}{n+1}. \quad (9.58)$$

The inhomogeneous term is the residue contribution, not an optional normalization.

9.8 Cyclotomic polylogarithm traces

The same finite module applies to a second evaluation. Put $\zeta_m = \exp(2\pi i/m)$ and evaluate $e_x \mapsto \text{Li}_s(e^{2\pi i x})$. For $\text{Re } s > 1$, grouping the defining series by multiples of p gives

$$\sum_{py=x} \text{Li}_s(e^{2\pi i y}) = p^{1-s} \text{Li}_s(e^{2\pi i x}).$$

Thus the weights are now $A_p = p^{1-s}$, and analytic continuation extends the identity wherever the individual expressions are defined.

For a primitive character χ of conductor $f \mid q$, define

$$\mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}(s) = \sum_{u \in U_q} \chi(u) \text{Li}_s(\zeta_q^u), \quad \tau(\chi) = \sum_{a \in U_f} \chi(a) \zeta_f^a. \quad (9.59)$$

At conductor one take $\tau(\mathbf{1}) = 1$ and $L(s, \mathbf{1}) = \zeta(s)$.

Theorem 9.29 (Conductor-lifted trace identity). *As a meromorphic identity, and with removable singularities interpreted by continuation,*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}(s) = (q/f)^{1-s} \prod_{\substack{p|q \\ p \nmid f}} (1 - \chi(p)p^{s-1}) \tau(\chi) L(s, \bar{\chi}).} \quad (9.60)$$

For every $q > 1$, the left side is an entire function of the spectral variable s .

Proof. At primitive conductor $f > 1$, absolute convergence and the primitive Gauss-sum identity give

$$\sum_{a \in U_f} \chi(a) \text{Li}_s(\zeta_f^a) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{\sum_a \chi(a) \zeta_f^{an}}{n^s} = \tau(\chi) L(s, \bar{\chi}).$$

The Gauss-sum convention, including the complex conjugate on χ , is the one in [76]. Applying (9.28) with $A_p = p^{1-s}$ multiplies this primitive trace by $E_{q,\chi}$. Extracting p^{1-s} from each first-appearance factor gives precisely the factor in (9.60). The conductor-one case follows directly from $\text{Li}_s(1) = \zeta(s)$ and the same polynomial identity.

For completeness, when $z = \zeta_q^u \neq 1$, regrouping by residues gives

$$\text{Li}_s(z) = q^{-s} \sum_{a=1}^q z^a \zeta(s, a/q). \quad (9.61)$$

Hurwitz zeta has only its simple pole at $s = 1$, whose coefficient in this finite sum is $\sum_a z^a = 0$. Hence $\text{Li}_s(z)$ is entire in s . All arguments in the primitive level- q trace differ from one. $\square$

Remark 9.30 (The character phase is consequential). For the order-four character modulo five with $\chi(2) = i$, the level-ten lifting factor is $2^{1-s} - i$, not $2^{1-s} + i$. A complex-character numerical check is included to catch an accidental interchange of χ and $\bar{\chi}$. Real quadratic examples alone would not detect that error.

9.8.1 Exact nonprincipal vanishing orders

For a nonprincipal primitive χ , set

$$\rho_\chi = \#\{p \mid q : p \nmid f, \chi(p) = 1\}.$$

These are the same conductor statistics that controlled the primitive-grid jet defects at Hurwitz order zero.

Theorem 9.31 (Character trace zeros at order one). *The entire function $\mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}(s)$ has a zero of exact order ρ_χ at $s = 1$, where order zero means a nonzero value. All lower derivatives vanish, and*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}^{(\rho_\chi)}(1) &= (-1)^{\rho_\chi} \rho_\chi! \tau(\chi) L(1, \bar{\chi}) \\ &\times \prod_{\substack{p|q, p \nmid f \\ \chi(p)=1}} \log p \prod_{\substack{p|q, p \nmid f \\ \chi(p) \neq 1}} (1 - \chi(p)). \end{aligned} \quad (9.62)$$

Proof. Each factor with $\chi(p) = 1$ in (9.60) is $1 - p^{s-1} = -(s-1) \log p + O((s-1)^2)$. All other displayed factors are nonzero at $s = 1$. A primitive Gauss sum is nonzero, and Dirichlet's nonvanishing theorem states $L(1, \bar{\chi}) \neq 0$ for nonprincipal characters [76, Eq. 25.15.9]. Thus there is no additional zero. Taking the first nonzero Taylor coefficient proves the formula. $\square$

Increasing the exponents of primes already present in q changes higher Taylor coefficients but not this first nonzero derivative: $(q/f)^{1-s}$ equals one at $s = 1$. This invariance provides an additional family of identities between traces at different levels.

9.8.2 The principal trace and its pole cancellation

Write $\mathcal{P}_q = \mathcal{P}_{q,1}$ and define

$$r = \omega(q), \quad P = \prod_{p|q} \log p, \quad B = \log q - \frac{1}{2} \log \text{rad}(q).$$

The conductor-one factor contains a pole, so the vanishing order is one less than the number of primes, not equal to that number.

Theorem 9.32 (Principal trace jet generator). *In a neighborhood of $t = 0$,*

$$\boxed{\mathcal{P}_q(1+t) = (-1)^r P t^{r-1} e^{-Bt} [t\zeta(1+t)] \prod_{p|q} \frac{\sinh(t \log p/2)}{t \log p/2}.} \quad (9.63)$$

In particular its zero at $s = 1$ has exact order $r - 1$, and

$$\mathcal{P}_q^{(j)}(1) = 0 \quad (0 \leq j < r - 1), \quad (9.64)$$

$$\mathcal{P}_q^{(r-1)}(1) = (-1)^r (r-1)! P, \quad (9.65)$$

$$\mathcal{P}_q^{(r)}(1) = (-1)^r r! P(\gamma - B), \quad (9.66)$$

$$\mathcal{P}_q^{(r+1)}(1) = (-1)^r (r+1)! P \left[-\gamma_1 - B\gamma + \frac{B^2}{2} + \frac{1}{24} \sum_{p|q} (\log p)^2 \right]. \quad (9.67)$$

Here γ_1 is the ordinary first Stieltjes constant in (9.44).

Proof. The principal case of (9.60) is

$$\mathcal{P}_q(1+t) = q^{-t} \prod_{p|q} (1-p^t) \zeta(1+t).$$

Use $1 - e^x = -xe^{x/2} \sinh(x/2)/(x/2)$ in every factor. This proves (9.63). The factors in square brackets and in the hyperbolic-sine product are analytic and equal to one at zero. Expanding them gives

$$t\zeta(1+t) = 1 + \gamma t - \gamma_1 t^2 + O(t^3), \quad \prod_p \frac{\sinh(t \log p/2)}{t \log p/2} = 1 + \frac{t^2}{24} \sum_p (\log p)^2 + O(t^4).$$

Multiplication by e^{-Bt} gives all the displayed derivatives. □

9.8.3 Concrete exact identities

The following examples are proved consequences of the preceding theorems, not integer-relation conjectures. The derivatives are in the *order* of the polylogarithm, not its argument.

At level thirty,

$$\sum_{u \in U_{30}} \text{Li}_1(\zeta_{30}^u) = 0, \quad (9.68)$$

$$\sum_{u \in U_{30}} \partial_s^1 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{30}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = 0, \quad (9.69)$$

$$\sum_{u \in U_{30}} \partial_s^2 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{30}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = \boxed{-2 \log 2 \log 3 \log 5}. \quad (9.70)$$

The third derivative of this trace is $-6 \log 2 \log 3 \log 5 [\gamma - \frac{1}{2} \log 30]$. At level 210, derivatives of orders zero, one, and two vanish, while

$$\sum_{u \in U_{210}} \partial_s^3 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{210}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = 6 \log 2 \log 3 \log 5 \log 7. \quad (9.71)$$

For the quadratic character χ_3 with $\chi_3(1) = 1$ and $\chi_3(2) = -1$, the primitive trace at order one is $\tau(\chi_3)L(1, \chi_3) = i\pi/3$. Since $\chi_3(7) = \chi_3(13) = 1$, one obtains

$$\sum_{u \in U_{21}} \chi_3(u) \partial_s^1 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{21}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = -\frac{i\pi}{3} \log 7, \quad (9.72)$$

$$\sum_{u \in U_{273}} \chi_3(u) \partial_s^2 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{273}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = \frac{2i\pi}{3} \log 7 \log 13. \quad (9.73)$$

In the first equation the order-zero trace vanishes; in the second, both order-zero and first-order traces vanish. Likewise the character χ_4 gives

$$\sum_{u \in U_{20}} \chi_4(u) \partial_s^1 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{20}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = -\frac{i\pi}{2} \log 5. \quad (9.74)$$

These primitive trace constants follow directly from $\text{Li}_1(z) = -\log(1-z)$ with the values continued from inside the unit disk, so the signs do not depend on an unspecified logarithm branch.

For the real quadratic character χ_5 , positive on residues 1, 4 and negative on 2, 3, let $\phi = (1 + \sqrt{5})/2$. Pairing conjugates in the primitive trace gives

$$\mathcal{P}_{5, \chi_5}(1) = 2 \log \frac{\sin(2\pi/5)}{\sin(\pi/5)} = 2 \log \phi.$$

As $\chi_5(11) = 1$,

$$\sum_{u \in U_{55}} \chi_5(u) \partial_s^1 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{55}^u) \Big|_{s=1} = -2 \log \phi \log 11. \quad (9.75)$$

This derivation needs no numerical integer-relation search or unproved independence statement about logarithms.

9.8.4 A stable independent formula for numerical checks

Differentiation of (9.61) at its cancelled pole gives, for $z = \zeta_q^u \neq 1$,

$$\partial_s^k \text{Li}_s(z) \Big|_{s=1} = \frac{(-1)^k}{q} \sum_{a=1}^q z^a \sum_{j=0}^k \binom{k}{j} (\log q)^{k-j} \gamma_j(a/q). \quad (9.76)$$

There is no pole term, because its complete Fourier coefficient vanishes identically. This supplies a finite Stieltjes-coordinate evaluator for the trace identities, independently of their Euler-factor right sides. In development, direct tiny-step numerical differentiation of a polylogarithm routine near integral order gave an unreliable trace derivative; the pole-cancelled formula avoids that cancellation problem. This observation is an implementation diagnostic, not a claimed theorem about all versions of a library.

9.8.5 A level-260 specialization and convention reconciliation

We use the unbarred weight $\chi(a)$ in $\mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}$. An alternative convention weights the trace by $\bar{\chi}(a)$; it conjugates the character factors and interchanges the primitive L -character. All formulas here use the first convention. The following exact specialization adds two primes with character value one.

Let χ be primitive of conductor $f > 1$, and $f \mid q$. Among the added primes, define

$$\mathcal{S} = \{p \mid q : p \nmid f, \chi(p) = 1\}, \quad r_\chi = |\mathcal{S}|.$$

The remaining added primes form $\mathcal{N}$.

Theorem 9.33 (Twisted leading jet). *The trace $\mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}$ vanishes to order at least r_χ at one, and*

$$\mathcal{P}_{q,\chi}^{(r_\chi)}(1) = (-1)^{r_\chi} r_\chi! \mathcal{P}_{f,\chi}(1) \prod_{p \in \mathcal{S}} \log p \prod_{p \in \mathcal{N}} (1 - \chi(p)). \quad (9.77)$$

Its order is exactly r_χ whenever $\mathcal{P}_{f,\chi}(1) \neq 0$. More generally its exact order is $r_\chi + \text{ord}_{s=1} \mathcal{P}_{f,\chi}(s)$.

Proof. The multiplier is

$$B_{q,f,\chi}(1 + \varepsilon) = (q/f)^{-\varepsilon} \prod_{\substack{p \mid q \\ p \nmid f}} (1 - \chi(p)p^\varepsilon).$$

The factors indexed by $\mathcal{S}$ have simple zeros with leading coefficient $-\log p$. All other factors are nonzero at zero and have value $1 - \chi(p)$. Multiply their leading terms by the Taylor series of $\mathcal{P}_{f,\chi}(1 + \varepsilon)$. $\square$

For primitive nonprincipal characters, the classical nonvanishing $L(1, \bar{\chi}) \neq 0$, together with the nonzero primitive Gauss sum in (9.60), supplies the stated nonvanishing hypothesis [76]. The explicit example below does not need that theorem; its primitive trace is computed directly from logarithms.

For $\chi_4(a) = (-1)^{(a-1)/2}$ on odd integers,

$$\mathcal{P}_{4,\chi_4}(1) = \text{Li}_1(i) - \text{Li}_1(-i) = \frac{i\pi}{2}.$$

Take $q = 260 = 4 \cdot 5 \cdot 13$. Both added primes have $\chi_4(p) = 1$. Consequently

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{U}_{260}} \chi_4(a) \text{Li}_1(\zeta_{260}^a) = 0, \quad (9.78)$$

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{U}_{260}} \chi_4(a) \partial_s^1 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{260}^a) \Big|_{s=1} = 0, \quad (9.79)$$

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{U}_{260}} \chi_4(a) \partial_s^2 \text{Li}_s(\zeta_{260}^a) \Big|_{s=1} = i\pi \log 5 \log 13. \quad (9.80)$$

This is a proved identity, not an integer-relation conjecture. More generally, for distinct primes $p_1, \dots, p_r \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$ and $q = 4p_1 \cdots p_r$,

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{U}_q} \chi_4(a) \partial_s^r \text{Li}_s(\zeta_q^a) \Big|_{s=1} = (-1)^r r! \frac{i\pi}{2} \prod_{j=1}^r \log p_j, \quad (9.81)$$

with all lower order traces vanishing. The same leading identity persists if the added prime factors occur with higher exponents.

9.9 Explicit tables for the second constant

We record the closed forms of $\gamma'_2 = -[\zeta''(2, a) + 2\zeta'(2, a)]$ (the $s = 2$ layer) and $\gamma''_2 = 2\zeta''(3, a) + 6\zeta'(3, a) + 2\zeta(3, a)$ (the $s = 3$ layer) at the elementary denominators. The new constants entering are the *second* s -derivatives $\zeta''(2), \zeta''(3), \beta''(s) = L''(s, \chi_{-4})$ and $L''(s, \chi_{-3})$; the values $L(3, \chi_{-4}) = \pi^3/32$ and $L(3, \chi_{-3}) = 4\pi^3/(81\sqrt{3})$ are elementary. As at the first-derivative layers, the odd-character block flips sign as a single unit under $p \mapsto q - p$ (including any elementary π -power value-part it carries). All entries are exact and were verified to $< 10^{-70}$.

Second constant, first parameter-derivative.

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma'_2(1) &= -\zeta''(2) - 2\zeta'(2), \\ \gamma'_2(\tfrac{1}{2}) &= -3\zeta''(2) - (6 + 8 \ln 2)\zeta'(2) - \tfrac{4}{3}\pi^2 \ln 2 - \tfrac{2}{3}\pi^2 \ln^2 2, \\ \gamma'_2(\tfrac{1}{3}) &= -4\zeta''(2) - (8 + 9 \ln 3)\zeta'(2) - \tfrac{3}{2}\pi^2 \ln 3 - \tfrac{3}{4}\pi^2 \ln^2 3 \\ &\quad - \left[\tfrac{9}{2}L''(2, \chi_{-3}) + 9(1 + \ln 3)L'(2, \chi_{-3}) + (9 \ln 3 + \tfrac{9}{2} \ln^2 3)L(2, \chi_{-3}) \right], \\ \gamma'_2(\tfrac{1}{4}) &= -6\zeta''(2) - (12 + 28 \ln 2)\zeta'(2) - \tfrac{14}{3}\pi^2 \ln 2 - 5\pi^2 \ln^2 2 \\ &\quad - \left[8\beta''(2) + 16(1 + 2 \ln 2)\beta'(2) + (32 \ln 2 + 32 \ln^2 2)G \right], \end{aligned}$$

with $\gamma'_2(2/3), \gamma'_2(3/4)$ obtained by negating the bracketed odd-character block, and the $q = 6$ entries given in the source report.

Second constant, second parameter-derivative.

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma''_2(1) &= 2\zeta''(3) + 6\zeta'(3) + 2\zeta(3), \\ \gamma''_2(\tfrac{1}{2}) &= 14\zeta''(3) + (42 + 32 \ln 2)\zeta'(3) + (14 + 48 \ln 2 + 16 \ln^2 2)\zeta(3), \\ \gamma''_2(\tfrac{1}{3}) &= 26\zeta''(3) + (78 + 54 \ln 3)\zeta'(3) + (26 + 81 \ln 3 + 27 \ln^2 3)\zeta(3) \\ &\quad + \left[27L''(3, \chi_{-3}) + (81 + 54 \ln 3)L'(3, \chi_{-3}) + (27 + 81 \ln 3 + 27 \ln^2 3)L(3, \chi_{-3}) \right], \\ \gamma''_2(\tfrac{1}{4}) &= 56\zeta''(3) + (168 + 240 \ln 2)\zeta'(3) + (56 + 360 \ln 2 + 248 \ln^2 2)\zeta(3) \\ &\quad + \left[64\beta''(3) + (192 + 256 \ln 2)\beta'(3) + (2 + 12 \ln 2 + 8 \ln^2 2)\pi^3 \right], \end{aligned}$$

again with $\gamma''_2(2/3), \gamma''_2(3/4)$ the odd-block negations. The reducible fractions collapse correctly ($\frac{2}{4} = \frac{3}{6} = \frac{1}{2}, \frac{2}{6} = \frac{1}{3}$), an internal consistency check.

9.10 The derivative $\leftrightarrow$ negapolygamma duality

The functional equation pairs the layer $s = k + 1$ of $\gamma_1^{(k)}$ with the layer $s = -k$, which is exactly where the negative-order polygamma $\psi^{(-k+1)}$ lives (its ladder uses $\zeta'(-k, \cdot)$). The seam is a single uniform identity.

Theorem 9.34 (Harmonic-number bridge law). *Let χ be a primitive character mod q for which $L(-k, \chi) \neq 0$. Then*

$$\frac{L'(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} + \overline{\left(\frac{L'(-k, \chi)}{L(-k, \chi)} \right)} = \gamma + \ln \frac{2\pi}{q} - H_k. \quad (9.82)$$

The same H_k that sets the master coefficient in Theorem 9.1 sets the bridge constant; the case $k = 1$ recovers the generalized-Glaisher constant $C_q = \gamma + \ln(2\pi/q) - 1$.

Proof of the bridge. For a primitive nonprincipal character of parity $\chi(-1) = (-1)^\epsilon$, the completed function is $\Lambda(s, \chi) = (q/\pi)^{(s+\epsilon)/2} \Gamma((s+\epsilon)/2) L(s, \chi)$. Its functional equation gives $\Lambda'/\Lambda(s, \chi) = -\Lambda'/\Lambda(1-s, \bar{\chi})$. At $s = k + 1$ with no trivial zero at $-k$, the two digamma terms, using reflection and recurrence, sum to $2(H_k - \gamma - \log 2)$ before their factor $1/2$ is applied. Collecting the conductor factor proves (9.82). The conductor-one principal character requires the meromorphic completed zeta function; the same nonzero-value calculation is valid for $k \geq 1$ where neither point is a pole. $\square$

Remark 9.35 (Trivial-zero bridge). For $k \geq 1$, $L(-k, \chi) = 0$ when $\epsilon \equiv k \pmod{2}$. At a simple trivial zero, cancellation of the pole in the completed gamma factor gives instead

$$\frac{L'(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} + \frac{\overline{L''(-k, \chi)}}{2L'(-k, \chi)} = \gamma + \log(2\pi/q) - H_k.$$

The factor 2 in the denominator is essential. This follows by writing $L(-k+u) = L'(-k)u + \frac{1}{2}L''(-k)u^2 + O(u^3)$ in the same logarithmic functional equation and taking its finite part.

At $z = \frac{1}{4}$ the governing character is χ_{-4} (odd). For k even there is no trivial zero, and $\psi^{(-k+1)}(\frac{1}{4})$ carries the unreduced derivative coordinate $\beta'(k+1) = L'(k+1, \chi_{-4})$, so $\gamma_1^{(k)}(\frac{1}{4})$ is an exact finite combination of $\psi^{(-k+1)}(\frac{1}{4})$ and the remaining zeta-value and zeta-derivative terms. The representative instance $k = 2$ is, after eliminating $\beta'(3)$ entirely,

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma_1''(\tfrac{1}{4}) = & -256\pi^3 \psi^{(-3)}(\tfrac{1}{4}) - 56\zeta'(3) - 84\zeta(3) - 120\ln 2 \zeta(3) + 35\pi \zeta(3) \\ & - 3\pi^3 - 4\ln 2 \pi^3 + 64\ln A \pi^3 - 2\gamma \pi^3 + 2\ln(2\pi) \pi^3, \end{aligned} \quad (9.83)$$

verified to $< 10^{-118}$. (The irrational coefficient $-256\pi^3$ on $\psi^{(-3)}(\frac{1}{4})$ is why a rational integer-relation search for this identity must take $\pi^3\psi^{(-3)}$, not $\psi^{(-3)}$, as the search atom.) For k odd the value-level duality *degenerates*: by Remark 9.35, $\psi^{(-k+1)}(\frac{1}{4})$ then carries only the lower *value* atom (for $k = 1$, $\beta'(-1) = 2G/\pi$, a value rather than a derivative at the positive point; for $k = 3$, $\beta'(-3) \sim \beta(4)/\pi^3$), while the genuine derivative atom $\beta'(k+1)$ of $\gamma_1^{(k)}(\frac{1}{4})$ is tied instead to the second derivative $\beta''(-k)$, absent from $\psi^{(-k+1)}$. Numerically the coefficient of $\beta'(k+1)$ in $\psi^{(-k+1)}(\frac{1}{4})$ is zero to $\sim 10^{-163}$ for $k = 1, 3$. The clean odd- k value-level duality therefore lives at even-character points (e.g. $q = 5$), where the parity is reversed.

9.11 One normalized functional equation for all derivative bridges

The Stieltjes drafts connect derivatives of $L(s, \chi)$ at a positive integer with derivatives at its reflected negative integer. A single identity of analytic germs organizes all these formulas and treats trivial zeros without differentiating singular logarithms. It also makes the conjugation required for complex characters unavoidable. The input is the classical primitive Dirichlet functional equation and the reflection and duplication formulas for Γ [45]; the all-order normalized form below is a systematic continuation of the bridges used in the corpus.

9.11.1 Regularization and the normalized germ

Let χ be primitive of conductor q , allowing the trivial character of conductor 1, for which $L(s, \chi) = \zeta(s)$. Fix $k \geq 1$, and write

$$\delta = \frac{1 - \chi(-1)}{2} \in \{0, 1\}, \quad \nu = \begin{cases} 1, & \chi(-1) = (-1)^k, \\ 0, & \chi(-1) \neq (-1)^k. \end{cases}$$

Define

$$B(t) = \frac{L(-k + t, \chi)}{t^\nu}, \quad B^\#(z) = \overline{B(\bar{z})}, \quad (9.84)$$

with the removable value filled in when $\nu = 1$. The function $B^\#$ is holomorphic near zero; it is coefficientwise conjugation of the Taylor series of B .

Theorem 9.36 (Normalized positive–negative germ). *The quantities $L(k + 1, \chi)$ and $B(0)$ are nonzero. On a sufficiently small disk about $z = 0$,*

$$\frac{L(k + 1 + z, \chi)}{L(k + 1, \chi)} = K_\nu(z) \frac{B^\#(-z)}{B^\#(0)}, \quad (9.85)$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} K_\nu(z) &= \left(\frac{2\pi}{q}\right)^z \frac{\Gamma(k + 1)}{\Gamma(k + 1 + z)} T_\nu(z), \\ T_0(z) &= \sec \frac{\pi z}{2}, \quad T_1(z) = \frac{\pi z/2}{\sin(\pi z/2)}, \quad T_1(0) = 1. \end{aligned} \quad (9.86)$$

All three normalized factors in (9.85) equal 1 at the origin.

Proof. The Euler product gives $L(k + 1, \chi) \neq 0$, since $k + 1 > 1$. Use the completed function

$$\Lambda(s, \chi) = \left(\frac{q}{\pi}\right)^{(s+\delta)/2} \Gamma\left(\frac{s+\delta}{2}\right) L(s, \chi)$$

and its functional equation

$$\Lambda(s, \chi) = \varepsilon_\chi \Lambda(1 - s, \bar{\chi}), \quad |\varepsilon_\chi| = 1. \quad (9.87)$$

At $s = -k$, the gamma factor is finite and nonzero if $\nu = 0$, and has a simple pole if $\nu = 1$. The reflected completed value at $k + 1$ is finite and nonzero. Consequently $L(-k, \chi) \neq 0$ in the first case, and $L(s, \chi)$ has a simple zero at $-k$ in the second. In either case B is holomorphic and $B(0) \neq 0$.

Put

$$a = \frac{\delta - k}{2}, \quad b = \frac{k + 1 + \delta}{2}.$$

Solving (9.87) at $s = k + 1 + z$ gives

$$L(k + 1 + z, \chi) = \varepsilon_\chi \left(\frac{q}{\pi} \right)^{-k - \frac{1}{2} - z} \frac{\Gamma(a - z/2)}{\Gamma(b + z/2)} L(-k - z, \bar{\chi}). \quad (9.88)$$

Since $L(-k - z, \bar{\chi}) = (-z)^\nu B^\#(-z)$, the numerator

$$F_\nu(z) = (-z)^\nu \Gamma(a - z/2)$$

has a nonzero removable value at the origin. Dividing (9.88) by its value at $z = 0$ cancels the root number and all constant factors:

$$\frac{L(k + 1 + z, \chi)}{L(k + 1, \chi)} = \left(\frac{q}{\pi} \right)^{-z} \frac{F_\nu(z)}{F_\nu(0)} \frac{\Gamma(b)}{\Gamma(b + z/2)} \frac{B^\#(-z)}{B^\#(0)}. \quad (9.89)$$

If $\nu = 0$, then a is a half-integer. The gamma reflection formula and $\sin(\pi(a - z/2)) = \sin(\pi a) \cos(\pi z/2)$ give

$$\frac{F_0(z)}{F_0(0)} = \frac{\Gamma(1 - a)}{\Gamma(1 - a + z/2)} \sec \frac{\pi z}{2}. \quad (9.90)$$

If $\nu = 1$, write $a = -m$, $m \geq 0$. Then $F_1(0) = 2(-1)^m/m!$, and the same reflection formula gives

$$\frac{F_1(z)}{F_1(0)} = \frac{\Gamma(1 - a)}{\Gamma(1 - a + z/2)} \frac{\pi z/2}{\sin(\pi z/2)}. \quad (9.91)$$

For example, the pole in $\Gamma(-m - z/2)$ is canceled by the explicit factor $-z$, so no logarithm of a function vanishing at zero has been taken.

The unordered pair $\{b, 1 - a\}$ is $\{(k + 1)/2, (k + 2)/2\}$, for either value of δ . Duplication therefore yields

$$\frac{\Gamma(b)\Gamma(1 - a)}{\Gamma(b + z/2)\Gamma(1 - a + z/2)} = 2^z \frac{\Gamma(k + 1)}{\Gamma(k + 1 + z)}. \quad (9.92)$$

Substituting (9.90) or (9.91), followed by (9.92), into (9.89) proves the theorem. $\square$

Remark 9.37. The statement concerns analytic germs and local logarithms. It requires no claim about a global zero-free region. For a complex character the functional equation involves $\bar{\chi}$, and therefore the reflected Taylor coefficients are conjugated. Replacing $B^\#$ by B is justified for a real character but generally false for a complex one.

9.11.2 Closed logarithmic coefficients at every order

Choose the normalized local logarithms, each zero at the origin, of $L(k + 1 + z, \chi)/L(k + 1, \chi)$ and $B(t)/B(0)$. For $r \geq 1$, set

$$\mathcal{L}_r = \frac{d^r}{ds^r} \log L(s, \chi) \Big|_{s=k+1}, \quad b_r = \frac{d^r}{dt^r} \log B(t) \Big|_{t=0}.$$

These derivatives do not depend on a choice of logarithm branch. Write

$$H_k^{(r)} = \sum_{j=1}^k j^{-r}, \quad H_k = H_k^{(1)}, \quad \eta(r) = (1 - 2^{1-r})\zeta(r) \quad (r \geq 2).$$

Theorem 9.38 (All-order logarithmic bridges). *For every $r \geq 1$,*

$$\mathcal{L}_r - (-1)^r \overline{b_r} = \kappa_r, \quad (9.93)$$

where

$$\kappa_r = \begin{cases} \gamma + \log \frac{2\pi}{q} - H_k, & r = 1, \\ (r-1)! (\zeta(r) - H_k^{(r)}), & r \geq 3 \text{ odd}, \\ (r-1)! (H_k^{(r)} + (-1)^\nu \eta(r)), & r \geq 2 \text{ even}. \end{cases} \quad (9.94)$$

Proof. Taking normalized logarithms of (9.85) gives

$$\log \frac{L(k+1+z, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} = \log K_\nu(z) + \log \frac{\overline{B(-\bar{z})}}{B(0)}.$$

The r -th derivative of the last term at zero is $(-1)^r \overline{b_r}$. It remains to compute the derivatives of $\log K_\nu$.

The convergent gamma expansion, on $|z| < 1$, is

$$\log \frac{\Gamma(k+1+z)}{\Gamma(k+1)} = (H_k - \gamma)z + \sum_{r \geq 2} \frac{(-1)^r}{r} (\zeta(r) - H_k^{(r)}) z^r. \quad (9.95)$$

The sine and cosine products give, in the same disk,

$$\log \sec \frac{\pi z}{2} = \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{(1 - 2^{-2m}) \zeta(2m)}{m} z^{2m}, \quad (9.96)$$

$$\log \frac{\pi z/2}{\sin(\pi z/2)} = \sum_{m \geq 1} \frac{2^{-2m} \zeta(2m)}{m} z^{2m}. \quad (9.97)$$

These identities also follow directly by taking logarithms of the absolutely locally convergent products $\cos(\pi z/2) = \prod_{j \geq 0} (1 - z^2/(2j+1)^2)$ and $\sin(\pi z/2)/(\pi z/2) = \prod_{j \geq 1} (1 - z^2/(2j)^2)$.

The linear term of $\log K_\nu$ is the stated κ_1 . Odd coefficients of order at least three come only from the negative of (9.95), giving the second case. For $r = 2m$, the secant coefficient combines with the gamma coefficient to give

$$(r-1)! \left[H_k^{(r)} - \zeta(r) + 2(1 - 2^{-r}) \zeta(r) \right] = (r-1)! (H_k^{(r)} + \eta(r)).$$

Replacing the secant factor by the sine quotient instead gives

$$(r-1)! \left[H_k^{(r)} - \zeta(r) + 2^{1-r} \zeta(r) \right] = (r-1)! (H_k^{(r)} - \eta(r)).$$

These are exactly the two even cases in (9.94). □

At a nonzero reflected value, $\nu = 0$, the first two identities read

$$\frac{L'(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} + \frac{\overline{L'(-k, \chi)}}{\overline{L(-k, \chi)}} = \gamma + \log \frac{2\pi}{q} - H_k, \quad (9.98)$$

$$(\log L)''(k+1, \chi) - \overline{(\log L)''(-k, \chi)} = H_k^{(2)} + \frac{\pi^2}{12}. \quad (9.99)$$

At a trivial zero, $\nu = 1$, the Taylor expansion

$$B(t) = L'(-k, \chi) + \frac{L''(-k, \chi)}{2}t + \frac{L'''(-k, \chi)}{6}t^2 + \dots$$

instead gives

$$\frac{L'(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} + \frac{1}{2} \frac{\overline{L''(-k, \chi)}}{L'(-k, \chi)} = \gamma + \log \frac{2\pi}{q} - H_k, \quad (9.100)$$

$$(\log L)''(k+1, \chi) - \left(\frac{L'''(-k, \chi)}{3L'(-k, \chi)} - \frac{L''(-k, \chi)^2}{4L'(-k, \chi)^2} \right) = H_k^{(2)} - \frac{\pi^2}{12}. \quad (9.101)$$

These formulas preserve the familiar first-order harmonic bridge and supply a uniform extension to every derivative order and both character parities.

9.11.3 Raw jets and an exact triangular implementation

The normalized germ also gives direct formulas for ordinary derivatives, without first converting each order to logarithmic derivatives. Define K_m by

$$K_\nu(z) = \sum_{m \geq 0} K_m \frac{z^m}{m!}, \quad K_0 = 1.$$

Since $\log K_\nu(z) = \sum_{r \geq 1} \kappa_r z^r / r!$, these coefficients are the complete exponential Bell polynomials:

$$K_m = m! \sum_{\substack{m_1, \dots, m_m \geq 0 \\ m_1 + 2m_2 + \dots + mm_m = m}} \prod_{r=1}^m \frac{1}{m_r!} \left(\frac{\kappa_r}{r!} \right)^{m_r} \quad (m \geq 1). \quad (9.102)$$

Leibniz's rule in (9.85) proves

$$\frac{L^{(m)}(k+1, \chi)}{L(k+1, \chi)} = \sum_{j=0}^m \binom{m}{j} K_{m-j} (-1)^j \frac{\overline{B^{(j)}(0)}}{B(0)}. \quad (9.103)$$

The required regularized derivatives are explicitly

$$\frac{B^{(j)}(0)}{B(0)} = \frac{j! \nu!}{(j+\nu)!} \frac{L^{(j+\nu)}(-k, \chi)}{L^{(\nu)}(-k, \chi)}. \quad (9.104)$$

The diagonal coefficient in (9.103) is $(-1)^m$, so the transformation is triangular and invertible. Its coefficients belong to the ring generated by the explicit κ_r 's. This supplies exact relation certificates at arbitrary order and avoids repeated symbolic differentiation across gamma poles.

Remark 9.39 (Correction of the complex-character formulas). The older derivative-relations report omits the conjugation in versions of the trivial-zero first bridge and the nonzero second bridge. Equations (9.100) and (9.99) give the required replacements. The two main Stieltjes articles already include conjugation in their displayed first bridges; those correct formulas should be retained. Exact source locators and numerical counterexamples to the omitted-conjugation versions appear in the correction register.

9.12 Experimental independence tests

The tables introduce $\zeta''(2), \zeta''(3), \beta''(2), \beta''(3)$ and $L''(2, \chi_{-3}), L''(3, \chi_{-3})$. Historical searches at 200 digits with planted controls recovered the known value reductions and found no accepted relation for the six derivative coordinates in the lower-order baskets. This supports using them as named coordinates in a reduction table. Their mutual independence, and the impossibility of reductions in larger baskets, remain open.

9.13 Elementary grids and the sixth-point completion

For $q = 3, 4, 6$ define

$$A_3(s) = \frac{3^s - 1}{2} \zeta(s), \quad A_4(s) = \frac{4^s - 2^s}{2} \zeta(s), \quad A_6(s) = \frac{(2^s - 1)(3^s - 1)}{2} \zeta(s),$$

$$B_3(s) = \frac{3^s}{2} L(s, \chi_{-3}), \quad B_4(s) = \frac{4^s}{2} \beta(s), \quad B_6(s) = \frac{6^s + 3^s}{2} L(s, \chi_{-3}).$$

Residue-class decomposition proves $\zeta(s, 1/q) = A_q(s) + B_q(s)$ and $\zeta(s, 1 - 1/q) = A_q(s) - B_q(s)$ for these three q . Consequently all four derivative tables, including the omitted sixth-point rows in the later article, follow from the differential operators

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma'_1(a) &= (\partial_s + 1)\zeta(s, a)|_{s=2}, & \gamma''_1(a) &= -(2\partial_s + 3)\zeta(s, a)|_{s=3}, \\ \gamma'_2(a) &= -(\partial_s^2 + 2\partial_s)\zeta(s, a)|_{s=2}, & \gamma''_2(a) &= (2\partial_s^2 + 6\partial_s + 2)\zeta(s, a)|_{s=3}. \end{aligned}$$

This supplies an exact symbolic recipe for every entry, without new fitted constants. Write $a = \log 2$, $b = \log 3$, and $L_j(s) = L^{(j)}(s, \chi_{-3})$. At the sixth points the first-constant rows are

$$\begin{aligned} \gamma'_1(1/6), \gamma'_1(5/6) &= 12\zeta'(2) + 2\pi^2 + \frac{8}{3}\pi^2 a + \frac{9}{4}\pi^2 b \\ &\quad \pm \left[\frac{45}{2} L_1(2) + \left(\frac{45}{2} + 18a + \frac{45}{2}b \right) L_0(2) \right], \\ \gamma''_1(1/6), \gamma''_1(5/6) &= -182\zeta'(3) - (273 + 208a + 189b)\zeta(3) \\ &\quad \mp \left[243 L_1(3) + \left(\frac{729}{2} + 216a + 243b \right) L_0(3) \right]. \end{aligned}$$

The second-constant rows are

$$\begin{aligned}
\gamma'_2(1/6), \gamma'_2(5/6) &= S_2 \mp O_2, \\
S_2 &= -12\zeta''(2) - (24 + 32a + 27b)\zeta'(2) \\
&\quad - \pi^2 \left(\frac{16}{3}a + \frac{9}{2}b + \frac{8}{3}a^2 + \frac{9}{4}b^2 + 6ab \right), \\
O_2 &= \frac{45}{2}L_2(2) + (45 + 36a + 45b)L_1(2) \\
&\quad + \left(36a + 45b + 18a^2 + \frac{45}{2}b^2 + 36ab \right) L_0(2), \\
\gamma''_2(1/6), \gamma''_2(5/6) &= S_3 \pm O_3, \\
S_3 &= 182\zeta''(3) + (546 + 416a + 378b)\zeta'(3) \\
&\quad + (182 + 624a + 567b + 208a^2 + 189b^2 + 432ab)\zeta(3), \\
O_3 &= 243L_2(3) + (729 + 432a + 486b)L_1(3) \\
&\quad + (243 + 648a + 729b + 216a^2 + 243b^2 + 432ab)L_0(3).
\end{aligned}$$

The upper sign is the 1/6 entry. These formulas consolidate the tables from the first-derivative, second-derivative and general-order reports.

Chapter 10

Positive kernels and the geometry of Stieltjes zeros

The derivative tower gives exact spectral coordinates. Its Mellin form does more: a reciprocal-gamma polynomial becomes a sign-changing kernel inside a positive Laplace transform. Root preservation bounds the total number of positive zeros, gamma concentration explains their motion, and outward rational computation certifies concrete base cases. This chapter unites the fixed-index zero geometry with the complementary spectral regime in which the Laurent index grows with the derivative order.

10.1 A unified Stieltjes–Lerch derivative family

For $a > 0$, write

$$\zeta(s, a) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n(a) (s-1)^n. \quad (10.1)$$

The superscript in $\gamma_n^{(k)}(a)$ means differentiation k times in a . In contrast, $\zeta^{(j)}(s, a)$ denotes differentiation j times in s . Set

$$P_k(t) = \prod_{j=1}^k \left(1 + \frac{t}{j}\right) = \sum_{i=0}^k e_i(k) t^i, \quad H_k^{(r)} = \sum_{j=1}^k j^{-r}, \quad H_k = H_k^{(1)}. \quad (10.2)$$

We take $H_0^{(r)} = 0$.

For $0 \leq \rho < 1$, define the convergent Lerch coefficients

$$\ell_n(\rho, a) = \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{\rho^m \log^n(a+m)}{a+m} = (-1)^n \partial_s^n \Phi(\rho, s, a)|_{s=1}, \quad \Phi(\rho, s, a) = \sum_{m \geq 0} \frac{\rho^m}{(a+m)^s}. \quad (10.3)$$

For $k \geq 1$ put

$$\mathcal{D}_{n,k}^\rho(a) = \begin{cases} \partial_a^k \ell_n(\rho, a), & 0 \leq \rho < 1, \\ \gamma_n^{(k)}(a), & \rho = 1. \end{cases} \quad (10.4)$$

Only the derivative family is unified at $\rho = 1$: the series defining ℓ_n generally diverges there. For $0 < \rho < 1$ the specialization $a = 1$ is directly polylogarithmic,

$$\ell_n(\rho, 1) = \frac{(-1)^n}{\rho} \partial_s^n \text{Li}_s(\rho)|_{s=1}. \quad (10.5)$$

At $\rho = 0$ it is simply $\log^n a/a$.

Proposition 10.1 (The classical master identity). *For $k \geq 1$, $n \geq 0$, and $a > 0$,*

$$\gamma_n^{(k)}(a) = (-1)^{n+k} k! n! \sum_{i+j=n} e_i(k) \frac{\zeta^{(j)}(k+1, a)}{j!}. \quad (10.6)$$

The same formula with $\Phi(\rho, \cdot, a)$ in place of $\zeta(\cdot, a)$ holds for $\mathcal{D}_{n,k}^\rho$ when $\rho < 1$.

Proof. The normally convergent defining series gives $\partial_a^k \zeta(s, a) = (-1)^k (s)_k \zeta(s+k, a)$ first in a right half-plane, and then by meromorphic continuation. Apply it to (10.1), noting that the pole term is independent of a . Substituting $s = 1+t$ and using $(1+t)_k = k! P_k(t)$ gives

$$\sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a) t^n = (-1)^k k! P_k(t) \zeta(k+1+t, a). \quad (10.7)$$

Coefficient comparison proves (10.6). For $\rho < 1$ the same calculation is justified directly by locally uniform convergence of the Lerch series. This is Coffey's Stirling-number formula in the harmonic/symmetric-function coordinates used by the source draft. $\square$

Definition 10.2 (Reciprocal-gamma Appell polynomials). *Define the monic polynomials Q_n by*

$$\frac{e^{xt}}{\Gamma(1+t)} = \sum_{n \geq 0} Q_n(x) \frac{t^n}{n!}. \quad (10.8)$$

Set $W_\rho(x) = (1 - \rho e^{-x})^{-1}$ for $x > 0$ and $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$.

Writing $y = x + \gamma$ and $\zeta_r = \zeta(r)$, the first polynomials are

$$\begin{aligned} Q_0(x) &= 1, & Q_1(x) &= y, \\ Q_2(x) &= y^2 - \zeta_2, & Q_3(x) &= y^3 - 3\zeta_2 y + 2\zeta_3, \\ Q_4(x) &= y^4 - 6\zeta_2 y^2 + 8\zeta_3 y + 3\zeta_2^2 - 6\zeta_4. \end{aligned} \quad (10.9)$$

They satisfy $Q'_n = nQ_{n-1}$ and the explicit recurrence

$$Q_{n+1}(x) = (x + \gamma)Q_n(x) + \sum_{r=1}^n (-1)^r \binom{n}{r} r! \zeta(r+1) Q_{n-r}(x). \quad (10.10)$$

This follows by differentiating (10.8) in t and using $-\psi(1+t) = \gamma + \sum_{r \geq 1} (-1)^r \zeta(r+1) t^r$ near zero.

Theorem 10.3 (Appell–Laplace representation). *For all $n \geq 0$, $k \geq 1$, $a > 0$, and $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$,*

$$F_{n,k}^\rho(a) := (-1)^{n+k} \mathcal{D}_{n,k}^\rho(a) = \int_0^\infty x^k e^{-ax} W_\rho(x) Q_n(\log x) dx. \quad (10.11)$$

The integral and every fixed number of its a -derivatives converge locally uniformly for $a > 0$, uniformly in $\rho \in [0, 1]$.

Proof. The Hurwitz and Lerch Mellin integrals give, for $|t|$ sufficiently small,

$$k! P_k(t) \Phi(\rho, k+1+t, a) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(1+t)} \int_0^\infty x^{k+t} e^{-ax} W_\rho(x) dx,$$

where $\Phi(1, s, a)$ means $\zeta(s, a)$ in its convergent half-plane. The cancellation of $\Gamma(k+1+t)$ is the reason for introducing Q_n . Extract the coefficient of t^n and apply (10.7).

For justification, $W_\rho(x) \leq W_1(x) = O(x^{-1})$ at zero and $W_\rho(x) = O(1)$ at infinity, uniformly in ρ . On $|t| \leq \eta < k$, the integrand near zero is bounded by a constant times $x^{k-1-\eta}$, and its coefficient derivatives introduce only powers of $|\log x|$. At infinity, a fixed positive lower bound on a supplies exponential domination. Multiplication by any fixed power of x handles the a -derivatives. These estimates also prove continuity at $\rho = 1$. $\square$

10.2 Real-rootedness and a global zero bound

Lemma 10.4 (A real-root preserving operator). *If a real polynomial f of degree n has only real roots and $c \neq 0$ is real, then $f + cf'$ has only real roots. An inherited root of multiplicity m has multiplicity $m - 1$ if $m \geq 2$, and every other root of $f + cf'$ is simple. Consequently, after $n - 1$ such operators, any real-rooted polynomial of degree n becomes strictly real-rooted.*

Proof. Away from the distinct roots r_i of f , of multiplicities m_i , the new roots solve

$$\frac{f'(x)}{f(x)} = \sum_i \frac{m_i}{x - r_i} = -\frac{1}{c}.$$

The left side is strictly decreasing on each complementary interval because its derivative is $-\sum_i m_i/(x - r_i)^2 < 0$. It has one solution between each consecutive pair of distinct roots and one further solution in the appropriate exterior interval. All these solutions are simple. Factoring at r_i proves the inherited multiplicity assertion, and counting degrees accounts for all roots. Repeating reduces every possible multiple root at each step; new roots never introduce multiplicity. $\square$

Theorem 10.5 (Strictly real-rooted reciprocal-gamma polynomials). *For every $n \geq 1$, Q_n has exactly n distinct real roots. The roots of Q_{n-1} strictly interlace those of Q_n .*

Proof. The classical Weierstrass product [40] is

$$\frac{1}{\Gamma(1+t)} = e^{\gamma t} \prod_{m=1}^{\infty} (1 + t/m) e^{-t/m}, \quad (10.12)$$

with locally uniform convergence. For a finite product, extracting $n![t^n]$ after multiplication by e^{xt} is equivalent to applying operators $1 + \partial_x/m$ and real translations to x^n . Lemma 10.4 therefore proves real-rootedness of each finite-product polynomial. Coefficient convergence and closure of the set of monic real-rooted polynomials prove real-rootedness in the limit.

A limit of simple-rooted polynomials alone would not prove simplicity. To obtain it, remove the first $n - 1$ factors $(1 + t/m)e^{-t/m}$ from (10.12). The Appell polynomial associated with the remaining tail is still real-rooted by the same finite-product argument. Restore the removed factors. The translations preserve multiplicity and commute with the differential operators; the $n - 1$ operators $1 + \partial_x/m$ make all roots simple by Lemma 10.4. Finally $Q'_n = nQ_{n-1}$ and Rolle's theorem give strict interlacing. $\square$

Lemma 10.6 (Laplace variation bound, with multiplicity). *Let $g : (0, \infty) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ have exactly N sign changes, with constant nonzero sign between the sign-change points, up to null sets. Suppose all exponentially weighted polynomial moments needed below are absolutely integrable. Its Laplace transform $G(a) = \int_0^\infty e^{-ax} g(x) dx$ is not identically zero and has at most N zeros on $(0, \infty)$, counted with multiplicity.*

Proof. For $N = 0$ the transform has a fixed strict sign. For $N > 0$, choose a sign-change point x_0 . Multiplying g by $x_0 - x$ removes that sign change and introduces no others. The transform of the new function is

$$(\partial_a + x_0)G(a) = e^{-x_0 a} \frac{d}{da} (e^{x_0 a} G(a)).$$

By induction it has at most $N - 1$ zeros. If G has any finite collection of zeros of total multiplicity M , Rolle's theorem with multiplicity gives at least $M - 1$ zeros of the displayed derivative between

the first and last zero, including inherited multiplicities at the endpoints when appropriate. Thus $M \leq N$. This bounds every finite collection, and hence all zeros. The induction hypothesis also says that the transform of the new kernel is not identically zero. If G were identically zero, its displayed transformed derivative would be identically zero as well, a contradiction. This completes the induction including nonvanishing. $\square$

Theorem 10.7 (Global bound on positive zeros). *For every $n \geq 0$, $k \geq 1$, and $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$, the function $\mathcal{D}_{n,k}^\rho(a)$ has at most n positive zeros, counted with multiplicity. In particular, this holds for $\gamma_n^{(k)}(a)$.*

Proof. The factor $x^k W_\rho(x)$ in (10.11) is strictly positive. By Theorem 10.5, $Q_n(\log x)$ has precisely n simple sign changes on $(0, \infty)$. The estimates in Theorem 10.3 justify every step of Lemma 10.6. The transform is not identically zero: as $a \downarrow 0$, scaling $x = u/a$ gives

$$F_{n,k}^\rho(a) \sim k! a^{-k-1} \log^n(1/a), \quad (10.13)$$

uniformly in ρ , with the convention $\log^0(1/a) = 1$. This follows from monicity of Q_n and $W_\rho(u/a) \rightarrow 1$, using the same integrable bounds after splitting at $u = a$. The variation bound now applies. $\square$

Remark 10.8 (The elementary endpoint explains possible multiplicity). At $\rho = 0$ one has

$$F_{n,k}^0(a) = k! a^{-k-1} n! [t^n] P_k(t) e^{-t \log a}.$$

The polynomial in $x = -\log a$ is $\prod_{j=1}^k (1 + \partial_x/j) x^n$. It has n real roots counted with multiplicity by Lemma 10.4. When $n > k$, the root $x = 0$ has multiplicity exactly $n - k$. Thus all zeros cannot be declared simple uniformly in ρ at small k . Any uniform simplicity threshold for $n \geq 2$ must be at least $n - 1$.

10.3 An all-order concentration expansion

The scale on which the zeros move is $a = ck$, with c bounded away from zero and infinity. Set

$$\mathcal{T}_{n,k}^\rho(c) = \frac{(-1)^{n+k} (ck)^{k+1}}{k!} \mathcal{D}_{n,k}^\rho(ck), \quad h_{n,\rho}(x) = W_\rho(x) Q_n(\log x). \quad (10.14)$$

Let Y_k have gamma density

$$\frac{k^{k+1}}{k!} y^k e^{-ky}, \quad y > 0.$$

Then $\mathbb{E} Y_k = 1 + 1/k$, and (10.11) becomes the exact identity

$$\mathcal{T}_{n,k}^\rho(c) = \mathbb{E} h_{n,\rho}(Y_k/c). \quad (10.15)$$

The shape is $k + 1$, not k ; the resulting $1/k$ shift matters for the constant term of each zero.

Define polynomials C_j by the formal generating function

$$\sum_{j \geq 0} C_j(z) w^j = \exp \left\{ \sum_{\ell \geq 1} w^\ell \left(\frac{z^\ell}{\ell} + \frac{z^{\ell+1}}{\ell+1} \right) \right\}. \quad (10.16)$$

For $C_j(z) = \sum_r c_{j,r} z^r$, use the *normal-ordered* differential operator

$$(A_j h)(x) = \sum_r c_{j,r} x^r h^{(r)}(x). \quad (10.17)$$

This notation does not mean $C_j(x\partial_x)$: the powers of x stand to the left of the derivatives. For example,

$$\begin{aligned} A_0 h &= h, \\ A_1 h &= xh' + \frac{1}{2}x^2 h'', \\ A_2 h &= x^2 h'' + \frac{5}{6}x^3 h''' + \frac{1}{8}x^4 h^{(4)}. \end{aligned} \tag{10.18}$$

Theorem 10.9 (Uniform complete expansion). *Fix $n, J, r \geq 0$ and a compact interval $I \subset (0, \infty)$. As $k \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$\mathcal{T}_{n,k}^\rho(c) = \sum_{j=0}^J \frac{(A_j h_{n,\rho})(1/c)}{k^j} + O_{n,J,r,I}(k^{-J-1}), \tag{10.19}$$

uniformly for $c \in I$ and $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$, also after any number of c -derivatives up to r .

Proof. The centered moment generating function is

$$\mathbb{E}e^{z(Y_k-1)} = e^{-z}(1 - z/k)^{-k-1}.$$

For fixed z near zero its logarithm is exactly the convergent expansion

$$\log \mathbb{E}e^{z(Y_k-1)} = \sum_{\ell \geq 1} k^{-\ell} \left(\frac{z^\ell}{\ell} + \frac{z^{\ell+1}}{\ell+1} \right). \tag{10.20}$$

Consequently the coefficient of k^{-j} in $\mathbb{E}(Y_k - 1)^m/m!$ is $[z^m]C_j(z)$. For fixed m , these moments are finite polynomials in $1/k$, since only finitely many terms of the exponential can contribute to z^m . The degree of C_j is at most $2j$.

Here are the estimates needed to turn coefficient comparison into a uniform asymptotic statement. On $1/2 \leq y \leq 3/2$, all derivatives of $h_{n,\rho}(y/c)$ of any fixed order in y and c are uniformly bounded for $c \in I$ and $\rho \in [0, 1]$. Indeed y/c stays in a compact subinterval of $(0, \infty)$ and $1 - \rho e^{-y/c}$ is uniformly positive there. Taylor's theorem at $y = 1$, through degree $2J + 1$, has remainder bounded by $C|y - 1|^{2J+2}$. Formula (10.20) gives

$$\mathbb{E}|Y_k - 1|^{2J+2} = O(k^{-J-1}).$$

Replacing truncated central moments by full central moments changes the answer only exponentially, as we now verify.

For each fixed derivative order, the functions to be averaged admit bounds

$$|\partial_c^u h_{n,\rho}(y/c)| \leq C(y^{-B} + y^B)(1 + |\log y|^n)$$

for some fixed B and C , uniformly in the stated parameters. These follow from $W_1(x) = O(1 + x^{-1})$ and its differentiated forms; enlarging B absorbs the logarithm if convenient. For a fixed real exponent v ,

$$\mathbb{E}[Y_k^v \mathbf{1}_{Y_k \notin [1/2, 3/2]}] = \frac{\Gamma(k+1+v)}{\Gamma(k+1)k^v} \Pr\{Z_{k,v} \notin [1/2, 3/2]\},$$

where $Z_{k,v}$ has shape $k+1+v$ and rate k , for all sufficiently large k . The prefactor is bounded, and a Chernoff bound obtained from the gamma moment generating function makes the probability $O(e^{-\eta k})$ for some $\eta > 0$. The same holds for the finitely many polynomial and inverse-polynomial bounds just used. This proves exponentially small tails for the Taylor remainder and all retained moments.

Taylor expansion in (10.15), followed by (10.20), therefore gives exactly (10.19) and the coefficients (10.17). Applying the same argument to $\partial_c^u h_{n,\rho}(y/c)$ proves the stated derivative uniformity. No differentiation of an uncontrolled big- O term is used. $\square$

Remark 10.10 (What uniformity does not say). The constants in Theorem 10.9 may depend on n and on the compact c -interval. The theorem does not supply estimates uniform when n grows with k , nor when $c \downarrow 0$ or $c \rightarrow \infty$. These are separate problems, especially because the extreme roots of Q_n then control very different scales.

10.4 Exactly n eventual zeros and their locations

Order the Appell roots and define the corresponding slopes by

$$x_{n,1} > x_{n,2} > \cdots > x_{n,n}, \quad c_{n,j} = e^{-x_{n,j}}, \quad 0 < c_{n,1} < \cdots < c_{n,n}. \quad (10.21)$$

Theorem 10.11 (Uniform eventual zero theorem). *For every fixed $n \geq 1$ there is an integer K_n such that, for every $k \geq K_n$ and every $\rho \in [0, 1]$, $\mathcal{D}_{n,k}^\rho$ has exactly n positive zeros, all simple. Number them increasingly as $a_{n,j,k}^\rho$. Uniformly in ρ ,*

$$a_{n,j,k}^\rho = kc_{n,j} + d_{n,j}(\rho) + O_n(k^{-1}), \quad (10.22)$$

where

$$d_{n,j}(\rho) = \frac{c_{n,j}}{2} \left(1 + \frac{Q_n''(x_{n,j})}{Q_n'(x_{n,j})} \right) - \frac{\rho}{\exp(1/c_{n,j}) - \rho}. \quad (10.23)$$

More generally, for every fixed $J \geq 0$ there are coefficients $b_{n,j,\ell}(\rho)$ such that

$$a_{n,j,k}^\rho = kc_{n,j} + d_{n,j}(\rho) + \sum_{\ell=1}^J b_{n,j,\ell}(\rho) k^{-\ell} + O_{n,J}(k^{-J-1}), \quad (10.24)$$

uniformly for $\rho \in [0, 1]$. These coefficients are recursively computable from (10.16).

Proof. The leading term in Theorem 10.9 is

$$G_0(c, \rho) = W_\rho(1/c) Q_n(-\log c).$$

Its zeros are exactly the $c_{n,j}$, and its derivative at such a zero is

$$\partial_c G_0(c_{n,j}, \rho) = -\frac{W_\rho(1/c_{n,j})}{c_{n,j}} Q_n'(x_{n,j}) \neq 0. \quad (10.25)$$

Choose disjoint closed intervals around these slopes on whose endpoints $Q_n(-\log c)$ has opposite signs. Since $1 \leq W_\rho(1/c) \leq W_1(1/c)$ on their union, the endpoint absolute values are bounded away from zero uniformly in ρ . The uniform $J = 0$ approximation gives one zero in each interval for all sufficiently large k , uniformly in ρ . The global bound of Theorem 10.7 excludes any further zero and, because it counts multiplicity, makes every one of the n zeros simple.

Put $c = c_{n,j} + d/k + O(k^{-2})$. The k^{-1} coefficient of (10.19) gives

$$d = -\frac{G_1(c_{n,j}, \rho)}{\partial_c G_0(c_{n,j}, \rho)}, \quad G_1(c, \rho) = (A_1 h_{n,\rho})(1/c). \quad (10.26)$$

At $x = 1/c_{n,j}$, write $Q' = Q_n'(x_{n,j})$ and $Q'' = Q_n''(x_{n,j})$. Because $Q_n(\log x) = 0$,

$$xh' + \frac{1}{2}x^2h'' = \frac{1}{2}W_\rho(x)(Q' + Q'') + xW_\rho'(x)Q'.$$

Also

$$\frac{W'_\rho(x)}{W_\rho(x)} = -\frac{\rho}{e^x - \rho}.$$

Substitution in (10.26) proves (10.23).

For completeness, the all-order assertion does not require a convergent power series in $1/k$. Apply Theorem 10.9 to one additional order at each step. Substitute a finite ansatz for c into the finite expansion. At every new order the unknown coefficient occurs linearly with the nonzero multiplier (10.25); hence it is uniquely determined. This derivative is bounded away from zero uniformly in ρ . The residual of a truncation, divided by a uniform lower derivative bound on a smaller root interval, bounds the error in the true zero by the mean value theorem. Expanding one order farther than the desired expansion of $a = kc$ gives (10.24) with its stated uniform remainder. $\square$

10.4.1 Examples and the first zero

For $n = 1$, $x_{1,1} = -\gamma$ and $c_{1,1} = e^\gamma$. Thus the unique zero of $\gamma_1^{(k)}$ satisfies

$$a_{1,1,k} = e^\gamma k + \frac{e^\gamma}{2} - \frac{1}{\exp(e^{-\gamma}) - 1} + O(k^{-1}). \quad (10.27)$$

The constant term is approximately -0.4370805068 . At $\rho = 0$ the zero is exactly e^{H_k} , whose constant term is $e^\gamma/2$; the Lerch kernel therefore changes the constant term, not the slope. A fully explicit refinement, obtained from Appendix 10.5, is available throughout the deformation. Put $c = e^\gamma$ and $g = \rho/(e^{1/c} - \rho)$. Then, uniformly in $\rho \in [0, 1]$,

$$a_k(\rho) = ck + \frac{c}{2} - g + \frac{1}{k} \left\{ \frac{c}{24} + \frac{g(g+1)}{c} - \frac{g(g+1)(2g+1)}{2c^2} \right\} + O(k^{-2}). \quad (10.28)$$

At $\rho = 1$, the coefficient of k^{-1} is approximately 0.0288707254211 . At $\rho = 0$ it is $c/24$, agreeing with the expansion of the exact zero e^{H_k} .

For $n = 2$ the roots are $-\gamma \pm \sqrt{\zeta(2)}$, and hence

$$c_{2,1} = e^{\gamma - \pi/\sqrt{6}}, \quad c_{2,2} = e^{\gamma + \pi/\sqrt{6}}. \quad (10.29)$$

The identity $Q''_n(x_j)/Q'_n(x_j) = 2 \sum_{i \neq j} (x_j - x_i)^{-1}$ gives an alternative expression for every offset entirely in terms of the Appell roots.

10.4.2 Nonasymptotic information at $n = 1$

Theorem 10.12 (Harmonic brackets and monotonicity). *For each $k \geq 1$ and $\rho \in [0, 1]$, $\mathcal{D}_{1,k}^\rho$ has exactly one positive zero, denoted $a_k(\rho)$. It is simple, and*

$$e^{H_{k-1}} < a_k(\rho) \leq e^{H_k}. \quad (10.30)$$

Equality at the upper endpoint occurs exactly when $\rho = 0$. The function $\rho \mapsto a_k(\rho)$ is continuous on $[0, 1]$ and strictly decreasing. In particular, $a_k(1) < a_k(\rho) < e^{H_k}$ for $0 < \rho < 1$.

Proof. Normalize the positive density proportional to $x^k e^{-ax} W_\rho(x)$ and write $m(a, \rho)$ for its expectation of $\log X + \gamma$. The sign of $F_{1,k}^\rho(a)$ is the sign of m . Under an unweighted gamma density of shape $k + 1$ and rate a , this expectation equals $H_k - \log a$. Weighting by the decreasing function

n	j	slope $c_{n,j}$	offset $d_{n,j}(1)$
1	1	1.781072417990	-0.437080506782
2	1	0.493943487920	0.287385687369
2	2	6.422230550060	-5.227782104747
3	1	0.261424326196	0.354674627668
3	2	1.064376550729	-0.506464646434
3	3	20.305020815096	-21.208385701520
4	1	0.172347335379	0.355378064541
4	2	0.465599872096	0.040510911109
4	3	2.062627326998	-2.178710104429
4	4	60.797835737559	-70.712693097880

Table 10.1: Numerical evaluations of the exact slope and offset formulas. These decimals are not isolating intervals. The accompanying CSV records zero computations at $k = 10, 40, 160$.

W_ρ lowers the expectation of the increasing function $\log X$; the decrease is strict when $\rho > 0$. The elementary covariance identity

$$2 \operatorname{Cov}(f(X), g(X)) = \mathbb{E}[(f(X) - f(X'))(g(X) - g(X'))]$$

for independent identically distributed X, X' justifies this comparison without an external stochastic-order theorem. Hence $m(e^{H_k}, \rho) \leq 0$, with equality exactly at $\rho = 0$.

Alternatively use a gamma density of shape k and rate a and weight it by $xW_\rho(x)$. This weight is strictly increasing, since

$$\frac{d}{dx} \frac{x}{1 - \rho e^{-x}} = \frac{1 - \rho(1+x)e^{-x}}{(1 - \rho e^{-x})^2} > 0 \quad (x > 0).$$

The unweighted expectation is $H_{k-1} - \log a$, so $m(e^{H_{k-1}}, \rho) > 0$. A zero exists between the brackets, and Theorem 10.7 proves uniqueness and simplicity.

For fixed ρ , exponential tilting gives $\partial_a m = -\operatorname{Cov}(\log X, X) < 0$. For $\rho_2 > \rho_1$, the ratio

$$\frac{W_{\rho_2}(x)}{W_{\rho_1}(x)} = \frac{1 - \rho_1 e^{-x}}{1 - \rho_2 e^{-x}}$$

is strictly decreasing in x . The same covariance comparison therefore gives $m(a, \rho_2) < m(a, \rho_1)$. Together with strict decrease in a , this implies $a_k(\rho_2) < a_k(\rho_1)$. Continuity follows from locally uniform dominated convergence in (10.11), uniqueness of the root, and the common compact bracket. No differentiability in ρ at the endpoint $\rho = 1$ is assumed. $\square$

10.4.3 Propagation and interlacing in the derivative order

Corollary 10.13 (Persistence and rightward interlacing). *Fix $n \geq 1$ and $\rho \in [0, 1]$. Once $F_{n,k}^\rho$ has n distinct positive zeros, the same is true at every larger derivative order. At consecutive such orders,*

$$a_{n,j,k}^\rho < a_{n,j,k+1}^\rho < a_{n,j+1,k}^\rho \quad (1 \leq j < n), \quad a_{n,n,k}^\rho < a_{n,n,k+1}^\rho. \quad (10.31)$$

Thus the unique $n = 1$ zero moves strictly rightward for every $k \geq 1$.

Proof. Differentiating the integral gives $F_{n,k+1}^\rho = -\partial_a F_{n,k}^\rho$. Rolle's theorem supplies a zero between each pair of consecutive simple zeros. Also $F_{n,k}^\rho(a) \rightarrow 0$ as $a \rightarrow \infty$, and it has a constant nonzero

sign after its last zero. There must be a stationary point after that zero: otherwise its nonzero derivative would have constant sign and could not both depart from zero and tend back to zero. Hence there are at least n distinct zeros at the next order. Theorem 10.7 gives exactly those zeros, all simple, and excludes any zero before the first interval or a coincident zero at an old simple root. Induction proves persistence. $\square$

10.5 A recurrence for the next zero coefficient

For a particular root, abbreviate $c_0 = c_{n,j}$ and $G_m(c, \rho) = (A_m h_{n,\rho})(1/c)$. Suppose

$$a_{n,j,k}^\rho = k c_0 + d + \frac{b_1}{k} + O(k^{-2}).$$

Taylor expansion of (10.19) gives

$$b_1 = -\frac{\frac{1}{2} \partial_c^2 G_0(c_0, \rho) d^2 + \partial_c G_1(c_0, \rho) d + G_2(c_0, \rho)}{\partial_c G_0(c_0, \rho)}. \quad (10.32)$$

Here d is (10.23), G_2 is explicit from (10.18), and the denominator is nonzero by (10.25). This is often more usable than a long expanded expression involving several root separations. It also explains why the quantity $k(a - k c_0 - d)$ tends to a finite limit. Higher coefficients follow by the same triangular recursion.

10.6 The classical half-unit bracket

For this specialization abbreviate $h_n = h_{n,1}$, and put $t_0 = e^{-\gamma}$.

Theorem 10.14 (Unique zero and an explicit bracket). *For every integer $k \geq 1$, $\gamma_1^{(k)}(a)$ has a unique positive zero a_k , which is simple. With $H_0 = 0$,*

$$e^{H_{k-1}} < a_k < e^{H_{k-1}} + \frac{1}{2}. \quad (10.33)$$

The zeros are strictly increasing in k . Their asymptotic expansion starts with

$$a_k = e^\gamma \left(k + \frac{1}{2}\right) - \frac{1}{e^{e^{-\gamma}} - 1} + O(k^{-1}). \quad (10.34)$$

Formula (10.32) supplies the next coefficient and an $O(k^{-2})$ remainder.

Proof. The endpoint signs, the Laplace representation above, and the bound of one zero prove existence, uniqueness, and simplicity. To obtain the bracket, normalize the positive density $t^k e^{-at}/(1 - e^{-t})$. The sign of $F_{1,k}(a)$ is the sign of $\mathbb{E}(\log T + \gamma)$ under this density.

Relative to a gamma density of shape k and rate a , the tilting factor is $r(t) = t/(1 - e^{-t})$, which is strictly increasing: its derivative has numerator $1 - e^{-t}(1 + t) > 0$. A strictly increasing tilt strictly increases the expectation of the strictly increasing function $\log t$. This elementary fact follows from

$$2 \operatorname{Cov}(u(X), v(X)) = \mathbb{E}[(u(X) - u(Y))(v(X) - v(Y))] > 0$$

for independent X, Y with the same continuous distribution and strictly increasing u, v . Consequently

$$\mathbb{E} \log T > \psi(k) - \log a = H_{k-1} - \gamma - \log a.$$

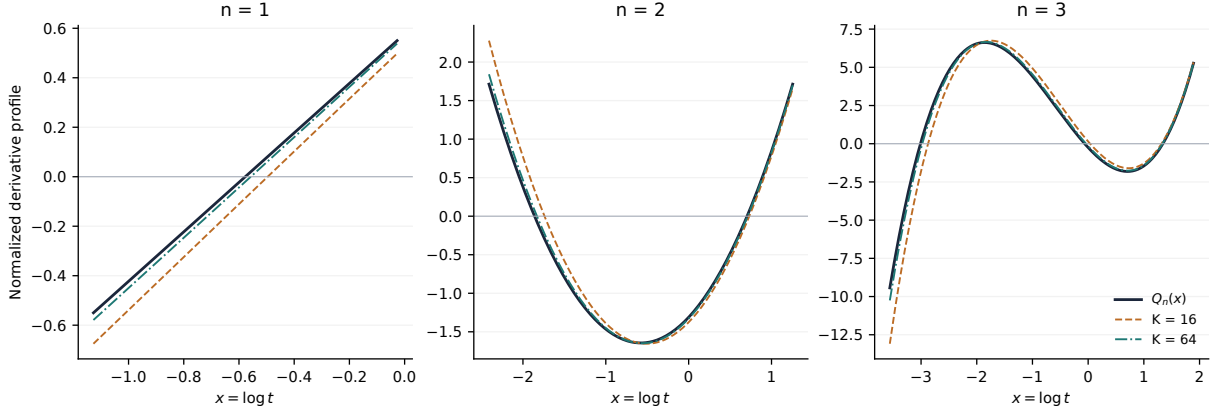


Figure 10.1: Normalized derivative profiles $(1 - e^{-e^x})\mathcal{H}_{n,K}(e^x)$ approach $Q_n(x)$ as $K = k + 1$ increases. Here $\mathcal{H}_{n,K}(t) = \mathbb{E}[Q_n(\log(tY/K))/(1 - e^{-tY/K})]$ for $Y \sim \text{Gamma}(K, 1)$. The plots illustrate $n = 1, 2, 3$. Quadrature produces the curves; Theorems 10.7 and 10.11, rather than the plots, prove the zero counts and asymptotic completeness.

At the zero this gives $a_k > e^{H_{k-1}} \geq 1$.

For $a > 1/2$, compare instead with a gamma density of shape k and rate $a - 1/2$. The tilting factor is $s(t) = t/(2 \sinh(t/2))$, which is strictly decreasing because $(t/2) \cosh(t/2) > \sinh(t/2)$. The covariance inequality reverses:

$$\mathbb{E} \log T < \psi(k) - \log(a - 1/2).$$

Applying it at $a_k > 1$ gives $a_k < e^{H_{k-1}} + 1/2$.

Finally, at a zero the signed kernel $f(t)$ in (10.11) satisfies $\int e^{-a_k t} f(t) dt = 0$ and $(t - t_0)f(t) > 0$ except at t_0 . Thus

$$F_{1,k+1}(a_k) = \int_0^\infty (t - t_0) e^{-a_k t} f(t) dt > 0.$$

Since $F_{1,k+1}$ crosses from positive to negative at its unique zero, $a_{k+1} > a_k$. The root of Q_1 is $-\gamma$, so (10.34) is Theorem 10.11. $\square$

The interval in (10.33) is an analytic certificate for bracketing a unique root, valid even at $k = 1$. Its width is uniformly $1/2$; no assertion that this is the best possible width is made. The accompanying computation uses this bracket rather than guessing an initial zero from a graph.

10.7 Exact low-index zero counts

The general theorem proves eventual saturation. At the classical endpoint $\rho = 1$, a finite exact certificate supplies a stronger statement for $1 \leq n \leq 4$ at every $k \geq 1$. Define the sign-preserving normalization

$$\mathcal{V}_{n,k}(a) = \frac{a^{k+1}(-1)^{n+k}}{k!} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a).$$

10.7.1 A reproducible Euler–Maclaurin sign certificate

The finite certificates above can be checked without floating-point special functions. Put $p = k + 1$, and define

$$R_{n,\ell}(v) = n! \sum_{j=0}^n e_{n-j}(\ell) \frac{(-v)^j}{j!}.$$

The master identity gives the absolutely convergent spectral representation

$$\mathcal{V}_{n,k}(a) = \sum_{m \geq 0} \left(\frac{a}{a+m} \right)^p R_{n,k}(\log(a+m)).$$

For positive rational a , integers $M, R \geq 1$, $A = a + M > 1$ and $L = k + 2R$, let

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{E}_{M,R} &= \sum_{m=0}^{M-1} \left(\frac{a}{a+m} \right)^p R_{n,k}(\log(a+m)) \\ &\quad + \left(\frac{a}{A} \right)^p \left[\frac{A}{k} R_{n,k-1}(\log A) + \frac{1}{2} R_{n,k}(\log A) \right] \\ &\quad + \left(\frac{a}{A} \right)^p \sum_{r=1}^R \frac{B_{2r}}{(2r)!} \left(\prod_{j=1}^{2r-1} \frac{k+j}{A} \right) R_{n,k+2r-1}(\log A). \end{aligned}$$

Proposition 10.15 (An explicit rational-certifiable remainder). *One has*

$$\begin{aligned} |\mathcal{V}_{n,k}(a) - \mathcal{E}_{M,R}| &\leq \left(\frac{a}{A} \right)^p \frac{|B_{2R}|}{(2R)!} \left(\prod_{j=1}^{2R-1} \frac{k+j}{A} \right) \mathcal{B}_{n,L}(\log A), \\ \mathcal{B}_{n,L}(v) &= \sum_{i=0}^{\min(n,L)} \sum_{j=0}^{n-i} \frac{n! e_i(L)}{(n-i-j)! L^j} v^{n-i-j}. \end{aligned}$$

Every factor in the bound is nonnegative.

Proof. Apply Euler–Maclaurin through the R th Bernoulli term to the spectral sum, or equivalently apply it to the Hurwitz series before extracting the n th spectral coefficient. The integral and half-endpoint terms give the second line of $\mathcal{E}_{M,R}$. The identity $(1+u)_k(k+1+u)_{2r-1} = (1+u)_{k+2r-1}$ gives its correction terms.

The periodic Bernoulli remainder has absolute kernel bound $|B_{2R}|$. After differentiation, bound the absolute value of $R_{n,L}(\log t)$ by $n! \sum_i e_i(L) (\log t)^{n-i} / (n-i)!$ for $t \geq A > 1$. For each $d \geq 0$,

$$\int_A^\infty t^{-L-1} \log^d t \, dt = \frac{A^{-L}}{L} \sum_{j=0}^d \frac{d!}{(d-j)! L^j} \log^{d-j} A.$$

The last factor in $(k+1)_{2R}$ cancels the leading L in this integral. Substitution yields precisely the displayed bound. $\square$

Logarithms of positive rationals have elementary rational enclosures. Reduce their argument to $1 \leq y < 2$ by a power of two, put $u = (y-1)/(y+1)$, and use

$$0 \leq \log y - 2 \sum_{j=0}^{T-1} \frac{u^{2j+1}}{2j+1} \leq \frac{2u^{2T+1}}{(2T+1)(1-u^2)}.$$

The interval verifier uses integer endpoints scaled by 10^{90} and rounds every operation outward. The Bernoulli numbers and $e_i(\ell)$ are exact rationals. A final enclosure lying strictly on one side of zero is therefore a sign certificate; the proof of the analytic remainder and the rational arithmetic play separate roles.

The fresh replay verified fourteen base signs for $n \leq 4$ and sixteen endpoint signs isolating the unique $n = 1$ roots for $k = 1, 2, 5, 10, 20, 50, 100, 200$. The endpoint pairs have width 10^{-20} . These are global root certificates because the zero-count theorem proves uniqueness, rather than merely sampled sign changes near a candidate root.

The following enclosures use integer interval arithmetic with outward rounding, rational logarithm bounds and a proved Euler–Maclaurin remainder. They have been replayed in this consolidation. The factor $a^{k+1}/k!$ is part of the tabulated value.

n	a	Certified enclosure for $\mathcal{V}_{n,1}(a)$	Sign
1	1	[0.70738581, 0.70738582]	+
1	1.5	[−0.20183770, −0.20183769]	−
2	1	[0.11418372, 0.11418373]	+
2	1.3	[−0.12008911, −0.12008910]	−
2	2	[0.45673490, 0.45673491]	+
3	0.8	[0.16385907, 0.16385908]	+
3	1.1	[−0.04095264, −0.04095263]	−
3	1.5	[0.05603756, 0.05603757]	+
3	2.1	[−0.24542536, −0.24542535]	−
4	0.8	[0.03897530, 0.03897531]	+
4	0.94	[−0.00338878, −0.00338877]	−
4	1.2	[0.02176370, 0.02176371]	+
4	1.7	[−0.03656822, −0.03656821]	−
4	2.2	[0.15091738, 0.15091739]	+

Corollary 10.16 (Saturation at every derivative order for $n \leq 4$). *For $1 \leq n \leq 4$ and every $k \geq 1$, $\gamma_n^{(k)}$ has exactly n positive zeros, all simple. They interlace to the right as k increases.*

Proof. At $k = 1$ each row group gives n sign-changing disjoint intervals, so there are at least n distinct zeros. The global bound with multiplicity makes them the only zeros and makes each simple. Persistence and interlacing follow from Corollary 10.13. $\square$

This finite certification does not settle every small- k case for $n \geq 5$, and it does not assert saturation at every small order uniformly in the Lerch deformation.

10.8 High parameter derivatives of Stieltjes constants

The parameter-derivative tower admits a useful separation into a finite polynomial coefficient and an exponentially small spectral tail. This gives a different asymptotic regime from the frequently studied limit of a large Stieltjes index with derivative order fixed. Here the derivative order k tends to infinity, while the index n may grow proportionally to $\log k$. The resulting profile is the reciprocal gamma function.

10.8.1 An exact spectral expansion

Fix the Laurent convention

$$\zeta(s, a) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n(a) (s-1)^n, \quad a > 0. \quad (10.35)$$

The superscript $\gamma_n^{(k)}(a)$ always denotes differentiation with respect to a , not to the index or the zeta variable. Define

$$P_{n,k}(x) = n! [z^n] \left(e^{xz} \prod_{j=1}^k \left(1 + \frac{z}{j} \right) \right). \quad (10.36)$$

This is a degree- n polynomial in x ; its coefficients are rational. In particular $P_{0,k} = 1$ and $P_{1,k}(x) = x + H_k$.

Theorem 10.17 (Spectral expansion and a finite-tail certificate). *For $a > 0$, integers $k \geq 1$, and $n \geq 0$,*

$$\frac{(-1)^{n+k}}{k!} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a) = \sum_{m=0}^{\infty} \frac{P_{n,k}(-\log(a+m))}{(a+m)^{k+1}}. \quad (10.37)$$

The series converges absolutely, locally uniformly for $a > 0$. If the sum is truncated before $m = M$, where $b = a + M \geq 1$, then for every real $0 < R < k$ the magnitude of the omitted part is at most

$$\frac{n!}{R^n} \prod_{j=1}^k \left(1 + \frac{R}{j} \right) \left(b^{-k-1+R} + \frac{b^{-k+R}}{k-R} \right). \quad (10.38)$$

Proof. The Hurwitz-zeta parameter identity

$$\partial_a^k \zeta(s, a) = (-1)^k (s)_k \zeta(s+k, a)$$

follows initially by differentiating its absolutely convergent Dirichlet series and then by analytic continuation; here $(s)_k = s(s+1) \cdots (s+k-1)$. The pole in (10.35) is independent of a . Put $s = 1 + z$, use $(1+z)_k = k! \prod_{j=1}^k (1+z/j)$, and compare coefficients. For $|z| < k$, the series for $\zeta(k+1+z, a)$ converges normally. This gives (10.37) and justifies the coefficient interchange. Alternatively, absolute convergence follows directly because each summand is a linear combination of $(a+m)^{-k-1} \log^\ell(a+m)$, $0 \leq \ell \leq n$. The parameter identity is also the starting point of Coffey's all-order formulas [25].

On the circle $|z| = R$, and for $x \geq b \geq 1$,

$$\left| e^{-z \log x} \prod_{j=1}^k (1 + z/j) \right| \leq x^R \prod_{j=1}^k (1 + R/j).$$

Cauchy's coefficient estimate bounds the m -th omitted summand by $n! R^{-n} \prod_j (1 + R/j) (a+m)^{-k-1+R}$. For the positive decreasing power, comparison with its integral gives

$$\sum_{m=M}^{\infty} (a+m)^{-k-1+R} \leq b^{-k-1+R} + \int_b^{\infty} x^{-k-1+R} dx.$$

This is (10.38). □

The condition $b \geq 1$ belongs to the stated majorant, rather than to the exact expansion. It always holds for the tail after the first term, because then $b = a + 1 > 1$. The choice of R can be optimized for a given n, k, M ; there is no need to differentiate a highly oscillatory numerical representation of γ_n .

10.8.2 Exact rational enclosures at parameter one

Write $\begin{bmatrix} v \\ u \end{bmatrix}$ for the unsigned Stirling number of the first kind. The elementary identity

$$\prod_{j=1}^k (1 + z/j) = \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{n=0}^k \begin{bmatrix} k+1 \\ n+1 \end{bmatrix} z^n \quad (10.39)$$

turns the first spectral term at $a = 1$ into an exact rational number.

Corollary 10.18 (Rational certificates). *Let $k \geq 2$, $n \geq 0$, and*

$$e_n(k) = \begin{cases} \begin{bmatrix} k+1 \\ n+1 \end{bmatrix} / k!, & 0 \leq n \leq k, \\ 0, & n > k. \end{cases}$$

For any integer $1 \leq h < k$, set

$$B_{k,n,h} = h^{-n} \binom{k+h}{h} \left(2^{-k-1+h} + \frac{2^{-k+h}}{k-h} \right). \quad (10.40)$$

Then the following is an exact inclusion between real numbers:

$$\frac{(-1)^{n+k} \gamma_n^{(k)}(1)}{k! n!} \in [e_n(k) - B_{k,n,h}, e_n(k) + B_{k,n,h}]. \quad (10.41)$$

One may take the minimum radius over all $h = 1, \dots, k-1$. In particular, the simple choice $h = 1$ gives

$$B_k = (k+1) \left(2^{-k} + \frac{2^{-k+1}}{k-1} \right), \quad (10.42)$$

independently of n .

Proof. Apply Theorem 10.17 with $a = M = 1$, $b = 2$, and $R = h$, and divide its bound by $n!$. The product in that bound is $\prod_{j=1}^k (1 + h/j) = \binom{k+h}{h}$. Equation (10.39) supplies the center. All quantities in the resulting endpoints are rational. $\square$

Thus the term *certificate* has its literal meaning here: integer arithmetic constructs the endpoints, and the proved tail bound supplies the inclusion. Floating-point agreement is not being renamed a proof. For example, positivity of an endpoint $e_n(k) - B_{k,n,h}$ rigorously proves $(-1)^{n+k} \gamma_n^{(k)}(1) > 0$. The accompanying script emits centers, radii, and both endpoints as numerator–denominator pairs, and checks their arithmetic exactly.

10.8.3 A uniform coefficient lemma

The main asymptotic step is an elementary coefficient estimate. It is convenient to set $n^j = n(n-1)\cdots(n-j+1)$ for $j \leq n$, and $n^j = 0$ for $j > n$.

Lemma 10.19 (Two uniform coefficient terms). *Suppose f is analytic on a neighborhood of the closed disk $|z| \leq R$, with $|f(z)| \leq M$ there. Let $L > 0$, $n \geq 1$, and $r = n/L < R$. Put*

$$Q_n(L; f) = \frac{n!}{L^n} [z^n] e^{Lz} f(z).$$

Then

$$|Q_n(L; f) - f(r)| \leq \frac{Mn}{L^2 R^2 (1 - r/R)^3}, \quad (10.43)$$

$$\left| Q_n(L; f) - f(r) + \frac{n}{2L^2} f''(r) \right| \leq \frac{3Mn}{L^3 R^3 (1 - r/R)^5}. \quad (10.44)$$

For $n = 0$, $Q_0(L; f) = f(0)$ exactly.

Proof. Write $f(z) = \sum_{j \geq 0} c_j z^j$. Since $|c_j| \leq MR^{-j}$,

$$Q_n(L; f) = \sum_{j \geq 0} c_j \frac{n^j}{L^j}$$

is a finite sum, which we compare with the absolutely convergent Taylor series at r .

For completeness, the needed inequalities remain valid when $j > n$. Choose j independent uniform elements of a set of n elements. The probability of no repeated choice is n^j/n^j , including its value zero when $j > n$. For the $K = \binom{j}{2}$ pair-collision events, every event has probability $1/n$, and every intersection of two distinct events has probability $1/n^2$, even if the pairs share a position. The union bound and the first two Bonferroni inequalities give

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &\leq n^j - n^{\underline{j}} \leq \binom{j}{2} n^{j-1}, \\ 0 &\leq n^{\underline{j}} - n^j + \binom{j}{2} n^{j-1} \leq \binom{\binom{j}{2}}{2} n^{j-2}. \end{aligned}$$

At $j = 0, 1, 2$, the second remainder is zero, so no negative-power exception is needed. Now use

$$\sum_{j \geq 2} \binom{j}{2} x^{j-2} = (1-x)^{-3}, \quad \sum_{j \geq 3} \binom{\binom{j}{2}}{2} x^{j-3} = 3(1-x)^{-5}.$$

The first inequality gives (10.43). In the second comparison,

$$\sum_{j \geq 2} c_j \binom{j}{2} \frac{n^{j-1}}{L^j} = \frac{n}{2L^2} f''(r).$$

This proves (10.44). □

10.8.4 The reciprocal-gamma profile

Theorem 10.20 (A joint logarithmic-range asymptotic). *Fix $0 < a_0 \leq a_1 < \infty$ and $C > 0$. For $a \in [a_0, a_1]$, put*

$$L = \log(k/a), \quad r = \frac{n}{L}, \quad g(r) = \frac{1}{\Gamma(1+r)}, \quad \rho = \frac{a_1}{a_1+1} < 1.$$

Uniformly over integers $0 \leq n \leq CL$, as $k \rightarrow \infty$,

$$\frac{(-1)^{n+k} a^{k+1} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a)}{k! L^n} = g(r) - \frac{n}{2L^2} g''(r) + O_{a_0, a_1, C} \left(\frac{n}{L^3} + k^{C+1} \rho^k \right). \quad (10.45)$$

Equivalently, the two displayed terms are

$$\frac{1}{\Gamma(1+r)} \left[1 + \frac{n}{2L^2} \left\{ \psi^{(1)}(1+r) - \psi(1+r)^2 \right\} \right]. \quad (10.46)$$

The formula includes $n = 0$, for which the first spectral term is exactly one. In particular, if $n/\log(k/a) \rightarrow c \geq 0$ in a bounded range, then the left side of (10.45) tends to $1/\Gamma(1+c)$.

Proof. Separate the $m = 0$ term of (10.37). Its generating function factors as

$$e^{-z \log a} \prod_{j=1}^k (1 + z/j) = e^{Lz} f_k(z), \quad f_k(z) = k^{-z} \prod_{j=1}^k (1 + z/j).$$

The gamma product gives

$$f_k(z) = \frac{\Gamma(k+1+z)}{\Gamma(k+1)k^z\Gamma(1+z)} = g(z)e^{D_k(z)}.$$

On $|z| < k+1$, define the analytic function

$$D_k(z) = z(H_k - \log k - \gamma) + \sum_{\ell=2}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^\ell z^\ell}{\ell} (\zeta(\ell) - H_k^{(\ell)}). \quad (10.47)$$

The factorization follows first on a small disk from the Weierstrass product and then throughout $|z| < k+1$ by analytic continuation. Defining D_k by its series avoids taking the logarithm of g at its zeros.

The elementary bounds

$$0 < H_k - \log k - \gamma < \frac{1}{2k}, \quad \sum_{j>k} j^{-2} \leq \frac{1}{k}$$

imply, for $|z| \leq R < k+1$,

$$|D_k(z)| \leq \frac{R}{2k} + \frac{R^2}{2k(1 - R/(k+1))}. \quad (10.48)$$

Indeed, for $\ell \geq 2$, bound the tail of $\zeta(\ell)$ by $(k+1)^{2-\ell}/k$, and use $1/\ell \leq 1/2$. Consequently f_k is uniformly bounded on every fixed disk, $f_k - g = O_R(k^{-1})$, and Cauchy's estimate gives $f_k'' - g'' = O_C(k^{-1})$ on $[0, C]$. The same estimate with $R = r$, or the real product, also gives the slightly sharper

$$f_k(r) - g(r) = O_C(r/k) \quad (0 \leq r \leq C).$$

It is this factor r that preserves the exact $n = 0$ first term.

Choose $R = C + 1$ in Lemma 10.19. For $n \geq 1$ the normalized first spectral term is

$$Q_n(L; f_k) = f_k(r) - \frac{n}{2L^2} f_k''(r) + O_C(n/L^3).$$

Replacing f_k by g costs $O_C(n/(kL) + n/(kL^2))$, which is absorbed in $O(n/L^3)$ because $L^2 \leq k$ for all sufficiently large k , uniformly on the compact parameter interval.

It remains to control the other spectral terms. Apply (10.38) with $M = 1$, and multiply the bound by a^{k+1}/L^n . The result is

$$\frac{n!}{(RL)^n} \prod_{j=1}^k (1 + R/j) \left(\frac{a}{a+1} \right)^{k+1} (a+1)^R \left(1 + \frac{a+1}{k-R} \right).$$

The first factor is at most one: for $n \geq 1$, use $n! \leq n^n$ and $n/L \leq C < R$; for $n = 0$, it is one by convention. The product is $O_R(k^R)$, as follows already from (10.48) at $z = R$. The remaining factors are uniformly bounded apart from $(a/(a+1))^{k+1} \leq \rho^{k+1}$. Thus the normalized tail is $O_{a_0, a_1, C}(k^{C+1} \rho^k)$. The case $n = 0$ follows directly from $P_{0,k} = 1$. Finally, $g''(r) = g(r)\{\psi(1+r)^2 - \psi^{(1)}(1+r)\}$. $\square$

Corollary 10.21 (A uniform eventual sign). *For every compact interval $[a_0, a_1] \subset (0, \infty)$ and every $C > 0$, there is k_0 such that*

$$(-1)^{n+k} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a) > 0$$

for all $k \geq k_0$, $a \in [a_0, a_1]$, and integers $0 \leq n \leq C \log(k/a)$.

Proof. The continuous function g is strictly positive on $[0, C]$, so its minimum there is positive. Both the displayed correction and the remainder in Theorem 10.20 tend uniformly to zero. The other factors in the normalization are positive. $\square$

The corollary is restricted to its stated range. It gives no sign theorem when n grows arbitrarily quickly compared with $\log k$. For a concrete finite pair n, k at $a = 1$, the rational interval in Corollary 10.18 is a separate, effective certificate.

10.8.5 Fixed-index expansions and the classical mechanism

For a fixed n , it is also useful to retain the polynomial in $L = \log(k/a)$. Define Appell polynomials

$$A_n(L) = n! [z^n] \frac{e^{Lz}}{\Gamma(1+z)}.$$

The first few are

$$\begin{aligned} A_0(L) &= 1, \\ A_1(L) &= L + \gamma, \\ A_2(L) &= (L + \gamma)^2 - \zeta(2), \\ A_3(L) &= (L + \gamma)^3 - 3\zeta(2)(L + \gamma) + 2\zeta(3). \end{aligned}$$

The standard gamma-ratio expansion [45] gives, uniformly on fixed z -disks,

$$e^{D_k(z)} = 1 + \frac{z + z^2}{2k} + \frac{3z^4 + 2z^3 - 3z^2 - 2z}{24k^2} + O(k^{-3}).$$

Consequently, for fixed $n \geq 1$ and a in a compact positive interval,

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{(-1)^{n+k} a^{k+1} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a)}{k!} &= A_n(L) + \frac{nA_{n-1}(L) + n(n-1)A_{n-2}(L)}{2k} \\ &\quad + O_n \left(\frac{(1+L)^{n-1}}{k^2} \right) + O_{a_0, a_1, n}(k^2 \rho^k). \end{aligned} \quad (10.49)$$

Terms with a negative Appell index are omitted. To see the stated polynomial error, note that the analytic remainder after the first correction vanishes at $z = 0$; its coefficient convolution with $e^{Lz}g(z)$ therefore has degree at most $n-1$ in L . For $n = 0$ the first term is exact and only the

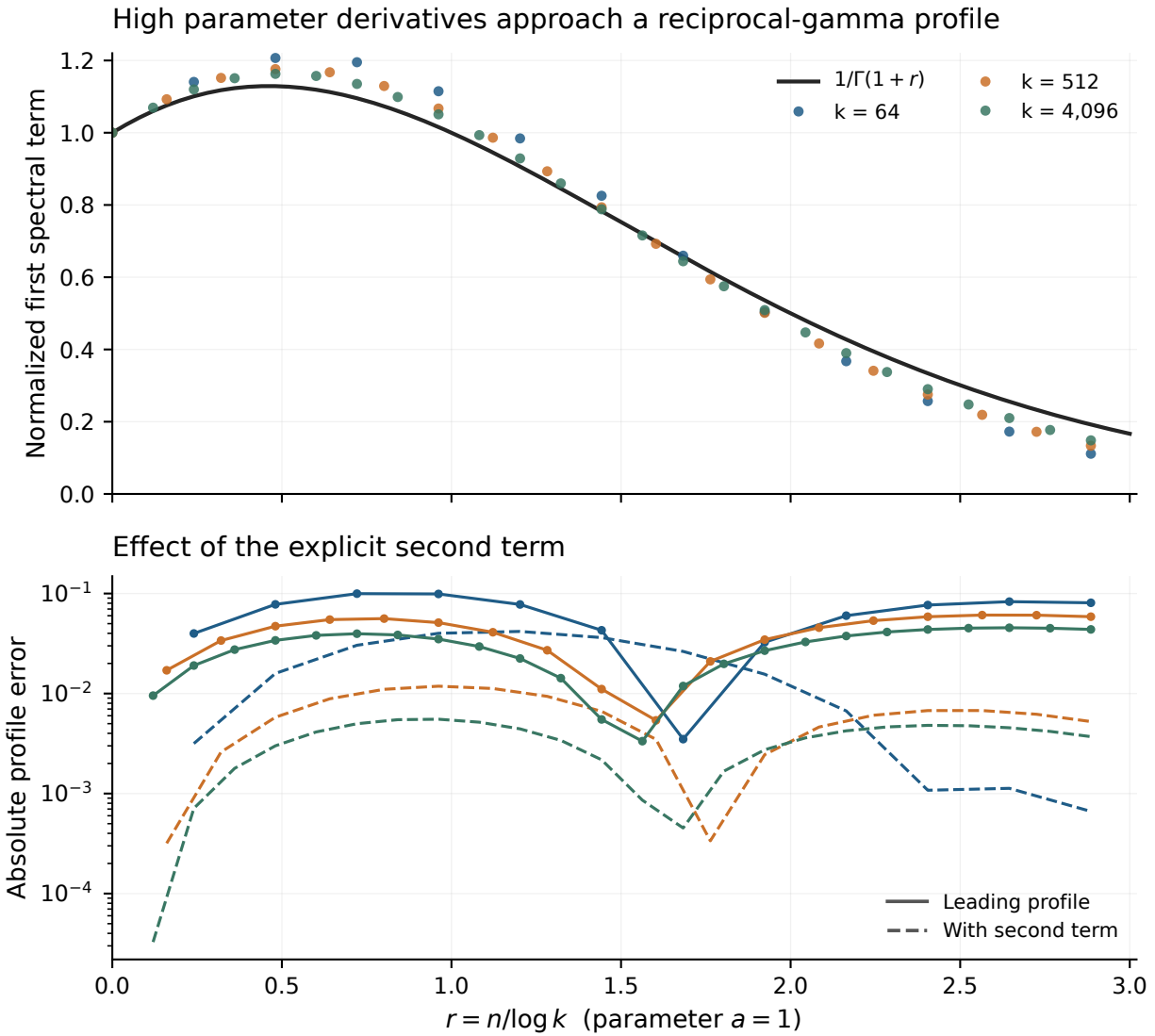


Figure 10.2: The reciprocal-gamma profile at $a = 1$. The first spectral term is computed from the elementary-symmetric coefficient recurrence; its rigorously bounded spectral error is smaller than the plotted resolution. The lower panel compares its deviation from the limiting profile with its deviation after the explicit second term is included. These plotted arithmetic evaluations are floating point; the separate rational certificates do not depend on them.

spectral error remains. Higher powers of k^{-1} follow by the same coefficient procedure. For example the k^{-2} numerator is

$$\frac{1}{24} (3n^4 A_{n-4} + 2n^3 A_{n-3} - 3n^2 A_{n-2} - 2n A_{n-1}).$$

At $a = 1$, (10.39) identifies the first spectral term with first-kind Stirling numbers. These are also the cycle-count coefficients of permutations. The reciprocal-gamma factor is thus a classical mechanism, closely related to mod-Poisson asymptotics [52]. The contribution to this programme is the explicit spectral transfer, the uniform second coefficient estimate, and the exact rational enclosure, not a claim that the reciprocal-gamma phenomenon itself is new.

10.9 The first classical failure of saturation: the fifth index

The first four Stieltjes indices in the preceding discussion have the maximum possible number of positive parameter-derivative zeros at every derivative order. That pattern fails at the next index. The failure is not restricted to a Lerch deformation: it occurs at the classical Hurwitz endpoint itself. We prove the exact transition

$$\#\{a > 0 : \gamma_5^{(k)}(a) = 0\} = \begin{cases} 3, & k = 1, 2, \\ 5, & k \geq 3, \end{cases} \quad (10.50)$$

and every zero in this display is simple. Thus the least derivative order after which fifth-index saturation persists is exactly three.

Two ingredients distinguish this conclusion from a numerical zero scan. A general upper bound of five controls the entire positive axis at order three. Certified signs at its stationary points then count the zeros at orders two and one by monotonicity. The large positive zeros near 148.9122 and 319.6184 are essential to this argument; a scan confined to a small neighborhood of $a = 1$ misses them.

10.9.1 Endpoint signs, parity, and monotonicity of zero counts

Retain the Laurent convention

$$\zeta(s, a) = \frac{1}{s-1} + \sum_{n \geq 0} \frac{(-1)^n}{n!} \gamma_n(a) (s-1)^n, \quad a > 0.$$

For the classical family write

$$U_{n,k}(a) = (-1)^{n+k} \gamma_n^{(k)}(a), \quad k \geq 1.$$

Then $U'_{n,k} = -U_{n,k+1}$. The established Appell–Laplace formula is

$$U_{n,k}(a) = \int_0^\infty \frac{t^k e^{-at}}{1 - e^{-t}} Q_n(\log t) dt, \quad \frac{e^{xz}}{\Gamma(1+z)} = \sum_{n \geq 0} Q_n(x) \frac{z^n}{n!}. \quad (10.51)$$

The reciprocal-gamma product makes Q_n strictly real-rooted, and Laplace variation diminution therefore bounds the positive zero count by n , including multiplicities. These are the global zero theorem and its proof mechanism, reproduced in Section 10.2 for completeness. The classical parameter-derivative identity underlying (10.51) is also contained in Coffey’s all-order formulas [25].

For fixed $n \geq 0$ and $k \geq 1$ the endpoint expansions are

$$U_{n,k}(a) \sim k! a^{-k-1} \log^n(1/a), \quad a \downarrow 0, \quad (10.52)$$

$$U_{n,k}(a) \sim (-1)^n (k-1)! a^{-k} \log^n a, \quad a \rightarrow \infty. \quad (10.53)$$

When $n = 0$, the logarithmic powers mean one. The first formula follows either by scaling the integral or by differentiating the shift term $\log^n a/a$ in $\gamma_n(a) = \log^n a/a + \gamma_n(a+1)$. For the second, set $t = u/a$ in (10.51) and use $(1 - e^{-u/a})^{-1} = a/u + O(1 + u/a)$ together with monicity of Q_n . The bound $(1 - e^{-v})^{-1} \leq 1 + v^{-1}$ supplies an integrable majorant after expanding the fixed polynomial in $\log u - \log a$. In particular, every $U_{n,k}$ tends to zero at infinity and has fixed strict signs near both endpoints.

Proposition 10.22 (Parity and persistence before saturation). *Let $N_{n,k}$ be the total multiplicity of the positive zeros of $\gamma_n^{(k)}$. Then*

$$0 \leq N_{n,k} \leq n, \quad N_{n,k} \equiv n \pmod{2}, \quad N_{n,k+1} \geq N_{n,k}. \quad (10.54)$$

Consequently every strict increase in the total zero count is by an even integer. The same assertions hold, at each fixed $0 \leq \rho \leq 1$, for the Stieltjes–Lerch family $D_{n,k}^\rho$.

Proof. The upper bound is the global variation theorem. The endpoint signs in (10.52)–(10.53) show that the total multiplicity has parity n : a real analytic zero reverses sign exactly when its multiplicity is odd.

Suppose the distinct zeros of $U_{n,k}$ are $r_1 < \dots < r_q$, with multiplicities $m_1, \dots, m_q$ and total $N = \sum_i m_i > 0$. Its derivative has inherited multiplicity $m_i - 1$ at each r_i , and Rolle’s theorem supplies a zero between each successive pair. These account for at least $(N - q) + (q - 1) = N - 1$ derivative zeros counted with multiplicity. There is one more stationary point strictly after r_q : a nonzero function leaving zero at r_q , with constant sign afterwards and limit zero at infinity, must attain an interior extremum. Thus $U_{n,k+1} = -U'_{n,k}$ has at least N zeros counted with multiplicity. The case $N = 0$ is immediate.

For fixed $\rho < 1$, the analogous Mellin weight $(1 - \rho e^{-t})^{-1}$ is positive and tends to $(1 - \rho)^{-1}$ at zero. The large- a leading term is then $(-1)^n k! (1 - \rho)^{-1} a^{-k-1} \log^n a$; the small- a leading term is unchanged. The same endpoint and Rolle arguments apply, including the possible multiple zeros at $\rho = 0$. $\square$

Proposition 10.23 (A classical lower bound from matching endpoint data). *For every $k \geq 1$, $\gamma_n^{(k)}$ has at least two distinct positive zeros if $n \geq 2$ is even, and at least three distinct positive zeros if $n \geq 3$ is odd. In particular, saturation for $n = 2, 3$ at every derivative order follows analytically, without a finite sign certificate.*

Proof. For $n \geq 2$, the shift identity at $a = 1$ and its first derivative give

$$\gamma_n(1) = \gamma_n(2), \quad \gamma'_n(1) = \gamma'_n(2), \quad \int_1^2 \gamma'_n(a) da = 0.$$

Put $g = \gamma'_n$. This is a nonzero real analytic function. If its common endpoint value is positive, its integral forces a negative interior value; hence there are at least two sign-changing zeros in $(1, 2)$. The same conclusion holds with signs reversed when the common endpoint value is negative. If the common endpoint value is zero, the integral forces both signs in the interior, and there are at least three distinct zeros in $[1, 2]$, including the endpoints.

For odd n in the nonzero-endpoint case, the two interior sign-changing zeros have odd multiplicities. The odd total parity from Proposition 10.22 forces an additional odd-multiplicity zero, distinct from them. This proves the asserted lower bounds at $k = 1$. Rolle's theorem between distinct zeros, together with the stationary point after the last zero used above, preserves a lower bound on the number of distinct zeros at every subsequent derivative order. The global upper bound makes the two or three zeros simple when $n = 2$ or $n = 3$. $\square$

Thus the count three in (10.50) is the smallest possible classical fifth-index count. Passing from order two to order three raises the positive zero count by exactly two.

10.9.2 A finite certificate that controls the whole positive axis

For the remainder of the proof abbreviate

$$U_k = U_{5,k}, \quad V_k(a) = \frac{a^{k+1}}{k!} U_k(a).$$

The normalization V_k preserves signs, but its stationary points are not the zeros of U_{k+1} . All monotonicity arguments below are applied to U_k , while V_k is used only for stable sign enclosures.

Let $\varepsilon = 10^{-16}$. Each row of Table 10.2 specifies a rational interval $[\ell, \ell + \varepsilon]$. The stated endpoint signs of V_k are certified by the rational Euler–Maclaurin enclosure already derived above; the displayed error bound is valid for every fixed nonnegative index.

k	j	ℓ	sign at ℓ	sign at $\ell + 10^{-16}$
3	1	0.9409528529131887	+	–
3	2	1.1292935180347063	–	+
3	3	1.6357795548293846	+	–
3	4	6.1361342793896981	–	+
3	5	319.6184025568026870	+	–
2	1	1.3713298168772550	+	–
2	2	1.9113619446041762	–	+
2	3	148.9122045692035618	+	–
1	1	1.1378900542449414	+	–
1	2	1.6389372768448503	–	+
1	3	2.1249028498579805	+	–

Table 10.2: Rational isolating intervals of width 10^{-16} . These endpoint signs and the critical-value signs in the next table are finite certificates. The proof establishes uniqueness and completeness.

Denote the five third-order roots by $c_1 < \dots < c_5$ and the three second-order roots by $d_1 < d_2 < d_3$. The interval computation also encloses the preceding-order function uniformly on every indicated root interval. Table 10.3 lists rational enclosures with outward rounding; they apply in particular at the true roots.

Theorem 10.24 (The exact fifth-index transition). *The positive zero counts are exactly those in (10.50). All zeros are simple. The eleven intervals in Table 10.2 isolate all zeros at derivative orders one, two, and three. For every $k \geq 3$, the five zeros at order $k + 1$ strictly interlace to the right of those at order k .*

Quantity	Certified rational enclosure
$V_2(c_1)$	[0.006154632340, 0.006154632341]
$V_2(c_2)$	[0.041073722584, 0.041073722585]
$V_2(c_3)$	[-0.097090480335, -0.097090480334]
$V_2(c_4)$	[106.545043234228, 106.545043234229]
$V_2(c_5)$	[-135615.425337743697, -135615.425337743695]
$V_1(d_1)$	[-0.014754703693, -0.014754703692]
$V_1(d_2)$	[0.028710652775, 0.028710652776]
$V_1(d_3)$	[-466915.576951780840, -466915.576951780837]

Table 10.3: Signs of the lower-order function at every critical point. The verifier encloses the function on the entire rational root bracket, so these signs do not presume a floating-point approximation to a root.

Proof. The five third-order interval signs give at least five distinct zeros of U_3 . The global upper bound of five, counting multiplicity, shows that they are all its positive zeros and that each is simple. Starting with the positive left endpoint sign, the signs of U_3 on the six complementary intervals are

$$+, -, +, -, +, -.$$

Consequently $U_2' = -U_3$ has constant nonzero sign on each such interval. Its values at the five critical points have signs

$$\text{sgn}(U_2(c_1), \dots, U_2(c_5)) = (+, +, -, +, -).$$

Therefore there is exactly one second-order zero in each of (c_2, c_3) , (c_3, c_4) , and (c_4, c_5) , and no zero in $(0, c_1)$ or (c_1, c_2) . After c_5 , the function U_2 is strictly increasing from a negative value to its limit zero, so there is no zero there either. The three zeros lie away from the critical points, so each is simple. Their brackets in Table 10.2 consequently identify them as d_1, d_2, d_3 .

The signs of U_2 are now $+, -, +, -$ on the four intervals cut out by the d_j , and $U_1' = -U_2$. The critical-value signs are $-, +, -$. Since U_1 is positive near zero, strict monotonicity gives exactly one zero in each of $(0, d_1)$, (d_1, d_2) , and (d_2, d_3) . After d_3 , U_1 increases from a negative value to zero, so it has no further zero. Again all three crossings are simple.

Finally, five simple zeros at order three force at least five distinct zeros at the next order: Rolle supplies four between adjacent roots and the vanishing tail supplies one after the last root. The global upper bound gives exactly five simple zeros, with no additional zero before the first interval. Repeating proves saturation and strict right interlacing for every $k \geq 3$. $\square$

This proof uses no claim that a dense set of sampled values accounts for every zero. Completeness at the highest checked order comes from a global analytic theorem; completeness at lower orders comes from the complete list of stationary points and their certified signs.

The fresh replay supplies twenty-two root endpoint signs and eight signs on whole critical-point intervals, using denominator 10^{80} , 120 logarithm-series terms, 24 initial Hurwitz summands and 16 Bernoulli corrections. The generic remainder proof in the preceding certificate subsection applies with $n = 5$. No floating-point sign enters acceptance. The data and executable verifier remain with the full incoming package.

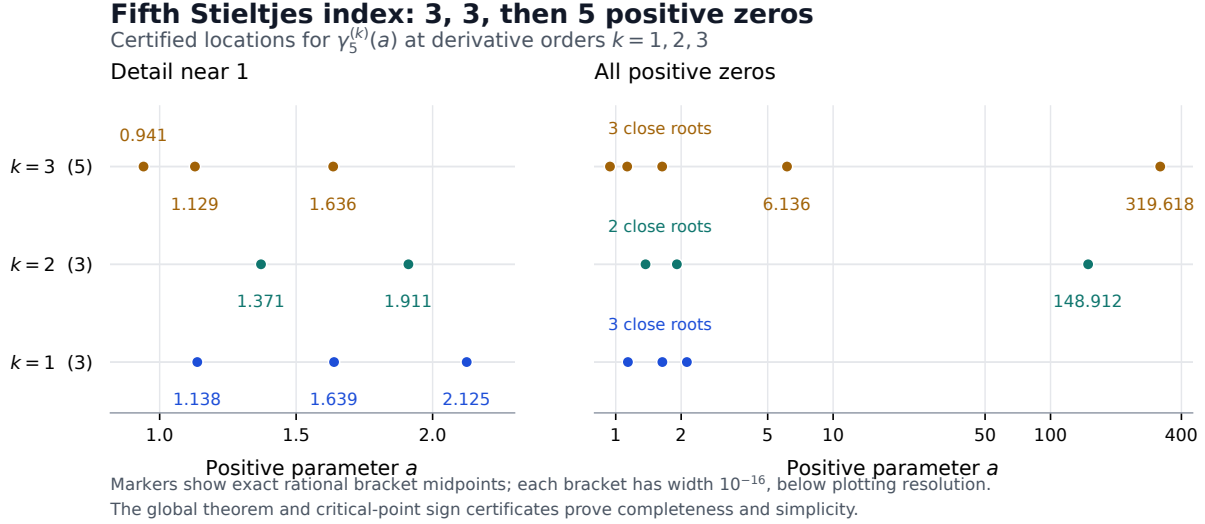


Figure 10.3: The eleven certified zero locations. The local panel separates the near-unit roots; the logarithmic panel includes the large roots. The brackets have width 10^{-16} , much smaller than a plotted marker.

10.10 Exact sixth- and seventh-index saturation thresholds

The incoming fifth-index method suggests a reproducible extension of the classical zero classification. Its next two first-derivative counts were reported only as numerical conjectures. Exact critical-value descent now settles both indices at every derivative order, not only the sampled first order. The argument retains the existing global bound and adds finite rational signs; it does not infer completeness from an approximate scan.

Theorem 10.25 (The next two classical transitions). *Let $N_{n,k}$ count the positive zeros of $\gamma_n^{(k)}$, with multiplicity. For every integer $k \geq 1$,*

$$N_{6,k} = \begin{cases} 4, & 1 \leq k \leq 3, \\ 6, & k \geq 4, \end{cases} \quad N_{7,k} = \begin{cases} 5, & 1 \leq k \leq 4, \\ 7, & k \geq 5. \end{cases}$$

Every zero is simple. Thus the least classical saturation thresholds are $K_6^{\text{cl}} = 4$ and $K_7^{\text{cl}} = 5$. At and above each threshold, the next-order zeros strictly interlace to the right of the current ones.

Retain $U_{n,k} = (-1)^{n+k} \gamma_n^{(k)}$ and the sign-preserving normalization $V_{n,k} = a^{k+1} U_{n,k} / k!$ of the previous section. The endpoint expansions give $U_{n,k} > 0$ near zero, $\text{sgn } U_{n,k} = (-1)^n$ near infinity, and $U_{n,k} \rightarrow 0$ there. Also $U'_{n,k} = -U_{n,k+1}$.

Lemma 10.26 (Complete descent from critical-value signs). *Suppose all positive zeros $c_1 < \dots < c_r$ of $U_{n,k+1}$ are simple, and $U_{n,k}(c_j)$ has a nonzero certified sign s_j at each one. Put $s_0 = 1$. Then every positive zero of $U_{n,k}$ is simple and*

$$N_{n,k} = \#\{0 \leq j < r : s_j \neq s_{j+1}\}.$$

There is no zero on the final interval (c_r, ∞) .

Proof. On each open interval cut out by the complete critical-point list, $U'_{n,k} = -U_{n,k+1}$ is nonzero and has constant sign. Hence $U_{n,k}$ is strictly monotone there. Its limits or endpoint values show one crossing exactly when the stated signs differ. It cannot vanish at a critical point, since each critical value is nonzero. On the final interval it is strictly monotone with limit zero; a nonzero strictly monotone function tending to zero cannot cross zero there. Every crossing lies where the derivative is nonzero, so it is simple. These intervals cover the whole positive axis. $\square$

n	k	j	Lower endpoint ℓ	$V_{n,k}(\ell)$	$V_{n,k}(\ell + 10^{-14})$
6	4	1	0.95661907907155	+	−
6	4	2	1.07179934147775	−	+
6	4	3	1.51367699674930	+	−
6	4	4	3.14848332199473	−	+
6	4	5	16.34597601190147	+	−
6	4	6	1389.12290266995208	−	+
7	5	1	0.97564797285268	+	−
7	5	2	1.03011037496236	−	+
7	5	3	1.39376738084727	+	−
7	5	4	2.31266214479726	−	+
7	5	5	5.93513467415295	+	−
7	5	6	38.92782595180997	−	+
7	5	7	5297.39431175614964	+	−

Table 10.4: All saturated-order root brackets. Each displayed decimal is an exact rational number, and each bracket has width 10^{-14} . The signs are determined by outward integer intervals, rather than floating-point root approximations.

n	Known critical order	Predecessor order	Signs at all critical points	Count
6	4	3	+, +, −, +, −, +	4
6	3	2	−, +, −, +	4
6	2	1	−, +, −, +	4
7	5	4	+, +, −, +, −, +, −	5
7	4	3	−, +, −, +, −	5
7	3	2	−, +, −, +, −	5
7	2	1	−, +, −, +, −	5

Table 10.5: The complete critical-value descent. Each predecessor sign is certified uniformly over the entire rational root bracket of its derivative.

Proof of Theorem 10.25. The terminal brackets in Table 10.4 have opposite strict endpoint signs, so give six distinct zeros at $(n, k) = (6, 4)$ and seven at $(7, 5)$. The global bound with multiplicity, Theorem 10.7, makes these complete lists and all their zeros simple. On every terminal bracket the preceding derivative has the sign recorded in the first applicable row of Table 10.5. Thus Lemma 10.26 gives exactly four sixth-index roots at order three and five seventh-index roots at order four.

The same exact certificate file supplies disjoint brackets with opposite endpoint signs for every one of these predecessor roots. Since the preceding descent already proves the total count, these brackets form the complete critical-point lists for the next step. Their whole-interval predecessor

signs are the next rows of Table 10.5. Iterating the lemma reaches order one, with the counts displayed in the theorem and simple zeros throughout. This use of lower-order brackets has no circular completeness assumption: their completeness is established before the next descent step.

At a saturated order there are n distinct simple zeros. Rolle's theorem supplies $n - 1$ next-order zeros between adjacent ones and one after the last, because the function has a nonzero sign there and tends back to zero. The same global bound makes these exactly n simple zeros, with strict right interlacing. Induction covers every larger order. The lower counts prove minimality of the two thresholds. $\square$

The exact evidence and its analytic contract. The finite proof data contain 45 rational root brackets: 18 for the sixth index and 27 for the seventh. They require **90** endpoint enclosures and **36** whole critical-interval enclosures. The first implementation uses the generic Euler–Maclaurin bound already proved in this chapter, with fixed denominator 10^{80} , 120 logarithm-series terms, 24 initial Hurwitz terms and 16 Bernoulli corrections. Its elementary symmetric coefficient table is rebuilt through degree seven; this changes no analytic hypothesis in the index-uniform remainder formula.

A second implementation independently extracts rising-factorial coefficients and encloses all 126 signs. It uses denominator 10^{100} , 128 logarithm-series terms, 32 initial Hurwitz terms and 16 Bernoulli corrections. Its precision was increased because the delivered 55-digit default could not resolve some new narrow brackets after very small powers were multiplied by large factorial coefficients. Unresolved intervals were never accepted as signs. Both replays use exact integer and fraction arithmetic throughout acceptance. The complete endpoints, analytic error budgets, source digests and descent signs are retained in `verification/higher-zero-certificates.json` and `verification/higher-zero-independent.json`.

The resulting first thresholds are

$$(K_1^{\text{cl}}, \dots, K_7^{\text{cl}}) = (1, 1, 1, 1, 3, 4, 5).$$

This finite sequence suggests further threshold questions; it does not prove a formula in the index. In particular no claim that $K_n^{\text{cl}} = n - 2$ for every $n \geq 5$ is made. Extending the terminating critical-point method with effective saturation estimates is a concrete next research problem.

Chapter 11

Herglotz arithmetic and quadratic regulators

The Herglotz function joins the digamma series to finite dilogarithm sums. At rational arguments this supplies exact evaluations; at quadratic units it connects continued-fraction cycles with real-quadratic Kronecker limits. The same experimental strategy thus leads from a finite cyclotomic sum to regulator candidates in class fields.

11.1 The function and the exact dilogarithm sum

For $x > 0$ define

$$F(x) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{\psi(nx) - \log(nx)}{n}, \quad J(x) = \int_0^1 \frac{\log(1+t^x)}{1+t} dt.$$

The series is locally uniformly convergent on the positive line and extends analytically to the cut plane $\mathbb{C} \setminus (-\infty, 0]$. Radchenko–Zagier [35] relate the two functions by

$$J(x) = \int_0^1 \frac{\log(1+t^x)}{1+t} dt, \quad J(x) = F(2x) - 2F(x) + F(x/2) + \frac{\pi^2}{12x}, \quad (11.1)$$

which relates the companion J to the Herglotz function F . For the rational-argument results the engine is Radchenko–Zagier’s Theorem 3, an *exact, finite* evaluation obtained from the second integral representation of F via the distribution relations:

$$F\left(\frac{P}{Q}\right) - F(1) = \sum_{\alpha^P=1} \left(\sum_{\substack{\beta^Q=1 \\ \beta \neq 1}} f(\alpha, \beta) - \sum_{\substack{\beta^P=1 \\ \beta \neq 1}} f(\alpha, \beta) \right), \quad f(\alpha, \beta) = \text{Li}_2\left(\frac{\beta}{\beta-1}\right) - \text{Li}_2\left(\frac{\alpha-\beta}{1-\beta}\right). \quad (11.2)$$

The finite sum is an exact analytic identity, with compatible principal branches at its arguments. Floating-point evaluation still has rounding and cancellation errors. It is a useful independent comparator for the defining integral, not a zero-error numerical oracle.

11.2 Quadratic-unit values: Tables 1 & 2, and two errata

For real quadratic units the relevant object is the companion $\mathcal{J}(x) = J(x) - \frac{\log^2 2}{2} + \frac{\pi^2}{24}(x - \frac{1}{x})$, and the arithmetic atoms are $S_{p,q} = \log \varepsilon_p \log \varepsilon_q$ where ε_d is the fundamental unit of $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{d})$ for a fundamental

discriminant $d > 1$ and $\varepsilon_1 := 2$. Tables 1 and 2 of the source paper express, for the 45 known one-class-per-genus cases, the quantities $4(\mathcal{J}(n + \sqrt{n^2 - 1}) - n\frac{\pi^2}{24})$ and $2(\mathcal{J}(n + \sqrt{n^2 + 1}) - n\frac{\pi^2}{24})$ as integer combinations of the $S_{p,q}$.

We re-implemented $\mathcal{J}$ and $S_{p,q}$ in PARI/GP (`intnum` integrals, `bnfinit` regulators) and evaluated both sides of all 45 rows at 200-digit precision. All 16 rows of Table 2 and 27 of the 29 rows of Table 1 agree to better than 10^{-80} . The two failures are $O(1)$:

$$n = 43: \text{LHS} - \text{RHS} = -13.0160\dots, \quad n = 61: \text{LHS} - \text{RHS} = -2.9011\dots$$

Each resolves to a single exact correction, confirmed against the high-DPI scan to be a typo in the printed paper rather than an OCR artifact.

Proposition 11.1 (Two corrections to Table 1).

- $n = 43$ ($n^2 - 1 = 2^3 \cdot 3 \cdot 7 \cdot 11$): the printed right-hand side overshoots by exactly $S_{33,56}$ ($(\text{LHS} - \text{RHS})/S_{33,56} = -1.000\dots$ to 110 digits); the spurious $+S_{33,56}$ term should be deleted.
- $n = 61$ ($n^2 - 1 = 2^3 \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 31$): the printed $S_{60,1032}$ should read $S_{60,248}$. The printed subscript $1032 = 2^3 \cdot 3 \cdot 43$ carries the prime 43, foreign to $n^2 - 1 = 3720$, whereas $60 \cdot 248 = 14880 = 4 \cdot 3720$ is the correct genus splitting.

A brute-force search over all single edits (delete a term, change a coefficient in $[-4, 4]$, or replace a subscript by any admissible fundamental-discriminant pair) returns these as the unique fixes. With both applied, all 45 rows verify to better than 10^{-80} .

The quadratic-unit tables concern specified arithmetic families. They do not imply that every even-trace unit has a pure-logarithm evaluation: outside genus characters the Kronecker-limit formula introduces additional class-group coordinates. Those coordinates are developed below.

11.3 Rational arguments: a family of theorems

The paper writes out only two rational-argument cases: $F(n)$ (pure logarithms, its eq. 23) and the lone fractional example $F(2/5)$ (its eq. 24). We now give the general laws.

11.3.1 Two reductions on the line $\text{Re} = \frac{1}{2}$

Everything rests on one observation: for a unit $\beta = e^{i\theta}$,

$$\frac{\beta}{\beta - 1} \text{ has real part } \frac{1}{2}, \quad \arg \frac{\beta}{\beta - 1} = \frac{\theta}{2} - \frac{\pi}{2}, \quad \left| \frac{\beta}{\beta - 1} \right| = \frac{1}{2 \sin(\theta/2)}. \quad (11.3)$$

By the reflection $\text{Li}_2(z) + \text{Li}_2(1 - z) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \log z \log(1 - z)$ with $1 - z = \bar{z}$ on $\text{Re } z = \frac{1}{2}$,

$$2 \text{Re Li}_2\left(\frac{1}{2} + iy\right) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \log^2 |z| - (\arg z)^2. \quad (11.4)$$

The second reduction handles the $\alpha = -1$ part of (11.2): $\frac{-1-\beta}{1-\beta} = -i \cot \frac{\theta}{2}$ is purely imaginary, and for real y

$$\text{Re Li}_2(iy) = \frac{1}{4} \text{Li}_2(-y^2). \quad (11.5)$$

11.3.2 $F(1/q)$: pure logarithms

Theorem 11.2. For all $q \geq 2$, with $m = \lfloor (q-1)/2 \rfloor$,

$$F\left(\frac{1}{q}\right) - F(1) = -\frac{(q-1)(3q-2)}{24q} \pi^2 - \sum_{k=1}^m \log^2\left(2 \sin \frac{\pi k}{q}\right) - [q \text{ even}] \frac{1}{2} \log^2 2.$$

Proof. With $P = 1$ only $\alpha = 1$ occurs and the inner β^P -sum is empty, so (11.2) reads $F(1/q) - F(1) = \sum_{\beta^q=1, \beta \neq 1} (\text{Li}_2(\frac{\beta}{\beta-1}) - \frac{\pi^2}{6})$. Pairing β with $\bar{\beta}$ and applying (11.4) gives the π^2 coefficient $-\left[\frac{q-1}{12} + \sum_{k=1}^m \left(\frac{k}{q} - \frac{1}{2}\right)^2\right] = -\frac{(q-1)(3q-2)}{24q}$ and the log-sine sum. For even q the self-conjugate root $\beta = -1$ contributes $\text{Li}_2(\frac{1}{2}) = \frac{\pi^2}{12} - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 2$. $\square$

11.3.3 $F(2/q)$: the general theorem

Theorem 11.3. For every $q \geq 3$,

$$F\left(\frac{2}{q}\right) - F(1) = -\frac{(q-1)(q-2)}{12q} \pi^2 + \log^2 2 - 2 \sum_{k=1}^{\lfloor (q-1)/2 \rfloor} \log^2\left(2 \sin \frac{\pi k}{q}\right) - \frac{1}{2} \sum_{k=1}^{\lfloor (q-1)/2 \rfloor} \text{Li}_2\left(-\cot^2 \frac{\pi k}{q}\right),$$

where for even q the two sums run to $k = \frac{q}{2} - 1$ and a further $-\log^2 2$ is added.

Proof (odd q). Here $\alpha \in \{1, -1\}$ and the inner β^P -sum is the single term $\beta = -1$. For the first part, $f(1, \beta) + f(-1, \beta) = 2 \text{Li}_2(\frac{\beta}{\beta-1}) - \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \text{Li}_2(\frac{-1-\beta}{1-\beta})$. Summing over $\beta \neq 1$ and using (11.4) for the first pieces and (11.5) (with $\frac{-1-\beta}{1-\beta} = -i \cot \frac{\pi k}{q}$, pairing $k \leftrightarrow q-k$) for the last gives $2S_1 - (q-1)\frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{1}{2} \sum_k \text{Li}_2(-\cot^2 \frac{\pi k}{q})$, where $S_1 = \sum_{k=1}^{(q-1)/2} [\frac{\pi^2}{6} - \log^2(2 \sin \frac{\pi k}{q}) - \pi^2(\frac{k}{q} - \frac{1}{2})^2]$. The boundary gives $-\sum_{\alpha} f(\alpha, -1) = +\log^2 2$ from $\text{Li}_2(\frac{1}{2})$. Collecting, the $\frac{\pi^2}{6}$ terms cancel and the π^2 coefficient is $-2 \sum_{k=1}^{(q-1)/2} (\frac{k}{q} - \frac{1}{2})^2$, which equals $-\frac{(q-1)(q-2)}{12q}$ by an elementary identity (verified symbolically). The even- q case differs only in that $\beta = -1$ is now a genuine q -th root, contributing the extra $-\log^2 2$. $\square$

The algebraic dilogarithm arguments make the field structure explicit. At $q = 5$ the symmetric sum can be reduced further as described below. Unsuccessful searches at larger conductors do not prove that no other closed form exists; the finite-sum theorem remains valid at every q .

11.3.4 The $F(n/(n+1))$ family and the $F(p/2)$ reciprocity

Theorem 11.4. For all $n \geq 2$, with $S(q) = \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} \log^2(2 \sin \frac{\pi k}{q})$,

$$F\left(\frac{n}{n+1}\right) - F(1) = -\frac{3n^2 + 3n + 2}{24n(n+1)} \pi^2 + \text{Li}_2\left(\frac{n}{n+1}\right) + \frac{1}{2} \log^2 \frac{n+1}{n} - \frac{1}{2} S(n+1) + \frac{1}{2} S(n),$$

the single dilogarithm $\text{Li}_2(n/(n+1))$ appearing with coefficient exactly $+1$ (the source paper's “bilinear-log” Example 2, made explicit). The π^2 coefficient equals $-\frac{1}{8} - \frac{1}{12n(n+1)}$.

Proof. The two functional equations of F are

$$F(x) - F(x+1) - F(x/(x+1)) = -F(1) + \text{Li}_2(1/(x+1)),$$

$$F(x) + F(1/x) - 2F(1) = \frac{1}{2} \log^2 x - \frac{\pi^2}{6x} (x-1)^2.$$

The second equation and Theorem 11.2 give

$$F(n) - F(1) = -\frac{(n-1)(n-2)}{24n}\pi^2 + \frac{1}{2}\log^2 n + \frac{1}{2}S(n).$$

Subtract the cases n and $n+1$ in the first equation, and apply Euler reflection to $\text{Li}_2(1/(n+1))$. Collecting the logarithms and rational π^2 coefficients yields the displayed formula. $\square$

Theorem 11.5 (Reciprocity). *For all odd $p \geq 3$,*

$$F\left(\frac{p}{2}\right) + F\left(\frac{2}{p}\right) - 2F(1) = -\frac{(p-2)^2}{12p}\pi^2 + \frac{1}{2}\log^2 \frac{p}{2}.$$

The $\text{Li}_2(-\cot^2 \frac{\pi k}{p})$ terms of $F(p/2)$ are exactly minus those of $F(2/p)$ and cancel in the sum; combined with Theorem 11.3 this yields $F(p/2)$ in closed form.

Proof. Substitute $x = p/2$ into the second functional equation above. $\square$

11.3.5 The derivative law

Theorem 11.6 (Radchenko–Zagier Proposition 4, $P = 2$). *For all $q \geq 3$, with $T(q) := \frac{2}{q}F'(2/q) - (1 + \log 2)$,*

$$T(q) = \frac{q^2 - 4}{24q}\pi^2 + W(q), \quad W(q) = \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} C(2k/q) \text{Cl}_2\left(\frac{2\pi k}{q}\right),$$

where $C(t) = \cot(\pi t)$ for $t \notin \mathbb{Z}$ and $C(t) = 0$ for $t \in \mathbb{Z}$, with an extra $-\log 2$ for even q . This assigned value at integers is part of the formula; a literal cotangent there would be undefined. The sum provides a Clausen representation, without an independence assertion.

11.3.6 Rational-argument samples and the companion integral

The source's proposed criterion $\text{rad}(q) \mid 30$ is false as a necessary condition for a reduction to rational dilogarithms: Theorem 11.2 gives a pure-logarithm answer for $F(1/7)$. Numerator, denominator and the available functional equations must all be considered. The formal five-term classification is proved in the following section. The following experimentally recovered samples are useful:

$$\begin{aligned} F(3/4) - F(1) &= -\frac{19}{144}\pi^2 - \frac{3}{4}\log^2 2 - 2\log 2 \log 3 + \frac{7}{4}\log^2 3 + 2\text{Li}_2(1/3), \\ F(4/5) - F(1) &= \frac{3}{80}\pi^2 + \frac{11}{4}\log^2 2 - \frac{1}{2}\log^2 5 - \text{Li}_2(1/5) - \log^2(2\sin(\pi/5)) - \log^2(2\sin(2\pi/5)), \\ J(2/3) &= -\frac{\pi^2}{144} + \frac{3}{4}\log^2 2, \\ J(2/5) &= \frac{11\pi^2}{240} + \frac{3}{4}\log^2 2 - 2\log^2 \phi. \end{aligned}$$

The last two values follow by combining the F evaluations through (11.1). Their existence does not prove that these are the only q for which $J(2/q)$ simplifies.

11.4 From rational examples to an exact formal criterion

The denominator-only condition was false, but the newer cyclotomic argument supplies a precise replacement. Its equivalences concern the specified five-term calculus. Successful cases give actual analytic evaluations; an unsuccessful formal test is not a proof of numerical period independence.

11.5 Cyclotomic symbols and formal reduction

We use additive notation for a multiplicative group after rationalization:

$$\mathcal{A}(K) = K^\times \otimes_{\mathbb{Z}} \mathbb{Q}, \quad \langle uv \rangle = \langle u \rangle + \langle v \rangle.$$

Roots of unity map to zero. Exterior powers below are over $\mathbb{Q}$ unless otherwise specified.

Definition 11.7 (Pre-Bloch group and formal reduction). *Let $\mathcal{P}(K)$ be the $\mathbb{Q}$ -vector space on symbols $[z]$, $z \in K$, with $[0] = [1] = 0$, modulo the five-term relations. Its differential is*

$$\partial[z] = \langle z \rangle \wedge \langle 1 - z \rangle \quad (z \neq 0, 1), \quad \partial[0] = \partial[1] = 0, \quad \mathcal{B}(K) = \ker \partial.$$

For an invariant dilogarithm element $\xi \in \mathcal{P}(K)$, a formal logarithmic reduction means $\xi = 0$ in $\mathcal{P}(K)$. A formal rational-dilogarithm reduction means that ξ belongs to the image of $\mathcal{P}(\mathbb{Q})$. Upon evaluation, five-term relations carry products of algebraic logarithms and rational multiples of π^2 ; these are the terms suppressed by this terminology.

For a finite Galois number field $K/\mathbb{Q}$, two standard rationalized facts will be used:

$$\mathcal{B}(K)^{\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})} = \mathcal{B}(\mathbb{Q}) = 0, \quad \partial \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{Q}) = \Lambda^2 \mathcal{A}(\mathbb{Q}). \quad (11.6)$$

The first is Bloch-group descent and the torsion of the Bloch group of $\mathbb{Q}$; the second is equivalent to the torsion of $K_2(\mathbb{Q})$. These are established algebraic K -theory inputs, not new results of this article; see [42, 41]. The same inputs underpin the symbol argument in [35, §7.2].

Let $\zeta_q = e^{2\pi i/q}$ and, for $(a, q) = 1$, set

$$\beta_q(a) = \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} \langle 1 - \zeta_q^{ak} \rangle \wedge \langle 1 - \zeta_q^k \rangle \in \Lambda^2 \mathcal{A}(\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)). \quad (11.7)$$

We put $\beta_1 = \beta_2 = 0$. The term $k = 0$ is excluded: there is no multiplicative-group element $\langle 0 \rangle$. For coprime positive p, q , the finite cyclotomic dilogarithm sum for $F(p/q) - F(1)$ defines a Galois-invariant element $\xi_{p/q}$ with

$$\partial \xi_{p/q} = \beta_q(p) - \beta_p(q) - \langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle. \quad (11.8)$$

One can take $K = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta_{pq})$. We retain this classical normalization throughout; the rational wedge in (11.8) matters for the distinction between logarithms and rational dilogarithms.

Lemma 11.8 (Elementary symmetries). *For every conductor and every invertible residue a ,*

$$\beta_q(-a) = \beta_q(a), \quad \beta_q(a^{-1}) = -\beta_q(a).$$

Each $\beta_q(a)$ is Galois invariant.

Proof. The identity $1 - \zeta_q^{-ak} = -\zeta_q^{-ak}(1 - \zeta_q^{ak})$ proves the first claim after roots of unity are killed. In the sum for $\beta_q(a^{-1})$, replace k by ak and reverse the exterior factors. Finally, every Galois automorphism multiplies k by a unit modulo q , permuting the summation set. $\square$

11.6 The all-conductor relation theorem

The following is the main algebraic theorem.

Theorem 11.9 (Complete kernel, every conductor). *Let $q \geq 3$, $\mathcal{G}_q = (\mathbb{Z}/q\mathbb{Z})^\times / \{\pm 1\}$, and $(c_a)_{a \in \mathcal{G}_q} \in \mathbb{Q}_q^{\mathcal{G}}$. Then*

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{G}_q} c_a \beta_q(a) = 0 \iff c_a = c_{a^{-1}} \text{ for every } a \in \mathcal{G}_q. \quad (11.9)$$

In particular,

$$\beta_q(a) = 0 \iff a^2 \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{q}, \quad (11.10)$$

$$\dim_{\mathbb{Q}} \text{span}\{\beta_q(a) : a \in \mathcal{G}_q\} = \frac{|\mathcal{G}_q| - |\mathcal{G}_q[2]|}{2}. \quad (11.11)$$

Choosing one a from each inverse pair $\{a, a^{-1}\}$ with $a \neq a^{-1}$ gives a basis of the symbol space.

The proof is short after the correct positive matrix is identified. Its use of *all* nontrivial roots, including those of smaller order, is essential at composite conductor.

11.6.1 Cyclotomic logarithms and a positive Gram matrix

For $1 \leq k < q$, define the real vector

$$v_k = (\log |1 - \zeta_q^{ak}|)_{a \in \mathcal{G}_q} \in \mathbb{R}_q^{\mathcal{G}}, \quad A_q = \sum_{k=1}^{q-1} v_k v_k^\top. \quad (11.12)$$

The entries are independent of the representative of a modulo sign. Let P_b be the permutation matrix $(P_b v)_a = v_{ab}$. Then

$$P_b v_k = v_{bk}, \quad P_b A_q P_b^\top = A_q, \quad P_b A_q = A_q P_b. \quad (11.13)$$

Lemma 11.10 (Positive definiteness). *The vectors v_k span $\mathbb{R}_q^{\mathcal{G}}$. Hence A_q is positive definite.*

Proof. Complexify the regular representation of the finite abelian group $\mathcal{G}_q$. Each character occurs once. The span of the v_k is $\mathcal{G}_q$ -invariant by (11.13), so it suffices to show a nonzero Fourier component for every character.

Let χ be nontrivial and let $f \mid q$ be its primitive Dirichlet conductor. It is an even character, so $f > 2$. Write χ^* for the primitive character modulo f . Reduction gives a surjection $\mathcal{G}_q \rightarrow \mathcal{G}_f$. For the vector with $k = q/f$, its Fourier coefficient is a nonzero positive integer multiple of

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{G}_f} \chi^*(a) \log |1 - \zeta_f^a| = -\frac{1}{2} \tau(\chi^*) L(1, \overline{\chi^*}) \neq 0. \quad (11.14)$$

The equality follows by Abel-regularizing $\log |1 - re^{i\theta}| = -\sum_{n \geq 1} r^n \cos(n\theta)/n$, summing over a , using the primitive Gauss-sum identity, and letting $r \uparrow 1$. The Gauss sum is nonzero and Dirichlet's nonvanishing theorem gives $L(1, \overline{\chi^*}) \neq 0$. This is a standard cyclotomic-logarithm identity; cf. [43, 44].

For the trivial character, choose a prime $\ell \mid q$. If ℓ is odd, use $k = q/\ell$ and

$$\sum_{a \in \mathcal{G}_\ell} \log |1 - \zeta_\ell^a| = \frac{1}{2} \log \ell \neq 0.$$

If $\ell = 2$, the vector $v_{q/2}$ is the nonzero constant vector $(\log 2)_{a \in \mathcal{G}_q}$. Thus every character component occurs. This proves the spanning assertion, and $w^\top A_q w = \sum_k (w^\top v_k)^2 > 0$ for $w \neq 0$. $\square$

11.6.2 From exterior symbols to skew matrices

There is a $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear logarithm map

$$\ell : \mathcal{A}(\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)) \longrightarrow \mathbb{R}_q^{\mathcal{G}}, \quad \ell(\langle u \rangle) = (\log |\sigma_a(u)|)_{a \in \mathcal{G}_q}.$$

Composing its exterior square with the passage to the real exterior power and then identifying $v \wedge w$ with $vw^{\top} - wv^{\top}$ gives a $\mathbb{Q}$ -linear map to real skew matrices. We do *not* assume this map is injective on the whole exterior power. Its value on (11.7) is explicitly

$$\ell_{\wedge}(\beta_q(b)) = P_b A_q - A_q P_b^{\top} = A_q(P_b - P_{b^{-1}}). \quad (11.15)$$

Proof of Theorem 11.9. If the left side of (11.9) vanishes, apply (11.15) and multiply by the invertible matrix A_q^{-1} . We get

$$0 = \sum_{b \in \mathcal{G}_q} c_b (P_b - P_{b^{-1}}) = \sum_{b \in \mathcal{G}_q} (c_b - c_{b^{-1}}) P_b.$$

The regular permutation matrices P_b are linearly independent, even over $\mathbb{R}$: their values on a single coordinate vector are the distinct coordinate vectors. Therefore $c_b = c_{b^{-1}}$.

Conversely, if these equalities hold, group the sum into inverse pairs and use Lemma 11.8; self-inverse classes have $2\beta_q(b) = 0$ and hence contribute zero. This proves (11.9). Applying it to a coefficient vector supported at one class proves (11.10), and counting nontrivial inverse pairs proves (11.11) and the basis assertion. $\square$

Remark 11.11 (Why the composite case is not a numerical rank claim). All matrix entries involving logarithms are used only in the proof of positive definiteness. The conclusion follows from exact character nonvanishing, not from a numerical determinant. In particular, no lower bound for a numerically computed singular value is required. The resulting coordinate model $\beta_q(a) \mapsto P_a - P_{a^{-1}}$ is exact on the symbol span, even though its derivation used a real logarithm map.

11.6.3 Explicit rank formula and zero conductors

Corollary 11.12. *For $q \geq 3$,*

$$d(q) := \dim_{\mathbb{Q}} \text{span}\{\beta_q(a)\} = \frac{\varphi(q) - r_+(q) - r_-(q)}{4}.$$

Write $q = 2^e \prod_{j=1}^s p_j^{e_j}$ with distinct odd primes p_j . Then

$$r_+(q) = 2^s \begin{cases} 1 & e = 0, 1, \\ 2 & e = 2, \\ 4 & e \geq 3, \end{cases}$$

and $r_-(q) = 0$ if $e \geq 2$ or some $p_j \equiv 3 \pmod{4}$; otherwise $r_-(q) = 2^s$.

Proof. The self-inverse elements of $\mathcal{G}_q$ are the sign classes of roots of $u^2 = 1$ or $u^2 = -1$. These two sets are disjoint for $q > 2$, and every sign class has two representatives. Thus $|\mathcal{G}_q[2]| = (r_+ + r_-)/2$. The stated root counts follow from the Chinese remainder theorem and the elementary square-root counts at prime powers. $\square$

Corollary 11.13 (Complete list of identically zero conductors). *With the conventions at $q = 1, 2$, the function β_q is identically zero exactly for*

$$q \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12, 24\}. \quad (11.16)$$

Exact cyclotomic symbol ranks

$1 \leq q \leq 200$; dimension over $\mathbb{Q}$

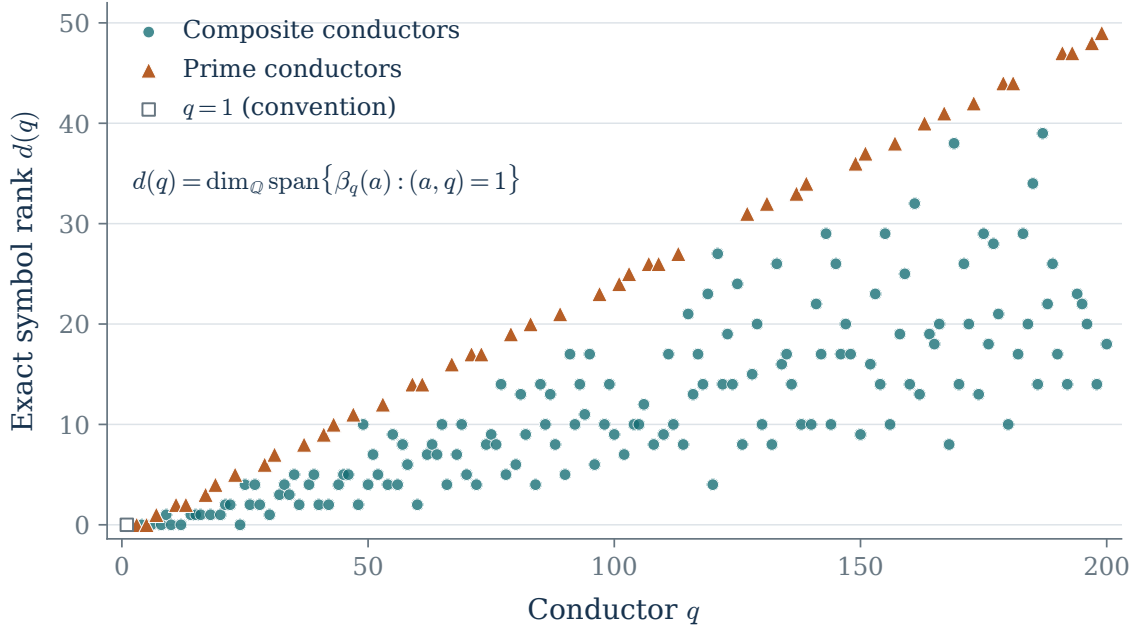


Figure 11.1: Exact ranks of the cyclotomic symbol spaces for conductors $1 \leq q \leq 200$. The plotted values come from integer residue counts and the proved rank formula. They are not numerical estimates of linear independence among evaluated periods.

Proof. The condition is that $\mathcal{G}_q$ have exponent at most 2. Projecting to each odd prime-power factor forces that factor to be 3 or 5 to the first power, since its unit group is cyclic and has order dividing 4. The 2-part is at most 8: the square of 3 modulo 16 is neither 1 nor -1 . If 5 occurs with 3 or with 4, the Chinese remainder theorem produces a unit whose square is -1 at 5 and 1 at the other factor; its square is not a global sign. Hence the cases containing 5 are only 5, 10. Without 5, all divisors of 24 work. This is exactly (11.16). $\square$

q	7	9	13	15	16	24	25	60	105
$d(q)$	1	1	2	1	1	0	4	2	10

The rank concerns symbols, not the dimension of the numerical span of Herglotz values. Formula (11.11) makes the distinction computable without a height-bounded integer-relation search.

11.7 Exact reduction criteria and constructive rational cores

The two cyclotomic pieces in (11.8) cannot cancel across coprime conductors. This needs a norm on the *individual exterior factors*; averaging an exterior symbol under Galois action would not work, because the symbols themselves are invariant.

Lemma 11.14 (Separation by normalized field norms). *Let $(p, q) = 1$ and regard both symbols in $\Lambda^2 \mathcal{A}(K)$, $K = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta_{pq})$. Then*

$$\beta_q(p) - \beta_p(q) \in \Lambda^2 \mathcal{A}(\mathbb{Q}) \iff \beta_q(p) = \beta_p(q) = 0. \quad (11.17)$$

Proof. Let $E = \mathbb{Q}(\zeta_p)$ and define the linear normalized norm

$$N_p : \mathcal{A}(K) \longrightarrow \mathcal{A}(E), \quad \langle u \rangle \longmapsto \frac{\langle \text{Norm}_{K/E}(u) \rangle}{[K : E]}.$$

It fixes the vectors from E . The fields $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_p)$ and $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)$ are linearly disjoint over $\mathbb{Q}$. In each summand of $\beta_q(p)$, the two factors are Galois conjugate in $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)$, so N_p sends them to the same rational vector. Hence

$$(\Lambda^2 N_p) \beta_q(p) = 0, \quad (\Lambda^2 N_p) \beta_p(q) = \beta_p(q).$$

The analogous statements hold with p, q exchanged. If the difference equals a rational wedge W , applying $\Lambda^2 N_p$ gives $W = -\beta_p(q)$. Applying $\Lambda^2 N_q$ to this equality gives $W = 0$, and both symbols vanish. The converse is immediate. The conventions for conductor 1 or 2 make the same argument valid in the degenerate field cases. $\square$

Theorem 11.15 (Complete formal reduction criterion). *For coprime positive integers p, q , the following are equivalent:*

1. $\xi_{p/q}$ has a formal rational-dilogarithm reduction.
2. $\beta_q(p) = \beta_p(q) = 0$.
3. $p^2 \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{q}$ and $q^2 \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{p}$.

Moreover, $\xi_{p/q}$ has a formal logarithmic reduction if and only if $p = 1$ or $q = 1$.

Proof. If $\xi_{p/q}$ is represented by rational dilogarithms, its differential is a rational wedge. Equations (11.8) and (11.17) imply (2). Conversely, if (2) holds, the differential is $-\langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle$. By (11.6) choose $\eta \in \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{Q})$ with this differential. Then $\xi_{p/q} - \eta$ is a Galois-invariant Bloch-group element and hence zero. The equivalence with (3) is Theorem 11.9.

For the last assertion, a normalized norm to $\mathbb{Q}$ sends every β -summand to zero on the exterior square. Thus $\partial \xi_{p/q} = 0$ implies $\langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle = 0$. If $p, q > 1$ are coprime, their prime-exponent vectors have disjoint nonempty supports, and their wedge is nonzero. If $p = 1$ or $q = 1$, all terms in (11.8) vanish; invariant Bloch descent gives the reduction. $\square$

Remark 11.16 (Interpretation of a failed test). The theorem gives a necessary and sufficient condition for a certificate in a specified algebraic calculus. A nonzero symbol is not a proof that the corresponding real number satisfies no other numerical identity. Such a statement would require additional information about the kernel of period evaluation. In particular, the theorem should not be restated as an unconditional transcendence theorem.

11.7.1 Checking the boundary formula directly

Because the reduction criterion depends on (11.8), it is useful to audit that formula algebraically. The finite evaluation uses the formal summand

$$f(\alpha, \beta) = \left[\frac{\beta}{\beta - 1} \right] - \left[\frac{\alpha - \beta}{1 - \beta} \right],$$

summed over $\alpha^p = 1$, first over nontrivial q th roots β , and then with the analogous sum over nontrivial p th roots subtracted. Terms with $\alpha = 1$ or $\alpha = \beta$ have zero differential and are set aside before taking multiplicative logarithms. For the remaining roots of unity α, β , put $A = \langle 1 - \alpha \rangle$,

$B = \langle 1 - \beta \rangle$, $C = \langle \alpha - \beta \rangle$. Away from the terms $[0], [1]$, which contribute zero, direct expansion gives

$$\partial f(\alpha, \beta) = -C \wedge A + C \wedge B + B \wedge A.$$

The differential of the subtracted summand is antisymmetric under $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$, so that sum has zero differential. In the first sum use

$$\prod_{\substack{\beta^q=1 \\ \beta \neq 1}} (\alpha - \beta) = \frac{\alpha^q - 1}{\alpha - 1}, \quad \prod_{\substack{\alpha^p=1 \\ \alpha \neq 1}} (\beta - \alpha) = \frac{\beta^p - 1}{\beta - 1}.$$

The first two wedge terms then give $-\beta_p(q)$ and $\beta_q(p)$. The last gives $\langle q \rangle \wedge \langle p \rangle$. This proves (11.8) independently of any finite-field cocycle claim.

11.7.2 A recurrence parametrization of the reducible pairs

The congruence criterion has an elementary arithmetic description that connects it to the golden-ratio ladder thread of the repository.

Theorem 11.17 (Quadratic recurrence families). *Apart from $(1, 1)$, all coprime pairs $1 \leq p < q$ satisfying (11.10) and Theorem 11.15 are exactly the adjacent pairs in the following three families. Their union need not be disjoint.*

1. For each integer $h \geq 2$, $u_0 = 1$, $u_1 = h$, $u_{j+1} = hu_j - u_{j-1}$.
2. $u_0 = 1$, $u_1 = 2$, $u_{j+1} = 3u_j - u_{j-1}$.
3. For each integer $h \geq 1$, $u_0 = 1$, $u_1 = h$, $u_{j+1} = hu_j + u_{j-1}$, retaining pairs in increasing order.

The first family has both square congruences $+1$, the second both -1 , and the third permits opposite signs, with the usual coincidences of signs modulo 1 or 2.

Proof. Suppose $1 < a < b$ and write $a^2 \equiv s \pmod{b}$, $b^2 \equiv t \pmod{a}$ with $s, t \in \{\pm 1\}$. Set

$$c = \frac{a^2 - s}{b}.$$

Then $1 \leq c < a$, $(c, a) = 1$, and the new pair (c, a) satisfies the same conditions with signs (t, s) . Indeed $bc \equiv -s \pmod{a}$ implies $c^2 \equiv b^{-2} \equiv t \pmod{a}$, while $a^2 \equiv s \pmod{c}$. This gives a strictly descending process.

If $s = t$, the positive integer $h = (a^2 + b^2 - s)/(ab)$ is preserved under descent and satisfies $b = ha - c$. For $s = 1$, the terminal pair is $(1, h)$ with $h \geq 2$. For $s = -1$, a terminal pair $(1, b)$ has $b \mid 2$, so it is $(1, 1)$ or $(1, 2)$ and the invariant is $h = 3$.

If $s = -t$, the positive integer $h = (b^2 - a^2 - t)/(ab)$ is preserved and satisfies $b = ha + c$. The terminal pairs are seeds $(1, h)$, with the terminal $(1, 2)$ also lying in the $h = 1$ sequence $1, 1, 2, 3, 5, \dots$. Reversing descent gives the three displayed recurrences. Conversely their preserved quadratic identities, or the same recurrence step in reverse, verify both congruences and coprimality at every stage. $\square$

For example, the second family is $1, 2, 5, 13, 34, \dots$, the odd-index Fibonacci numbers. The first family with $h = 3$ is $1, 3, 8, 21, 55, \dots$, and the third with $h = 3$ is $1, 3, 10, 33, 109, \dots$. This is an arithmetic parametrization of *which* rational arguments admit formal reduction, not an assertion that all their logarithmic correction terms are already tabulated.

11.7.3 An explicit rational-dilogarithm core

Theorem 11.18 (A short core with a boundary certificate). *For every pair satisfying Theorem 11.15, one can produce a rational combination $C_{p/q}$ of symbols $[z]$, $0 < z < 1$, such that*

$$\partial C_{p/q} = -\langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle, \quad \xi_{p/q} - C_{p/q} = 0 \quad \text{in } \mathcal{P}(K).$$

The following recursion suffices for $1 \leq p < q$:

1. If $p = 1$, use $C_{p/q} = 0$.
2. If $q = p + 1$, use $C_{p/q} = [p/q]$.
3. Otherwise choose $s \in \{\pm 1\}$ with $q \mid p^2 - s$, put $c = (p^2 - s)/q$, and use

$$C_{p/q} = C_{c/p} + \begin{cases} -\frac{1}{2}[1 - p^{-2}], & s = 1, \\ \frac{1}{2}[p^2/(p^2 + 1)], & s = -1. \end{cases} \quad (11.18)$$

Put $C_{1/1} = 0$. For $p > q$, negate the core for q/p . After the consecutive-pair shortcut, the number of terms is $O(\log \max(p, q))$.

Proof. The first two cases have the required differential. In the last case $cq = p^2 - s$. Direct calculation gives

$$\begin{aligned} -\frac{1}{2}\partial[1 - p^{-2}] &= -\langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle - \langle p \rangle \wedge \langle c \rangle & (s = 1), \\ \frac{1}{2}\partial[p^2/(p^2 + 1)] &= -\langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle - \langle p \rangle \wedge \langle c \rangle & (s = -1). \end{aligned}$$

Adding $\partial C_{c/p} = -\langle c \rangle \wedge \langle p \rangle$ leaves the required $-\langle p \rangle \wedge \langle q \rangle$. Descent terminates by the previous theorem. Both $C_{p/q}$ and $\xi_{p/q}$ are invariant; their difference lies in the Bloch group and vanishes by (11.6).

For the length bound, the $h = 2$ minus recurrence consists of consecutive integers and is handled in one step. Every remaining minus recurrence has $h \geq 3$ and grows by a factor greater than 2 after its seed. Each plus recurrence grows at least as fast as the Fibonacci recurrence. Thus the number of descent steps is logarithmic in the larger input. $\square$

Argument	A rational-dilogarithm core for $F(p/q) - F(1)$
2/5	$\frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(4/5)$
3/8	$-\frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(8/9)$
4/17	$\frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(16/17)$
5/13	$\frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(4/5) + \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(25/26)$
10/33	$\frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(9/10) - \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(99/100)$

In this table the difference between $F(p/q) - F(1)$ and the displayed core is a combination of logarithm products and π^2 . The core algorithm certifies the dilogarithm part; it does not yet print the full logarithmic correction. Constructing that correction efficiently and with a complete branch certificate is a further research task.

Corollary 11.19 (A lower bound for a family of formal values). *Fix $q \geq 3$ and choose one positive numerator representing each nontrivial inverse pair in $\mathcal{G}_q$. The corresponding $d(q)$ elements $\xi_{a/q}$ are linearly independent modulo rational dilogarithms.*

Proof. Take a common cyclotomic field for all numerators and q , and apply the exterior square of its normalized norm to $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)$. The numerator-conductor symbols disappear and the denominator symbols $\beta_q(a)$ remain. If their combination were a rational wedge, the normalized norm to $\mathbb{Q}$ would kill it, so it would be zero. The chosen $\beta_q(a)$ are independent by Theorem 11.9. $\square$

11.8 Complete classification and evaluations of $J(2/q)$

Define

$$S(n) = \sum_{k=1}^{n-1} \log^2 \left(2 \sin \frac{\pi k}{n} \right), \quad S(1) = 0, \quad \phi = \frac{1 + \sqrt{5}}{2}.$$

The reciprocal-integer identity, obtainable by pairing conjugate roots in the finite dilogarithm formula, is

$$F(1/n) - F(1) = -\frac{(n-1)(3n-2)}{24n} \pi^2 - \frac{1}{2} S(n), \quad n \geq 1. \quad (11.19)$$

All logarithms here are real logarithms of positive algebraic numbers.

Theorem 11.20 (Complete formal classification). *For integers $q \geq 2$:*

1. $J(2/q)$ has a formal logarithmic reduction exactly when $q \in \{2, 3, 5\}$ or $4 \mid q$.
2. It has a formal rational-dilogarithm reduction exactly when $q \in \{2, 3, 5, 6, 10\}$ or $4 \mid q$.

In every positive case the evaluations below give the corresponding analytic identity.

Proof. First suppose q is odd. Applying (11.8) to (11.1) at $x = 2/q$, the numerator symbols at conductors 1, 2, 4 vanish and the rational wedges cancel. Thus the boundary is

$$\beta_q(4) - 2\beta_q(2).$$

Put $g = 2 \in \mathcal{G}_q$. By Theorem 11.9, this vanishes exactly when g has order at most 2. To check the assertion directly, an element of order 3 gives $\beta(g^2) - 2\beta(g) = -3\beta(g)$; order 4 gives $-2\beta(g)$; for order at least 5, the two relevant inverse pairs are distinct. Hence vanishing is equivalent to $4 \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{q}$, or $q = 3, 5$. A rational wedge cannot remove a nonzero combination of these symbols, since the normalized norm to $\mathbb{Q}$ kills the combination and fixes rational wedges. This proves both classifications for odd q .

If $4 \mid q$, all three arguments $4/q, 2/q, 1/q$ in (11.1) are reciprocal integers. Equation (11.19) gives a logarithmic reduction.

The remaining case is $q = 2m$ with m odd. Its boundary is

$$\beta_m(2) - \langle 2 \rangle \wedge \langle m \rangle. \quad (11.20)$$

For $m = 1$ it is zero. For $m > 1$, applying the normalized norm to $\mathbb{Q}$ gives the nonzero rational wedge $-\langle 2 \rangle \wedge \langle m \rangle$; there is no formal logarithmic reduction. Rational dilogarithms are allowed exactly when $\beta_m(2) = 0$, equivalently $m = 3, 5$. Invariant Bloch descent supplies the stated formal reductions. $\square$

11.8.1 All positive evaluations

The isolated cases are

$$J(1) = \frac{1}{2} \log^2 2, \quad (11.21)$$

$$J(2/3) = -\frac{\pi^2}{144} + \frac{3}{4} \log^2 2, \quad (11.22)$$

$$J(2/5) = \frac{11\pi^2}{240} + \frac{3}{4} \log^2 2 - 2 \log^2 \phi, \quad (11.23)$$

$$J(1/3) = \frac{\pi^2}{9} + \frac{1}{2} \log^2 2 - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 3 - \text{Li}_2(1/3), \quad (11.24)$$

$$J(1/5) = \frac{7\pi^2}{60} + \frac{1}{2} \log^2 2 - \frac{1}{4} \log^2 5 - \log^2 \phi - \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(1/5). \quad (11.25)$$

For all even $m \geq 2$, the infinite family is

$$J(1/m) = \frac{\pi^2(m^2 - 2)}{48m} + S(m) - \frac{1}{2}S(m/2) - \frac{1}{2}S(2m). \quad (11.26)$$

Thus (11.26) evaluates $J(2/q)$ for every multiple q of 4, without a dilogarithm term.

Derivation of the evaluations. Equation (11.21) follows by integrating $\log(1+t)/(1+t)$. For (11.26), substitute (11.19) at $n = m/2, m, 2m$ in (11.1). The constant $F(1)$ cancels; the polynomial coefficient simplifies to $m/48 - 1/(24m)$, yielding the formula.

The small odd cases are obtained from the finite root-of-unity dilogarithm formula and the reflection, duplication, and Landen relations. For clarity, the two fractional F evaluations needed in the calculation can be taken as

$$\begin{aligned} F(2/3) - F(1) &= \frac{\pi^2}{36} + \log^2 2 - \frac{3}{4} \log^2 3 - \text{Li}_2(1/3), \\ F(2/5) - F(1) &= \frac{1}{2} \text{Li}_2(4/5) - \frac{\pi^2}{5} + \log^2 \left(2 \sin \frac{\pi}{5}\right) + \log^2 \left(2 \sin \frac{2\pi}{5}\right) + \log 2 \log(2/5). \end{aligned}$$

The second is the previously known evaluation [35]; the first follows by using $\cot^2(\pi/3) = 1/3$ in the $F(2/q)$ sum and $\text{Li}_2(-1/3) = 2 \text{Li}_2(1/3) - \pi^2/6 + \frac{1}{2} \log^2 3$. Substitution in (11.1), together with (11.19) and the two standard functional equations

$$\begin{aligned} F(x) + F(1/x) &= 2F(1) + \frac{1}{2} \log^2 x - \frac{\pi^2(x-1)^2}{6x}, \\ F(x) - F(x+1) - F(x/(x+1)) &= -F(1) + \text{Li}_2(1/(1+x)), \end{aligned}$$

gives (11.22)–(11.25). Reflection of $\text{Li}_2(4/5)$ supplies the $\text{Li}_2(1/5)$ in (11.25). All manipulations use arguments in $(0, 1)$ or the real negative axis, so no unstated complex logarithm branches are involved. $\square$

The first member of (11.26) is particularly useful for auditing the earlier claim:

$$J(1/2) = \frac{\pi^2}{48} + \frac{1}{4} \log^2 2. \quad (11.27)$$

The complete classification proves a precise replacement for the unsupported numerical “if and only if” in the draft. It also shows that the distinction between logarithms and rational dilogarithms is real at the level of the boundary: the cases $q = 6, 10$ have a nonzero rational wedge, even though their cyclotomic obstruction vanishes.

11.9 Bridges to the golden ladders and the Clausen lattice

The new constants are not isolated; they touch two corpora we have already mapped.

The golden bridge ($q = 5$). The arguments $-\cot^2 \frac{\pi}{5} = -\frac{5+2\sqrt{5}}{5}$ and $-\cot^2 \frac{2\pi}{5} = -\frac{5-2\sqrt{5}}{5}$ lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{5})$, the field of the golden polylogarithm ladders. Comparing Theorem 11.3 ($q = 5$) with eq. 24 gives the functional equation

$$\text{Li}_2\left(\frac{4}{5}\right) + \text{Li}_2\left(-\cot^2 \frac{\pi}{5}\right) + \text{Li}_2\left(-\cot^2 \frac{2\pi}{5}\right) = 2 \log^2 2 - 2 \log 2 \log \frac{2}{5} - 6 \left(\log^2 \left(2 \sin \frac{\pi}{5}\right) + \log^2 \left(2 \sin \frac{2\pi}{5}\right) \right),$$

hence the golden-sum closed form (with $\varphi = \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2}$)

$$\operatorname{Li}_2\left(-\cot^2 \frac{\pi}{5}\right) + \operatorname{Li}_2\left(-\cot^2 \frac{2\pi}{5}\right) = \operatorname{Li}_2\left(\frac{1}{5}\right) - \frac{\pi^2}{6} - 3\log^2 \varphi + \frac{1}{4}\log^2 5.$$

The symmetric sum has the displayed reduction. The antisymmetric combination $X = \frac{1}{2}[\operatorname{Li}_2(-\cot^2(\pi/5)) - \operatorname{Li}_2(-\cot^2(2\pi/5))]$ did not reduce in the source's tested basket. Its independence is open. A formal symbol with nonzero Bloch boundary is not subject to a vanishing-rank conclusion for the Bloch group.

The Clausen bridge. The coefficients of $W(q)$ are real algebraic numbers contained in $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_{\operatorname{lcm}(4,q)})^+$; at odd conductors the factor i implicit in the cotangent can require an extension of $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_q)^+$. This is an algebraic coefficient issue, not a proof of numerical period independence. Applying the distribution identities of Chapter 2 gives

$$W(8) = 2\operatorname{Cl}_2(\pi/4) - 2\operatorname{Cl}_2(3\pi/4) = G, \quad W(12) = \frac{11\sqrt{3}}{9}\operatorname{Cl}_2(\pi/3).$$

For the second formula, pair k with $12 - k$:

$$W(12) = 2\sqrt{3}[\operatorname{Cl}_2(\pi/6) - \operatorname{Cl}_2(5\pi/6)] + \frac{2}{\sqrt{3}}[\operatorname{Cl}_2(\pi/3) - \operatorname{Cl}_2(2\pi/3)].$$

Use $\operatorname{Cl}_2(\pi/6) - \operatorname{Cl}_2(5\pi/6) = V/2$ and $\operatorname{Cl}_2(2\pi/3) = 2V/3$. This proves the original report's coefficient $22\sqrt{3}/9$ multiplying the first difference. It is also checked against direct derivative quadrature in the fresh verification battery.

11.10 Positive measures and sharp approximation

Binet's kernel, already encountered in the gamma-integral chapter, gives the Herglotz function a positive-measure representation. The same representation certifies truncation errors and explains the optimal cutoff's arithmetic fluctuations. These analytic results complement the exact symbol calculus without relying on period conjectures.

11.11 A positive measure and certified remainder bounds

The analytic part begins with a representation already obtained by Radchenko and Zagier [35, §7.3]. We derive its consequences explicitly, keeping signs and normalizations visible. Put

$$G(x) = -F(x) - \frac{\zeta(2)}{2x}, \quad \mathcal{L}(u) = \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} \sigma_{-1}(m)e^{-2\pi mu}, \quad \sigma_{-1}(m) = \sum_{d|m} \frac{1}{d}. \quad (11.28)$$

Expanding a geometric series gives

$$\mathcal{L}(u) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{n(e^{2\pi nu} - 1)}.$$

Binet's digamma integral, followed by a positive change of variables and Tonelli's theorem, yields

$$G(x) = 2 \int_0^{\infty} \frac{u\mathcal{L}(u)}{x^2 + u^2} du = \int_0^{\infty} \frac{d\mu(s)}{x^2 + s}, \quad d\mu(s) = \mathcal{L}(\sqrt{s}) ds. \quad (11.29)$$

Thus $y \mapsto G(\sqrt{y})$ is a Stieltjes transform of a positive measure with a positive density on $(0, \infty)$.

Lemma 11.21 (Explicit moments). *Every nonnegative moment exists, and*

$$\mu_j := \int_0^\infty s^j d\mu(s) = \frac{2\Gamma(2j+2)\zeta(2j+2)\zeta(2j+3)}{(2\pi)^{2j+2}} = \frac{|B_{2j+2}|}{2j+2} \zeta(2j+3). \quad (11.30)$$

Proof. Substitute $s = u^2$, integrate each positive exponential term, and use $\sum_m \sigma_{-1}(m)m^{-w} = \zeta(w)\zeta(w+1)$ for $w > 1$. Euler's formula for the even zeta values gives the second equality. $\square$

Define the approximation and its first omitted term by

$$F_N(x) = -\frac{\zeta(2)}{2x} - \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \frac{(-1)^j \mu_j}{x^{2j+2}}, \quad T_N(x) = \frac{\mu_N}{x^{2N+2}}, \quad N \geq 0. \quad (11.31)$$

The empty sum for $N = 0$ is zero. The series is asymptotic and divergent; we will work with its exact finite remainder.

Theorem 11.22 (Signed remainder and three-moment bounds). *For $x > 0$ and $N \geq 0$,*

$$F(x) - F_N(x) = (-1)^{N+1} R_N(x), \quad (11.32)$$

$$R_N(x) = x^{-2N} \int_0^\infty \frac{s^N}{x^2 + s} d\mu(s) > 0, \quad (11.33)$$

$$R_N(x) + R_{N+1}(x) = T_N(x). \quad (11.34)$$

Set

$$A = \frac{\mu_{N+1}}{\mu_N x^2}, \quad B = \frac{\mu_{N+2}}{\mu_N x^4}.$$

Then the strict bounds

$$\frac{1}{1+A} < \frac{R_N(x)}{T_N(x)} < 1 - \frac{A^2}{A+B} < 1 \quad (11.35)$$

hold. In particular, two consecutive truncations bracket $F(x)$.

Proof. The finite geometric identity

$$\frac{1}{x^2 + s} = \sum_{j=0}^{N-1} \frac{(-s)^j}{x^{2j+2}} + \frac{(-1)^N s^N}{x^{2N}(x^2 + s)}$$

gives (11.32)–(11.33), and multiplying the remainder integrand by $1 + s/x^2$ gives (11.34).

Under the probability measure $s^N d\mu(s)/\mu_N$ let $U = s/x^2$. Then $R_N/T_N = \mathbb{E}(1+U)^{-1}$, $\mathbb{E}U = A$, and $\mathbb{E}U^2 = B$. Strict Jensen convexity gives the lower bound. Cauchy–Schwarz gives

$$\mathbb{E} \frac{U}{1+U} \mathbb{E}(U(1+U)) \geq (\mathbb{E}U)^2,$$

so $\mathbb{E}(1+U)^{-1} \leq 1 - A^2/(A+B)$. Both inequalities are strict because the measure has a nonconstant positive-density support. $\square$

For interval computation, an equivalent and useful form is

$$\begin{aligned} L_N(x) &= \frac{x^{-2N} \mu_N^2}{x^2 \mu_N + \mu_{N+1}}, \\ L_N(x) &< R_N(x) < T_N(x) - L_{N+1}(x). \end{aligned} \quad (11.36)$$

It uses only three adjacent moments, and hence only rational Bernoulli numbers and odd zeta values. No oscillatory integral is needed.

11.11.1 An exact rational certification scheme

For integer $s \geq 2$, integer $M \geq 2$, and $J \geq 1$, Euler–Maclaurin gives

$$Z_{M,J}(s) = \sum_{n=1}^{M-1} n^{-s} + \frac{M^{1-s}}{s-1} + \frac{1}{2M^s} + \sum_{j=1}^{J-1} \frac{B_{2j}}{(2j)!} (s)_{2j-1} M^{-s-2j+1}, \quad (11.37)$$

$$|\zeta(s) - Z_{M,J}(s)| \leq \frac{|B_{2J}|}{(2J)!} (s)_{2J-1} M^{-s-2J+1}. \quad (11.38)$$

Here $(s)_k$ is a rising factorial. A direct positive-kernel proof is useful because it fixes the endpoint convention in this bound. The partial fraction expansion of the hyperbolic cotangent gives

$$k(t) := \frac{1}{1-e^{-t}} - \frac{1}{t} - \frac{1}{2} = 2t \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{1}{t^2 + (2\pi n)^2}, \quad t > 0.$$

Expand each denominator through $J-1$ terms by the finite geometric identity. After summing, the result is

$$k(t) = \sum_{j=1}^{J-1} \frac{B_{2j}}{(2j)!} t^{2j-1} + \varepsilon_J(t), \quad |\varepsilon_J(t)| \leq \frac{|B_{2J}|}{(2J)!} t^{2J-1}.$$

Indeed the remainder before summing is $(-1)^{J-1} 2t^{2J-1} / ((2\pi n)^{2J-2} ((2\pi n)^2 + t^2))$, whose magnitude is bounded by replacing the last denominator by $(2\pi n)^2$. Integrate against $t^{s-1} e^{-Mt} / \Gamma(s)$, using

$$\sum_{n=M}^{\infty} n^{-s} = \frac{1}{\Gamma(s)} \int_0^{\infty} \frac{t^{s-1} e^{-Mt}}{1-e^{-t}} dt.$$

This proves (11.37)–(11.38), including the first-omitted-term bound, rather than assuming a truncation-sign rule. Related sharper Hurwitz-zeta remainder bounds are discussed in [46].

All quantities in (11.37)–(11.38) are rational. Combining their enclosing intervals with (11.30), (11.31), and (11.36) yields exact rational endpoints for $F(x)$ when x is rational. The code uses interval operations with integer numerators and denominators throughout; decimal endpoints are rounded outward only for display.

x	N	Certified width of the interval for $F(x)$, at most
2	6	$4.18751510340 \times 10^{-7}$
4	12	$4.88272699850 \times 10^{-13}$
8	25	$2.15471915709 \times 10^{-24}$
16	50	$1.10232929493 \times 10^{-46}$

These are reproducible certificates, not estimates based on the number of floating-point digits. The file `data/rational_intervals.json` contains the complete exact endpoints. The parameters here are $M = J = 48$; no optimality of that computational choice is asserted.

11.11.2 Classical Stieltjes consequences

The representation also settles the qualitative approximation question without any new special-function identity.

Proposition 11.23 (Determinacy and positive rational approximation). *The measure μ is uniquely determined by its moments. Gaussian quadrature for μ produces lower bounds that are rational functions of y for $G(\sqrt{y})$, $y > 0$; Gauss–Radau quadrature with a prescribed node at 0 produces rational upper bounds. These bounds converge pointwise to $G(\sqrt{y})$ as their orders tend to infinity.*

Proof. Stirling’s formula in (11.30) gives $\mu_j^{-1/(2j)} \sim \pi e/j$. Thus the Stieltjes Carleman sum diverges, which implies determinacy. The quadrature error signs follow from the alternating derivatives of $(y + s)^{-1}$: Gaussian quadrature has a positive even-order remainder, while the Radau rule with left endpoint 0 has a negative odd-order remainder. For convergence, the discrete positive quadrature measures have the same total mass and, eventually, every fixed finite set of moments as μ . A first-moment bound gives tightness; higher moment bounds give uniform integrability of each fixed power. Every subsequential weak limit therefore has all the moments of μ and must equal μ by determinacy. Integration of the bounded continuous function $(y + s)^{-1}$ proves the claim. These are standard Stieltjes and Padé consequences; see [47]. $\square$

The value of the proposition here is practical: it explains why positive rational approximations are available even in parameter regimes where an asymptotic series is not an efficient evaluator. An effective convergence rate for this particular measure remains a separate problem.

11.12 Uniform sharp asymptotics at the optimal scale

The scale $N \sim \pi x$ can be located from the ratio of consecutive moments. To obtain the error constant and its corrections, it is more efficient to convert the exact remainder into gamma expectations. Write

$$a = 2\pi x, \quad K = 2N + 2, \quad r = K - a = 2\delta + 2, \quad \delta = N - \pi x. \quad (11.39)$$

Let T have gamma density $t^{K-1}e^{-t}/\Gamma(K)$ on $(0, \infty)$, and define

$$E_K(c) = \mathbb{E} \frac{1}{1 + (T/c)^2}, \quad w_m = \sigma_{-1}(m)m^{-K}, \quad Z_K = \sum_{m \geq 1} w_m = \zeta(K)\zeta(K+1).$$

Lemma 11.24 (Exact gamma mixture). *For all $x > 0$ and $N \geq 0$,*

$$R_N(x) = \frac{2\Gamma(K)}{a^K} \sum_{m=1}^{\infty} w_m E_K(ma), \quad T_N(x) = \frac{2\Gamma(K)}{a^K} Z_K. \quad (11.40)$$

For $K \geq 4$,

$$0 < Z_K - 1 \leq 4 \cdot 2^{-K}. \quad (11.41)$$

Proof. In each positive exponential summand of (11.33), written in the variable $u = \sqrt{s}$, substitute $t = 2\pi mu$. Collecting powers gives (11.40). For the tail, use $\sigma_{-1}(m) \leq m$ and

$$\sum_{m \geq 2} m^{1-K} \leq 2^{1-K} + \frac{2^{2-K}}{K-2} \leq 4 \cdot 2^{-K}.$$

$\square$

The arithmetic terms $m \geq 2$ therefore do not affect any algebraic coefficient in the optimal-scale expansion. They do, however, move the exact transition point by an exponentially small amount; this effect is treated separately in Section 11.14.

11.12.1 Gamma moments and a uniform remainder mechanism

Let $f(v) = (1 + v^2)^{-1}$ and $H = (T - a)/a$. The local Taylor expansion is

$$f(1 + H) = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{H}{2} + \frac{H^2}{4} - \frac{H^4}{8} + \frac{H^5}{8} - \frac{H^6}{16} + \cdots,$$

and the moments are exactly

$$\mathbb{E}H^\ell = a^{-\ell} \sum_{j=0}^{\ell} \binom{\ell}{j} (-a)^{\ell-j} (a+r)_j. \quad (11.42)$$

This is an algebraic coefficient algorithm, not a fit to numerical data.

For rigor at any fixed order J , Taylor-expand f through degree $2J + 1$. Every derivative of f is bounded on $[0, \infty)$, so the absolute remainder is bounded by a constant times $|H|^{2J+2}$. The centered gamma cumulants are $K(j-1)!$ in orders $j \geq 2$. Consequently each centered even moment of order $2J + 2$ is a polynomial in K of degree at most $J + 1$. Translating the center from K to $a = K - r$, with r bounded, gives

$$\mathbb{E}|H|^{2J+2} = O_J(a^{-J-1})$$

uniformly on each compact interval of r . This proves the required uniform remainder after taking expectations. In particular,

$$\begin{aligned} 2E_K(a) = 1 + \frac{1/2 - r}{a} + \frac{(r^2 + r)/2 - 3/4}{a^2} + \frac{-3r^2/2 + r/4 + 13/8}{a^3} \\ - \frac{4r^4 - 16r^3 - 66r^2 + 74r + 59}{16a^4} + O_D(a^{-5}). \end{aligned} \quad (11.43)$$

The subscript D signifies that the constant may depend on a fixed bound for $|r|$; the same convention will be used for δ .

The classical shifted Stirling expansion [45, §5.11.8] is

$$\frac{\Gamma(a+r)}{a^{a+r}} \sim \sqrt{2\pi} a^{-1/2} e^{-a} \exp \left(\sum_{j=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{j+1} B_{j+1}(r)}{j(j+1)a^j} \right). \quad (11.44)$$

It is uniform for r in compact sets. Combining its rigorous finite forms with the gamma-moment argument proves the following theorem.

Theorem 11.25 (Complete optimal-scale expansion). *For each fixed $D > 0$ and each integer $J \geq 0$, there are explicitly computable rational polynomials $C_j(\delta)$ such that, uniformly for integers $N \geq 0$ with $|N - \pi x| \leq D$,*

$$R_N(x) = \frac{e^{-2\pi x}}{\sqrt{x}} \left(\sum_{j=0}^J \frac{C_j(\delta)}{(2\pi x)^j} + O_{D,J}(x^{-J-1}) \right). \quad (11.45)$$

The first three are

$$\begin{aligned} C_0(\delta) &= 1, \\ C_1(\delta) &= 2\delta^2 + \delta - \frac{5}{12}, \end{aligned} \tag{11.46}$$

$$C_2(\delta) = 2\delta^4 + \frac{2}{3}\delta^3 - \frac{10}{3}\delta^2 - \frac{7}{12}\delta + \frac{205}{288}. \tag{11.47}$$

Moreover, $R_N(x)/T_N(x) \rightarrow 1/2$ uniformly in that regime.

Proof. Use (11.42) to expand $2E_K(a)$, multiply by (11.44), and put $r = 2\delta + 2$. The frequency tail (11.41) is smaller than every power of a^{-1} . The leading factor is $\sqrt{2\pi} a^{-1/2} e^{-a} = x^{-1/2} e^{-2\pi x}$. For an explicit check of the first two coefficients, put $g_1 = B_2(r)/2$ and $g_2 = -B_3(r)/6$. Before substituting for r they are

$$g_1 + \frac{1}{2} - r, \quad \frac{1}{2}g_1^2 + g_2 + g_1(\frac{1}{2} - r) + \frac{1}{2}(r + r^2) - \frac{3}{4}.$$

These simplify to (11.46)–(11.47). The ratio assertion follows directly from (11.40), since $E_K(a) \rightarrow 1/2$ and $Z_K \rightarrow 1$. $\square$

The leading constant is therefore exactly 1. Replacing the true remainder by the first omitted term loses a factor of 2 at the optimal scale. The three-moment bounds also approach this factor: there $A \rightarrow 1$ and $B \rightarrow 1$, so both sides of (11.35) tend to $1/2$.

The program `code/truncation_coefficients.py` generates C_j symbolically using rational polynomial operations and Bernoulli polynomials. The theorem's bounded- δ condition is essential to the stated uniformity. A growing window, for example $N - \pi x$ of order $\sqrt{x}$, requires a different scaling.

11.13 The exact best cutoff and its transitions

An asymptotic nearest-integer rule is useful, but it cannot determine the best cutoff arbitrarily close to a transition. The positive measure supplies an exact answer.

Theorem 11.26 (Unique transitions and global minimizers). *For every $N \geq 0$, there is a unique $x_N > 0$ such that $R_N(x_N) = R_{N+1}(x_N)$. The sequence x_N is strictly increasing and tends to infinity. With $x_{-1} = 0$, the index N is a global minimizer of $R_j(x)$, $j \geq 0$, exactly when*

$$x_{N-1} \leq x \leq x_N. \tag{11.48}$$

There are exactly two adjacent minimizing indices at an endpoint and exactly one elsewhere on $x > 0$. An exact transition equation is

$$x_N^2 \int_0^\infty \frac{s^N}{x_N^2 + s} d\mu(s) = \frac{\mu_N}{2}. \tag{11.49}$$

Proof. Put $y = x^2$ and $M_N(y) = \int s^N (y + s)^{-1} d\mu(s)$. Strict Cauchy–Schwarz gives

$$M_{N+1}(y)^2 < M_N(y)M_{N+2}(y).$$

Hence $R_N = y^{-N} M_N(y)$ is strictly log-convex as a sequence in N , and its consecutive ratios are strictly increasing. The recurrence $M_{N+1} = \mu_N - y M_N$ gives

$$\frac{R_{N+1}(x)}{R_N(x)} = \frac{\mu_N}{y M_N(y)} - 1. \tag{11.50}$$

By dominated convergence, $yM_N(y) = \int s^N y/(y+s) d\mu(s)$ increases continuously and strictly from 0 to μ_N as y increases from 0 to infinity. The ratio in (11.50) thus decreases continuously from infinity to 0, proving the unique transition and (11.49).

Strict increase of the ratios in N forces $x_{N+1} > x_N$. For fixed y , the moment ratios M_{N+1}/M_N tend to infinity. Indeed, if their increasing sequence were bounded by B , the moments would be at most $M_0 B^N$, contradicting positive mass on an interval strictly to the right of B . This also proves $x_N \rightarrow \infty$ and existence of a global minimum. The strict ratio monotonicity now gives (11.48) and the assertions about ties. $\square$

To expand the transition, let α_K be the unique positive root of

$$E_K(\alpha_K) = \frac{1}{2}, \quad (11.51)$$

and write $\beta_K = 2\pi x_N$ for $K = 2N + 2$. The full transition is the unique root of

$$\Phi_K(a) := \sum_{m \geq 1} w_m \left(E_K(ma) - \frac{1}{2} \right) = 0. \quad (11.52)$$

The symbols α_K, β_K in this analytic section are real numbers; the subscript and argument distinguish β_K from the cyclotomic symbol $\beta_q(a)$.

Theorem 11.27 (Algebraic transition expansion). *Put $b = K - \frac{1}{2} = 2N + \frac{3}{2}$. As $N \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$\alpha_K = b + \frac{3}{8b} - \frac{1}{b^2} + \frac{407}{128b^3} + O(b^{-4}). \quad (11.53)$$

The same expansion holds for $\beta_K = 2\pi x_N$, and the two quantities have identical expansions to every algebraic order.

Proof. The gamma law gives $T/K \rightarrow 1$ in probability. Evaluating at $a = cK$ shows that both roots have $a/K \rightarrow 1$. More precisely, substitution of $a = K + C$ for fixed constants on either side of $C = -1/2$ in (11.43) brackets both roots for large K ; the frequency tail does not change these opposite signs. Therefore $r = K - a$ is bounded at the roots, and the uniform expansion applies.

Solve $2E_K(a) = 1$ from (11.43) to obtain

$$r = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{3}{8a} + \frac{1}{a^2} - \frac{425}{128a^3} + O(a^{-4}).$$

For example, putting $r = 1/2 + q_1/a + q_2/a^2 + q_3/a^3$ gives successively $q_1 = -3/8$, $q_2 = 1$, $q_3 = -425/128$. Since $\partial_a[2E_K(a)]$, with K fixed, is $1/K + O(K^{-2})$ near the root (see (11.56)), a residual of order a^{-j-1} locates the root to order a^{-j} . Thus the formal inversion has the asserted error control. Reexpressing it in $b = K - 1/2$ yields (11.53). Finally, the perturbing tail in (11.52) is $O(2^{-K})$, while its derivative is of order $1/K$; it changes the root by $O(K2^{-K})$. This proves the last assertion. $\square$

To leading order, choose the integer nearest to $\pi x - 1/4$. The exact prescription remains (11.48); no rounding formula with an unspecified remainder resolves every near-tie case.

11.14 An arithmetic displacement beyond all algebraic orders

The comparison in this section is between two exactly defined transition points. Subtracting a finite approximation such as $b + 3/(8b) - 1/b^2$ would leave an algebraic error much larger than the effect we want to measure.

Theorem 11.28 (First arithmetic shift). *For every $K = 2N + 2 \geq 2$, the full transition satisfies $0 < \beta_K < \alpha_K$. As $K \rightarrow \infty$,*

$$\beta_K - \alpha_K = -\frac{9}{10}K2^{-K} \left(1 + O(K^{-1}) + O((2/3)^K)\right). \quad (11.54)$$

Equivalently, with $x_N^{(1)} = \alpha_K/(2\pi)$, $x_N - x_N^{(1)}$ has leading term $-9K2^{-K}/(20\pi)$.

Proof. The function $E_K(c)$ is strictly increasing in c . At $a = \alpha_K$, the $m = 1$ term of (11.52) vanishes, while every $m \geq 2$ term is positive. Hence $\Phi_K(\alpha_K) > 0$. Since Φ_K is strictly increasing, its root lies below α_K .

For the coefficient, $\alpha_K = K + O(1)$ and gamma concentration with its second-moment bound gives

$$E_K(2\alpha_K) = \frac{4}{5} + O(K^{-1}).$$

Also $w_2 = (3/2)2^{-K}$ and $\sum_{m \geq 3} w_m = O(3^{-K})$. Therefore

$$\Phi_K(\alpha_K) = \frac{9}{20}2^{-K} \left(1 + O(K^{-1}) + O((2/3)^K)\right). \quad (11.55)$$

Differentiation under the expectation gives

$$E'_K(a) = \frac{1}{a} \mathbb{E}h(T/a), \quad h(v) = \frac{2v^2}{(1+v^2)^2}.$$

On a bounded neighborhood of K , $h(1) = 1/2$ and a second-moment expansion yield $E'_K(a) = (2K)^{-1}(1 + O(K^{-1}))$. For any m , the derivative of $E_K(ma)$ with respect to a is $a^{-1}\mathbb{E}h(T/(ma))$, and $0 < h \leq 1/2$. Thus

$$\Phi'_K(a) = \frac{1}{2K} \left(1 + O(K^{-1}) + O(2^{-K})\right) \quad (11.56)$$

uniformly in that neighborhood. In particular it has a positive lower bound of order K^{-1} . The mean value theorem first gives $\beta_K - \alpha_K = O(K2^{-K})$ and then, using (11.55)–(11.56), gives (11.54). $\square$

The constant has a transparent decomposition:

$$\frac{9}{10} = \underbrace{\frac{3}{2}}_{\text{divisor weight at } m=2} \underbrace{\left(\frac{4}{5} - \frac{1}{2}\right)}_{\text{kernel gap}} \bigg/ \underbrace{\frac{1}{2}}_{\text{scaled derivative}}.$$

It records the second Lambert frequency, rather than a correction to the Stirling expansion.

Remark 11.29 (A transferable positive-mixture calculation). The same argument applies to a positive exponential mixture with frequencies $1, \rho, \dots, \rho > 1$, and coefficients $c_1, c_\rho > 0$. If its higher-frequency Dirichlet tail is $o(\rho^{-K})$, the corresponding normalized transition displacement is

$$-\frac{c_\rho \rho^2 - 1}{c_1 \rho^2 + 1} K \rho^{-K} (1 + o(1)).$$

This follows by replacing the kernel limit $4/5$ by $\rho^2/(1+\rho^2)$ in the proof. It is a useful extension of the calculation, rather than a claim to a new general method of exponentially improved asymptotics; see [45, §2.11] for the broader established theory.

Periodic correction to the optimal error

$$\min_N R_N(x) = \frac{e^{-2\pi x}}{\sqrt{x}} \left[1 + \frac{c(t)}{2\pi x} + O(x^{-2}) \right]$$

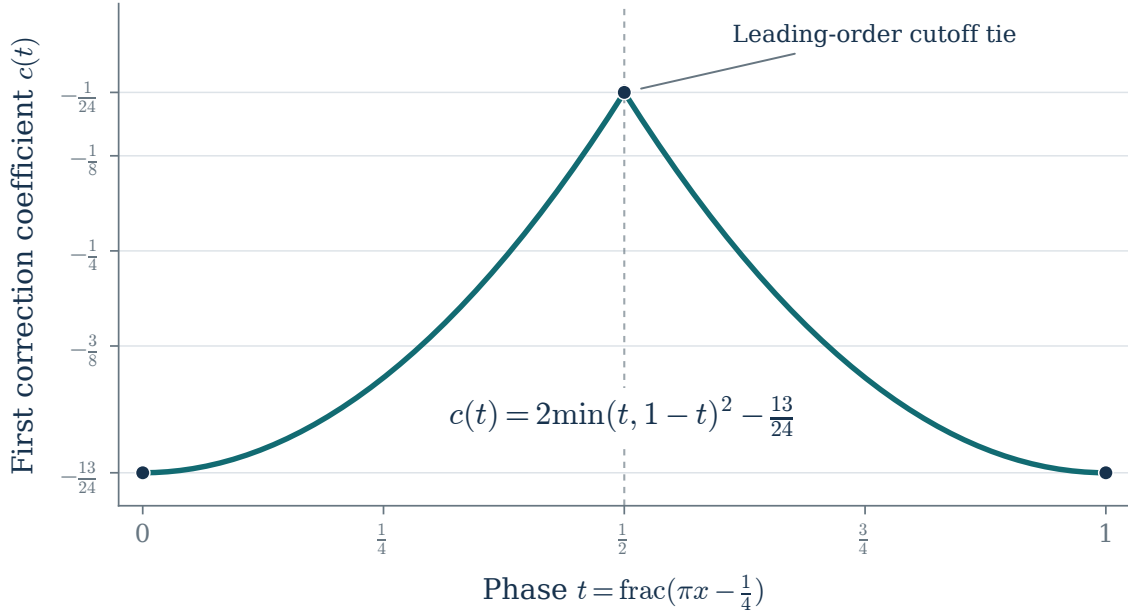


Figure 11.2: The explicit first correction in (11.57), as a function of the fractional part of $\pi x - 1/4$. This plots a proved coefficient function, not fitted numerical data. The two endpoint phases represent the same point of the unit circle.

11.14.1 The periodic correction to the best attainable error

Corollary 11.30 (Integer-cutoff oscillation). *Uniformly for real $x \rightarrow +\infty$,*

$$\min_{N \geq 0} R_N(x) = \frac{e^{-2\pi x}}{\sqrt{x}} \left[1 + \frac{2 \operatorname{dist}(\pi x - \frac{1}{4}, \mathbb{Z})^2 - \frac{13}{24}}{2\pi x} + O(x^{-2}) \right]. \quad (11.57)$$

The numerator of the first correction ranges from $-13/24$ to $-1/24$.

Proof. Complete the square in (11.46): $C_1(\delta) = 2(\delta + 1/4)^2 - 13/24$. The exact transition expansion shows that the optimizing index differs from a nearest integer to $\pi x - 1/4$ only within $O(x^{-1})$ of a tie phase. There the squared distances for the two competing integers differ by $O(x^{-1})$; after multiplication by $(2\pi x)^{-1}$ this contributes only $O(x^{-2})$. The bounded- δ uniformity of Theorem 11.25 completes the proof, including arbitrarily close approaches to transition points. $\square$

11.15 Rational Herglotz derivatives and an exponentially small oscillation

Let

$$F(x) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \frac{\psi(nx) - \log(nx)}{n}, \quad D_r(x) = \frac{(-1)^{r+1} x^{r+1}}{r!} F^{(r)}(x) \quad (r \geq 1, x > 0).$$

The all-orders assertion that rational jets reduce to depth-one cyclotomic polylogarithms is already stated by Radchenko–Zagier [35], immediately after Proposition 4 of their preprint, p. 9. It must not be presented as a new closure theorem. The explicit Bernoulli coefficient formula below gives a constructive version; the large-order estimate and its effective remainder bound are derived independently here. The limit considered below is derivative order tending to infinity at a fixed positive argument.

11.15.1 An explicit finite rational-jet formula

Write $B_j(X)$ for the Bernoulli polynomials with $B_1(X) = X - 1/2$. For positive integers p, q (coprimality is unnecessary for this formula), put

$$c_{a,b} = \frac{a}{q} + \frac{b}{p}, \quad d_{r,j}(a,b) = \binom{r}{j} B_{r-j}(1 - b/p) - \mathbf{1}_{j=0} B_r(a/q),$$

where $1 \leq a \leq q$, $0 \leq b < p$, and $0 \leq j < r$.

Theorem 11.31 (Finite Bernoulli–Hurwitz evaluator). *For $r \geq 1$,*

$$F^{(r)}(p/q) = \frac{(-1)^{r+1}(r-1)!q^{r-1}}{p^{r+1}} \left\{ \sum_{a=1}^q \sum_{b=0}^{p-1} \left[-\psi(c_{a,b}) + \sum_{j=0}^{r-1} d_{r,j}(a,b) \zeta(r+1-j, c_{a,b}) \right] + pq \left(\frac{1}{r} - \gamma - \log q \right) \right\}.$$

In particular every Hurwitz zeta value in the formula has integer order between 2 and $r+1$; no spectral derivatives occur.

Proof. Use the classical integral representation (Radchenko–Zagier, eq. (6))

$$F^{(r)}(x) = (-1)^{r+1} \int_0^\infty t^r \operatorname{Li}_{1-r}(e^{-xt}) \left(\frac{1}{1-e^{-t}} - \frac{1}{t} \right) dt.$$

After $t = qu$ introduce, initially for $\Re s > 0$,

$$I(s) = \int_0^\infty u^{r+s} \operatorname{Li}_{1-r}(e^{-pu}) \left(\frac{1}{1-e^{-qu}} - \frac{1}{qu} \right) du.$$

The combined integral is holomorphic on $\Re s > -1$ since its integrand is $O(u^{\Re s})$ at zero. In $\Re s > 0$ the two terms can be integrated separately, giving

$$I(s) = \Gamma(r+1+s) \sum_{n \geq 1, m \geq 0} \frac{n^{r-1}}{(pn+qm)^{r+1+s}} - \frac{\Gamma(r+s)}{qp^{r+s}} \zeta(1+s).$$

Set $n = qk + a$, $m = p\ell + b$, and $h = k + \ell$. Faulhaber’s identity gives

$$\sum_{k=0}^h (qk+a)^{r-1} = \frac{q^{r-1}}{r} [B_r(h+1+a/q) - B_r(a/q)].$$

Writing $v = h + c_{a,b}$ expands the bracket as $\sum_{j=0}^r d_{r,j}(a,b) v^j$, with $d_{r,r} = 1$. Consequently

$$\sum_{n \geq 1, m \geq 0} \frac{n^{r-1}}{(pn+qm)^{r+1+s}} = \frac{q^{r-1}}{r(pq)^{r+1+s}} \sum_{a,b} \sum_{j=0}^r d_{r,j}(a,b) \zeta(r+1+s-j, c_{a,b}).$$

The $j = r$ terms have Laurent expansion $\zeta(1 + s, c) = s^{-1} - \psi(c) + O(s)$. Their combined residue cancels that of the second term of $I(s)$. The finite part of the two gamma factors contributes $pq[1/r - \gamma - \log q]$ after factoring out $(r - 1)!/(p^{r+1}q^2)$. Finally $F^{(r)}(p/q) = (-1)^{r+1}q^{r+1}I(0)$. All rearrangements took place in an absolutely convergent half-plane; holomorphy of the combined integral justifies taking the finite part. $\square$

Cyclotomic interpretation. For coprime p, q , the rational function

$$R_{r,p,q}(z) = \frac{\text{Li}_{1-r}(z^p)}{1 - z^q}$$

has poles only at p th and q th roots of unity. Its coefficient sequence has a unique finite decomposition

$$[z^N]R_{r,p,q}(z) = \sum_{\omega^p=1 \text{ or } \omega^q=1} \sum_{j=0}^r a_{\omega,j} N^j \omega^N \quad (N \geq 1).$$

The coefficients lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\mu_{pq})$, $a_{1,r} = 1/(rp^r q)$, and $a_{\omega,r} = 0$ for $\omega \neq 1$. Partial fractions therefore give the equivalent formula

$$F^{(r)}(p/q) = (-1)^{r+1}(r-1)!(q/p)^r \left(\frac{1}{r} + \log p \right) + (-1)^{r+1}r!q^{r+1} \sum_{\omega} \sum_{j=0}^{r-1} a_{\omega,j} \text{Li}_{r+1-j}(\omega).$$

This proves the already known closure statement and gives all its coefficients. The special $a_{1,r}\zeta(1+s)$ term is the only pole: its finite-part contribution is exactly the displayed elementary term.

For example,

$$\begin{aligned} F''(1) &= -\frac{1}{2} - \zeta(2), & F'''(1) &= \frac{2}{3} + 3\zeta(2) + \zeta(3), \\ F''(1/2) &= -2 - 8\zeta(2) - \frac{7}{2}\zeta(3), & F'''(1/2) &= \frac{16}{3} + 48\zeta(2) + 32\zeta(3). \end{aligned}$$

At $p = q = 1$ the complete formula reduces to

$$F^{(r)}(1) = (-1)^{r+1}(r-1)! \left[\frac{1}{r} + \sum_{j=1}^{r-1} \binom{r}{j} B_{r-j}(1) \zeta(r+1-j) \right].$$

For high r this exact expression can suffer substantial floating-point cancellation; exact coefficients do not make low-precision evaluation reliable.

11.15.2 The complete algebraic large-order expansion

Define

$$E_r(x) = D_r(x) - \zeta(2) - \frac{x}{r}(\log x - H_{r-1}).$$

The following result concerns $r \rightarrow \infty$ with x fixed, not the large- x Bernoulli expansion of F .

Theorem 11.32 (Large derivative order with effective remainder). *For $x > 0$, integers $r \geq 2$, real $1 < A < r$, and $\pi/4 < \theta < \pi/2$,*

$$|E_r(x)| \leq \frac{2x\zeta(A)\zeta(A+1)}{\pi(2\theta - \pi/2)\cos\theta} \left(\frac{x}{2\pi\cos^2\theta} \right)^A \frac{\Gamma(r-A)\Gamma(A)\Gamma(A+1)}{\Gamma(r+1)}.$$

Consequently, uniformly for x in each compact subinterval of $(0, \infty)$,

$$E_r(x) = O\left(r^{-1/2} \exp[-2\sqrt{\pi r/x}]\right).$$

In particular, the exact harmonic-number expression $\zeta(2) + (x/r)(\log x - H_{r-1})$ contains every algebraic order in $1/r$.

Proof. Binet's digamma integral and Mellin inversion give, for $1 < c < 2$,

$$F(x) + \frac{\zeta(2)}{2x} = -\frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{c-i\infty}^{c+i\infty} \frac{\pi \Gamma(s) \zeta(s) \zeta(s+1)}{(2\pi x)^s \sin(\pi s/2)} ds.$$

One derivation is to Mellin-transform $\psi(y) - \log y + 1/(2y)$ in $1 < \Re s < 2$ using $\int_0^\infty v^{s-1}/(1+v^2) dv = \pi/[2\sin(\pi s/2)]$; the sum over n supplies $\zeta(s+1)$. Absolute convergence of Binet's integral and exponential decay on vertical lines justify inversion and fixed-order differentiation. After r differentiations,

$$D_r(x) = \frac{\zeta(2)}{2} + \frac{1}{2\pi i} \int_{(c)} \frac{\pi \Gamma(r+s) \zeta(s) \zeta(s+1) x^{1-s}}{\Gamma(r+1) (2\pi)^s \sin(\pi s/2)} ds.$$

Move the contour to $\Re s = -A$. The only crossed poles are $s = 1$ and $s = 0$. At the negative even integers the zero of $\zeta(s)$ cancels the sine denominator; gamma poles lie to the left since $A < r$. The residue at 1 is $\zeta(2)/2$. Using $\zeta'(0) = -\frac{1}{2} \log(2\pi)$ and $\psi(r) = H_{r-1} - \gamma$, the residue at 0 is $x(\log x - H_{r-1})/r$. Thus the integral on the new line equals $E_r(x)$.

Apply the zeta functional equation twice to its kernel:

$$\frac{\pi \zeta(s) \zeta(s+1)}{(2\pi)^s \sin(\pi s/2)} = 2(2\pi)^s \cos(\pi s/2) \Gamma(1-s) \Gamma(-s) \zeta(1-s) \zeta(-s).$$

On $s = -A + it$, use $|\zeta(1-s) \zeta(-s)| \leq \zeta(A+1) \zeta(A)$ and $|\Gamma(r-A+it)| \leq \Gamma(r-A)$. Rotating the Euler gamma integral through angle $\theta \operatorname{sgn}(t)$ gives the elementary inequality

$$|\Gamma(a+it)| \leq \Gamma(a) (\cos \theta)^{-a} e^{-\theta|t|} \quad (a > 0, 0 < \theta < \pi/2).$$

Use it for the other two gamma factors, with parameters A and $A+1$, and use $|\cos(\pi s/2)| \leq e^{\pi|t|/2}$. The remaining integral is $\int_{\mathbb{R}} e^{-(2\theta-\pi/2)|t|} dt = 2/(\theta - \pi/2)$, yielding the stated effective bound. The same estimates justify the horizontal-contour limits.

For the stretched-exponential estimate take an integer $m = \sqrt{\pi r/x} + O(1)$ and $\theta = \pi/4 + 1/(2m)$. For r sufficiently large, $1 < m < r$ and the bound applies. Uniformly on compact positive x -intervals,

$$\frac{\Gamma(r-m)}{\Gamma(r+1)} = r^{-m-1} \exp\left[\frac{m(m+1)}{2r} + O(r^{-1/2})\right], \quad \Gamma(m) \Gamma(m+1) = 2\pi m^{2m} e^{-2m} (1 + O(m^{-1})).$$

Also $(2\pi \cos^2 \theta)^{-m} = \pi^{-m} e^{1+O(m^{-1})}$, and the prefactor is $O(xm)$. The power and exponential factors reduce to $O(r^{-1/2} e^{-2\sqrt{\pi r/x}})$, as required. $\square$

An elementary factorial form. At $\theta = \pi/3$ and integer $2 \leq m < r$ the estimate becomes

$$|E_r(x)| \leq \frac{24x}{\pi^2} \zeta(m) \zeta(m+1) \left(\frac{2x}{\pi}\right)^m \frac{(r-m-1)!(m-1)!m!}{r!}.$$

It is useful as a directly computable error certificate even without asymptotic optimization.

Positivity and a convergent Taylor certificate. The derivative integral has a positive kernel with $1/2 < 1/(1 - e^{-t}) - 1/t < 1$, so

$$\frac{\zeta(2)}{2} < D_r(x) < \zeta(2).$$

Therefore the Taylor expansion of $F(x + h)$ about $x > 0$ has, for $\rho = |h|/x < 1$, the explicit remainder bound

$$\left| F(x + h) - \sum_{j=0}^N \frac{F^{(j)}(x)}{j!} h^j \right| \leq \frac{\zeta(2)}{x} \frac{\rho^{N+1}}{1 - \rho}.$$

Its radius is exactly x , since $D_r(x) \rightarrow \zeta(2)$.

11.15.3 Exact arithmetic sectors and the leading oscillation

The divisor-weighted eta/Binet representation in Radchenko–Zagier [35, Section 7.3] is classical context for this calculation. The following identity is a differentiated and reciprocity-transformed form useful for large derivative order. The quantitative sum estimates are needed in addition to a one-sector expansion.

Write $\sigma_{-1}(n) = \sum_{d|n} d^{-1}$. Let U denote Tricomi’s confluent hypergeometric function with its principal branch. Its integral representation is DLMF 13.4.4 [78]. The large-first-parameter asymptotics used below are classical (DLMF 13.8.11–16; Temme [79]); a direct saddle calculation is included to fix the branch and the first correction in this application. The arithmetic sum over all sectors and its aggregate error bound must be justified in addition to that classical one-sector asymptotic.

Theorem 11.33 (Exact divisor-weighted expansion). *For every integer $r \geq 2$ and $x > 0$,*

$$\begin{aligned} E_r(x) &= 2x\Gamma(r) \sum_{n \geq 1} \sigma_{-1}(n) \operatorname{Re} U\left(r, 0, \frac{2\pi i n}{x}\right) \\ &= 2x \sum_{n \geq 1} \sigma_{-1}(n) \int_0^\infty \frac{u^{r-1}}{(1+u)^{r+1}} \cos\left(\frac{2\pi n u}{x}\right) du. \end{aligned}$$

The series of the integrals is absolutely convergent. The assertion does not require absolute convergence after moving the infinite sum inside the oscillatory u -integral.

More precisely, for $1 < A < r$ and $\pi/4 < \theta < \pi/2$, the contribution of an arbitrary subset $\mathcal{N} \subset \mathbb{N}$ is bounded by the previous effective estimate with $\zeta(A)\zeta(A+1)$ replaced by $\sum_{n \in \mathcal{N}} \sigma_{-1}(n)n^{-A}$.

Proof. Set $w = -s$ in the post-functional-equation contour representation:

$$E_r(x) = \frac{2x}{2\pi i \Gamma(r+1)} \int_{(A)} \Gamma(r-w)\Gamma(w)\Gamma(w+1)\zeta(w)\zeta(w+1) \cos(\pi w/2) \left(\frac{x}{2\pi}\right)^w dw.$$

The Dirichlet series $\zeta(w)\zeta(w+1) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \sigma_{-1}(n)n^{-w}$ converges absolutely on this line. The effective gamma bound proves absolute convergence of the resulting series of contour integrals.

For $\Re z > 0$ put

$$M_r(z) = \int_0^\infty e^{-zu} \frac{u^{r-1}}{(1+u)^{r+1}} du = \Gamma(r)U(r, 0, z).$$

For $0 < \Re w < r$, taking its Mellin transform in z gives

$$\int_0^\infty z^{w-1} M_r(z) dz = \frac{\Gamma(w)\Gamma(r-w)\Gamma(w+1)}{\Gamma(r+1)}.$$

Mellin inversion is valid in that strip. Both the defining integral and the Barnes integral extend continuously to $z = \pm i\tau$, $\tau > 0$: the first by dominated convergence, since its rational weight is integrable, and the second by its exponential vertical decay. Averaging the two boundary values replaces z^{-w} by $\tau^{-w} \cos(\pi w/2)$. Substitution proves the formula and the termwise bounds. $\square$

A finite-sum tail bound. For an integer cutoff $N \geq 1$ and $A > 1$,

$$\sum_{n>N} \sigma_{-1}(n) n^{-A} \leq N^{1-A} \left[\frac{1 + \log N}{A-1} + \frac{1}{(A-1)^2} \right],$$

because $\sigma_{-1}(n) \leq H_n \leq 1 + \log n$ and $(1 + \log t)t^{-A}$ is decreasing for $t \geq 1$. Thus the exact series comes with a computable truncation bound.

An alternative bound avoids the auxiliary contour parameters. Rotate the defining u -integral for $M_r(i\tau)$ to the negative imaginary ray. There are no poles in that quadrant; the small and large arcs vanish. Then

$$|M_r(i\tau)| \leq \int_0^\infty e^{-\tau y} \frac{y^{r-1}}{|1 - iy|^{r+1}} dy \leq \Gamma(r) \tau^{-r}.$$

It follows that the arithmetic tail after N terms is at most

$$2x\Gamma(r) \left(\frac{x}{2\pi}\right)^r N^{1-r} \left(\frac{1 + \log N}{r-1} + \frac{1}{(r-1)^2}\right), \quad r \geq 2. \quad (11.58)$$

This is often the simplest finite-sum certificate; the earlier gamma-factor bound is more useful for the sharp large- r exponent.

Theorem 11.34 (Two-term oscillatory asymptotic). *For fixed $x > 0$ define*

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{A}_r(x) &= 2^{5/4} \pi^{3/4} x^{3/4} r^{-3/4} e^{-2\sqrt{\pi r/x}}, \\ \Phi_r(x) &= 2\sqrt{\pi r/x} - \frac{\pi}{x} - \frac{\pi}{8}, \\ \kappa(x) &= \frac{3}{16} \sqrt{\frac{x}{2\pi}} + \frac{1}{12} \left(\frac{2\pi}{x}\right)^{3/2}. \end{aligned}$$

Then, uniformly for x in compact subintervals of $(0, \infty)$,

$$E_r(x) = \mathcal{A}_r(x) \left[\cos \Phi_r(x) + \frac{\kappa(x)}{\sqrt{r}} \cos \left(\Phi_r(x) + \frac{\pi}{4} \right) + O(r^{-1}) \right].$$

This is an additive oscillatory expansion; a relative-error claim after division by $\cos \Phi_r(x)$ would be invalid near its zeros.

Proof. We first prove, uniformly for $z = i\tau$ with τ in any compact positive interval,

$$M_r(z) = \sqrt{\pi} z^{1/4} r^{-3/4} e^{z/2 - 2\sqrt{rz}} \left[1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{r}} \left(\frac{3}{16\sqrt{z}} - \frac{z^{3/2}}{12} \right) + O(r^{-1}) \right]. \quad (11.59)$$

All powers use their principal values.

Rotate the u -contour in the integral defining $M_r(i\tau)$ to argument $-\pi/4$. There are no poles in that quadrant. On the large arc the rational factor is $O(R^{-2})$, while $|e^{-i\tau u}| \leq 1$; a small arc of radius ϵ contributes $O(\epsilon^r)$. Hence the rotation is justified directly. Put

$$u = \sqrt{r/z} v, \quad \lambda = \sqrt{rz}, \quad \epsilon = \sqrt{z/r}.$$

This gives the exact representation

$$M_r(z) = \sqrt{z/r} \int_0^\infty v^{-2} \exp[-\lambda v - (r+1) \log(1 + \epsilon/v)] dv.$$

On any fixed compact positive v -interval,

$$\begin{aligned} -\lambda v - (r+1) \log(1 + \epsilon/v) &= -\lambda(v + v^{-1}) + \frac{z}{2v^2} \\ &\quad + r^{-1/2} \left(-\frac{\sqrt{z}}{v} - \frac{z^{3/2}}{3v^3} \right) + O(r^{-1}), \end{aligned}$$

with the same estimates after any fixed number of v -derivatives.

For completeness, localization at $v = 1$ is uniform. Write $a = \sqrt{\tau/(2r)}$, so $\epsilon = a(1+i)$ and $\Re \lambda = ra$. On a compact v -interval the real part of the exponent is $-ra(v + v^{-1}) + O(1)$, and $v + v^{-1}$ has its unique minimum 2 at 1. For the small tail $0 < v < \delta < 1/2$, use $|1 + \epsilon/v| \geq 1 + a/v$ and substitute $y = a/v$:

$$\int_0^\delta v^{-2} |1 + \epsilon/v|^{-r-1} dv \leq \frac{1}{ar} (1 + a/\delta)^{-r} = O\left(r^{-1/2} e^{-ra/\delta + O(1)}\right).$$

This is exponentially smaller than e^{-2ra} . For $v > M > 2$, the factor $e^{-\lambda v}$ gives the analogous bound $O(e^{-Mra})$. The remaining compact interval outside any fixed neighborhood of 1 also has a strict exponential gap.

Apply complex Laplace expansion at $v = 1$ to $\phi(v) = v + v^{-1}$ and $g(v) = v^{-2} e^{z/(2v^2)}$. It is legitimate since $\arg \lambda = \pi/4$ lies strictly inside the right half-plane. The Gaussian integral along the real v -axis gives $e^{-2\lambda} \sqrt{\pi/\lambda}$. The coefficient of $1/\lambda$, divided by $g(1)$, is

$$\frac{g''(1)}{4g(1)} + \frac{3g'(1)}{4g(1)} + \frac{3}{16} = z + \frac{z^2}{4} + \frac{3}{16}.$$

Adding the explicit $r^{-1/2}$ correction in the exponent at $v = 1$ gives

$$-\sqrt{z} - \frac{z^{3/2}}{3} + \frac{1}{\sqrt{z}} \left(z + \frac{z^2}{4} + \frac{3}{16} \right) = \frac{3}{16\sqrt{z}} - \frac{z^{3/2}}{12}.$$

This proves (11.59); further terms follow by the same finite Taylor and Gaussian-moment calculation, with standard local remainder estimates. As an independent classical check, in DLMF 13.8.11 with $b = 0$ one has $p_0(z) = 1$ and $q_0(z) = -z/12$; the standard large-argument expansions of K_1 and K_0 give exactly the same first correction.

At $z = 2\pi i/x$, taking $2x$ times the real part of (11.59) gives the stated main term and correction. Indeed $z^{1/4}$ has argument $\pi/8$, and the correction equals $\kappa(x)e^{-\pi i/4}$.

It remains to control all the other arithmetic sectors uniformly. For $A \geq 2$,

$$\zeta(A)\zeta(A+1) - 1 = \sum_{n \geq 2} \sigma_{-1}(n) n^{-A} \leq 4(\zeta(2)\zeta(3) - 1) 2^{-A}.$$

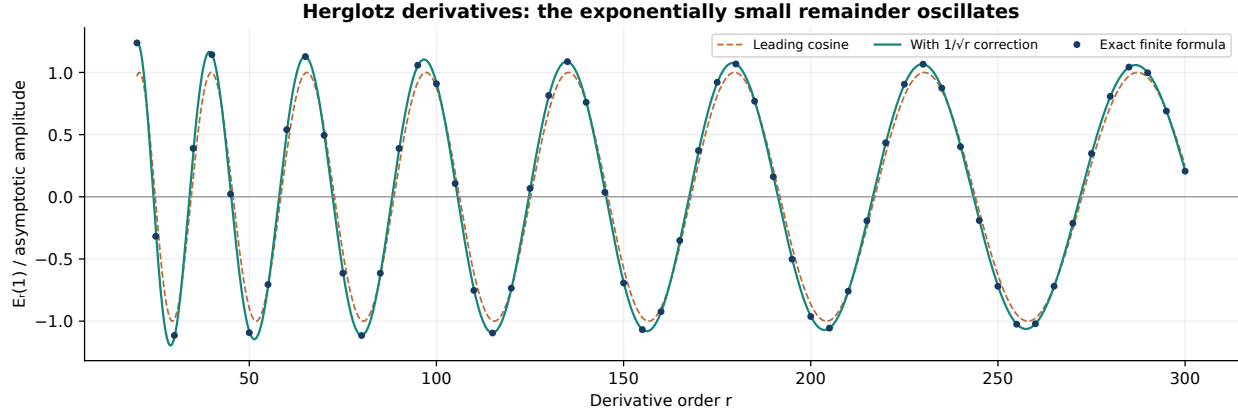


Figure 11.3: The Herglotz remainder divided by its asymptotic amplitude at $x = 1$. The leading cosine and its first correction track the exact finite-formula values. The asymptotic is additive, so no division by a small cosine is used.

Use the effective sector bound with $A = \sqrt{2\pi r/x} + O(1)$ an integer and $\theta = \pi/4 + 1/(2A)$. Exactly the previous optimization yields

$$\sum_{n \geq 2} 2x\sigma_{-1}(n) \operatorname{Re} M_r(2\pi in/x) = O\left(r^{-1/2} e^{-2\sqrt{2\pi r/x}}\right).$$

This is absorbed into $\mathcal{A}_r(x)O(r^{-1})$, uniformly on compact positive x -intervals. $\square$

Corollary 11.35 (Sharp exponential rate and infinitely many signs). *For each fixed $x > 0$ the real sequence $E_r(x)$ takes positive and negative values infinitely often. More precisely,*

$$\limsup_{r \rightarrow \infty} \frac{E_r(x)}{\mathcal{A}_r(x)} = 1, \quad \liminf_{r \rightarrow \infty} \frac{E_r(x)}{\mathcal{A}_r(x)} = -1,$$

and

$$\limsup_{r \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\log |E_r(x)|}{\sqrt{r}} = -2\sqrt{\pi/x}.$$

Here $\log 0 = -\infty$ if an exact zero occurs.

Proof. The phase $\Phi_r(x)$ increases to infinity, with successive differences tending to zero. Consequently it has subsequences approaching any fixed phase modulo 2π . Apply the additive expansion and choose phases 0 and π . The same subsequences establish the lower bound for the limsup of the logarithmic rate; the asymptotic envelope gives the upper bound. $\square$

Further research specific to this section. Compute and certify several further half-integer corrections in (11.59); build an interval implementation of the exact sector sum; locate the sign-transition indices beyond the leading $\sqrt{r}$ phase law; and obtain a uniform transition theory when x also varies with r . The fixed- x theorem above does not justify such a double-scaling limit automatically.

11.16 Quadratic units and Kronecker-limit coordinates

Define the normalized functions

$$\mathcal{F}(x) = F(x) - F(1) + \frac{\pi^2}{12}(x - 2 + x^{-1}) - \frac{1}{4}\log^2 x, \quad \mathcal{J}(x) = J(x) - \frac{1}{2}\log^2 2 + \frac{\pi^2}{24}(x - x^{-1}).$$

For a real quadratic order of discriminant D , a narrow ideal class $\mathcal{B}$ has a partial zeta function. Its Kronecker constant is

$$\varrho(\mathcal{B}) = \lim_{s \rightarrow 1} \left[D^{s/2} \zeta(\mathcal{B}, s) - \frac{\log \varepsilon_D}{s - 1} \right],$$

where $\varepsilon_D > 1$ is the least norm-one unit. In the reduced-form cycle representation, $w_j > 1 > w'_j > 0$, Radchenko–Zagier give

$$\varrho(\mathcal{B}) = 2\gamma \log \varepsilon_D - \ell(\mathcal{B}) \frac{\pi^2}{6} + \sum_{j \bmod \ell} [\mathcal{F}(w_j) - \mathcal{F}(w'_j) + L(w'_j/w_j)], \quad (11.60)$$

where L is the unnormalized Rogers dilogarithm. Class characters turn the ϱ coordinates into Hecke L -values. Their Theorem 5 expresses $\mathcal{J}$ at specified even-trace units in these coordinates. The source’s independent cycle engine reported checks at $n = 2, 4, 6, 8$ with residuals about 5×10^{-38} ; the engine was not imported into this checkout.

11.17 Regulator candidates and field degrees

The published Stark examples and the source’s follow-up fits are conjectural or numerical evaluations. A cubic polynomial over $\mathbb{Q}$ defines a degree-three field E . It cannot itself be a Hilbert or ring class field containing a quadratic field K . In the examples at issue, its degree-six splitting field can be a cyclic cubic extension of K ; E is a cubic subfield. The distinction corrects a repeated field-degree error in the report.

For $u = 16 + \sqrt{257}$ the source reports

$$\mathcal{J}(u) \stackrel{\text{num}}{=} 4\zeta(2) + \log 2 \log u + 2 \operatorname{reg}(E), \quad E = \mathbb{Q}[x]/(x^3 - 2x^2 - 3x + 1). \quad (11.61)$$

The determinant of the two selected unit-logarithm columns is signed; with the source’s ordering it is $-\operatorname{reg}(E)$. Vertical bars around a matrix denote its determinant, not an absolute value. Replacing this negative determinant by its absolute value without changing its external coefficient reverses the regulator term.

The other published example concerns $u = 10 + 3\sqrt{11}$ and the order of discriminant 396. Its unit-logarithm expression is a Stark minor rather than a full field regulator. We retain that structural distinction; the unimported algebraic-unit definitions do not provide a locally replayable formula for the minor.

The source reports that $n = 6, 10, 14, 16, 26$ are the narrow-class-number-three cases in its scan of $2 \leq n \leq 5000$. This is a bounded census, not a proof that the family is finite. Negative fits at class numbers five and seven likewise do not establish a universal “single regulator if and only if cyclic cubic” theorem.

There is a precise conditional route to a leading- L interpretation. Suppose a non-Galois totally real cubic field E has quadratic resolvent K , and its normal closure supplies a nontrivial order-three class character χ of K . Artin induction gives $\zeta_E(s) = \zeta(s)L_K(s, \chi)$. The analytic class-number formula then gives

$$L_K(s, \chi) = h_E \operatorname{reg}(E) s^2 + O(s^3),$$

n	D_0	cubic field polynomial	c_1	c_2	c_3
6	37	$x^3 - x^2 - 3x + 1$	3/2	2/3	2/3
10	101	$x^3 - x^2 - 5x - 1$	5/2	2/3	2/3
14	197	$x^3 - x^2 - 7x - 3$	7/2	2/3	2/3
16	257	$x^3 - x^2 - 4x + 3$	4	1	2
26	677	$x^3 - x^2 - 11x - 7$	13/2	2/3	2/3

Table 11.1: Historical numerical candidates $\mathcal{J}(n + \sqrt{n^2 + 1}) = c_1\zeta(2) + c_2 \log 2 \log u + c_3 \operatorname{reg}(E)$. The source reports residuals below 1.2×10^{-109} . These are not unconditional theorems.

because $\zeta_E(s) = -h_E \operatorname{reg}(E)s^2/2 + O(s^3)$ and $\zeta(0) = -1/2$. Thus the coefficient equals $\operatorname{reg}(E)$ only after $h_E = 1$ and the field-character identification have been established. This argument does not convert the numerical Herglotz fits into proofs of Stark’s conjecture.

11.18 Exact class-number-one certificates

Proposition 11.36 (Class-number certificates for the five cubic fields). *Each of the five totally real cubic fields in Table 11.2 has class number one. In the table, α denotes a root of the polynomial in its row, d_H is the field discriminant, and $B = \lfloor 2\sqrt{d_H}/9 \rfloor$ is the integer Minkowski bound. The final column lists a generator of a principal ideal of norm p for each indicated rational prime p ; the field norm of the generator may be $-p$.*

Polynomial for α	d_H	B	p : generator
$X^3 - X^2 - 3X + 1$	148	2	$2 : \alpha - 1$
$X^3 - X^2 - 5X - 1$	404	4	$2 : \alpha + 1; \quad 3 : \alpha^2 - 2\alpha - 2$
$X^3 - X^2 - 7X - 3$	788	6	$2 : \alpha + 1; \quad 3 : \alpha; \quad 5 : \alpha^2 - 2\alpha - 4$
$X^3 - X^2 - 4X + 3$	257	3	$3 : \alpha$
$X^3 - X^2 - 11X - 7$	2708	11	$2 : \alpha + 1; \quad 3 : \alpha + 2; \quad 7 : \alpha$ $5 : -\alpha^2 + 2\alpha + 10; \quad 11 : 2\alpha^2 - 4\alpha - 17$

Table 11.2: Exact generators used in the class-number-one proof.

Proof. The rational-root test proves irreducibility of each polynomial f . Their polynomial discriminants are, in the displayed order, 148, 404, 788, 257, 2708, all positive. Thus all five fields are totally real. At discriminant 257, squarefreeness immediately gives $\mathcal{O}_{H_0} = \mathbb{Z}[\alpha]$. In each other row only 2 could divide the index. In all four cases $\bar{f} = (X + 1)^3$ modulo 2, while

$$\left. \frac{f(X) - (X + 1)^3}{2} \right|_{X=1} \in \{-5, -7, -9, -13\}.$$

These values are odd. Dedekind’s index criterion therefore excludes 2 from the index. Equivalently, each shifted polynomial $f(X + 1)$ is Eisenstein at 2, so its root generates the local ring of integers [51, Proposition 7.55 and Remark 7.56]. This proves maximality and the asserted field discriminants. The use of Dedekind factorization below is consequently valid also at 2.

Minkowski’s theorem gives an integral ideal in every ideal class with norm at most $2\sqrt{d_H}/9$ for a totally real cubic field [51]. It suffices to prove principalness for every prime ideal whose norm is at most B . In the four even-discriminant rows, 2 is totally ramified; the displayed norm-2 element

generates its unique prime ideal. At discriminant 257, the polynomial is irreducible modulo 2, so the prime above 2 has norm $8 > B$.

For each relevant odd rational prime $p \leq B$, direct factorization of f modulo p has type $1 + 2$. There is therefore exactly one prime ideal of norm p . The corresponding element in the table has norm $\pm p$, so this degree-one prime is principal. Its degree-two partner is principal as well, since their product is (p) . This last observation covers in particular the prime of norm 9 in the field of discriminant 2708. The table accounts for all rational primes $p \leq B$, hence for all prime ideals within the Minkowski bound. Every ideal class is therefore trivial.

All finite calculations in this proof—discriminants, index tests, modular splitting types, and generator norms—are reproduced with integer arithmetic by `../reports/corpus-corrections/code/12-relation-spaces-verify_cubic_class_numbers.py`. $\square$

For the other polynomial used in the 257 example, $x^3 - 2x^2 - 3x + 1$, the same bound is three: it is irreducible modulo two, and its unique norm-three prime is generated by $\alpha - 1$. Its squarefree discriminant is 257, so its order is maximal. Thus that cubic also has class number one. The leading primitive Artin coefficient consequently specializes to the regulator in these cases. Inflating a primitive character to a ray modulus can remove Euler factors; at the 257 modulus-two example the factor at zero is three. The primitive and ray-modulus Dirichlet series must be identified before comparing their leading coefficients. This still does not turn the fitted Herglotz evaluations into proved Stark identities.

Chapter 12

Experimental discovery and the route to proof

The mathematical progression of the manuscript suggests a practical method. One begins with a value that is easy to compute but hard to recognize, finds an exact transformation that organizes its arguments, and then asks which coordinates remain after known laws are imposed. Numerical experiments are especially effective at proposing those coordinates. Their usefulness increases when the proposed identity is subsequently derived, and when a negative result is recorded with enough detail to explain its limits.

12.1 Constructing a meaningful integer-relation experiment

An experiment consists of a target, a finite ordered basket of constants, their coefficient field, a working precision, a coefficient bound and an acceptance rule. Weight and character parity give strong guidance for the basket. For instance a rational-angle Fourier transform can require $\sqrt{q}$ -weighted atoms; searching only with rational coefficients in the unweighted values misses that structure. The $\pi^3\psi^{(-3)}(1/4)$ coordinate in Chapter 9 is another example: omitting the π^3 factor changes the question.

Before searching, remove known basket dependencies. A search containing both $\log \Gamma(1/2)$ and $\frac{1}{2} \log \pi$ may return their tautology instead of a relation involving the target. Reflecting arguments, distributing roots of unity and replacing elementary odd beta values reduce this problem before numerical linear algebra starts.

Working precision must exceed the cancellation loss as well as the digits needed to discriminate the proposed coefficient height. The heuristic $10^{P/d}$, for P available digits and d basket coordinates, estimates a scale at which accidental short numerical relations can appear. It is neither a theorem about a specific basket nor a rigorous exclusion bound. Coefficient sizes, conditioning and the number of searches all matter. The earlier false negative for S_5 illustrates this: a 51-coordinate basket at 150 digits obscured the height-3840 relation that a smaller, properly structured basket exposed.

12.2 Controls and independent recomputation

A planted positive control checks that the search can recover a known relation of comparable scale. A perturbation of one coefficient tests the resolution of the residual check. A negative control and an auxiliary “canary” constant can expose numerical coincidences. These controls are diagnostics.

In particular no independence theorem is known between the Champernowne constant and the periods in these baskets, and a zero canary coefficient cannot certify an identity.

A successful candidate should be frozen as exact rational or algebraic coefficients, then reevaluated at higher precision using an independent representation. For a nested sum that may be an iterated integral; for a CM row sum it may be a modular Fourier series; for Herglotz values it may be a defining integral compared with the finite dilogarithm sum. Agreement between two engines using the same incorrect formula is less informative than agreement between different mathematical representations. Error-controlled interval evaluation can establish a finite residual bound, but even an arbitrarily small nonzero numerical bound alone does not establish equality of general transcendental constants.

12.3 What exact linear algebra proves

An exact relation matrix proves an upper bound on the number of necessary coordinates in its presented quotient. Its row-combination matrix is a replayable finite certificate relative to the input identities. A free column is independent in that formal quotient, not automatically among the evaluated numerical periods. Additional functional equations or regularization can reduce the quotient further.

Likewise a motivic dimension theorem concerns motivic objects. To infer numerical independence one needs a period-injectivity statement, generally conjectural. A dimension for a chosen word-length grading need not be the dimension of the classical depth filtration. The Gaussian triples are a natural test case for this distinction.

Certificates require both exact atom cancellation and sound law instantiation. Substitution strings must be parsed within a restricted grammar; branches and domains must be established mathematically. A numerical branch guard is useful for rejecting errors but leaves a separate domain obligation. These issues motivate a future formal development rather than a current claim of proof-assistant verification.

12.4 Computational conventions

The manuscript uses decreasing nested indices. In the tested Wolfram Language 15 interface,

$$\text{Li}_{a,b}(z_1, z_2) = \text{MultiplePolyLog}[\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b}\}, \{\mathbf{z1}, \mathbf{z2}\}], \quad \zeta(a, b) = \text{MultipleZeta}[\{\mathbf{a}, \mathbf{b}\}].$$

Finite checks such as $\zeta(2, 1, 1) = \zeta(4)$ and $H(0, 1; z) = \text{Li}_2(z)$ calibrate the interface. A divergent call does not resolve ordering ambiguities on its own. The same calibration is needed for signed harmonic indices and generalized-polylogarithm letter order.

Negative-order polygamma means the integral based at zero: $\psi^{(-1)} = \log \Gamma$ and $\psi^{(-n)}(z) = \int_0^z \psi^{(-(n-1))}(t) dt$ for $n \geq 2$. Balanced conventions can differ by explicit polynomials. In Hurwitz jets, $\zeta^{(j)}$ always differentiates the spectral variable; the superscript (k) on γ_n differentiates its parameter. The CM hexagonal point $e^{i\pi/3}$ and the Eisenstein cube root $e^{2\pi i/3}$ are different arguments even when a local section denotes each by ρ .

12.5 The surviving research programme

Several concrete proof problems now fit into one framework. The odd-weight S_p directions need a precise choice of comparison algebra and a rigorous reduction or obstruction; the even-weight

direction has the generating-integral proof of Chapter 4. The Gaussian and Eisenstein inverse-color points now have an all-weight partial-fraction reduction, and the distribution ranks have a complete character normal form. A full regularized relation computation remains useful for the other colored points. Numerical independence of character derivative coordinates remains a separate arithmetic problem.

The gamma programme can transport its exact row certificates across the DFT and prove branch validity for each law instance. Its finite-matrix termination should remain separate from Rohrlich's conjecture. The CM programme can replace fitted coefficients by modular equations and class-field computations, while taking account of periods under Galois conjugation. The Herglotz programme needs complete explicit class-character and unit definitions for the regulator candidates before they become locally replayable, followed by the relevant Stark argument.

The cubic log-gamma moment now has the explicit Tornheim representation and certified enclosure of Section 8.5. Reduction of those derivative coordinates into a stated smaller algebra remains a precise question, alongside the opaque individual CM components. The Gaussian weight-five relation, weight-six doubles, weight-four triples and cubic/quartic ladders likewise now have exact proofs. The S_4 relation now has the exact certificate of Theorem 4.8. Higher golden ladder certificates and numerical period independence remain open; the S_6 candidate supplies a concrete next mixed-reduction problem. A richer representation is often more productive than a larger unstructured search. The scientific value of the experiments is that they tell us which representation to seek next.

12.6 Questions sharpened by the exact continuations

12.6.1 Zero geometry beyond a fixed Laurent index

The complete classical counts are now known through Laurent index seven. The fifth-index transition has threshold three, and Theorem 10.25 proves sharp thresholds four and five at indices six and seven. Critical-point descent determines the deficits below saturation with exact signs, rather than extrapolating from a root scan. Small-order classification for higher indices remains open. Effective thresholds uniform in the positive Lerch parameter require quantitative separation of the Appell roots and explicit concentration remainders. The spectral coefficient expansion for $n = O(\log k)$ does not by itself supply moving-zero asymptotics throughout that range, because the extreme root slopes can leave a compact scale. For higher zero branches, monotonicity in the deformation parameter is suggested by the first correction but is proved globally only at $n = 1$.

12.6.2 Certificates, integral structure and arithmetic evaluation

The complex distribution module is free even at resonant weights. What changes there is the usefulness of selected coordinates, not its rank. Integral Smith forms, torsion, cyclotomic coefficient arithmetic and short certificate generation remain separate questions. The same distinction applies to the exterior-symbol calculus: a nonzero formal obstruction rules out a certificate in that calculus, while the kernel of numerical period evaluation is a deeper arithmetic problem. Constructive reduction can now be benchmarked against an exact admissibility criterion rather than a denominator heuristic.

12.6.3 Further positive kernels and approximation regimes

The harmonic-index transition and Herglotz optimal cutoff illustrate two ways that positive kernels convert experiments into uniform asymptotics. Other roots of unity introduce complex weights and

can destroy positivity; their extensions need a replacement argument rather than a formal reuse of the signed bounds. The general $J(p/q)$ symbol problem extends the proved $J(2/q)$ classification. At the optimal approximation scale, algebraic corrections and exponentially smaller arithmetic shifts require separately defined reference transitions. Their numerical diagnostics should retain that separation of scales.

12.6.4 A focused path toward formal verification

The finite algebraic interfaces are suitable first targets: character projectors, prime distribution edges, polynomial normal forms, exact partial fractions and the rational interval operations. Analytical formalization can then isolate the root-preserving operator, Laplace variation argument, positive-kernel remainder theorems and local normalized functional equation. These are explicit future tasks, not claims that the present ordinary proofs have already been checked by a proof assistant.

12.7 From decimal fits to short executable proofs

The Gaussian continuation illustrates a complete experimental cycle. A weight-five relation first found with large coefficients is the combination of two simple shuffle rows; the parity theorem then explains all five weight-six double reductions. The one-two integral supplies the three weight-four triples, while algebraic argument substitutions and rational row operations certify the cubic and quartic ladders. The cubic log-gamma moment requires a Tornheim derivative coordinate rather than a larger unstructured single-value basket.

The accompanying fresh replay re-expands all 511 ending-in-one binary words through weight nine and checks 45 bigraded sectors. It verifies 35 exact algebraic ladder substitutions and reproduces the integer cubic moment certificate, whose endpoints share 112 decimal places. Independent defining-integral comparisons check 64 double and one-two formulas. The Chebyshev implementation supplies 89 interval residual enclosures, including one for S_4 , which was conjectural at that checkpoint. That enclosure containing zero did not prove equality; the later octahedral certificate provides the exact argument. Six separate midpoint rectangles enclose the Gaussian and Eisenstein inverse-color values to widths below 10^{-70} . These finite replays test the implementations. The all-weight and asymptotic statements rest on the analytic and algebraic arguments in the chapters.

12.8 What the new reports change in the research programme

The exact S_4 proof adds a convergent octahedral word transformation and higher-depth lifted rows to a vocabulary that the finite obstructions had shown insufficient. The weight-three companion in Theorem 4.11 supplies a second exact mixed reduction. The product-matrix rank conjecture is now proved by Theorem 5.15. The next task is to compress the larger certificate and investigate the frozen S_6 relation with the same analytic control. Pure complementary seeds now have a complete collision classification and an algebraic-degree cutoff; arbitrary multiplicative unit relations and maximal ladder weights remain broader questions.

Primitive-grid determinants and Smith factors quantify coordinate failures without changing the free distribution quotient. Explicit finite descent and pole-cancelled Fourier jets give constructive all-index identities and trace zeros; integral lattices and certified high-order implementations remain distinct developments. The new sharp and reflected moment theories separate fixed-exponent asymptotics, optimal truncation and simultaneous large-exponent limits. Likewise, the Herglotz

oscillation is proved for fixed positive argument and large derivative order; joint scaling requires further uniform estimates.

12.9 A certified rejection beyond the discovery precision

A new Cayley continuation supplies a useful counterexample to premature promotion of integer-relation output. At weight nine, define the ordered basket

$$\mathbf{b}_8 = (S_8, g_{8,1}, g_{7,2}, g_{6,3}, g_{5,4}, \pi^9, \beta(8) \log 2, \beta(2)\zeta(7), \beta(4)\zeta(5), \beta(6)\zeta(3)).$$

A search with 110 working digits, tolerance 10^{-90} and coefficient ceiling 10^{12} returned the integer vector

$$\mathbf{c}_8 = (-6451250972, -4072849461, -710107844, -10984374763, \\ -6393592639, 31875, -1955138863, 3459066102, -1034180101, -1477786143).$$

Proposition 12.1 (The frozen weight-nine vector is false). *With $R_8 = \mathbf{c}_8 \cdot \mathbf{b}_8$,*

$$-1.3274179020580459 \times 10^{-86} < R_8 < -1.3274179020580457 \times 10^{-86} < 0.$$

Proof. The delivered rational evaluator encloses each harmonic double and each single atom with 1000 Euler terms, using the explicit signed tail budgets. It forms all products and the frozen linear combination in exact interval arithmetic. The resulting rational residual interval has width less than 2.080×10^{-290} and lies strictly inside the displayed negative interval. The fresh isolated replay recomputes every rational atom endpoint and the residual, comparing exact fractions with the preserved record `reports/cayley-s4-continuation/data/S8_exclusion_N1000.json`. Both the negative sign and the containment are exact rational comparisons. This computation proves the displayed exclusion; it uses no floating-point sign or integer-relation search as an acceptance criterion. $\square$

This rejects precisely the frozen vector, not every possible relation in the basket. A later unsuccessful higher-precision search likewise proves no arithmetic independence. In contrast the new alternative S_6 vector still has an enclosure containing zero; it remains conjectural, and Proposition 4.41 proves by two convergent shuffles that it is the earlier S_6 conjecture in a different basket.

Appendix A

Literature problems and source provenance

The two source catalogs organize questions that motivated or could extend the programme. Their categories and answer status describe the June 2026 survey, not a current audit of the websites. A catalog entry is a research lead, not an accepted identity. Closely overlapping questions are retained under a single thread identifier. The external reports numbered one through four contributed leads to these catalogs; their unverified prose and claims are not used as mathematical authorities.

One erroneous external formula is corrected here with a proof. Euler reflection at $1/3$, together with Landen at $-1/3$ and duplication, gives

$$6 \operatorname{Li}_2(1/3) - \operatorname{Li}_2(1/9) = \frac{\pi^2}{3} - \log^2 3.$$

For completeness, put $A = \operatorname{Li}_2(1/3)$ and $B = \operatorname{Li}_2(-1/3)$. The five-term relation at $x = y = 1/2$ and Landen at $-1/3$ give

$$2 \operatorname{Li}_2(1/2) = \operatorname{Li}_2(1/4) + 2A + \log^2(2/3), \quad \operatorname{Li}_2(1/4) = -B - \frac{1}{2} \log^2(4/3).$$

With $2 \operatorname{Li}_2(1/2) = \pi^2/6 - \log^2 2$, collecting the logarithms gives $2A - B = \pi^2/6 - \frac{1}{2} \log^2 3$. Duplication says $\operatorname{Li}_2(1/9) = 2A + 2B$, so subtracting it from $6A$ proves the corrected formula. This derivation fixes the factor-two error in the external report without relying on numerical recognition.

A.1 Polylogarithm questions

Thread	Research question	Historical category
MSE 1424600	Real part of $\operatorname{Li}_2(1/2 + i/6)$	Seed question
MSE 1430169	Dilogarithm values at algebraic complex arguments	Seed question
MSE 1373123	An identity for six rational tetralogarithm values	Seed question
MSE 945972	Relations among rational polylogarithm values	Seed question
MSE 1579355	Trilogarithms and the imaginary golden ratio	Seed question
MSE 918680	Closed Form for the Imaginary Part of $\operatorname{Li}_3((1+i)/2)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 3290798	A conjectured value for $\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_4(1+i)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange

Thread	Research question	Historical category
MSE 3447529	On the relationship between $\operatorname{Re} \operatorname{Li}_n(1+i)$ and $\operatorname{Li}_n(1/2)$ when $n \geq 5$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 676124	Proving a $\operatorname{Li}_3(-1/3) - 2 \operatorname{Li}_3(1/3)$ identity	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1450917	A special value polylogarithm identity involving $\operatorname{Li}_3(-1/2)$, $\operatorname{Li}_3(-1/3)$, $\operatorname{Li}_3(2/3)$, $\operatorname{Li}_2(-1/3)$, $\operatorname{Li}_2(2/3)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 935366	Simplification of an expression containing $\operatorname{Li}_3(x)$ terms	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 5092144	How to prove this $\zeta(3)$ form with Li_3 and Li_2	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 463682	Closed form of $\operatorname{Li}_2(\phi)$ and $\operatorname{Li}_2(\phi-1)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1410276	Closed-form of $\operatorname{Li}_2(1 + i \sqrt{3})$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 967398	Extract real and imaginary parts of $\operatorname{Li}_2(i(2 + \sqrt{3}))$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1602647	Extract imaginary part of $\operatorname{Li}_3(2/3 - i \sqrt{2}/3)$ in closed form	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 980179	Closed-form of a special value dilogarithm identity	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 989704	Closed-forms of real parts of special value dilogarithm identities from inverse tangent integral function	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1436493	Dilogarithm identity containing the tribonacci constant	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 481682	Polylogarithm ladders for the tribonacci and n-nacci constants	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1064100	Why does the tribonacci constant have a trilogarithm ladder?	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1959503	Proof of a dilogarithm identity	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 932932	Known exact values of the Li_3 function	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1411312	Closed form of a series (dilogarithm)	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 2389425	A very odd-looking statement about $\zeta(3)$ and $\operatorname{Li}_2(1/\phi^2)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MO 492746	Proving identity involving dilogarithms and $\pi/9$	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 85986	A dilogarithm identity: known or new?	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 144322	The relationship between the dilogarithm and the golden ratio	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 261408	Several conjectured identities for polylogarithms	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 450252	An identity involving polylogarithms	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 511718	Two-term dilogarithmic identity simplification	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 511765	Daniel Shanks "simplest cubic fields" and dilogarithm identities	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 131111	Is this combination of generalized polygamma and dilogarithm actually zero?	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow

Thread	Research question	Historical category
MSE 5080786	Ramanujan type formulas for polylogarithm	Open prompts with usable identity examples but no meaningful answers
MSE 5023055	How to find closed form for a complex expression involving special functions and polylogarithms?	Open prompts with usable identity examples but no meaningful answers
MO 173492	Dilogarithm of $-1/2$?	Open prompts with usable identity examples but no meaningful answers
MO 141185	A second polylogarithm ladder for the tribonacci and n-nacci constants	Open prompts with usable identity examples but no meaningful answers
MO 490573	The imaginary part of two-term complex dilogarithms	Open prompts with usable identity examples but no meaningful answers
MO 496682	Deriving a 4-term functional dilogarithm identity by Kirillov	Open prompts with usable identity examples but no meaningful answers
MSE 3938336	Evaluate a series equal to $\text{Li}_3((3-\sqrt{5})/2)$	Duplicate-like or low-new-information threads
MSE 5110303	Does the polylogarithm $\text{Li}_k(x)$ solve a first or second order ODE/ADE?	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MSE 5127863	Completing proof of formula for a hard polylogarithmic integral	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MSE 4986171	Understanding polylogarithm branch points, monodromy and multivaluedness	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MO 85774	Is the quantum dilogarithm related in any way to cohomology of quantum groups?	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MO 160646	Inverse of polylogarithm	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MO 333610	Limiting property of polylogarithm ratio	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MO 279588	Approximations of polylogarithm and Lerch transcendent?	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MO 218158	Root polylogarithm dominance questions	Rejected or parked: no answer and no special-value identity example
MSE 1210644	Proving a sum $\cos(n)/n^4$ evaluation	Near misses and background threads
MSE 376180	Integral identity involving $\text{Li}_2(-1-e^{\{ix\}})$	Near misses and background threads
MSE 4284361	Closed form evaluation of a trigonometric integral in terms of polylogarithms	Near misses and background threads
MSE 5125161	Verify a polylogarithmic evaluation of a 5D integral over a positive orthant	Near misses and background threads

Thread	Research question	Historical category
MO 347747	Simplify the difference of two dilogarithms	Near misses and background threads
MO 2402	Abel's equation for the dilog	Near misses and background threads
MO 25428	What is special about polylogarithms that leads to so many interesting identities and applications?	Near misses and background threads
MO 242920	Polylogarithm sheaves	Near misses and background threads
MO 309945	A remarkable almost-identity	Near misses and background threads

A.2 Polygamma and Hurwitz questions

Thread	Research question	Historical category
MSE 897967	Trigamma identity $4 \psi_1(1/5) + \psi_1(2/5) - \psi_1(1/10) = 4 \pi^2 / (\phi \sqrt{5})$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 4290297	New trigamma identity for $\Psi_1(3/20) + 6 \Psi_1(1/5) + 10 \Psi_1(2/5) - \Psi_1(1/20)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 953976	Prove $\psi^{(1)}(5/6) - \psi^{(1)}(1/6) = 5(\psi^{(1)}(2/3) - \psi^{(1)}(1/3))$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 2802872	Trigamma identity $\psi_1(11/12) - \psi_1(5/12) = 4 \sqrt{3} \pi^2 - 80G$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 3063097	Alternative proof for $\zeta(2, 1/4) = \psi^{(1)}(1/4) = \pi^2 + 8G$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 2952474	Is it possible to simplify $\psi^{(2)}(1/8)$ or $\psi^{(2)}(p/q)$?	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 4040435	General summation formula for $\psi^{(s)}(1/2)$, including negative orders	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 4784920	Closed form for $\psi^{(-2)}(1/4)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 893486	Identity connecting polylogarithm and polygamma functions of arguments $1/4$ and $3/4$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 4504218	Identity relating the polygamma function and the Lerch transcendent	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 3653746	Decomposition of $\psi^{(n)}(1)$ in terms of $\psi^{(n)}(k)$	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1154373	An identity on Polygamma	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 597867	Multiplication formula for the Hurwitz zeta function	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 1335002	An infinite series in polygamma function	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MSE 4441095	Closed form for a derivative limit involving $\psi^{(0)}$ and higher polygamma values at 1	Primary answered matches on Math Stack Exchange
MO 312479	π in terms of polygamma	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 312550	$\psi(2, 1/6)$, $\psi(4, 1/6)$ in terms of zeta and π only	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow

Thread	Research question	Historical category
MO 42696	Connection between Bernoulli polynomials and polygamma function	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 347520	Reference request: sums of rational functions and polygamma functions	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MO 251727	Closed form for sum involving digamma?	Primary answered matches on MathOverflow
MSE 1909595	Interesting connection between polylogarithms and polygamma functions	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MSE 4319642	Simplification of a difficult identity involving the digamma function	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MSE 3555737	Sum involving 2nd antiderivative of the digamma function	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MSE 7183	Connection between Bernoulli polynomials and polygamma function	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MSE 521203	Recurrence relation for polygamma reflection polynomials	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MSE 4845364	Closed form for $\psi(1/k)(1)$, where k is an integer	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MO 152299	Recurrence formula for digamma function with rational number	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MO 372726	Can a digamma generating-function expression be simplified?	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MO 455136	Negativity of a determinant involving trigamma, tetragamma, and pentagamma	Open or no-meaningful-answer leads
MSE 1427206	Conjecture for an integral involving $\psi(1)(1/3)$	Adjacent answered leads
MSE 1346396	Logarithmic Integral I	Adjacent answered leads
MSE 3075324	Improper integral with trigamma identity in the solution path	Adjacent answered leads
MSE 4634827	Closed form for a fractional-part integral	Adjacent answered leads
MSE 2683542	Meaning and definition of $\psi(-2)(x)$	Adjacent answered leads
MSE 5080998	Integral of a trigamma difference at conjugate half-line arguments	Adjacent answered leads
MO 220759	Closed form for $\sum 1/(1+n+\dots+n^a)$	Adjacent answered leads
MO 378665	Closed form of $\sum_{r \geq 2} \zeta(r)/r^2$	Adjacent answered leads

A.3 The provenance boundary

The original drafts retain their snapshot identifiers. The accompanying source inventory records the SHA-256 digest of all thirty-nine textual sources. The editorial ledger maps each source to the merged mathematical development, records which results later drafts supersede, and identifies claims that have been withdrawn or weakened. The old PDFs are source evidence and are superseded as reading artifacts by this manuscript.

The original identity stores, reduction tools, notebook parsers, certificate checker and many high-precision search scripts were not included in the import. A historical receipt in a source report is therefore not a fresh replay here. The new verification scripts exercise representative corrected formulas from independent definitions. Their receipt specifies engine, precision, tolerance and actual residuals; it does not assert a complete replay of every historical experiment.

A.4 A version-specific external consistency check

The final paragraph of §7.2, printed page 16 of the inspected 18-page 2020 preprint [35], displays the untwisted identity

$$\beta_p(n) = \beta_p(n+1) + \beta_p\left(\frac{n}{n+1}\right). \quad (\text{A.1})$$

For its stated exterior-square symbol, this identity is false. Take $p = 7$, $n = 2$. Since $2/3 = 3$ in $\mathbb{F}_7$ and the class of 3 is inverse to that of 2 modulo sign,

$$\beta_7(3) = -\beta_7(2).$$

Equation (A.1) would therefore imply $3\beta_7(2) = 0$. But $2^2 = 4$ is neither 1 nor -1 modulo 7, so Theorem 11.9 proves $\beta_7(2) \neq 0$.

There is also a small exact matrix certificate. In the regular basis of sign classes 1, 2, 3, the image of the defect under the coordinate model $\beta_7(a) \mapsto P_a - P_{a^{-1}}$ is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 3 & -3 \\ -3 & 0 & 3 \\ 3 & -3 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \neq 0. \quad (\text{A.2})$$

Its entries are integers; no numerical logarithm independence test enters this counterexample.

Proposed correction and version scope. Withdraw the untwisted identity as printed, or supply a corrected coefficient action or quotient together with a proof. This article does not guess what a missing action should be. The definition of β and the boundary formula (11.8) remain valid; the latter was independently derived in Section 11.7. The statement was verified against the 18-page author preprint and its 2020 version; the separately published 2023 journal version is not covered by this particular check. The correction is therefore specifically to the inspected 2020 preprint, and must not be attributed to an unchecked version.

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